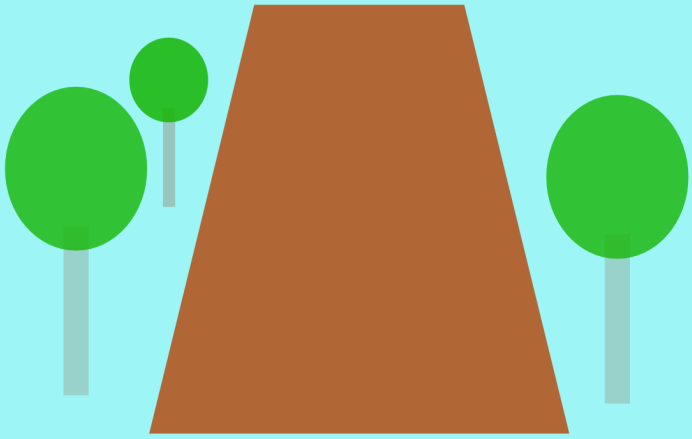
HISTORY OF ODISHA



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HISTORY OF ODISHA (FROM EARLIEST TIMES TO 1434 A.D.)

By

Dr. Manas Kumar Das

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UNIT-1
Chapter-I

SOURCES OF ANCIENT HISTORY OF ODISHA:
Literary Sources, Foreign Accounts, Inscriptions, Coins, Material Remains, Madala Panji

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1.1.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the sources of ancient history of Odisha. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the different sources of ancient history of Odisha*
- *understand the literary sources for the reconstruction of history*
- *know about the foreign accounts as a source of history*
- *identify the inscriptions as sources of ancient history of Odisha*
- *evaluate the value of coins for making history*
- *list the contributions of material remains for the reconstruction of history of Odisha*
- *recognise the place of Madala Panji in the history of Odisha*

1.1.1. Introduction

History writing is not possible without sources because as it plays an important role. History without sources is not history rather it may be considered as a part of literature or anything else. The historical sources provide us the scientific and rational base for writing history. There are many gaps between different periods of ancient Odishan history. with the availability of new source materials, old ideas have been changed and history has been reconstructed with the new facts. Similarly, many missing links have been established in Odishan history due to the discovery of new source materials. Therefore, sources represent the heart and soul of all kinds of history of any state.

1.1.2. Sources of ancient history of Odisha

The history of Odisha is based on various available sources. There are several sources like Literary Sources, Foreign Accounts, Inscriptions, Coins, Material Remains, Madala Panji etc, which helps us in writing the history of Odisha, which can be discussed as follows:

1.1.2.1. Literary sources

The literary sources provide a lot of information for the reconstruction of the history of a nation as literature is considered as the mirror of the society. Numerous literature speaks about the glory of the Odisha in different ways in different periods.

1.1.2.1.1. The epics

The Mahabharata makes the earliest reference to Kalinga and Odra. The Mahabharata mentions about this land and its sacred river Vaitarani and Goddess Viraja. In this epic the sage Lomasa advised the Pandavas to visit to river Vaitarani to take a holy deep in the river and to wash away all their sins. On the other hand, the Ramayana refers to Kalinganagara situated to the west of river Gomati and refers to the Gandhamardana and Utkala associating it with Mekala and

Dasarna countries. Further, different Puranas like Vayu Purana, Mastya Purana, Bhagavata, Harivamsa Purana and Vishnu Purana etc. throw light on Kalinaga and Utkala and legendary kings. The Kapila Samhita and Prachi Mahatmya are also considered as the sources of Odishan history.

1.1.2.1.2. The Jaina sources

The Jaina literature contains descriptions of Kalinga and Utkala. In ancient time the people of Odisha were largely the followers of Jainism and Buddhism. So, the Jaina and Buddhist literature narrates about the people of ancient Odisha and its culture. The *Avasyaka Niryukti* reveals that Aranatha, the eighteenth Jaina Tirthankara had achieved his first goal in the city of Rayapura which was said to be a capital city of Kalinga. Further, it states that how Mahavira, while travelling in Tosali was tortured by the local people who took him to be a thief and he was rescued by the timely interference of the Tosali-Kshatriyas. It also refers to the city of Dantapura. The Jaina *Harivamsa* gives a genealogy of the Chedis describing Abhichandra as the founder of that dynasty in Kosala region.

1.1.2.1.3. The Buddhist sources

The Buddhist literature also contains descriptions of Kalinga and Utkala. The Buddhist literature also reflects the history of ancient Odisha. The Mahagovinda Suttanta of *Digha Nikaya*, mentions 'Kalinga-rattha' *(Kalinga Rashtra)* along with its capital Dantapura. The 'Upalisutta' of *Majjhima Nikaya* describes how king Nalikira of Kalinga breathed his last as a consequence of his ill treatment towards some innocent ascetics. Kalinga and Utkala find mention in *Kurudharma Jataka, vessantara Jataka, Kumbhakara Jataka, Kalinga Bodhi Jataka* etc. *Mahaparinirvana Sutta, Dathavemsa, Dighanikaya* and *Mahavastu* also throw light on Utkala and Kallhga. Jatakas like Kurudharma, Kalinga Bodhi, Sarabhanga, etc. furnish information about Odisha. Majjim Nikaya and Mahabhagga describe the meeting of the two merchants, Tapassu and Bhallika of Utkala with Lord Buddha. A Buddhist work named Gandavyuha describes that Tosala was a prosperous kingdom in Kalinga in 3rd century A.D. The Dipavamsa and Mahavamsa, the two Buddhist works mentions about the friendly relationship between Kalinga and the Ceylon. The Chulavamsa also depicts about the frequent visit of the king of Kalinga to Ceylon.

1.1.2.1.4.Other important ancient literature

The Arthasastra of Kautilya composed in 4th century B.C. is a standard treatise on polity and statecraft which influenced the political organisations of Kalinga. Among other such works mention may be made of the legal texts like the Smritis of Manu, Narada, Brhaspati, Katyayana, Yajnavalkya and Kamandaka which have moulded the political systems of Odisha. On the other hand, the Brihat Samhita of Varahamihira, Astadhyayi of Panini and Kamasutra of Vatsyana also throw welcome light on the socio-religious and economic condition of ancient Odisha.

In the Baudhayana Dharmasastra, the kalinga has been described as an impure country. The Natyasastra of Bharat of depicts Kosala, Tosala and Kalinga as the southern countries. Kalidasa's Raghuvmasam narrates Kalinga and Utkala. Banabhattas's Harshacharita mentions about the king of Kalinga. Harshavardhan's Ratnavali also mentions about Kalinga. Further, the post-Sangam literatures like Silpadikaram and Manimekalai of 2nd century A.D. mentions about Kalinga. Among the real historical works relating ancient Odisha, mention may be made of Gaudavaho by Vakpatiraja (cir. 725 A.D.). This gives an account of the conquests of Yasovarman of Kanauj.

1.1.2.1.5.Literary sources during Ganga period

The Ganga literature are a great source of the time for socio-religious and economic study of Odisha. The Ganga period also saw the development of Sanskrit literature of which reference can be made of Murari's Anargharaghava Natakam which was staged at Puri during a Car festival of Lord Jagannath. Sri Harsha's Naishad Charita Mahakavyam mentions about the cowrie cells as currency prevalent in Odisha during medieval period, chewing of betel by the people of Odisha and Jagannatha's procession from the temple to platform (mancha) on the fullmoon day of Jeyestha. On the other hand, two treaties on astrology 'Bhasvati' and 'Satananda Ratnamala' and a legal text 'Satananda Samgraha' by Satananda Acharya in the latter half of 11th century A.D. throw light on socio-economic aspects. Vidyadhara's Alankar work 'Ekavali" composed in 13th century A.D., describes the encounters of the Ganga Emperor Narasimhadeva with the Sultans of Delhi and Bengal. Visvanatha Kaviraja, the author of the famous 'Sahitya Darpana' has written 'Chandrakala Nataka' which hints at the military victories of his patron Gajapati Nisanka Bhanudeva or Bhanu IV (1407-37 A.D.) against the Sultan of Bengal. The Chandrakala Natika is a great work during the Ganga rule. One of the masterpieces in Vaishnava literature during the Ganga period was the marvelous work of Jayadeva's Gitagovindam.

Thus, the ancient literature gives a wide range of knowledge regarding the social, political, economic, religious and cultural life of the people of ancient Odisha.

1.1.2.2. Foreign Accounts

The foreign accounts also give a good account of knowledge on ancient Kalinga. The Greek historians like Pilny, Diodorus, Curtius, Plutarch have mentioned about the people of Kalinga. Megasthenes refers to Gangaridum Calingarum Regia (Gangetic Kalinga Region). Pliny divides Kalinga into three divisions-Gangarides (Gangetic), Maceo (Middle) and Calingae (Kalinga). "The Peri plus of the Erythrean sea" by an anonymous Greek sailor also gives some information about Kalinga. Ptolemy, the Greek geographer (2nd century A.D.) gives an account of the ports of Kalinga. His indication to a people called 'Oretes' living near the mount 'Maleus' is significant because the former is identified with Odras whereas the latter with the Malaya mountain.

The most valuable of the foreign accounts is that of the Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang who visited Odisha in 638-39 AD. His writings have been made available to us as 'On Yuan Chwang's Travels' by T. Watters, 'Life of Hiuen Tsang' by Hwuie and 'Records of the Buddhist World'. These are invaluable sources of authentic information. Another Chinese traveller l-Tsing's 'Records of the Buddhistic Religions as practised in India and the Malay Archipelago' is also of significant help. Gerini's 'Researches on Ptolemy' and Tibetan historian Lama Taranath's history provide valuable information regarding ancient period of Odisha. .

1.1.2.3. Inscriptions

Inscriptions play a very important part in shaping the history of Odisha. We find the place-names, territorial boundaries, religion, administrative units, grant of lands as well as the social and economic condition of the people Odisha from inscriptions which were very useful in reconstructing the political, social, economic and religious history of Odisha.

1.1.2.3.1. Inscriptions in different forms

We find the inscriptions in different forms and at different places of Odisha. The pictographs project the earliest examples of inscriptions in Odisha. Pictographs are found in several rock shelters in the hills of Sundargarh, Sarnbalpur and Kalahandi districts. Some classic examples of such writings are the Vikramkhol, Yogimath and Gudahandi rock art sites. The inscriptions and signs in these shelters have not been properly deciphered. In spite of that these

earliest signs and pictographs had expressed the idea of men who were living in Odisha in pre-historic period. Not only on cave walls, inscriptions in Odisha are largely engraved on copper plates stone pieces and temple walls. Two sets of Asokan stone edicts (separate Kalinga edicts found at Dhauli and Jaugada are the earliest epigraphs in the pre-Christian era which throw light on the administrative arrangement of Asoka in Kalinga. The Hatigumpha inscription of Kharavela is the first of its kind in the entire country that throws light on the achievements of Kharavela for the long thirteen years of his rule ceaselessly. Written in Brahmi script and prakrit language, the inscription has allured the attention of scholars from different parts of the country for its uniqueness.

1.1.2.3.2.Inscriptions in Sanskrit language

On the other hand, the Sanskrit language was used largely in other inscriptions. The Bhadra inscription of Maharaja Gana (3rd century A.D.), the Allahabad inscription of Samudragupta (4th cenury *AD.)*, the Asanapat stone inscription of Satrubhanja (4th century A.D.), the Ningond grant of Mathara ruler Prabhanjanavarman (5th century A.D.), the Rithapur grant of Nala ruler Nandivardhana (5th century A.D.), the Narla grant of Parvatavaraka ruler Nandaraja and Terasingha charter of Tustikara of the same dynasty (both the inscriptions belonging to 5th century A D.), the Jirjingi charter of the Eastern Ganga ruler Indravar the I(urud charter of Sarbhapuriya rulers Narendra (6th century A.D) and the Khariar charter of Sudevaraja-l (7th century A.D.) are the inscriptions which throw good deal of early history of this land. Similarly, the inscriptions found from Kanasa, Sumandala, Tekhali, Ganjam etc. depict the achievements of Sailodbhava rulers.

1.1.2.3.3.The inscriptions of the Bhaumakaras

The inscriptions of the Bhaumakaras provides a great deal of knowledge for the reconstruction of the history of Odisha. It is because the rule of the Bhauma-Karas (8th-9th century A.D.) forms glorious epoch in the annals of Odishan history. The Talcher copper plate of Sivakaradeva-I, the Hindol copper plate of Subhakaradeva-I, the Terundia copper plate of Subhakaradeva-l , the Dhenkanal copper plate of Tribhubana Mahadevi-I and several other Bhauma copper plates throw a good deal of light on the territorial expansion with Bhaumas, their administration, religion, grant of land to others etc.

1.1.2.3.4.The inscriptions of the Somavamsi rulers

We get the idea of territorial expansion, division of state, administration, religion etc. from the inscriptions of the Somavamsis who ruled from 9th to 11 th century A.D. The Bonda copper plate of Tivaradeva, Adhavara copper plate of Mahanannararaja, the Patna, Kalibhana and other inscriptions of Janamejaya, the Cuttack, Nibinna and Patna copper plates and the Kalanjar and Sirpur stone inscriptions of Yayati-I and several other inscriptions give information about the-Sornavamsi rule.

1.1.2.3.5.Other important inscriptions

The four hundred years glorious rule of the Gangas brought stabilization in Odishan politics. The Korni, Nagari, Draksharam, Chinnabadamu, Simhachalam, Choudwar and many other inscription acquaint the scholars with the achievement of Ganga rulers. Similarly Lingaraj temple inscription, Velagalani, Srisailam, Velicherla, Simhachalam and other inscriptions explain the achievements of the Gajapati rulers.

Thus, inscriptions form a major source of information for the reconstruction of the history of Odisha. In fact, in the majority of cases, these are the, only source of information to reconstruct history. Their merit lies in the fact that they are authentic government records issued under the seal and the authority of kings and, are not subject to any change through interpolation, exaggeration or distortion. It is rightly said that original contribution on Odishan historiography is not possible without epigraphy.

1.1.2.4. Coins

Coins play a vital role in the making of the history of a nation. The study of coins is known as Numismatics. Coins help in reconstructing the economic life of the people, trade and commerce, religion, metallurgy etc. Coins in Odisha can be grouped as punch-marked coins, the Puri-Kushana coins, Gupta gold coins, Nala and Sarbhapuriya coins, Srinanda, Kalachuri and Nagas, the Ganga fanams and probable Gajapati Pagoda.

1.1.2.4.1. The punch-marked coins

The earliest coins available in Odisha are punch-marked coins which were in circulation between 4th century B.C. to 4th century A.D. These coins were profusely available in coastal eastern parts of Odisha. These coins were made of silver and copper and were irregular in shape and size. These coins bore the punch marks of sun, animals, birds, trees, human, geometrical designs etc. These coins could very well give a picture of ancient economy of Odisha.

1.1.2.4. 2.The Puri-Kushana coins

The Kushana coins and their imitations known as Puri-Kushana coins have been found in large numbers being scattered at different parts of Odisha from Mayurbhanj to Ganjam. These coins were in circulation in Odisha for around the first three centuries of Christian era.

1.1.2.4.3. The Gupta coins

The occupation some parts of Odisha by Samudragupta brought Odisha in touch with the Gupta empire. The Gupta archer-type gold coins have been found at Bhanapur, Khiching and Angul. These coins give an idea that trade and commerce of Odisha existed definitely with the Gupta empire.

1.1.2.4.4. The Nala coins of the western region of Odisha

The Nala coins of the western region of Odisha threw light on the Nala rule in South Kosala of 5th-6th century AD. The peculiarity of these Nala coins is that the reverse is found blank and the obverse contains a humped bull with crescent with the name of the king in box headed script. The Nala coins have led to the reconstruction of the history of the Nalas. Even now the coins of Nalas are being discovered regularly.

1.1.2.4.5. Other important coins of Odisha

Besides the above coins we have found many other coins which have shaped the history of Odisha. The Gold coins of the Sarbhapuriyas have helped a lot for the reconstruction of the history of that dynasty. The coins of Prasannamatra, Mahendraditya and Kramaditya help a lot in the reconstruction the genealogy and chronology of that dynasty. The findings of these coins from Chatishgarh, western parts of Odisha and Cuttack suggests that there was a trade link between Chhatisgarh and Cuttack via western parts of Odisha. The Srinanda coins have been found from Soro. He as a ruling chief of Chhatisgarh region i e 6th century AD.

A Somavamsi gold coin (9th to 11th century AD.) consisting of the image of Gaja-Laxmi have been found from Junagarh. The Kalachuris of the Western Odisha (10th-14th century AD.) issued varieties of coins in gold, silver and copper coins. These coins have been found from Sonepur, Khurda and Jonk river valley describe about Ratnadeva, Prithvideva and Gangeyadeva. The gold coins of Chhindika Nagas (Bastar-Koraput region) also issued gold coins. From their coins it is known that they ruled over Sonepur in 12th century AD. Further, the discovery of *Padmatankas* (coins bearing lotus having eight petals a he centre) has opened new

dimension to Odishan numismatics. These coins belong to the Jadavas of Devagiri. However, their rule in Odisha is doubtful.

With the coming of the Ganga rulers, Odishan coins took a new turn. The small gold coins known as fanams were issued by the Ganga kings. Those fanams are found from Angul, Cuttack and Sonepur. These coins bear South Indian influence. Some gold coins have been found in Karnataka. Those coins are also known as Gajapati Pagoda. These coins were in circulation between 13th-15th century AD. It is really difficult to assign these coins to the Suryvamsi Gajapati rulers. However, the coins have helped a lot in reconstructing the history of Odisha.

1.1.2.5. Material Remains

The material remains provide a wide range of knowledge on the ancient history of Odisha.

1.1.2.5.1. Knowledge of pre-history from material remains

Valentine Bali's exploration in 1875 at Angul, Talcher, Dhenkanal and Bursapalli exposed the pre-historic sites of Odisha. Paramananda Acharya of Mayurbhanj and C. Worman of Harvard University had discovered the famous paleolithic site at Kulina. R.P. Chanda's works on Mayurbhanj and G.C. Mahapatra's location of extensive paleolithic sites in Central and Northern Odisha are great contributions to early history of Odisha. The discovery of Asokan rock art at Dhauli and his edicts at Dhauli and Jaugada threw significant light on Kalingan history of third century B.C. Jaugada was another fortified city which served the purpose of Asoka's administration.

1.1.2.5.2. Sources of information through excavations by ASI and others

In 1949 a new chapter opened in the history of Odisha with the excavation at Sisupalgarh conducted by B.B. Lal. A fort with impressive gateways led historians to identify it with Kalinganagari which is assumed as the capital city of Kharavela. The art and architecture of Khandagiri and Udayagiri added another source to the history of ancient Odisha. Further, the site of Sisupalgarh has been excavated several times by R.K. Moanty and Monica L. Smith discovering the material remains which gives us a good idea on the socio-economic life of the people of the then Odisha. The excavation at Manikpatna and Golbai speaks about the maritime activities of the people of Odisha and also mentions about the social and economic life of the people. The recent excavations at Harirajpur and other places by K.K. Basa has revealed many unexplored aspects of ancient history of Odisha.

1.1.2.5.3. Excavations of Ratnagiri, Udayagiri and Lalitgiri

Devala Mitra's major excavation conducted at Ratnagiri brought to lime light the imposing Buddhist monasteries and stupas with famous *Nagabandha.* It flourished between 5th-13th century A.D. as a centre of Buddhist religion, art and architecture. Two other Buddhist sites at Udayagiri and Lalitgiri near Ratnagiri project the remains of Buddhist and Hindu religion. Sri Madhavapura Mahavihara and Simhaprastha Mahavihara which flourished between 7th- 8th century A.D. was located at Udayagiri. Lalitgiri is a famous site that contains Buddhist stupas, monasteries, images of Buddha, three Buddhist relics and images of Brahmanic divinities. Ratnagiri, Udayagiri and Lalitgiri also yielded archaeological remains relating to Brahmanic religion, pottery, terracotta plaques, iron implements, figurines of animals and mother goddess. These three sites are also known as the 'Diamond Triangle' of Odishan history and archaeology. All the three sites contained large number of material remains like pottery, terracotta plaques, iron implements, articles of household, figurines of mother goddesses and animals which gives an idea of the dominance of Buddhism in that region.

1.1.2.5.4. Material remains of Western Odisha

The material remains have also played an important part in revealing the history of Western Odisha. The temple-complex at Ranipur Jhanal in Bo1angr contains several temples. The most important of them are the 64-Yogini temple and Somesvara Siva temple. The site developed around 7th-8th century A.D. The material remains through excavations at Boudh, Maraguda(also known as Jonk) valley, Sonepur, Amathgarh, Kharligarh, Manikgarh etc. have thrown a good deal of light on the history of Western Odisha. Partial excavations in some of them have brought to light structures and icons which are assigned to the time of the Nalas (Cir. 350-500 A.D.) and the Sarabhapuriyas (Cir. 500-700 A.D.). The site of Podagarh (Navarangpur district), the capital town Puskari of the Nalas also contains a good amount of relics scattered over a wide area.

1.1.2.5.5. Material remains of southern and the south-western parts of Odisha

The southern and the south-western parts of Odisha have projected a few specimens of *Pidha* or *Bhadra deulas* (temples). The Gokarnesvara group on Mahendra mountain in the Gajapati district and the Nilakantthesvara group on the Jagamunda hill in Rayagada district are the best examples Of this kind. The existence of Sundara Mahadeva on the bank of river

Rusikulya has given opportunity to study the origin of this cult that developed during Purusottamadeva of Gajapati dynasty.

On the other hand, the temples of Odisha also provide sources of information for the reconstruction of history of Odisha. The typical Odishan style, the Sikhara or rekha (curvilinear) also known as Kalingan style of architecture developed in 6th_7th century A.D. in Bhubaneswar. The Laxmanesvara, Bharatesvara and Satrughnesvara group of temples marked the early phase of temple architecture in Odisha. The Parsuramesvara group is a transition to the ornate Muktesvara which later on developed in Lingaraja, Jagannatha and Konarka. The Lingaraj, Jagannath, and Konarka marked the perfection of Kalingan style of architecture. The Black Pagoda marked the perfect stage of temple architecture as well as iconography in Odisha in comparison to the other temples of Odisha. These temples along with other temples like Ganesh temple at Panchama, Biranchi-Narayan temple at Palia, Samalesvari temple at Sambalpur etc throw light on Saivism, Vaishnavaism, Saktism, Ganapatya Cult, Sun worship etc. Thus, the material remains have been adequately used for the reconstruction of the history of ancient Odisha.

1.1.2.6. Madalapanji

Madala Panji is the temple chronicle of Lord Jagannath of Puri. It describes the historical events of Odisha related to Lord Jagannath or Jagannath Temple. Though the actual date of starting of Panjis is not known, but it is believed that it might be started from 12th or the 14th century AD. The book is a classic and literary master piece of the Oriya language first order, parallel to which very few vernacular of India possess. It can be compared with Rajvansham of Sri Lanka, Rajtarangini of Kashmir or Burunji of Assam. The earliest use of prose can be found in the Madala Panji or the Palm-leaf Chronicles of the Jagannatha temple at Puri, which date back to the 12th century.

1.1.2.6. 1.Role of Madalapanji in the history of Odisha

Madalapanji has played an important role in shaping the history of Odisha by some historians. While writing Oriya history, historians like Sir W.W.Hunter and Andrew Stirling considered the facts related in Madala Panji as base. The Madala Panji was traditionally written on a year-to-year basis. On Vijaya-Dashami day, the Karanas (official history writers of Puri, a

caste of Odisha, involved in keeping the chronicle. This ritual is cited as a proof that the tradition of keeping this chronicle began with Oriya king Anantavarman Chodaganga Dev himself. It is said that the Madalapanji was destroyed by the Muslim invaders including the so called Kalapahara, but it was rewritten in a fashion that mixed legend with history. However, some historians never consider Madalapanji as a source for writing the history of Odisha as they claim that it is just a writing based on eulogy.

Therefore, the Madalapanji, the temple-chronicle of Jagannath temple of Puri, preserves a number of traditions relating to the Kesaris (Somavamsis), the Imperial Gangas, the Suryavamsi Gajapatis and the Bhois of Khurdha. This is so called because the palm-leaf records are tied in big round bundles resembling the Indian drum (Madala). Although it is considered by some historians as, "nothing more than a farrago of legends," some others consider it to possess . "some historical substratum". Besides, all classes of records relating to Jagannath temple, it contains historical information, some of which, particularly of the Ganga-Gajapati-Bhoi times, throw light on the history. Its Sanskrit and Telugu versions are also available under the titles of "Katakarajavamsavali" and "Jagannatham.Kaifiyat".

1.1.3. Conclusion

Thus, the above sources help a lot in the reconstruction of the history of Odisha. We have ample sources to write the history of Odisha. The history of Odisha will be enriched with the discovery of new inscriptions, coins and archaeological remains etc and the history of Odisha will find a new dimension.

1.1.4. Summary

- The history of Odisha is based on various available sources.
- There are several sources like Literary Sources, Foreign Accounts, Inscriptions, Coins, Material Remains, Madala Panji etc, which helps us in writing the history of Odisha.
- The literary sources provides a lot of information for the reconstruction of the history of a nation as literature is considered as the mirror of the society.
- The Mahabharata makes the earliest reference to Kalinga and Odra.
- The Jaina literature contain descriptions of Kalinga and Utkala.
- The Buddhist literature also reflects the history of ancient Odisha.

- Among the literary works, mention may be made of the legal texts like the Smritis of Manu, Narada, Brhaspati, Katyayana, Yajnavalkya and Kamandaka which have moulded the political systems of Odisha.
- The foreign accounts also give a good account of knowledge on ancient Kalinga.
- The most valuable of the foreign accounts is that of the Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang who visited Odisha in 638-39 AD.
- Inscriptions play a very important part in shaping the history of Odisha.
- We find the inscriptions in different forms and at different places of Odisha.
- Coins help in reconstructing the economic life of the people, trade and commerce, religion, metallurgy etc.
- Coins in Odisha can be grouped as punch-marked coins, the Puri-Kushana coins, Gupta gold coins, Nala and Sarbhapuriya coins, Srinanda, Kalachuri and Nagas, the Ganga fanams and probable Gajapati Pagoda.
- The material remains provide a wide range of knowledge on the ancient history of Odisha.
- Madalapanji has played an important role in shaping the history of Odisha by some historians.
- The history of Odisha will be enriched with the discovery of new inscriptions, coins and archaeological remains etc and the history of Odisha will find a new dimension.

1.1.5. Exercise

- **Write a note on the sources of ancient history of Odisha.**
- **Make an analysis on the literary sources of Odisha history.**
- **Explain the role of foreign accounts in shaping the history of ancient Odisha.**
- **Discuss the role of inscriptions in the reconstruction of history of Odisha.**
- **Describe the contribution of the coins for making the history of Odisha.**
- **Discuss how material remains help us in writing the history.**
- **High light the contribution of Madala Panji to the ancient history of Odisha.**

1.1.6. Further Reading

- RD. Banerjee, *History of Odisha,* Vol. I, 1930
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- N.K. Sahu, *Utkal University History of Odisha,* Vol. I, 1964
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UNIT-1
Chapter-II

HISTORICAL GEOGRAPHY:
Kalinga, Utkala, Odra, Tosali, Kangoda and Kosala

Structure

1.2.0. Objectives

1.2.1. Introduction

1.2.2. Historical geography

1.2.3. Kalinga

1.2.4. Utkala

1.2.5. Odra

1.2.6. Tosali

1.2.7. Kangoda

1.2.8. Kosala

1.2.9. Conclusion

1.2.10. Summary

1.2.11. Exercise

1.2.12. Further Reading

1.2.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Historical Geography of Odisha. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the historical geography of ancient Odisha*
- *understand the boundary of Kalinga*
- *know about the extent of Utkala*
- *identify the history of Odra*
- *evaluate the importance of Tosali in ancient history of Odisha*
- *list the contributions of Kangoda for the reconstruction of history of Odisha*
- *recognise the place of Kosala in the history of Odisha*

1.2.1. Introduction

In order to make a scientific study on the history of any land, a broad and thorough knowledge of its geography is essential. It will be certainly not easy on the part of a historian to look into the course of events unless he possesses accurate information about the precise location of various places that figure significantly in the narrative. On the other hand, no historian of a state can overlook the immense influence of its physical features that play a vital role in shaping the character of its people and their socioeconomic and political condition of a state.

1.2.2.Historical geography

The Geographical importance of places in relation to historical significance brings forward the concept of 'historical geography'. Historical geography essentially aims at the reconstruction of geography of a region of a period which has already passed. By putting together pieces of scattered evidence, all aspects of geography of that period can be reconstructed. In this context, the historical geography of ancient Odisha deserves special attention. The region now known as Odisha, was known in ancient times under various names, the most prominent of which were *Kalinga, Utkala, Odra, Tosali , Kangoda* and *Kosala.* To have an idea about the ancient geography of Odisha it is necessary to have an idea about the antiquity and extent of main ancient geographical units. Each of them during its historical existence found mention in different sources which provide interesting accounts about it. The ancient geographical units can be discussed as follows:

1.2.3. Kalinga

Among the different political units of this ancient land, Kalinga occupied a prominent place. The fertile coastal plains stretching from the mouth of the river Ganges up to Godavari, with mountains and forests, gave a natural boundary to Kalinga. The name Kalinga occurs in the

Puranas in association with Anga, Vanga, Pundra and Sumha. In the *Mahabharata* there is an indication about the location and the extent of Kalinga. In the *Vana Parva* the sage Lomasa pointed out, "This is the country of the Kalingas where flows the river Vaitarani." This evidence clearly indicates that the land now known as Odisha was included in the Kalinga country, but its extent in the *Mahabharata* age cannot be determined. The epic account also finds substantiation in the works of early Greek writers. In the description of Megasthenes, the river Ganges forms the eastern boundary of Kalinga. Pliny divides Kalinga into three parts *Viz- Gangarides Calingae, Maceo Calingae and Calingae.* Its southern boundary, as per Pliny's description, is limited on the bank of the river Godavari basing upon the puranas like *Matsya, Kurma* and *Skanda,* the western frontier of Kalinga is supposed to have stretched upon the Amrakantaka hills on the river bank of Narmada. Thus, as per the Puranic tradition, Kalinga is said to have extended up to the Gangetic valley in the north, the Godavari in the south, the sea in the east and the Amrakantaka hills in the west.

In the list of the sixteen *Mahajanapadas* of the sixth century B. C., described in the Pali literature Kalinga does not appear as one, but this omission does not mean that, Kalinga did not exist as a *Mahajanapada* or a great state. In the fourth century B. C., Kalinga was under the suzerainty of the Nandas. In the third century B. C. during the period between the Nandas and Mauryas, it slipped away from the fold of Magadhan imperialism. With Ashok's Kalinga war of 261 B. C., it came again under the authority of Magadha. His Special Edicts (also known as Kalinga Edicts) at Dhauli near Bhubaneswar, are addressed to the *Mahamatras* and the *Kumaramatya* (prince viceroy) of Toshali, while his same edicts at Jaugada in the Ganjam district are addressed to only the *Mahamatras* of Samapa. From these two inscriptions of Asoka now to be found in Odisha, it becomes apparent that for the sake of administration he had divided the Kalinga country into two broad divisions, northern and southern. In the northern division the capital Tosali was situated, while Samapa formed the second capital in the southern division. The evidence furnished by Asoka's Inscription thus clearly proves that Kalinga in his time included the entire region now known as Odisha, though its northern and southern boundaries cannot exactly be determined. It seems, however, that its southern boundary extended up to the river Godavari. The northern limits of Kalinga of Asoka's time cannot be determined.

During the second century B.C. the present state of Odisha was certainly known as Kalinga as is evident by the fact that in the Hatigumpha Inscription at Udayagiri near

Bhubaneswar, Kharavela is described as *Kalingadhipati*. During his reign, Kalinga expanded into an empire, the extent of which is variously determined by scholars. We do not know when his empire became dismembered, but even after the fall of his empire the land of Odisha continued to be called Kalinga. By the fourth century A.D. when Kalidasa wrote his *Raghuvamsam,* Kalinga seems to have been divided into two regions, of which the northern region was known as Utkala. In the fourth stanza of his work it is stated that the people of Utkala showed Raghu the path to Kalinga. In the Allahabad Inscription of Samudragupta, it is stated that during his southern campaigns Samudragupta conquered Kottura, Pishtapura, Erandapalli and Devarashtra, which have been identified with Kothoor in the Ganjam district, Pithapuram in the Godavari district, Erandapalli and Yellamachilli in the Visakhapatanam district respectively. In one of the earliest copper plate records of Odisha, known as Sumandala Copper Plates of Prithvivigraha, Kalinga as a *rashtra (kingdom*) has found mention, but in the subsequent medieval epigraphic records the name Kalinga does not appear. This does not, however, mean that Kalinga as a geographical name became extinct. It continued to be applied to the territory between Ganjam and the river Godavari in the subsequent ages down to the Ganga and Suryavamsi periods.

Dantapura, one of the early capitals of Kalinga, has not been identified. Various suggestions made by scholars about its location and its identity still remains to be confirmed by archaeological evidences. Kalinganagara which was capital of Kharavela, has tentatively been identified with Sisupalagarh near Bhubaneswar. The Early Eastern Gangas established their capital at a place which was also known as Kalinganagara and it has been identified with Mukhalingam in the Srikakulam district by Mr. R. Subbarao, though there are also other suggestions for its identification. Kalinganagara ceased to be the capital of the Gangas when Chodaganga conquered Odisha about A.D. 1110 and he chose Kataka (Cuttack), more centrally situated in his extended kingdom, as his new capital.

1.2.4.Utkala

The territory of Utkala has been narrated in various Puranas. Utkala appears in the *Mahabharata* in association with the countries of Odras, Mekala, Kalinga,Darsana and Andhras. Tradition associates the origin of Utkala which Vaivasvata Manu who finds mention among the kings of India. It is said that Ila-Sudyumna, of the ten sons of Manu, who became male and female alternatively, gave birth to Utkala, Gaya,Vinitasva and Puru. He distributed the portion of

his territory received from Manu among his sons and the land which came under the sway of Utkala was known as Utkala. This geographical name has also found mention in the *Ramayana* and is considered by some scholars to be older than Kalinga. Utkala has found mention in Kalidasa's *Raghuvamsam* as a neighbouring kingdom of Kalinga. The earliest epigraphic evidence of the extent of Utkala is gleaned from the Midnapur Plates of Somadatta, a feudatory of Sasanka. The name Utkala is not found thereafter in epigraphic records for a long time. Towards the final quarter of the seventh century A.D., the name Utkala appears in Adhabhara plates of Mahanannararaja of *Sasivamsa* which includes Utkala in the early Somavamsi Kindgom of Kosala. This geographical name also occurs in the copper plate grants up to the times of the Gangas of Odisha and Palas of Bengal. During the reigns of Ramapala of the Pala dynasty and Chodaganga of the Ganga dynasty the whole territory now known as Odisha appears to have been designated as Utkala. From the records of these kings it appears that Karnadeva, the last Somavamsi king, was driven out from his throne by Jayasimha, a lieutenant of Ramapala, but he was reinstated by Chodaganga. Even now the name Utkala is applied to the whole of Odisha. The earliest capital of Utkala was *Viraja* as is evidenced by the Soro Copper Plates. This place has been identified with Jajpur where the shrine of Viraja still exists. Viraja has also been mentioned in the Bhauma copper plate grants. Guhadeva Pataka or Gudhesvara Pataka, mentioned as the capital of the Bhaumas, was situated in its immediate neighbourhood.

1.2.5.Odra

The present name of Odisha has been derived from the name Odra or Udra or Odraka. It appears as Urshin or Ursfin in the accounts of the Muslim geographers of the ninth and tenth century A.D. These geographers, who apparently collected information during the rule of the Bhauma-Karas in Odisha, give the divisions of the Bhauma kingdom as Urshin or Ursfin, Myas, Harkhand and Andras which have been identified with Odisha proper, Mahishya or Midnapore, Jharkhand (the hilly tracts of Odisha) and Andhra. Thus, the name Odisha appears to have existed as early as the tenth century A.D. if not earlier. The Tibetan historian Taranatha refers to Odisha as Odivisa which is apparently a Tibetan corruption of Odisa. In the later Muslim accounts and in the early Oriya literature the name Odisha finds frequent mention.

The geographical unit of Odra has found mention in different ancient texts. The Pali texts make repeated mention of *Oddaka* and the Greek writers refer to *Oretes* which can be equated with Odra, mentioned in various Sanskrit texts. The *Bhagabata Purana* mentions Odra, among

the six sons of Dirghatamas by queen Sudesna, after whom the land had been named. Pliny placed *Oretes* near mountain *Malus* which can be identified with Malayagiri near Pallahara in the pesent Angul district. Odra has also found mention in the *Manusamhita* where it is associated with the Paundrakas, Dravidas, Kambojas, Yavanas, Sakas, Paradas, Palavas, Chinas, Kiratas, Daradas and Khasas. The earliest epigraphic records in which this geographical name appears as a *Visaya* or district, are the Soro Copper Plates of Somadatta from which it becomes apparent that it was a part of Uttara Tosali. Yuan Chwang mentions Odra or *Wvcha* not as a district, but as a kingdom, 7000 *li* in circuit. From this description it appears that it was a big kingdom occupying the coastal strip up to the Puri district from which the kingdom of Kongoda began. In his accounts of Odra Yuan Chwang mention two important places, *Che-li-ta-lo* and *Pue-sie-po-ki-li,* of which the later place has been satisfactorily transcribed as Puspagiri. Recently some scholars have identified the 'Dimond Triangle' i.e. the Buddhist monasteries at Ratnagiri, Udaygiri and Lalitgiri as the probable site of Puspagiri. However, much research is needed for the exact location of Puspagiri. In the inscriptions of the Somavamsis and other contemporary dynasties Odra as a kingdom has also found frequent reference.

1.2.6.Tosali

Tosala or Tosali formed an important political unit in ancient Odisha. It has been described frequently in ancient Indian texts. It is mentioned in the 'Parisistha' of *Atharva Veda* along with Kosala and the Puranas have associated the people of this territory with Kotalas, Nisadas, Traipuras, Tumuras, Valdisas etc. The Jaina text *Avasyaka Niryukti* mentions about this land as follows: "Lord Mahavira, in the eleventh year of his monkship, came to Tosali where he was taken to be a robber and hit hard. From here, the venerable teacher went to Masoli, where too he was taken to be a robber, was arrested and brought to the king's court, but was released as the king was a friend of Mahavir's father. On his return jurney from Masoli Mahavira again came to Tosali. Here, again, he was caused great troubles and was on the point of being hanged when he was rescued through the timely interference of the Tosali-Kshatriyas.

In Asoka's inscription at Dhauli, Tosali has found mention as a city which has been identified by some scholars with modern Sisupalagarh, but Tosali or Tosala as the name of a territory also occurs in the subsequent literature and epigraphic records. In the *Gandavyuha,* a part of the Buddhist *Avatamsaka,* there is the mention of a country named Amita Tosala, the chief city of which was Tosala. Tosali as a territory has found mention in the copper plate

records of Sambhuyasa and Lokavigraha and it also occurs in the Bhauma copper plate grants. From these references it appears that Tosali was divided into two parts, northern and southern. With regard to the extent of these divisions. N. K. Sahu observes that “the extent of the territories of both the Tosalis can be tentatively known from the Soro, Patiakela, Midnapore and Kanasa Copper Plates. The modern Midnapore, Mayurbhanj and Balasore districts as well as the northern part of the Kataka (Cuttack) district may be said to have formed the kingdom of Uttara Tosali, while Daksina Tosali comprised roughly the modern Puri district and parts of Cuttack and Ganjam districts upto the river Rishikulya and the river Mahanadi appears to be the dividing line between the two territories.”

1.2.7.Kangoda

Kangoda was another geographical unit of ancient Odisha. It was during the Sailodbhava dynasty, Kongoda came into eminence. Kongoda may be explained as the “Land of Honey” as *Kongu* in Tamil means honey. This was a *Mandala* state and flourished in the sixth-seventh century A.D. It continued as parts of Kalinga and Odra. The Sailodbhavas gave this Kongoda *Mandala* (undivided Ganjam district) its true shape. The Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang who visited Kongoda about 638 A. D. states that this country was above 1000 *Ii* in circuit. The country contained some tens of towns from the slope of the hills to the edge of the sea". Accordingly, it is presumed that it was about 200 miles in circumference and it was a hilly country bordering on the Bay of Bengal. By the time of Hiuen Tsang's visit, Kongoda had emerged as a powerful kingdom under the Sailodbhavas.

On Hiuen Tsang's observation, T. Watters write that "As the towns are naturally strong, there was a gallant army which kept the neighbouring country in awe, and so there was no enemy." The towns referred to in the Hiuen Tsang's accounts are Gudda, Kondenda, Saumyapura, Matrachandra-pataka, Jaya Kataka, Devagrama, Nivina and Phasika. These towns have not been satisfactorily identified. Vijaya Kongodvasaka appears to be the capital of Kongoda *mandala* which has been identified with modern Bankada in the light of the antiquities found there on the river bank of Salia. Harsavardhan, after the death of King Sasanka of Gauda subjugated Kongoda. R. S. Tripathi observes that "Harsa made this region a strong military outpost of his far-flung empire, probably with a view to preventing any foreign incursion on the borders, threatened as they were by the eastward advance of Pulakesin II". With the death of

Harsa in 647 A.D. Madhavaraja II, the Sailodbhava King of Kongoda maintained his power and ruled for a long time which is revealed by his Cuttack charter.

Thus, Kongoda got back her independence shortly after the death of Harsavardhan. With the fall of the Sailodbhavas, in the first half of the eighth century A.D., Kongoda *mandala* lost its glory. Subsequently, it was reduced to a *Visaya* (district) of Dakshina Tosali when the Bhauma-Karas emerged as a dominant political power and united both the Tosalis i.e. North Tosali and South Tosali.

1.2.8. Kosala

Kosala as a geographical unit was existed in ancient Odisha. The earliest depiction of Kosala is found in the Parisistha of the Atharvaveda. The Epics and the Puranas also throw light on its ancient history. It was named after- like Kalinga, Utkala and Odra - an ancient people called Kosalas. The kingdom of Kosala was divided into two units- Uttara (north) and Daksina (south) from very early time. The territory of Kosala is attributed to a mythical origin. Rama, the Prince of Kosala, being banished with his brother Laxmana and his wife Sita travelled south from Ayodhya to Prayaga. Travelling south-west up to Narmada valley, he came up to a place identified with modern Chhatisgarh area. He dwelt there for at least a decade. Pargiter opines that his long stay in that region gave rise to the name Dakshina Kosala (South Kosala), after his original homeland Kosala. The *Ramayana* projects the fact that after Rama, the kingdom of Kosala was divided between his two sons-Lava and Kusa holding sway over North Kosala and South Kosala respectively. Sravasti was the centre of political activities for North Kosala while Kusavati or Kusthalipura, near the Vindhyas, was regarded as the citadel of political power for Southern Kosala.

Kosala also finds mention in the "Vana Parva' of the *Mahabharata.* Of course, the great epic remains silent about Uttara Kosala (North Kosala) which comprised the Ayodhya region. However, H. C. Raychaudhuri locates Dakshina Kosala in the territory comprising the modern districts of Bilaspur, Raipur and undivided Sambalpur. The Allahabad pillar inscription of Harisena includes Kosala among the territories of *Dakshinapatha* which were subjugated by Samudragupta. Kosala along with Mekala and Malava formed the empire of the Vakatakas and after their fall, it came under the grip of the Sarbapuriyas. Hiuen Tsang who visited Kosala in 639 A D. described the kingdom as *6000 li* in circuit. As per the description, it may be presumed that Kosala comprised the districts of Bilaspur and Raipur in Madhya Pradesh along with the

undivided districts of Sundargarh, Sambalpur and Bolangir in Odisha. Kosala remained under the Somavamsis in the eighth-ninth century A.D. At about the middle of the ninth century A.D. when Kalachuris of Dahala became a rival power of the Somavamsis, the latter had to shift the centre of their political activities to Sripura which was captured by the Kalachuris subsequently. Then, the Somavamsis had to shift their head quarters to various places like Murasimakataka, Arama and Vinitapura identified with Murshing, Rampur and Binaka respectively, all in the Bolangir district.

With the annexation of Khinjali mandala, Yajatinagara became the capital of Kosala. The formidable Somavamsi king Yajati II brought Kosala and Utkala under one umbrella about the middle of the eleventh century A. D., making Suvarnapura (at the confluence Mahanadi and Tel) the capital of Kosala and Yajatinagar, (Viraja in Jajpur) the capital of Utkala. When the Somavamsi power declined away, the Telugu Chodas occupied Kosala towards the close of the eleventh century A.D. They were subsequently driven away by the Kalachuris who established their sway over the region for a long time till the Gangas established their authority over this region and their rule continued till the middle of fourteenth century A.D. Outsting them from power, the Chauhans rose to political prominence and made Sambalpur the centre of their political ativities. They became the overlord eighteen states (Atharagarha) comprising almost the whole Kosala country described by the Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang.

1.2.9.Conclusion

Thus, all these geographical units have played their roles in the enrichment of political and cultural history of the Odisha. As we observe that Kalinga, Utkala, Odra, Tosali , Kongoda and Kosala were territories having distinct boundaries of their own and the boundary changed from time to time in ancient and early medieval period. Sometimes, it is noticed that some of these names were used as interchangeable terms, e.g. Odra was known as Tosali during the Bhaumakara At the advent of fifteenth century A.D. poet Sarala Dasa made Udisa or Odisha synonym with Odrarastra which became Odisha rajya during the great Gajapatis. Right from the days of Kapilendradeva (1435-1467 A.D.), this empire land of the Odia speaking people has been known as Odisha.

1.2.10. Summary

- In order to make a scientific study on the history of any land, a broad and thorough knowledge of its geography is essential.
- Historical geography essentially aims at the reconstruction of geography of a region of a period which has already passed.
- Among the different political units of this ancient land, Kalinga occupied a prominent place.
- The fertile coastal plains stretching from the mouth of the river Ganges up to Godavari, with mountains and forests, gave a natural boundary to Kalinga.
- During the second century B.C. the present state of Odisha was certainly known as Kalinga as is evident by the fact that in the Hatigumpha Inscription at Udayagiri near Bhubaneswar, Kharavela is described as *Kalingadhipati*.
- Utkala appears in the *Mahabharata* in association with the countries of Odras, Mekala, Kalinga,Darsana and Andhras.
- The present name of Odisha has been derived from the name Odra or Udra or Odraka.
- It appears as Urshin or Ursfin in the accounts of the Muslim geographers of the ninth and tenth century A.D.
- Odra has also found mention in the *Manusamhita* where it is associated with the Paundrakas, Dravidas, Kambojas, Yavanas, Sakas, Paradas, Palhavas, Chinas, Kiratas, Daradas and Khasas.
- Tosala or Tosali formed an important political unit in ancient Odisha.
- It is mentioned in the 'Parisistha' of *Atharva Veda* along with Kosala and the Puranas have associated the people of this territory with Kotalas, Nisadas, Traipuras, Tumuras, Valdisas etc.
- It was during the Sailodbhava dynasty, Kongoda came into eminence. Kongoda may be explained as the “Land of Honey” as *Kongu* in Tamil means honey.
- This was a *Mandala* state and flourished in the sixth-seventh century A.D.
- The earliest depiction of Kosala is found in the Parisistha of the Atharvaveda.
- The Epics and the Puranas also throw light on its ancient history.
- Thus, all these geographical units have played their roles in the enrichment of political and cultural history of the Odisha.

1.2.11.Exercise

- Give an account on the historical geography of ancient Odisha.
- Write a note on the boundary of Kalinga in ancient period.
- Describe the area under Utkala in ancient times.
- Discuss the topography of ancient Odra state.
- Make an analysis on the political boundary of Tosali.
- High light the territory under the Kangoda region.
- Write a note on the topography of Kosala in ancient period.

1.2.12.Further Reading

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UNIT-1
Chapter-III

KALINGA WAR:
Causes and results

1.3.0. Objectives
1.3.1. Introduction
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1.3.3. Causes of the Kalinga war
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1.3.3.4. Commercial factor
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1.3.5. Results of the Kalinga War
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1.3.5.2. Annexation of Kalinga
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1.3.5.4. Acceptance of Buddhism after Kalinga war
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1.3.5.6. Paternal attitude towards his subjects
1.3.5.7. Growth of art, architecture and literature
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1.3.5. 10. Well organised bureaucracy
1.3.6. Conclusion
1.3.7. Summary
1.3.8. Exercise
1.3.9. Further Reading

1.3.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Kalinga war. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the different causes of the Kalinga war*
- *understand the nature of the war*
- *know about the results of Kalinga war*

1.3.1.Introduction

The Kalinga War of 261 B.C. is considered as the sheet anchor of Odishan history. With it begins the dated history of Orissa. The Mauryan influence over Kalinga not only added a new feather in the already crowned Magadhan imperialism, but it also brought about a radical change in the existing polity of the land. Though the Nandas had established their authority over Kalinga, they had probably altered the existing administrative set up of Kalinga. After Kalinga war , an elaborate system of administration was arranged by Ashoka for this newly conquered province.

1.3.2.Kalinga War

The Kalinga war was a milestone in the splendid career of Asoka. It took place in 261 B.C. eight years after the coronation of Asoka. A detailed account of this war is known from Rock Edict XIII found at Shahbazgarh in Pakistan. Kainga was under the suzerainty of Magadha till Dhana Nanda. Kalinga probably slipped away from the fold of Magadhan imperialism when Kautilya and Chandragupta Maurya revolted against the Nandas around 322-321 B.C. Chandragupta Maurya had never attempted to annex Kalinga during his life time. Bindusara had also not fought with the people of Kalinga. So, it was a historic necessity on the part of Asoka to conquer Kalinga.

1.3.3.Causes of the Kalinga war

The following factors were responsible for the outbreak of the Kalinga war in 261 B.C.

1.3.3.1.Powerful neighbour

The Magadhan Empire during Asoka had surrounded Kalinga in the north, west and south. Tile existence of Kalinga as a powerful neighbour on the border of Magadha was definitely a threat to the power and potentiality of the latter. Thus, Kalinga posed a menace to the grand Magadhan empire. Before Kalinga rose to that extent, Asoka wanted to defeat and capture it.

1.3.3.2. Imperialistic design of Ashoka

Asoka's invasion of Kalinga in 261 B.C. appears to have been actuated by his imperialistic designs. By the time of Asoka's accession the Magadhan Empire had spread over most parts of India. From the Himalayas in the north to Mysore in the sourth and from the Kabul valley in the north-west to Bengal in the east, the whole territory was under the sovereignty of Ashoka. An independent kingdom of Kalinga, not very far from the centre of gravity of the Magadhan empire, was intolerable for a warlike- king like Chandasoka or Black Asoka .

1.3.3.3.Economic prosperity of Kalinga

There were certain economic factors which had created rivalry between Kalinga and Magadha. Kalinga monopolised the oversea trade in the Indian ocean and gained vast wealth. Her wealth also increased from inland trade. Through the Mauryas had foreign relation with the contemporary Hellenistic powers, they had not maintained commercial relation with them. It may also be pointed out that the Mauryas by that time had not built up a naval power and the *Navadhyaksha* (Superintendent of Shiping) mentioned by Kautilya in his *Arthasastra* was in charge of policing the rivers, lakes and seashores rather than building ships for maritime trades. So, the economic prosperity of Kalinga became an eye-sore for Magadha.

1.3.3.4.Commercial factor

In trade and commerce, Kalinga was a great competitor of Magadha. Important trade-routes from the Gangetic valley to the Deccan and further south passed through Kalinga facilitating her trade and commerce. Though, Magadha had foreign relation and huge internal resources, it suffered from a commercial crisis due to the lack of trade routes. The existence of flourishing Kalinga with her trade and commerce was adversely affecting the economy of the Mauryan empire.

1.3.3.5.Stealing of Asoka's jewels by the Nagas

According to the description of Lama Taranath, a Tibetan author, the Nagas stole away the jewels of Asoka. So, the emperor became angry and conquered their territory. These Nagas were identified with the seafaring people of Kalinga. In order to take revenge, Asoka invaded Kalinga.

1.3.3.6.Legend of Karuvaki

A strange story regarding the cause of Kalinga war prevails among the fisherman community of the eastern coast of Odisha. According to this, Asoka invaded Kalinga being infatuated by the beauty of Karuvaki, the daughter of a fisherman and the fiancee of the crown prince of Kalinga. Though this fact appears absurd, but it cannot be rejected outright because from the Queen's

Edict, it is known that Asoka had a queen named Karuvaki who was the mother of Tivara, a son of Ashoka.

1.3.3.7.Religious factor

Religion was another potential factor for Asoka's invasion of Kalinga. Before Kalinga War, Asoka was a devout Saiva. Though, it is difficult to ascertain what was the prevalent form of religion in Kalinga, with tolerable degree of certainty, it can be stated that Buddhism and not Brahminism (Saivism) was prevailing in Kalinga. Asoka might have decided to wage a holy war against Kalinga to teach the Buddhists a lesson. Though, nothing concrete is available to the historians regarding the nature of polity in Kalinga during Asoka's invasion· and also the state of religion in this land, it appears that Brahmanism, as a state religion, did not prevail here. However, this is a controversial issue.

1.3.4.The nature of the Kalinga War

The much anticipated Kalinga War took place in 261 B.C. which is known from Meghasthenes account that Magadhan army during Chandragupta Maurya, consisted of 6,00,000 men. Definitely, it would have increased during Asoka. So, with that grand army Asoka invaded Kalinga from north, west and south. However, the Kalingans resisted the attack vehemently. The war took place on the bank of the river Daya near Dhauli. The Rock Edict XIII mentions the horror of the Kalinga war.

1.3.5.Results of the Kalinga War

The Kalinga war had far reaching results which made lasting impact on mankind. The results can be discussed as follows:

1.3.5.1.Loss of man and material

Each and every war in history almost results in the loss of man and money. There was huge loss of man and material in the Kalinga war. In this war 150,000 soldiers from the side of Kalinga were taken as prisoners by Asoka and 100,000 were slain and many others got died out of injuries and epidemic after the war. The war brought miseries not only to those who took to arms but also to a large number of civil population.

1.3.5.2.Annexation of Kalinga

With the victory of Asoka in the Kalinga war, Kalinga was annexed to Magadhan empire and it constituted its fifth province. The other four provinces of the empire were Prachya, Uttarapatha, Avanti and Dakshinapatha having their capitals at Magadha, Takshasila, Ujjaini and Suvarnagiri

respectively. Tosali was the capital of Kalinga and the centre of political activities for the Mauryan administration in Kalinga. Two separate Kalinga edicts of Asoka found at Dhauli and Jaugarh enumerate the pattern of Mauryan administration for the province of kalinga.

1.3.5.3.Change from *Chandasoka* to *Dharmasoka*

The horror of the Kalinga war changed the mind of Asoka. In Rock Edict XIII, Asoka expresses- "In conquering indeed an unconquered country (Kalinga), the slaying, death, deporting that occur there are considered extremely painful and serious by the Devanampiya" This war brought about a great transformation in the heart of Asoka. He was changed from *Chandasoka* to *Dharmasoka* with a vow to conquer mankind by conquering the heart of the people and not-to win over them by war.

1.3.5.4.Acceptance of Buddhism after Kalinga war

The Kalinga War had brought deep feeling or remorse in the mind of Asoka. It drew himself close towards Buddhism. After Kalinga War, he was converted to Buddhism by Upagupta, a Buddhist monk or Nigrodha, the seven year old son of Asoka's elder brother Sumana whom he had killed or Mogaliputtatissa, the president of the Third Buddhist Council. Whatever the fact might be, Asoka accepted Buddhism after the Kalinga war.

1.3.5.5.Spread of Buddhism in India and outside countries

The transformation of Asoka helped in the spread of Buddhism. Buddhism, which was confined to the middle of the Gangetic Valley in Pre-Asokan period, suddenly became an all-India religion within a decade of his conversion. Not only in India, Buddhism also spread to different parts of the world. He sent Mahendra and Sanghamitra, his son and daughter respectively to Ceylon, Sana and Uttara to *Suvarnabhumi* (Burma) and further, he maintained friendly relation with Kings of Greece, Syria, Egypt, Macedonia and Cryne by sending missions of peace. Thus, Asoka, being converted to Buddhism after the Kalinga War, was instrumental for the spread of Buddhism from Greece to Burma and from the Himalayas to the Ceylon.

1.3.5.6.Paternal attitude towards his subjects

Asoka adopted a paternalistic attitude towards his subjects after the Kalinga War. In separate Kalinga *Edicts* (Dhauli and Jaugad) Asoka expresses himself as such . "All men are my children and just as I desire for my children that they should obtain welfare and happiness both in this world and the next, the same I do desire for all men...” This attitude made him a completely benevolent ruler.

1.3.5.7.Growth of art, architecture and literature

An important aspect of the Kalinga War was that it led to the growth of art, architecture and literature unprecedented in the land. Engravement in the edicts, erection of stupas etc. made the Mauryan art unique in the annals of ancient Indian history. The Pali language which Asoka used in his edicts brought cultural unification of India popular among his subjects

1.3.5.8.Appointment of Viceroy and Ministers

As the Kalingans had exhibited their violent protest against the Mouryan authority in the Kalinga war, Asoka wanted to give them a healing touch by providing an administrator tinged with mercy and liberalism. Although, he appointed a prince of royal blood as Viceroy to look after the administration of Kalinga, he also devoted his heart and soul to the smooth running of administration in Kalinga. As per the administration gathered from separate RE I found from Dhauli, Asoka appointed a body of ministers to aid and advise the Kumara Viceroy of Kalinga and to check balance his administrative powers.

1.3.5.9.Appointment of Dharma Mahamatras

In other parts of his empire, Asoka had given authority to the Viceroys to appointed Dharma Mahamatras on triennial tours inside the empire to impart religious instruction to the people. In case of Kalinga, however, the Viceroy had no such authority. Asoka took keen interest in appointing the *Dharma Mahamatras* specially for Kalinga. This shows that emperor Asoka had his personal involvernent in the administration of Kalinga even though he had appointed Viceroy to look after the administration of Kalinga.

1.3.5. 10.Well organised bureaucracy

Asoka appointed a well organised bureaucracy to assist the viceroy of Kalinga. The important officers during Asoka's time were the *Mahamatras, Rajukas, Yuktas, Vachabhumikas, Antamahamatras, Ithijakamahamatras, Dharma Mahamatras* etc. *Antamahamatras* were the ministers of the border provinces and the Mahamatras of Tosali and Samapa probably belonged to this cateogry. For Kalinga, Dhamma *Mahamatras* were appointed by Asoka personally. They were employed to look after the spiritual and moral upliftment of people of this land. As the *Rajukas* were in charge of welfare of the Janapadas and were competent enough with absolute power in matters of reward and punishment, they might have played a dominant role in the administration of Kalinga.

1.3.6.Conclusion

Thus, the Kalinga war was a land mark in the history of ancient Odisha. It left some permanent legacies. The war gave to this land with its predominant aboriginal and primitive population a civilized administration which could achieve its moral and social uplift by its constant solicitude and work for the welfare of the people. Buddhism became a world religion after the war. Ashoka's rule also resulted in the introduction of Mauryan art and architecture in Odisha.

1.3.7.summary

- The Kalinga War of 261 B.C. is considered as the sheet anchor of Odishan history. With it begins the dated history of Orissa.
- Tile existence of Kalinga as a powerful neighbour on the border of Magadha was definitely a threat to the power and potentiality of Magadha.
- Asoka's invasion of Kalinga in 261 B.C. appears to have been actuated by his imperialistic designs.
- There were certain economic factors which had created rivalry between Kalinga and Magadha.
- In trade and commerce, Kalinga was a great competitor of Magadha.
- The Nagas stole away the jewels of Asoka, so in order to take revenge, Asoka invaded Kalinga.
- Asoka invaded Kalinga being infatuated by the beauty of Karuvaki, the daughter of a fisherman and the fiancee of the crown prince of Kalinga.
- Religion was another potential factor for Asoka's invasion of Kalinga.
- The much anticipated Kalinga War took place in 261 B.C.
- The Kalinga war had far reaching results which made lasting impact on mankind.
- In this war 150,000 soldiers from the side of Kalinga were taken as prisoners by Asoka and 100,000 were slain and many others got died out of injuries and epidemic after the war.
- With the victory of Asoka in the Kalinga war, Kalinga was annexed to Magadhan empire and it constituted its fifth province.

- This war brought about a great transformation in the heart of Asoka. He was changed from *Chandasoka* to *Dharmasoka* with a vow to conquer mankind by conquering the heart of the people and not-to win over them by war.
- After Kalinga War, he was converted to Buddhism by Upagupta, a Buddhist monk or Nigrodha, the seven year old son of Asoka's elder brother Sumana whom he had killed or Mogaliputtatissa, the president of the Third Buddhist Council.
- The transformation of Asoka helped in the spread of Buddhism.
- Asoka adopted a paternalistic attitude towards his subjects after the Kalinga War.
- An important aspect of the Kalinga War was that it led to the growth of art, architecture and literature unprecedented in the land.
- Asoka appointed a well organised bureaucracy to assist the viceroy of Kalinga.

1.3.8.Exercise

- Write a note on the Kalinga war.
- Discuss the causes of the Kalinga war.
- Describe the results of the Kalinga war.
- Discuss the measures taken by Ashoka towards Kalinga after the Kalinga war.

1.3.9.Further Reading

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UNIT-2
Chapter-I

THE MAHAMEGHAVAHANAS:
Career and achievements of Kharavela, Time of his rule

Structure

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2.1.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students investigate about the Mahameghavahans and Kharavela. After studying this lesson you will be able to:

- *understand about the Mahameghavahanas*
- *discuss the career of Kharavela*
- *investigate the achievements of Kharavela*
- *Identify the time of his rule*

2.1.1.Introduction

The history of Kalinga after the Maurya rule is obscure and it is not known exactly when this country regained its independence. A flood of light is focused upon this dark period of Odishan history with the discovery of Hatigumpha inscription at Udayagiri in Bhubaneswar. The facts described in this inscription undoubtedly proves that its author Kharavela, the mighty monarch was a remarkable figure in the contemporary India. His mighty sword blasted the vanity of Kalinga's age-old enemy Magadha and subjugated a vast area under Kalingan suzerainty. Under his reign Kalinga reached the pinnacle of glory. The facts narrated in the Hatigumpha inscription has been amply corroborated by the excavation at Sisupalgarh near Bhubaneswar and through some figures engraved in different caves at Udyagiri. The Hatigumpha inscription at Udaygiri hill near Bhubaneswar describes in details about the career and achievement of Kharavela, the mighty ruler of Mahameghvahana family.

2.1.2. The Mahameghavahanas

The Hatigumpha inscription mentions that Kharavela belonged to the *Mahameghavahana* family of the Chedi clan. The Chedis were originally ruling in Madhyadesa or Magadha and it has been suggested that a branch of this royal family of the hoary ambiguity, came to Kalinga and established its sway over it. We do not know when they migrated to Kalinga, but from the Hatigumpha inscription it becomes apparent that Kharavela was the third member of the Kalingan Chedis.

Kharavela is introduced as 'Airena Maharajena, Mahameghavahanena and Chetarajavasavadhanena'. Each part of the expression has admitted of controversies. Barua reads 'Aira' as 'Veera' meaning hero but explains it as a royal title' Ayira' meaning Svami i.e., master or lord. Mahameghavahana is considered to be the grandfather of Kharavela, the founder of the dynasty in Kalinga which came to be known as Mahameghavahana after his name. Like the Satavahanas of the South, Mahameghavahana dynasty was established in Kalinga. The Manchpuri cave inscription describes Kharavela's son as 'Maharaja-Kalingadhipati-

Mahameghavahana- Kudepasiri'. Another inscription at Guntupalli in West Godavari district of A.P. (cir. 1st century B.C.) in the same Brahmi script and Prakrit language refers to "Mahameghavahana-Kalinga- Mahisakadhipati-Siri-Sada". "Cetarajavasavadhanena" has been interpreted as one who increases the glory of the Cedi dynasty. The latest view in the regard is that Chetaraja was the father of Kharavela. Kharavela, the son of Cetaraja, was the third ruler Mahameghavahana dynasty also known as Kalingarajavamsa. The Hathigumpha inscription precisely records his career and achievements up to thirteen years of his reign.

2.1.3. Career and achivements of Kharavela

The career and achievements of Kharavela has gone through two phases, (1) his career as a prince and (2) his career and achievement as a ruler.

2.1.3.1. His Career as a Prince

The inscription opens with a salutation to the Jaina saints and then gives us some ideas about the childhood and the boyhood of Kharavela before accession to the throne. It is said that he was born with auspicious physical marks and noble qualities which were indicative of his future greatness as a ruler. Till the fifteenth year, he spent his time in different types of sports and games. During this period he also acquired knowledge in different branches of learning, which were essential for discharging royal duty, such as writing or correspondence (Lekha), finance, currency (Rupa), arithmetic (Ganana) and law (Vldhl and Vyvahara). As a prince, Kharavela underwent training in the art of warfare (Dhanuryidya), music and dance (Gandharva vidya) and religion. In the fifteenth year he became the crown prince and started probation in the practical field of administration. At the age of twenty four, he was crowned king by assuming the title Kalingadhipati and gave his subjects a sound administration.

2.1.3.2. His career and achievement as a ruler

After giving a description of his early life up to the 24th year, the Hatigumpha inscription records the events of his 13 years' reign chronologically.

2.1.3.3. Renovation of his capital

In his first regnal year, he involved himself in the renovation work by repairing the gates and buildings of his capital Kalinganagara, which had been destroyed by a furious cyclone. He employed people to dig a deep lake and to create beautiful gardens. These repairs and some other public works in the same year cost him thirty-five lakhs of coins from the royal exchequer.

This fact has been amply corroborated with the excavation at Sisupalgarh that brings out the remnants of defensive ramparts gateways, high rowers etc.

2.1.3.4. Expedition against Satavahana king

Kharavela possessed a large army, consisting of infantry, cavalry, elephant force and chariots. Having made adequate preparation, he undertook expedition against the powerful Satavahan king, Satakarni-I in the second year of his rule. Satakarni-I was ruling over a vast empire, comprising northern part of modern Maharashtra, western part of modern Madhya Pradesh and Andhra region. Kharavela's army advanced up to the Krishna river and besieged the city of Rishikanagara which was obviously situated within the Satavahan territory

2.1.3.5. Entertainment of his subjects

After the southern campaign, Kharavela provided entertainment to his subjects in the third year. Kalinganagari, the capital of Kharavela was overwhelmed with joy and jubilation in his third regnal year. Kharavela was proficient in all arts of music and dance. He organised various performances where dance and music, both vocal and instrumental, took place. He also arranged ceremonials and social gatherings in which feast and merrymaking etc. for the entertainment of his subjects.

2.1.3.6. Southern campaign

In the fourth regnal year, the war-drum of Kalinga was heard again. Kharavela mobilised his army and marched towards the Deccan again. The territory of the Rathikas and Bhojakas lying respectively to the south and north of Nasik region were conquered. The Rathikas and Bhojakas paid homage and booty to Kharavela.

2.1.3.7. Extension of canal from the Tansulia to Kalinganagari

The role of Kharavela as a benevolent king is reflected in the fifth year of his reign. In this year, Kharavela extended the canal from the Tansulia road up to Kalinganagari. This canal was excavated 300 or 103 years before by king Nanda (a Nanda king) for the purpose of irrigation.

2.1.3.8. Remittance of taxes

In the sixth year of his reign, Kharavela did not undertake any war campaign rather he devoted himself to the welfare activities of his subjects. He remitted taxes and benevolences both in urban and rural area of his kingdom. This clearly shows that the treasury of Kharavela was

overflowed with wealth. As a benevolent ruler, he took up this task of remitting taxes to his beloved subjects to win their hearts.

2.1.3.9. Attainment of fatherhood

In the seventh year of his rule, Kharavela attained fatherhood. His chief queen known by the name 'the queen of Vajiraghara' gave birth to a son.

2.1.3.10. Expedition to the north

In the eighth year of his reign, Kharavela led an expedition to the north and attacked the city of Rajagriha and devastated Gorathagiri which was situated on the Barbara hill of the Gaya district. His triumph at Rajagriha created terror among the yavanas who were then in occupation of Mathura. After their success in that region, they had a plan to attack Magadha, Hearing the exploits of Kharavela, the yavana king fled away from Mathura. The yavana ruler, whose name is read doubtfully as 'Dimita' or 'Dimata' might be Demitrius or Minandar as opined by several scholars. He had collected large booty from that war campaign of north.

2.1.3.11. Establishment of Victory of Palace

In the ninth year of his rule, he built the 'Great Victory Palace*(Mahavijaya Prasadam)* by spending 38 lakhs of coins in order to commemorate his victory in the northern campaign. He had also distributed the wealth gained from exploits among the Brahmins and Arhats of his empire.

2.1.3.12. Northern Indian campaign

In the tenth year, Kharavela, who was the embodiment of the principles of politics, diplomacy and peace directed the army towards North India for conquest but the result was obscure.

2.1.3.13. Expedition against southern confederacy

In the eleventh year, he defeated a confederacy of southern powers. The confederacy of the southern powers consisted of Cholas, Pandyas, Satpuriyas, keralaputras and Tamraparnis. He secured large amount of jewels, pearls and precious stones as a symbol of allegiance.

2.1.3.14. Campaign against Bruhaspati Mitra

In the twelfth regnal year, Kharavela led campaign against Bruhaspati Mitra, the Sunga ruler of Magadha with a vast army. He inflicted a crushing defeat on the Magadhan king and also on the ruler of Anga. The people of Magadha and Anga bowed to Kharavela in awe and respect. By defeating Bruhaspati Mitra, he secured the K*alinga Jina* (the venerated image of Kalinga)

as trophy of his victory which was taken 300 or 103 years before by a Nanda king most probably Mahapadmananda. He also brought a vast treasure of wealth from Anga and Magadha. Really Kharavela avenged the defeat of the Kalingans at the hand of the Nanda King who had taken away the Jina image from Kalinga. The scene of Bahasatimita's surrendering at the feet of Kharavela is found in the Ranigumpha of Udayagiri. A scene from the Manchapuri cave shows the installation of Kalinga Jina by Kharavela. After his victory over the Magadhan king, Kharavela's suzerainty was acknowledged by the Naga king of Central India and the Pandya king of South India. The Naga king sent to him jewels, elephants, horses and deer as presents. The pandyan king also sent jewels to him as a mark of loyality.

2.1.3.15. Construction of caves

In the thirteenth year of his reign, Kharavela probably gave up military activities and turned his attention towards religious pursuits. He built 117 (1700 ? not possible) caves at *Kumari Parvata* (Udayagiri) for Jaina monks, monks of other religion, sheers and Arhats. This was his noble service rendered to the Jaina and other monks. He revived the art and architecture of ancient Kalinga (Mukhiya Kala) which was going to be extinguished. In different caves of Udaygiri and Khandagiri the images of Jaina Tirthankaras, trees, creepers, images of royal servants were built by him in that year.

2.1.4. Time of his rule

The date of Kharavela is a highly controversial one. We may rely upon some clues in the Hatigumpha inscription to determine the date of Kharavela. This inscription says that in the twelfth year of his reign, Kharavela defeated the Magadhan king Bahasati Mita (Bruhaspati Mitra). Mitra was being suffixed by the rulers of the Sunga dynasty which came to power in Magadha in 187 B.C. on the break-up of the Mauryan empire and continued to rule upto 40-30 B.C. The first ruler of this dynasty was Pushya Mitra who ruled from187 B.C. to 151 B.C. Some scholars identify Pushya Mitra with Bruhaspati Mitra without proper justification. Pushya Mitra was succeeded by his son Agni Mitra, the hero of Kalidas's drama, *Malavikagnimitram.* After Agri Mitra the Sungas became weak. It is probable that Kharavela defeated a later Sunga king, bearing the name Bruhaspati Mitra. Therefore, his invasion of Magadha could have taken place sometimes after 151 B.C. and before 40 B.C. Another clue of Kharavela's date is the statement in the Hatigumpha inscription that in the fifth year of his reign Kharavela renovated a canal which had been dug by a Nanda ~ (Nanda Raja) 103 or 300 years (*Ti-basa-sata)* before. Some scholars

identify the Nanda Raja with Mahapadrnananda, the powerful founder-king of the Nanda dynasty of Magadha and read *Ti-basasata* as there hundred years.

In this line of fixation, we have to know accurately the year of the commencement of Mahapadmananda's reign. Taking 345 B.C. as the year of digging of canal by Mahapadmananda, N. K. Sahu fixes 40 B.C. as the year of Kharavela's coronation. Relying upon the Puranic sources, according to which Nandas ruled for one hundred years, and taking 424 B.C. as the starting point of Nanda rule and reading *Ti-basa- Ita* as 300 years, Kedarnath Mahapatra fixes 100 B.C. as the your of Kharavela's coronation.

Some palaeographists are of the opinion that the Hatigumpha inscription should be assigned to the first century B.C. On the other hand, K.C. Panigrahi holds a different view. He accepts B.M. Barua's Identification of Nanda Raja with Asoka on two grounds. First, there was no Nanda rule in Odisha, as Asoka was the first king of Magadha to conquer Kalinga according to his statement in Rock Edict XIII. Secondly, as Chandragupta Maurya, Asoka's grand father, has been called Nandanvaya (an offspring of Nanda family), the description of Asoka as Nanda Raja should not appear absurd. Panigrahi also reads *Ti-basa-sata* as 103 years and taking 261 B.C. as the year of conquest of Kalinga by Asoka (after which the canal was dug), he fixes the coronation of Kharavela at 159 B.C. Panigrahi identifies Bruhaspati Mitra as a later Mauryan king, named Bruhaspati who is mentioned in *Divyavadana.* The Hatigumpha inscription also mentions Satavahan king Satakarni as Kharavela's contemporary. Satakarni is identified as Satakarni-l who belonged to second or first century B.C.. From the above discussion we may conclude that Kharavela could not be earlier than second century B.C. and later than first century B.C. Most probably he belonged to first century B.C. However, N. K. Sahu has fixed up the chronology of Kharavela's reign, as follows:

(1)Establishment of Chedi rule in Kalinga -73 B.C.,(2) Birth of Kharavela-64 B.C,(3) Coronation-40 B.C., (4) Rule as Heir-apparent- 49-40 B.C.

2.1.5. Conclusion

Thus, Kharavela was undoubtedly a great conqueror and empire builder in the early phase of the Indian history. He can be compared with Mahapadmananda, Chandragupta Maurya, Asoka and Samudragupta in this respect. He was a great military genius. He possessed a vast army, composed of impressive elephant force, cavalry, infantry and chariots. His political sway extended in the north as far as Mathura and, in the south, as far as the Pandya kingdom.

Conquests, however, impressive are ephemeral. Kharavela's greatness in history rests on safer and much more abiding grounds than mere conquests. Kharavela is remembered as a 'protagonist and a patron of Jainism.

2.1.6. Summary

- The Hatigumpha inscription at Udaygiri hill near Bhubaneswar describes in details about the career and achievement of Kharavela, the mighty ruler of Mahameghvahana family.
- The Hatigumpha inscription also mentions that Kharavela belonged to the *Mahameghavahana* family of the Chedi clan.
- As young prince he acquired knowledge in different branches of learning, which were essential for discharging royal duty, such as writing or correspondence (Lekha), finance, currency (Rupa), arithmetic (Ganana) and law (Vldhl and Vyvahara). As a prince, Kharavela underwent training in the art of warfare (Dhanuryidya), music and dance (Gandharva vidya) and religion.
- In the fifteenth year he became the crown prince and started probation in the practical field of administration.
- At the age of twenty four, he was crowned king by assuming the title Kalingadhipati and gave his subjects a sound administration.
- In his first regnal year, he involved himself in the renovation work by repairing the gates and buildings of his capital Kalinganagara.
- Having made adequate preparation, he undertook expedition against the powerful Satavahan king, Satakarni-I in the second year.
- After the southern campaign, Kharavela provided entertainment to his subjects in the third year.
- In the fourth regnal year, Kharavela marched towards the territory of the Rathikas and Bhojakas and defeated them.
- In 5th year, Kharavela extended the canal from the Tansulia road up to Kalinganagari.
- In the sixth year of his reign, Kharavela remitted taxes .
- In the seventh year of his rule, Kharavela attained fatherhood.
- In the eighth year of his reign, Kharavela led an expedition to the north.
- In the ninth year of his rule, he built the 'Great Victory Palace.

- In the 10th year, Kharavela, who was the embodiment of the principles of politics, diplomacy and peace directed the army towards North India for conquest but the result was obscure.
- In the eleventh year, he defeated a confederacy of southern powers.
- In the twelfth regnal year, Kharavela led campaign against Bruhaspati Mitra, the Sunga ruler of Magadha with a vast army and inflicted a crushing defeat on the Magadhan king.
- In the thirteenth year of his reign, Kharavela probably gave up military activities and turned his attention towards religious pursuits.
- He built 117 (1700 ? not possible) caves at *Kumari Parvata* (Udayagiri) for Jaina monks, monks of other religion, sheers and Arhats.
- The date of Kharavela is a highly controversial one.
- we may conclude that Kharavela could not be earlier than second century B.C. and later than first century B.C. Most probably he belonged to first century B.C.
- However, N. K. Sahu has fixed up the chronology of Kharavela's reign, as follows: (1)Establishment of Chedi rule in Kalinga -73 B.C.,(2) Birth of Kharavela-64 B.C,(3) Coronation-40 B.C., (4) Rule as Heir-apparent- 49-40 B.C.
- Thus, Kharavela was undoubtedly a great conqueror and empire builder in the early phase of the Indian history.

2.1.7. Exercise

- Write a note on the Mahameghavahana family of Chedi clan.
- Highlight the career of Mahameghavahana Kharavela.
- Give an account on the career and achievement of Kharavela.
- Make an analysis on Kharavela’s time of his rule.

2.1.8. Further Reading

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Unit-2
Chapter-II
RISE OF LOCAL DYNASTIES:
Matharas, Sailodbhavas and early Eastern Gangas

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2.2.0. Objectives

In this chapter we intended providing you an insight into the rise of local dynasties. By the end of this chapter the learners would be able to:

- *to know the rise of Matharas as a local dynasty and the achievements of Mathara rulers.*
- *to trace in brief the growth of Sailodbhavas and their achievements.*
- *to study the development of Bhaumakaras as a local dynasty and the achievements of the rulers*
- *to assess the status of women rulers in the Bhaumakara dynasty.*
- *to understand the rise of the early Eastern Ganga dynasty.*

2.2.1. Rise of local dynasties

The outcome of Samundragupta's invasion were noteworthy. The kingdoms of Kosala, Kantara and Kalinga region could not raise their heads from the blow. On the other hand, it gave way for the rise of petty kingdoms on the map of Odisha in the middle of 4th century A.D. Some of them had survived for a hundred and fifty years whereas some others just appeared and then disappeared in a short time.

2.2.2. The Matharas

The history of Kalinga region underwent great change about the middle of the fourth century AD. after the South India campaign of Sarnudragupta. The political situation of the period contributed to the rise of a new ruling dynasty named Mathara. In ancient time the Mathara family enjoyed high political and social status and had matrimonial relations with several powerful ruling families of Kosala and South India.

2.2.2.1. The Mathara family under Vishakha Varman (350 to 360 A.D)

About the middle of the fourth century, Vishakha Varman of the Mathara family succeeded in organising a small principality in Kalinga region with its headquarters at Sripura identified with the modern village Batiasripua near Paralakhemundi in Ganjam district. Vishakhavarman assumed the title Sri Maharaja and started his political career as a modest ruler of a petty territory. His territory was divided into a few Panchalis of which one was named Karosodaka. In the seventh year of his reign, Visakhavannan is known to have donated the village Tapoyoka located in that Panchali to five- Brahmanas. In the records of the early Ganga king we find the Karasodaka Panchali as a part of the Kalinga territory. But Visakhavarman did not assume the title "Lord of Kalinga" No record of Visakhavarman is found beyond his seventh regnal year. It appears that he established the new kingdom for his family towards the later part of his life and ruled only for about the decade from circa 350 to 360 A.D.

2.2.2.2. Umavarman (360 A.D-395 A.D)

Maharaja Visakhavannan was succeeded by Umavarman who was very likely his son. Umavarman started his career as a modest ruler like his father with Sripura as the headquarters of his small principality. But, he was an ambitious ruler and taking opportunity of the political changes of his time, he began to extend his territory and power at the cost of the neighbouring territories. By his sixth regnal year he extended his kingdom up to the Svetaka region (modern Chikiti) and established a new headquarters at Sunagara. King Umavarman issued two of his copper plate grants-Baranga grant and Dhavalapeta grant from this headquarters donating the lands to the Brahmins.

By his ninth regnal year, his territory further extended to the south and comprised the modern Tekkali region. He shifted his headquarters from Sunagara to Vardhamanpur where form he issued his Tekkali copper plate grant. Thus, Umavarman extended his territory steadily and by his thirtieth regnal year his territory comprised the present Srikakulam disttict. By that time he declared himself as the "Lord of Kalinga" and transferred his capital from Vardhamanpura to Simhapura. It was from this new headquarters which he called Vijaya Simhapura that he issued his Vrihatproshtha grant in which he declared himself the "Lord of Kalinga." The territory of Kalinga had remained in obscurity after the Call of the Chedi rule in the first century A.D. and its historical tradition was revived by Maharaja Umavarman towards the end of the fourth century A.D. Thus Umavarman was the first great ruler ofthe Mathara dynasty and with him Kalinga entered into a long and vigorous political career and her influence was felt in the history of Eastern India and Deccan. Maharaja Umavarman ruled for about thirty five years and was succeeded by Sankarvarman in circa 395 A.D.

2.2.2.3. Sankarvarman (395 A.D-400 A.D)

Sankarvannan was very probably a brother of Umavarman and his rule appears to be very short one. No copper plate grant issued by him has come to light as yet. It is known from the records of his son that Maharaja Sankaravarman married in the Vasishtha family which was a ruling family of the Devarastra region during the period after the South Indian campaign of Samudragupta. This matrimonial relation paved the way for extension of the Mathara kingdom over the middle Kalinga region. Maharaja Sankaravarman died about 400 A.D. and was succeeded by his son Maharja Saktivarman.

2.2.2.4. Maharja Saktivarman (400 A.D-420 A.D)

Maharja Saktivarman was an ambitious and war like ruler and succeeded in unifying the Northern and Southern Kalinga. The vasishthas of the middle Kalinga region with whom the Matharas had matrimonial relation must have been a great help for Saktivarman in occupying South Kalinga. The occupation of South Kalinga signifies the fall of the Salankayana power in Vengi. The Ningondi grant of king Prabhanjanavarman reveals that Saktivarman, the son of Sankaravarman extended his territory from the Mahanadi to the river Krishna and ruled the far flung empire following the ancient laws. The Mathara kingdom extended up to Krishna at the cost of the Salankayanas. The Pallavas who were the allies of the Salankayanas were also at a state of decline by that time. Saktivannan very likely defeated the combined-forces of the Salankayanas and the Pallavas to extend his territory up to the banks of the river Krishna. Thus, Saktivarman built a strong empire on the foundation laid by Umavarman and heightened the prestige and powers of the Matharas. The political condition of India by the time of Saktivarman was being dominated by three imperial powers - the Matharas in the South, the Guptas in the North and the Vakatakas in Central India.

Maharaja Saktivarman transferred his capital from Simhapura to Pishtapura some time before his 13th regnal year when he issued his Ragolu copper plate grant from his new capital. This indicates that he conquered the Southern region before his 13th regnal year and he maintained the integrity of his empire as long as he ruled. Maharaja Saktivarman died in circa 420 A.D. and was succeeded by his son Anantasaktivarman.

2.2.2.5. Anantasaktivarman (420 A.D-450 A.D)

The political history of South India underwent a change by that time owing to the rise of the Vishnukundin dynasty. Madhavavarman I who was the founder of this dynasty was a powerful and ambitious ruler and was very probably a contemporary of Anantasaktivarman. The Ipuru plates (of Madhavavarman-Il) reveal that he fought successful battles with his neighbours and performed eleven horse sacrifices and thousands of other sacrifices. The Vishnukundins had to fight for their rise and stability with the Pallavas in the south and Matharas in the north. King Madhavavarman fought with the Mathara king Anantasaktivarman and the Pallava king Simhavarman-II and defeated both the adversaries. After defeating Anantasaktivarman, he occupied the southern regions of the Mathara kingdom including south Kalinga.

Anantasaktivarman issued his Andhavarman grant from the military camp at Vijayapura in his 14th regnal year. It appears that his wars with the Vishnukundins were continuing at the time of the issue of this grant and very probably he was compelled to leave Pishtapura by that time. His Sakunaka grant issued in his 28th regnal year was executed by his two high military officers- Commander in chief (Mahabaladhikrita), Sivabhojaka and the General (Dandarieta) Vaasudatta. This indicates that the military had unusual predominance in the sphere of civil administration during his rule. Anantasaktivarman could not maintain the integrity of the empire inherited from his father. After the loss of south Kalinga he had to shift his headquarters from Pishtapura to Simhapura and tried to consolidate his position in northern and middle Kalinga. He died circa 450 A.D. and was succeeded by Chandravarman who was very likely his son.

2.2.2.6. Chandravarman (450 A.D-460 A.D)

Maharaja Chandravarman is known from the Bobbiii and Komarti copper plate grants issued by him in his 4th and 6th regnal years respectively. His two grants do not reveal any political activity of this ruler. He bore the ephithets like Paramabhagavata and Parmadaivata and ruled from his capital Sirnhapura. Chandravarman probably had a premature death about 460 A.D. when he was succeeded by Prabhanjanavarman, another son of Saktivarman.

2.2.2.7. Prabhanjanavarman (460 A.D-480 A.D)

It appears that after the death of Saktivarman there was a rift between his two sons Anantasaktivarman and Prabhajanavarman. This internal quarrel contributed to the weakness of the Mathara dynasty. The defeat of the Matharas when they were at the zenith of their power by newly organised Vishnukundins was probably due to their internal dissensions. It may be pointed out that Maharaja Prabhanjanavarman while referring to his predcessors in the Nirgondi grant ignores Anantasaktivarman and Chandravarman and declares himself as direct successor of Saktivarman, the son of Sankarvarman. This indicates the rift between the houses of Anantasaktivarman and Prabhanjanavarman. The Mathara power could not recover the loss of prestige and territory and they began to decline steadily. No doubt king Prabhanjanvarman attempted to recover South Kalinga and he assumed the title "Sakala Kalingadhipati". This epithet was not borne by the previous Mathara rulers and it indicates his temporary success against Visbnukundins. He died around 480A.D.

2.2.2.8. Nandapravanjanavarman (480 A.D-498 A.D)

Nandapravanjanavarman succeeded Prabhanjanavarman. But his relation with the latter is not clearly known. He was the last Mathara king and during his time, the political status-of the Matharas relapsed to that of the time of Visakhavarrnan and early years of king Urnavarrnan. King Nandapravanjanavarman made Vardhamanapura his headquarters which was the headquarters of king Urnavarman in , his ninth regnal year. But in spite of the political decline Prabhanjhanavarrnan continued to bear the title "Sakala Kalingadhipati" which was assumed by his successor Nanda Pravanjanavarman. During the close of his reign the Eastern Gangas appeared in the Trikalinga territory and extended their power over the Kalinga region. Dantapura, the famous city of Kalinga was declared to be the capital of the Eastern Gangas. The Ganga era which was founded in 498 AD. heralded the political change signifying the rise of the Eastern Gangas and the fall of the Matharas.

Thus, the Matharas ruled for one hundred and fifty years. Politically independent of the Gupta suzerainty, the Mathara monarchs styled themselves as Maharajas, and Lords of Kalinga *(Kalingadhipati).* Their rule provided a sound administrative set-up to the Kalinga region. They divided their kingdom into such territorial units as *Panchali, Bhoga* and *Vishava.* Their inscriptions mention some territorial units, such as Mahendrabhoga, Dantayavagubhoga, Bhillingabhoga, Vishaya, Kalinga Vishaya and Varahavarttini Vishaya. Village was the lowest territorial unit. The Mathara king was assisted by a number of civil and military officials, such *Amatya* (minister), *Kumara-Amatya* (minister of royal blood), *talavara.* (revenue offIcial), *ueshaksapatla* (record keeper), *Mahapratihara* (chamberlain), *Ajna Bhogika* (messenger), *Dutata* (spy), *Mahavaladhikrita* (head of the army), *Mahadanda nayak* (chief commander), *Dandanayaka* (commander) and *Dandaneta* (commander of a group). Culturally, the Matharas subscribed to the general trend of the time in north India. The Mathara period saw the development of such Brahmanical cults in Orissa as Bhagavata and Saiva. The Matharas patronised Sanskrit literature. The pre-Mathara period in Orissa had seen the dominance of the non-Brahmanical religions like Jainism and Buddhism. But in Mathara period the Brahmanical religion gradually began to assume a place of importance. During this period, the people of Kalinga were carrying on maritime trade with south-east Asian countries. Dantapur (modern Palur), the great city port, was situated in the territory of Matharas.

2.2.3. The Sailodbhavas

Towards the middle of the sixth century A.D. and more obviously at the advent of the seventh century A.D., the obscure political scene of Odisha became clear to some extent. In the political scenario of Odisha, the Sailodbhavas emerged as a mighty power extending their sway from the Mahanadi in the north to Mahendragiri in the south. They ruled over Kongoda *Mandala,* roughly comprising the undivided Ganjam and Puri districts. The centre of their political activities was Kongodavasaka which was, perhaps, on the bank of river Salia in the Ganjam district.

2.2.3.1. Sources

The *Ekamra Purana Kapila Samhita, Svarnadri Mahodaya and* Hiuen Tsang's *Si-yu-ki* help a lot in constructing the history of the Sailodbhavas. The Sumandala plate, Kanasa copper plate grant, Soro charter, Chicacole plates, Khurda grant, Tekkali charter, Ganjam plates etc. form the inscriptional sources for the dynasty.

2.2.3.2. Origin of the Sailodbhavas

The origin of the Sailodbhavas is shrouded in mystery. The Sailodbhava inscriptions state that once upon a time when anarchy prevailed over Kalinga, an aboriginal chief named Pulindasena worshipped Lord Brahma *(Svayambhu)* to save the country by providing it with a strong ruler. The Lord was pleased and created an able-bodied person named Sailodbhava, who became the founder of the dynasty. The name *Sailodbhava* literary means 'born out of rocks'. Coming to the historical analysis of the origin of the Sailodbhavas, scholars opine that Sailodhbavas were either a branch of the Ganga family or Saila dynasty of Madhya Pradesh. Both these opinions do not seem plausible. Pulindasena may be regarded as the chieftain of the Pulindas. The Pulindas may be identified with Kulindas of the Rock Edict XIII of Asoka who were a tribe of the *Atavika Rajya* which was a part of Kalinga and was not conquered by Asoka. Varahamihira's *Brihat Samhita* is a pointer in this direction because he associates the Pulindas with the Sailajas inhabiting the rocky region of Kalinga. Perhaps, Pulindasena was instrumental in helping Sailodbhava of the Sailaja tribe in establishing the dynasty after his name .and the territory, over which its rulers ruled, was known as Kongoda *mandala.* Abhaya of the Sumandala

plate, whose descendent was Dharmaraja, may be identified with Sailodbhava, the founder of the dynasty. The genealogy of the Saliodbhavas is as follows.

Genealogical Table of the Sailodbhavas

Ranabhita

↓

Madhavaraja I Sainyabhita I

↓

Chharamparaja Ayasobhita I

↓

Madhavaraja II Sainyabhita II (Madhavavarman)

↓

Madhyamaraja I Ayasobhita II

↓

Dharmaraja II Sri Manabhita

↓

Madhyamaraja II

↓

Ailaparaja Yuvaraja Tailapa

↓

Madhyamaraja III

2.2.3.3. Dharmaraja I Ranabhita (553-575 A. D.)

From the Sumandala charter dated Gupta era 250 (570 A.D.), it is known that Dharmaraja I other wise known as Ranabhita was the first known historical ruler of the Sailodbhaba dynasty. He was not an Independent ruler, rather, a feudatory under the Vigraha ruler Prithivivigraha of Kalinga. It is apparent that towards the close of sixth century A.D., the Vigrahas had become powerful and the Sailodbhavas acknowledged their suzerainty. Dharmaraja I was, perhaps, the devotee of Sun God as in the Sumandala Charter, it is mentioned that he devoted at the feet of thousand-rayed sun *(Sahasrarasmi padabhakta).*

2.2.3.4. Madhavaraja I Sainyabhlta I(575- 600 A. D.)

Madhavaraja succeeded Dharmaraja I to the throne of Kongoda. He was feudatory of the Vigrahas as is revealed from the Kanasa copper plate grant of Gupta era 280 (600 A.D.) wherein

he has been described as a *Mahasamanta* under Lokavigraha. This fact has been corroborated in the Ganjam grant of his grandson Madhavaraja II. Thus, the two early rulers of this dynasty were not independent rulers rather they acknowledged the suzerainty of the Vigrahas of Kalinga.

2.2.3.5. Chharamparaja Ayasobhita I (600-615 A.D.)

With Chharamparaja Ayasobhita I, a new phase began in the history of the Sailodbhavas. In the struggle between the Vigrahas and Mudgalas for supremacy over Tosali, Ayasobhita I fished in that troubled water and became independent of the Vigraha rule. From Eradanga Charter (555 A.D.) and the Soro Charter (580 A.D.), it is known that the Mudgala King Sambhuyasa became powerful over Tosali and wanted to subjugate Kalinga. His dream was shattered into pieces when he was defeated by Lokavigraha. About 603 A. D. Sambhuyasa avenged the defeat by driving out Lokavigraha from South Tosali. Immediately, after the assertion of his power over South Tosali, he was defeated by Prithvimaharaja, the King of Pistapura and thus, ended the Mudgala rule over Tosali.

At the advent of the seventh century A. D. Prithvimaharaja encountered the attack of Sasanka of Gauda from the north who occupied the Northen Tosali. At about the same time, Pulakesin II established his sway over Pistapura. At this juncture, Ayasobhita I asserted his independence over Kongoda. For the first time, he named his capital Vijaya Kangodavasaka. From the Khandipada Nuapali grant, it is known that he was an independent ruler and was assisted by a number of officers like *Sri Samanta, Maha Samanta, Maharaja Rajanaka, Rajaputra, Dandanayaka, Kumaramatya, Uparika* and *Ayuktaka.* The creation of new capital and different officers including feudatories clearly show that he was an independent and sovereign ruler. He was a devotee to Lord Siva (Hara) and patronised Saivism as is revealed from his Nuapali grant. Perhaps, towards the close of his reign or his success of Madhavaraja II, Kongoda came under the sway of Sasanka of Gauda.

2.2.3.6. Madhavaraja II Sainyabhita II (615 - 665 A.D.)

The lost glory of the Sailodbhava dynasty was restored and firmly established by Madhavaraja II Sainyabhita II, the son and successor of Charamparaja. He ruled over Kongoda *Mandala* under different circumstances at least for fifty years as feudatory and independent ruler exhibiting his diplomatic genius. In his Ganjarn grant dated 620 AD., he has been described as the Mahasamanta of Sasanka. In the Khurda Charter of Madhavaraja, he is described as the Lord of entire Kalinga. This shows that around 626 A.D., with the fall of Sasanka, Madhvaraja II

asserted his Independence and grabbed entire Kalinga assuming the title *Sakala-Kalingadhipati*. The Gangas, who had been driven away from Kalinga by Sasanka, now gained momentum and with the help of the Western Chalukyas reasserted their sway over Kalinga. This fact has been asserted from the Chicacole plates of the Ganga ruler Indravarman III. At this juncture, Madhavaraja II thought it prudent to acknowledge the suzerainty of the Gangas which has been corroborated by the subsequent Charters. After the issue of Khurda Charter, he never, mentions himself as the 'Lord ot Kalinga'.

Right from 628 A.D. Madhavaraja “became conspicuously famous as Madhavavarman, revealed from the Buguda and Purusottampur Charters. Further, his kingdom was known as Kongoda *mandala.* In the struggle for mastery over South India between' Harsavardhan and Pulakeshin II, Madhavavarman remained silent and maintained his independent status as a buffer state. With the death of Pulakesin II in 642 AD., Harsavardhan conquered Kongoda and Madhavavarman had no alternative but to accept the suzerainty of Harsa. Again, with the demise of Harsavardhan in 647 A.D. Madhavavarman became the independent sovereign of Kongoda *mandala.* After fiftieth regnal year i.e. C-665 AD. nothing is known about him. The way Madhavaraja II tackled the turbulent situation encompassing Kongoda testifies his genius as a shrewd diplomat. He not only saved the nascent Sailodbhava kingdom from the wrath of the great rulers like Sasanka, Pulakesin II and Harsa but also became successful in maintaining the sovereignty and strength of the empire.

2.2.3.7. Madhyamaraja I Ayasobhita II (665-695 A.D.)

Madhavaraja was succeeded by Madhyamaraja I Ayasobhita II, His Parikuda Charter describes him as a mystic person who can establish link with departed souls. He was so strong that he could run easily with able bodied persons standing on his soldiers. He was a patron of Brahmanism as the above mentioned charter records tne grant of a village in Katakabhukti *Visaya* in favour of twelve Brahmanas. Further, he performed the Vedic sacrified like *Asvamedha* and *Vajapeya.* After a glorious reign of thirty years, he breathed his last in C - 695 A.D.

2.2.3.8. Dharmaraja II Srimanabhita (C-695 - 725 A.D.)

With the passing away of Ayasovita II, a war of succession took place between his two sons- Dharmaraja II and Madhavaraja. Madhavaraja, the younger son of Ayasobhita II usurped the throne of Kongoda violating the law of primogeniture and tried to drive away Dharmaraja

from the Kingdom. However, Dharmaraja in retrospect secured the support of some powerful officers and feudatories and defeated his younger brother, Madhavaraja. The latter left Kongoda and formed an alliance with Tivaradeva, the ruler of South Kosala who wished to help Madhava for extending his sway to Kongoda. However, contrary to his expectation, of the combined army Tivaradeva and Madhavaraja was defeated by Dharmaraja. After that, Dharmaraja II firmly established his authority over Kongoda. It is known that he was a great builder of towns as revealed from his Banapur, Puri, Rampur, Nivina, Chandesvara and Kondeddle charters.

The Kama Nalinakshapura grant of Ganga King Samantavarman, mentions a high road named *Dharmaraja Kalingamarga* which was perhaps, built by Dharmaraja II. Dharmaraja II was a saintly king. He had love and adoration for religion and philosophy. He performed the Vedic sacrifices and patronised Brahmin scholars. He was famous for his religious toleration. It is known from his Banpur grant that his queen Kalyanadevi granted lands in favour of a Jaina monk Prabodha Chandra. This shows her religious catholicity.

2.2.3.9. Decline of the Sailodbhavas

Dharmaraja II was succeeded by his son Madhyamaraja II as is known from Tekkali Charter of Madhyamaraja III, the last known ruler of the dynasty. Madhyamaraja II was a young ruler and *brave* warrior. Perhaps, after his death, Sailodbhavas were driven away from Kongoda by the Bhaumakaras of Tosali around 736 A.D. Allaparaja, who succeeded Madhyamaraja, was sheltered by the Gangas of Kalinga. He ruled *over* Tekkali region as a feudatory of the Gangas. He was succeeded by grandson Madhyamaraja III, because his own Tailapa met premature death. After Madhyamaraja II, no information is gathered regarding the Sailodbhavas. *Whatever* the fact may be, the Sailodbhavas ruled over Kongoda nearly about 200 years. During their period, Brahmanism arose as a great religion over Kongoda. The dynasty faced great upheavels from external enemies and withstood those aggressions. At last, the Bhauma-Karas brought ecllipse to the Sailodbhava dynasty.

2.2.3.10. Conclusion

To conclude it can be said that the Sailodbhava rule cannot be considered to be of much importance from the political point of view. They were feudatories, ruling over a small territory and asserted their independence at opportune moments. Their historical significance lies in the fact that from them onwards we get a regular dynastic history of Odisha. The Sailodbhava period was a period of creativity in Odishan art and architecture. A number of Saiva temples like

Parsurameswar, Bharteswar, Laxmaneswar, Satrughnesvar, svarnajaleswar etc. can be assigned to Sailodbhava period.

2.2.4. The early Eastern Gangas

The Gangas of Kalinga are known in history as the Eastern Gangas in analogy of the Gangas of Mysore who are known as the Western Gangas. According to the tradition recorded in the early copper-plate grants of Chodaganga, the Eastern Gangas of Kalinga were a branch of the ruling Western Ganga family of Mysore.

Kamarnava the founder of the Eastern Ganga dynasty is said to have migrated to Kalinga with his four brothers from Kolahalapura in Gangabadivishaya (of Mysore) leaving his ancestral kingdom to his paternal uncle. He came to the Mahendragiri where he worshipped Gokarneswara Siva and then occupied the Kalinga country after defeating the Savara Chief named Baladitya, It is not possible to say how far the tradition is based on history.

2.2.4.1.Indravarman I (537 A.D.)

The first historical ruler of the Eastern Ganga dynasty known from reliable record is Indravarman I whose Jirjingi copperplate grant was issued in the Ganga year 39, i.e., 537 A.D. He is known to be a powerful ruler having a large number of vassal chiefs under him and his capital was located at Dantapura. Indravarman is identified with king Adhiraja Indra who mounting on his elephant Supratika defeated the Vishnukundin king Indrabhattaraka who fought on his elephant Kumuda. King lndravarman was also the lord of Trikalinga. He was the first great ruler of the Ganga dynasty and started the Ganga era the initial year of which is 498 A.D. This is very likely the year in which he occupied the Ganga throne.

2.2.4.2.Samantavarman(562 A.D)

The next king in the line was Samantavarman who issued his grant in the year 64 (562 A.D) from Saumyavana which was called the abode of the goddess of Victory. Like his predecessor Samantvarman assumed the title or Trikalingadhipati.

2.2.4.3.Hastivarman(577 A.D.)

Samantvarman was succeeded by king Hastivarman sometime before the year 79 (577 A.D.). This king is known to have fought many battles and he claims to have crushed a mighty confederacy of his enemies. He did not call himself the Lord of Trikalinga but declared himself as the Lord of all Kalingas (Sakala Kalinga. From his time onward till the time of Vajrahasta V (who came to the throne in 1038 AD.) no Ganga ruler called himself Trikalingadhipati.

Hastivarman was also known as Rajasimha alias Ranabhita. He was a devotee of Narayana and his Narsimhapali charter (year 79) registers grant of six halas of land along with four shrines (niresana) and a free fooding establishment in honour of god Narayan, the Lord of Seven worlds who sleeps on seven oceans and for whose pleasure seven Sama songs are being sung. Hastivarman transferred his capital from Dantapura to Kalinganagaraon the River Vamsadhara.

2.2.4.4.Indravarman II(589 AD.)

He was succeeded by his son Indravarman II who ruled at least up to the year 91 (589 AD.) the date of issue of his ParJakimedi plates.

2.2.4.5.Indravarman III (626 AD.)

The next king was Indravarman III who came to the throne sometime before the year 128 (626 AD.). He was the son of Danarnava about whom we do not know much. Indravarman III issued his first Chicacole grant in 626 A.D. On the occasion of a lunar eclipse on the full moon day of Margasira. His second Chicacole grant was issued in the year 138 (636 A.D.) on the occasion of Ratha saptami in the month of Magha indicating that Sun worship was popular in the kingdom of Gangas. In this charter he claims to have acquired proficiency in various sciences and arts. His last record the Tekkli grant is dated in the year 154.

2.2.4.6.Devendravarman-I(681 AD.)

The earliest record of the next known king Devendravarman-I is dated in the year 183 (681 AD.). Dcvendravarman was the son of Gunarnava about whom nothing is known from any record. King Devendravarman was a devout Saiva and in the year 184 he had Mantra-diksha from Patanga Sivacharya who was learned in Vedas and Vedangas, Itihasa and Puranas. He also patronised Brahmachari Pill and his sister Pillika Svamini, who were well versed in Vedas and Vedangas.

2.2.4.7.Anantavarman I(702 AD.)

He was succeeded by his son Anantavarman I who came to the throne sometime before the year 204 (702 AD.), the date of his Dharmilingeswar grant which was issued on the occasion of the marriage of a girl of the royal family.

2.2.4.8. Devendravarman(752 AD.)

After,Anantavarman-1 his two sons Nandavarrnan and Devendravarman-II became kings of Kalinga one after the other. Nandavarman came to the throne sometime before the year 221 and Devendravarman-ll sometime before the year 251. Devendravarman-Il's last known date is

the year 254 (752 AD.) after which we do not find any record of the family for about half a century.

2.2.4.9.Anantavarrnan II

The next important ruler of the family is Anantavarrnan II the son of Rajendravarman I. No grant of Rajendravarman I has come to light and as such he remains in obscurity like Danarnava and Gunarnava the fathers of Indravarman III and Devendravarman I respectively. Anantavarman II issued the Almanda grant in the year 304 (802 A.D.) on the occasion of a solar eclipse when a tank was consecrated and made open to public. He was succeeded sometime before the year 306 by his brother Devendravannan III, another son of Rajendravarman I. The last known date of this king is the year 310 when he donated the village Niyina free of all taxes to a Brahmin poet who was the son of the doorkeeper of his palace.

2.2.4.10.Anantavarman III

He was succeeded by his son Anantavarman III and after him two of his sons Rajendravarman II and Devendravarman IV became kings one after the other. One Chicacole grant of king Devendravarman IV is dated in the year 351(849 AD.) and another Chicacole grant of his son Satyavarman is also dated in the same year 351.

2.2.4.11.Other rulers of Eastern Gangas

Devendravarman was succeeded by his son Satyavarman who claims to have acquired supremacy over the whole of Kalinga by the edge of his sword. After Satyavarrnan his brother Anantavarman IV (another son of Devendravarman 1V) came to the throne. He is known from his Tekkali grant dated in the year 358 (865 A.D.). He was popularly called Vajrahasta I. The next Ganga king was Maharaja Bhupendra-varman alias Narasimha, two of whose sons Anantavannan V and Devendravarman V ruled one after the other. The Chipurupalli grant of Anantavarman V is dated in the year 383 *(881 A.D.).* In this charter Anantavarman is given the epithet Maharajadhiraja and he is also called Sri Vajrahastadeva. He was succeeded by his brother Devendravarman V sometime before the year 397 (895 AD.) the date of issue of the Chidivalasa grant . From the above discussion we find the following genealogy of the first group of the Eastern Ganga kings ofKalinga.

The Ganga years found in the respective charters of these kings are mentioned bellow against each of them :

1. [ndravarman 1-39

2. Sartlantavarman - 64

3. Hastivarman (also called Rajasimha and Ranabhita) 79,80.

4. Indravarman II (Rajasimha) 87, 91.

5. Danarnava

6. lndravarrnan II(son of No. 5) -128,137.138,154

7. Gunarnava

8. Devendravarman 1. (son of No. 7)--183,184,192,195

9. Anantavarman I(son of No. 8) - 204

10. Nandavarman (son of No.9) -221

11. Devendravarrnan II(son of No.9) - 254

12. Rajendravarman I

13. Anantavarman II (son of No. 12) - 304

14. Devandravarman Ill (son of No. 12) - 306,308,310

l5. Anatavarman II1 (son oCNo. 14) - 313,314

16. Rajendrvarman II (son of No 15) - 342

17. Devendravarman IV (son of No. *16)-35l*

18. Satyavarman (son ofNo.17) - 351

19. Anantavarrnan IV also called Vajri ofVajrahasta I(son of No.17) -358

20. Bhupendravarman (Marasimha)

21. Anantavarman V also called Vajrabasta II (son of No. 20)-383

22. Devendravarman V (son of No. 20) -397

The account of the second group of the Eastern Ganga kings is found from the charters issued by Vajrahasta V. Altogether seven copper plate grants of this king have come to Iight and these grants present identical genealogy of this group of Ganga kings with number or reigning years of each of them.

The genealogy is given below:

I. Gunarnaharnava

2. Vajrasta III (son of No. 1) - 44 years.

3.Gundarna 1 (son of No. 2) - 3 years

4. Kamarnava I(son ofNo. 2) -35 years

5. Vinayaditya (son of No.2) - 3 years

6. Vajrahasta IV also called Aniyankabhima (Anangabhima l)-35 years

7. KamarnavaJI(sonofNo.6)-1I2year

8. Gundarna II (son of No.6) - 3 years

9. Madhukamarnva (son of No.6) - 19 years

10. Vajrahasia V - (was crowned in S.E. 960) (son of No.7)

All these Ganga kings ruled over a narrowly circumscribed region which they called Kalinga. They were hemmed by the Eastern Chalukyas in the south and by the Sailodbhavas in the north. About the middle of the eighth century A.D. king Harshadeva of Kamarupa claimed victory over them. At the beginning of the 9th century A.D. the Pratihara king Nagabhata overran Kalinga and Andhra. About the middle of the 9th century the Eastern Gangas were for sometime under the Bhaurna Karas and the Eastern Chalukyas claim supremacy over Kalinga in the second half or that century. In the later part of the 10th century A.D. the Eastern Gangas were for sometime under the supremacy of the Somavamsis and lndraratha was the governor of Kalinga before he was crowned king at Yayatinagara about 1000 A.D.The Somavamsi supremacy over the Eastern Gangas was brought to an end by Vajrahasta V who came to the throne of Kalinga in 1038 A.D. and made that territory independent and powerful. Not with standing various fluctuations of their fortunes the Eastern Gangas continued to rule over Kalinga with firmness and they stalled an era of their own which continued to be used in their official charters for more than 500 years. Vajrahasta V discontinued the Ganga era and started the use of Saka era which was followed by all later Ganga kings.

2.2.5.Conclusion

Thus, political condition of Odisha underwent a great change during this period. The Matharas ruled for one hundred and fifty years. Politically independent of the Gupta suzerainty, the Mathara monarchs styled themselves as Maharajas, and Lords of Kalinga *(Kalingadhipati).* Their rule provided a sound administrative set-up to the Kalinga region. The Sailodbhavas ruled over Kongoda nearly about 200 years. During their period, Brahmanism arose as a great religion over Kongoda. The dynasty faced great upheavals from external enemies and withstood those aggressions. On the other hand, the early Eastern Gangas ruled for more than five hundred years. At last, the Bhauma-Karas brought an end to the Sailodbhava dynasty.

2.2.6. Summary

- After Samundragupta's invasion many local dynasties rose to prominence in Odisha.

- The history of Kalinga region underwent great change about the middle of the fourth century AD. after the South India campaign of Sarnudragupta.
- The political situation of the period contributed to the rise of a new ruling dynasty named Mathara.
- About the middle of the fourth century, Vishakha Varman of the Mathara family succeeded in organising a small principality in Kalinga region with its headquarters at Sripura identified with the modern village Batiasripua near Paralakhemundi in Ganjam district.
- Maharaja Visakhavannan was succeeded by Umavarman who was very likely his son.
- Maharja Saktivarman was an ambitious and warlike ruler and succeeded in unifying the Northern and Southern Kalinga.
- The Matharas ruled for one hundred and fifty years.
- Politically independent of the Gupta suzerainty, the Mathara monarchs styled themselves as Maharajas, and Lords of Kalinga *(Kalingadhipati).*
- Their rule provided a sound administrative set-up to the Kalinga region.
- In the political scenario of Odisha, the Sailodbhavas emerged as a mighty power extending their sway from the Mahanadi in the north to Mahendragiri in the south.
- They ruled over Kongoda *Mandala,* roughly comprising the undivided Ganjam and Puri districts.
- The *Ekamra Purana. Kapila Samhita, Svarnadri Mahodaya and* Hiuen Tsang's *Si-yu-ki* help a lot in constructing the history of the Sailodbhavas.
- The origin of the Sailodbhavas is shrouded in mystery.
- The Sailodbhava rule cannot be considered to be of much importance from the political point of view.
- They were feudatories, ruling over a small territory and asserted their independence at opportune moments.
- Their historical significance lies in the fact that from them onwards we get a regular dynastic history of Odisha.
- The Gangas of Kalinga are known in history as the Eastern Gangas in analogy of the Gangas of Mysore who are known as the Western Gangas.

- The first historical ruler of the Eastern Ganga dynasty known from reliable record is Indravarman I whose Jirjingi copperplate grant was issued in the Ganga year 39, i.e., 537 A.D.
- All these Ganga kings ruled over a narrowly circumscribed region which they called Kalinga.
- They were hemmed by the Eastern Chalukyas in the south and by the Sailodbhavas in the north.
- About the middle of the eighth century A.D. king Harshadeva of Kamarupa claimed victory over them.
- At the beginning of the 9th century A.D. the Pratihara king Nagabhata overran Kalinga and Andhra.
- About the middle of the 9th century the Eastern Gangas were for sometime under the Bhaurna Karas and the Eastern Chalukyas claim supremacy over Kalinga in the second half or that century.
- Thus, political condition of Odisha underwent a great change during this period. The Matharas ruled for one hundred and fifty years.
- The Sailodbhavas ruled over Kongoda nearly about 200 years. During their period, Brahmanism arose as a great religion over Kongoda.
- On the other hand, the early Eastern Gangas ruled for more than five hundred years.
- At last, the Bhauma-Karas brought an end to the Sailodbhava dynasty.

2.2.7. Exercise

- Write a note on the rise of the local dynasties after Samudragupta's invasion.
- Give an account on the rulers of Mathara dynasty.
- Make an analysis on the kings of Sailodbhava dynasty.
- Write a note on the achievements of early Eastern Ganga kings.

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Unit-2
Chapter-III
THE BHAUMAKARAS:
Origni, Chronology and Administration

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2.3.1. Introduction
2.3.2. Origin and chronology of the Bhaumakaras
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2.3.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students investigate about the Bhaumakaras. After studying this lesson you will be able to:

- *understand about the origin of the Bhaumakaras*
- *discuss the chronology of the Bhaumakaras*
- *investigate the achievements of the Bhaumakaras*
- *Identify the administration of the Bhaumakars.*

2.3.1.Introduction

In the first, half, of the eighth century A. D. a dynasty called Bhauma or Kar (also known as Bhaumakara) established its rule over the coastal belt of Orissa. The capital of this dynasty, called Guhadevapataka or Guhesvarapataka was situated near modern Jajpur town of the Jajpur district. The main literary source for constructing the history of the Bhauma-Karas are the *Vishnu Purana, Brahmanda Purana, Harivamsa Purana, Dathavamsa, Gandavyuha and Hudud-al-Alam etc*. Besides, the inscriptions and grants of the rulers of this dynasty like Neulpur plate, Ganeshgumpha inscription, Dhauli cave inscription, Terundia, Dharakote, Dhenkanal, Talcher, Ambagaon, Angul, Talatalia and several other plates throw much light on the politico-economic and religious history of this dynasty.

2.3.2.Origin and chronology of the Bhaumakaras

A dynasty called Bhauma or Kar (also known as Bhaumakara) established its rule over the coastal belt of Orissa in the first, half of the eighth century A. D.. The capital of this dynasty, called as Guhadevapataka or Guhesvarapataka was situated near modern Jajpur town of the Jajpur district. The scholars have not been able to settle conclusively the origin and chronology *of* Bhaumas. K.C. Panigrahi has traced the origin of this dynasty on the basis of the Pasupati temple inscription of Nepal. According to this inscription, Rajyamati, the queen of the Nepalese king Jayadeva, was the daughter of Harsavarman who belonged to a royal family, called Bhagadatta and conquered Gauda, Odra, Kalinga and Kosala. Since the Bhaumas of Orissa claim their descent from Bhagadatta, Panigrahi concludes that Bhaumas of Orissa and Harsavarman, the ruler of Assam, belong to Bhagadatta. He presumes that Harsavarman, after his conquest of Odra i.e., the coastal belt of Orissa, installed a member of his family as the governor of the conquered territory, who subsequently proved to be the founder of the independent dynasty of Bhauma. Because of the chaotic political situation which prevailed in Bengal and Orissa during the early part of the eighth century, it is natural that such an invasion might have taken place.

The linguistic similarity between Assamese and Oriya languages supports the possibility of interaction between the two regions in the early phase.

The scholars have also identified artistic affinity between Orissa and Assam. The Ganga images of Dah Parvatiya in the Tezpur district of Assam and of Ratnagiri in the Jajpur district possess similar iconographic features. The geographical location of Orissa is such that migration or invasion into its territory could have taken place from three directions - north-east, north-west and south-west. The Bhaumas had came from the north-east. Subsequently, the Somavamsis came from the north-west and the Gangas came from the south-west. Binayak Mishra and some other scholars hold that Orissa was the original home land of Bhaumas, and that they were a non-Aryan tribe and most probably same as Bhuyans who reside in present day Orissa. Some scholars hold that Guhasiva, the Buddhist king of Kalinga, whose name has been mentioned in the Cylonese chronicle *Dathavamsa* might have been the founder of Bhauma rule in Orissa.

In *Vishnu Purana* there is the mention of a king, named Bhauma Guha who was ruling over Kalinga, Mahisya (Midnapore) and Mahendra. Some scholars presume that Bhauma Guha was the predecessor of the Bhaumas and that Guhadeva Pataka, the Bhauma capital, was named after him. The Bhaumas, in their inscriptions and copper plate grants, used a *Samvat* or era. According to K. C. Panigrahi, the initial year of the Bhauma era corresponds to 736 A.D. of the Gregorian calendar. Who was the founder of the "Bhauma dynasty? Who initiated this new era? The Bhauma records mention two ancestors of the Bhauma rulers of Orissa. They were Lakshmikaradeva and Kshemankaradeva. According to some, Kshemankaradeva initiated the new Bhauma era. According to others, the Bhaurna era begins with the accession of Kshemankaradeva's son and successor, Sivakaradeva-1. Kshemankaradeva was a devout Buddhist. Therefore, the Buddhist epithet 'Paramopasaka' has been applied to him in the Bhauma epigraphic records. After due analysis, Biswarup Das has accepted the *view* of S. N. Rajguru who fixes it in 736 A.D. and most of the scholars incline to accept this view. The genealogy of the Bhauma-Kara rulers has been given bellow.

Genealogical table of the Bahumakara dyansty

. Kshemankaradeva = Vatsadev I

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1. Sivakaradeva I = Jayavalidev I Unmattasimha

↓

2. Subhakaradev I = Madhavadev I

↓

3.Sivakaradeva II= Mohinidevi

↓

5.Subhakaradeva II

4. Santikaradeva I Gayada I

↓

6.Subhakaradeva III

Kusumabhara I, Simhaketu

↓

7.Tribhubanamahadevi I

↓

8. Santikaradeva II

Lavanabhara I, Gayada II

↓

9.Hiramahadevi

↓

10.Subhakaradeva IV

↓

12. Prithivi Mahadevi

Tribhuvanamahadevi II

11.Sivakaradeva III

Lalitahara II

↓

13. Tribhuvanamahadevi III

↓

14. Shantikaradeva III

Lavanabhara II

15.Subhakaradeva V

↓

16. Gaurimahadevi

↓

17. Dandimahadev I

↓

18. Vakulamahadevi

↓

19.Dharmamahadevi

2.3.2.1.Kshemankaradeva

Kshemankaradeva was the founder of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty in Odisha. Before him anarchy had destoyed the social structure in this land. The Neulpur Charter of Subhakaradeva II reveals that Kshemankara established the traditional four-fold caste system in the society. His blood and iron policy maintained law and order in the empire. On the other hand, he showed his conciliatory policy towards his subjects to bring peace and harmony in the society. Kshemankaradeva took adequate steps to *preserve* the integrity of his empire. From Samangad inscription and the *Dasavatara* inscription, it becomes apparent that Rastrakuta ruler Dantidurga won victories *over* Kalinga and Kosala, but did not venture to attack Odra and Utkala. This shows the heroism of Kshemankaradeva who left no stone unturned in consolidating the Bhauma rule in Odisha.

2.3.2.2.Sivakaradeva I (C-736-783 A.D.)

Kshemankaradeva was succeeded by his worthy son Sivakaradeva I alias Unmattasimha or Unmatta Kesari. He was a mighty ruler and followed the principle of extensive aggrandisement in the north-east and south-west. The Talcher plate of Sivakara III compares him with Poros who had fought against Alexander and his Macedonian garrison. From the same plate it is known that with his grand army he marched to south west Bengal, defeated the ruler of Radha and "took away in *victory* the daughter of the king along with the latter's kingly fortune". That princess may be identified with queen Jayavallidevi who is known from the Chaurasi plate of Sivakaradeva II.

From the Talcher plate of Sivakara III, it is inferred that during his period, the Bhauma army conquered the entire Kalinga stretching from the *river* Vamsadhara to *Godavari* defeating the Ganga power. Further, his victorious arms went upto Kongoda and *Svetaka.* The Ganjam grant of *Jayavaramandeva* of *Svetaka* reveals that the *Svetaka* ruler donated the village Valarisranga in Varttini *Visaya* of Kongoda *mandala* to Bhatta Nannata after obtaining the necessary permission of Unmatta Kesari of Viraja through Visavarnavadeva, who was perhaps the *governor* of Kongoda. This fact clearly indicates that Jaya Varmandadeva was a *vassal* of Unmattakesari alias Sivakaradeva I, who was the overlord of Kongoda and Svetaka. Thus,

Sivakaradeva I extended his sway to Kalinga, Kongoda, *Svetaka* and Radha. Sivakara I was eager to maintain cultural relation with countries outside Odisha. He sent a Buddhist work *Gandavyuha* as a presentation to the Chinese emperor Te-tsong through Prajna, a Buddhist scholar who was instructed to provide the emperor of China a translation of that work. This was definitely a pointer in the direction of Sino-Indian cultural relation. Of course, scholars differ in opinion regarding the presentation of *Gandavyuha.* Some opine that it was done during Subhakaradeva I, the son and successor of Sivakaradeva I. However, the patronage of SivakaradevaI to the distinguished scholars tempt the present writer to opine in the line of many scholars that this act must *have* been accomplished during the reign period of that ruler and not probably during the time of his son Subhakaradeva I.

2.3.2.3.Subhakaradeva I (C-780-800 A.D.)

Subhakaradeva I succeeded to his father *Sivakaradeva* I who had bequeathed a *vast* kindgom for his son. During the reign period of his father, he was really instrumental to extend the sway of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty to Kalinga, Kongoda and *Svetaka.* His dream could not be fully fulfilled as he had to bear the brunt of the Rastrakuta ruler *Govinda* III. The Sanjan plate of Amoghavarsa states that Govinda III conquered Odraka along with Kosala, Kalinga, Vanga and Dahala. This fact finds a faint reference in the Hindol plate of Subhakara I which reveals that "even though he (Subhakaradeva I) was deserted by his soldiers his glory was never impaired by his adverseries and he was the best of men". Making a reterence to the *Madala Panji.* K. C. Panigrahi analyses a story recorded in it and that has near e.aborated by A. Stirling. The episode states the invasion of Haktavahu and the retreat of Subhanadeva, the king of Odisha with the images of Jagannath. Balabhadra and SLbhadra. Prof. Panigrahi identified Raktavahu with the Rastrakutas and Subhanadeva WitI' Subhakaradeva I. However, Biswarup Das rejects the view of Prof. Panigrahi on the ground that the Rastrakutas had no ill reputation of destroying the Buddhist image (God Jagannath has been treated as a Buddhist deity) anywhere. The present writer is inclined to say that since Subhakara I assumed full imperial titles like *'Paramabhattaraka* and *Paramesvara',* it is definite that he was not a feudatory of the Rastrakutas. Of course, Rastrakuta invasion took place, but it was like a meteor and had no impact on the Bhauma suzerainty. Subhakaradeva I was known for his religious toleration.Though he was a Buddhist ruler as is evident from the assumption of the title *'Parama Saugata',* he granted Komparaka village in Panchala *Visaya* and two villages of Dondaki and

Yoka in Vabhyudayar *Visaya* to 200 Brahmins. Further, his queen Madhavadevi built Madhavesvara Siva temple at Viraja and appointed a *Saivacharya* for the worship of the God as is evident from the Hamsesvara temple inscription of Jajpur. Further, she also excavated a tank near the temple and established a market *(hata)* nearby. Out and out Subhakaradev I was a brave and benevolent ruler. The Hamsesvara temple inscription describes him as a mighty king of Bhauma-Kara family. In the Bhauma records he has been described as 'a mine of good conduct and good qualities'.

2.3.2.4.Sivakaradeva II (C-800-820 A.D.)

With the accession of Sivakaradeva II, an inglorious chapter began in the history of the Bhauma-Karas. During his period, the Palas invaded Odisha. The Badal Pillar inscription of the time of Narayanapala reveals that "the Lord of Gauda (Devapala) exterminated the race of the Utkalas'. Some scholars opine that he was definitely defeated by Devapala. This fact of the Badal Pillar inscription has been corroborated by the accounts of Taranath which refers to the conquest of Utkala by Devapala. Sivakaradeva I was a Buddhist king and was known as *'Saugatasraya'*. Of course, his queen Mohinidevi was a Saiva and she built the Mohini temple at Bhubaneswar. When the Bhauma-Karas were in utter disdain and the Bhauma Kindgom resembled "a female who had a distressful heart", Sivakaradeva II stepped down from the throne giving way to his younger brother Shantikaradeva I.

2.3.2.5.Shantikaradeva I (C- 820-835 A.D.)

The manner in which Shantikaradeva I succeeded his elder brother, proved to be a turning point in the Bhauma history. To strengthen the Bhauma power, he cemented matrimonial alliance with the Western Ganga king Rajamalla. With the help of the latter, Shantikaradeva I inflicted a crushing defeat upon the Palas. Under his leadership, Odisha soon emerged as an independent kingdom. This fact has been faintly corroborated by the Hindol plate of Subhakaradeva III. In this context, it can be stated that Gosvaminide alias Tribhuvanamahadevi, whom Pandit B. Mishra and D. C. Sircar attach with Naga family is wrong, rather she belonged to the Western Ganga family, as the historical analysis reveals. Shantikaradeva I was an effective ruler and exercised tremendous control over his feudatories. The Talcher plate of Sivakara III describes that "……his fascinating lotus like feet shone with the crown less heads of subjugated rulers". The Talcher plate of Subhakara IV also corroborates this fact. Like his predecessors, he possessed noble qualities. The Hindol plate of Subhakaradeva III mentions that "he was powerful

and renowned in the world". He was well behaved, peace loving, affable and peerless in quality. The contemporary records have bestowed lavish praise on the power and glory of the Bhauma kingdom during his reign period. Perhaps, during his time, Bhauma kingdom reached the pinnacle of celebrity.

2.3.2.6.Subhakaradeva II (C-835-.838 A.D.)

The reign period of Subhakaradeva II is completely barren as nothing glorious had been attained during his reign period. From his Terundia copper plate grant it is known that he was a Buddhist and he granted a village named Lavaganda in Sulantarakurbha *Visaya* in South Tosali in favour of six Brahmins of Bharadvaja *gotra.*

2.3.2.7.Subhakaradeva III (C- 838-845 A.D.)

Subhakaradeva was succeeded by his cousin Subhakaradeva III. His reign period, though short marked a change in the Bhauma ruling family. Because this younger branch is his charter never mentions the name of Subhakaradeva II of the elder branch. Subhakaradeva III was known for his catholicity. By the request of Pulindraja, as Hindol Charter reveals, he built the temple of Pulindesvara at Yuvangulapatika and installed there a deity named Vaidyanatha Bhattaraka. For the maintenance of this temple, he donated a village Naddilo in the Kankavir *visaya* of Northern Tosali. His generosity is also reflected in the Dharakot plate that records the grant of the village Gundaja in the Jayantika *visaya* of Kongoda *mandala* in favour of two Brahmins named Narayana and Devakantha of Maudgalya and Kausika *gotra* respectively.

2.3.2.8.Tribhuvana Mahadevi I (C- 845-850 A.D.)

The political history of Bhauma-Karas took a new turn with the accession of Tribhuvana Mahadevi I. As Subhakaradeva III died issueless, his mother, the widow queen of Shantikaradeva I assumed the imperial title 'Tribhuvana Mahadevi' and ascended the throne. Her glory has been sung in the Talcher plate of Subhakaradeva IV as such- "She took upon the burden of the entire kindgom and shone like Sesanaga, holding up the entire earth on her hoods." Perhaps, her accession to the Bhauma throne was not without any opposition and she quelled the rebellion with an iron hand. A faint echo of it has been preserved in her own record in which she has been described to *have* "ascended the throne like Katyayani". She took up the title *Paramavaisnavi* as her Dhenkanal plate *reveals.*

Tribhuvana Mahadevi I maintained an effective hold over her vassals who showed her their "devoted loyalty". She gave an efficient administration to her subjects by appointing officers "of pure character and clean hands." Highlighting her glories, the Talcher plate of Subhakaradeva IV states, "During her rule the country advanced in three (branches of administration), the foes were exterminated, the glory spread abroad and there was harmony among the people."

The *Hudud-al-Alam* states that "the royal power belongs to a woman 'Who is called *rayina'* (rani or queen) and that the "Dahuma (Bhauma) does not consider anyone superior to herself." Tribhuvana Mahadevi I was instrumental in maintaining social harmony. She patronised Vaishnavism and was a great patron of Hari. She set an example by taking the reign of administration of the Bhauma family for the first time. This gave inspiration to the subsequent women ruler of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty.

2.3.2.9.Shantikaradeva II (C-850-865 A.D.)

Shantikaradeva II succeeded Tribhuvana Mahadevl I alias Gosvamini Devi. The Talcher plate of Subhakaradeva IV states that she abdicated the Bhauma-Kara throne in favour of her grandson Shantikaradeva II when the latter grew up and became fit to bear the burdern of administration. Though Shantikaradeva II has no inscription, available till now, still he has been referred in the records of his successors. From those records it is known that he was also known as "Lonabhara" or "Lavanabhara I" and "Gayada II". His queen was Hira Mahadevi, in the records of her son Subhakaradeva IV, she is known as *'Maharajadhiraja Paramesvari'*. This suggests that she took up the reign of administration for a short time after the death of her husband when her son was minor.

2.3.2.10.Subhakaradeva IV (C- 865-882 A.D.)

Shantikaradeva II was succeeded by his eldest son Subhakaradeva IV alias Kusumahara II. As revealed from the charters Subhakaradeva IV showed signs of promise since his childhood. He delved deep into the inner meaning of the sacred hymns narrated in the *Sastras* when he was not even a youth. He has been praised highly in the contemporary records which depict him as a man devoted to noble human virtues like magnanimity, gentleness royal behaviour and veracity. However, during his regime the Bhauma-Kara Kingdom had to bear the brunt qf the Somavamsi aggression. By that time Janmejaya I, the Somavamsi ruler attacked Bhauma Kingdom and Ranabhanjadeva, the feudatory of the Bhaumas in Khinjali *mandala* had

to cross swords with the mighty ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty. The ultimate death of Ranabhanja led Janmejaya I to annex Khinjali *mandala* to the Somavamsi Kingdom. Thus, this was the first signal of the decline of the Bhauma-Kara power. Anyway, Janmejaya I cemented matrimonial alliance with the Bhaumas by giving his daughter Prithivi Mahadevi to Subhakaradeva IV. This was another blunder of the Bhaumas and was largely responsible for contributing a lot to the extinction of the Bhauma authority. As envisaged, Subhakaradeva IV was a weak ruler though he possessed many good qualities.

2.3.2.11.Sivakaradeva III (C- 882-890 A.D.)

As Subhakaradeva IV died childless, he was succeeded by his brother Sivakaradeva II alias Lalitahara. Nothing remarkable is known about his reign period. In his records, he was known as *'Paramamahesvara'* and *'Paramabhattaraka'*. This shows that he was a devout Saiva. On the otherhand, he was a patron of Buddhism. This fact has been testified by his two Talcher charters which show the grant of two villages namely, Kami in the Purvarastra *visaya* and Surdhipura in the Madhyama-Khanda *visaya* in favour of the 'Buddha Bhattaraka' whose temple has been built by Ambubhattaraka. This shows his catholicity and spirit of tolerance.

2.3.2.12.Prithivi Mahadevi alias Tribhuvana Mahadevi II (C-890-896 A.D.)

After Sivakaradeva III, Prithivi Mahadevi alias Tribhuvana Mahadevi II ascended the throne. Perhaps, this happened due to interference of her father Janamejaya I. The fact cannot be definitely asserted but the possibility also cannot be over ruled. So in her charters, she pays glowing tribute to her father Janmejaya I. In the Brahmesvara inscription of the time of Somavamsi King Udyotakesari Mahabhavagupta, it is stated that Janmejaya "drew to himself the fortune of the King of Odra country, who was killed by his Kunta in a battle". This fact along with the description of his qualities in Tribhuvana Mahadevi's charters together establish the fact that Janmejaya I was instrumental in placing Prithiv Mahadevi in the throne of the Bhauma-Karas. At this juncture, Sankaragana, the Kalachuri king invaded Kosala and Janmejaya I remained busy in fighting with the aggressor. Taking advantage of this situation, the loya officials of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty approached the widow queen of Sivakaradeva III to assume the Bhauma throne subsiding the claim of Prithivi Mahadevi. This led Tribhuvana Mahadevi to ascend the Bhauma throne. By that time Janmejaya I had concluded peace with the Kalachuris. However, he did not think it prudent to interfere in the administration of Tosali as

Tribhuvana Mahadevi III had firmly established his position in Tosali. It appears that Prithivi Mahadevi spent rest of her life at her father's residence at Kosala.

2.3.2.13.Tribhuvana Mahadevi III (C-896-905 A.D.)

It has been stated earlier the circumstance in which Tribhuvana Mahadevi II ascended the throne. She assumed imperial titles like *'Paramabhattaraka', Maharajadhiraja* and *'Paramesvan'.* She was praised for her magnanimity, courtsey, beauty and valour. She was also a Vaisnava by faith. She was a pious lady. From the Dhenkanal Charter it is known that she granted a village Kontaspara in favour of one Bhatta Jagadhar, an astrologer for the purpose of bringing down rains inorder to avert the calamity of death. She reigned for a brief period of nine years.

2.3.2.14.Shantikaradeva III and Subhakaradeva V (C- 905-910 A.D.)

Shantikaradeva III and Subhakaradeva V, the son of Sivakaradeva III succeeded Tribhuvana Mahadevi III one after another. Their reign period was quite uneventful. However, peace and tranquility prevailed over the Bhauma kingdom. Regarding Shantikaradeva III, the Angul plate of Dharma Mahadevi states that he "lived happily, as fearless he was, after the extirpation of all adversaries." Similarly, regarding Subhakaradeva V, the Kumurang plate of Dandi Mahadevi states that he was "the slole repository of all kinds of prosperity". However, nothing concrete is known about his activity.

2.3.2.15.The last days of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty (C-910-950 A.D.)

After Subhakaradeva V, the last male ruler of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty, four female rulers occupied the Bhauma throne one after another.

2.3.2.16.Gauri Mahadevi

First among them was Gauri Mahadevi, the queen of Subhakaradeva V. Of course, no record of her time is available. She was however, able to preserve the law and order inside the kingdom. Praising her, the Kumurang plate of Dandi Mahadevi states " ..... at her lotus-like feet was prostrate the entire population (of the kingdom)"

2.3.2.17.Dandi Mahadevi

Gauri Mahadevi was succeeded by her daughter Dandi Mahadevi. She issued a large number of grants like Kumurang grant. Santarigrama grant, Arual grant, Ambagan grant and two Ganjam grants. She not only possessed grace and charm but successfully maintained her authority over the entire Bhauma kingdom. Further, she secured the boarders of the Bhauma-

Kara dynasty from the "formidable and hostile kings, humbled by her prowess". In her records, she assumed imperial titles like *'Paramamahesvari' 'Paramabhattarika'* and *'Maharajadhiraja Paramesvari'*. This indicates that she was a powerful ruler. This fact has been further corroborated by the donation of lands both in *Uttara* Tosali and *Dakshina* Tosali. The description of pearls and gems in her records testifies the fact, that Bhauma Kingdom was prosperous by her time.

2.3.2.18.Vakula Mahadevi

Dandi Mahadevi died a premature death and was succeeded by her step mother Vakula Mahadevi who belonged to the Bhanja family. 'Nothing more is known about this ruler except the donation of a village in *Uttara* Tosali. One thing becomes clear that the Bhanjas now entered into the internal administration of the Bhauma-Karas.

2.3.2.19.Dharma Mahadevi

Dharma Mahadevi, the wife of Shantikaradeva III succeeded Dandi Mahadevi. She was the last known ruler of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty. She issued two charters, the Angul charter and Taltali charter. In the latter charter, she has been described as *'Paramabhattarika Maharajadhiraja Paramesvari'*. However, as she was a Bhanja princess, the entry of the Bhanjas in the internal affairs of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty had become crystal clear. Her rule was not significant and paved the way for the downfall of the Bhauma-Karas. The rise of the Somavamsis under Janmejaya I had more particularly, during Yayati I signalled the down fall of the Bhauma-Karas. Yayati I who ousted the Bhanjas from Baud-Sonepur region, perhaps occupied the Bhauma kingdom by killing Dharma Mahadevi, the last ruler of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty. This is evident from his copper plate grant which mentions about his donation of a village named Chandra grama in Marada *Visaya* of *Dakshina* Tosali. Thus, with the fall of the Bhauma-Karas, the reign of administration of Tosali passed into the hands of the Somavamsis.

2.3.2.20.Administration

The Bhauma-Karas gave a stable administration to the people of this land. The kings used high sounding titles like *'Paramabhattaraka', 'Maharajadhiraja', 'Paramesvara* etc. The form of government was obviously monarchical and the Bhauma-Karas follow the law to primogeniture. However, there was exception to it as is found particularly, witthe Bhauma queens.

2.3.2.21.Officers in Bhauma administration

The Bhauma kings were assisted by many officers in discharge in their administration. They *were Mahasamanta, Maharaja, Ranaka, Rajaputra, Antaranga. Kumaramatya, Uparika, Visayapati, Ayuktaka, Danda pasika, Sthanontarika, Vallabha Chata, Bhata, Pratihara, Mahasandhivigraha (ka), Mahakshapatalika, Kutakola, Dutaka* etc The capital of the Bhauma Kingdom was Guhadevapataka (Guhesvarapataka) at Biraja in Jajpur. Though there is controversy among historians, still this is accepted with tolerable degree of certainty.

2.3.2.22.Relation with the feudatories

Like the Guptas, the Bhauma-Kara kings maintained good relation with the feudatories. Their kingdoms were not annexed and so, they remained as *vassel* states helping the Bhauma sovereign at the time of war. The Sulkis, Bhanjas and the Nandodbhavas remained as feudatories under the Bhauma-Karas. Thus, the state-craft under the Bhauma- Karas was efficient and well-organised.

2.3.2.23. Religion during Bhauma-Kara rule

The Bhauma-Kara kings were the patrons of Buddhism. During their reign the Mahayana Buddhism reached the pinnacle of celebrity in Orissa. During their perioc the evolution of Buddhism from Mahayana to Vajrajana took place. The hills of Ratnagir Udyagiri and Lalitgiri near Chandikhol possess various images of the Mahayana deities an, ruins of some stupas. The Bhauma-Karas also patronised Saivism. The Saiva temples of Shishiresvara, Markandesvara and *Talesvara* in Bhubaneswar bear ample testimony of it. The figures of the couchant bull on the seals attached to most of the Bhauma copper plates are also pointers in this direction. Under their patronage, Vaishnavism also grew I this land. The Dhenkanal plate of Tribhuvana Mahadevi I shows that she bore the title *'Parama Vaisnavi'*, a devout worshipper of Vishnu. Similarly, Subhakaradeva IV, Prithi Mahadevi and Shantikaradeva II were also followers of Vaishnavism. Among the feudatories of the Bhaurna-Karas, the Bhanjas and Nandodbhavas were the followers of Vaishnavism. Saktism also received patronage from the Bhauma rulers. Their capital Guhadevapataka (Viraja) was a famous Sakti centre during that time. As discussed earlier, Tribhuvana Mahadevi I compared herself as *Katyayani* (a form of goddess Durga) in her Dhenkana charter when she ascended the throne. The Vaitala temple, Mohini temple and Uttresvara temple in Bhubaneswar which contain the *Chamunda* figures also bear ample testimony of the patronage to the Sakta cult by the Bhauma-Kara rulers. Thus, patronising Buddhis Saivism, Vaishnavism and Saktism, the Bhauma ruler tried to bring synthesis among

Various religious cults which actually was the precursor of a new era. The Buddhist art, archetecture and sculpture reached their perfection in Orissa during the Bhauma-Kara period. Several images of Buddha and Bodhisattava found at Udayagiri, Ratnagiri and Lalitgiri, Khadipada, Solanapura, Kupari, Ayodhya, Tara images of Ratnagi, various Buddhist sculptures found at Choudwar, the Buddhist images of Sankaresvara temple in Salipur and Gokamesvara temple in Dharmasala, Buddhist bronze images of Banapur etc. clearly show that the Buddhist art and architecture were qiver patronage during the Bhauma-Kara period.

2.3.3.Conclusion

Thus, the Bhauma-Kara rule was a landmark in the socio-cultural life of Orissa. It brought a stable administration with full control over the feudatories. The Bhauma-Kings paid attention to the growth of trade and commerce of the land. They were great builders too. The period witnessed the coherence among various religions like Buddhism, Saivism, Saktism and Vaishnavism. A culminating trend among these religions began during this period. Their capital Guhesvarapataka (modern Viraja in Jajpur) was studded with 'various temples associated with Saiva, Sakta and Vaishnava faith. However, the glorious rule of the Bhauma-Karas ended with the capture of power by the Somavamsis.

2.3.4. Summary

- In the first, half, of the eighth century A. D. a dynasty called Bhauma or Kar (also known as Bhaumakara) established its rule over the coastal belt of Orissa.
- The capital of this dynasty, called Guhadevapataka or Guhesvarapataka was situated near modern Jajpur town of the Jajpur district.
- The main literary source for constructing the history of the Bhauma-Karas are the *Vishnu Purana, Brahmanda Purana, Harivamsa Purana, Dathavamsa, Gandavyuha and Hudud-al-Alam etc*.
- The scholars have not been able to settle conclusively the origin and chronology *of* Bhaumas.
- After due analysis, Biswarup Das has accepted the *view* of S. N. Rajguru who fixes it in 736 A.D. and most of the scholars incline to accept this view.
- Kshemankaradeva was the founder of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty in Odisha.
- Before him anarchy had destoyed the social structure in this land.

- Kshemankaradeva was succeeded by his worthy son Sivakaradeva I alias Unmattasimha or Unmatta Kesari.
- He was a mighty ruler and followed the principle of extensive aggrandisement in the north-east and south-west.
- Subhakaradeva I succeeded to his father *Sivakaradeva* I who had bequeathed a *vast* kindgom for his son.
- With the accession of Sivakaradeva II, an inglorious chapter began in the history of the Bhauma-Karas.
- The manner in which Shantikaradeva I succeeded his elder brother, proved to be a turning point in the Bhauma history.
- To strengthen the Bhauma power, he cemented matrimonial alliance with the Western Ganga king Rajamalla.
- The reign period of Subhakaradeva II is completely barren as nothing glorious had been attained during his reign period.
- Subhakaradeva was succeeded by his cousin Subhakaradeva III. His reign period, though short marked a change in the Bhauma ruling family.
- The political history of Bhauma-Karas took a new turn with the accession of Tribhuvana Mahadevi I.
- Shantikaradeva II succeeded Tribhuvana Mahadevl I alias Gosvamini Devi.
- Shantikaradeva II was succeeded by his eldest son Subhakaradeva IV alias Kusumahara II.
- He has been praised highly in the contemporary records which depict him as a man devoted to noble human virtues like magnanimity, gentleness royal behaviour and veracity.
- After Sivakaradeva III, Prithivi Mahadevi alias Tribhuvana Mahadevi II ascended the throne.
- Shantikaradeva III and Subhakaradeva V, the son of Sivakaradeva III succeeded Tribhuvana Mahadevi III one after another.
- After Subhakaradeva V, the last male ruler of the Bhauma-Kara dynasty, four female rulers like Gauri Mahadevi, Dandi Mahadevi, Vakula Mahadevi, Dharma Mahadevi occupied the Bhauma throne one after another.

- The Bhauma-Karas gave a stable administration to the people of this land. The kings used high sounding titles like *'Paramabhattaraka', 'Maharajadhiraja', 'Paramesvara* etc.
- The form of government was obviously monarchical and the Bhauma-Karas follow the law to primogeniture.
- The Bhauma-Kara kings were the patrons of Buddhism. During their reign the Mahayana Buddhism reached the pinnacle of celebrity in Orissa.
- The Buddhist art, archetecture and sculpture reached their perfection in Orissa during the Bhauma-Kara period.
- Thus, the Bhauma-Kara rule was a landmark in the socio-cultural life of Orissa.
- It brought a stable administration with full control over the feudatories.

2.3.5. Exercise

- Write a note on the Bhaumakaras.
- Give an account on the origin and chronology of the Bhaumakaras.
- Make an analysis on the political history of Bahumakara dynasty.
- High light the achievements of the kings of Bhaumakara dynasty.
- Discuss about the administration of the Bhaumakara dynasty.

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Unit-3
Chapter-I
THE SOMAVAMSIS:
Early history, Dynastic history and achievements of rulers::
Cultural significance of the Somavamsi rule

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3.1.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students investigate about the Somavamsi dynasty. After studying this lesson you will be able to:

- *to learn the early history of the Somavamsis;*
- *to analyze the dynastic history of the Somavamsis;*
- *to investigate achievements of the Somavamsi rulers;*
- *to trace the cultural significance of the Somavamsi rulers*

3.1.1. Introduction

The reign of the Somavamsis for two hundred years forms a glorious epoch in history of Odisha. For the first time Kalinga, Utkala, Kongoda and Kosala were unified and brought under one political authority. The uniform pattern of administration removed anarchy and confusion throughout the state and paved the way for a cultural synthesis leading to the emergence of a unique Odia culture. The Odishan temple architecture took a concrete shape during the Somavamsis and the kingdom witnessed peace and prosperity.

3.1.2. The early history of the Somavamsis

The Somavamsis, other wise known as Panduvamsis, ruled over Odisha from the middle of the ninth century A.D. to the early part of the twelfth century A.D. Initially, in the seventh and eighth centuries A.D., they ruled over a piece of territory, known as Dakhina Kosal or South Kosala (corresponding to the Raipur and Bilaspur districts of Madhya Pradesh and the Sambalpur and Kalahandi districts of Odisha). Sirpur, a place, situated in the Raipur district, was the capital of-the Somavamsis of south Kosala. Udayana was the founder of this dynasty. Tivaradeva, the fourth king of the line, was its most powerful ruler. He established his sway over the whole of Kosala. In the west he extended his territory as far as the Vindhyas. But in the east his efforts to bring Kangoda within his political sway failed. Tivaradeva ruled from 700 A.D. to 725 A.D. At the dawn of the ninth century A D., Sornavamsi kingdom was invaded by Govinda-lll, the Rastrakuta king. For sometime, the Somavamsis remained under the hegemony of the Rastrakutas. After the death of Govinda-III in 814 A.D the Somavamsis could emancipate themselves from the hegemony of the Rastrakutas. But, there after they were exposed to the threats of another power, the Kalachuris of Ratnapur (a place in the Bilaspur district of Madhya Pradesh). By the middle of the ninth century A.D. the Somavamsis were seeking eastward expansion most probably because of the Kalachuri menace. The last known king of Somavamsis of south Kosal was Balarjuna Sivagupta who died in 810 A.D. After him, there is a genealogical gap for more than half a century. With the emergence of Janrnejaya-l in the last quarter of the ninth century A.D. we get a regular genealogical line of the Sornavarnsis up to the beginning of

the twelfth century A.D. The inscription of Janmejaya-I, the builder of the Somavamsi power in Odisha, mention Sivagupta as his predecessor. The Somavamsi rulers of Odisha were alternatively using two titles - Mahabhavaupta and Mahasivagupta. Besides these facts the same dynastic name strongly suggests that Janmejaya-I was the descendant of the Somavamsis of south Kosala.

Sources

There is no such written record regarding the complete history of the Somavamsi rulers and their achievements. However, we get some information from the following inscriptions.

The Banda Copper plates of Tivaradeva, Adhavara plates of Mahanannararaja Banda plates of Mahasivagupta; Patna, Kalibhana and other copper plates of Janrneiaya Cuttack, Nibinna and Patna plates of Yayati I; Kalanjar stone inscription, Arang store inscription, Sirpur stone inscription and other inscriptions of the rulers of this dynasty ar the contemporary Bhanja, Bhauma-Kara, Ganda and other inscriptions throw a good dea of light on the achievements of the rulers of this dynasty.

3.1.3. Dynastic history and achievements of the rulers

The dynastic history of the Somavamsis deals with the rulers of this dynasty and the achievements of the Somavamsi kings which we found from the above sources. The genealogy of the Somavamsis can be reconstructed as follows.

GENEALOGY OF THE SOMAVAMSIS

Mahasivagupta

↓

Janmejaya I

↓

↓	↓	↓
Yayati I	Vichitravira	Prithvi Mahadevi (Bhauma Queen)
↓	↓	
Bhimarath	↓	
↓	↓	
	↓	
↓ ↓ ↓	↓	

Dharmaratha Nahusa Indrarath ↓

Abhimanyu

↓

Chandidhara Yayati II

↓

↓ ↓

Udyota Keshari Abhimanyu II (Koshala

↓

↓ ↓

Janmejaya II Kumar Somesvara

↓ ↓ ↓

Yuvaraja Dharmaratha Puranjaya Karnadeva

3.1.3.1. Janmejaya I Mahabhavagupta (C- 882 - 922 A.D.)

Janmejaya I was the successor of Panduvamsi or Somavamsi dynasty. His copper plates describe his relation with Mahasivagupta, his only predecessor, who is supposed to be his father. Being driven away from D*akshina* Kosala that comprised the undivided Sambalpur and Bolangir districts of western Odisha which he termed as Kosala whose capital was Suvarnapura (modern Sonepur), Janmejaya I, thus, became the first ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty of Kosala. After consolidating his empire, Janmejaya I wanted to cross sword with the Bhanjas of Khinjali *MandaI* who were the feudatory of the Bhauma-Karas of Tosali. The Bhanja king Ranabhanjadeva became the victim of Janmejaya who inflicted a crushing defeat on the former and annexed the Baud-Phulbani area to his kindgom. This paved the way for the conquest of Utkala.

In addition, Janmejaya I wanted to extend his sway over Utkala. He was instrumental in placing Tribhuvana Mahadevi II alias Pritivi Mahadevi, the widow queen of Subhakaradeva IV on the throne of the Bhaumas. Though he had defeated the King of Odra, but he made peace with him perhaps, due to the fact that he had to deal with the kalachuris of Oahala. However, his endeavour to extend his authority upto Utkala was certainly commendable. Janmejaya I also

subdued the Kalachuris. In the record of his son and successor Yajati I, Subhatunga (Janmejaya I) is said to have defeated the Chaidyas (Kalachuris). Janmejaya I was a powerful ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty. He assumed high sounding titles like' *Paramesvara', 'Paramabhattaraka,' 'Trikalingadhipati'* etc.

3.1.3.2. Mahasivagupta Yayati I (C-922-955 A.D.)

Yayati I ascended the throne after Janmejaya I. He not only firmly consolidated his empire but also followed a policy of expansion. Soon after his accession, he shifted his capital from Suvarnapura to Vinitapura, which has been identified with Binka around twenty-five kilometer from Sonepur situated on the bank of river Mahanadi. Fifteen years after, he shifted the capital again to Yayatinagara near Baud. However, Biswarup Das identifies Yayatinagara with Jajpur which was also known as *Yayatitirtha.* Yayati I had a rift with the Kaiachuris. His two copper plate grants and also a charter of his son and successor state that he captured 32 elephants and rescued the captured women who were forcibly being taken away from Kosala by Yuvaraja, the Kalachuri king of Dahala. The charters narrate that Yayati I not only rescued the women and elephants of Kosala but also killed the protector and burnt a part of the Kalachuri country. Thus, with tolerable degree of certainty, it can be stated that he subdued the Kalachuris.

The great achievement of Yayati I was his annexation of the Bhauma kingdom into his own kingdom. Though the circumstance under which Yayati I occupied the Bhauma throne is not known, still it is definite that the territory was under the grip of his authority. In his ninth regnal year, he granted a village Chandragrama in *Dakshina* Tosali in favour of a Brahmin named Sankhapani of Odra *desa* recorded in his Cuttack plate charter. From this it is *evident* that he had extended his sway upto Tosali. It was Yayati I who was instrumental in subjugating the Bhanjas. From his copper plate grant of the fifteenth regnal year it is known that he offered a village named Gandharadi in the later Bhanja period as gift in the Gandhatapati *mandala.* Gandharadi is *twelve* miles away from Baud. It happened during the period of Satrubhanja who was defeated by Yayati I. Had it not been so, it would not *have* been possible on his part to grant a *village* at the heart of the Bhanja territory. Yayati I was a *brave* warrior. Not only he crossed sword with the Kalachuris but subdued the Bhanjas and held his sway *over* the Bhauma kingdom of Tosali.

3.1.3.3. Bhimaratha Mahasivagupta I (C-955-980 A.D.)

After Yayati I, his son Bhimaratha ascended Somavamsi throne. The records of his time do not throw much light on his political career. Bilhari stone inscription of the Kalachuri king Yayati I states that Lakshmanaraja who ruled at Tripuri from around 945 to 970 A.D. "worshipped *Somesvara* and with the effigy of Kaliya wrought of jewels and gold which had been obtained from the prince of Odra after defeating the Lord of Kosala." This shows that by that time Odra had become a part of the Kosala kingdom. The defeat of the king of Kosala and the taking away of the effigy of Kaliya (the serpent) from Odra by Lakshmariaraja clearly shows that Odra was under the sway of Kosala and most probably the appointment of subordinate rulers for Odra started with Bhimaratha. In the Khandapara plates of Dharmaratha, he has been praised as "religious, courageous, valorous who performed wonderful activities and assumed the status of *Devaraja* (Indra)." Definitely, his rule contributed in the consolidation of the Somavamsi Empire and brought peace and tranquility in the country.

3.1.3.4. Dharmaratha (C-980-1005 A.D.)

Dharmaratha who succeeded Bhimaratha was definitely a powerful ruler. His grant of a village in the Antaruda *Visaya* (Antarudra *Pragana* of the undivided Puri district) clearly shows that he was the master *over* the Bhauma Kingdom by then. In the Brahmesvara temple inscription, he has been described as the 'Second Parasurama'. Perhaps, he subdued the Pala power in Gauda and fought valiantly with the Estern Chalukyas of the South.

3.1.3.5. Nahusa (C-1005-1021 A.D.)

As Dharmaratha died issueless, his brother, Nahusa succeeded him to the throne of Kosala. His period was uneventful. His inefficiency might have brought unpopularity to him. Perhaps, he was killed by Indraratha, another brother of Dharmaratha, who ascended the throne after him.

3.1.3.6. Indraratha (C-1021-1023 A.D.)

Indraratha had been appointed by Dharmaratha as the governor of Kalinga. Perhaps, the aspiration of Indraratha to the throne of Kosala led him to cross sword with Nahusa. As a result, the latter with his uncle Abhimanyu were killed. Indraratha was regarded as a usurper and so, his name does not figure in the Somavamsi charters. He was defeated at the hands of Rajendra Chola and was probably killed.

3.1.3.7. Chandihara Yayati II (C-1 023-1040 A.D.)

The death of Indraratha by Rajendra Chola at Yayatinagara created anarchy and confusion in the Somavamsi dynasty. At that critical juncture, the ministers declared Chandihara Yayati II, the son of Abhimanyu and grandson of Vichitravira, a lineal descendant of Janmejaya as the king of Kosala. With his accession, Yayati II paid his attention to the kingdom of Utkala which fell vacant due to the death of Dharma Mahadevi, the last ruler of the Bhauma-Karas. Yayati II immediately occupied it. Thus, Utkala was totally subjugated and amalgamated with the kingdom of Kosala.

Chandihara Yayati II was a mighty ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty. In his charter it has been described that his "footstool is kissed by the great jewels of the headgears of all kings or subordinate kings, who (in character) resembled such, renowned kings as Nala, Nahusa, Mandhata, Dilipa, Bharata and Bhagiratha." In his records, he has also been credited to have conquered Karnata, Lata, Gujrat, Dravida country, Kanchi, Gauda, Radha, Trikalinga and assumed the title *'Maharajadhiraja'*. Of course, the conquest of the above mentioned territories are mere poetic exaggeration. He appears to have maintained friendly relation with Rastrakutas as during the period of Krishna III, his records never mention about himself or his army who carried arms to Kosala or Utkala. No Rastrakuta king after Krishna III also has mentioned the latter's victory over Kosala or Utkala.

Yayati II was a patron of Brahmanism. Tradition credits him of inviting 10,000 Brahmins from Kanyakubja (Kanauj) to perform Dasasvamedha sacrifice at Jajpur. It was a great landmark in the cultural heritage of Odisha and till now the memory of that noble work of Yayati II is reflected in the nook and corner of Odisha during the marriage ceremony and at the time of giving *pinda* at *Navigaya* in Jajpur. Yayati II is also credited with the construction of the Lingaraj temple at Bhubaneswar which was completed during his successor Udyotakesari. Of course, the family deity of Yayati II was Panchamvari Bhadramvika, a form of Goddess Durga. Yayati II was the greatest ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty. He consoiidated the empire firmly which was full to anarchy and confusion. His vast empire extended from the Bay of Bengal in the east to Sambalpur in the west and from Dandakabhukti to Ganjam in the south. Under his patronage, Brahmanism flourished in Odisha.

3.1.3.8. Udyotakesari Mahabhavagupta (C-1 040-1 065 A.D)

Udyotakesari, who succeeded Yayati II, was a worthy son of an illustrious father. He settled score with Karna, the Kalachuri ruler who had first invaded the Somavamsi kingdom. Later on, Udyotakesari invaded Dahala and got victory over it. Similarly, the enemity that existed between Gauda and Kosala ended with the defeat of Vigrahapala II of the Pala dynasty. As Udyotakesari faced the attack of the enemies from different directions, he divided his kingdom into two parts, *viz*, the Kosala part left under the care of his grandfather Abhimanyu and he himself ruled over Utkala portion. He also completed the construction of the Lingaraj temple at Bhubaneswar.

3.1.3.9. Janmejaya II (C-1065-1085 A.D.)

With the accession of Janmejaya II, the son of Udyotakesari, disintegration of the Somavamsi dynasty started. During his period, Somesvaradeva, the Chandika Naga ruler sent his general, Yasorajadeva of Telugu Choda family who occupied the Eastern Kosala. By that time, the Western Kosala also passed into the hands of the Kalachuris. Janmejaya II also faced an invasion from the Ganga king Raja Raja II of Kalinga. All these invasions brought distress to Janmejaya who breathed his last after the Ganga invasion.

3.1.3.10. Puranjaya (C-1085-1100 A.D.)

Janmejaya II was succeeded by his son Puranjaya I. During his period, Ratnagiri inscription states that he kept his feudatory chiefs in control. Further, he also resisted successfully the invasion of the kings of Gauda, Dahala, Kalinga and Vanga. It seems that taking advantage of the weakness of the Somavamsis, the above mentioned powers invaded the Somavamsi kingdom and paved the way for its downfall.

3.1.3.11. Karnadeva (C-1100-1110 A.D.)

Karnadeva was the last known ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty who was the brother of Puranjaya. Though in his records, he has been praised as a great ruler having full control over his feudatories, but it is not true. From his fragmented inscription preserved in the Jayadev museum, Bhubaneswar proves that his kingdom extended upto Balasore district (from Gandibeda village, the inscription is found) which was the last limit of *Uttara* Tosali. Dandakabhukti *mandala* was ruled then by Jayasimha, the feudatory of Ramapala of Bengal.

During his period, Chodagangadeva attacked Utkala more than once. The Ratnagiri inscription and the *Ramacharita* of Sandhyakara Nandi together justify the fact that by the help

of the Palas, Krishnadeva, the shrewed and able minister of karnadeva saved Utkala from the onslaught of the Gangas. However, this resistance was feeble and at last the Somavamsi Kingdom fell a prey to the Gangas who established their sway over Utkala.

3.1.3.12. Administration of the Somavamsis

The political unification of Odisha under the Somavamsis brought with it an efficient administration. Due to political reasons, the Somavamsi kings shifted their capital from time to time. As they had no permanent capital, they issued their charters from different places like Vinitapura, Murasima, Suvarnapura and Yayatinagara. Yayatinagara, popularly identified with Jajpur, is very much familiar as the capital of the Somavamsis.

3.1.3.13. Position of the King

The king occupied the highest position in the realm of administrative structure. No doubt, kingship was hereditary but some times the ministers had a voice in the selection of a king as happened in the case of Yayati II. When a king was minor, someone from the royal family acted as his regent. The king exercised unlimited royal power. For promoting trade and commerce inside the country the king generously gave grants to the merchant community. For the promotion of learning, they granted lands to the Brahmins. To spread Brahmanism inside the land, they patronised the Brahmin, performed several Vedic sacrifices including *Asvamedha* sacrifice. They also built a good number of Saiva temples to meet the same end. All these activities show that though the Somavamsi kings were powerful, they were not despots rather on the other hand, they were liberals and looked after the welfare of the people.

3.1.3.14. Ministers and officials

The king was assisted by many important ministers and officers. Among the ministers important were *Mantritilaka* (Chief Minister), *Mahasandhivigrahika* (Minister of war and peace and also looking after the preparation of the charter) and *Mahakshapatalika* (Minister, preparing charter). The *Mahasenapati* (Commander-in-chief) looked after the army promotion of religion and morality. Besides, a number of officers like *Samahartri, Sannidhatri, Outaka, Niyuktaka, Dandapasika, Mahakashapataia, Mahakshapataladhyaksha, Chattas, Bhattas, Ranaka, Rajaputra* etc. The Somavamsis divided their kingdom into several *mandalas* corresponding to a province. A *mandala* was further divided into several *bhuktis* and each *bhukti* was further subdivided into *bhoga*, *khanda* and *grama* which was the smallest administrative unit under the Somavamsi kings. The Somavamsi rulers maintained large standing armies, consisting of

infantry, cavalry and elephantry. The kings themselves were the supreme heads of the military forces and led them in battle.

3.1.4. Cultural significance of the Somavamsi rule

The cultural contribution of the Somavamsis is significant in many ways. The Somavamsis accepted the *Varnashrama dharma* i.e., traditional division of the society into four *Varr.as (Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya* and *Sudra),* and gave the highest status to the Brahmanas. By performing Vedic sacrifices and facilitating the migration of Brahrnanas from northern India through generous offer of land grants the Somavamsi rulers promoted the Brahminisation of the socio-religious life of Odisha as well as the assimilation of the north Indian Sanskritic culture into the Odishan culture.

Women enjoyed respectable status in the Somavamsi society. Some of the Somavamsi queens performed important works like the construction of temples. The Queen Kolavatidevi, the mother of Udyota Keshari constructed the Brahmeswar temple at Bhubaneswar. Nevertheless, the status of women appears to have degenerated during this period. The *Devadasi* practice (the practice of dedicating maidens to the temples) and prostitution were prevalent during this period. The last Somavamsi king, Karnadeva married a dancing girl, named Karpurasri who was born of a *Mahari* or *Devadasi.*

3.1.4.1. Religious life of the Somavamsi rulers

The Somavamsi rulers were devoted Saivites. They helped the growth and spread of Saivism by the construction of Siva temples and offer of liberal land grants to the Saiva temples, priests and ascetics. Consequently, a number of Saiva gurus, such as Sadasivacharya, rathamacharya and Acharya Gagana Siva came to Odisha from far and wide and enjoyed the patronage of the Somavamsi rulers. With the help of Janmejaya I Gagana Siva built the Someswar temple at Ranipur-Jharial. Yayati-I built the beautiful Saiva temple of Mukteswar. The construction of the gigantic Saiva temple of Lingaraj was started by Yayati-ll and completed by Udyotakeshari. Though ardent Saivites themselves, the Somavamsis continued the Bhaumakara tradition of religious toleration. They tolerated other sects such as Jainism, Vaishnavism and Saktism.The king Udyota Keshari carved Navamuni and Varabhuja caves for the Jaina ascetics.

3.1.4.2 Art and Architecture

The Somavamsis left their imperishable legacy in the field of art and architecture. The Odishan temple architecture which began in the Sailodbhava period reached the height of perfection towards the close of the Somavamsi period. The Odishan temple reached its complete form towards the close of the Somavamsi period. The architectural activities in the later period, though by no means scarce, were more concerned with elaboration than with any introduction of new features or forms indicating new directions of development. Out of the numerous temples, built by the Somavamsis four are most magnificent Lingaraj, Brahmeswar, Mukteswar and Rajarani (all in Bhubaneswar). Each of them is a masterpiece of Odishan architecture. The images of these temples are also the finest specimens of sculpture.

3.1.4.3. Promotion of Learning

There was a phenomenal development in the field of Sanskrit learning and literature during the Somavamsi period. The inscriptions of the period speak of the proficiency of the scholars in *Vedas, Vedanga, Smtitis, Puranas,* medical sciences, Astrologgy, *Arthasastra,* Grammar, Poetry, History, Political Science and Logic. The land grants to the learned Brahmanas facilitated the study of Sanskritic literature. A number of Sanskrit scholars such as Sadharana, Purushottam Bhatta, Bhavadeva, Acharya Subhachandradeva and Narayana Satakarni flourished during the Somavamsi period. Sadharana, the chief minister of Janmejava I was well-versed in *Veda, Vedanga, Vidya, Siksa, Kalpa, Itihas, Smriti* and *Arthasastra.* Purushottam Bhatta wrote a eulogy on King Udyota Keshari. Some of the Somavamsi kings themselves were scholars. The Somavamsi inscriptions use some typical Odia words such as *Khamba, Punya* and *Machha.* This period was undoubtedly a significant phase in the formation of Odia language.

3.1.5. Conclusion

Thus, the Somavamsi rule undoubtedly ushered a new era in the history of medieval Odisha. The rulers of this dynasty were great conquerors who, by their extensive conquests, gave a geographical unity to this land by bringing a large chunk of territory comprising the undivided Balasore, Cuttack, Puri, Keonjhar, Dhenkanal, Baud-Kondamal and Ganjam districts of Odisha. Of course, their political achievements became shadowy in the foot-prints of time but their cultural activities remained uneffaceable for all times to come.

3.1.6. Summary

- The reign of the Somavamsis for two hundred years forms a glorious epoch in history of Odisha.
- The Somavamsis, other wise known as Panduvamsis, ruled over Odisha from the middle of the ninth century A.D. to the early part of the twelfth century A.D.
- For the first time Kalinga, Utkala, Kongoda and Kosala were unified and brought under one political authority.
- we get some information from the inscriptions like Banda Copper plates of Tivaradeva, Adhavara plates of Mahanannararaja Banda plates of Mahasivagupta etc.
- Janmejaya I was a powerful ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty who assumed high sounding titles like' *Paramesvara', 'Paramabhattaraka,' 'Trikalingadhipati'* etc.
- Yayati I was a *brave* warrior. Not only he crossed sword with the Kalachuris but subdued the Bhanjas and held his sway *over* the Bhauma kingdom of Tosali.
- After Yayati I, his son Bhimaratha ascended Somavamsi throne and his rule contributed in the consolidation of the Somavamsi Empire and brought peace and tranquility in the country.
- Dharmaratha who succeeded Bhimaratha was definitely a powerful ruler.
- As Dharmaratha died issueless, his brother, Nahusa succeeded him to the throne of Kosala.
- Indraratha had been appointed by Dharmaratha as the governor of Kalinga.
- Chandihara Yayati II was a mighty ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty.
- Yayati II was a patron of Brahmanism.
- Tradition credits him of inviting 10,000 Brahmins from Kanyakubja (Kanauj) to perform Dasasvamedha sacrifice at Jajpur.
- Udyotakesari, who succeeded Yayati II, was a worthy son of an illustrious father.
- With the accession of Janmejaya II, the son of Udyotakesari, disintegration of the Somavamsi dynasty started.
- Janmejaya II was succeeded by his son Puranjaya I.
- Karnadeva was the last known ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty who was the brother of Puranjaya.

- At last the Somavamsi Kingdom fell a prey to the Gangas who established their sway over Utkala.
- The political unification of Odisha under the Somavamsis brought with it an efficient administration.
- The king was assisted by many important ministers and officers.
- The cultural contribution of the Somavamsis is significant in many ways.
- The Somavamsi rulers were ardent Saivites.
- They helped the growth and spread of Saivism by the construction of Siva temples and offer of liberal land grants to the Saiva temples, priests and ascetics.
- They also tolerated other sects such as Jainism, Vaishnavism and Saktism.
- The Somavamsis left their imperishable legacy in the field of art and architecture.
- The Odishan temple architecture which began in the Sailodbhava period reached the height of perfection towards the close of the Somavamsi period.
- The Odishan temple reached its complete form towards the close of the Somavamsi period.
- Out of the numerous temples, built by the Somavamsis four are most magnificent Lingaraj, Brahmeswar, Mukteswar and Rajarani (all in Bhubaneswar).
- There was a phenomenal development in the field of Sanskrit learning and literature during the Somavamsi period.
- The inscriptions of the period speak of the proficiency of the scholars in *Vedas, Vedanga, Smtitis, Puranas,* medical sciences, Astrologgy, *Arthasastra,* Grammar, Poetry, History, Political Science and Logic.
- The land grants to the learned Brahmanas facilitated the study of Sanskritic literature.
- Thus, the Somavamsi rule undoubtedly ushered a new era in the history of medieval Odisha.

3.1.7. Exercise

- Write a note on the early history of the Somavamsi dynasty.
- Discuss the dynastic history of the Somavamsis.
- Highlight the achievements of the Somavamsi rulers.
- Describe the culutual significance of the Somavamsi rule.

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Unit-3

Chapter-II
THE GANGA:
Sources, Political History (Anantavarman Chodagangadeva, Anangabhimadeva and Narasimhadeva)

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3.2.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students explore the Ganga dynasty and about its rulers. After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- *trace the history of the Gangas;*
- *identify the sources and political history of the Ganga rulers*
- *recognize the contribution of Anantavarman Chodagangadeva;*
- *appreciate the role of Chodagangadeva in the Ganga dynasty .*
- *know the contribution of Narasimhadeva I*

3.2.1.Introduction

The rise of the Imperial Gangas is a remarkable event in the history of Odisha. The period of Ganga rule is considered as an era of vigorous imperial wars and conquests, hectic political activities, sound administration and great cultural attainments. In fact, the Gangas as a rulling dynasty appeared in the Odishan history towards the end of the fifth century A.D. and in the eleventh century A.D., they emerged as a paramount power. The Gangas not only succeeded in building a vast empire but their well organised administrative set up, 'unparalled architectural splendours like Sri Jagannath temple at Puri and Sun temple at Konarka made their name immortal in the annals of medieval Odishan history.

3.2.2.The Gangas

The reign of the Gangas, popularly known as the Eastern Gangas, forms a splendid era in the medieval Odishan history. They struggled hard for a long period from 498 A.D. to 940 A.D. for their survival and during this phase, they passed through many vicissitudes. This was followed by four hundred years of glorious rule, a period from 1038 A.D. to 1435 A.D.

3.2.3Sources

It is very difficult to find out the sources of the Ganga dynasty. However, as a tribe they can be traced back to fourth century B.C. Megasthenes, the Greek ambassador to the court of Chandragupta Maurya, mentions a tribe, named Gangaridai, which inhabited on the bank of the Ganges. In the first century AD., Pliny refers to their southward movement and settlement on the bank of the river Vamsadhara.The Draksaram temple inscription, Kenduli plate, Korni copper plate, Nagari plate, Kendupatana plate, Jagannath temple inscription, Chinna Badamu plates, Ronaki inscription, Kanchipuram inscription, Kapilasa inscription, Kamarnava copper plate (Choudwar) etc. form the main inscriptional scources of the imperial Gangas. Among literary works, very important are the *Madala Panji, Tabaqat-i-Nasiri, Tarikh-i-Firoze Shahi,*

Ramacharita and *Kalingattuparani* etc. which throw considerable light on the career and achievements of the Ganga kings.

3.2.4.Political History

The Ganga imperialism brought political stabilisation to Odisha in the medieval age. The competent rulers of this dynasty like Chodagangadeva, Anangabhimadeva III and Narasimhadeva I were great warriors and men of exceptional ability who succeeded in keeping their vast kingdoms independent when the Hindu kingdoms, one after another, were falling victims to Muslim aggression.

The genealogy of the Imperial Gangas

The genealogy of the Ganga rulers can be discussed in the following way.

Anantavarman Vajrahasta V

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Devendravarman Raja Raja I

↓

↓ ↓ ↓

1.Anantavarman Chodagangadeva Viayaganda Premadideva

2. Kamarnava 3. Raghava 4. Raja Raja II 5. Ananga Bhimadeva II

↓

6.Raja Raja III

↓

7.Ananga Bhimadeva III

↓

8.Narasimhadeva I

↓

9.Bhanudeva I

↓

10.Narasimhadeva II

↓

11.Bhanudeva II

↓

12.Narasimhadeva III

↓

13.Bhanudeva III

↓

14.Narasimhadeva IV

↓

15. Bhanudeva IV

3.2.4.1.Anantavaraman Vajrahasta V (C-1038-1070 A.D.)

With the accession of Anantavarman Vajrahasta V in 1038 A.D. , the Gangas got freed from the clutches of the Somavamsi kings. As the first independent Ganga king, he used titles like *'Maharaja, Maharajadhiraja, Paramamahesvara, Paramabhattaraka* and *Trikalingadhipati'*. His title' *Trikalingadhipati'* clearly indicates that he brought Utkala, Kongoda and Kalinga under his control. He followed the policy of rnatrirnorual alliance for strengthening his empire. His marriage with Vinaya Mahadevi, the Kalachuri princess made his position stable in the Southern India and prompted him to deal with the Somavamsis. It is presumed that he maintained diplomatic relation with distant neighbouring countries which enhanced his glory.

3.2.4.2.Devendravarman Rajarajadeva (1070-1077 A.D.)

Vajrahasta V was succeeded by his son Devendra Varman Rajarajadeva in 1070 AD. Being pressed by the Somavamsis of Utkala and the Chalukyas of Vengi, Rajarajadeva was determined to follow a vigorous policy. He carried on his arms far as Vengi, defeated Kulottungachoda alias Rajendrachoda II, who gave the hand of his daughter Raja sundari to Rajarajadeva. From Dirghasi inscription, it is known that Vanapati, the Brahmin minister and commander of Rajaraja inflicted crushing defeat upon the rulers of Vengi, Utkala, Khimidi, Gidrisingi, Kosala and Chola. The acquisition of the neighbouring territories by following a vigourous policy of aggrandisement enabled Rajarajadeva to bring stability to the Ganga rule. He took up the independent highsounding titles like *Parama Mahesvara, Paramabhattaraka, Maharajadhtraja* and *Trikalingadhipati.* He died in 1077 AD.

3.2.4.3.Anantavarman Chodagangadeva (1077-1147 A.D.)

Anantavarman Chodagangadeva was a prominent king of the Ganga dynasty. The initial phase of his reign was critical because of his infancy. But as the king grew up to adulthood, he

proved his ability as a ruler and ruling over Odisha for a long period of seventy years. In fact, he founded the Gangas dynasty in the Odishan soil, which ruled till 1435 A D.

3.2.4.3.1.Conquests and empire building

In order to establish a strong empire, Anantavarman Chodagangadeva followed the policy of conquest and empire building.

3.2.4.2.War with the Cholas

In the early years of his succession to power, Chodagangadeva had to face Chola threat. It was happened perhaps due to the marriage of Chodagangadeva with Chodadevi, the daughter of Virachoda, a son of Kulottungachoda. This was perhaps against the will of Kulottunga and thus, his son Virachoda was ousted from governorship of Vengi. This led Virachoda to take shelter at the court of Chodagangadeva, and so, the latter had to bear the brunt of Kulottungachoda's aggression. This war took place around 1093-94 AD. Chodagangadeva lost the southern part of Kalinga which was occupied by the Cholas. However, Chodagangadeva never lost his heart. With increasing power and potentiality, he defied the payment of tribute to the Cholas as has been reflected by the *Kalingattuparani* composed by Jayamagondam, the court poet of Kulottunga. As a result the Cholas marched to Kalinga and fought with Chodagangadeva who defeated them and occupied Vengi. This led the expansion of the Ganga dynasty upto Vengi in the Western direction.

3.2.4.3.3.Subjugation of Utkala

The weakness of the Somavamsis of Utkala brought the attention of Chodagandadeva to subjugate it under his suzerainty. The Corni copper plate grant of Chodagangadeva mentions that Chodagangadeva waged war against the kings of Utkala and Vengi simultaneously. He first defeated the king of Utkala whose name appears as Karnadeva in the *Ramacharita* of Sandhyakaranandi. It is a fact that Karnadeva or Karnakesari, the last ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty was defeated by Chodagangadeva. After that, the Ganga empire extended upto Utkala in the eastern direction. After the annexation of Utkala, Chodagandadeva had annexed Vengi as is suggested by the above mentioned copper plate grant. The year of occupation of Odisha by Chodagangadeva might have taken place around 1110 A. D.

3.2.4.3.4.Relation with the Palas of Bengal

Getting success over Utkal and Vengi, Chodagandadeva next looked towards Bengal Taking advantage of the death of Ramapala, Chodagangadeva attacked Bengal beyond

Dandakabhukti. He defeated the weak and feeble ruler of Dandakabhukti and brought under his control its capital city Aramya. However, Vaidyadeva, the able minister of Kumarapala had offered a stubbern resistance to the Odishan emperor as is revealed from the copper plate of the former. The achievement of Chodagangadeva in relation to Bengal is known from the Nagari plate. In the task of the conquest of Bengal, Chodagangadeva was most probably assisted by Samantasena, the Sena King of Radha (South-West Bengal), the enemy of the Palas and the founder of the Sena dynasty in Bengal. He was appointed by Chodagangadeva as his nominee to rule over this Suhma teritory. Vijayasena, the grandson of Samantasena, established cordial alliance with Chodagangadeva and became the master of Radha *desa*. By these extensive conquests, Chodagangadeva became the master of a vast kingdom stretching from the *river* Ganges in the north to that of *Godavari* in the south.

3.2.4.3.5. Other achievements

Chodagangadeva was known by several names as Anantavarman, Chalukya Ganga, Virarajendra Chodaganga, Vikrama Gangesvara and Gangesvara Deva bhupa. From his Ronaki inscription, it is revealed that he bore titles like *'Maharajadhiraja, Trikalingadhipati, Sri Gangachudamani, Rajaparamesvara, Paramabhaftaraka, Paramamahesvara, Paramavaisnava'* etc. These high sounding and pompous titles show that Chodagangadeva was undoubtedly great king of the Ganga dynasty. Though Kalinganagara was the capital of his empire, but he made Sarangagarah another political head-quarter of the empire. Kalinganagara has been identified by the scholars with modern Mukhalingam on the river bank of Vamsadhara in the Srikakulam district of Andhra Pradesh. The reason behind this is obvious as Sarangagarah (near Baranga in Cuttack district) was almost centrally located in the vast empire of Chodagangadeva. Besides, he also built *several* strong forts at Jajpur Kataka, *Amaravati* Kataka (near Chhatia) Choudwar Kataka, Sarangagarh Kataka etc.

3.2.4.3.6. Introduction of a well organised administration

In order to give stabilisation and consolidation to the vast empire, Chodagangadeva introduced a well organised administration. Being a foreigner to this alien land he could very well realise his duty towards the people of Odisha. He devoted himself for the material prosperity of his subjects by executing various humanitarian and welfare projects. This made him popular among his Odishan subjects.

3.2.4.3.7. Patron of literature and learning

He was a great patron of literature and learning. His inscriptions bore brilliant testimony of the fair knowledge of Sanskrit, Odia and Telegu literature that he possessed. Being a good conversationalist, he was also well acquainted with the Vedic lore. He displayed his talent in fine arts and poetical composition. Science had its progress during his age. Satananda composed *Bhasvati,* a manual of rules to determine the position of the heavenly bodies. As an outstanding ruler, Chodagangadeva was famous for his religious toleration. Though, he was a great devotee of Lord Gokarnesvara in the Mahendra mountain at his earlier days but later on, he became a loyal follower of God Jagannath at Puri. Still then, he never imposed his personal religion upon anybody. His construction of the temple of Jagannath at Puri and the endeavour to bring all religious faiths into the fold of a single cult. i.e. the Jagannath cult was a landmark in the religious history of Odisha.

3.2.4.3.8. In the field of art and architecture

In the field of art and architecture, Chodagangadeva has contributed a lot. He had started the building of the great temple of God Jagannath at Puri which was completed by Anangabhimadeva III. However, it is controversial that Chodagandadeva started the construction of the temple of God Jagannath. The Dasgoba plates of Rajaraja III states that the construction place of Purusottama (God Jagannath) abandoned by earlier kings was taken up by *Gangesvara* (Chodagangadeva). Chodagangadeva was also instrumental in building several forts in several strategic places for the protection of his vast empire from the onslaught of the enemies. The glorious career of Chodagangadeva came to an end with his death in 1147 A.D. His wife Kasturikamodini built a Jagannath temple at Tekkali in 1150 A.D. to preserve the memory of her deceased husband.

Thus, the seventy years long rule of Chodagangadeva was a glorious epoch in the medieval Odishan history. Of course, his discomfiture in the hands of the Kalachuri ruler Ratnadeva II could not enable him to have his sway over Sambalpur-Sonepur-Bolangir tract. Still then, the vast empire extenidng from the Ganges to the Godavari definitely establishes the fact that Chodagandadeva was a great military genius. As an administrator, patron of art, architecture and culture and a liberal ruler, Chodagandadeva is a remarkable figure in the medieval Odishan history.

3.2.4.4.Kamarnava (1147-1156 A.D.)

Kamarnava ascended the throne after the death of his father through his wife Kasturikamohini. His brief rule for a decade was mostly devoted to the fight against the Kalachuris for the possession of Sambalpur-Sonepur-Bolangir tract. Like his father, he was unsuccessful in his mission. A notable event during his period was that he performed the *Tulabharam* ceremony by which he weighed himself against gold which he distributed among the Brahmins and his courtiers.

3.2.4.5.Raghava (1156-1170 A.D.)

After the death of Kamarnava his younger brother Raghava to ascended the Ganga throne in 1156 AD. He was another son of Anantavarman Chodagandadeva through his queen Indiradevi. He also took up high-sounding title, *'Anantavarma Devidasa Ranaranga Raghava Chakravarti.* Perhaps during his period Kulottunga Rajendrachoda II of Velanadu attacked Kalinga and got some success. Among his two inscriptions found inside the *Jagamohana* of the Lingaraja temple, one describes about Jayadeva, a reputed poet of Odisha for his eternal creation *Gitagovinda.* His reign was comparatively peaceful and tranquile.

3.2.4.6.Rajaraja II (1170-1190 A.D.)

Next Rajaraja II succeeded Raghava as he had no son and successor. He was another son of Chodagandadeva through his queen Chandralekeha. With him the lost glory of the imperial Gangas revived. At the beginning of his reign, he recovered the lost territory of the Gangas extending from Simhachalam to Godavari during Kamarnava and Raghava. However, with the attack of Prithivisvara, the Velanati Chola ruler over Kalinga who extended his sway up to Srikurmam, Rajaraja II had to accept the supremacy of the former and remained under him as a vassal king. The victory of Lakshmanasena, the Sena ruler of Bengal and the contemporary of Rajaraja II over Utkala is rejected by scholars because it is untenable. Jayadeva, the great. poet of the time also flourished during the reign of Rajaraja II.

3.2.4.7. Anangabhimadeva II (1190-1198 A.D)

Anangabhimadeva II, the brother of Rajaraj II, ascended the throne as he had no children. His reign was peaceful and it witnessed vigorous activities in the building of many Saivite temples. His brother-in-law, Svapnesvaradeva constructed the famous Meghesvara temple at Bhubaneswar. Probably, he built Sovanesvara Siva temple at Niali. He undertook massive works of public welfare like building of roads, digging of wells and tanks, construction of high

compound walls etc. He patronised men of letters and also looked after the material and spiritual well being of his subjects. He died in 1198 A.D.

3.2.4.8. Rajaraja III (1198-1211 A.D.)

Anangabhimadeva II was succeeded by his son Rajaraja III in 1198 A.D. His reign witnessed the increasing desire of the Muslims to invade this land. The *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* of Qazi Minhaj-us-siraj mentions that under the instruction of Bakhtyar Khilji, Muhammad Sheran and Ahmad Sheran had advanced to occupy Lakhnor (in Bengal) and Jajnagar (Jajpur in Odisha). The death of Bhaktyar Khiljl, while leading the Muslim army in a campaign against Kamarupa (Assam) put a stop to the plan. The Muslim governors of Bengal, however, continued their attacks on Odisha during the reign of his successors.

3.2.4.9. Anangabhimadeva III (1211-1238 A.D.)

Rajaraja-III was succeeded by his son, Anangabhimadeva-III in 1211 AD. Anangabhimadeva-III came to power at a time when the Muslim rule in Bengal had threatened the security of the Ganga kingdom in Odisha. On the other hand, the Kalachuris were the traditional rival of the Gangas. At the same time, the Chola Empire was disintegrating in the south. Such was the situation when Anangabhimadeva III ascended the throne of the Gangas.

3.2.4.9.1. Resistance to Muslim invasion

Just after his accession, Anangabhimadeva III had to face the violent march of the Muslim army of Bengal under the command of Ghiyas-ud-din Iwar who ascended the throne in 1215 A.D. The *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* mentions that Ghiyas-ud-din I was the Khilji ruler who received revenue from Jajnagar, Kamrup, Tirhut and several other places. However, this fact does not find corroboration from any other source. On the contrary, the Chatesvara inscription of Anangabhimadeva III found in the village of Krishnapur in the undivided Cuttack district refers to the defeat of the Muslim governor at the hands of Vishnu, the Brahmin minister of Anangabhimadeva. The inscription describes: "How are we to describe his (Vishnu's) heroism during his fight against the Muslim King? He fought drawing arrows upto his ear killing many famous warriors, which became a grand feast to the sleepless and un-winking eyes of the gods who were interested onlookers in the heaven above." Thus, it can be stated with historical anlysis that anangabhimadeva III did not pay any tribute to Iwaz rather foiled the latter's attempt by inflicting a crushing defeat upon him. It is known that between 1211 and 1215 A.D.

Angangabhimadeva had fought with Ghiyasud- din Iwaz, defeated him and saved Odisha from the Muslim menace.

3.2.4.9.2. Conquest of the Sambalpur-Sonepur-Bolangir tract

The greatest achievement of Anangabhimadeva III as a conqueror was his victory over the Kalachuris. The Chatesvara inscription describes that Vishnu, the Brahmin minister of Anangabhimadeva III defeated the king of Tumanna on the bank of river Bhima at the skirts of the Vindhya hills and on the sea-shore. Though scholars like N.N. Vasu and M. Somasekhara Sharma identify Tummana with a person but most of the scholars relate it to a place as the expression of the above mentioned inscription *"Tumanna-Prithivi- Pathe"* means "Of the king of Tummana land". The place in question is most probably the South Kosala where the Kalachuris or Haihayas were ruling. Perhaps, the Ganga imperialism had prompted Anangabimadeva III to cross sword with Dakshina Kosala in order to put an end to the Ganga-Kalachuri struggle that had started during the reign of Chodagandadeva. This victory of the Ganga monoarch pushed the limit of the Ganga Empire covering a large chunk of area comprising Sonepur-Bolangir-Sambalpur tract. From the records, it can be presumed that *Tummana* came under the away of Anangabhimadeva III in or around 1220 A.D.

3.2.4.9.3. Matrimonial alliance

Anangabhimadeva III was a shrewd diplomat. He wanted to cement matrimonial alliance with the Kalachuris for maintaining the far flung Ganga empire for the realization of that end, he gave his daughter Chandrika in marriage to the valiant Kalachuri prince Paramadrideva. By this materimonial alliance ended the long prevailed antagonism and hatred between the Kalachuris and the Gangas. The united strength of the Gangas and Haihayas became unchallengable in North-Eastern India and gave a solid resistance to the Muslim invasion when Paramadrideva, his son-in-law joined hands with Narasimhadeva I in the latter's fight with Tughril Tughan Khan of Bengal.

3.2.4.9.4. Invasion of Kanchipuram and Srirangam

Taking advantage of the weakness of the Cholas, the Kakatiya king Ganapati invaded the Chola empire. The records of Ganapati show that he had his sway over the coastal districts to the east of Warangal and Kalinga. This political development prompted Anangabhimadeva to interfere in the Chola politics of the South. He marched with his grand army and overran Kanchipuram and Srirangam. This fact finds ample corroboration in the Allalanatha temple

inscription of Kanchipuram where Somaladevi Mahadevi, the queen of Anangabhimadeva III recorded a valuable gift on the sout~ wall of the said temple. By this conquest, the Ganga empire cr?ssed the river Godavari and extended upto Krishna. This event took place around 1230 A:D.

3.2.4.9.5. Transfer of Capital

The Allalanatha temple inscription of Kanchipuram shows that Anangabhimadeva III transferred his capital from Kalinganagar to *Abhinava Varanasi Kataka* (Cuttack) on the bank of river Mahanadi. Earlier, Chodagangadeva had made Sarangagarh, a second centre of political activities of the Ganga empire, but Anangabhimadeva completely shifted the capital to the centre place like Cuttack. He named it after Varanasi, the sacred place of pilgrimage of the Hindus. With all probability, it can be stated that he must have completed this work by 1230 A.D.

3.2.4.9.6. His achievements as a builder

He was not only a conqueror but also a great builder. The Kanchipuram inscription states that he had built a new capital, called Abhinava Baranasi Kataka. As per the Nagari grants, issued by the great king in 1230-31 AD., he raised a temple for Lord Purushottam and two Siva temples in his new capital. The *Madalapanji* attributes the erection of the Puri temple of Lord Jagannath to Anangabhimadeva-III , but the statement of the *Madalapanji,* which was a later work is not accepted by the historians because of the fact that the copper plates grants of the Gangas clearly mention that Chodagangadeva was the builder of the great temple at Puri. However, it can be assumed that Anangabhimadeva-III, might have added some new structures to the temple of Jagannath.

3.2.4.9.7. His devotion to Lord Jagannath

As Anangabhimadeva-III was a devotee of Lord Purushottam, he professed great devotion to Lord Jagannath. The Drakshasrama and Kanchipuram inscriptions mentions him as the Rauta or deputy of Lord Jagannath. The *Madalapanji* also mentions mentions him as a great devotee of Lord Jagannath. According to some scholars in order to win the loyalty of the Nayakas and feudatory chiefs under him Ananqabhirnadeva III proclaimed himself as the *Rauta* or deputy of Lord Jagannath in 1216 AD. The subsequent Suryavamsi and Bhoi rulers followed Anangabhimadeva's policy of owing unquestioning loyalty to Lord Jagannath and professed themselves as the servants of the deity. According to some scholars, this expression of loyalty and devotion to Lord Jagannath led to the origin of the practice of *Chhera Pahara,* according to

which the king has to perform the job of a sweeper in front of the car of Lord Jaqannath at the time of the annual car festival. This practice has been continuing since then.

3.2.4.9.8. Other achievements

Anangabhimadeva III had also great esteem for Saivism and Saktism. The Draksharam inscription of 1216 A.D. mentions him as the deputy of Purushottama, Rudra and Durga. The Nagari plate inscription credits him of celebrating *Hiranyagarbha Mahadana* and *Tulapurusa Mahadana.* It also reveals his numerous gifts of lands to several Brahmins. As a benevolent ruler, Anangabhimadeva undertook massive humanitarian works for the welfare of his subjects.The Chatesvara inscription refers to the construction of roads, tanks, houses and temples for the general and religious purposes of his subjects. According to the *Madalapanji* he undertook a land settlement with the help of two revenue ministers like Damodar Badapanda and Isana Pattanayak. The total land revenue collected during his reign amounted four crores and forty-three lakhs of *tankas.* The revenue, thus collected, was spent definitely for .the welfare of his people. He provided an enlightened administration, as he himself was learned and acquainted with *'Dharma'* and *'Nitt* texts.

3.2.4.9.9. Importance on preserving places of historical significance

In the medieval Odishan history, Anangabhimadeva for the first time showed a bright example of preserving places of historical significance. His Lingaraja temple inscription refers to the fact that he donated *five Vatikas* of land to a potter for repairing roofs of the *Mandapas* of that temple in every twelve years, two *Vatikas* of land were given to a limemaker for white washing the walls of the *mandapa* once in a year and one *vatika* of land was given to a sweeper for sweeping the *mandapa* thrice a day.

3.2.4.9.10. Patron of learning

He was also a great patron of learning. He granted lands to the Brahmanas who were well-versed in the *Vedas, Puranas* and *Vyakaranas* and also donated lands to the *mathas* which were, by that time centres of education, religion and culture. From Nagari plates it is inferred that Anangabhimadeva III ruled his empire by following *Dharma* and *Niti* texts. Anangabhimadeva III died in 1238 A.D.

Thus, Anangabhimadeva III was a great warrior, administrator, diplomat, pious man, lover of scholars, protector of all religious faiths, preserver of historical monuments etc. He has left an indellible mark in the *medieval* Odishan history.

3.2.4.10. Narasimhadeva I (1238 - 1264 A.D.)

With the succession of Narasimhadeva I to the Ganga throne in 1238 A.D., the Ganga Empire reached its zenith. His twenty-six years of glorious rule witnessed extraordinary achievements in every aspect of the Ganga administration. His aggressive and offensive military policy created panic in the minds of the Muslim rulers of Bengal and Oudh. This led the imperial Gangas to the pinnacle of power, glory and splendour. For the first time, he bore the title *Gajapati* exhibiting the vast possession of elephants and this title was borne by the later Ganga rulers occassionally and by the Suryavamsi kings invariably. The Sun temple at Konarka was the magnificent creation in the field of architecture that brought Narasimhadeva. He was popularly known as Langula Narasimhadeva among the people of Odisha.

3.2.4.10.1. Attack on Bengal

After his accession in 1238 A.D., Narasimha I followed the policy of aggressive imperialism. By that time, Tughril Tughan Khann (1233 - 1246 A.D.) had become the governor of Bengal. After consolidating his position, Narasimha marched with his grand army aided by Paramadrideva, his brother-in-law towards Bengal in 1234 A.D. The Odishan army overran a number of semi independent Hindu rajas of the neighbouring area, east ofthe river Ganges and made a calculated move to northern Radha, the territory of Tughri Tughan Khan. At this juncture, Tughril Tughan gave a clarion call to all the Muslims for a zihad (holy war) against the Hindus. Even Qazi Minhaj-us-Siraj joined this holy war.

In his *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* Minhaj gives a vivid picture of the war. By 1244 A.D. Tughril Tughan launched a counter attack on the Odishan army. Gaining some initial success, the Muslim army compelled the forces of Narasimhadeva to retreat towards their frontier fort Katasin (Kantei in the Midnapur district of West Bengal) which was surrounded by jungles and cane-bushes and provided strategic defence to the Odishan army. Tughril-Tughan Khan retired to Lakhnauti in order to save his life. His rule over Radha came to an end. The victory of Narasimhadeva I over the Muslim army has been described in the Anantavasudeva temple inscription.

It certainly established the fact that Narasimha had extended his sway upto Radha by defeating Tughril-Tughan Khan. Narasimhadeva did not retire after conquering Radha. He wanted to extend his sway upto Varendra. By that time Lakhnauti consisted of two main divisions- Radha and Varendra, situated on either side of the Ganges. Lakhnor was the

headquarters of Radha while Diwkot was that of Varendra. Having his sway over Radha, Narasimhadeva directed his army against Varendra. The Odishan army ransacked the Muslim territory at Bengal and created panic in the minds of the Muslims. Being fearful, Tughril Tughan Khan appealed to Sultan Alauddin Masud Saha of Delhi to come to his rescue who sent Quamuruddin Tamur Khan, the governor of Oudh to help Tugha Khan. However, after reaching Bengal, Tamur had a sharp difference of opinion with Tughril Tughan who was ultimately driven away from Bengal and Tamur Khan continued as its governor till his death in 1246 A.D.

Balban, the Sultan of Delhi Sultanate appointed lkhtiyar-ud-Din Yuzbak as the governor of Lakhnauti. Again Narasimhadeva carried on his arms upto Bengal. Minhaj's *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* mentions that four battles were fought between Yuzbak and Narasimha from 1247 to 1256 A.D. Again, the leader of this battle from the side of the Odishan army was Paramadrideva whom Minhaj mentions as *Saba ntar*. In the first two battles, Yuzbak gained success. In the third one he sustained discomfiture at the hands of Odishan army. He asked for military aid from Delhi and marched towards Umurdan (present Amarda Mayurbhanj district). However, in this great battle Paramadrideva, the valiant son-in-law of Anangabhimadeva III and brother-in-law of Narasimhadeva I lost his life. The victory of Yuzbak has been substantiated by the issue of silver coins from the mint of Lakhnauti in memory of the conquest of Umardan. However, after his death, Lakhnauti came under the direct grip of Delhi Sultanate and Narasimhadeva subjugated Bengal, Midnapur, Howrah and Hoogly to the Ganga empire.

3.2.4.10.2. Hostilities with the Kakatiyas

He not only subdued the Muslims but created terror in the mind of Kakatiya ruler Ganapati. The Lingaraj temple inscription refers to a struggle which took place between Ganapati and Narasimha. Ganapati was a very powerful ruler of Kakatiya dynasty who must have invaded the southern part of Kalinga grabing some portions of it as is known from the Bhimesvara temple inscription. So, it can be assumed that there might have been frequent struggle between the two kings and Narasimhadeva must have inflicted a crushing defeat upon Ganapati.

3.2.4.10.3. His achievements as a builder

Narasimhadeva's achievement as a builder was unparallel. The outstanding Sun temple at Konarka bears the testimony in the field of art, architecture and sculpture. Though the main temple has been ruined, *Jagamohana* (Porch) is still standing. The marvelous art, architecture

and sculpture of the temple allure the attention of millions of tourists all over the world who visit the Sun temple of Konark.

3.2.4.10.4. His contribution to religion, art and literature

He was not only a great military genius or builder but also he was a great statesman of his time. His sound administration was marked with catholicity. He was a champion of the cause of the Hinduism. His Lingaraj temple inscription reveals that he constructed a monastery called Sadasiva *Matha* in the *Ekamrakhetra* (Bhubaneswar). This monastery was the asylum for the refugee Hindus who came from Gauda and Radha being oppressed by the Muslim rulers.

3.2.4.10.5. Patron of Sanskrit literature

He was a great patron of Sanskrit literature. Vidyadhara, his court poet composed his famous *Alankara* work *Ekavali* which describes the achievements of Narasimhadeva I. His court was adorned with great men of letters as is gleaned from the language and style of different inscriptions of, his period. Narasimhadeva was famous for his religious toleration. If the Sun temple at Konarka makes an impression that he was a great devotee of sun God his Kapilasa inscription terms him as *Sri Durga Putra, Sri Purusottam Putra* and a devotee to God Mahesvara. He definitely followed the policy of his father Anangabhimadeva III. Narasimhadeva I bore the high sounding titles befitting to his status. The *Ekavaii* crowns him with the title *'Vavanani Uallabha'* the Lingaraja temple inscription adorns him with the title *'Vira-Nara-Kesari-Dharadhipa'* and the Kapilash inscription entitles him as *'Gajapati*. His glorious rule came to an end in 1264 A.D.

Thus, Narasimhadeva-I was a king of a many laudable qualities. He was skilled in the art of government and also patronized men of letters. He was famous due to his heroism and marvelous creation of the Sun temple, at Konarka.

3.2.4.11.Bhanudeva I (1264-1279 A.D.)

Narasimhadeva was succeeded by his son Bhanudeva I. Yuzbak, the Governor of Bengal marched as far as Jajnagar (Jajpur) in or around 1275 A.D. and took away some elephants. It is presumed that the Muslim sway was extended upto Jajpur. Bhanudeva was a benevolent ruler. His donation of lands, mango gardens and trees to the Brahmins shows that he promoted Brahmanism. The coming of Narahari Tirtha, the Dvaita Vedantin and his acceptance of the images of Rama and Sita from Bhanudeva I suggests that the worship of Sita-Rama began during his period. However, the disintegrating tendency of the Ganga empire started right from the days

of Bhanudeva I when several feudatories like Matsys of Oddadi, the Chalukyas of Elamancili and the Pallavas of Virakutam showed defiant attitude towards the Ganga suzerainty. During his reign, Chandrikadevi, the daughter of Anangabhimadeva III and the wife of Paramadrideva built Anantavasudeva temple at Bhubaneswar.

3.2.4.12. Narasimhadeva II (1-.279-1306 A.D.)

Narasimhadeva II ascended the throne with the death of Bhanudeva I in 1279 A.D. As he was a minor, Narahari Tirtha became his regent for long twelve years. During his time Tughril Khan-i-Yuzbak, the governor of Bengal fought with Balban, the Sultan of Delhi. So, Narasimhadeva II enjoyed a comparatively peaceful time during his period. He facilitated trade and commerce by improving communication facility and brought prosperity to the land. Like his forefathers, he bore highsounding titles like *'Vira Narasimhadeva, Sri Narasimhadeva, Pratapa Vira Sri Narsimhadeva etc.* He also performed *Tulapurusadana.* He patronised the Brahmanas and established many Brahmana *shasanas* (villages). His court was crowned with the men of letters. Among them, Sambhukara Vajapeyi's *Sraddhapaddhati*, Vidyakara's , *Nityachara Paddhati* and *Karmadipika* and Sankhadhara's *Smriti Samuchaya* were famous Sanskrit works of the time. He died in 1306 A.D.

3.2.4.13.Bhanudeva II (1306-1328 A.D)

The decline of the Ganga empire started with the accession of Bhanudeva II. After subjugating Warrangal in 1323 A.D. Ulugh Khan (Muhammad Tughluq) had a raid in Jajnagar area who took away forty elephants from him. This clearly shows that Bhanudeva II had to deal with the Muslims. However, no loss of any part of the Ganga territory is evident during his period. The fact remains that the aggressive imperialism of the Gangas had come to an end. He also considered himself as the Deputy of God Jagannath.

3.2.4.14.Narasimhadeva III (1328-1352 A.D.)

Narasimhadeva III ascended the throne in 1328 AD with the death of Bhanudeva II. Taking advantage of the weakness of the Musunuri Nayakas, the Reddies and Velemas declared themselves as independent Kingdoms in the coastal Andhra region. At this juncture, the death of Toyyeeti Anavota Nayaka (who was ruling over that region on behalf of Kapaya Nayaka, the Musunuri ruler), Narasimhadeva III considered it as a golden opportunity to extend his sway upto Srikakulam. However, that victory was short lived because Anavota Reddi, a powerful Reddi ruler forced the Kalingan army to retreat upto, the boarder of Kalinga crossing of

Godavari river. Thus, the Ganga empire was gradually leaning towards its decline. He died in 1352 A.D.

3.2.4.15.Bhanudeva III (1352-1378 A.D.)

Bhanudeva to ascend the Ganga throne in 1352 A.D with the death of his father Narasimhadeva III. His period witnessed a turbulent phase in the glorious rule of the Gangas. During his time, Iliyas Shah, the governor of Bengal, defied the authority of Firoz Shah, the Sultan of Delhi and thus, a war between the two was inevitable. Prior to it, in or around 1351 A.D. Iliyas had invaded Jajnagar. Further, the help rendered to Iliyas Shah by Bhanudeva III in 1353-54 A.D. in defeating Firoz Toghluq who retreated towards Delhi suggests that Iliyas had never attacked Jajnagar. At this juncture, Bhanudeva III might have thought it prudent to help Iliyas because he wanted to get rid of any possible attack to his kingdom from the side of the Sultan of Delhi (Firoz Tughluq).

The friendship of Bhanudeva III with Iliyas was costly for him. To retaliate his defeat, Firoz Tughluq invaded Bengal in 1357 A.D. and Sikandar Shah who had succeeded his father lliyas Shah, negotiated with Firoz Tughluq. In 1360 A.D., all of a sudden Firoz marched towards Jajnagar and the Ganga King Bhanudeva III was not at all prepared for that. The trechery of some of the officers of Bhanudeva III, helped Firoz to inflict a crushing defeat on the Odishan King who concluded peace treaty with the Sultan of Delhi. The destruction of the Puri Jagannath temple by the Muslim invaders described in *Tarikh-i-Firoze Shahi* finds no corroboration in any other contempory source. In 1356 A.D. Vijayanagara Empire launched an attack on the Ganga kingdom under the able command of Sangama, the nephew of Bukkaraya I, who defeated Bhanudeva III and snatched away the southern empire of the Gangas. Further, Anavema Reddi, the powerful Reddi ruler crossed the river Godavari and subjugated the Ganga empire upto Simhachalam under his suzerainty in 1375 A.D. During his period, the glory of the Ganga was shattered into pieces. King Bhanudeva III styled himself as 'Sri Vira, Pratapavira Bhanudeva and Vira Sri Bhanudeva, died in 1378 A.D.

3.2.4.16.Narasimhadeva IV (1378-1414 A.D.)

Narasimhadeva IV ascended the Ganga throne in 1378 A.D with the death of Bhanudeva III. In 1386 A.D. directed by Kumaragiri, his brother-in-law, Kataya Vema attacked South Kalinga and devastated Cuttack. It is evident from the fact that he assumed the title *Kataka Chudakara* after this invasion. Narasimhadeva IV had no alternative but to go for peace by

offering the hands of his daughter to Kumara Anavota, the son of Kumaragiri. The conflict between the Reddis and Velemas in the South weakened the Reddi power and taking advantage of this Narasimhadeva started to consolidate his sway over South Kalinga. However, the Ganga military power declined further during his period. The Odia language and grammer developed due to his initiative. He was a patron of Brahmins, scholars and men- of letters.

3.2.4.17. Bhanudeva IV (1414-1435 A.D.)

Bhanudeva IV, the last Ganga king, ascended the throne after the death of Narasimhadeva IV in 1414. As downfall had already begun in the Reddi Empire, Bhanudeva IV in association with Devaraya I, the king of Vijayanagara, attacked the Reddy territory; Allada Reddi of Rajahmundry had to conclude peace with both the kings of Utkala and Vijayanagara. The *Chandra kala Natika* of a great Odishan poet, Viswanath Kaviraj gives credit to Bhanudeva IV with the conquest of Gauda (Bengal). He had marched towards Bengal to save the Hindus from the control of Jalal-ud-dln Muhammad Shah. He took up royal titles like *Srivira Bhanudeva, Gajapati Pratapa Vira Sri Nisanka Bhanudeva* etc. He was the last ruler of the Ganga dynasty. When he was busy- in his southern campaign against the Reddis, Kapilesvara Routraya, .his trusted minister betrayed him and by the help of the Brahmins usurped the throne. Thus, the Ganga dynasty came to an end to the glorious reign of the Gangas.

3.2.4.18. The extent of the Empire of the Gangas

When the Gangas were at the height of their power, they ruled over the northern, southern and western parts of modern Orissa as well as a large part of modern Andhra Pradesh. The records of Chodagangadeva's reign reveal that his empire extended from the river Ganges in the north to the river Godavari in the south. Anangabhimadeva III added to the Ganga empire, the western part of Orissa, i.e., Sambalpur-Sonepur-Balangir region.

3.2.5. Conclusion

Thus, the Gangas appeared in the Odishan history towards the end of the fifth century A.D., and in the eleventh century AD. During this period they emerged as the paramount power. Among the Ganga rulers three rulers like Chodagangadeva, Anangabhimadeva III, and Narasimhadeva-I were prominent. The seventy years long rule of Chodagangadeva was a glorious epoch in the medieval Odishan history. As an administrator, patron of art, architecture and culture and a liberal ruler, Chodagandadeva is a remarkable figure in the medieval Odishan history. Anangabhimadeva III was a great warrior, administrator, diplomat, pious man, lover of

scholars, protector of all religious faiths, preserver of historical monuments etc. On the other hand, Narasimhadeva-I is famous due to his heroism and marvelous creation of the Sun temple, at Konark. To conclude, the development in both territorial and cultural of Odisha was possible due to of the Ganga dynasty.

3.2.6.Summary

- The rise of the Imperial Gangas is a remarkable event in the history of Odisha.
- The period of Ganga rule is considered as an era of vigorous imperial wars and conquests, hectic political activities, sound administration and great cultural attainments.
- In fact, the Gangas as a rulling dynasty appeared in the Odishan history towards the end of the fifth century A.D. and in the eleventh century A.D., they emerged as a paramount power.
- The Draksaram temple inscription, Kenduli plate, Korni copper plate, Nagari plate, Kendupatana plate, Jagannath temple inscription,etc. form the main inscriptional scources of the imperial Gangas.
- Among literary works, the *Madala Panji, Tabaqat-i-Nasiri, Tarikh-i-Firoze Shahi, Ramacharita* and *Kalingattuparani* etc. which throw considerable light on the career and achievements of the Ganga kings.
- The Ganga imperialism brought political stabilisation to Odisha in the medieval age.
- The competent rulers of this dynasty like Chodagangadeva, Anangabhimadeva III and Narasimhadeva I were great warriors and men of exceptional ability.
- With the accession of Anantavarman Vajrahasta V in 1038 A.D. , the Gangas got freed from the clutches of the Somavamsi kings.
- Vajrahasta V was succeeded by his son Devendra Varman Rajarajadeva in 1070 AD.
- Anantavarman Chodagangadeva was a prominent king of the Ganga dynasty.
- In the early years of his succession to power, Chodagangadeva had to face Chola threat.
- Karnadeva or Karnakesari, the last ruler of the Somavamsi dynasty was defeated by Chodagangadeva.
- By his extensive conquests, Chodagangadeva became the master of a vast kingdom stretching from the *river* Ganges in the north to that of *Godavari* in the south.
- Though Kalinganagara was the capital of his empire, but he made Sarangagarah another political head-quarter of the empire.

- He also built *several* strong forts at Jajpur Kataka, *Amaravati* Kataka (near Chhatia) Choudwar Kataka, Sarangagarh Kataka etc.
- In order to give stabilisation and consolidation to the vast empire, Chodagangadeva introduced a well organised administration.
- He was a great patron of literature and learning.
- His inscriptions bore brilliant testimony of the fair knowledge of Sanskrit, Odia and Telegu literature that he possessed.
- His construction of the temple of Jagannath at Puri and the endeavour to bring all religious faiths into the fold of a single cult. i.e. the Jagannath cult was a landmark in the religious history of Odisha.
- The next important king was Anangabhimadeva-III who ascended the throne in 1211 AD.
- The greatest achievement of Anangabhimadeva III as a conqueror was his victory over the Kalachuris.
- The Allalanatha temple inscription of Kanchipuram shows that Anangabhimadeva III transferred his capital from Kalinganagar to *Abhinava Varanasi Kataka* (Cuttack) on the bank of river Mahanadi.
- Anangabhimadeva III was a great warrior, administrator, diplomat, pious man, lover of scholars, protector of all religious faiths, preserver of historical monuments etc.
- With the succession of Narasimhadeva I to the Ganga throne in 1238 A.D. , the Ganga empire reached its zenith.
- After his accession in 1238 A.D., Narasimha I followed the policy of aggressive imperialism.
- Narasimhadeva's achievement as a builder was unparallel.
- The outstanding Sun temple at Konarka bears the testimony in the field of art, architecture and sculpture.
- He was a great patron of Sanskrit literature. Vidyadhara, his court poet composed his famous *Alankara* work *Ekavali* which describes the achievements of Narasimhadeva I.
- Bhanudeva IV, the last Ganga king, ascended the throne after the death of Narasimhadeva IV in 1414 till 1435 A.D.

- When he was busy in his southern campaign against the Reddis, Kapilesvara Routraya, his trusted minister betrayed him and by the help of the Brahmins usurped the throne in 1435 A.D.
- Thus, the Ganga dynasty came to an end to the glorious reign of the Gangas.

3.2.7. Exercise

- Discuss the political history of the Ganga dynasty.
- High light the achievements of Anantavarman Chodagangadeva.
- Discuss the contribution of Anagngabhimadeva to the political history of Ganga dynasty.
- Describe the achievements of Narasimhadeva I.

3.2.8.Further Reading

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Unit-3
Chapter-III
THE GANGA ADMINISTRATION

Structure

3.3.0. Objectives

3.3.1. Introduction

3.3.2. Ganga Administration

3.3.2.1. Concept of kingship

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3.3.2.3. Council of ministers

3.3.2.4. Division of the empire

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3.3.2.6. Taxes, Land settlement and Land revenue

3.3.3. Conclusion

3.3.4. Summary

3.3.5. Exercise

3.3.6. Further Reading

3.3.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students explore the Ganga administration. After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- *trace the history of the Ganga administration*
- *identify the pattern of Ganga administration*
- *recognize the division of the empire*
- *appreciate the role of army in the Ganga administration .*
- *know the sources of income of the Ganga dynasty.*

3.3.1.Introduction

In order to give stabilisation and consolidation to the vast empire, the Gangas introduced a well organised administrative system. Chodaganga being a foreigner to this alien land could very well realise his duty towards the people of Odisha. The Gangas devoted themselves for the material prosperity of their subjects by executing various humanitarian and welfare projects. This made them popular among his Odishan subjects.

3.3.2. Ganga Administration

The Gangas had a vast kingdom stretching from the Ganges in the north to Godavari in the south. The four hundred years unbroken rule of the Gangas gave a good opportunity for them to give good administration to the subjects of the Ganga dynasty.

3.3.2.1.Concept of kingship

They had a superior conception of kingship. They intended at realising the Kautilyan idea of providing Yogakshema to their subjects. They sought to work out the principle that the king must be learned, ideal, efficient and capable of upholding justice and promoting the welfare of the people. As the records of the Ganga rule show, kings like Vajrahasta-I, Anantavarman Chodagangadeva, Ananqabhirnadeva-lll, Narasimhadeva-I, and Bhanudeva-I were wise, benevolent and accomplished rulers. They were all well-versed in the canons of religion and statecraft. The Ganga kings assumed high sounding titles like *'Maharaja, Maharajadhiraja, Parama Mahesvara, Paramabhattaraka, Trikalingadhipati, Paramavaisnava, Chakravarti, Gajapati,* etc. They ruled the country in accordance with the principles laid down in the *Niti* and *Smriti* texts. They looked after the material prosperity and spiritual well-being of their subjects. Undoubtedly, the aim of the kings was the fulfilment of the desire of their subjects.

3.3.2.2.Power of the king

The king was the pivot of the government. Among the powers of the king, appointment of ministers, imposition of taxes, exemption of the subjects from taxes, building of temples,

declaration of war and conclusion of peace, grant of lands to Brahmins, conduction of tours to different parts of the empire to acquaint with the problems of the subjects etc. were important.

3.3.2.3.Council of ministers

Though the king was the supreme head of the government, during the Ganga period, he exercised his authority in consultation with the council of ministers. The Ganga kings were assisted by several officials like *Mantri, Purohita, Yuvaraja, Sandhivigrahika, Senapati, Dauvarika* etc. In general, the ministers were called *Patra-Samantas.* The revenue minister was designated as *'Mahapatra.* The minister in charge of war and peace and foreign affairs was known as Sandhivigrahika.

3.3.2.4.Division of the empire

For the administrative convenience the Gangas divided the empire into a number of *Mahamandalas* (greater provinces). The administrator of a *Mahamandala* was designated as *Mahamandalika* (governor in chief). A *Mahamandala* was divided into a number of *Mandalas* (provinces). Every *Mandala* was under the charge of a *Mandalika* (governor). Further, a *Mandala* consisted of *Vishayas* or *Bhogas* (districts). A *Vishaya* or *Bhoga* was in charge of a *Vishayapati* or *Bhaugika.* A *Vishaya* or *Bhoga* consisted of anumber of *gramas* (villages). Each village was under the charge of a *gramika.*

3.3.2.5.Powerful army

The Ganga emperors maintained their rule over an extensive territory with the help of a powerful army. The Ganga rulers themselves were great warriors. The following designations of their army commanders are mentioned in the Ganga inscription – *Sakata batapati* (Supreme Commander of armed forces), *Senadhyaksa* (Commander-in-Chief), *Senapati, Dalapati* and *Vahinipati.* The army men could be recruited from all the four *varnas - Brahmana, Kshatriya , Vaishya* and *Shudra.* The army consisted of three wings elephantry, cavalry and infantry. Elephants were particularly used for striking terror in the heart of the enemies. The soldiers used various types of weapons in the wars, such as sword, dagger, shield, spear, mace, and bows etc.

3.3.2.6.Taxes , Land settlement and Land revenue

During the Ganga period the revenue system was sound. A variety of taxes like *bheta, Voda, Paika, Ohour, Paridarsana* etc. were being collected as is gleaned from the Ganga inscriptions. Land revenue was the major source of income for the Ganga government. One-sixth

of the production of the land was collected as the land revenue. According to the land settlement, undertaken by Anangabhimadeva-1I1 of the Ganga dynasty had 9,49,60,000 acres of cultivable land in Odisha during his rule. Out of this amount of the total cultivable land 4,63,00,000 acres of land were tax-free lands, donated to the temples, Brahmanas, royal servants and others. The Ganga rulers donated lands, with all proprietary rights. Taxes were collected by the Ganga monarchs from 4,86,00,000 acres of undonated lands. Besides land revenue other sources of income for the state were duties on exports, imports and forest products and fines, court fees, salt tax etc.

3.3.3.Conclusion

Thus, the above fact shows that the Ganga kings were benevolent despots who always looked after the welfare of the people. They were also great patrons of art, architecture and literature. In fact, by their unbroken rule around four hundred years, they projected a well-organised political set up which guided the future rulers of the Suryavamsi Ganapati dynasty and after. Undoubtedly, the Ganga administration brought peace, tranquility and stability to the people of Odisha for four centuries which is unparalled in the administrative history of Ganga dynasty.

3.3.4.Summary

- In order to give stabilisation and consolidation to the vast empire, the Gangas introduced a well organised administrative system.
- The Gangas devoted themselves for the material prosperity of his subjects by executing various humanitarian and welfare projects.
- The four hundred years unbroken rule of the Gangas gave a good opportunity for them to give good administration to the subjects of the Ganga dynasty.
- They had a superior conception of kingship. They intended at realising the Kautilyan idea of providing Yogakshema to their subjects.
- They sought to work out the principle that the king must be learned, ideal, efficient and capable of upholding justice and promoting the welfare of the people.
- As the records of the Ganga rule show, kings like Vajrahasta-I, Anantavarman Chodagangadeva, Ananqabhirnadeva-lll, Narasimhadeva-I, and Bhanudeva-I were wise, benevolent and accomplished rulers.
- The king was the pivot of the government.

- Among the powers of the king, appointment of ministers, imposition of taxes, exemption of the subjects from taxes, building of temples, declaration of war and conclusion of peace, grant of lands to Brahmins, etc. were prominent.
- Though the king was the supreme head of the government, during the Ganga period, he exercised his authority in consultation with the council of ministers.
- The Ganga kings were assisted by several officials like *Mantri, Purohita, Yuvaraja, Sandhivigrahika, Senapati, Dauvarika* etc.
- For the administrative convenience the Gangas divided the empire into a number of *Mahamandalas* (greater provinces).
- The Ganga emperors maintained their rule over an extensive territory with the help of a powerful army.
- . The army men could be recruited from all the four *varnas* - *Brahmana, Ksh*a*triya* , *Vaishya* and *Shudra.*
- The army consisted of three wings elephantry, cavalry and infantry.
- During the Ganga period the revenue system was sound.
- A variety of taxes like *bheta, Voda, Paika, Ohour, Paridarsana* etc. were being collected as is gleaned from the Ganga inscriptions.
- One-sixth of the production of the land was collected as the land revenue.
- According to the land settlement, undertaken by Anangabhimadeva-1I1 of the Ganga dynasty had 9,49,60,000 acres of cultivable land in Odisha during his rule.
- Besides land revenue other sources of income for the state were duties on exports, imports and forest products and fines, court fees, salt tax etc.

3.3.5.Exercise

- Give an account on the Ganga administration.
- Discuss the different aspects of the administrative system of the Ganga dynasty.
- Write a short note on the concept of kingship during the Ganga period.
- Describe the administrative policies of the Ganga rulers.

3.3.6.Further Reading

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Unit-3
Chapter-IV

Cultural significance of the Ganga rule

Structure

3.4.0. Objectives
3.4.1. Introduction
3.4.2. Cultural significance of the Ganga rule
3.4.2.1. Traditional *Varna* system
3.4.2.2. Development of *Karanas* (Kayasthas) caste
3.4.2.3. Position of women during the Ganga period
3.4.2.4. Religion during the Ganga period
3.4.2.5. Secular nature of the Ganga rulers
3.4.2.6. Art and Architecture during the Ganga period
3.4.2.7. Patron of Learning
3.4.2.8. Evolution of Odia Language
3.4.2.9. Music and Dance during Ganga rule
3.4.2.10. Overseas Trade:
3.4.3. Conclusion
3.4.4. Summary
3.4.5. Exercise
3.4.6. Further Reading

3.4.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students explore the cultural significance of Ganga dynasty. After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- *trace the cultural significance of the Ganga dynasty*
- *identify the social pattern of life during the Ganga period*
- *recognize the religion of the Gangas*
- *know the cultural life of the people of the Ganga dynasty*

3.4.1. Introduction

The cultural efflorescence of Odisha during the Ganga period was undoubtedly the outcome of the able leadership, political stability, strong administration and economic prosperity. The art, architecture and sculpture developed during the Ganga period. The Ganga rulers were alos great patern of learning and literature. Their court adorned many great literary persons. The people in the society were living in a peaceful state as the kings of the Ganga dynasty were benevolent in nature.

3.4.2. Cultural significance of the Ganga rule

In order to understand the cultural significance of Ganga dynasty, it is essential to know about the society and condition of people during the Ganga period, the religion, art and architecture, music, dance, language and literature, trade and commerce etc.

3.4.2.1. Traditional *Varna* system

During the Ganga period the traditional *Varna* system(Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Sudra) was prevailed. The Brahmanas enjoyed the highest status and maximum privileges in the society during this period. Many of them enjoyed land grants *(Agraharas)* as scholars and priests. During this period it is found that a number of Brahmanas entered into non-religious professions like military service, other categories of government service, and trade.

3.4.2.2. Development of *Karanas* (Kayasthas) caste

The records of the Ganga period mention the *Karanas* (Kayasthas) as an important caste developed during this period. They were a hereditary class of writers. Their *Varna* status is not clear from the available records. Some sources say that they were Kshatriyas. Others hold that they were Shudras. Whatever might be their *Varna* status, they occupied all cadres of posts in government, from that of a village-headman and accountant to that of a prime minister and army general.

3.4.2.3. Position of women during the Ganga period

During the Ganga period women were held in esteem in the society specially in case of royal women. In many of the donative records the donors state the names of their mothers. Royal ladies were noted for their pious disposition and devotion to husbands. It appears that the royal ladies had access to education and specialised forms of art like music and dance. Chandrikadevi, the daughter of Anangabhimadeva III was accomplished in music and dance. She built the temple of Ananta Vasudeva in Bhubaneswar. Sivarani, a lady of Ganga lineage was called the *Kaliyuga Saraswati* (Goddess of Learning in Kali Age). However, the women's status seems to have been some extent reduced during this period. The *Smritis* and *Nitisastras* of the time restrict their freedom. Women were expected to be devoted to their husbands. But the Ganga kings themselves were polygamous. The *Smritis* also permitted the rulers to go for poligamy. In practice it appears that women enjoyed a good deal of freedom. They also danced as *Devadasis* in the temples. The plentiful depiction of women as singers and dancers, erotic partners and seductive *Nayikas* also point out their independence.

3.4.2.4. Religion during the Ganga period

The early Ganga rulers were devout Saivites. But after capturing Odisha, the Gangas accepted Vaishnavism. They showed great devotion to Purushottam-Jagannath who was regarded as a manifestation of Vishnu. Chodagangadeva built the present gigantic temple of Lord Jagannath. Anangabhimadeva-III declared that he ruled the empire as the *Routa* or deputy of Lord Jagannath. Puri with Lord Jagannath as the presiding deity became a great centre of Vaishnavism during the Ganga period. The great *Bhakti* saints like Ramanuja, Narahari Tirtha and Jagannath Tirtha came to Odisha from outside during this period. The recital of *Gita Govinda* of Jayadeva (the Vaishnava poet of this period) was introduced into the daily rituals of the Jagannath temple.

3.4.2.5.Secular nature of the Ganga rulers

The Ganga rulers were secular in nature. Inspite of allegiance to Lord Jagannath, the state deity, the Gangas also patronized the worship of other deities - Siva, Parvati and Sun-God. Chodagangadeva donated a village for the maintenance of a perpetual lamp in the Lingaraj temple of Bhubaneswar. Parvati temple was built inside the precinct of the Lingaraj temple during the Ganga rule. Narasihmhadeva-I built the temple for Sun-God at Konark. The Ganga rulers seem to have attempted a harmony between Saivism and Vaishnavism. The transformation

of Siva of the Lingaraj temple into the conjoint deity, Harihar (Vishnu as well as Siva), and the construction of the Vishnu temple of Ananta Vasudeva by a Ganga princess named Chandrika devi in the midst of the Siva temples indicate attempts at such a synthesis of Hari-Hara cult.

3.4.2.6.Art and Architecture during the Ganga period

The art and architecture of Odisha reached the zenith of glory in the constant and strenuous building activities of the great Ganga monarchs like Chodaqanqadeva, Anangabhimadeva-III and Narasimhadeva-1. The Gangas built two unrivaled and beautiful monuments - the Jagannath temple of Puri and the Sun temple of Konark. These two temples are remarkable for their massive structure, architectural skill, fine ornamentation and beautiful images representing animals, gods, goddesses, episodes from mythology and erotic partners.

3.4.2.7.Patron of Learning

Being learned and cultured themselves, the Ganga monarchs extended their patronage to the promotion of learning. They offered land grants to the learned Brahmins, temples and *maths* (monasteries). The temples and *maths* were centres of religious culture as well as learning. The copper plate grants and stone inscriptions show the high water mark of Sanskrit literature in Odisha during the Ganga era. During this era there were a number of intellectual luminaries in Odisha. Pandit Vidyadhar (*Ekavali),* Jayadeva (*Gita Govinda),* Shridhar Acharya and Nilambar Acharya (the *Smriti* writers), Viswanath Kaviraj (*Sahitya Darpan),* and Satyananda (the astronomer who wrote *Surya Siddhanta)* belong to Ganga period.

3.4.2.8.Evolution of Odia Language

During this period some stone and copper plate inscriptions of the Ganga period clearly indicate that Odia language and script took a definite shape. As a result, during the reign of Kapilendradeva, the immediate successor of the Gangas, Sarala Das could write his magnus opus, *Mahabharat* in the language of the masses i.e. Odia.

3.4.2.9.Music and Dance during Ganga rule

The Ganga monarchs were great patron of music and dance. The *Natamandapas* (Dancing Halls) of the temples were the places where the *Devadasis* (the maidens dedicated to the temples) were performing dances to the tune of compositions and musical instruments. The temple of Jagannath at Puri and the Sun Temple of Konark (which were built by the Gangas) have *Natamandapas.* Anangabhimadeva-III added *Natamandapa* to the temple of Lingaraj in Bhubaneswar. The Ganga kings employed damsels in the temples for singing and dancing.

Tradition states that Padmavati, the wife of poet Jayadeva was a *Devadasi*, dedicated to Lord Jagannath. She used to dance to the tune of the songs, composed by her husband. The Ganga temples, particularly the *Natamandapas* are full of singing and dancing girls in ecstatic postures with musical instruments found in the panels.

3.4.2.10.Overseas Trade:

The development of cultural activities of Odisha during the Ganga period was possible due to her economic prosperity. During this period Odisha continued her ancient commercial relation with South East Asian countries. The engraving of boats in the *Bhoga Mandapa* of the Jagannath temple of Puri, a panel show in the transportation of elephants (preserved in the Odisha State Museum) and, the reference to a township, inhabited by the artisans and traders in the Nagari plate of Anangabhimadeva-1I1, etc. are the evidence of Odisha's overseas trade an commerce during the Ganga period. Clothes, diamonds and elephants were exported from Odisha to outside countries.

3.4.3.Conclusion

Thus, the four hundred years of glorious rule of the Gangas is unique in many sense in the history of medieval Odisha. The land was politically and culturally got united. The Kalinga school of architecture reached the zenith during the Ganga period. Further, the Sanskrit literature developed to a great extent during that period. The overall socio-economic-political and cultural pictures of this period testify to the fact that peace and tranquility prevailed all over the empire during the period of the mighty rulers of the Ganga dynasty.

3.4.4.Summary

- The cultural efflorescence of Odisha during the Ganga period was undoubtedly the outcome of the able leadership, political stability, strong administration and economic prosperity.
- In order to understand the cultural significance of Ganga dynasty, it is essential to know about the society and condition of people during the Ganga period, the religion, art and architecture, music, dance, language and literature, trade and commerce etc.
- During the Ganga period the traditional *Varna* system(Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Sudra) was prevailed.
- During the Ganga period women were held in esteem in the society specially in case of royal women.

- In many of the donative records the donors state the names of their mothers. Royal ladies were noted for their pious disposition and devotion to husbands.
- It appears that the royal ladies had access to education and specialised forms of art like music and dance.
- The early Ganga rulers were devout Saivites.
- But after capturing Odisha, the Gangas accepted Vaishnavism.
- They showed great devotion to Purushottam-Jagannath who was regarded as a manifestation of Vishnu.
- Chodagangadeva built the present gigantic temple of Lord Jagannath. Anangabhimadeva-III declared that he ruled the empire as the *Routa* or deputy of Lord Jagannath.
- The art and architecture of Odisha reached the zenith of glory in the constant and strenuous building activities of the great Ganga monarchs like Chodaqanqadeva, Anangabhimadeva-III and Narasimhadeva-1.
- The Gangas built two unrivaled and beautiful monuments - the Jagannath temple of Puri and the Sun temple of Konark.
- Being learned and cultured themselves, the Ganga monarchs extended their patronage to the promotion of learning.
- They offered land grants to the learned Brahmins, temples and *maths* (monasteries).
- During this era there were a number of intellectual luminaries in Odisha. Pandit Vidyadhar (*Ekavali),* Jayadeva (*Gita Govinda),* Shridhar Acharya and Nilambar Acharya (the *Smriti* writers), Viswanath Kaviraj (*Sahitya Darpan),* and Satyananda (the astronomer who wrote *Surya Siddhanta)* belong to Ganga period.
- During this period some stone and copper plate inscriptions of the Ganga period clearly indicate that Odia language and script took a definite shape.
- The Ganga monarchs were great patron of music and dance.
- The *Natamandapas* (Dancing Halls) of the temples were the places where the *Devadasis* (the maidens dedicated to the temples) were performing dances to the tune of compositions and musical instruments.
- The Ganga temples, particularly the *Natamandapas* are full of singing and dancing girls in ecstatic postures with musical instruments found in the panels.

- The development of cultural activities of Odisha during the Ganga period was possible due to her economic prosperity.
- During this period Odisha continued her ancient commercial relation with South East Asian countries.
- Thus, the four hundred years of glorious rule of the Gangas is unique in many sense in the history of medieval Odisha.
- The overall socio-economic-political and cultural pictures of this period testify to the fact that peace and tranquility prevailed all over the empire during the period of the mighty rulers of the Ganga dynasty.

3.4.5.Exercise

- Make an analysis on the cultural significance of the Ganga dynasty.
- Describe the contribution of the Ganga rulers to the Culture of Odisha.
- Discuss the different aspects of culture developed during the Ganga period.
- Write a note on the importance of Odishan culture during the Ganga rulers.

3.4.6.Further Reading

- S.N. Rajguru, *History of the Gangas,* Part I, Bhubaneswar, 1968.
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Unit-4

Chapter-I

Growth of temple architecture

Structure

4.1.0. Objectives

4.1.1. Introduction

4.1.2. Growth of temple architecture

4.1.2.1. Styles of temple architecture in India

4.1.2.2. Texts on temple architecture

4.1.2.3. Typical Odishan temple

4.1.2.4. Components of the Odishan temple

4.1.2.5. Initial years of temple architecture in Odisha

4.1.2.6. Growth temple architecture between the 8th and the 10th centuries

4.1.2.7. Main innovations of the temples of the 9th-lOth century

4.1.2.8. Growth of Odishan temple architecture between 11th century to 13th century A.D.

4.1.2.9. Some important temples of Odisha

4.1.2.10. Parsuramesvara Temple

4.1.2.11. Muktesvara Temple

4.1.2.12. Vaitala Temple

4.1.2.13. Rajarani Temple

4.1.2.14. Lingaraja Temple

4.1.2.15. The Jagannath temple at Puri

4.1.2.16. The Sun temple at Konarka

4.1.3. Conclusion

4.1.4. Summary

4.1.5. Exercise

4.1.6. Further Reading

4.1.0.Objectives

In this lesson, students explore the growth of temple architecture. After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- *trace the growth of temple architecture of Odisha*
- *identify the types of temple architecture in Odisha*
- *understand the main innovations of temple architecture during different periods*
- *know the different of temples in Odisha.*

4.1.1.Introduction

The art and architecture of a nation is considered as her property. The history of Odishan art and architecture starts with her dated history i.e. from 261 B.C., when Asoka conquered this land, then known as Kalinga. The art and architecture of Odisha, in its formative phase took a new turn. The style was so elegant, balanced and beautiful that it carved a new identity for itself. This was famous as Kalinga School of art.

4.1.2.Growth of temple architecture

Odisha is famous in the world for her beautiful temples. In fact, the temples constitute the most dominant and significant form of architecture in Odisha. They form "One of the most compact and homogeneous architecture groups in India."

4.1.2.1.Styles of temple architecture in India

Out of the three styles of temple architecture found in India like Nagara, Dravida and Vesara, Odisha has followed the Nagara with a distinctive regional bias of its own known as 'Kalinga'. An inscription in Amritesvara temple at Holal (Karnataka) dated 1235 A.D. mentions the names of all the four categories like Nagara, Dravida,Vesara and Kalinga.

4.1.2.2.Texts on temple architecture

In due course of time, several canonical texts were written for the construction of temples. Among such texts Bhuvana Pradipa, Bhuvanapravesa, Silpasastra, Silpasarini, Silpaprakasa, Silparatna Kosa and Silpi pothi etc are prominent. These texts helped in maintaining basic standards in the construction notwithstanding varieties of form and size. The Silpasarini mentions about several kinds of temples, viz., Manjusri, Mrudanga eka bhagika,

Vasusri, Mahameru, Kailasa, Ratnasara, Vartula ratha Vimana and Suvamakuta. Each variety has its own design based on a specific yantra (diagram).

4.1.2.3.Typical Odishan temple

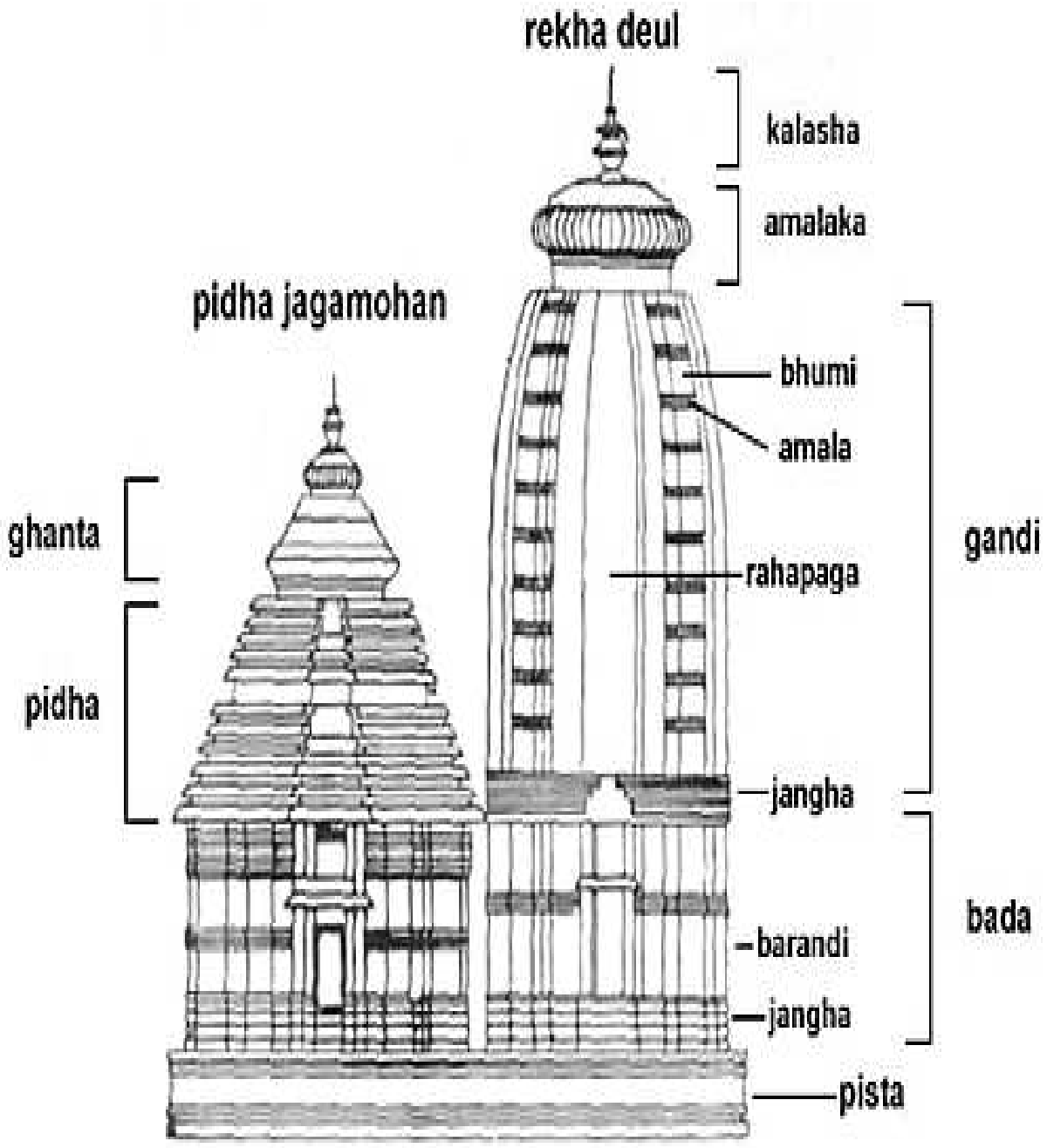
Bhuvana Pradipa mentions about three kinds of temples on the basis of their architectural features. These are: Rekha (curvilinear superstructure), Bhadra or Pidha (monument with a pyramidal roof) and Khakhara (oblong building with wagon-vault roof). The text mentions about 36 varieties of Rekha, 5 varieties of Bhadra and 3 varieties of Khakhara with proportionate measurements of each part and their heights. The typical Odishan temple consists of both Rekha and Bhadra-the Rekha for the Deula (sanctum cella or garbha griha with the curvilinear superstructure called sikhara or gandi) and the Bhadra for the pidha-deula to serve as the audience hall (Jagamohana or mukhasala). The pidha-deula, added to the front of the Rekha-deula, is covered by a pyramidal roof of receding steps. The smaller height of Pidha-deula represents a balance with the higher Rekha-deula and "greatly enhances the grandeur of the soaring curvilinear spire". N.K. Bose mentions that the axial arrangement of the Rekha and the Bhadra components of the Odishan temple began with the sanctum to which the porch was added later. Along the same axial line, Nata mandira (dance-hall) and Bhoga mandapa (hall of offering) were added later.The Odishan temples are usually of curvilinear spire with square sanctum. A few Pidha-type temples are made on the summit of the Mahendra and in Koraput, two hypaethral (circular and open) Yogini temples at Ranipur-Jharial and Hirapur the starshaped Ones at Baudh, and a few Khakhar temples.

4.1.2.4.Components of the Odishan temple

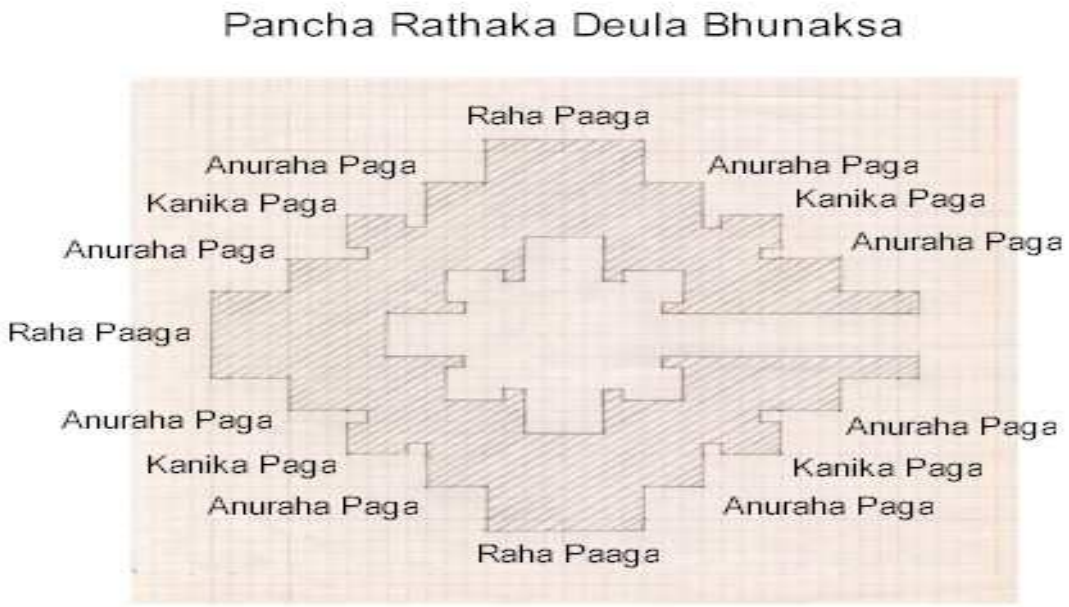
As regards the plan, in elevation the Odishan temple has four components, such as, pista (platform or vedika), the Vada (the vertical wall), gandi (the trunk), the mastaka (head or crown). The pista is absent in many temples. The bada consists of three parts, such as, pabhaga (foot-portion or bottom part consisting of Khura, Kumbha, Patta, Kani, Basanta), jangha (the thigh part) and baranda (moulding forming uppermost part of bada). The jangha is sub-divided into two parts-tala janga (lower thigh) and upper jangha (upper bond thigh) by a set of mouldings known as bandhana. There is similarity between the main temple and the pidha up to bada. The difference starts from the gandi. Where as gandi of the Rekhadeula inclines inward in a convex form, *i.e.* curvilinear outline, that of Pidha takes a pyramidal form. The gandi of Rekhadeula is

divided into several pagas (vertical projections). The corner pagas known as kanika-pagas are further sub-divided into horizontal sections known as bhumi by miniature amlas (ribbed disc resembling amla fruit). The central paga is known as Rahapaga and the next two as kanika and anu-raha. The door or entrance comes on the raha paga whereas niches come on the other three raha-pagas which go down upto pa- bhaga. It is thus in the plan of a four-door shrine. The subsidiary pagas are placed midway between the raha and the corner. Depending upon the number of pagas (also called rathas), temples are classified as triratha, pancha-ratha, sapta-ratha,etc. The topmost course of gandi is called visama. The mastaka (skull) above it consists of Veki (neck), amla, Khapuri (skull) Kalasa (Gar) ayudha (attribute or symbol of the deity).

In pidha deula, the gandi consists of a number of pidhas, gradually diminishing towards top in a pyramidal shape. The topmost pidha is reduced to about half of the lowest one. In later temples pidhas were grouped into tiers called potalas which are separate from each other by recessed vertical walls known as kanti. The hollow interior above the sanctum (garbha-griha) is hidden by a ceiling (garbhamuda) consisting of stone beams and rafters to maintain stability of the structure by binding the walls. In bigger temples, two or three ceilings (mudas) are found, as in the case of Lingaraja. Access to the chambers is made through an opening above the lintel of the door of the sanctum. The construction of such lofty temples like Lingaraja and Jagannatha creates awe and wonder in the mind of the onlooker regarding the technique of construction. In fact, the technique adopted was corbelling. The sized-Khondalite stones, used in most of temples, are laid horizontally one upon another, "held together mainly by a system of counterpoise, the weight of one stone acting against the pressure of another, much of the stability being a matter of balance and equilibrium". No cementing mortar of any kind has been used but iron cramps and dowels were used to keep the stone stabs in position.



Outline of Typical Kalingan Temple



Ground Plan of Kalingan Temple

4.1.2.5.Initial years of temple architecture in Odisha

The history of temple building in Odisha is said to have begun with Laxamanesvara,Bharatesvara and Satrughnesvara group of temples at Bhubaneswar in 6th century A.D. and culminated with the Sun temple of Konarka in 13th century AD. The earliest surviving temples at Bhubaneswar are the three ruined temples like Laksamaneswar, Bharateswar and Satrughneswar. These are Rekha temples in triratha plan. On the basis of an inscription on the Laksmaneswara the date of the temples are assigned to the .later half of 6th century AD. Each of them has niches on its bada to contain parsvadevata. The front raha of Bharateswara temple is carved with two chaitya windows containing Ravananugraha form of Siva and Nataraja in the lower and upper niches respectively. These temples are unicameral *i.e.*, having only the sanctum without the Jagamohana. The Parsurameswara temple assigned to 7th century AD. is the best preserved specimen among the early group of temples. It consists of both Deula and Jagamohana. The Deula is tri-ratha in plan in the bada but features of Pancharatha are visible in the Gandi. The Sikhara is of modest height and gives a squattish look. The Jagmohana is a rectangular hall with a terraced roof sloping in two tiers with clerestory in between. The Svavnajalesvara temple at Bhubaneswar offers another example of the early type. The temple, consisting of vimana only, bears clear affinities with the Parasurameswar in elevation and

decoration. For example, the theme of marriage of Siva and Parvati is rendered almost in an identical manner in both the temples.

4.1.2.6.Growth temple architecture between the 8th and the 10th centuries

The next stage of growth of temple architecture is noticed in the temples built between the 8th and the 10th centuries. The 8th century temples at Bhubaneswar include Vaital, Sisiresvar, Uttaresvar, Mohini and Markandesvar. Outside Bhubaneswar, the notable temples are Bhringeswar, Siva temple at Bajrakot, Kanakesvar temple at Kualo, Manikesvar temple at Sukleswar, Dakshesvar temple at Badgan and Nilakanthesvar temple at Padmapur. The changes and innovations of the period are seen at the Sisiresivara temple (cir. 775 AD.). It is pancharatha in plan. The front raha paga contains the image of Nataraja in a chaitya window. The Jagamohana, like that of Parasuramesvara is rectangular in plan and has a terraced roof but does not have any window or pillar. The roof is held in its position by cantilever principle. It is an advancement in architectural feature.

The Mohini temple on the South bank of Bindu Sarovar has a totally undecorated pancharatha sikhara, with a plain recessed bandhana below it. The Mukhasala, a recent restoration with plain blocks of stone, is a pillared hall with pilasters against the side wall. The Svapnesvar temple at Kualo on the bank of the Brahmani near Talcher is a badly damaged example of a panchayatana temple. The main temple, like the Satrughneswara group and Parasuramesvara, contains an Astagraha Panel on the lintel of the shrine. The main temple is dedicated to Siva while the corner shrines contains images of Durga, Ganesa, Surya and Visnu. The Durga temple at Vaidyeswara is a small shrine in the Khakhara Style, with a height of about 12 feet. The barrel-vaulted roof is made of in two levels and the narrow sides are decorated with Vajramastakas containing Ekapadasiva and Ganesa on one side and Andhakasura badha-form of Siva and Nataraja Siva on the other side. It appears to be the precursor of the Vaital Deula which has an oblong sanctum, a wagon-vault roof and a mandapa like that of the Parasuramesvara. It has interesting architectural features-instead of Raha projections, the Bada has elegantly carved shallow pilasters. At each of the four comers of the Jagamohana stands a miniature rekha temple. Though small in size, the tower of the temple is most proportionate and very beautiful. However, the style did not thrive because of the popularity of Sikhara Style.

4.1.2.7.Main innovations of the temples of the 9th-l0th century

Temples of the 9th-lOth century temples evolved with more advanced architectural features like the harmonious proportion of pagas on the Bada and the Gandi. The pyramidal form of the Jagamohana emerged in the period. The Singhanath temple in the bed of the Mahanadi in Cuttack district, the twin temples of Nalamadhava and Siddhesvara at Gandharadi in Boud district are some of the specimens of the period. V. Dehejia states that the Singhanath is "the most advanced of our Formative phase Temples as far as the joint between Shrine and Mukhasala is concerned." The Mukhasala is a rectangular flat-roof and pillared. The roof is triple- tiered without any sign of any clerestory between them. The Shrine Walls are triratha in plan. The main innovations were the tall and slender pilasters on either side of the niches extending up to the Bandhana level.

The Varahi temple at Chaurasi is "one of the most fascinating of early Odishan temples." Dehejia notes that it marks the transitional phase in Odisha architecture. It is said to have represented the Vimanamalini or Kamagarbha type of temple prescribed in the text of Silpaprakasha. The walls of the shrine reveal pancharatha features and contain the features of a typical transition temple. The Sikhara of the shrine is barrel vaulted like that of Vaital but it has "a richer, more baroque appearance characterstic of the transition period." The Mukhasala is rectangular, unpillared and has a flat double-roof, profusely decorated with Kumbhas and Mithunas in the clerestory.

The Muktesvara temple belongs to the period of transition. The sanctum is a full-fledged pancharatha in plan and the roof of the Mandapa has a horizontal tier with Kalasa (Vase or Jar) as the crowning element. Its Sikhara gives a rounded look with elegant contours. The central projection contains an elaborate chaitya window flanked by two grinning dwarfs, which constitutes an early form of the "bho" motive. It is an important feature of developed Odishan style. Dehejia notes, “Early Odishan architecture reached its peak in the exquisite little Muktesvar temple located at the edge of a tank at Bhubaneswar. Long years of architectural and sculptural experience here crystallized into faultless shape and dimensions, and, as though this were not enough, the sculptors decided to add a beautiful carved torana gateway and a low sculptured decorative wall enclosing the temple.” It is considered to be a piece of "gem of Odishan architecture." The Kutaitundi temple at Khiching is another fine specimen of the lOth century A.D. The star-shaped triple temples at Boudh, the ruined Visnu temple at Ganeswarpur, the 64-Yogini temple of Hirapur and Ranipur Jharial may also be assigned to the time. The

Odisha State Gazetteer (Vol. Il), mentions, “The fully evolved temple style emerged about the 11th century. A deula of rekha type and a Jagamohan of pidha order became the standard type with all their components clearly articulated. The Pancha-kama pabhaga, Panchanga bada, multiple mouldings as haranda, introduction of Khakhara and Pidha mundi designs on the jangha, Vidalas and Kanyas in the recesses and figures in high relief are some of the changes introduced during the period. The deula with well developed projections, vertically running from the base to the bisama and added with angasikharas on the gandi came to possess a soaring height and majestic appearance not known in the preceding phase. The projecting lion-on-elephant motif on the raha, insertion of figures on the beki, etc., are some of the additional features of the rekha deula. The Jagamohan emerged as well-formed pidha deula with harmonious grouping of pidhas in tiers and all the component members in the mastaka.”

4.1.2.8.Growth of Odishan temple architecture between 11th century A.D. to 13th century A.D.

The Rajarani temple (l1th century AD.) represents a unique experiment in temple architecture. Its Sikhara has been clustered by miniature repetition of the Sikhara (called anga-Sikhara) around the Gandi in the Khajuraho Style. The beautiful female figures and standing Digpalas are the outstanding features of the temple. The Rajarani temple and its Jagamohana facing east stand on a platform having three mouldings. The bada is divided into five parts indicating a progress from trianga to panchanga bada. While the vimana represents Rekha style clustered with miniature Sikharas, the Jagamohana is a typical pyramidal structure (pidha deula) similar to that of the Muktesvara temple. The Jagamohana is pancharatha in plan and crowned by a kalasa. It is surprisingly devoid of any sculptures in contrast with the heavily carved and decorated main temple. There is no rampant lion on the rahapaga and the top amalaka is supported by four squat figures. The Deula appears circular on account of the anga sikharas which cluster round the gandi. The Silpa ratna kosa calls the type as Manjusri (also called Misragarbha, Misrarekha, Vimanagarbhaka, Vimanamauli and Saptangagarbha) on the basis of the representation of angasikharas. The Brahmesvara temple of 11th century AD. is a full-fledged curvilinear pancharatha panchayatana temple. Its pidha temple and components of mastaka are fully developed and have been followed in the majestic Lingaraja temple.

The Lingaraja is the loftiest, grandest and most majestic temple of 11th century AD. It marks the culmination of temple architecture. It is the perfect specimen, a landmark, among

rekha temples of the entire country with fully developed Vimana, Jagamohana, Natamandira and Bhogamandapa. The sanctum is pancharatha in plan. The portion below the spire consists of five divisions and rests on five richly decorated mouldings. The niches of the central projections on three sides contain Parsva-devata images. The upara jangha contains roofs of horizontal tiers (pidhamundis) whereas the tala jangha is presented with miniature shrines of wagon-vaulted roofs (khakhara mundis). It is described as a shrine “.....with a maturity and blooming Odishan style showing fully developed vimana, Jagamohana, natamandira and bhogamandapa. The parabolic curve of the tower, rising to a great height lends a unique grandeur to the temple. The height and soaring character of the towering Sikhara are emphasised by deeply incised lines of the rathas (vertical projections) a pair of which carry four diminishing replicas of the tower itself as a decorative pattern.”

The Lingaraja temple-pattern followed by a number of temples like the Kedaresvara at Bhubaneswar, Jalesvara at Kalarbhanga, Gatesvara at Algem etc. The Jagannatha temple of Puri is "by far the most important temple of the 12th century and the highest extant temple of Odisha." The temple, like the Lingaraja, consists of the four components of Deula, Jagmohana, Natamandira and Bhogamandapa. The removal of the coats of plaster, in recent years, from the bada and the gandi revealed the plan as well as the decoration of the temple. The plan is pancharatha with rounded and projecting kanika. The kanika is divided into ten bhumis. Multiple baranda mouldings form the base of the gandi. There is almost no transition from the bada to gandi. Although it is a very lofty tower (about 215 '), a perfectly developed specimen of rekha temple, it lacks 'the elegance and proportion of the Lingaraja'. The first bhumi of the raha has horizontal projections of four angasikharas, two on each side of the Garuda motif which crowns the vajramastaka on the baranda. The Jagamohana is a fully developed pidha deula with a pyramidal roof. The temple has two compound walls with four gates on the four directions.

The Meghesvara temple (cir. 1195 AD.) of Bhubaneswar is an important structure in the evolution of Odishan temple architecture. It stands on a platform. It has seven fully formed pilasters which give it the look of a rounded structure. The intermediate pilasters have a series of complete miniature sikharas running up to the top and making a part of the walls. The comer pilasters have half-amalakas in place of anga- sikharas. The Jagamohana is a plain, undecorated pidha temple with a door and two balustraded windows. The most important change in the plan was adoption of saptaratha in place of pancharatha. It is the earliest example of Saptaratha.

The temple architecture has attained its most advanced form in the 13th century AD. with the construction of the Sun temple at Konark. It is rightly observed “Its advancement is marked by the blending of sculpture with architectural magnificance, chariotcar conception, completely detached natamandira and provision of a high basement for the sanctum and Jagamohana. The intact Jagamohana compensates for the loss of the lofty tower. Its bold conception, massive execution, perfect propertions and imposing dimensions leave the visitor with an undescrible feeling of awe and amazement.” (Art Traditions of Odisha, Odisha Sahitya Akademy)

The temple is conceived as the mythical chariot of the Sun god with twenty-four wheels and seven richly caparisoned horses. Each of the wheels is a master piece of Indian art. The conception, in deed, makes it 'a charming monument unique in the realm of art. The main temple, which is not in existence now, was said to be 228 feet high. The gigantic Jagamohana, which survives, speaks volumes on the attainment of the Kalinga style of architecture. It is pancharatha in plan and stands on a pista. It is a pidha-deula having a three-tiered pyramidal roof in contrast to the two-tiered roof of the Lingaraja and the Jagannatha temples. The interior is a square of 60 feet on each side and the ceiling is supported by four pillars and, iron beams. It possesses three entrances with beautifully carved door-jambs and lintels of finely grained chlorite stone.

The natamandira is, unlike that the Lingaraja and the Jagamohana of the temple, a detached structure, standing at a distance of thirty feet in front of the Jagamohana. It stands on a richly decorated platform. The mandira is a profusely ornate pillared hall. The temple-complex is very huge measuring 865 x 540 feet. The plinth and the pedestal measure 16 feet 6 inches. The stylobate befits the giant wheels each of which measure 9 feet 9 inches in diameter. Each of the seven horses four on the right and three on the left side-measure 5 feet 2 inches. Most importantly, the temple is planned in such a way as to receive the first rays of the Sun, the presiding god of the temple. Abul Fazl, the court-historian of Akbar, has narrated the existence of 28 temples in the grand complex near the Sun temple. The ruins of the temple of Chhayadevi vouch safe the fact. About the Sun temple he narrates, “Near Jagnnath is the temple dedicated to the sun. Its cost was defrayed by twelve years revenue of the province. Even those whose judgement is critical and who are difficult to please stand astonished at its sight.” On the otherhand, Sir John Marshall was overwhelmed with the grandiose plan and unique execution and remarked,“There is no monument of Hinduism, I think, that is at once so stupendous and so

perfectly proportioned, as the Black Pagode, and none which leaves so deep an impression on the memory."

4.1.2.9.Some important temples of Odisha

During the Sailodbhaba period Lakshmanesvara, Bharatesvara, Satrughnesvara, Parsurarnesvara and Svarnajalesvara temple had been constructed in Bhubaneswar. During the Bhauma-Kara period Sisiresvara, Vaitala (Khakara type) and Markandesvara temples were built. During Somavamsi period Muktesvara, Rajarani, Brahmesvara and Lingaraja temples were built. During Ganga period Jagannath temple and Sun temple were famous. Let us discuss some important temples of Odisha in brief which are given bellow.

4.1.2.10.Parsuramesvara Temple

The Parsuramesvara temple of Bhubaneswar belongs to the 7th century A.D. Although it is *tri-ratha* in plan, but the *Gandi* projects the *Pancharatha* style The *pagas* (pilasters) which constitute the special feature of the Odishan temple architecture were not fully developed in this temple. Each of the three pilasters contains a niche. The central pilaster contains the highest number of niches and the two other contain equal number of niches. There are all together eleven niches in this temple The *sikhara* portion contains an *amalaka*, a *kalasi* and a *lingam* instead of *Ayudha.* This is a peculiar feature of the Parasuramesvara temple of Odisha.

The *Jagamohana* or *Muklasala* made its appearance first in the temple of Parasuramesvara. It is rectangular having skylight between two sloping tires of terrace roof. The roof is supported by two rows of three pillars on each side and the roof supported by the two side-walls. The addition of the porch-hall to the main shrine reflect the second step in the evolution of temple architecture in Odisha. The Parsuramesvara temple reflects other architechiral peculiarities. It has two doors and four windows placed irregularly in the *Mukhasala.* One Door in on the south side and the other is in the west wall. It faces the sanctuary. The windows of north and south help in the ventilation. The windows on each side of the west door contain figures musicious and dancers. The walls of the porch and shrine are carved with various sculptures scros creepers, human and animal figures and stories from mythology are found as decorative motif of the temple. Although the carvings are crude and coarse but the figures look lively and natural. Simplicity and elegance were the hallmarks of such sculptures. Even today these sculptures are unparalled in the history of temple architechure of Odisha.

4.1.2.11.Muktesvara Temple

The Muktesvara temple is a unique one in the field of Odishan temple architechure. It was so elegantly disigned that it became one of the most beautiful temples of India. The gate of the temple was well designed and its balance and design give it a grandoise look. The *Vimana* stands on a raised platform. It is square in ground plan. The base has its five divisions such as *Khura, Kumbha, Pata, Kani* and *Vasanta.* These five divisions were absent in earlier divisions of temple. The pilasters have recesses which contain *Gaja Simha* and *Naga* columns. Here in this temple, the niches are empty and have no *Parsvadevatas* (side deities). The *Sikhara* is short. It has four *Natarajas* and four *Kirtti-mukhas* on four facades. The *Nataraja* figure from the western facade has been detached and kept inside a miniature temple inside the same temple premises. It has *no Anga-sikhara* (replica of the main tower). The ground plan as the *Jagamohana* of the Muktesvara temple is just like a star. The *The Muktesvara* Temple steps of the pyramidal roof recede when it ascends. The temple has on *amlaka.* The *Badas* on the northern and southern sides have pilasters and each of them contains a square-shaped perforated window. The portions of the roof above the windows rise in two tires with the steps (pidhas) and are surmounted by images of lions. The recesses between the pilasters contain the figures of *Gaja-simha* and Naga-columns. The *Torana* (gate) is a unique fealure of the temple of Mhktesvara. It stands before the *Jagamohana.* The basement of the pillars contain an each face a miniature shrine having a twin *Gaja-simha* figures at the top. Each of the sixteen-sided shafts consists of four blocks of stone and at their top appears *Kirtti-mukhas.* The top most blocks has imposed *Vedika, Amlaka* and a spreading lotus capital on both the sides a pair of female figures with graceful pose are found. Each arch has a projecting *Makara-mukha* which is quite distinct in the *Torana* of Muktesvara.

4.1.2.12.Vaitala Temple

The Vaitala temple (c. A.D. 775) of Bhubaneswar in a typical temple architecture. It represents the perfact presentation of the *Khakhara* type of architecture. Although, it represents a *ratha* type but the finials consists of *Amalaka* and *Ayudha.* The plan of the temple is different. It stands on a lower platform. Scroll mouldings are found at the lower basement. Except the west on all the sides of the temple rectangular niches occur on the walls in the form of window. Between *Bada* and *Mastaka* erotic sculptures occur. The *Jagamohana* of the vaitala temple is rectangular on its four corners are placed the replicas of the *Sikhara* type of temple. The *Jagamohana* has no pillar, grill or window. There are fifteen sculptures in the *Jagamohana.* The

inner structure of Vaitala temple has an eight-armed chamunda figure was in the presiding deity. She is surrounded by other *Matrika* figures like Brahmane; Mahesvari; Kaumari; Vaishnavi; Varahi and Aindri. The image of Virabhadra is also found associated with the Matrika figures. Historians presume that the vaitala temple was meant for the practice of Tantra rituals. Unusually, the inside of the temple is dark in comparism to other temples. Perhaps, some esoteric practices were going on inside the temple.

4.1.2.13.Rajarani Temple

The Rajarani temple (A.D. 1000-1022) in Bhubaneswar is a splendur in Odishan architecture. Some historians think that its name was Indresvara or Indralingesvara as per the name its builder lndraratha, an illustrious somavamsi ruler. This temple has no presiding deity at present and it is famous as a temple having no deity.

The Rajarani temple stands on a platform having three mouldings. The temple has a punchanga *Bada.* The *Vimana* of the temple represents *Rekha* style clustered with miniature *Sikharas.* Its *Jagamohana* is a *Pidha deula* having a pyramidal structure. It is *Pancharatha* in plan. In is crowned with a Kalasa. In the Rajarani temple, the *Navagraha* Panel appears on the lintels of both the purch and the sanctur. The *Digpalas, Dvarapalas* and other decorative motifs are found on the body of the temple. The *Vimana* of the temple bears a large number of its miniature prototype called as *Anger-sikharas.* The images of beautiful ladies, Dikpalas and shall images in alto-relievo of the vimana add lusture to the temple. Considered from every angle, the Rajarani temple attains perfaction in the Kalingan style of temple architechure.

4.1.2.14.Lingaraja Temple

Among all the temples of Odisha, the Lingaraja temple at Bhubaneswar deserves special mention. It bears architectural splendour and is regarded as one of the best archaeological monument of the east reflecting *Kalinga* type of architect; with all its perfection. It was constructed between 1025 and 1065 A.D. A gigantic structure of about 180 feet high dominating the entire landscape at Bhubaneswar. The temple stands within a spacious compound of laterite measuring 520 by 465 feet surrounded by a number of smaller temples. The presiding deity of this temple is known as *Tribhubanesvara* (Bhubaneswar) from which the city has derived its name.

The majestic Lingaraja temple has four frontal projected sections such as the *Deula, Jagamohana, Natamandira* and *Bhogamandapa.* It can be stated beyond doubt that the

Natamandira and *Bhogamandapa* are later additions. The *Vimana* and *Jagamohana* of the Lingaraja temple are wonders for the people in general and art-historians, in particular because it is a surprise that how big pieces of rocks could be lifted to such a great height when modern device was quite unknown in that remote phase of history. The *Jagamohana* of the Lingaraja temple is decorated with various sculptures. I had also balustrated windows in the north and south, which of course, are closed now. The *Natamandira* and the *Bhogamandapa* are open halls. The images of Parvati, Ganesa and Kartikeya appear in the northern, southern and western niches of the sanctuary respectively. The life-size images of the *Parsva-devatas* are made of chlorite. The three distinct Puranic episodes are found on the walls of the sanctuary and of the *Jagamohana.*

On the southern door of the *Jagmohana,* the marriage scene of Lord Siva has been depicted where Siva wears the crown of a bride groom but appears perfectly naked. The images of Bhrikuti,Brahma and Parvati are associated with the scene. On the southern facade of the sanctuary, a scene is found where Yasoda churns curd and Srikrishna, as a child, disturbs her. The image of Nanda is also associated with it. The third episode on the western side of the *Vimana* is represented with a simple form of Lord Siva's marriage. The Lingaraja temple is a *rekha deula* planned in the *Pancharatha* style without a *Pistha* (platform) having *Panchangabada.* The *Varanda* of the temple contains 10 mouldings beautifully carved. The *Janghas* are richly decorated and the lower *Jangha* is ornamented with *Khakaramundis.* The *Mastaka, Khapuri* and *Kalasha* of the temple have been arranged very nicely and *trisula* is the finial in the temple. The beauty of the *deula* and *Mukhasala* is very much artistic in nature. Thus, the Lingaraja temple is architecturally magnificent and it represents the matured kalinga-style of artistic excellence.

4.1.2.15.The Jagannath temple at Puri

Among all the temples built during the Ganga period, the Jagannath temple at Puri deserves commendation. As stated earlier, Chodagangadeva might not have started the construction of that temple. He probably, extended the work of the Jagannath temple after 1147 A.D. and failed to complete it during his life time as the Dasgoba inscription states that it was constructed in 1198 A.D. which is certainly after the death of Chodagangadeva. The construction of the temple was completed most probably by Anangabhimadeva III. Be that as it may, with the construction of the Jagannath temple, Puri became a great centre of religion and culture not only

in Odisha but also outside of it. However, many later additions to this temple were made during the rule of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis in Odisha.

The imposing structure consists of the *Vimana, Jagamohana, Natamandira* and *Bhogamandapa.* The last two structures were, perhaps, constructed during the Suryavamsi Gajapati rule. The *Vimana* of the temple stands at a lofty height of 214 ft. and 8 inches an a square of 80 ft. The heavy plaster of the temple in the exterior prevented the scholars to know about the sculptural decoration of the outer walls. However, the recent removal of plasters from the outer walls of the temple by the Archaeological survey of India brought to light the decorative motif of the temple. The figures in the *Vimana* are the proofs of the developed art of Kalinga. Among those, the figures of *Astadikpa/a,* lion standing over crouching elephants, the figure of adult Krishna, the procession of horses and elephants, various sociao-cultural scene, erotic panels etc. The *Vimana* has been constructed in a *Pancharatha* plan.

The *Jagamohana* of the temple like that *Vimana,* follows a *Pancharatha* style. The roof of this structure is amply supported by several iron beams. Its outer surface contains some erotic scence. Its height is 120 ft. The *Natamandira* of the temple is pyramidal in form. It is a square room measuring 69 ft x 67 ft. inside and the outside measurement of it is a square of 80 ft. The *Natamandira* depicts the story of the Kanchi-Kaveri expedition which most probably found place there during the glorious reign of Gajapati Purusottamadeva. Like *Natamandira,* the *Bhogamandapa* is a pyramidal structure measuring 58 ft. x 56 ft. The sculptures in this structure depict mainly stories related with Sri Krishna's life like his playing of flute when the cows listen to it with' upraised heads, Krishna's various poses, his play with the cowherd women in the boat, Dola yatra etc. The depiction of other deities of Brahmanical pantheon in the *Bhogamandapa* is quite interesting. The scene of *indrasabha,* (the court of Indra) *Rajyavisekha* (investitrue ceremoney) of Ramachandra, God Siva sitting on his bull etc, are depicted marvellously well.

The entire Jagannath temple is surrounded by an outer wall known as the *Meghanada Prachira.* Historians point out that this wall did not form a part of the Original plan of the temple. It gave the temple the form of fort having four gate-ways. The gateways of the temple definitely added grandeur to the structure. The eastern gate is popularly known as *Simhadvara.* On either side of the entrance, the figure of big crouching lion with a crown on the head is found. Two rubust figures, Jaya and Vijaya are found on the pilasters of that door. This gate is famous among the pilgrims as *Jaya Vijaya dvara.* This gate is the main entrance to the temple. This gate

contains the images of Patitapabana, Ganesha, Hanumana etc. In front of the gate is *Aruna Stambha* (the Surya pillar) which was brought from Konarka and installed there during the Maratha rule. The southern gate or Asvadvara comes next in order of importances. The gate is so named because two big horses (one black and another white) with their riders (Balabhadra and Jagannath respectively) are found on the pilaster of that door. This reminds the people regarding the legend of the Kanchi-Kaveri expedition of Purusottamadeva. The northern gate has two colossal elephants on either side. For that reason it is known as the *Hastidvara.* It comes next in importance to the *Asvadvara.* The last entrance gate to the temple of God Jagannath is known as the *Vyaghradvara.* It is due to the presence of two big tiger images there. Their presence gives a grandiose look to the gate. The religious significance of these four gates is well discerened. The *Simhadvara* represents Dharma (piety); the *Asvadvara, Jnana* (knowledge); the *Hastidvara, Aisvarya* (material prosperity) and lastly, the *Vyaghradvara* represents *Vairagya* (renounciation).

Immediately, after the entrance into the temple through *Simhadvara,* a pilgrirn has to cross *Baisipahacha* (22 steps) which, as per the Hindu belief, represent twenty-two sins of human life. When one crosses these steps, he crosses all the sins and attains *Punya* (religious merit). The main shrines in this area are the gateway of *Kurma bedha* and *Saraghara* of the *Suras.* The Small shrines in this *Baisipahachas* area are Kasivisvanatha, Ganesa, Nrusimha and Ghantamundia Thakurani. At the top of the *Baisipahacha,* a double wall divides the area into two, the outer one and the inner. One can notice the shrines of Nrusimha, Barabhai Hanumana, Gopala, Rama and Budhima in the area stretching between the *Asvadvara* and the inner inclosure. Towards the western gate four important *tirthas* (places of pilgrimage) of India viz- the Vadrinarayana, Ramanatha, Krishanatha and Jagannath are found. If one visits these four shrines, he attains *Punya.*

The outer enclosure, after the *Hastidvara* is significant with the presence of the shrines of Sitala, Uttarayani, Hanumana, Somanatha, Dhavalesvara and Patalesvara. Four epigraphs of the famous Ganga monarch Anangabhimadeva III found in the Patalesvara temple describe the rituals of the Jagannath temple.

The *Rosasala* or the kitchen of Lord Jagannath is regarded as the greatest kitchen of the world. Here, rice and vegetables are cooked simultaneously by earthern pots kept over one another. The cooked rice and curry are offered to the God as *Bhoga* which becomes *Mahaprasada* after the offering is made. Among the important shrines in the southern side the

Astadhatu (made of eight metals) image of Nilamadhava in the shape of Lord Jagannath is important. The *Kalpabata* is another notable thing inside the temple complex where the women, desirous of son, bind threads in the branches of that great banyan tree.

The *Muktimandapa* (hall of salvation) is another sixteen pillared eleved rectangular building measuring 30 ft. x 38 ft. It was constructed by Gajapati Prataprudradeva. There the Brahmin Pandits, apt in sastric law assemble and give their expert guidance to people to get rid of sins. For centuries, this *Mandapa* has allured the attention of the people of Odisha and India as well. Close to the *Muktimandapa* there is *Rohini Kunda.* It contains an image of a crow with four hands. The water of this *Kunda* is regarded as sacred by the pilgrims who sprinkle the same over their head. Among other small temples inside the Jagannath temple complex, the Vimala temple deserves commendation. From the iconographic point of view, its construction can be dated before the construction of the Jagannath temple. The sacrifice of the goat before goddess Vimala on the Dasahara festival clearly indicates the *Sakta-tantric* character of the temple. The shrines of Sakshigopala, Kanchi Ganesh, *Panchasakti* Nilamadhava and Bhadrakali. The temple of goddess Laxmi is another notable architectural splendour inside the temple complex of Lord Jagannath. The scene of elephants pouring water over the head of that goddess makes the pilgrim spell-bound for its artistic excellence. The temple of *Navagraha* including the Sun god is another shrine inside the temple complex. It indicates the *Saura* cult had gained momentum during the glorious days of the Gangas as is evident also from the Sun temple at Konarka.

The *Anandabazar* is another notable site inside the temple complex. Here, the *Mahaprasada* of the Lord is sold. At that place, male and female irrespective of caste and creed take the *prasada* together. Besides, *Anandabazara* , the *Koili Vaikuntha*, *Nilachala Upabana* (garden) and a museum (recently opened) etc. are other noticeable features of the temple of Lord Jagannath.

Thus, it is apparent that the temple of God Jagannath represents the amalgamation of the Saiva, Vaishnava, Ganapataya, Sakta and other cults thereby showing religious synthesis. It was again the best representation of the Kalinga style of art.

4.1.2.16.The Sun temple at Konarka

The Sun temple at Konarka, popularly known as ‘Black Pagoda’ was the fullest manifestation of the Kalinga style of architecture. Architecturally, it was 148pecimen in stone. This monumental temple was constructed by Narasimhadeva I or Langula Narasimhadeva in the

13th century A.D. The legend goes on that 1200 Odishan artists took 12 years for the construction of this gigantic structure. Situated at a distance of 35 kms to the north-west of Puri on the river bank of Chandrabhaga, the Sun temple has allured the attention of tourists from all over the world.

Konarka is popularly known as *Arkakshetra* connecting the worship of the Sun god. The temple consisted of the *Vimana, Jagamohana* and *Natamandira.* The *Vimana* is now lost due to the fall of stones from the top of the temple. The existing *Jagamohana* (Mukhasala), designed with a pyramidal roof, stands on a high platform. The 24 wheels, carved on the sides of that elevated platform upon which the *Deul* (sanctum) and *Jagamohana* (porch) stand, represent the 24 hours of a day. A group of 7 spirited horses sculptured on the sides of the staircase denote 7 days of a week. The wheels and horses together present the idea that the temple was designed in the form of a colossal Solar Chariot. The *Jagamohana* contained three doors each with attached steps. However, all these doors and steps have been blocked up and the interior filled up with sands. The *Vimana* and *Jagamohana* were planned in the *Pancharatha* style.

The *Natamandira* was planned as a detached building in front of the main temple. It had approachable flight of-steps on four sides. It is a lavishly carved pillared structure. All over the structure *am* depicted dance and musicai performance that consist of *Pakhoaj* (leader braces and wooden blocks for producing designed intonation), *Dholak* (barrel shaped double faced longish drum), *Sahanai* (large pipes giving sweet music), *Karatalas* (large metallic cymbals with strings), *Vina* (strined musical instrument), *Vamsi* (flute) etc. In front of the eastern flight of the *Jagamohana* stood a colossal chlorite pillar, known as *Arunastambha.* As stated earlier, it had been shifted from Konarka and installed in front of the temple of God Jagannath at Puri during the Maratha rule. The main temple, that contained the idol of Sun god, was 230 ft. high, the biggest in the “Whole India. However, it is ruined. The compound of the temple is 877 ft. x 540 ft. It is really a wonder, how such big stone slabs were carried on to the top for the construction of this temple. It is suggested by the archaeologists that after 149pecime the structure from the ground by sands, the big stones were placed over it.

The Sun temple of Konarka is remarkable for its variety of sculptures. Among them are the deities, musician-nymphs of the celestial sphere, secular sculptures, erotic figures, birds, beasts, acquatic animals, mythological figures, 149pecimen149149g149l motifs reflected in figures, decorative bodies etc. Among the deities the most remarkable are the chlorite images of

Surya in the three projected southern, western and northern niches of the *Deul* 150pecimen150150g the rising sun, mid-day sun and setting sun respectively. The artists very rightly matched their talent with creation by depicting the rising sun with a smiling face, the mid-day sun with grave look and the setting sun with faded look.

The *Navagraha* sculpture of the temple is another 150pecimen150 piece of architectural creation. From the left to right the planets have been installed in this order as such the Ravi (Sun), Chandra (Moon). Mangala (Mars), Budha (Mercury), Brihaspati (Jupiter), Sukra (Venus), Sani (Saturn), Rahu (the ascending node) and Ketu (the descending node). Now the Navagraha slab is kept inside separate temple. The worship of Siva (in the form of Linga), Purusottama (God Jagannath) and Mahisamardhini (Durga) is gleaned from the sculptural remains of the Sun temple of Konarka. Four such sculptures have been preserved in four different places viz. one at Sun temple of Konarka, one in Konarka museum, one at the National Museum (New Delhi and the last in the *Bhogamandapa* of the Jagannath temple at Puri. A noteworthy feature of the Sun temple of Konarka is the three outstanding animal figures which guarded the three starcases of the *Jagamohana*. Among these figures Gajasimhas (lion on elephant) find place in the east, elephants on the north and warhorses, on the south. These animal figures express the artistic skills of the Oriya sculptors.

The Sun temple at Konarka is a 150pecimen of sculptures. Several sculptures like the decorated doors, royal chambers, the procession of king to receive the warriors, musicians playing on various musical instruments, meditation of saints, figures of elephants, horses, camels, snakes, divine and semidivine figures etc. bear ample testimony of the creative mind of the Oriya artists of that period. Very interesting is the depiction of a ziraffe eating grapes on the temple wall of Konarka. It was an African animal. It is not known how the Oriya artists came in contact with this animal. Be that as it may, it was definitely a noteworthy feature of the temple art at Konarka.

A notable feature of the architecture of the Sun temple of Konarka is the presence of erotic figures in the walls. Like the Khajuraho temple, the obscence sculptures of Konarka, depict the sensual pleasures of human life. It is a clear indication that human life is equal to the life of beasts. The aim of such depiction was perhaps that a pilgrim who visits the temple should not be swayed by the mundane life but should control hissenses to get victory over it. A. K. Coomarswamy, a notable art historian remarked regarding these sculptures as such: “Love and

desire are part of life. Life is a veil behind or within which is God. The outside of the temple is an image of this life, *Samsara,* and the carvings on it present everything that belongs to *Samsara* and perpetuate illusion, every bond and each desire of loveliness that binds men to the wheel of life and death."

N. N. Bhattacharya comments on the erotic sculptures of the Sun temple of Konarka stating that it was the reflection of the abnormal sexual desires of the dominant class of the man whose magnificence was responsible for the construction of this temple. However, its importance has been rightly painted out by Robert Ebersole as such : "Even if one elects to dismiss the intrinsically superb sculptural qualities of the erotic figures, there still remains a tremendous number of morally acceptable example which attest to the fact that the temple of the Sun represents the culmination of medieval Hindu art and the supreme achievement of temple sculpture."

Really, the Sun temple at Konarka is the finest 151pecimen of the creative genius of the Oriya artists. The Kalinga style of art reached the pinnacle of perfection with the erection of the Sun temple at Konarka. From the point of elegance, balance and beauty this temple, the only temple in Eastern India which got distinction to be one of the seven wonders of the world.

Besides these two great temples of national and international importance, the Ganga period also witnessed massive temple building activities. The temple of Ramesvara, the temple of Gangesvara at Bhubaneswar were built by Chodagangadeva. The temple of Chintamanisvara near Laxmisagara in Bhubaneswar was built by Lakshmi Devi, the wife of Chodagangadeva. The Anantavasudeva temple, located on the eastern bank of Vindusarovara was another important temple of that period which was built by Chandrikadevi, the daughter of Anangabhimadeva III. Another important temple of the Ganga period was Meghesvara temple of Bhubaneswar, constructed by Svapnesvaradeva, the brother-in-law of Rajaraja II and the Commander-in-chief of the Ganga army. Further, the Yamesvara temple, Mitresvara temple, Varunesvara temple, Bhaskaresvara temple, Chitresvara temple, Parvati temple (in the complex of the Lingaraj temple) all in Bhubaneswar belonged to this period. Among other temples, the Sobhanesvara Siva temple at Niali, the Dakshaprajapati Siva temple at Banapur, the Kshirachora Gopinath temple at Remuna in the Balasore district, the temple of Mukhalingam, Simhachalam, Narayanapuram, Tekkali etc. were also constructed during the glorious days of the Gangas.

4.1.3.Conclusion

Thus, the temple building activities that started during the 6th century AD reached its climax during the Ganga Period started declining during the Gajapati. The most important factors for the declines of temple building activities are, lack of royal patronage and decline of Hindu power. Whatever it may be till recent Orissa has possessed the rich Temple heritage, which are the imprints of our ancestor, still existing with the ravage of time. These are the pride of Orissan people in particular and that of Indian in general. These are most compact and Homogenous architectural group in India.

4.1.4.Summary

- The history of Odishan art and architecture starts with her dated history i.e. from 261 B.C., when Asoka conquered this land, then known as Kalinga.
- In fact, the temples constitute the most dominant and significant form of architecture in Odisha.
- Out of the three styles of temple architecture found in India like Nagara, Dravida and Vesara, Odisha has followed the Nagara with a distinctive regional bias of its own known as 'Kalinga'.
- An inscription in Amritesvara temple at Holal (Karnataka) dated 1235 A.D. mentions the names of all the four categories like Nagara, Dravida,Vesara and Kalinga.
- In due course of time, several canonical texts were written for the construction of temples.
- Among such texts Bhuvana Pradipa, Bhuvanapravesa, Silpasastra, Silpasarini, Silpaprakasa, Silparatna Kosa and Silpi pothi etc are prominent.
- These texts helped in maintaining basic standards in the construction notwithstanding varieties of form and size.
- The history of temple building in Odisha is said to have begun with Laxamanesvara,Bharatesvara and Satrughnesvara group of temples at Bhubaneswar in 6th century A.D. and culminated with the Sun temple of Konarka in 13th century AD.
- The Parsurameswara temple assigned to 7th century AD. is the best preserved specimen among the early group of temples. It consists of both Deula and Jagamohana.
- The next stage of growth of temple architecture is noticed in the temples built between the 8th and the 10th centuries.

- Temples of the 9th-lOth century temples evolved with more advanced architectural features like the harmonious proportion of pagas on the Bada and the Gandi.
- The pyramidal form of the Jagamohana emerged in the period.
- The Rajarani temple (l1th century AD.) represents a unique experiment in temple architecture. Its Sikhara has been clustered by miniature repetition of the Sikhara (called anga-Sikhara) around the Gandi in the Khajuraho Style.
- The Lingaraja is the loftiest, grandest and most majestic temple of 11th century AD. It marks the culmination of temple architecture.
- It is the perfect specimen, a landmark, among rekha temples of the entire country with fully developed Vimana, Jagamohana, Natamandira and Bhogamandapa.
- The temple architecture has attained its most advanced form in the 13th century AD. with the construction of the Sun temple at Konark.
- It is rightly observed "Its advancement is marked by the blending of sculpture with architectural magnificance, chariotcar conception, completely detached natamandira and provision of a high basement for the sanctum and Jagamohana.
- The temple is conceived as the mythical chariot of the Sun god with twenty-four wheels and seven richly caparisoned horses. Each of the wheels is a master piece of Indian art. The conception, in deed, makes it 'a charming monument unique in the realm of art.
- Thus, the temple building activities that started during the 6th century AD reached its climax during the Ganga Period started declining during the Gajapati.
- The most important factors for the declines of temple building activities are, lack of royal patronage and decline of Hindu power. Whatever it may be till recent Orissa has possessed the rich Temple heritage, which are the imprints of our ancestor, still existing with the ravage of time.

4.1.5.Exercise

- Write a note on the growth of temple architecture in Odisha.
- High light the components of temple architecture in Odisha.
- Give an account on the growth of kalinga style of temple architecture.
- Discuss the architectural components of temple architecture.

4.1.6.Further Reading

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Unit-4

Chapter-II

Society and Economy during the Bhaumakara, Somavamsis and the Ganga period

Structure

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4.2.4. Conclusion
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4.2.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students explore the society and economy during the Bhaumakara, the Somavamsis and the Ganga period. After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- *trace the society and economy of Odisha during the Bhaumakaras*
- *identify the social and economic position of Odisha during the Somavamsi rulers*
- *understand the sociao-economic situation of Odisha during the Ganga kings*
- *know the social and economic life of the people of Odisha from the Bhaumakara rulers to the Ganga rulers.*

4.2.1. Introduction

Change and continuity has been the way of social life in ancient and medieval Odisha along with the rise and fall of empires in Odisha. The glorious rule of the Bhauma-Karas, the Somavamsis, and the Gangas, contributed a lot to preserve the social and economic structure of this land. With the gradual march of time, besides the four traditional castes, many sub-castes emerged in the Odishan society. The *agrahara* villages granted to Brahmins by different kings of various dynasties, gave vent to the progress of education. The villages of Odisha became the centres around which evolved the social life of its people. Their dress, profession, hobby, learning etc. form the main theme of the social and economic life in Odisha

4.2.2. Society and economy during the Bhaumakara

The inscriptions of the Bhaumakaras gives us the knowledge regarding the society and economy during the Bhaumakara period.

4.2.2.1. Society during the Bhaumakara

Society underwent changes during ancient and medieval Odisha. Although the Bhauma rulers were Buddhists, they accepted the Brahmanical socio-religious order. They tried to enforce the *Varnashrama*, i.e., division of society into four *Varnas* (Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra). The Neulpur charter of Subhakaradeva I states that Kshemankardeva put Varnas in their proper places. The Terundia charter of Subhakaradeva II states that he established the *Varnashrama* system in accordance with the scriptures. As the Bhauma rulers accepted the *Varnashrama* urder, they attached great importance to the *Brahmanas*, the highest *Varna*. They

encouraged immigration of Brahmans from Madhyadesa (north India) and Bengal by the offer of land grants.

4.2.2.2. The Social Structure : Caste system

Let us know the social structure of caste system during the Bhaumakara period. One of the notable feature of ancient Indian society was the caste system. The Odishan society was not an exception to it. It consisted of numerous castes and sub-castes and the interaction among them brought social harmony bringing peace and tranquility in the Odishan society. The caste structure of the society of the Bhaumakara period is given bellow:

4.2.2.2.1. The Brahmins

In the *Varna* system, the Brahmins enjoyed the highest position in the society of and belonged to the first order. They commanded respect from the people in the society by their learning, prudence, pious character and other virtuous qualities. It is known from many inscriptions of the Bhauma-Karas that Brahmins belonging to several *gotras* like Bharadwaja, Kausika, Visvamitra, Sandilya, Kashyapa, Atreya, etc. settled in Odisha. They settled in the *Shasanas (agrahara* villages) as is known from numerous inscriptions belonging to the Ganga and Suryavamsi Gajapati period. They received land grants from the kings and other landed aristocrats to worship gods and goddesses in different temples. Those lands were tax free lands. Further, they were also indispensable for many important ceremonies like the *Abhiseka* (coronation ceremony) of the king, marriage, *upanayana* (sacred thread ceremony) etc. By their noble works as priests, they commanded respect of the society and were placed in the highest position in the caste structure. Besides discharging their duties as priests, the Brahmins also got lucrative posts in the courts of the kings and Zamindars.

4.2.2.2.2. The Kshatriyas

The Kshatriyas occupied their position in the society next to the Brahmins. They were warrior class and shouldered the responsibility to protect the country from internal rebellion and external aggression. Besides fighting they administered the country. As the inscriptions and literary sources of this land refer, they were benevolent rulers not despots or autocrats. They had great veneration towards the Brahmins from whom they sought advice to carry on administration. They were great builders. By receiving their patronage, a good number of temples were built up in Odisha. They were famous for their charity. The digging of tanks,

establishment of *Shasanas*, educational institutions etc. were also their look out. They also took interest in the promotion of learning inside the society. Besides the kings and members of the royal family, the army chiefs, soldiers and other officials belonged to the Kshatriya *caste.* The Kshatriyas looked for the welfare of the subjects of the society

4.2.2.2.3. The Vaisyas

The Vaisyas belonged to trading class who resorted to cultivation, cowherdship, trade and commerce. Generally, prosperity of the land depended largely upon the people of this community. They organised *hatas* (local markets) and controlled both inland and maritime trade. From the time of Asoka, it is evident that trade routes on land passed to distant South via Kalinga and it monopolised the trade and commerce and her economic prosperity had become an eyesore to Kalinga. This was possible due to the trading class (Vaisyas) in the ancient and medieval Odisha. Further, the Vaisyas of Odisha carried on oversea trade with the countries like Ceylon, Siam, Burma, Suvarnadvipa etc. and brought wealth to this land. They also helped in spreading the Odishan culture in South-East Asia. The Kshatriyas also paid attention for the growth of the Vaisyas. The kings granted special villages for them known as the' *Vaisya agrahara.*

4.2.2.2.4. The Sudras

In the traditional class structure, the Sudras occupied the lowest position. The Sudras were drawn from the community that consisted of artisans, craftsmen, petty agriculturists, servants etc. Even, they were attached to the temples to serve the gods and goddesses. Besides the above mentioned professions, some Sudras were untouchables. They were untouchables and remained outside the society. However, they served the society in various capacities. Among them were the washerman *(rajaka),* fisherman , *(kaivartta),* shoe-maker *(charmakara),* basket-maker *(doma)* etc. Besides Sudras, other sub-castes in the society were *saundikas* (brewers), *tantuvayas* (weavers), *kumbhakaras* (potters), *malakaras* (gardeners), *napita* (barber), *tambarakara* (coppersmith), *tathakara* (metal worker), *kamara* (blacksmith) etc. who rendered their habitual service to the society.

4.2.2.3. Promotion of Language and learning

Sanskrit language was used in the inscriptions and literature of the Bhaumakara period. The Buddhist manuscript, *Gandavyuha* was written in Sanskrit. The Bhauma rulers were learned and cultured who extended their patronage to the institutions of learning. The monastery of Ratnagiri was one of the greatest centres of Buddhist learning in medieval lndia, and attracted

scholars from different countries. According to the Tibettan tradition, recorded in *Pag* Sam *Jon Zang*, Bodhisri and Noropa practised *Yoga* at Ratnagiri. Taranath mentions that Acharya Pito who had acquired the *Siddhi* of invisibility was teaching *Yoga* at Ratnagiri and that Abadhuti, Bodhisri and Naro (Naropa ?) were his disciples.

4.2.2.4. Position of women

Women enjoyed high position in the society during the Bhaumakara period. Although, they were dependant on their parents and husbands, still they commanded respect in the society. A striking feature of the Bhauma rule was that it provided a number of female rulers. In ancient India, if a king died without a male issue, the chief queen adopted a boy as the son to ascend the throne, or if the king died leaving a minor son, the dowager queen acted as the regent, but during the Bhauma rule women ruled independently in their own rights. Tribhuvana Mahadevi-I ruled as a full-fledged sovereign after the death of her son. Tribhuvana Mahadevi-II ruled over the kingdom after the death of her husband, even though her husband's brother had sons, who had legitimate claims over the throne. There were six female rulers in the Bhauma period. Five of them were dowagers and one was a king's daughter. Women of high birth and noble families received education. They also received educations in music and dance. The Bhauma queens were great devotee, to various religious faiths and were instrumental for building temples and creating provisions for the worship of the God or Goddess. The literature of the time reflects that monogamy was the prevailing norm of the society. However, polygamy was not unknown in royal and higher families. The systems of *Sati* and *Pardah* were not prevalent. In general, women enjoyed high position in the society.

4.2.2.5. Dress and ornaments

The women of Bhauma period were fond of various hair styles, cosmetics, perfumes and ornaments. The sculptures of the period exhibit various types of organments, such as *Kundala* (ear ring), *Karnaphula* (ear flower), *Ratnahara* or *Chandrahara* (necklace), *Mekhala* (girdle), *Koyura* (armlet). *Manjira* (foot ornament) and *Kankana* (bracelet). The queens preferred necklaces and foot ornaments. Their ornaments were made of gold and silver and studded with pearls and diamonds.

4.2.2.6. Religious Life during the Bhaumakaras

In the pre-Bhauma period both Hinayana and Mahayana schools of Buddhism were prevalent in Odisha. Hinayana monks of Odisha had the audacity to assert the superiority of their

doctrine before the king Harsha who was a great patron of Mahayana Buddhism. The early phase of Bhauma rule saw the phenomenal development of Mahayana and Vajrayana or *Tantrik* Bupdhism in Odisha. The three early Bhaumakara rulers - Kshemankaradeva, Sivakaradeva I and Subhakaradeva I respectively bore the following Buddhist epithets - *Paramopasaka* (devout worshipper of Buddha), *Parama-tathagata* (devout worshipper of Tathagata or Buddha) and *Paramasaugata* (devout worshipper of Saugata or Buddha). At the behest of Sivakaradeva I, a Buddhist monk, named Prajna, went from Odisha to China to translate the Buddhist manuscript named *Gandavyuha.* A number of *Viharas* or Buddhist monasteries which had come into existence in the pre-Bhauma period continued to flourish in the Bhauma period. Puspagiri, Ratnagiri, Lalitagiri, Udayagiri, Khadipada, Kupari, Chaurasi and Jayarampur were the great Buddhist centres of the Bhauma period. A number of the Mahayana and *Tantrik* Buddhist images of this period have been found in most of the places, mentioned above. The Bhauma rulers followed a policy of magnanimity and toleration towards all religious sects. It appears that the later Bhauma kings inclined towards the non-Buddhist sects like Saivism, Vaishnavism, Tantricism and Shakti cult. Madhava Devi, the wife of Subhakaradeva I built a Siva temple, Subhakaradeva III donated a village for the maintenance of the Siva temple of Pulindesvar. Subhakaradeva IV, Sivakaradeva III and Dandi Mahadevi were great devotees of Siva. The Siva temples of Sisiresvara, Markandesvara and Talesvara in Bhubaneswar belong to the Bhauma era. Tribhuvana Mahadevi I, Subhakaradeva IV, Prithvi Mahadevi, and Santikaradeva II appear to be devotees of Vishnu. The Nandodbhavas, who were feudatory to the Bhaumas patronized Vaishnavism. The Bhauma period also saw the growth of the Sakti cult in Odisha. The Vaital and Mohini temples of Bhubaneswar, enshrining Chamunda, were built during this period. The various temples and images of the Bhauma period testify to the architectural and sculptural excellence as well as religious synthesis and eclecticism.

4.2.2.7. Economy during the Bhaumakaras

The Bhauma rulers collected moderate tax from their subjects. They helped the growth of feudalism by giving land grants to their officers on hereditary basis instead of paying salaries. Land grants were also given to the religious institutions like monasteries and temples and Brahmins. In the donated villages the peasants paid tax to the donees instead of the king. Next to agriculture, the most important industry of the Bhauma period was the manufacture of cloth. There were other industries such as stone work, metal work, carpentry, poetry, ivory work,

perfumery, jewellery and oil industry. The surviving temples and images are eloquent testimonies of artistic activities of the Bhauma period. The copper plates and bronze images of the period speak of the metallurgical advancement. It appears that during the Bhauma period Odisha had commercial relation with Ceylon, China and South East Asia. Tamralipti, Che-li-ta-lo and Palur were the ports, situated in the Bhauma territory.

4.2.3. Society and economy during the Somavamsis and the Ganga period

The society and economy during the Somavamsis and the Ganga period underwent many changes which enriched the rulers of the land. An established social structure and sound economic condition helped the rulers of the Somavamsi and Ganga period to construct beautiful temples in Odisha and to look after the welfare of the subjects.

4.2.3.1. Society during the Somavamsis and the Ganga period

The Somavamsis had adopted the *Varnashrama dharma* i.e., traditional division of the society into four *Varnas (Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya* and *Sudra),* and gave the highest status to the Brahmanas. By performing *Vedic* sacrifices and facilitating the migration of Brahrnanas from northern India through generous offer of land grants the Somavamsi rulers promoted the Brahminisation of the socio-reliqious life of Odisha as well as the assimilation of the north Indian Sanskritic culture into the Odishan culture.

On the other hand the traditional *Varna* system prevailed during the Ganga period. As before, the Brahmanas enjoyed the highest status and maximum privileges in the society during this period. Many of them enjoyed land grants *(Agraharas)* as scholars and priests. Besides discharging their duties as priests, the Brahmins also got lucrative posts in the court of the king. The Ganga inscriptions show that the Brahmins like Vanapati, Govinda and Vishnu worked under the Ganga kings Raja Rajadeva I, Anangabhimadeva II and Anangabhimadeva III respectively as ministers having high reputation. The inscriptions at Srikurmam and Simhachalam refer to Narahari Tirtha who acted as a regent when Bhanudeva I, was a minor. The Ganga inscriptions states that some Brahmins served as military officers using titles like Vahinipati, Chamupati and Senapati. Further, the Brahmins were also appointed in the posts of *Sandhivigrahi (Ka), Sasanadhikarin,* record- keeper etc. The Brahmins during that period were also engaged in several other professions besides the above mentioned works. The inscriptional

and literary sources of the period reveal that they resorted the agriculture, trade, temple building activity and so on. The Brahmins performing higher works like the priests, *guru, Mahasandhivigrahika* etc. were known as the *Shasani* Brahmins. The Brahmins who resorted to lower professions like agriculture, trades etc. were known as *Halua* or *Jharua* Brahmins. Whatever the fact might be, learning and imparting education were the main .functions of the Brahmins in the society. They were well-versed in the *Vedas* and other *Sastras.* They grew under the patronage of kings and maintained their educational institutions. The court of the Ganga monarchs and Suryavamsi kings basked with the learned Brahmins. They contributed a lot of *Smriti, Vyakarana,* poetry, drama and other branches of knowledge. Due to their high education-they were revered by the people in the Odishan society. During this period it is found that a number of Brahmanas also entered into non-religious professions like military service, other categories of government service, and trade. The army men could be recruited from all the four *varnas - Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya* and *Shudra.*

The Kshatriyas occupied their position in the society next to the Brahmins. Besides the kings and members of the royal family, the army chiefs, soldiers and other officials belonged to the Kshatriya caste. The *Khandayats* or Paiks were Kshatriyas who resorted, to cultivation at the time of peace and jumped into the prey when the war drums were heard. The ruling families cemented matrimonial alliances with other kings and feudatory chiefs to secure their position. Whenever there was any external aggression they joined hands to oust the army. The help of Paramadrideva, during the reign period of Narasimhdeva I against the Muslim rulers of Bengal, is well known. The Kshatriyas were thus, instrumental in maintaining peace and stability of the-land and looked after the welfare of their subjects. The records of the Ganga period mention the Kayasthas as an important caste.

4.2.3.2. The Kayasthas or Karanas

The Kayasthas or the Karanas were a hereditary class of writers. Their *Varna* status is not clear from the available records. Some sources say that they were Kshatriyas. Others hold that they were Shudras. Whatever might be their *Varna* status, they occupied "all cadres of posts in government, from that of a village-headman and accountant to that of a prime minister and army general". The Kayasthas occupied a dominant position in the medieval Odisha. Though, the formation of this sub-caste cannot be traced back to an exact year, still in the 10th-11th century A.D. references to them were made in the inscriptions. The Kshatriya and Vaisya descent of the

Kayastha or Karana is known from inscription. They became hereditary class of writers and became indispensable for maintaining royal records owing to their superior knowledge in accountancy and day to day administration. Not only they were the keeper of the records, but they also occupied high position in revenue department, army and other departments. From the Ganga period onwards, their high position never dwindied away. The present day titles like Pattnayak, Dandapata, Mohanty, Kanungo etc. are remembrances of the past where the Karanas, like today, were regarded as an important class inside the society of Odisha.

The Vaisyas belonged to trading class who were next to the Kshatriyas in the caste hierarchy. The Kshatriyas also paid attention for the growth of the Vaisyas. The kings granted special villages for them known as the' *Vaisya agrahara'*. The Chicacole plates of the Ganga king Madhukamarnava refers to the grant of land to a Vaisya named Erapa Nayaka. This clearly indicates that the Vaisyas went hand in hand with the Kshatriyas for maintaining stability in the society. The term 'Nayaka' is an indicator to the fact that the Vaisyas also entered into the military service of the king and thus, had a close collaboration with the Kshatriyas to maintain political stability of the land. Their sound economic condition led them to donate villages to the Brahmins and the temples.

The Sudras occupied the lowest position in the society. The Sudras were drawn from the community which consisted of artisans, craftsmen, petty agriculturists, servants etc. They also changed their professions and absorbed within the fold of Kshatriyas and Vaisyas. Even, they were attached to the temples for the service of the gods and goddesses. In due course of time, the Sudras gave up their duties and from among them emerged many *Siddhacharyas* and tantric *gurus* who belonged to basket maker, fisherman and leather worker communities.

4.2.3.3. Religious life

The Somavamsi rulers were ardent Saivites. They helped the growth and spread of Saivism by the construction of Siva temples and offer land grants to the Saiva temples, priests and ascetics. Consequently, a number of Saiva gurus, such as Sadasivacharya, rathamacharya and Acharya Gagana Siva came to Orissa from far and wide and enjoyed the patronage of the Somavamsi rulers. With the help of Janmejaya I Gagana Siva built the Someswar temple at Ranipur-Jharial. Yayati-I built the beautiful Saiva temple of Mukteswar. The construction of the gigantic Saiva temple of Lingaraj was started by Yayati-ll and completed by Udyota keshari.

Though ardent Saivites themselves, the Somavamsis continued the Bhaumakara tradition of religious toleration. They tolerated other sects such as Jainism, Vaishnavism and Saktism.The king Udyota Keshari carved Navamuni and Varabhuja caves for the Jaina ascetics.

The early Ganga rulers including Chodagangadeva were devout Saivites. But after acquiring Orissa the Gangas professed allegiance to Vaishnavism. They showed great devotion to Purushottam-Jagannath who was regarded as a manifestation of Vishnu. Chodagangadeva built the present gigantic temple of Lord Jagannath. Anangabhimadeva-III went to the extent of saying that he ruled the empire as the *Routa* or deputy of Lord Jaqannath. Puri with Lord Jagannath as the presiding deity became a great centre of Vaishnavism during the Ganga period. The great *Bhakti* saints like Ramanuja, Narahari Tirtha and Jagannath Tirtha came to Orissa from outside during this period. The recital of *Gita Govinda* of Jayadeva (the Vaishnava poet of this period) was introduced into the daily rituals of the Jagannath temple. While professing allegiance to Lord Jagannath, the state deity, the Gangas patronized the worship of other deities - Siva, Parvati and Sun-God. Chodagangadeva donated a village for the maintenance of a perpetual lamp in the Lingaraj temple of Bhubaneswar. Parvati temple was built inside the precinct of the Lingaraj temple during the Ganga rule. Narasihmhadeva-I built the temple for Sun-God at Konark. The Ganga rulers seem to have attempted a harmony between Saivism and Vaishnavism. The transformation of Siva of the Lingaraj temple into the conjoint deity, Harihar (Vishnu as well as Siva), and the construction of the Vishnu temple of Ananta Vasudeva by . a Ganga princess in the midst of the Siva temples indicate attempts at such a synthesis.

4.2.3.4. Dress and ornament

The sculptures and literature of the period give clues to form an idea about the dress and ornaments of the people. The male persons used *dhoti* as lower garment and *Chaddar* as upper garment. Female dress consisted of two garments, upper and lower. They seemed to have wore sarees. The folds of sarees, sometimes, were gathered, carried on to back between the legs and tucked. The garments of the higher class people were ornamented with embroidery showing their status. The *Devadasis* (dancing girls) also used ornamented dress and richly decorated caps. The females took particular care in dressing their hairs. The sculptures of Konarka temple indicate that comb and mirror were used for that purpose. Perfumes were also used by ladies as inscriptions of the time refer to perfumers. The sculptures of the period show that both male and female used ornaments like *Kundala* (ear-ring), *Keyura* (armlet) and *hara* (neck-lace). Besides,

the women used ornaments like *mekhala* (girdle), *Karnafula* (ear-flower), *Kankana* (bracelet), *manjira* (foot ornament). *nupura* (anklet), *Katisutra* or *Katibandha* (waistlet) etc. The female prepared beautiful hair locks and decorated them with flowers.

4.2.3.5. Food and drink

The inscriptions and literature of the period throw light on the food and drink of the society. The Ganga inscriptions narrate how rice, ghee, curd, milk, pulse, curries and *payasa* (rice cooked with milk) etc. were offered as bhoga (offerings) to the deities in the temples. These descriptions give an idea regarding the vegetarian food pattern in the society. Non-vegetarian meals were also in vogue in the society. Drinking of wine was not unknown to the people.

4.2.3.6. Entertainment

Among entertainments, hunting and *pa* (chess) formed the pass time resorts of the royal families. The common people might has resorted to certain games, learning, archery and fighting, music, writing etc. as gleaned from the description of literature.

4.2.3.7. Promotion of Learning and literature

There was a phenomenal development in the field of Sanskrit learning and literature during the Somavamsi period. The inscriptions of the period speak of the proficiency of the scholars in *Vedas, Vedanga, Smtitis, Puranas,* medical sciences, Astrology, *Arthasastra,* Grammar, Poetry, History, Political Science and Logic. The land grants to the learned Brahmanas facilitated the study of Sanskritic literature. A number of Sanskrit scholars such as Sadharana, Purushottam Bhatta, Bhavadeva, Acharya Subhachandradeva and Narayana Satakarni flourished during the Somavamsi period. Sadharana, the chief minister of .Ianrnejava.] was well-versed in *Veda, Vedanga, Vidya, Siksa, Kalpa, Itihas, . Smrifi* and *Arthasastra.* Purushottam Bhatta wrote a eulogy on king Udyota Keshari. Some of the -Somavamsi kings themselves were scholars. The Somavamsi inscriptions use some typical Oriya words such as *Khamba, Punya* and *Machha.* This period was undoubtedly a Significant phase in the formation of Oriya language.

Being learned and cultured themselves, the Ganga monarchs also extended their patronage to the promotion of learning. They offered land grants to the learned Brahmins, temples and *maths* (monasteries). The temples and *maths* were centers of religious culture as well as learning. The copper plate grants and stone inscriptions show the high water mark of Sanskrit literature in Orissa during the Ganga era. During this era there were a number of

intellectual luminaries in Orissa. Pandit Vidyadhar (the composer of *Ekavalr),* Jayadeva (the author of *Gita Govinda),* Shridhar Acharya and Nilambar Acharya (the *Smriti* writers), Viswanath Kaviraj (the author of *Sahitya Darpan),* and Satyananda (the astronomer who wrote *Surya Siddhanta)* belong to this period.

4.2.3.8. Evolution of Oriya Language

Some stone and copper plate inscriptions of the Ganga period clearly indicate that Oriya language and script took a definite shape during this period. Consequently during the reign of Kapilendra, the immediate successor of the Gangas, Sarala Das could write his Magnus opus, *Mahabharat* in the language of the masses.

4.2.3.9. Music and Dance

The Ganga monarchs extended patronage to the development of music and dance. The *Natamandapas* (Dancing Halls) of the temples were the places where the *Devadasis* (the maidens dedicated to the temples) were performing dances to the tune of compositions and musical instruments. The temple of Jagannath at Puri and the Sun Temple of Konark (which were built by the Gangas) have *Natamandapas.* Anangabhimadeva-III added *Natamandapa* to the temple of Lingaraj in Bhubaneswar. The Ganga kings employed damsels in the temples for singing and dancing. Tradition avers that Padmavati, the wife of poet Jayadeva was a *Devadasi,* dedicated to Lord Jagannath. She used to dance to the tune of the songs, composed by her husband. The Ganga temples, particularly the *Natamandapas* are full of the panels of singing and dancing girls in ecstatic postures with musical instruments.

4.2.3.10. Position of women

Women enjoyed high position in the society. Women enjoyed respectable status in the Somavamsi society. Some of the Somavamsi queens performed important works like the construction of temples. The Queen Kolavatidevi, the mother of Udyota Keshari constructed the Brahmeswar temple at Bhubaneswar. Nevertheless, the status of women appears to have degenerated during this period. The *Devadasi* practice (the practice of dedicating maidens to the temples) and prostitution were prevalent during this period. The last Somavamsi king, Karnadeva married a 'gancing girl, named Karpurasri who was born of a *Mahari* or *Devadasi.* Women of high birth and noble families received education. They also received educations in music and dance.

Women were held in respect in the society during the Ganga period. In many of the donative records the donors mention the names of their mothers. Royal ladies were noted for their pious disposition and devotion to husbands. It appears that the royal ladies had access to education and specialised forms of art like music and dance. Chandrikadevi, the daughter of Anangabhimadeva- III was accomplished in music and dance. She built the temple of Ananta Vasudeva in Bhubaneswar. Sivarani, a lady of Ganga lineage was called the *Kaliyuga Saraswati* (Goddess of Learning in Kali Age). Women's status seems to have been somewhat reduced during this period. The *Smritis* and *Nitisastras* of the time restrict their freedom. Women were expected to be devoted to their husbands. But the Ganga kings themselves were polygamous. The *Smritis* also permitted the rulers to have several wives. In practice it appears that women enjoyed a good deal of freedom. They sang and danced as *Oevadasis* in the temples. The profuse depiction of women as singers and dancers, erotic partners and seductive *Nayikas* also indicate their freedom.

Chandrikadevi, a daughter of Anangabhimadeva III, excelled in the field of song, music. The pious character of the women of that period is well-known. The the Somavamsi and Ganga queens were great devotee, to various religious faiths and were instrumental for building of many temples and creating provisions for the worship of the God or Goddess. The literature of the time reflects that monogamy was the prevailing norm of the society. However, polygamy was not unknown in royal and higher families. The systems of *Sati* and *Pardah* were not prevalent. The concubinage system was practiced in the society. A reference can be made in this matter to Gajapati Purusottamadeva who was the son of a concubine of Gajapati Kapilendradeva. Inspite of the high position enjoyed by the women in the society, the practice of *Oevadasi* was a veritable stain in this regard. In different Buddhist Viharas and in the Jagannath temple at Puri, this ugly practice was prevalent which undermined the position of women in society. In general, women enjoyed high position in the society.

4.2.3.11. Economy during the Somavamsis and the Ganga period

The economy of the Somavamsi and the Ganga rulers was based upon various types of revenue collected from land, agriculture, industry, products, trade and commerce etc.

4.2.3.12. Land revenue

Land revenue was the major source of income for the Somavamsi and Ganga government. One-sixth of the production of the land was collected as the land revenue.

According to the land settlement, undertaken by Anangabhimadeva-III there were 9,49,60,000 acres of cultivable land in Orissa during his rule. Out of this amount of the total cultivable land 4,63,00,000 acres of land were tax-free lands, donated to the temples, Brahmanas, royal servants and others. The Ganga rulers donated lands, with all proprietary rights. Taxes were collected by the Ganga monarchs from 4,86,00,000 acres of undonated lands. Agriculture formed the main source of revenue of the kingdom. Besides land revenue other sources of income for the state were duties on exports, imports and forest products and fines, court fees, salt tax etc.

The king was deriving a large chunk or revenue from the land. He also imposed professional taxes or *tantuvayas* (weavers), *gokutas* (cowherds), *Saundikas* (brewers), *Kumbhakaras* (potters *Suvamakaras* (goldsmiths) etc. The king also derived his income by imposing taxes or *ghatta* (landing places for boatmen), *nadittarasthana* (ferry places), *sakheta* (hamlets *gutmaka* (forests) etc. The income, thus derived, was spent in the royal expenditure, satary to officers, worship of deities, reward to scholars, welfare activities for the subjects etc Villages were the centres of agrarian structure in ancient and medieval Odisha Land was divided into various categories. Among those were *krishta* (cultivable), *vas* (land for residential house), *arama* (land for groves), *udyana* (land for garden), *gochara* (pasture land) etc. There was clear cut demarcation of cultivable lands through boundaries The inscriptions of the early Eastern Gangas refer to Khandakshetra denoting to revenue-paying village, though previously it was a rent free *Ian* donated to Brahmins or deities. Sometimes, *hasta* (cubit) formed a unit of land rneasurerner: and the hand of a particular man (mainly royal officer) was used for that purpose. The inscriptions of the Gangas of Svetaka refer to a unit called *nata* which was made of a piece of bamboo or wood. The inscriptions of the early Eastern Gangas of Kalinganagara refer to a unit called *hala* (plough). The inscriptions of the period refer to rice, mango, banana jack-fruit, melon, black-berry, tamarind, betel etc. Besides, other agricultural products might have included wheat, oil-seeds, sugarcane, pulses and vegetables.

4.2.3.13. Indudstry

Along with agriculture, several industries also grew during the Somavamsi and Ganga period. Besides agricultures, industries also helped a lot for the enhancement of economy.

4.2.3.14. Textile industry

Cloth manufacturing was carried on the great success in the nook and corner of Odisha. Kautilya, in his *Arthasastra*, refers to Kalinga for manufacturing the finest variety of cotton

cloth. The *Manasollasa* describes about different varieties of clothes for the royal use and mentions the name of Kalinga as one of the the producers of such fine clothes. The sculptures of the time depict the high designs of clothes.

4.2.3.15. Jewellery industry

The sculptures and literature of the period furnish an idea regarding the use of several ornaments. From the depiction and description, an idea is formed about the advancement of jewellery of the time. The art of jewellery, particularly during the period of the Somavamsis and Gangas was a prominent craft. The jewelers made ornaments befitting to the taste of the time. Both men and women used ornaments.

4.2.3.16. Iron industry

Iron industry was a very well known industry of the period under review. The sculptural representation in different temple walls of various weapons like swore, dagger, battle-axe, shield etc. testify to the fact that iron industry was very much popular in Odisha. The iron beams used in the Jagannath temple at Puri and Sun temple at Konarka project the advanced skill of the Odishan people in the field of iron technology. Besides, house equipments and tools of agriculture were undoubtedly manufactured by the iron smiths of the time.

4.2.3.17. Stone industry

The evidence of numerous temple building of that time clearly exhibit that stone work had advanced sufficiently to give the proof of its excellence. All these temples prove the artistic skill of the Oriya masons who carried on gigantic block of stones up, for the construction of the temples. The decorative motif of the temples clearly prove that a large number of sculptors were employed for the work. Thus, it is conceived that stone works gave sustenance to thousands of stone cuttors, masons and sculptors.

4.2.3.18. Pottery industry

Pottery was a developed industry in this period. Several inscriptions show the grant of land to potters to supply earthen pots for cooking *bhoga* and lightening lamps for the deities in several temples. Undoubtedly, they must have manufactured earthen pots for the families of a large number of villages which were the chief units of the administrative set up in Odisha.

4.2.3.19. Oil industry

Oil is an essential item in the day-to-day life. Frequent reference to this industry is made in several inscriptions.' The need for lightening lamps before the deities prompted people to

resort to the profession of oil-manufacturing. Castor oil was generally used for the prepetual burning of lamps before the deities, mainly in Ganga period. The class people who manufactured oil, were known as *Tailapas.*

4.2.3.20. Production of Salt

Salt is another essential commodity in the daily life. Salt industry existed in Odisha at that time. In Ganga inscription, the term *'Lavanakaradhikari* occurs. It suggests that salt industry was well established during the Somavamsis and the Ganga rulers.

4.2.3.21. Liquor industry

The reference to a term *'Saundika'* in several inscriptions, given an idea that liquor was being produced in Odisha. The tradition mentions that after the ten horse sacrifice made by Yayati Kesari, the river Vaitarani turned into a river of liquor *(Sura).* Further, the drinking vessels in the sculptures of Vaitala temple of testifies to this fact.

4.2.3.21. Other industries

Besides the above mentioned industries, sugar industry, boat-making industry, ivory works etc. were other crafts of the period under review. These industries made a self-sufficient economy which largely catered the needs of the people of Odisha. The surplus products were exported to the outside countries which brought economic prosperity to this land.

4.2.3.22. The Guild system

The growth of trade and urbanisation brought guilds into existence. The guilds were organisation of merchant communities following the same profession. The *srenis* or guild described in Kautilya's *Arthasastra*, were formed having certain rules and regulations and enjoyed executive and judicial powers. The head of guilds or *Sresthins* held lucrative posts under the kings of Odisha as gleaned from the medieval inscriptions of this land. The state and the guilds went hand in hand. The latter exerted great influence over the forme' by giving certain valuable suggestion to the king. The king was also deriving a qreater income for the state by extracting taxes from the guilds. Incase of any dispute among the members of the guilds, the king acted as an arbitrator. Further, the king also put a chec to the guilds when they tried to exploit the common people. The guilds were definitel instrumental for the economic prosperity of this land.

4.2.3.23. Trade and commerce

The cultural efflorescence of Orissa during the Ganga period was undoubtedly an outcome of her economic prosperity. During this period Orissa continued her ancient commercial

relation with South East Asian countries. The engraving of boats in the *Bhoga Mandapa* of the Jagannath temple of Puri, a panel. show in the transportation of elephants (preserved in the Orissa State Museum) and, the reference to 9 township, inhabited by the artisans and traders in the Nagari plate of Anangabhimadeva-1I1 are the evidence of Orissa's overseas trade during the Ganga period. Clothes, diamonds and elephants were exported from Orissa.

4.2.4. Conclusion

Thus, the society and economy during the Bhaumakaras, Somavamsis and the Ganga period did not remain same. The changing political and religious scenario brought many changes in the social structure. On the other hand, the economy of the state during the above period was prosperous which is evident from the construction of numerous beautiful temples in Odisha. Surplus production, emergence of towns and port towns, merchant guilds, trade routes, etc. facilitated the people of Odisha to carry on trade and commerce both inside and outside India which had made the people of this land rich and prosperous. People in general were living peaceful and prosperous during the above period of the Bhaumakaras, Somavamsis and the Ganga rulers.

4.2.5. Summary

- Change and continuity has been the way of social life in ancient and medieval Odisha along with the rise and fall of empires in Odisha.
- The glorious rule of the Bhauma-Karas, the Somavamsis, and the Gangas, contributed a lot to preserve the social and economic structure of this land.
- Although the Bhauma rulers were Buddhists, they accepted the Brahmanical socio-religious order. They tried to enforce the *Varnashrama*, i.e., division of society into four *Varnas* (Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya and Shudra).
- The Neulpur charter of Subhakaradeva I states that Kshemankardeva put Varnas in their proper places.
- The Terundia charter of Subhakaradeva II states that he established the *Varnashrama* system in accordance with the scriptures.
- In the *Varna* system, the Brahmins enjoyed the highest position in the society of and belonged to the first order.

- It is known from many inscriptions of the Bhauma-Karas that Brahmins belonging to several *gotras* like Bharadwaja, Kausika, Visvamitra, Sandilya, Kashyapa, Atreya, etc. settled in Odisha.
- The Kshatriyas occupied their position in the society next to the Brahmins.
- They were warrior class and shouldered the responsibility to protect the country from internal rebellion and external aggression.
- Besides fighting they administered the country.
- The Vaisyas belonged to trading class who resorted to cultivation, cowherdship, trade and commerce. Generally, prosperity of the land depended largely upon the people of this community.
- In the traditional class structure, the Sudras occupied the lowest position. The Sudras were drawn from the community that consisted of artisans, craftsmen, petty agriculturists, servants etc.
- Sanskrit language was used in the inscriptions and literature of the Bhaumakara period.
- The Buddhist manuscript, *Gandavyuha* was written in Sanskrit.
- The Bhauma rulers were learned and cultured who extended their patronage to the institutions of learning.
- Women enjoyed high position in the society during the Bhaumakara period.
- A striking feature of the Bhauma rule was that it provided a number of female rulers.
- The women of Bhauma period were fond of various hair styles, cosmetics, perfumes and ornaments.
- The Bhauma rulers collected moderate tax from their subjects.
- Land grants were also given to the religious institutions like monasteries and temples and Brahmins.
- An established social structure and sound economic condition helped the rulers of the Somavamsi and Ganga period to construct beautiful temples in Odisha and to look after the welfare of the subjects.
- The Somavamsis had adopted the *Varnashrama dharma* i.e., traditional division of the society into four *Varnas (Brahmana, Kshatriya, Vaishya* and *Sudra),* and gave the highest status to the Brahmanas.
- On the other hand the traditional *Varna* system prevailed during the Ganga period.

- The Kayasthas or the Karanas were a hereditary class of writers.
- The Ganga inscriptions narrate how rice, ghee, curd, milk, pulse, curries and *payasa* (rice cooked with milk) etc. were offered as bhoga (offerings) to the deities in the temples.
- There was a phenomenal development in the field of Sanskrit learning and literature during the Somavamsi period.
- Some stone and copper plate inscriptions of the Ganga period clearly indicate that Oriya language and script took a definite shape during this period.
- The Ganga monarchs extended patronage to the development of music and dance.
- Women enjoyed respectable status in the Somavamsi society.
- The economy of the Somavamsi and the Ganga rulers was based upon various types of revenue collected from land, agriculture, industry, products, trade and commerce etc.
- Land revenue was the major source of income for the Somavamsi and Ganga government.
- One-sixth of the production of the land was collected as the land revenue.
- Along with agriculture, several industries also grew during the Somavamsi and Ganga period. Besides agricultures, industries also helped a lot for the enhancement of economy.

4.2.6. Exercise

- Give an account on the society of the Bhaumakara period.
- Write a note on the society and economy of the Bhaumakara period.
- Discuss the economic condition of Odisha during the Somavamsi and Ganga rule.
- Make an analysis on the society and economy of the Somavamsi and Ganga period.

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Unit-4

Chapter-III

The Cult of Jagannath- Origin, Development and Impact on Odishan Society

Structure

4.3.0. Objectives

4.3.1.Introduction

4.3.2.The Cult of Jagannath

4.3.3.Origin and development of the Cult of Jagannath

4.3.3.1.Tribal origin of Lord Jagannath

4.3.3.2.Vedic origin of Jagannath

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4.3.3.9.Jagannath and Islamism

4.3.4.Impact of Jagannath Cult on Odishan society

4.3.5.Conclusion

4.3.6.Summary

4.3.7.Exercise

4.3.8.Further Reading

4.3.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students investigate about the The Cult of Jagannath- Origin, Development and Impact on Odishan Society. *After studying this lesson you will be able to:*

- *to learn the Cult of Jagannath;*
- *to analyze the origin of the Jagannath Cult;*
- *to investigate development of Jagannath Cult;*
- *to trace the impact of Jagannath Cult on Odishan society;*

4.3.1.Introduction

Lord Jagannath has always remained as mysterious to the knowledge of mankind. The origin of Jagannath cult is shrouded in obscurity. The veil of darkness that pervades over this cult has not been lifted till today. However, God Jagannath has been accepted as the representative of the Oriya people, an embodiment of love, a guiding force behind the cultural heritage of this land, a synthesis of all the Hinduite faiths and finally, as the God of the universe.

4.3.2.The Cult of Jagannath

The cult of Jagannath embodies universal brotherhood, combining elements of Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism and the native religious practices of the tribal people. The presiding deities of the temple, Jagannath, his elder brother Balabhadra and younger sister Subhadra, portrayed in black, white and yellow, represent the three major races of humanity according to noted religious and social commentators. The cult of Jagannath shows special concern and compassion for the lowliest and the most unfortunate in society. It is this spirit of universal love that has attracted even Muslim devotees such as Salabega whose songs in praise of Lord Jagannath are popular among all Oriyas and devotees all over the world who celebrate the Car Festival or Rath Yatra of Lord Jagannath with ardent passion.

4.3.3.Origin and development of the Cult of Jagannath

The origin and development of the Cult of Jagannath is quite mysterious. Different scholars have different views regarding the origin and development of Jagannath Cult in Odisha which can be discussed as follows:

4.3.3.1.Tribal origin of Lord Jagannath

The cult of Jagannath is stated to be of tribal origin. It is difficult to determine whether this tribal origin of God Jagannath is pre-Vedic or not. As per the depiction of Sarala's *Mahabharata,* God Krishna, killed by the arrow of Jara *Savara,* was not burnt in wood fully after

his death. As per the order of the divine voice, Arjuna and Jara threw the half-burnt body into the sea and that body was, later on, worshipped by Jara in the Dhauli hill at Bhubaneswar. In the mean while, Galamadhava, the king of Kanchi knowing about the death of Krishna, sent a Brahmin named Vasudeva to collect the body who located it in Bhubaneswar and transferred it to Nilachala. By that time, king Indradyumna had constructed a temple at Nilachala and by divine order, the king proceeded to that place. With the help of Jara, he brought the *daru* (wood) from Rohini *kunda* and installed the image inside the temple at Nilachala. Due to his folly, the images of God Jagannath, Balabhadra and Subhadra were found incomplete as he opened the door of the temple defying the request of the sculpture (Bisvakarma in disguise) who had instructed the king not to open the door before the expiry of fifteen days. The story revealing the tribal origin of God Jagannath is different in the *Skanda Purana.*

The *Purusottama Mahatmya* section of that *Purana* narrates that the original place of worship of Nilamadhava (God Jagannath) was at *Nila Saila* (blue mountain) amidst a thick forest. In a dream, king Indradyumna of Avanti saw it and sent Vidyapati, a Brahmin to bring the God. Vidyapati married Lalita, the daughter of the tribal chief Visvavasu. After much persuasion of his daughter, Visvavasu took his son-in-law for the visit of Nilamadhava. While going to that place with his eyes covered, Vidyapati, cleverly threw the mustard seeds on the way. In the rainy season, the seeds germinated which clearly indicated the way to the place of worship of Nilamadhava. Vidyapati informed this to king Indradyumna who went to pays visit to the God. To his utter dismay, the God had vanished from that place. The king dreamt that a sacred log was coming from *Svetadvipa* where lied God Vishnu.

In the next morning, he was informed that a log containing the signs of God Vishnu was found on the sea-shore. The king rushed to the sea-shore immediately and the log was brought with much rejoicement. Out of the log, four images i,e. Jagannath, Balabhadra Subhadra and Sudarsana were made and installed in the temple constructed at *nila seus* (Puri). Though this fact is narrated differently in the *Deula Tala* of poet Nilambara Das and the work of the same name of Sisu Krishna Das, the fact remains the same that God Jagannath had a tribal origin which has been accepted by many notable scholars like B. Padhi, G.C. Tripathy, H. Kulke and A. Eschmann. Further, the association of the *sevakas* of God Jaqannath in Puri bear the name *Daitas.* The *Vanayaga* before the search of *Daru* for *Navakalevara* of the God also speaks of the tribal origin of God Jagannath. The three tribal deities like Jaleri Penu, Tana Penu and Murani

Penu, worshipped by the Khonds Odisha are regarded as Jagannath, Balabhadra and Subhadra respectively .

4.3.3.2.Vedic origin of Jagannath

Many scholars trace the Vedic origin of God Jagannath. The 3rd verse of the 155th *Sukta* in the 10th *Mandala* of *Rig Veda* states :

"There is a log floating on the sea and no one claims this as his property. O' ugly evil spirit, ride on that and remove yourself to the other side of the ocean." On the otherhand, Sayana, a 15th century commentator interprets the above quoted *sukta* as such :

"O, you are difficult to destroy, take resource to the (sacred) log of wood which has no creator and which exists on the far distant sea coast, and achieve your salvation by the object."

Through the above mentioned *Sukta* and its interpretation given by Sayana, the Vedic origin of God Jagannath is traced by several scholars. As, primarily, the cult of Jagannath is associated with tribal origin, which is non-Aryan in character, the Aryans might be aware about it and might have reflected that in a different way in the *Rig Veda.* This definitely gives a clue to the scholars to think the prevalence of the worship of Jagannath in a *daru* (log) from long before the Vedic age. However, this is controversial.

4.3.3.3.Jaina origin of Lord Jagannath

The Jaina origin of God Jagannath is traced by several scholars. As a heterodox religion, Jainism gave great challenge to Vedic religion. It has already been discussed earlier that before 6th century B.C., Jainism had entered into Odisha. It received royal patronage from Kharavela, the mighty monarch of the Chedi dynasty. Jainism gained momentum in the nook and corner of Odisha. The numerous Jaina monuments of Odisha amply justify the fact. Owing to the popularity of Jainism in Odisha, Balabhadra, Subhadra and Jagannath have been regarded as the three cardinal principles of Jainism like *Samyak Jnana, Samyak Charitra* and *Samyak Drishti* by N. K. Das. The concept of *Kalpa* tree in Jainism is regarded as the *Kalpavata* inside the sacred complex of God Jagannath temple at Puri. *Kaivalya Mukti,* one of the tenets of Jainism is identified with the *Kaivalya (Mahaprasada)* of Lord Jagannath that offers salvation to man. Further, B.M. Padhi tends to locate *Vaddha Managala* and *Nandipada,* the two Jaina symbols in the image of God Jagannath that give scope to presume the Jaina origin of the deity. However, these facts did not conclusively prove that Jagannath had a Jaina Origin. The principle of

Kaivalya Mukti or *salvation* of Jainism is found in other religious faiths too. Similarly, *Kalpavatas* are worshipped in different parts of India.

4.3.3.4.Buddhist origin of God Jagannath

Some scholars trace a Buddhist origin of the trinity of the Jagannath temple. It is said that the tooth relic of Lord Buddha is preserved in the image of Jagannath, that the three deities - Jagannath, Subhadra and Balabhadra - represent Buddha, Dharma and Sangha respectively, that the *Snana Yatra* (bathing festival) and *Ratha yatra* (car festival) of the Jagannath temple are of Buddhist origin and that the sharing of *Kaivalya* (sacred food) on equal footing by all castes is due to the Buddhist impact. There are some literary evidence of co-relation between Lord Jagannath and Buddhism.

According to some scholars, Jagannath is a common epithet of Buddha. In Tibet, one of the names of Buddha is Jagannath. Jayadeva, the twelfth century Vaishnava poet who, according to some scholars, identified Jagannath with Krishna or Vishnu also accepted Buddha as the ninth incarnation of Krishna or Vishnu. Sarala Das, the fifteenth century poet, in his *Mahabharat* regarded Jagannath as an embodiment of Buddha. He wrote, "To deliver mankind, Jagannath has manifested himself in the form of Buddha." *Daru Brahma Gita* of Jagannath Das says, "To assume the form of Buddha the Lord gave up his hands and legs." Some Oriya Vaishnavas regarded Chaitanya as the partial manifestation of Buddha. In the *Chaitanya Bhagavata* of Isvar Dasa, Shri Chaitanya is reported to have said, "I am Chaitanya in the form of Buddha." Evidently there was a synthesis between Buddhism and Vaishnavism at some stage, and Jagannath cult bears the imprint of that synthesis.

4.3.3.5.The *Saiva-Tantric* origin of God Jagannath

Though by the tenth century A.D., the presiding deity of Puri was known as Purushottama, which is one of thousand epithets of Vishnu, yet during the Bhauma period, the deity appears to have been profoundly influenced by Saivism, Shaktism, Tantricism and Buddhism which were simultaneously prevalent. Scholars are of the opinion that the image of Jagannath has striking similarity with that of Ekapada Bhairava (Bhairava with one foot, which is a manifestation of Siva, whose worship was prevalent during the Bhauma period). Some Tantrik texts refer to Puri as a seat of Shaktism, Vimala as the *Shakti* and Jagannath as his Bhairava. The prevalence of Saivism at Puri is proved by the existence of such Saiva shrines as Markandeyesvara, Patalesvara and Lokanath.

4.3.3.6.Jagannath Cult and Saktism

The prevalence of Shaktism at Puri is borne out by the worship of Vimala inside the temple, and the existence of Saptamatruka image. The 'Utkal Khanda' of *Skanda Purana* describes Subhadra as the Shakti of Jagannath. The name 'Purushottama', though an epithet of Vishnu, has Tantrik significance according to some scholars. It represents the erotic aspect of Vishnu. Purushottama is to be found with Lakshmi, the female erotic partner. In the *Anargharaghava natakam,* Murari Mishra describes Purushottama with Lakshmi on his lap. Jayadeva, in his *Gitagovinda,* dealt with erotic sports of Krishna with Radha, and identified Radha with Kamala or Lakshmi, the consort of Narayana. Jayadeva also regarded Jagannath as Krishna. Subhadra was treated as Lakshmi during the Ganga period, and afterwards. The *Purushottama Mahatmya* of *Skanda Purana* (a work of 13th century A.D.) and of *Vishnurahasya* (a work of 16th century A.D.) referred to the female wooden image between Jagannath and Balabhadra as Lakshmi.

4.3.3.7.Vaishnavite origin of the Jagannath cult

The Vaishnavite origin of the Jagannath cult is traced by some scholars *Purusottama Mahatmya* projects God Jagannath as Narayana, Krishna-Vasudeva, Buddha etc. Poet Jayadeva, as stated earlier, had popularised Vaisnavism in Odisha thro his immortal creation *Gita Govinda.* Further, during the Suryavamsi Gajapati rule, particularly during Prataparudradeva, the visit of Srichaitanya and his intimate association with the temple of God Jagannath made Vaisnavism popular in Odisha. Several festivals associates with Krishna cult like *Krishna Janma, Nandotsava, Kaliyadalana, Kemseveare Vakasuravadha, Chandana Yatra* etc. were intimately associated with the festivals of temple of God Jagannath as are being celebrated till now. No doubt, Vaisnavism was intimately associated with the Cult of God Jagannath in comparison to any other religion. Though, the origin of Jagannath cannot be traced satisfactorily, one thing is certain that the Cult, the assimilation of tribal element, Vedic religion, Jainism, Buddhism, Saivism, Saktism, tantric elements,Vaisnavism, is found.

4.3.3.8.Sikhism and Jagannath

It is told that Sikhism has relation with Jagannath. The Mangu Math of Puri bears its memory. That math has the photograph of Guru Nanak. The Sikhs believe that Guru Nanak has visited Puri. The future research will provide more fact on this.

4.3.3.9.Jagannath and Islamism

Jagannath was regarded as sacred by the Muslims of Odisha. Yavana Salabega had given importance to him. He had composed many *Bhajans* for Jagannath. Those Bhajans are very popular in the nook and corner of Odisha even today.

4.3.4.Impact of Jagannath Cult on Odishan society

The Jagannath cult exercises deep impact over the socio-religious-political life of Orissa. During the Ganga and Surya rules, Jagannath, so to say, became the State deity. Puri has been visited from ancient times by founders of different religious cults, who left their legacy through the monasteries.

The Jagannath Temple at Puri in Orissa has been a center of religious, spiritual and artistic pursuits through the ages. Lord Jagannath is more than a religious deity for the people of Orissa, he is fountainhead of their cultural, intellectual and emotional sustenance. Odissi dance and music as well as Orissan sculpture and the famous *patachitra* paintings were inspired and enriched by Jagannath culture. The poet Jayadeva composed his famous Gita Govinda staying in Puri. As discussed earlier, Yayati I, the great Somavamsi king is supposed to had started the construction work of the temple of God Jagannath at Puri. Perhaps, during the period of the Somavamsis, the worship of God Jagannath was given a special attention. The play *Anargharaghava* of Murari Mishra of 9th century A.D. refers to the worship God Purusottama (Jagannath) on the sea-shore. Similarly, the *Tantra Yamala* (10th cent - A.D.) and the *Kalki purana* (11th century A.D.) refer to God Jagannath as the venerate deity of this land. During the glorious days of the imperial Gangas from 12th century A.D. to 16th century A.D., the worship of God Jagannath was given due patronage. The mighty rulers of this dynasty like Chodagangadeva, Anangabhimadeva III and Narasimhadeva were ardent worshippers of God Jagannath and they stated in different inscription the longing to the God. During the Suryavamsi Gajapati rule, the power and prestige of Jagannath were enhanced by the rulers of this dynasty.

Its impact on the people of Odisha was so much so that, they even did not oppose the enthronement of Purusottamadeva, when the legitimate claim of Hamvira was thrown aside by Kapilendradeva who justified his action as it was the divine will of God Jagannath and thus, kept his subjects mum. In the Kanchi-Kaveri legend Jagannath and Balabhadra exhibited their martial spirit by defeating the king of Kanchi. The reign period of Prataparudradeva witnessed the

growing popularity of God Jagannath as reflected in the *Pancha Sakha* literature. The visit of Sri Chaitanya to Puri during his reign period popularised the cult of God Jagannath in the nook and corner of Odisha. His efforts made the people of Odisha a blind follower of God Jagannath. During the reign period of the Bhoi dynasty, adequate attention was given for the temple rituals and looking after the comforts and safety of the pilgrims who carnd to this land from different parts of the country. The ardent devotion of king Ramachandradeva in keeping Jagannath, Balabhadra and Subhadra out of the touch of the Muslims, shows the great devotion of the king and people of this land towards the Cult of God Jagannath. Even today the *Chhera Pahanra* by the Gajapati king of Odisha, in front of the Gods during *Ratha Yatra* in the presence of hundreds and thousands of devotees, proved the popularity of this cult not only in Odisha but also in different parts of the country and abroad.

It has become one of the four important places of pilgrimage for the devout Hindus not only of Orissa but also of all parts of India and the world. Largest crowds of devotees are to be noticed in Puri at the time of the car festival of Lord Jagannath. It is the belief of Hindus that on seeing Lord Jagannath, the manifestation of supreme being, in his chariot one never falls into the mire of the cycle of rebirth.

4.3.5.Conclusion

Thus, Jagannath cult is an amalgam of diverse religious cults like tribal religion, Brahmanical religion, Buddhism, Saivism, Shaktism, Tantricism and Vaishnavism. The prevalent religious trends in Odisha assimilated in the Cult of God Jagannath in due course of time. With the gradual march of time all the religious sects, mingled in the cult of Jagannath. Every Hindu Pantheon saw its god or goddess in Him. Even to-day, Jagannath, the 'Lord of the Universe' is honoured and worshipped by the followers of different religious sects in India.

4.3.6.Summary

- Lord Jagannath has always remained as mysterious to the knowledge of mankind.
- The origin of Jagannath cult is shrouded in obscurity.
- The cult of Jagannath embodies universal brotherhood, combining elements of Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism and the native religious practices of the tribal people.
- The presiding deities of the temple, Jagannath, his elder brother Balabhadra and younger sister Subhadra, portrayed in black, white and yellow, represent the three major races of humanity according to noted religious and social commentators.

- The cult of Jagannath is stated to be of tribal origin.
- The *Vanayaga* before the search of *Daru* for *Navakalevara* of the God also speaks of the tribal origin of God Jagannath.
- The three tribal deities like Jaleri Penu, Tana Penu and Murani Penu, worshipped by the Khonds Odisha are regarded as Jagannath, Balabhadra and Subhadra respectively .
- Many scholars trace the Vedic origin of God Jagannath. The 3rd verse of the 155th *Sukta* in the 10th *Mandala* of *Rig Veda.*
- Owing to the popularity of Jainism in Odisha, Balabhadra, Subhadra and Jagannath have been regarded as the three cardinal principles of Jainism like *Samyak Jnana, Samyak Charitra* and *Samyak Drishti* by N. K. Das.
- The concept of *Kalpa* tree in Jainism is regarded as the *Kalpavata* inside the sacred complex of God Jagannath temple at Puri.
- Though by the tenth century A.D., the presiding deity of Puri was known as Purushottama, which is one of thousand epithets of Vishnu, yet during the Bhauma period, the deity appears to have been profoundly influenced by Saivism, Shaktism, Tantricism and Buddhism which were simultaneously prevalent.
- The prevalence of Shaktism at Puri is borne out by the worship of Vimala inside the temple, and the existence of Saptamatruka image. The 'Utkal Khanda' of *Skanda Purana* describes Subhadra as the Shakti of Jagannath.
- The *Purushottama Mahatmya* of *Skanda Purana* (a work of 13th century A.D.) and of *Vishnurahasya* (a work of 16th century A.D.) referred to the female wooden image between Jagannath and Balabhadra as Lakshmi.
- The Vaishnavite origin of the Jagannath cult is traced by some scholars *Purusottama Mahatmya* projects God Jagannath as Narayana, Krishna-Vasudeva, Buddha etc. Poet Jayadeva, as stated earlier, had popularised Vaisnavism in Odisha thro his immortal creation *Gita Govinda.*
- It is told that Sikhism has relation with Jagannath. The Mangu Math of Puri bears its memory.
- Jagannath was regarded as sacred by the Muslims of Odisha. Yavana Salabega had given importance to him. He had composed many *Bhajans* for Jagannath.

- The Jagannath cult exercises deep impact over the socio-religious-political life of Orissa. During the Ganga and Surya rules, Jagannath, so to say, became the State deity.
- Puri has been visited from ancient times by founders of different religious cults, who left their legacy through the monasteries.
- Its impact on the people of Odisha was so much so that, they even did not oppose the enthronement of Purusottamadeva, when the legitimate claim of Hamvira was thrown aside by Kapilendradeva who justified his action as it was the divine will of God Jagannath and thus, kept his subjects mum.
- It has become one of the four important places of pilgrimage for the devout Hindus not only of Orissa but also of all parts of India and the world.
- Largest crowds of devotees are to be noticed in Puri at the time of the car festival of Lord Jagannath.
- It is the belief of Hindus that on seeing Lord Jagannath, the manifestation of supreme being, in his chariot one never falls into the mire of the cycle of rebirth.
- Thus, Jagannath cult is an amalgam of diverse religious cults like tribal religion, Brahmanical religion, Buddhism, Saivism, Shaktism, Tantricism and Vaishnavism.

4.3.7.Exercise

- What do you mean by Cult of Jagannath? Discuss the origin and development of Jagannath Cult.
- Write a note on the origin and development of Jagannath cult in Odisha.
- Highlight the association of different cults with the Cult of Jagannath.
- Discuss the impact of Jagannath Cult on Odishan society.

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HISTORY OF ODISHA
(FROM 1435 TO 1803 A.D.)

By

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HISTORY OF ODISHA (From 1435 TO 1803 A.D.)

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UNIT-1
Chapter-I

The Suryavamsi Gajapatis:
Sources, Political history (Kapilendradeva, Purusottamadeva, Prataprudradeva)

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1.1.7. Conclusion
1.1.8. Summary
1.1.9. Exercise
1.1.10. Further Reading

1.1.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Suryavamsi Gajapatis. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the different sources of Suryavamsi Gajapatis*
- *understand the political history of Kapilendradeva*
- *know about the political history of Purusottamadeva*
- *evaluate the political history of Prataparudradeva*

1.1.1. Introduction

The Ganga dynasty was followed by the establishment of the rule of another glorious dynasty known as the Suryavamsi Gajapatis. The political chaos which had been prevailing in Odisha from the middle of the fourteenth century A.D. due to the weakness and ineffectiveness of the later Gangas was ended by the emergence of a powerful military leader, named Kapilendradeva who overthrew the Gangas and founded a new dynasty, called Suryavamsi (solar dynasty). For personal glorification, the rulers of this dynasty claimed their descent from the mythical solar dynasty to which Lord Ramachandra belonged. As they possessed large elephantry in their army, they were popularly known as Gajapatis, i.e. the lords of the elephants.

1.1.2. The Suryavamsi Gajapatis

The Suryavamsi rulers traced their origin to the Sun God. The title 'Gajapati' or 'Lord of elephants' was invariably born by the rulers of this dynasty. Earlier some Eastern Ganga rulers also bore 'Gajapati' title but they were not famous as Gajapati rulers. Perhaps the royalty of the rulers of this dynasty owed a lot to the possession of a large number of elephants. In the 15th and 16th centuries, Odisha reached the zenith of its glory under the Suryavamsi kings. The Suryavamsi Gajapati kings were not only noted for their aggressive imperialism but their rule for a century and also for the renaissance in Odia literature.

1.1.3. Sources

The history of Suryavamsi Gajapatis of Odisha is based on various available sources. The sources can be divided into two groups (1) Literary sources , and (2) Inscriptions.

Literary sources: Sanskrit literary works like the *Parasurama Vijaya, Abhinava Venisamharam, Sarasvati vilasam, Jagannatha vallabha, Prabodha Chandrodaya etc,* Odia works like the *Mad,ala Panji, Sarala Mahabharata, Chaitanya Bhagavata, Jagannatha Cheritemrite* etc. Bengali literary works like the *Chaitanya Charitamrita, Chaitanya Mangala* etc. Telugu works like *Manucharitam, Krishnarasa Vijayamu* etc, Persian works like the *Tarikh-*

i-Ferishta, Tabaqat-i-Akbari, Akbarnamah, Burhan-i-Ma'asir etc. form the literary sources of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis.

Inscriptions: Similarly some inscriptions like the Velagalani copper plate inscription, Lingaraj temple inscription, Puri Jagannath temple inscription, inscriptions found from Simhachalam, Sri Sailam, Srikurmam and further Velicherla copper plates, Kondavidu inscription etc. comprise the inscriptional sources for the Suryavamsi rule in Odisha.

1.1.4. Political history of Kapilendradeva (1435-1467 A.D.)

The political history of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis started with Kapilendradeva who ascended the throne in 1435 A.D. The *Madala panji* narrates him as an adopted son of Matta Bhanudeva or Bhanudeva IV, the last Ganga king who was childless. On the other hand, the *Gangavamsanucharitarn* of Vasudeva Ratha describes that Kapilendradeva usurped throne of the Gangas when Bhanudeva IV was fighting in a distant place.

Various inscriptions of Simhachalam support this fact revealing that Bhanudeva IV was carrying on protracted struggle against the Reddis of Rajahmundry in distant south by that time. Had it not been so, Kapilendradeva would not have crowned himself at *Kritivasa kataka* i.e. Bhubaneswar rather at Cuttack which was the citadel of Ganga power. Perhaps, out of the fear of the feudatories, he accomplished the coronation work at Bhubaneswar with great hasty. Further, had he been adopted as son of Bhanudeva IV, he would have described himself as a Ganga king in his own records and also the records of his successors would have described him as a Ganga king. On the other hand, he himself, his sons and grand-sons, all have been described as the member of the Suryavamsa. The story of Kasia-Kapila, Kapila as a cow boy, a thief, etc. and his selection by the Ganga king Matta Bhanudeva by the will of and Jagannath all had been designed to legitimatize his claim to the throne and thus, are far from historical facts.

1.1.4.1. Problems for Kapilendradeva at the time of accession

Just after his accession in 1435 AD., he found the throne of Odisha as full of problems. (1) In the South, the Reddi rulers of Rajahmumdry were extending their frontiers further north. Form the North, the country was threatened by the Sultan of Bengal. (2) The distant Malwa also tried to take advantage of the revolution of local chiefs and feudatories to acknowledge the suzerainty of Kapilendradeva.

At that critical juncture, Kapliendradeva took immediate steps and by his army subdued the rebel chiefs like the Matsyas of Oddadi, the Salivamsi chiefs of Nandapura, the

Vishnuvardhana Chakravartins of Panchadharala and the Gangas of Khimindi. His Lingaraj temple inscription reveals thus: "all kings of my kingdom of Odisha should work for the good of the paramount sovereign and should keep to virtuous ways and not remain in bad ways. If they act badly towards their sovereign, they will be expelled from the kingdom and all their property confiscated." This order definitely directed the defiant chiefs to acknowledge the suzerainty of Kapilendradeva.

1.1.4.2. Introduction of Kapilabda

Kapilendradeva introduced 'Kapilabda' after his ascession. The above mentioned Lingaraj temple inscription was issued in the 7th year of Kapilendradeva's rule. It states that by 1442-43 A.D., the task of quelling the internal rebellions by Kapilendradeva had been accomplished. After subjugating the unruly feudatory chiefs, Kapilendradeva embarked upon the policy of aggrandizement which earned him a good name as a great hero of the Gajapati dynasty.

1.1.4.3. His wars and conquests: Victory over Gauda

After his accession, he wanted to settle score with the lllyas Shahis of Bengal. Taking the internal quarrel of the Sarquis of Jaunpur, the Gangas had extended the frontier of Odisha upto the river Bhagirathi (Ganges). Perhaps, Kapilendra, while fighting against the combined army of the Reddis of Rajahmundry and Vijayanagara Empire, received the news of the attack of sultan Nasiruddin Abul Muzzafar Mahmud Shah of Bengal. He rushed immediately and inflicted a crushing defeat upon him extending the sway of Kapilendradeva up to the river Ganges. In an inscription dated 1447 A.D., Kapilendradeva assumed the title *'Goudesvara'*. So, definitely by 1447 A.D., Bengal (Gauda) was under the sway of Kapilendradeva. However, the attack of Sultan Mahmud Sharqul of Jaunpur in 1457 A.D. and his son in 1458 A.D. and Kapilendra's negotiation with them as per Ferishta's *Tabaqat-i-Akbari* have not been ascertained by any other corroborative evidences. One thing is affirmed that Kapilendra had won victory over Bengal. Had it not been so, he would not have assumed the title *'Gaudesvara'*.

1.1.4.4. Occupation of Rajahmundry

In the south, Virabhadra I, the Reddi ruler of Rajahmundry posed a great problem of Kapilendradeva in checking the southward progress. An inscription at Draksharam dated 1444 A.D. clearly proves that by that time Rajahmundry was under the control of the Vijayanagara Empire. Before his engagement with Mahmud Shah of Jaunpur, Kapliendradeva had suffered a setback at the hand of Mallappa Odeyar sent by the ablest ruler of Bahamani, Devaraya II when

Kapiledndra had attacked Rajahmundry. With the death of Devaraya II in 1446 A.D. the Vijayanagara Empire became weak under his son and successor Mallikarjunaraya. The hold of Vijayanagara over Rajahmundry became weak. Taking advantage of this situation, Kapilendradeva dispatched a grand army under his son Hamvira for the occupation of Rajahmundry. Hamvira defeated the Reddis with ease and Rajahmundry was annexed to the empire of Kapilendradeva. Raghudeva Narendra Mahapatra was appointed as the Governor of Rajahmundry. The task of subjugating Rajahmundry was accomplished before 1448 A.D.

1.1.4.5. Conquest of Kondavidu

For a few years, Kapilendradeva postponed his conquest in the South as he had to pay attention towards his northern frontier. The inscription of Mallikarjuna at Matamura in the Guntur district dated August 19, 1453 testifies the fact that the territory to the South of Krishna was under the authority of the Vijayanagara empire. Taking advantage of the weakness of Mallikarjuna Kapilendra's army crossed the krishna river and occupied Kondavidu. Kapiiendradeva appointed Ganadeva Routaraya, one of his relations as the *Pariksha* of Kondavidu. An inscription at Chintapallipadu in the Guntur district dated April 12, 1454 records Ganadeva Routaraya's gift to a temple. Thus, almost whole of the Guntur district passed into the hands of Kapilendradeva before April 1454. Now, he became the master of the Reddi Kingdom of Rajahmundry and Kondavidu.

1.1.4.6. Victory over Telingana

Having encouraged with his success, Kapilendra wanted to extend his sway up to Telingana coast that lied between Rajahmundry and Bahamani Kingdom. Telingana had important forts like Rachakonda, Devarkonda and Warangal. They were under the occupation of the Bellama chiefs of Telingana. Their support to Devaraya II, the king of Vijayanagar in a war against Bahamani enraged Alauddin ahmad Shah who through Sanjar Khan subdued the Bellamas, describes *Burhan-i-Maasri.* Alauddin Ahmed Shah II was succeeded by his son Humayun Saha who appointed Malik Shah as the governor of Telingana. Sikandar Khan, the son of Jalal Khan revolted against this decision of Humayun Shah. Aided by Linga, the Bellama chief at Devarkonda, Jalal Khan took up arms against Humayun shah and was killed by the latter. Humayun wanted to punish Linga. Linga appealed Kapilendradeva to render military service to him. Kapilendradeva readily extended his helping had to Linga.

The Bahamani forces sustained a total defeat at the hands of the combined army of Odisha and Devarkonda in 1458 A.D. After this, the Bellemas of Devarkonda, Rachakonda and Warangal became vassals of Kapilendradeva against Bahamani Kingdom. This victory over Devarkonda led Kapilendradeva to assume the title *'Kala vargesvara'*.

1.1.4.7. Capture of Bahamani Kingdom

The death of Humayun Shah in 1461 created appropriate situation for Kapilendradeva to invade Bahamani kingdom. Now Kapilendra with his grand army aided by the Bellama chiefs marched towards Bidar, the capital of Bahamani kingdom. Sultan Nizam Shah was only eight years old. The Hindu army plundered and devastated the country while proceeding towards the capital of Bahamani kingdom. The fall of the Muslim Kingdom was inevitable. However, at that juncture, Kapilendradeva had to retreat.

Ferishta informs that the Hindu army took refuge in a fort and Kapilendradeva had to pay a large sum of money and retreated. This description of Ferishta is to be taken with a pinch of salt. If a critical analysis is made, it will be apparent that Kapilendradeva had no chance to surrender to a weak and feeble minor ruler of the Bahamani kingdom. On the other hand, it can be presumed that the long absence of the Odishan army from the capital led the Muslim ruler of Bengal to attack Odisha and Kapilendradeva had to retreat to deal with sultan Hussain Sharqui of Jaunpur. However, after setting score with the Sultan of Bengal, Kapilendra again marched towards Bahamani kingdom with renewed vigour and captured Hahur, Bidar and several other places that rightly led him to justify the title *'Kalavargasvara'*.

1.1.4.8. Vijayanagara Empire

The death of Devaraya II and the succession of his son in 1447 A.D. created an opportunity for Kapilendradeva to cross sword with the Vijayanagara empire. Saluva Narasimha the subordinate ruler of Chandragiri under the Vijayanagara empire was dreaming of building his own castle over the Vijayanagara empire. The internal mal-administration of the empire prompted Kapilendra to attack that country. To materialise his plan, Kapilendra first wanted to conquer Udayagiri fort which occupied a strategic position of the Vijayanagara empire in the coastal regions.

By the instruction of Kapilendra, his lieutenant Tamma Bhupala conquered it in 1460 A.D. as an inscription of the top of Udayagiri hill of the same year records the construction of a temple. After the conquest of Udayagiri, Basava Bhupala, son of Tamma Bhupala was appointed

as its governor. With Udayagiri as base, Hamvira, the valiant son of Kapilendradeva, marched along the coastal line of the Vijayanagara empire, Now, Mallikarjuna transferred Saluva Narasimha, the ruler of Chandragiri *rajya* to the central division of his empire with Vinukonda as its capital. This made Chandragiri *rajya* weak. Pasupati Tamma Bhupati, a lieutenant of Kapilendradeva, attacked the fort of Chandragiri and occupied it sometimes before 1464 A.D. Controversy prevails over the occupation of Vijayanagara empire by Odishan army. The Anantavaram plates of Prataprudradeva state that Kapilendra sent his son Hamvira to conquer Hampi, the capital of Vijayanagara who succeeded in conquering it and forcing the emperor to pay tribute.

The *Gangadasa- Vilasa Charitam* confirms the fact stating that Kapilendradeva in combination with the Hayapati (Bahamani Sultan) wanted to humiliate the young emperor of the Vijayanagara empire but the latter came out like a cub of the lion from his den and defeated the combined army of the *Gajapati* and *Hayapati*. R. Subramanyam brings a solution to this riddle by his opinion that though Hamvira defeated the Vijayanagara army but the whole Vijayanagara Kingdom did not come under the sway of the Gajapati ruler of Odisha. That Hamvira had proceeded upto Trichinapolli is evident from an inscription in Sriranga temple which records a gift of cows in 1464 A.D. by '*Dakshina* Kapilesvara Kumara Mohapatra'. After the conquest of Tanjor and Tnchinapolli regions, Hamvira stopped his agressive march. The grandson of Kapilendra named Kumara Kapilesvara Mohapatra was appointed as the Viceroy of the conquered tsrntores n 1464 A.D. By extensive conquests of Kapilendradeva, the Odishan empire extended from the rivel Ganges, in the north to Kaveri, in the south.

1.1.4.9. Closing years of Kapilendradeva

The last years of Kapilendradeva were full of sorrows and problems. He found himself deserted and betrayed by some of his trusted servants and soldiers. Though, diplomatically he nominated Purustottamadeva, his younger son as his successor by the will of God Jagannath. But it was not accepted by Hamvira with ease. When a fratricidal war was imminent between the two brothers, news of the loss of territories reached Kapilendradeva. In the North, Ruknuddin Barbak captured Mandaran fort. In the South, Saluva Narasimha occupied his previous kingdom driving out the Odia army from that territory. The internal quarrel between Hamvira and Purusottama and the loss of territory made Kapilendra weak and he breathed his last most probably in 1466-67 A.D.

1.1.4.10. Estimate of Kapilendradeva

The reign of Kapilendrdeva was a splendid epoch in the history of Odisha. He was a great military genius. He was the founder of the Suryavamsi rule in Odisha. The spirit with which he subdued the refractory chiefs and firmly established the Suryavamsi regime is certainly commendable. He bore high-sounding titles befitting to his status. By putting an end to the Ganga rule in Odisha and bore the title *'Gajapati'*. After conquering a part of Bengal, he justified his title *Gaudesvara*. His conquest of a part of the Bahamani kingdom and his expedition to Bidar led him to assume the title *'Kala varges vara'*. After conquering a part of the Vijayanagar empire, he entitled himself as *'Navakoti Karnata'*. *'Navakoti*, perhaps meant 'nine crores' of people of the parts of Bahamani kingdom and Vijayanagara empire. Thus, the pompous title of Kapilendradeva was *'Gajapati Gaudesvara Navakoti Karnata Kalavargesvara'*.

After centuries of military inactivity, Kapilendradeva brought Odisha into the chess board of Indian politics breaking her isolation. He defeated his contemporary rulers like Mahmud Shah, Humayun Shah, Mallikarjuna and Saluva Narasimha. As a result, he created a vast empire stretching from the river bank of the Ganges to that of Kaveri.

Kapilendradeva was a great patron of literature. He himself was an accomplished scholar in Sanskrit. His play *Parasurama Vijaya* shows that he was a dramatist of no mean order. This drama had been staged before God Jagannath during a Mahotsava, informs the *Madala Panji*. During his reign period, Nrusingha Vajapayee, a famous *Advaitavadin* had written a commentary named *Samkshepa Saririka Vartika* on Sankaracharya's work *Samshepa Saririka*. The first renaissance started in Odia literature during Kapnendradeva. Sarala Dasa's Odia *Mahabharata* represented the totality of Odishan culture. His *Vilanka Ramayana* and *Chandi Purana* were two other great works.

Not only Kapilendradeva was a patron of poets and men of letters but he was great builder too. He constructed the outer-wall of the Jagannath temple at Puri. He also established Kapilesvarpura and Damodarapura *Shasana*. Perhaps, he constructed the temple of Kapilesvara near Bhubaneswar. Further, the Gokarnesvara Siva temple at Midnapur and Mallkarjuna Siva temple contained the inscriptions of Kapilendradeva. Kapilendradeva was a great devotee of God Jagannath. He always described himself as the *Sevaka* (servant) of the God. He provided the number of facilities for the worship of the God in Puri Jagannath temple.

Thus, in achieving his political goal, he also used the name of the God as a magic stick. Kapilendradeva wanted to maintain peace and tranquility throughout the empire. Though he was constantly busy with warfare, he desired that his people should live happily. It is needless to say that his reign period created several mile-stones in the annals of Odishan history.

1.1.5. Political history of Purusottamadeva (1467 - 1497 A.D.)

Purusottamadeva was a unique personality among the Suryavamsi Gajapati kings of Odisha. His success, in its varied aspects, was multi-dimensional, original and effective. His assumption of power in 1467 A.D. by the 'Will of God Jagannath' as Kapilendradeva had pointed out, marked a fratricidal war with Hamvira, his older brother. During the period of Kapilendradeva, his eldest son Hamvira had accompanied him in almost all his expeditions and brought laurel to the former. His claim to the throne was set aside by Kapilendra, perhaps, due to the persuasion of the mother of Purusottama who was a *Phula-Vivahi* wife (a position between queens and concubines) of Kapilendradeva. Since the legitimate claim of Hamvira to the throne of Odisha was relegated to back-ground, he proceeded to settle his score with Purusottamadeva.

As per the accounts of Ferishta, Hamvira, in association with the Bahamani king Muhammad Shah III attacked the Gajapati kingdom in the south. Muhammad Shah had sent Malika Hussain Bheiry on his behalf to help Hamvira in the campaign. Hamvira occupied Kondapalli and then proceeded to Cuttack and defeated Purusottamadeva. Hamvira was placed as the Gajapati on the throne of Odisha. Taking Ferishta's accounts into consideration and also taking into consideration the version of the S*aravati Vilasa*, Subrarnanyam supports this fact because from 1472 to 1476 A.D. no inscription of Purusottamadeva is found in any part of Odisha. He further states that Hamvira drove away his brother Purusottama to forest and occupied the throne. When he failed to receive any assistance from the Bahamani Sultan for the outbreak of a great famine in the Bahamani kingdom, he had to compromise with his younger brother Purusottama. Prof. R. D. Banerjee and K.C. Panigrahi do not agree with Dr. Subramanyam's view and reject the Muslim accounts of Ferishta. Prof. Panigrahi says that there is no source from 1472 A.D. to 1476 A.D. to show Hamvira's rule in Odisha. Further, as Hamvira enthroned himself as the Gajapati king of Odisha, what was his necessity to receive help from Bahamani Sultan for maintenance of his position when he had already driven away Purusottamadeva to the forest?

However, the views of Prof. Banerjee and Prof. Panigrahi cannot be accepted on three grounds. First thing, why there is no evidence to support the rule of Hamvira? It is, perhaps, due to the fact that after reassuming the throne Purusottamadeva, through his sincere efforts, might have obliterated all the evidences associated with the reign period of Hamvira, Secondly, as the people of Odisha had tremendous faith on God Jagannath, they ventured not to mention anything about Hamvira who had a legitimate claim over Odisha as Purusottama was declared Gajapati by the will of Lord Jagannath. Thirdly, when Harnvira felt that he would not receive the support of the people of Odisha due to their fear to God Jagannath, he thought it prudent to compromise with his brother. Of course, he did it when he was defeated at the hands of Purusottama and the latter also allowed Hamvira to rule over Khimindi as a vassal. Perhaps, Purusottama never wanted, to reflect his discomfiture at the hands of Hamvira or the latter's defeat at his hand· as both the facts were correlated. In the genealogical list of the Suryavamsis given.by Raghudeva Narendra in the copper plate grant, the name of Hamvira does not figure. Perhaps, right from the days of Purusottamadeva, there was sincere and deliberate attempt to ignore the name of Hamvira from the pedigree of Kapilendradeva, the founder of the Suryavamsi Gajapati rule in Odisha.

1.1.5.1. Recovery of Kondavidu and Rajahmundry

Taking an opportunity of the civil war that took place between Purusottamadeva and Hamvira, Saluva Narasimha had occupied a large slice of Odishan territory extending his sway as far as Masulipatam, in the north sometimes before 1476 A.D. Meanwhile, Sultan Muhammad Shah III of Bahamani had conquered Rajahmundry and Kondapalli. When Purusottamadeva marched towards Rajahmundry, the fort of Kondavidu was already in possession of the Sultan of Bahamani. As per the accounts of Ferishta, Purusottama had to sue for peace with the Sultan being unable to recover the fort and offered 25 elephants to the Sultan as a token of friendship.

After the expulsion of Odishan army from Rajahmundry and Kondavidu, the Sultan of Bahamani placed Muslim governors there and when wanted to take revenge upon Saluva Narasimha who was a silent spectator when Purusottama was marching to cross sword with him. After suppressing a revolt at Kondavidu, when Muhammad Shah III was encamping at Malur, he got a forged letter of Nizam-UI-Mulk Hassan Bahry showing that Mahmud Gawan, his trusted general and well-wisher of Bahamani Sultan had asked the help of Purusottamadeva against him. At this, he became furious and ordered to execute Mahmud Gawan which was immediately

obeyed after his death, the plot was unearthed and out of grief, the Sultan died in 1482 A.D. leaving the empire with chaos and confusion. The accession of Mahmud Shah to the throne of Bahamani kingdom who was only twelve years old, provided an opportunity to Purusottama to recover the lost territories in the South. Taking advantage of the Mal-administration of Bahamani, Purusottama fished in that troubled water and easily conquered Rajahmundry and Kondavidu early in 1484 A.D.

1.1.5.2. Recovery of Udayagiri-rajya

After consolidating his power in the entire Krishna Godavari delta, Purusottama aimed at the occupation of *Udayagiri-rajya* which was under the possession of Odisha under Kapilendradeva and that had been occupied by Saluva Narasimha during the civil war between Hamvira and Purusottama with which, the latter was grossly entangled. Now, Purusottama, with his army, marched to Udayagiri, defeated and imprisoned Saluva Narasimha who purchased his freedom by surrendering Udayagiri and offering his daughter to Purusottama who is associated with 'Kanchi-Kaveri legend'. Though, no definite date or year is known about the occupation of Udayagiri, but with tolerable degree of certainty. It can be stated that the task was accomplished sometimes before 1489-90 A.D. The Sanskrit epic *Prabodhachandrodaya* refers to the fact that in the conquest of Udayagiri Purusottamadeva was helped by Vira Vasava or Basavabhupati. Further, the *Sarasvati Vilasam* narrates that Saluva Narasimha was captured alive in the battle and he purchased peace by surrendrening Udayagiri-rajya to Purusottarnadeva.

After the conquest of Udayagiri, Purusottamadeva is never seen in the war-field. He tried to bring peace inside his kingdom by performing religious and constructive works. He spent his time with the company of eminent scholars. Purusottamadeva died in 1497 A.D.

1.1.5.3. Padmavati episode

The Padmavati episode or Kanchi-Kaveri legend is a romantic episode among the people of Odisha till to-day. According to this tradition, King Purusottama wanted to marry Padmavati, the daughter of Saluva Narasimha, the ruler of Kanchi. Although, Saluva Narasimha had given his consent for the marriage but his visit to Puri and observation of the work of Purusottama who performed *Chherapahanra* (sweeping away the dirts before the cars of Gods with golden broom during car-festival) led the former to deny the marriage proposal of his daughter with the latter. This infuriated Purusottamadeva who led an expendition to Kanchi but was defeated at the hands of Saluva Narasimha. This led the king to fall at the feet of God Jagannath who told the former in

a dream to march towards the Kanchi for the second time and in that expedition success was bound to kiss the feet of Purusottama. Surcharged with enthusiasm, Purusottamadeva marched towards the south. While proceeding with galloping march, he had to take a halt on the bank of Chilka lake at the prayer of Manika, a milk-maid. She narrated the fact that two young soldiers of the king, one dark and the other fair complexioned, riding black and white horses respectively ate all the curd from her pot. When she asked for payment, they presented her a ring saying that the Gajapati of Odisha who was about to come on that way, would make payment to the milk-maid on their behalf. King Purusottama looked at the ring and knew that it was of God Jagannath. His eyes were filled up with tears of joy who established a village near the lake named Manikapatana after the name of the milk-maid. As is apparent, the king of Kanchi was defeated and Purusottama forcibly brought Padmavati to Odisha. He instructed his minister that the princess would be given in marriage to a *Chandala* (lower-born) so that his anger would be pacified. The clever minister of the king waited for an appropriate opportunity. At the time of the car festival, Padmavati garlanded Purusottamadeva by instruction of the minister, when the king was performing the work of a *Chandala i.e.Chhera pahanra.* The king had no alternative but to accept Padmavati as his queen. This legend has been accepted by many scholars as a historical truth. However, a few scholars also reject the legend. Almost all the scholars accept Saluva Narasimha as the ruler of Kanchi. Of course, Chandragiri was the base of Saluva's political power and it remained under the Vijayanagara empire. There was no place named Kanchi upon which Saluva Narasimha held his sway. Prof. K. C. Panigrahi states that Chandragiri was a sacred place. In cultural activities, it was so famous that it assumed the name Kanchi after the capital of the Pallavas. To justify his stand, Prof. Panigrahi says that as Kapiiendradeva conquered Bidar, the capital of Bahamani and called himself as *'Kalavargesvara'*, similarly, Chandragiri would have taken the place of Kanchi.

Prof. Panigrahi, while accepting the historicity of the Padmavati episode, cites *Sarasvati vilasam* where the name of Prataparaudra's mother appears as Rupamvika. He further says that perhaps, the name of Saluva Narasimha's daughter was Rupamvika which was changed into Padmini or Padmavati after her marriage following the tradition of the change of bride's name after marriage by the family members of the groom which is prevalent in Odisha and other parts of the country too. Here, again attention can be drawn towards the institution of *Chherapahanra.* Some scholars are of the opinion that it was introduced by Purusottamadeva in order to

demonstrate his boundless devotion for the throne of Jagannath. He exploited the situation whose creator was his father Kapiiendradeva. Since, the choice of Purusottama by Kapilendra to the throne of Odisha was illegal, Purusottama wanted to legalize it by showing his greater devotion to God Jagannath who had already occupied a unique position in the mind and heart of the people of Odisha. However, this enumeration is to be taken with a pinch of salt.

It is a fact that Purusottama had framed this story through the priests of the temple. The scene of the encounter of God Jagannath and Balarama with Manika, the milk-maid with a pot has been depicted in the *Jagamohana* of the temple of God Jagannath. That scene might have been utilised by the Brahmins to mobilise the pilgrims in favour of Purusottama who held the Brahmins with high esteem. On the other hand, it can alternatively be suggested that Purusottama might not be the creator of the institution of *Chherapahanra.* It might have been instituted by his father Kapiiendradeva. As Kapilendra was an usurper to the throne of the Gangas, he might have started this tradition of *Chherapahanra* in order to efface the bitter memory from the mind of the Odishan people in the light of the Ganga theory of kingship that made the king a subordinate to God Jagannath. This tradition which had, perhaps, not been highlighted during the reign of Kapilendradeva, was fully capitalised by Purusottamadeva. Later on, it was popularised by the Odia poets and writers.

Prof. K. C. Panigrahi, in his much controversial book *Sarala Sahityara Aitihasika Chitra* written in Odia correlates the Kanchi-Kaveri legend with *Surekha-harana* episode of the Odia *Mahabharata* which is fantastic and superfluous. Here, a simple question can be asked. When was the *Sarala Mahabharata* composed? It is definitely during the reign period of Kapilendradeva. So how this Kanchi-Kaveri legend be related with the episode of *Surekha harana* by poet Saraladasa who composed the *Mahabharata* during the reign of Kapilendradeva ? Could the poet visualise the future activities of Purusottamadeva from a distant past? Keeping all these facts in mind, as an impartial observer it can be stated that the romantic Padmavati episode is not a historical fact. Purusottamadeva had framed it through the priests of the Puri temple (or through Brahmins) to legitimatise his position as his father Kapilendradeva had ignored the claims of his eldest son Hamvira. The episode, undoubtedly, gave a subordinate position to Purusottama in relation to the God and Brahmins but however, it was an impending necessity on the part of the king to stabilise his position on the throne of the Gajapati Kings of Odisha.

1.1.5.4. Estimate of Purusottamadeva

To estimate Purusottamadeva, as envisaged, he was a great diplomat. Immediately after his accession, he abolished *Chaukidari tax* which was imposed previously on the Brahmins. He also renewed old grants to them as is evidenced from his Jagannath temple inscription. He capitalised the favour of his father Kapilendradeva, the divine blessings of God Jagannath and the sympathy of the Brahmins to legitimatise his position on the Suryavamsi throne. Like his father Kapilendradeva, Purusottama was an opportunist. Taking the weakness of the Bahamani Kingdom, he attacked it and recovered the lost Rajahmundry region and Kondavidu fort. He also recovered *Udayagiri-rajya* from Saluva Narasimha.

During his reign, the boundary of Odisha did not expand. He was not a hero of the first rate calibre like his father Kapilendradeva. As an administrator, Purusottama was a liberal man. His reign was peaceful which created circumstances for the growth of Odia literature. There was no attack, either from the North or South on Odishan Empire during his reign. This, undoubtedly, brought happiness to his subjects who breathed a fresh air of peace and tranquility. Though there was initially trouble at the time his accession owing to the revolt of Hamvira but very soon, Purusottama diplomatically solved the problem and brought normalcy inside his empire. Purusottamadeva was a patron of literature.

He was a great Sanskrit scholar. The two Sanskrit lexicons- *Haravali* and *Trikandasesam* are ascribed to him. Prof. P. Mukherjee informs that these lexicons were quoted by the lexicographer Vandaghatiya Sarvananda in his *Tika Sarvasva.* Purusottama is credited with the composition of abhmava *Gitagovinda* and *Namamalika.* Besides, *Chaininka Chakada Pustaka* by Fakir Chaini, Arjuna Dasa's *Kalpalata* and *Ramavibhaha,* Damodara's *Rasakoili Chautisa* were some notable works in Odia that belonged to his reign period.

Like his father, Purusottamadeva was a builder too. According to tradition, Purusottamadeva built the temple of Sundara Madhava at Purusottamapur in the Ganjam district. During his reign period, Tamma Raya, one of his vassals installed an image of Gopala Krishna at Udayagiri which Krishnadevaraya had taken away to Vijayanagara after his conquest on Udayagiri-rajya. Purusottamadeva was a pious man. Besides giving grant to the Brahmins, he also made arrangements for new provisions in the Jagannath temple. He made gifts for the personal enjoyment and stage entertainments of the Siva deity at Potavara. He gave away the revenue of a village to meet the expenses of offerings to the Simmachalam temple.

Thus, Purusottamadeva was a noble ruler. His reign period witnessed peace and stability in the Gajapati empire.

1.1.6. Pratarudradeva (1497 -1540 A.D.)

Prataparudradeva ascended the throne after the death his father Purusottarnadeva He was the last Gajapati ruler in the realm. Though, he was warrior of superb caliber but misfortune encompassed him time and again. Thus, he became a stupendous failure as a ruler paving way for the decline of the Gajapati rule in medieval Odisha.

1.1.6.1. Early South Indian Expeditions

The Anantavaram and Rajavolu plates together testify to the fact that by 1500- 1501 A.D. Prataparudra had encamped on the banks of river Krishna. Perhaps, he was thinking to invade the Vijayanagara Empire. His Anantavaram plate dated 1500 A.D. states: *Yatram Dakshina-digvijayaya Vidadhat Samprapya Krishnatatim.* After the death of Saluva Narasimha in 1419 AD., Narasa Nayaka had become the virtual ruler of that empire. When Prataparudra was measuring the strength of Narasa Nayaka, the covetous glance of Ala-ud-Din Abul Muzaffar Hussain Shah, the Sultan of Bengal over Odisha compelled him to return to his capital.

With the death of Narasa Nayaka, his son Vira Narasimha succeeded his father as the regent, who expelled Immadi Narasimha, the son of Saluva Narasimha from the throne in 1505 AD. and became the founder of Tuluva dynasty in Vijayanagara. He breathed his last in 1509 AD. and was succeeded by Krishnadevaraya, the greatest among the rulers of the Vijayanagar empire. His accession lifted Prataparudra from lethargy who led his second expedition to the South. The work *Rayavachakamu*, an inscription at Tangeda (in the Guntur district) and the Gundapalam copper plates suggest that Prataparudra waited on the river bank of Krishna till 1510 AD. and ventured not to attack the Vijayanagara empire. Again, he had to retreat to his capital to deal with Hussain Shah of Bengal.

1.1.6.2. War with Hussain Shah

When Prataparudra was encamping in the distant South, Hussain Shah was trying to cross the border. A clash between the Odishan army and that of Bengal took place. The upada grant and Velicherla plates of Prataparudradeva testify to the fact. Hussain Shah increased his army and around 1510 A.D. invaded Odisha. The *Tabaqat-i-Akbari* informs that Hussain Shah conquered the country up to Odisha and levied tribute upon the subjects. The *Madala Panji* states that

Amura (Amir) *Surathana (Sultan),* the *Patisa* (Badshah) of Gauda marched upto Puri and destroyed the images of God Jagannath, Balabhadra and Subhadra.

It further informs that on hearing the advance of the Sultan, Prataparudra marched back to Odisha in haste and inflicted a crushing defeat upon the invader pushing him back up to Bengal. Out of fear, Hussain Shah entered into the fort of Mandaran and the fort was besieged by the Gajapati. At this juncture, his able and trusted general Govinda Vidyadhara played treachery and joined the Muslim Camp. This led Prataparudradeva to retreat without subduing Hussain Shah.

1.1.6.2. Krishnadevaraya's invasion of Odisha

Krishnadevaraya first attacked Udayagiri in 1512 A. D. He besieged the fort with his strong army. That fort was a great strong-hold of the Odishan army in the South. Being unable to make his entry into the fort, the emperor prepared new routes through stones and his army entered into the fort. The Udayagiri fort was captured at least in 1513 A.D. and Tirumala Routaraya, the uncle of Prataparudradeva was made captive. Krishnadevaraya, then focused his attention on the Kondavrdu fort which was another stronghold of Prataparudra in the South. Saluva Timma was appointed on behalf of Krishnadevaraya to carry on the operation. Saluva Timma besieged the fort of Kondavidu. The *Amuktamalyada* states that the Odia soldiers who were inside the fort of Kondavidu "went to heaven without any wounds in their bodies." This fact has also been corroborated by the Mangalagiri pillar inscription. The narration of both the sources are indirect and an observation on it can be made in this way that being besieged by the soldiers of Krishnadevaraya, the Odia soldiers inside the fort of Kondavidu met their end by starvation and lack of water. This led to the fall of Kondavidu in 1515 A.D.

The Amaravati, Tiruvannamalai and Kalahasti inscriptions of Krishnadevaraya with the accounts of Nuniz provide with a list of important persons captured during the siege of the Kondavidu fort. Among them were Balachandra Mohapatra, Narahari Patra, Mallu Khan, Udanda Khan and last but not least, Virabhadra, the valiant son of Prataparudradeva. In the meanwhile, the forces of Krishnadevaraya also occupied other minor fortresses of the region like Addanki, Vinukonda, Bellamakonda, Nagarjuna Konda, Tangenda and Ketavaram. The next target of Krishnadevaraya was Kondapalli. This was the last attempt of the Odia soldiers to check the progress of Krishnadevaraya. Praharesvara Patra, the commandant of this fort, fought with the army of Vijayanagara Empire but was defeated. From the Kalahasti inscription, it is

known that from the side of the Odias Sirsachandra Mahapatra, Bijili Khan and Bodhan Mahapatra were taken as captives. Nuniz informs that during the capitulation of Kondapalli, a queen of Prataparudradeva was taken as a captive by krishnadevaraya which has been rejected by almost all the scholars in the absence of any other corroborative evidence. Of course, Prataparudra tried to check the progress of Krishnadevaraya but he was defeated repeatedly at the hands of the latter. Prataparudradeva proceeded back towards his capital Cuttack to assemble fresh army to deal with Krishnadevaraya.

Finding no opposition, Krishnadevaraya proceeded towards Odisha and reached Simhachalam. There he planted the pillar of victory. Though he sent news to prataparudra to meet him, the latter did not turn up. The *Amuktama/yada* and *Manucharita* inform that Krishnadevaraya proceeded to Puri, worshipped the Gods, marched towards Cuttack, burnt the capital and inflicted a crushing defeat upon the Gajapati of Odisha. Why Prataparudradeva did not turn up to fight against Krishnadevaraya. It was only because the death of his valiant son Virabhadra due to the disgrace (as Virabhadra was directed by Krishnadevaraya to display sword-fighting with a man who was not of noble birth) in the court of the Vijayanagara empire. This weakened the strength of his mind and conquering zeal and he had no alternative but to conclude peace with Krishnadevaraya by giving his own daughter Jagamohini (Tukka) to the latter. As a result of this peace treaty, river Krishna was marked as the line of demarcation between Vljayanagara empire and that of Prataparudradeva. Being weak in mind due to the death of Virabhadra and the miserable fate of his daughter, he found panacea in Vaisnavism and became an ardent follower of Sri Chaitanya. He breathed his last in 1540 A.D. His death paved the way for the downfall of medieval Odisha. Of course, Prataparudradeva had marched with his army to the Vijayanagara empire after the death of Krishnadevaraya in 1529 but sustained defeat at the hands of Achyutadeva and never marched again to that land till his death.

1.1.6.3. Quli Qutb Shah's invasion of Odisha

When Prataparudradeva became weak after the reverses at the hands of Krishnadevaraya, Quli Qutb Shah, a general of Sultan Mahmud Shah of Baharnani kingdom who had carved out an independent kingdom at Golkunda, invaded the southern province of Odisha. Though Prataparudra was weak and feeble, still then he marched towards the South and by the help of his army, defeated Quli Qutb Shah and drove him back to Golkunda. On this occasion, he built the

temple of Mangalagiri on the bank of river Krishna. Prataparudradeva led a painful life till his death in 1540 A.D.

1.1.6.4. Estimate of Prataparudradeva

To evaluate the achievements of Prataparudradeva, it can be stated that undoubtedly, he was a military genius. He had displayed it for many a times e.g. in dealing with Sultan Hussain Shah of Bengal and Quli Qutb Shah of Golkunda. No doubt, he was a failure in waging wars with Krishnadevaraya who was an apt warrior of that time. As shown above, different circumstances weakened the strength of his mind and brought military debacles to his career. Prataparudradeva was a great builder.

The *Madala Panji* informs that he built the audience hall of the Jagannath temple at Puri. As per the popular tradition, he built the temple of Chandrasekhara on the Kapilasa hill in the Dhenkanal district. He was also instrumental of renovating the temple of Varaha at Viraja in the Jajpur district. He also constructed the temple of Dhavalesvara near village Mancheswar in Cuttack District.

Sanskrit language received the patronage of Prataparudradeva. In the Undavaill inscription, he is called the master of all arts and the repository of sixty-four kinds of learning. The Velicherla plate describes that Prataparudradeva assumed the title *Vidyanidhi.* His *Sarasvativilasam* is a famous law *(Vyavahara)* book of the Hindus. However, its authorship is doubtful and scholars give credit to Lalla Laxmidhar, one of the court poets of Prataparudra who wrote commentary on *Saundarya Lahari.* Sarvabhauma, who was originally hailed from Navadvipa, wrote a commentary on Laxmidhara's *Advaita-makaranda.* Jivadeva was a poet patronised by Prataparudradeva who composed the *Bhakti Bhagavata.* Ramananda Raya wrote the *Jagannatha Vallabha Natakam.* Paramananda Sena *'Kavikamapura'* who wrote a Kavya entitled *Chaitanya Charitamrita* for the consolation of Prataparudradeva who was sticken with grief after the passing away of Sri Chaitanya. Besides, Sanskrit scholars like Markandeya, Ramakrishna Bhatta. Balabhadra Mishra and several others flourished in Odisha during his life time.

The Renaissance in Odia literature reached its zenith during the reign of Prataparudradeva. That age in Odia literature was famous as the 'Age of *Panchasakhas'*. The five celebrities were Balarama Dasa, Jagannatha Dasa, Ananta Dasa, Achyutananda Dasa and Yosobanta Dasa who flourished during the reign of Prataparudradeva. They were famous for

their immortal creations in Odia literature (discussed in the forthcoming pages). Chaitanya Dasa, Arjuna Dasa, Kanhai Khuntia and Madhaba Pattanayaka were other famous poets during this period. Besides patronising the poets and men of letters, Prataparudra was famous for his liberalism. He generously offered gifts to different deities related with Vaisnava, Saiva and other cults. This shows his religious catholicity. He was a lover of peace and his administration was marked with tranquility prevalent throughout his empire. No doubt, Prataparudradeva paved the way for the decline of medieval Odisha, but his reign period was maked with a tremendous growth of both Sanskrit and Odia literature and progress of Vaisnavism in Odisha.

1.1.7. Conclusion

Thus, the rule of Suryavamsi Gajapatis started with the rule of Kapilendradeva. He was a great military genious. After centuries of military inactivity, he brought Odisha into the chess board of Indian politics. He took the pompous title like *'Gajapati Gaudesvara Navakoti Karnata Kalavargesvara'*. Besides that he himself was a man of literature and a great patron of poets. On the other hand, Purusottamadeva was a great diplomat. During his reign, the boundary of Odisha did not expand. As an administrator, Purusottama was a liberal man. His reign was peaceful which created circumstances for the growth of Odia literature. However, during the rule of Prataprudradeva, the imperial greatness of Odisha, built by Kapilendradeva and maintained by Purusottamadeva was lost. Due to the appearance of Sri Chaitanya and the Panchasakhas, the people of Odisha lost their military tactics which opened the path for the decline of Gajapati dynasty.

1.1.8. Summary

- The Ganga dynasty was followed by the establishment of the rule of another glorious dynasty known as the Suryavamsi Gajapatis.
- For personal glorification, the rulers of this dynasty claimed their descent from the mythical solar dynasty to which Lord Ramachandra belonged.
- As they possessed large elephantry in their army, they were popularly known as Gajapatis, i.e. the lords of the elephants.
- The history of Suryavamsi Gajapatis of Odisha is based on (1) Literary sources , and (2) Inscriptions.
- The political history of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis started with Kapilendradeva who ascended the throne in 1435 A.D.
- Just after his accession in 1435 AD., he found the throne of Odisha as full of problems.

- In the South, the Reddi rulers of Rajahmumdry were extending their frontiers further north. Form the North, the country was threatened by the Sultan of Bengal.
- The distant Malwa also tried to take advantage of the revolution of local chiefs and feudatories to acknowledge the suzerainty of Kapilendradeva.
- Kapilendradeva introduced 'Kapilabda' in the 7th year of his rule.
- Kapilendra had won victory over Bengal or Gauda, Rajahmundry, Kondavidu, etc.
- He breathed his last most probably in 1466-67 A.D.
- He was a great military genious, an accomplished scholar, patron of learning and literature and a great builder.
- Purusottamadeva was a unique personality among the Suryavamsi Gajapati kings of Odisha.
- His assumption of power in 1467 A.D. by the 'Will of God Jagannath' as Kapilendradeva had pointed out, marked a fratricidal war with Hamvira, his older brother.
- Taking an opportunity of the civil war that took place between Purusottamadeva and Hamvira, Saluva Narasimha had occupied a large slice of Odishan territory extending his sway as far as Masulipatam, in the north sometimes before 1476 A.D.
- Taking advantage of the Mal-administration of Bahamani, Purusottama fished in that troubled water and easily conquered Rajahmundry and Kondavidu early in 1484 A.D.
- Purusottama, with his army, marched to Udayagiri, defeated and imprisoned Saluva Narasimha who purchased his freedom by surrendering Udayagiri and offering his daughter to Purusottama who is associated with 'Kanchi-Kaveri legend'.
- It can be stated that the task was accomplished sometimes before 1489-90 A.D.
- Prataparudradeva ascended the throne after the death his father Purusottarnadeva
- He was the last Gajapati ruler in the realm.
- The Anantavaram and Rajavolu plates together testify to the fact that by 1500- 1501 A.D. Prataparudra had encamped on the banks of river Krishna.
- When Prataparudra was encamping in the distant South, Hussain Shah was trying to cross the border. A clash between the Odishan army and that of Bengal took place.
- Krishnadevaraya first attacked Udayagiri in 1512 A. D. He besieged the fort with his strong army.
- When Prataparudradeva became weak after the reverses at the hands of Krishnadevaraya, Quli Qutb Shah, a general of Sultan Mahmud Shah of Baharnani kingdom who had

carved out an independent kingdom at Golkunda, invaded the southern province of Odisha.

- Prataparudradeva led a painful life till his death in 1540 A.D.
- No doubt, Prataparudradeva paved the way for the decline of medieval Odisha, but his reign period was maked with a tremendous growth of both Sanskrit and Odia literature and progress of Vaisnavism in Odisha.

1.1.9. Exercise

- **Write a note on the political history of Kapilendra Deva.**
- **Give an account on the wars and conquests of Kapilendra Deva.**
- **Highlight the achievements of Purusottama Deva.**
- **Discuss the political history of Gajapatis under the rule of Prataprudra Deva.**
- **Explain how Prataprudra Deva was responsible for the decline of medieval Odisha?**
- **Discuss the growth of Odia literature during the Gajapati rule.**

1.1.10. Further Reading

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Unit-1

Chapter-II

Suryavamsi Administration

Structure

1.2.0. Objectives

1.2.1. Introduction

1.2.2. Suryavamsi Administration

1.2.2.1. The theory of Kingship

1.2.2.2. Council of Ministers

1.2.2.3. Land revenue

1.2.2.4. Military organization of the Gajapati rulers

1.2.2.5. The size of the Gajapati army

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1.2.3. Conclusion

1.2.3. Summary

1.2.3. Exercise

1.2.3. Further reading

1.2.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students investigate about the Suryavamsi administration*. After studying this lesson you will be able to:*

- *to learn the theory of kingship;*
- *to analyze the council of ministers;*
- *to investigate the military organization of the Gajapatis;*
- *to trace the forts existed during the Gajapati rule.*

1.2.1.Introduction

The Vast empire of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis extended from the river bank of the Ganges to that of Godavari. The capital of this vast empire was Kataka-Pattana (Cuttack) which was known during the glorious days of the Gangas as Abhinava Varanasi Kataka. The second citadel of the Gajapati power was Kruttivasa Kataka (Bhubaneswar) where Kapilendradeva had been coronated. In order to give stability to the vast empire, the Gajapati rulers had given a good administration.

1.2.2.Suryavamsi Administration

The Suravamsi Gajapatis had given a benevolent administration to their subjects which can be discussed as follows.

1.2.2.1. The theory of Kingship

The Suravamsi Gajapatis had given a benevolent administration to their subjects When the feudatories became disobedient to him Kapilendra went to the temple of Lord Jagannatha and engraved an order on the *Jagamohana* invoking the name of Jagannatha and declaring that the chiefs revolting against him, would actually rebel against this great deity.

From the reign of Kapilendra the Suryavamsi kings assumed high-sounding titles such as *Maharajadhiraja, Paramesvara, Gajapati, Gaudesvara, Navakoti Karnataka Kalavargesvara* etc. Kapilendra first assumed these titles after his conquests in Bengal, the Bahamani kingdom and the Vijayanagara empire and all these titles were continued by his son and grandson and even by the Bhoi rulers.

1.2.2.2. Council of Ministers

The king was assisted by a good number of ministers and officers in discharging his duty. Some of them were the *amatyas* (ministers), *Mantri sreni siromani* (Head of the ministers), *Sandhivigrahi* (Minister of war and peace), *Sena-narendra* (Chief of the army), *Vahinipati*

(Leader of the contingent), *Rautaraya* (Captain of the army), *Kathaghara, Samantaraya. Pariksha* (Secretary for treasury), *Mudra Hasta* (Seal bearer). *Budha Lenka* (Chief priest of the temple of God Jagannath). *Srikarana* (writer of accounts) etc.

1.2.2.3. Land revenue

The land revenue system of the Gajapati period was well developed. The land was measured and accordingly tax assessment was made. The *Guntha* (20 Cubits square). *Mana* (25 *Gunthas)* and *Bati* (20 *Manas)* denoted different units of land. The crown lands were divided into *Khanda* or *Bisi* under two hereditary officers like *Khandadhipati* or *Bisayee* respectively. To facilitate revenue collection from the village, the king appointed its headman like *pradhan* or *Bhai.* The revenue officers in the south were called as the *Nayaka* and *Naidu.* At the time of natural calamities, the peasants were assisted by the state with seeds to carryon their cultivation.

1.2.2.4. Military organization of the Gajapati rulers

A strong military organisation was an indispensible concomitant of a strong state, which was necessary both for its protection and expansion. The Gajapati kings like that of the Gangas were famous for their military organisation. The Suryavamsi records however enable us to form a clear picture of their military organisations. The Suryavamsis inherited from the Gangas a well-organised military system which was improved upon and made a very strong force that accounted for their success in building up an empire. In the reign of Kapilendradeva Odisha was virtually made a military state and all the castes and communities were called upon to render military service at the time of emergency. The Brahmins seems to have been exempted from a compulsory military service, but even then some Brahmins entered into the army as big and small officers. If the *Madalapanji* is to be believed, the traitor Vasudeva Ratha, a Brahmin, was the commander-in-chief of the last Somavamsi king and it is through his treachery that Chodaganga succeeded in conquering Odisha. In the Chatesvara Inscription Vishnu, the Brahmin minister of Anangabhimadeva HI (A.D. 1211-1238), is represented to have led an army against the Kalachuris of Ratnapura and to have succeeded in wresting the Sonepur tract from them. In the Gopinathapura Stone' Inscription Gopinatha Mahapatra is represented to have been a Brahmin minister and general of Kapilendradeva. From these evidences it is clear that Brahmins also occupied high posts in the army, though they, as a rule, were exempted from compulsory military service. The other castes had no option but to serve in the military organisation as officers and soldiers.

As is apparent from Sarala Dasa's *Mahabharata,* which, as we have seen, was composed in the reign of Kapilendra, a belief was created in the minds of the Oriyas that dying in the battle field was the surest way to go to the heaven. To die in the battle field with weapons in hands, has been considered by the poet to be a most religious and meritorious act, which, according to him, provides for the person so dying a secure place in the heaven and exempts him, from the serious sins committed in this world. In the *Sabha Parva* Narada tells Sri Krishna the ways with which a man killing a Brahmin can escape from this terrible sin, and prescribes *inter alia* death in the battle field while fighting with weapons in hands. The poet lays great emphasis on the necessity begetting male children and has nothing to say about the necessity from female ones. The birth of a son was a joyous occasion which he has sometimes described in detail, but has ignored the occasions of the birth of daughters. According to him a wife without male children is unlucky and inauspicious and for her he prescribes in the *Adi Parva* of his *Mahabharata* eight ways for begetting sons. Since a very large number of young men were required for the army and many of them were losing their lives in the battle field, we can easily understand the poet's partiality for male children and his anxiety for increasing the male population. The protection of the state and its expansion were the joint responsibilities of the entire population and not of the king alone. Militarism penetrated into all ranks of the society and all able-bodied persons were called upon to perform military service. The king had a standing army, but the number of the local militia was far greater than the number of the soldiers in the standing army. Besides, the feudal lords also supplied to the king a stipulated number of soldiers at the time of war and had to fight for him in the battle field.

A vast number of the Oriyas and even the Adivasis and Harijans still bear military titles which their ancestors must have received from the Gajapatis. It seems that, even though some people did not actually serve in the army, they received honorary military titles from the monarch for helping him in some way or other in perfecting his military organisation. Among the local militia the vast majority were cultivators who took to cultivation at the time of peace and turned into soldiers at the time of war. A rough survey indicates that about fifty percent of the people of Odisha still bear military titles, of which a few examples are cited below: *Senapati, Chamupati* (Champati), *Routaraya* (the commander of the cavalry), *Sahani* (the commander of the elephant force), *Dandapata, Dandasena, Paschime Kava te, Uttara Kavata* etc. (the guardians of the marches), *Samantaraya, Vidyadhara, Bhramaravara, Harichandana,*

Jagaddeva, Marddaraja, Samantasimhara, Raya Simha, Manasimha, Valiyarasimha, Pahadasimha, Nayaka, Pattanayaka, Dandanayaka, Gadanayaka, Petre, Mahapatra, Behera, Da/abehera, Jena, Badajena, Pradhana, Sama/a, Rauta, Khuntia, Parichha, Parija, Padhihari, Dandapani etc. Sarala Dasa's *Mahabharata* also gives us an idea about the different divisions of the Gajapati army on march. The first division was known as the *Hantakaru Da/a* Le., the pioneer force clearing jungles and making roads; the second was known as the *Aguani Thata* i.e., the advance units; the third was *Pradhana Vala* i.e., the main army and the fourth division was *Pachhiani Thata* i.e., the rear guards. The king and the big military officers were furnished with bodyguards who were known as *Angavalas;* and the detachments which were placed in charge of the captured forts and conquered territories, were known as *Paridandas.*

Sarala Dasa also gives us a picture of an army on the move, in which flags and other decorative devices were used and the musical instruments such as *Damalu, Dadama Tamaka, Bijighosa, Daundi, Ghumura, Bheri, Turi, Ranasinga* etc. were sounded. The weapons used have been given as *Dhanu, Trona, Sara, Asi Parigha, Patiisa, Kunta, Jathi, Guruja, Saveli* etc. The above few facts are gleaned from Sarala Dasa's *Mahabharata* which is not a historical work, but though these facts occur in connection with the fights among different characters of his *Mahabharata,* we may be sure that in making such references he was merely drawing upon his own knowledge and experience gained in actual wars. From the poet's description we also gather that the gateways and the walls of the forts used to be breached with the help of horses, elephants, crow-bars and shovels.

1.2.2.5. The size of the Gajapati army

About the size of the Gajapati army different sources give us different accounts which may not represent the actual number of men and animals employed in it. The Muslim sources have sometimes exaggerated or sometimes belittled its number. In the *Burhan-i-Ma'rtasir* it is stated that Kapilendra possessed elephants numbering two hundred thousand, which is obviously an exaggeration. Nizam-ud-din tells us that Purushottamadeva had encamped on the bank of Godavari with 7,00,000 foot soldiers. Azizullah writes that Kapilendra attacked Bidar with only ten thousand foot soldiers, which appears to be an absurdly small number. The figures given by the Portuguese writer Nuniz appear to be more reliable. He states that the king of Odisha opposed Krishnadeva Raya with an army of thirteen hundred elephants and twenty thousand

horses. "The people of Otisa" writes Nuniz "are very good fighting men." The king of Otisa has a mighty army of foot soldiers." In one section of the *Rayavachakam* an account of the teats of strength exhibited in the Gymnasia at the Capital of the Gajapati has been given. This accont was given to the Vijayanagara emperor Krishnadeva Raya by his spies, who had been employed by him for ascertaining the military strength of the Gajapati Prataparudradeva. Some southern scholars have considered the account to be an exaggerated one. Even granting that it is an exaggerated one, we have to respect the basic truth that the Oriyas of the time possessed great physical strength and were capable of showing wonderful physical feats. We reproduce below a summary of this account as given in *Further Sources of Vijayanagara* "We entered the city, and saw the palace of the Gajapati, the mansions of the sixteen *Patras,* the Gymnasia and the people who take exercises therein. Even the gods and the demons are not capable of exhibiting such skill in physical exercises as they show. Your majesty might have observed the skill in physical exercises shown by the great wrestlers of other countries; but the style of the people at the capital of the Gajapati is totally different. They alone are capable of lifting up such heavy dumb-bells. They lift them up, and what is more, they lift them up cross-wise. They raise a sack weighing *10 paddes* to the height of the uplifted arm of a standing man and throw it upon their own bodies.

Moreover, they catch the sack between their thighs, and-suspend themselves in the air taking hold of the cross-beam (ot the gymnasium). The reason for taking this exercise is this; while engaged in battle, the troopers are accustomed to carry away their opponents bodily imprisoning them between one of their arms and the body; if, however, the opponents fight without losing their hold on their steeds, they abandon their attempt, considering the opponent to be unmanageable. The riders on the armoured horses are not afraid of any wound which they might receive. They attempt to carry away under their arm such riders (?). The soldiers practise this exercise in order to remain firm courageously (in their seats) on such occasions. They completely demolish walls of hundred feet with a *rummi mattakhandam* (?) which is heavy enough to be carried by a man on his head. They also cut with that sword strong tamarind pillars as easily as they cut the pitch of the plantain trees. Planting two crowbars together on the ground they cut them to pieces with their sword.

1.2.2.6. Judicial system

Coming to the judicial system of the time, it was quite effcient in discharging its function. The criminal justice was harsh. Gopinatha Badajena, a revenue officer was tried and put on the

Chang (an instrument to give torturing death by putting a man under two swords). Similarly, Rama Patra was sentenced to death. Thus severe punishments were awarded to the criminals for committing crimes.

1.2.2.7. The provincial administration

The provincial administration under the Gajapati kings was quite efficient. The empire was divided into several provinces known as *Dandapata* or *Rajya.* The governors of such provinces were designated *Parikhas* or *Rajas.* Provinces were divided into *simas* which were further sub-divided into *sthalas* or *muthas* that consisted of some villages and the lowest unit of the provincial administration was village *(grama).*

1.2.2.8. The *Samanta Rajas*

The Gajapati empire was also divided into fragments, each under a *Samanta* or feudal lord. It is clear that feudalism was at its blooming phase during the Gajapati rule. Among the feudal lords, mention may be made of the Matsyas of Oddadi, the Suryavamsis of Nandapur, the chiefs of Panchadharala, Palkonda, Narasapur etc. This feudalism, an ugly feature of medieval period, contributed a lot for the downfall of the Suryavamsi Gajapati rule in Odisha.

1.2.2.9. The forts

The forts played a vital role in the military system of the Gajapatis. The Odishan kings occupied the old forts or established new ones in the entire stretch of their empire. In the north the great forts that were in their occupation, were Mandaran which is now known as Bhitargarh, situated in the Arambagh subdivision of the Hooghly district of West Bengal; Kotisamigarh, variously described as Kotasin, Katasin etc. which is now known as Kotsimul situated on the west bank of the river Damodara, and Raivania and Deulgoan in the Balasore district. In the Cuttack and Puri districts several forts which existed from earlier times, were also utilised during this period. They are Jajpur Kataka, Amaravati Kataka (near Chhatia), Chaudwar Kataka, Varanasi Kataka (modem Cuttack) and Chudanga Kataka or Sarangagarh near Barang. Kasiagarh, situated on the road from Chandaka to Khurda near the village Dalua, was also a great fort which was probably meant to conceal troops, in the dense forest at the time of war. Besides these big forts, there were also smaller ones which have been referred to by Abul Fazl in his *Ain-i-Akabari.* In south Odisha ancient forts of considerable importance existed at Humma, Khimidi, Chikiti, Palur, Khallikot and Athagarh. In the conquered territories of the south great forts existed at Rajahmundry, Undrakonda in the Krishna district, Kondapalli near Bezwada in the Krishna district, Adanki in

the Ongole Taluk, Vinukonda in the Vinukonda Taluk, Vellamkonda in the Sattenapalle Taluk, Nagarjunakonda on the bank of the river Krishna, Tangeda in the Palnad Taluk and Ketavarman in the Sattenapalle Taluk. In Telingana the great fort of Devarakonda, situated in the Nalgonda district, and also the famous fort of Warangal were in occupation of the feudatories of Gajapatis. But the forts of Udayagiri in Nellore district and Kondavidu near Guntur, were the strongest of all occupied by the Odishan kings. The occupations of these two great forts by Krishnadeva Raya decided the fate of the Gajapati empire in the south.

1.2.3. Conclusion

In order to give stability to the vast empire, the Gajapati rulers had given a good administration. The Suravamsi Gajapatis had given a benevolent administration to their subjects. The Suryavamsis mainly based their administration on that of the Gangas and introduced a few innovations. Kapilendra Deva could not give a good administration during his rule as he was involved in wars and conquests. It was during the rule of Purusottama Deva, the people enjoyed peace and tranquility. However, Prataprudra Deva's period saw instability due to external attack. So, good administration was not possible during his reign.

1.2.3. Summary

- The Vast empire of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis extended from the river bank of the Ganges to that of Godavari.
- In order to give stability to the vast empire, the Gajapati rulers had given a good administration.
- The Suravamsi Gajapatis had given a benevolent administration to their subjects.
- The Gajapati rulers were benevolent in nature.
- The Suryavamsis mainly based their administration on that of the Gangas and introduced a few innovations.
- The king enjoyed the supreme power in the state, but his powers were to some extent, checked by the ministers and generals and the priestly class who, as observed earliar, were the custodians of Lord Jagannatha.
- The Suryavamsi rulers also subscribed to the theocratic conception that Lord Jagannatha was the real king of Odisha and they were their deputies.

- Kapilendra, Purushottama and Prataparudra in the beginning of their reigns paid homage to this great deity and presented certain objects to him and recognized him as their overlord.
- From the reign of Kapilendra the Suryavamsi kings assumed high-sounding titles such as *Maharajadhiraja, Paramesvara, Gajapati, Gaudesvara, Navakoti Karnataka Kalavargesvara* etc.
- The king was assisted by a good number of ministers and officers in discharging his duty.
- The land revenue system of the Gajapati period was well developed.
- The Gajapati kings like that of the Gangas were famous for their military organisation.
- The Suryavamsi records however enable us to form a clear picture of their military organisations.
- Sarala Dasa's *Mahabharata* also gives us an idea about the different divisions of the Gajapati army on march.
- Sarala Dasa also gives us a picture of an army on the move, in which flags and other decorative devices were used and the musical instruments such as *Damalu, Dadama Tamaka, Bijighosa, Daundi, Ghumura, Bheri, Turi, Ranasinga* etc. were sounded.
- Coming to the judicial system of the time, it was quite effcient in discharging its function.
- The provincial administration under the Gajapati kings was quite efficient. The empire was divided into several provinces known as *Dandapata* or *Rajya.* The governors of such provinces were designated *Parikhas* or *Rajas.*
- The Gajapati empire was also divided into fragments, each under a *Samanta* or feudal lord. It is clear that feudalism was at its blooming phase during the Gajapati rule.
- The forts played a vital role in the military system of the Gajapatis.
- The Odishan kings occupied the old forts or established new ones in the entire stretch of their empire.

1.2.3. Exercise

- **Give an account on the Suryavamsi Gajapati administration.**
- **Write a note on the administration of the Gajapati king Kapilendra Deva.**

- **Highlight the administration of Purusottamsa.**

- **Discuss administration during the rule of Prataprudra Deva.**

1.2.3. Further reading

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UNIT-1
Chapter-III

The Chalukyas and Bhoi

Structure

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1.3.3. 16. Padmanavadeva (1736-1739 A.D.)
1.3.3. 17. Birakishoradeva (1739-1793 A.D.)
1.3.3. 18. Divyasimhadeva II (1793-1798)
1.3.3. 19. Mukundadeva II (1798-1817 A.D.)
1.3.3. 20. Administration
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1.3.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Chalukyas and Bhoi. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know about the successors of Suryavamsi Gajapatis*
- *understand the political history of Chalukya rulers*
- *to judge the achievements of Mukunda Deva*
- *know about the political history of Bhoi rulers*
- *evaluate the achievements and administration of the Bhoi rulers.*

1.3.1. Introduction

The dynasty established by Mukundadeva has been described as the Chalukya dynasty. It seems that he claimed his descent from the Eastern Chalukyas of Vengi, established by Pulakesin II of the famous Western Chalukya dynasty of Vadami.

1.3.2. The Chalukyas

It is usual for the ruling dynasties of Odisha to associate their origin with the famous ruling dynasties of India. Mukundadeva might have done the same after ascending the Gajapati throne. There is, however, no other independent evidence to show that he actually belonged to the Eastern Chalukya family. In his inscription on the Bhimesvara temple at Draksharama in the East Godavari district, he is described as the son of Saravaraju and grandson of Singaraju.

1.3.2. 1. Mukundadeva(A.D. 1560-1568)

Mukundadeva is considered as the last Hindu king of Odisha. In Odishan traditions Mukundadeva is known as Telinga Mukundadeva. Ferishta mentions about a feudatory dynasty known as Bahuvalendras and as Harichandanas, ruling in the Sarvasidhi taluk of the Visakhapatnam district, Mukundadeva possibly belonged to this ruling family who were originally the feudatories of the Gajapati. Mukundadeva first came into prominence by defending the fort Kataka (Cuttack) when it was besieged by Raghubhanja Chhotaraya in the reign of Govinda Vidyadhara and since then his influence in the politics of Odisha increased.

1.3.2. 2. His achievements

Mukundadeva's inscription of Draksharama, referred to above, clearly indicates that he was in possession of the southern part of the Gajapati kingdom upto the river Godavari. It states that Mukundadeva defeated the king of Gauda and then having performed *Tulapurusha* (the ceremony of weighing against gold) and other ceremonies, he remitted taxes on marriages. This inscription provides the clear evidence that Mukundadeva's kingdom extended upto Triveni in the north before 1567. A flight of steps constructed on the Ganges at Triveni (in the Hooghly district), which is still known as Mukunda-ghata, corroborates the above epigraphical evidence. Prof. R. D. Banerjee states that Mukundadeva also built a great embankment on which the road from Magra to Triveni has been laid and that there is still a considerable influence of the Oriyas at Triveni. Mukundadeva was thus a very able ruler who succeeded in preserving the prestige of the Gajapati empire to a great extent, even though he got the Gajapati throne through murder. The Odishan people still remember him with gratitude on account of the fact that he succeeded in restoring peace and prestige.

However, he became involved in the politics of Bengal, which ultimately cost him his life and throne. Very unwisely he gave shelter to Ibrahim Sur who was a great enemy of Sulaiman Karrani, the Sultan of Bengal, and thus incurred his displeasure. He further gave offence to the Sultan by exchanging embassies with the great Mughal emperor Akbar.In 1566 Akbar A.D. sent envoys to the court of Mukundadeva and Mukundadeva in exchange sent a Hindu ambassador named Paramananda Ray to the court of the Mughal emperor. In this diplomatic relations Akbar gained upper hand as his ultimate aim was to annex Bengal to his empire. For this purpose he wanted the support of the neighbouring Hindu kingdom of Odisha. He was not, however, in favour of strengthening the position of Mukundadeva as was evident from the fact that he did not give any help to the king of Odisha when he was attacked by Sulaiman Karrani.

In A.D. 1568 when Sultan of Bengal invaded Odisha Akbar was engaged in the seige of Chitor and he did not extend any help to the Odishan king probably with the object that Odisha should become a part of Bengal, so that he would ultimately annex Bengal with Odisha. Placed in this predicament, Mukundadeva was attacked by Sulaiman Karrani in A.D. 1568 who sent an expedition under the comand of his son Bayazid assisted by Sikandar Uzbeg and Kalapahara. The Bengal army marched through Dhalbhum and Mayurbhanj and emerged in the coastal strip. Mukundadeva was not prepared for the invasion and he sent Raghubhanja Chhotaraya to resist the invaders. This Raghubhanja seems to have been the same person who had been cast into

prison by Govinda Vidyadhara for claiming the Gajapati throne. He seems to have been released from the prison by Mukundadeva and sent to oppose the invading army. But he could not succeed in the mission entrusted to him and the Bengal army irresistibly reached Kataka (Cuttack). Mukundadeva had no other alternative than to submit to the invaders, as Raghubhanja seems to have turned a traitor at this stage.

Different versions have been given in our sources about the Muslim invasion of 1568. In the *Madalapanji* it is stated that Odisha was invaded by two different armies of Bengal, one of which fought against Mukundadeva on the bank of the Ganges and the other proceeded under Bayazid and Kalapahara towards his capital at Kataka (Cuttack). Mukundadeva bravely fought with the Muslim army, but was ultimately forced to take refuge in the fort of Kotisami, which has been identified with Kotsimul on the western bank of the river Damodara in the Hooghly district of Bengal. The other army under Bayazid reached Kataka which was then under the command of Koni Samanta Simhara who fought bravely against the invaders, but was killed. At this time Ramachandra Bhanja, the commadant of Sarangagarh, declared himself to be the king of Odisha. Mukundadeva heard all these developments in Odisha and hastened to Kataka but due to the rebellion of Ramachandra Bhanja, he had to submit to the invader. Mukundadeva then proceeded to suppress the rebellion at Sarangagarh (near Baranga), but in the fight that followed Ramachandra killed him. Ramachandra in turn was killed by the invaders on the same day.

Another tradition is that Mukundadeva fought with the invading army at Gohiratikari (near Jajpur) and was killed in the battle. Another tradition speaks of two traitors, Sikhi and Manai, who were the generals of the king of Odisha. These traitors indicated a jungle path to Kalapahara who came to the rear of the Mukundadeva's army and routed it.

There are thus different stories about the death of Mukundadeva. It is, however, most probable that he was killed by the traitor Ramachandra Bhanja. In the *Madalapanji* this traitor has sometimes been described as Ramachandra Bhanja and sometimes as Ramachandradeva. The latter name seems to be more correct. He was a local chief who had been put in Charge of the important fort of Sarangagarh. After the fall of the important forts of Kataka and Sarangagarh the Muslim army occupied Odisha.

Our account of the Muslim conquest of Odisha will not be complete without a reference to the desecration of the Jagannatha temple at Puri by Kalapahara. It is stated in the *Madalapanji* that when the servants of the temple got the information of the fall of Kataka they took out the

images of Lord Jaqannatha and his associates from the temple and secreted them in an island in the Chilka lake, but Kalapahara got the scent of it. He proceeded thither and placed the images on an elephant and took them to Bengal where he burnt them on the bank of the Ganges. A Vaishnava devotee named Bishar Mahanti followed Kalapahara to the place where the images were burnt and managed to recover the *Brahmas* (probably jewels) inside the images, put them inside a *mridanga* (a kind of drum) and brought them back to Odisha.

It is stated in the same cronicle that Kalapahara destroyed the great temple of Jagannatha upto the *Amalakasila* and defaced the images. It is difficult to ascertain the truth of the statement since the temple is now covered with a thick coat of plaster which has hidden the evidences of destruction and disfigurement, but to us it seems that the temple was not pulled down or razed to the ground, though the images were damaged and disfigured as far as possible. There is no archaeological evidence to show that the temple was rebuilt at any time. The original temple as built by Chodaganga has come down to us, though the carvings on the outer faces of the temple have been damaged and disfigured. Kalapahara is also represented as the destroyer of several other Hindu monuments of Odisha. As a matter of fact, Kalapahara is a familiar name in Odisha and all damages of Hindu temples and images, irrespective of their age, are attributed to him. It may be true that Kalapahara actually destroyed a large number of Hindu monuments in Odisha, but it is not a fact that he went to every nook and corner of Odisha with a view to destroy them.

There is a tradition in Bengal that Kalapahara was originally a Hindu Brahmin. Dulari, the daughter of the Bengal Sultan, fell in love with him and ultimately married him. Kalapahara had two Hindu wives and he intended to remain a Hindu even though he married a Muslim girl. He came to Puri to perform the ceremony of expiation in the temple of Jagannatha, but the Brahmins did not permit him to perform it. Kalapahara's reaction was very great and therefore, he became a great fanatic. This tradition has however been challenged by scholars. The name Kalapahara was not peculiar only to the Hindus. A nephew of Bahalul Lodi bore this name. Mr. P. Mukherji observces that "the Muslim chronicles conclusively prove that Kalapahara was a full-blooded Afghan and not a Brahmin renegade."

1.3.2. 3. Conclusion

Thus, Mukundadeva ruled for only eight years and during this short time he showed great abilities. He again became the master of the Gajapati kingdom stretching from the Ganges in the north to the Godavari in the south. The people of Odisha still remember him as the creator of

Brahmin *Sasanas* and the builder of several structures within the compound of the Jagannatha temple at PurL He was also a patron of art and literature. The foreign travellers like Saesare Fredericke and Tieffenthaler have nothing but high praise for him. All these evidences prove that the last Hindu king of Odisha was great both in war and peace.

1.3.3. The Bhoi dynasty

With the death of Prataparudradeva, the political scenario of Odisha became turbulent. Treachery, confusion and bloodshed became the order of the day. Gajapati Prataparudradeva had left behind no strong successor to uphold the banner of Gajapati imperialism. Cowed down by selfish rivalry in politics among the feudatories, with impending threat of Muslim invasion and economic bankruptcy caused by ceaseless wars fought during Prataparudradeva, medieval Odisha was heading towards a great disaster. At this juncture, the accession of Kaluadeva, the eldest son of Prataparudradeva to the Gajapati throne in 1540 A.D., provided the people with no peaceful administration. Just after seventeen months of inglorious rule, he was killed by Govinda Vidyadhara, the trecherous general of Prataparudradeva. His death made the confusion worst confounded. Kakharudeva, the younger brother of the deceased Gajapati, who succeeded the former to the throne of Odisha, met the same fate again at the hand of Govinda Vidyadhara who usurped the Gajapati throne in 1541-42 AD. and became the founder of the Bhoi dynasty in Odisha.

1.3.3. 1. Govinda Vidyadhara (C-1542-1549 A.D.)

Govinda Vidyadhara ascended the throne of Odisha when the land was passing through political upheavel. With his assumption of power, he wanted to exert his influence upon the people of Odisha by adopting the title 'Suvarna Kesari' as gleaned from the Narasimha temple inscriptions at Simhachalam. From the *Madala Panji*, it is known that he had led an expedition to Golkonda to recover the Krishna-Godavari-Doab from Sultan Quli Qutab Shah.

In the meanwhile, Raghubhanja Chhotaray, a scion of the Bhanja dynasty of Mayurbhanj and a nephew of Govinda Vidyadhara, rose in revolt. Assisted by Valmiki Srichandana, another nephew of Goyinda Vidyadhara and Abdul Shah, he attacked Cuttack and besieged it. However, the fort was successfully defended by Mukunda Harichandana in the absence of Govinda Vidyadhara. Having heard this news, Govinda entrusted the task of operation against Bahamani kingdom to Danai Vidyadhara and hurried back towards his capital. At his approach,

Raghubhanja left the capital. Govinda Vidyadhara defeated the combined army led by his nephew Raghubhanja Chhotaraya and pursued them to the boarder of Bengal. On his way back to Cuttack, he fell ill and breathed his last at Dasasvamedha *ghata* on the river bank of Vaitarani in 1549 AD.

If the social history of Odisha is analysed, one will find that there was no such caste as Bhoi. However, with the gradual march of time, the accountants and record keepers of the kings of Odisha termed themselves as Bhoi. In due course of time, they served as generals in the Odishan army. Govinda Vidyadhara and subsequently, Danai Vidyadhara were bright examples of it. Whatever the fact may be, the corner stone of the Bhoi dynasty was iaid down by Govinda Vidyadhara and the dynasty is looked down upon as the dynasty of traitors. Some historians also treat the Bhois of belonging to inferior caste (Sudra).

1.3.3. 2. Chakrapratapa (C 1549-1557 A.D.)

Chakrapratapa succeeded his father Govinda Vidyadhara in or about 1549 A.D. He called back the general Danai Vidyadhara from the South and made him his Prime Minister. Chakrapratapa was a tyrannical, cruel and oppressive ruler. Abul Fazl, in his *Akabarnama* narrates that he was killed by his son after the eventful reign of eight years.

1.3.3. 3. Narasimha Jena (C 1557-1558 A.D.)

Narasimha Jena ascended the throne in 1557 A.D. He came under the tremendous influence of Mukunda Harichandana who persuaded the king to dismiss Danai Vidyadhara from power. However, Narasimha Jena paid a deaf ear to Mukunda Harichandana. When his persuaticn failed, reports *Madala Panji*, he murdered Narasimha Jena and placed Raghurama Chhotaraya, the younger brother of Narasimha Jena on the throne.

1.3.3. 4. Raghurama Chhotaraya (C 1558-1560 A.D.)

Raghurama Chhotaraya succeeded his elder brother Narasimha Jena to the throne of Bhoi dynasty. He became a puppet ruler at the hands of Mukunda Harichandana, the general of the Odishan army. Receiving the news of Raghurama's accession, Danai Vidyadhara returned from the South. On his way to Cuttack, Mukunda Harichandana met him at Mangalajori in Puri and won his confidence. Danai Vidyadhara was entraped by Mukunda who placed the former inside the prison. After a short while, Danai Vidyadhara met his end. In the mean while, Raghubhanja Chhotaraya, receiving the help from Bengal, marched upto Cuttack and challenged the authority

of Mukundadeva. He was captured and killed by Mukundadeva. After that Mukunda Harichandana killed Raghurama Chhotaraya and proclaimed himself as the king of Odisha.

1.3.3. 5. Ramachandradeva I (1568-1607 A.D.)

The accession of Ramachandradeva to the throne of Bhoi dynasty at Khurda marks a glorious epoch for that dynasty. Who is Ramachandradeva ? As stated earlier, Danai Vidyadhara was taken captive by Mukundadeva at Puri. Having heard this news, his son Ramai Routaray wanted to march towards Puri but was confined at the fort of Rajahmundry by the order of Mukunda Harichandana. With the passing away of Mukunda Harichandana in 1568 A.D., Ramai Routaraya was released from the fort and he returned Odisha. As Cuttack, by that time was under the clutches of the Afghans, Ramai selected Khurda as the centre of his political activity. This he got from Vala Vikrama Singh as a token of gift, informs the *Chaininka Chakada.* In that place, Ramai Routaraya proclaimed himself as king in 1568 A.D. This Ramai Routaraya is none but Ramachandradeva I, popularly known as Ramachandradeva, who assumed this name after coronation. Then, he proclaimed himself as the Gajapati of Odisha and introduced his own *Anka* (year) in 1568 A.D.

1.3.3. 6. His achievements

The *Madala Panji* describes him belonging to the *Yadu Vamsa.* After his accession, Rarnachandradeva wanted to extend his boundary in every direction- north, south, east and west. That was the time of Mughal-Afghan conflict for the possession of Odisha. The coming of Mirja Raja Mansingh to Odisha led Ramachandradeva to think that his position might be jeopardized. It was only because Telenga Mukundadeva and Chhakadi Bhramarabara, the two sons of deceased Mukundadeva had appealed to Akbar, the Mughal emperor to recognise them as the legitimate rulers of Odisha. Initially, Ramachandradeva fortified the fort of Sarangagarh and gave shelter to the Afghans inside it.

On his way to Puri, Mansingh waited at Sali and Raja Ramachandradeva wanted to negotiate with him by sending his son Birabara. However, Mansingh did not listen to Birabara and desired to see Ramachandradeva personally in his camp. Ramachandradeva did not turn up. At this, Mansingh proceeded towards Khurda accompanied by his son Jagat Singh, Abul Baqa, Shahabuddin Diwan and others and captured forts like Sahajpala, Kharagarh, Kalupada, Bhumal, Konon, Lonagarh and Bhumala. Ramachandradeva did not come out from the fort of Khurda. .

Akbar now changed his mind. In order to crush Afghans in Odisha, he wanted to satisfy Ramachandradeva, on the one har.d and the sons of Mukundadeva, on the other. Accordingly, Mansingh did the needful. The *Madala Panji* states that during *Chandana Yatra,* Mansingh proceeded towards Puri with the two rival claimants, Ramachandradeva and Telenga Mukundadeva. The priests of the Jagannath temple asked Mansingh to whom he would offer the power and authority as the king of Odisha. Mansingh took up *Khadi prasada* from the priests and offered to Ramachandradeva proclaiming him as the king of Odisha. However, he satisfied the two sons of Mukundadeva. The fort of Aul (All) and the Zamindari assigned to it were offered to Telenga Mukundadeva who became king over it. Chhakadi Bhramarabara, another son of Mukundadeva was made the chief of Patia. By doing this Mansingh gave the proof of his diplomacy. One notable event during the reign period of Ramachandradeva was the invasion of 1brahim Qutab Shah, the Sultan of Golkunda. He pursued his enemy Mukunda Raja of Kasimkota who sought the help of Ramachandradeva. Of course, it is not clear what happened to Ramachandradeva in that battle waged against Ibrahim. It is to be believed with a tolerable degree of certainty that Ramachandradeva was defeated. This assumption is to be made, because, by that time Kalinga and Rajahmundry were lost to the Odishan empire and included in the kingdom of Golkunda Sultan. Though Ramachandradeva was hard pressed by the Afghans of Bengal in the north and Sultan of Golkunda in the south, he had as many as thirty-two zamindaries at his disposal. Among them, the Zamindari of Khurda was very important which contained 73 forts. Besides, there were Zamindaries of Banki, Domapara, Baramba, Tigiria, Narasinghpur, Angul, Talcher, Nayagarh, Dasapalla, Parikud, Ghumsar, Khallikote, Tekkali, Raghunathpur, Rathipur, Tapang, Rorung, Karki, Bolegarh etc. Roughly, the territory of Ramachandradeva extended upto the river Mahanadi in the north to the borders of Khimindi in the south and from Chilika lake, in the east to Nayagarh and Dasapalla region in the west.

1.3.3. 7. His benevolent works

Ramachandradeva was a pious man. Immediately after his accession to the throne, he reinstalled the idols of Jagannath, Balabhadra and Subhadra in the Puri Jagannath temple which were burnt during Afghan invasion of Odisha under the redoubtable Kalapahada. The *Madala Panji* informs that he himself remained present near the *Jaya Vijaya dvara* and distributed *Mahaprasada* to different sections of the Hindu society. For this noble work, he was called *Dvitiya Indradyumna.* He was also instrumental in building the tempte at Sakshigopala. He also

wanted to appease the Brahmins because he had ascended the throne by ignoring the claims of the sons of Mukundadeva. Though this was recognized by emperor Akbar, still, Ramachandradeva thought it prudent to get the blessings of the Brahmanas to legimatize his claim. So, he established several *Shasanas* (Brahmin villages) among which Vira Ramachandrapura exists today. The *Madala Panji* further informs that Gauri Rani (the queen of Raja Mansingh) built the present *Mukti Mandapa* inside the sacred complex of the Jagannath temple at Puri. Raja Ramachandradeva I was a great patron of scholars. He himself was an accomplished poet who composed *Durgotsava Chandrika* and *Sri Krishna Bhakta Vatsalya Charitam.* However, the composition of *Durgotsava Chandrika* by Raja Ramachandradeva is controversial and its authorship is assigned to Vardhamana Mahapatra, the *Rajaguru* of the family. Ramachandradeva breathed his last in 1607 A.D.

1.3.3. 8. Purusottamadeva (1607-1622 A.D.)

Purusottamadeva succeeded his father Ramachandradeva in 1607 A.D. His reign witnessed the vigorous Mughal atrocity over Odisha. During his reign, the Mughal emperor at Delhi was Jahangir who appointed Hasim Khan as the *Subahdar* of Odisha. He wanted to march towards Khurda and settle score with Purusottamadeva. One of his subordinates, named Raja Keso Das Maru went with his Rajput soldiers and entered into the temple of God Jagannath. Though, Purusottamadeva besieged the temple, the soldiers of Keso Das Maru threw rags socked with oil and ghee setting fire in them which burnt the Chariots of the Raja who ultimately surrendered and came in terms with Keso Das Maru. Raja Kalyana Mal, who succeeded Hasim Khan, was much more titanic than the former. He invited Vidyadhara, the Prime Minister of Purusottamadeva and made him captive at Ghantasila Tangi and attacked Khurda. Purusottama concluded peace with him. . After Kalyan Mal, Mukarram Khan was appointed as Governor of Odisha who brought injury to the image of Sakshigopal.

Being infuriated, Ramachandra advanced to cross sword with this fanatical governor appointed by Jahangir but he was defeated. He immediately fled away from Khurda and sought asylum with the king of Rajahmundry. It appears that Khurda was temporarily annexed to the Mughal empire. He was removed in 1620 A.D. and Husain Ali Khan became the *Subahdar* of Odisha for a short time. After him, Ahmad Beg who succeeded Husain Ali Khan as the Governor of Odisha in 1621 enabled Purusottamadeva to deal with the Mughals. Gathering support from the local chiefs, Purusottamadeva marched against him. Ahmad Beg proceeded from Khurda to

deal with him. While holding a camp near Banapur, Purusottamadeva passed away in 1622 A.D. King Purusottamadeva was a great devotee of God Jagannath. He also patronized the Brahmins. He is credited with the establishment of three Brahmin *Shasanas* namely, *Purusottamapura Shasana, Sri Purusottamapura Shasana* and *Pratapa Purusottamapura Shasana.*

1.3.3. 9. Narasimhadeva (1622-1647 A.D.)

After the death of Purusottamadeva, his son Narasimhadeva ascended the throne of Khurda in 1622 A.D. He could not escape the wrath of Ahmad Beg, the then *Subahdar* of Odisha. As his humiliating proposal that the royal family of Khurda should remain as security at the Mughal court in Cuttack was not accepted by Narasimhadeva, the former invaded Khurda. Narasimhadeva gave a toe fight to the Mughal Governor and defeated him. This infuriated Ahmad Beg who wanted to lead a second expedition to Khurda. At this juncture, prince Khurram (Shah Jahan) revolted against his father Jahangir and proceeded towards Odisha from Golkunda. This foiled the plan of Ahmad Beg's attack on Khurda and he fled immediately with his family towards Burdwan and then to Akbar Nagar. The rebellious Mughal prince was treated with humility. Being fully satisfied with the behaviour of Narasimhadeva, Shah Jahan left for Bengal. However, the alertness of Mahabbat Khan prompted the prince to retreated towards Golkunda via Odisha.

After the departure of Shah Jahan, Ahmed Beg again returned and remained as Governor of Odisha till 1628 A.D. and did not create any trouble for Narasimhadeva. During the governorship of Baquar Khan Nazim Sani who was appointed after Ahmad Bag, Narasimhadeva faced fresh troubles. Nazim Sani led an expedition to the Sun temple at Konarka. Knowing well the attitude of that *Subahdar,* Narasimhadeva had already removed the image of Sun god from Konarka temple to that of God Jagannath. Raja Narasimhadeva showed regards to God Jagannath. During the governorship of Ahmad Beg, the idols of Jagannatha, Balabhadra and Subhadra had been transferred to Garah Manitri from the Puri temple. Narasimhadeva brought back these images again to the temple and reinstalled them. The *Madala Panji* states that he had ordered to plaster the temple of God Jagannath at Puri. Further, after a long gap, he again arranged car festival during the Spring season which was not being celebrated due to the fear of Mughal governors. From the *Rasika Mangala,* it is known that Sri Rasikananda Deva Gosvami, the famous disciple of Syamananda, visited Puri and propagated his faith in the nook and corner of the kingdom of Narasimhadeva. The removal of the image of sun god from the temple of

Konarka prompted Mutquad Khan to attack Khurda. In that fierce battle, Narasimhadeva met his end at the hands of his enemy.

1.3.3. 10. Balabhadradeva (1648-1659 A.D.)

The death of Narasimhadeva enabled Gangadharadeva, a nephew of the deceased king by the help of Mutquad Khan, the Governor of Odisha. This led to a great resentment among the subjects and some officials of the king. By taking their help, Balabhadradeva, the elder brother of Narasimhadeva, killed Gangadhara and ascended the throne in 1648 A.D. During his reign period, he had to fight with the Mughals. It was only because when Turbiyat Khan was the Deputy to rule Odisha on behalf of the Mugtial. Mirza Balaki attacked the fort of Andhari. Raipitam, who was incharge of that fort appointed by Balabhadradeva, was defeated and fled away from the fort. His family members were captured. At this juncture, Balabhadradeva fought with the Muslims and freed the family of Raipitam from their clutches. However, the Mughals occupied Andhari fort. The reign period of Balabhadradeva was inglorious. He is known to have established the Vira Balabhadrapura *Shasana* near Puri.

1.3.3. 11. Mukundadeva I (1659-1688 A.D.)

With the death of Balabhadradeva, his son Mukundadeva I succeeded him to the throne of Khurda in 1659 A.D. As he was a minor, Dharmadeva Rajaguru carried on the administration of the kingdom on behalf of Mukundadeva. Taking the fatricidal war among the sons of Shah Jahan, Dharmadeva Rajaguru organised the zamindars of the kingdom and did not pay any tribute to the Mughals. With the victory of Aurangzeb, Khan-i-Dauran was sent to deal with the Odishan zamindars and the king of Khurda. He killed many recalcitrant zamindars and proceeded towards Khurda. He defeated Mukundadeva in 1661 and offered the Kingdom of Khurda to Bhramarabara, the younger brother of Mukundadeva. However, Mukundadeva negotiated with Khan-i-Dauran to get back his kingdom and for materialising this, he sent Dharmadeva Rajaguru to deal with the matter. Khan-i-Dauran was convinced the Mukundadeva got back his throne. After his coronation was over, he imprisoned Bhramarabara Raya.

During the *Subahdarship* of Sayasta Khan, the maternal uncle of Aurangzeb, Mukundadeva faced problems from the side of the Mughals. Abu Nasir, one of the sons of Sayasta Khan marched to Jajpur and Jhankada and broke the temples, establishing mosques nearby. On his way to Puri, at Sakshigopal, he halted. His plan to attack the Jagannath temple at Puri was not materialised, because the *MadalaPanji* informs that there was sudden thunderbolt

during spring season at Sakshigopal and Abu Nasir returned to Cuttack out of fear after negotiating with Mukundadeva. The career of Mukundadeva came to an end in 1688 when he breathed his last affected by the small-pox.

1.3.3. 12. Divyasinghadeva I (1688-1714 A.D.)

Divyasinghadeva I, who succeeded his father in 1688 A.D. was one of the ablest rulers of the Bhoi dynasty. During his reign period, Ekram Khan had attacked the Jagannath temple at Puri and captured fake images of the Lords. However, after his departure, Divyasinghadeva, reinstalled the original images in the temple, opened *Simhadvara* and allowed to continue all the rites of the temple including the car festival which brought joy and jubilation among the people of Odisha. When Murshid Quli Khan the Governor of Bengal was also appointed as the governor of Odisha, he sent Shuia-ud-din, his son-in-law as the Deputy of Odisha, Shuja-ud-din, marched towards Khurda and was defeated by Divyasinghadeva who had gathered the local zamindars in his side.This added a new feather in his cap. However, he breathed his last in 1714 A.D.

1.3.3. 13. Harekrishnadeva (1714-1719 A.D.)

With the death of Divyasinghadeva, his younger brother Harekrishnadeva succeeded him. His reign period was marked with peace and tranquility, because by that time, there was no Muslim attack either on Khurda or Puri Jagannath temple. The white washing of the temple of Lord Jagannath was completed during his reign period. He also established a new *shasana* named *Vira Harekrushnapura shasana.* During his reign period, Gadadhara Rajaguru created many celebrated works like *Sudhi Sara, Kala Sara* and *Achara Sara.* He died in 1719 A.D.

1.3.3. 14. Gopinathadeva (1719-1727 A.D.)

The accession of Gopinathadeva gave a halt to the conflict with the Mughals which was a regular feature of the Bhoi dynasty. His reign is marked with one romantic episode. He was attracted by the beauty of Suka Dei, the queen of Trailokya Harichandana of Banki. To materialise his dream, he attacked Banki and occupied some *paraganas.* Trailokya Harichandana, while fighting in the battle field, was killed by Gopinathadeva. At this, queen Suka Dei went to the battle field and *gave* a toe tight to Gopinathadeva Who was defeated and taken as prisoner by the queen, However, he was released by the gracious queen and Gopinathadeva returned all the previously occupied territories to her.

Gopinathadeva was known for his charity. He established a village named Routarapura near Puri. He also granted a *village* to his physician Dhananjaya Nedhinatha Rao who cured the

king from a fatal disease. During his reign period, a special ritual cleansing took place in the temple of God Jagannath that involved the bathing of the Gods for three times. However, there were many black spots in the character of Gopinathadeva. One glaring instance has already been narrated in connection with Suka Dei. Further, when the chief of Ranapur was on his way to Puri to visit God Jagannath, Gopinathadeva blocked his way and tried to take his daughter forcibly who was a paragon of beauty. The situation was *saved* with the steady flight of the chief with his daughter and followers to Rathipur. He was infuriated with his soldiers entered the palace of Gopinathadeva and killed him bringing an end to the uneventful reign of Gopinathadeva.

1.3.3. 15. Ramachandradeva II (1721-1736 A. D.)

With Ramachandradeva II, another turbulent phase began in the history of Bhoi dynasty. Immediately after his accession, he had to bear the brunt Nizam's invasion from Hyderabad. Ramachandradeva's territory extending between Tekkali, Raghunathpur and the Chilka lake came under the sway of the Nizam. At that crucial phase of his career,Ramachandradeva /I *never* lost his heart and assembled the native paiks and zamindars. He gave a tough fight to the army of Hyderabad but was easily routed by the army of the Nizam. The above mentioned territory was lost to the Nizam. Taqui Khan, the Naib of Odisha, appointed by Murshid Quli Khan, did not come to the rescue of Raja Ramachandradeva II.

Muhammad Taqui Khan was a religious bigot. Destroying many Hindu shrines in Odisha, he proceeded towards Khurda. Though, Ramachandradeva II had gathered the Paiks around him but by the persuation of the Brahmins, they did not fight for the king and even Bakshi Benu Bhramaravara Rai and Diwan Nilambara Harichandana fled from the battle field. Now, Ramachandradeva appointed two Muslims, Lodhu Miana Diwan and Khalifa Gadadhara Mangaraja as Baksi but the result was negative. Taqui Khan demanded the surrender of Ramachandradeva II after killing the newly appointed Diwan and Bakshi. Though, his order was executed by the kings, Taqui Khan marched towards Khurda, captured Ramachandradeva and brought him to Cuttack. In the meanwhile, Taqui Khan marched towards Khurda and the rebellious sons of Ramachandradeva fled away from the palace. Taqui Khan pursued them and occupied the territory lying between Khurda and Banapur. After leaving Khurda, Bhagirathi Kumar one of the sons of Ramachandradeva II sought the help of the king of Kodala. Athagarh and their combined army brought the disaster for the Mughals. However, Taqui Khan persued Ramachandradeva II to fight on his own behalf against Bhagirathi Kumar who was defeated and

left the battle field marching towards Dasapalla. Still then, Taqui Khan never took Ramachandradeva into confidence and kept him in the palace of Khurda under housearrest.

Ramachandradeva II was quite aware about the bigotry of Taqui Khan. So, he had taken steps to remove the images of Jagannath, Balabhadra and Subhadra from the Puri Temple, to bring them to Banapur and subsequently to Takkali. The invasion of Taqui Khan to Puri and his entry to the Jagannath temple was proved futile because the idols were absent. So, he again attacked Khurda but Ramachandradeva fled away. The departure of Taqui Khan to Murshidabad, led Ramachandradeva to reinstall the images of the Lords in the temple. Taqui Khan hurried back from Murshidabad and made Ramachandradeva a prisoner in the fort of Barabati. Taqui Khan was murdered in that fort by two Khandayats employed by Rajaguru Paramalakshmi. With the death of Taqui Khan, Murshid Quli Khan II was appointed as the Naib Nazim of Odisha and Ramachandradeva was released from the fort of Barabati. He was greeted by the feudatory chiefs. It is stated that he fell in love with Souria, the daughter of Murshid Quli Khan II and married her being converted to Islam.

This fact is to be taken into account with a pinch of salt. It is to be believed that as he was a weak ruler, he was forced to be converted into Islam. His entry into the temple of God Jagannath was banned after he was converted to Islam. He wanted to enter into the temple by force but he Brahmins and the temple priests obstructed this way and an open rebellion was proclaimed against him. At this juncture, Mir Habib, the Deputy of Murshid Quli, look after administration of Odisha. Out of frustration, he took poison and breathed his last in 1736 A.D. Surendra Mohanty, a notable novelist of the Odia literature, has glorified the career and achievements of Raja Ramachandradeva II for preserving the honour of the Gods of the temple at Puri in his two monumental historical novels, the *Neela Saila* and *Niladri Vijaya.* However, many facts of these two novels are based on imagination of the novelist and should not be taken as solid historical facts. If it is done, it will be a misnomer leaving the history of Odisha on the cross road of puzzles.

1.3.3. 16. Padmanavadeva (1736-1739 A.D.)

The death of Ramachandredeva II created a vacuum in the political history of the Bhoi dynasty for some time. To put an end to this malady, Padmanavadeva, the king of Patia was appointed as king of Khurda by Mir Habib. He was not the choice of Ramachandradeva II.

However, the rule of Padmanavadeva was opposed by the people of Khurda. It appears that he could not smoothly discharge his duties as a king and left the throne of Khurda in 1739 AD.

1.3.3. 17. Birakishoradeva (1739-1793 A.D.)

Birakishoradeva was the right choice of Raja Ramachandradeva II to the throne of Khurda. When popular discontentment arose against Padmanavadeva, the claim of Birakishoradeva was placed before Mir Habib who ordered to place Birakishoradeva on the throne of Odisha and that was materialised in 1739 AD. He established cordial relation with Murshid Quli Khan II. Due to his help, the family of Murshid Quli was saved from the attack . of Alivardi Khan. For that reason, perhaps, the relation between Birakishoradeva and Alivardi Khan, the Naib Nazim of Bengal, was strained in the initial phase.

Later on, when Mirza Baquar, the son-in-law of Murshid Quli Khan II, rose against Alivardi, the latter wanted to bring Birakishoradeva to his side by offering the former royal insignia near the *Paschimadvara* of the Jagannath temple at Puri, informs the *Madala Panji.* Odisha became the chess board of political strife between the Mughals and the Marathas. Though, Birakishoradeva did not side with the Marathas, ultimately he had to succumb before them. Thus, the Marathas captured Puri and reduced considerably the empire of Birakishoradeva by snatching away from his territories of Banki, Dhenkanal, Narasinghpur, Tigiria, Talcher, Hindol, Angul, Kendrapara, Daspalla and Baud and made the zamindars of these area free from the rule of Khurda. Further, by bribing the priests of the Jagannath temple at Puri, the Marathas maintained the administration of the temple. This gave a rude shock to Birakishoradeva who is said to have become mad towards the end of his career.

Coming under the spell of the Pattnaik family of Bangoraba, he lebelled charge of dishonesty against Paramalakshmi Rajaguru who left the kingdom and went to Narasinghpur. The madness led him to kill his four sons. Bakshi Damodara Bhramaravara captured him and brought him to Cuttack where he was made prisoner by Rajaram Pandit, the Maratha Governor of Odisha. The Maratha Governor reccqnised his grandson Divyasimhadeva II as the successor of Birakishoradeva. Birakishoradeva breathed his last in 1793 AD. The reign of Birakishoradeva constitutes a glorious epoch in the cultural history of Odisha. The worship of Radha-Krishna started right from his period and it became very popular in his kingdom. His mother Lalita Devi was a pious lady who founded Lalitapura *Shasana.* She also built *several mandapas* inside the Jagannath temple. Birakishoradeva also *renovated* the Markanda tank by removing mud from it.

His long rule of fifty-two years, of course, brought peace and tranquility, though struggle between the Mughals and Marathas had brought temporary disturbance in the political scenario of the land.

1.3.3. 18. Divyasimhadeva II (1793-1798)

The reign period of Divyasimhadeva II, though short, was marked with achievements. From the *very* beginning of his career, he maintained a strained relation with the Marathas. Inspite of the desire of the Marathas and the East India Company, he *gave* shelter to Balarama Maharatha, a refractory landholder of the British Company at Ganjam. Being captured, when Balarama Maharatha was taken by the sepoys of Snodgrass, the British officer in charge of Ganjam, the Paiks attacked them and setBalararn free. When Rajaram Pandit, the Maratha *governor* marched to settle score with Divyasimhadeva II, he was convinced that Balarama had breathed his last and thus, Divyasimhadeva escaped the *Maratha* wrath. During his reign, a famine broke out which took a heavy toll of life. However, he whitewashed the temple of God Jagannath and performed the *Jhulana Yatra* of the Gods. The *Aruna* pillar, brought from the Sun temple at Konarka, was installed before the temple of God Jagannth. Divyasimhadeva died in 1798 A.D.

1.3.3. 19. Mukundadeva II (1798-1817 A.D.)

The death of Divyasimhadeva II brought a conflict between Shyamsundaradeva, the second son of Birakishoradeva and Mukundadeva II, the son of Divyasimhadeva II. Sadashiv Rao, the Maratha Governor, supported the cause of Mukundadeva " and the British authority supported it. So, Mukundadeva II became the king of Khurda in 1798 A.D. In course of his administration, he did not maintain good relation with the East India Company. Inspite of the denial of Jayi Rajaguru, Mukundadeva started negotiation with the East India Company who planned to oust the Marathas from Odisha. Accordingly, they promised to handover the king Lembal, Rahang, Serai and Chabiskud which the Marathas had taken under their authority right from the days of Birakishoradeva who kept these Paraganas as mortgage near the Marathas.

Further, the British authority also promised to pay rupees one lakh to Mukundadeva II for the safe Passage of the British army through the territory of the king. As per the negotiation, the Britishers attacked Odisha in 1803 and after capturing Puri, they moved to Cuttack and occupied the Barabati fort. Mukundadeva remained a silent spectator to it for which he had to pay a price. When the British authority did not handover the four Paraganas, mentioned earlier, to

Mu~undadeva, the latter became rebellious. Jayi Rajaguru who was looking after the administration of Khurda on behalf of Mukundadeva II, advised the king not to send his Vakil to Cuttack to receive other fifty thousands of rupees. The forty thousands had already been paid to Jayi Rajaguru. The delay of the king to come to terms with the British authority, prompted the latter to deal with the former corn and contempt. Mukundadeva II raised troops receiving help from the local chiefs. The British authonty feared the design of the king.

The British authority could knowthat Jayi Rajaguru was the brain behind it and demanded his surrender. Mukundadeva did not oblige it. Under Major Fletcher, an elaborate preparation was made to deal with the king who succeeded in capturing him and Mukundadeva became a prisoner at Cuttack. Jayi Rajaguru was captured and hanged. Mukundadeva II was sent to Midnapur and he sent a petition seeking pardon from the British government. The British Government, after careful consideration of the prayer of the Raja, released him from Midnapur. However, the kingdom of Khurda was not handed over to him again. He died in 1817. His successors were allowed to stay at Puri and hence. they were known as the kings of Puri.

1.3.3. 20. Administration

The Bhois maintained an efficient administration. King was at the apex of the administrative set up. The succession to the throne was in conformity with law of primogeniture. However, there was exception to this principle also, if situation so demanded. In the case of Narasimhadeva, Divyasimhadeva and Ramachandradeva II, there was exception to the law of succession. The king assisted by a good number of officials among whom the position of 'Rajaguru' was highly esteemed. The Rajagurus were drawn from the influential Brahmin family belonging to *Batsasa gotra.* However, there was an exception to this principle also. Sometimes, the Brahmins belonging to *Kausika gotra* were also chosen as Rajaguru. They were very influential and virtually dictated the state administration. They developed deep into the *Sastras* and became constant advisor to the king, Besides *Rajaguru,* the *oalabehera, Khandayat, Bisoi, Bebarta* (Vakil) *Dalai, Karanas, Naik* etc. helped the king in the smooth discharge of administration.

The army administration under the Bhois was quite efficient. *Baksi* was an officer, who managed the military affairs of the kingdom. He enjoyed rent-free *jagirs* and was loyal to the king out and out. The soldier of the army was known as *Paika* who belonged to the community

of cultivators. The Khonds, Telegus and even Muslims, also formed the part of militia under the Bhois. Cavalry, elephants and chariots formed parts of the military organisation.

The role of forts in the army administration, is quite known to all. Reward to victors and punishment to traitors formed part of the military administration of the Bhois.

The revenue administration under the Bhois was quite sound. Rent was fixed on land which was realised in kinds. Further, the king also obtained *Nazrana* (presentation) from his subordinate rulers and subjects at various ceremonies associated with the royal family. The duty on exported salt also formed a part of king's income. The income, thus realised, was spent for religious purposes like maintaining the Jagannath temple at Puri and its surroundings, 'as discussed earlier. No doubt, a large chunk of revenue must have been spent for the welfare of the state.

For administrative efficiency, the. kingdom of the Bhois was divided into severa *Jagirs.* This clearly indicates that feudalism was in vogue during that period. *Dalabehera* was in charge of the administration of a *Jagir. Jagir* denoted the modern district. Village was the lowest unit of the administrative set up under the Bhois. *Pradhan* was the head of the village who maintained the local administration.

1.3.3. 21. Literature

Like the Gajapati age, the Bhoi period also witnessed tremendous progress in Odia literature. Right from the days of the Gajapatis, the importance of Sanskrit literature had declined. So, in the Bhoi period, less works in Sanskrit were produced. Ramachandradevad *Srikrishna Vakta Vatsalya Charitam.* Poet Chintamani Mishra composed many Sanskrit works like *Sambarari Charita, Vagmaya Viveka* and *Kadambarisara.* Biswanatha Samantaraya's *Retrtssere,* Haladhara Mishra's *Sangita Kalpalata* and *Basantotsava,* Raghunatha Ratha's *Natyamanorama,* Mukundadeva's *Narayana Satakam* and *Hridayalu Rasaba* etc. were notable Sanskrit works of the Bhoi period.

1.3.3. 22. Development of Odia literarture

The Odia literature went a long way in creating immortal works during that period. The Bhanja kings of Ghumsar enriched the Odia literature of that time. Dhananjaya Bhanja was the author of *Raghunatha Vilas, Madana Manjari, Ichhabati,* and *Tripura Manjari,* Ghana Bhanja is credited with the composition of mythological *Kavyas* like *Trailokya Mohini, Rasanidhi,* and *Govinda Vilasa,* Upendra Bhanja, the poet laurate of the time, surpassed all by his immortal

romantic creations. His *Vaidehisa Vilasa, Subhadra Parinaya, Lavanyavati, Koti Brahmanda Sundari, Prema Sudhanidhi* etc. were marked with literary style and jugglery of words. In, almost all his literary creations, the feudal thought has been expressed.

Poet Dinakrushna Das was another notable figure in the domain of literature during that time. He composed *Rasakal/ola, Rasa Vinoda, Gundicha Vijaya* and *Namaratna Gita. Another* great name among *the Odia* poets of *that time* was of Abhimanyu Samantasimhara who is credited with the composition of *Vidagdha Chintamani, Prema Chintamani, Rasabati* and *Premakanta;* Brajanatha Badajena's *Amvika Vilasa and Chatura Vinoda,* Bhakta Charana Das's *Mathura Manga/a;* Biswanatha Khuntia's *Vichitra Ramayana,* Mahadeva Dasa's *Vishnu purana, Markanda purana, Padmapurana, Kartika Mahatmya, Magha Mahatmya* and *Baisakha Mahatmya* Narasimha Mishra's drama *Siva Narayana Bhanja Mahodaya Natika, Kavi Ratna;* Purusottama Mishra's *Sangita Narayana;* Raghunatha Ratha's *Natya Manorama;* Chandrasekhara Pattnaik's *Lilavati Vistara;* Jadumani Routraya's *Kavi Kalpadruma* etc. were the immortal creations of that time.

1.3.4. Conclusion

Thus, the dynasty established by Mukundadeva has been described as the Chalukya dynasty. Mukundadeva ruled for only eight years and during this short time he showed great abilities. On the other hand, the Bhoi rule marked a new beginning in the political history of medieval Odisha. Though, this dynasty was established through treachery and bloodshed but it was instrumental in giving continuity to the decadent Gajapati Empire. With the coming of Afghans, Mughals, Marathas and Britishers, they manoeuvered the situation and tried to manage their state, craft until Khurda was annexed to the British authority in 1817. However, the vast literary treasure, which was created during the Bhoi period, created several milestones in the history of literature of Odisha.

1.3.5. Summary

- The dynasty established by Mukundadeva has been described as the Chalukya dynasty.
- It is usual for the ruling dynasties of Odisha to associate their origin with the famous ruling dynasties of India.
- Mukundadeva might have done the same after ascending the Gajapati throne.
- Mukundadeva is considered as the last Hindu king of Odisha. In Odishan traditions Mukundadeva is known as Telinga Mukundadeva.

- Mukundadeva's inscription of Draksharama, referred to above, clearly indicates that he was in possession of the southern part of the Gajapati kingdom upto the river Godavari.
- In A.D. 1568 when Sultan of Bengal invaded Odisha Akbar was engaged in the seige of Chitor and he did not extend any help to the Odishan king probably with the object that Odisha should become a part of Bengal, so that he would ultimately annex Bengal with Odisha.
- Placed in this predicament, Mukundadeva was attacked by Sulaiman Karrani in A.D. 1568 who sent an expedition under the comand of his son Bayazid assisted by Sikandar Uzbeg and Kalapahara.
- Thus, Mukundadeva ruled for only eight years and during this short time he showed great abilities.
- He again became the master of the Gajapati kingdom stretching from the Ganges in the north to the Godavari in the south.
- Govinda Vidyadhara ascended the throne of Odisha when the land was passing through political upheavel.
- With his assumption of power, he wanted to exert his influence upon the people of Odisha by adopting the title 'Suvarna Kesari' as gleaned from the Narasimha temple inscriptions at Simhachalam.
- Chakrapratapa succeeded his father Govinda Vidyadhara in or about 1549 A.D.
- Narasimha Jena ascended the throne in 1557 A.D.
- Raghurama Chhotaraya succeeded his elder brother Narasimha Jena to the throne of Bhoi dynasty.
- The accession of Ramachandradeva to the throne of Bhoi dynasty at Khurda marks a glorious epoch for that dynasty.
- The *Madala Panji* describes him belonging to the *Yadu Vamsa.*
- After his accession, Rarnachandradeva wanted to extend his boundary in every direction-north, south, east and west.
- Purusottamadeva succeeded his father Ramachandradeva in 1607 A.D.
- After the death of Purusottamadeva, his son Narasimhadeva ascended the throne of Khurda in 1622 A.D.

- The death of Narasimhadeva enabled Gangadharadeva, a nephew of the deceased king by the help of Mutquad Khan, the Governor of Odisha.
- This led to a great resentment among the subjects and some officials of the king.
- By taking their help, Balabhadradeva, the elder brother of Narasimhadeva, killed Gangadhara and ascended the throne in 1648 A.D.
- With the death of Balabhadradeva, his son Mukundadeva I succeeded him to the throne of Khurda in 1659 A.D.
- Divyasinghadeva I, who succeeded his father in 1688 A.D.
- With the death of Divyasinghadeva, his younger brother Harekrishnadeva succeeded him.
- The accession of Gopinathadeva gave a halt to the conflict with the Mughals which was a regular feature of the Bhoi dynasty.
- With Ramachandradeva II, another turbulent phase began in the history of Bhoi dynasty.
- The death of Ramachandredeva II created a vacuum in the political history of the Bhoi dynasty for some time. To put an end to this malady, Padmanavadeva, the king of Patia was appointed as king of Khurda by Mir Habib.
- Birakishoradeva was the right choice of Raja Ramachandradeva II to the throne of Khurda.
- The reign period of Divyasimhadeva II, though short, was marked with achievements.
- Mukundadeva II became the king of Khurda in 1798 A.D.
- The Bhois maintained an efficient administration. King was at the apex of the administrative set up. The succession to the throne was in conformity with law of primogeniture.
- Like the Gajapati age, the Bhoi period also witnessed tremendous progress in Odia literature.

1.3.6. Exercise

- **Write a note on the political history of the Chalukyas.**
- **Give an account on the achievements of Mukunda Deva.**
- **Make note on the political history of the Bhois.**
- **Highlight the administration of the Bhois.**
- **Discuss the achievements of Ramachandradeva** I.

1.3.7. Further reading

- P. Mukherjee, *The Gajapati Kings of Orissa*, Calcutta, 1953.
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UNIT-2
Chapter-I

Decline and disintegration of Medieval Odishan Kingdom

Structure

2.1.0.Objectives
2.1.1. Introduction

2.1.2. Decline of medieval Odishan empire

2.1.2.1. Natural phenomenon

2.1.2.2. Weak successors of Prataparudradeva

2.1.2.3. War between Hamvira and Purusottamadeva

2.1.2.4. Muslim attack

2.1.2. 5. Invasion of Krishnadevaraya

2.1.2.6. Adversities of Prataparudradeva

2.1.2.7. Betrayal of Govinda Vidyadhara

2.1.2.8. Weak army

2.1.2.9. Role of Sri Chaitanya and Vaishnavism

2.1.2.10. Treachery and Confusion after the death of Prataparudradeva

2.1.2.11. Economic bankruptcy

2.1.2.12. Laziness of the Feudatory chiefs

2.1.2.13. Lack of unity and harmony

2.1.2.14. Attack of Kalapahada

2.1.3. Conclusion

2.1.4. Summary

2.1.5. Exercise

2.1.6. Further reading

2.1.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the decline and disintegration of medieval Odishan kingdom. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the different causes responsible for the decline of medieval Odishan kingdom*
- *understand the factors that led to the disintegration of medieval Odishan kingdom*
- *know about the political causes for the decline*
- *identify the socio-economic causes for the decline*
- *recognise the other causes for the decline of medieval Odishan kingdom*

2.1.1. Introduction

The rise and fall of nations, like day-and night, follows each other in succession. There was no exception to the.Gajapati empire of medieval Odisha. This political decline was a sad story of sheer misfortunes. The cold arms of decadence embraced the medieval Odishan empire that had reached the zenith of glory and splendour during a century rule under the great Gajapatis. No doubt, internal strifes had weakened the strong foundation of the Gajapati rule.

2.1.2. Decline of medieval Odishan empire

Different factors like law of nature, conspiracy and treachery, Muslim invasions, aggressive march of Krishnadevaraya, misfortunes of Prataparudradeva, desire for power among the feudatories, coming of Sri Chaitanya to Odisha, weak army etc. contributed a lot for the decline of medieval Odishan empire.

2.1.2.1. Natural phenomenon

Like birth and death, the rise and fall of an empire is the law of nature. This law of nature was also applicable in case of the Gajapati empire in medieval Odisha. In the words of Ibn Khaldun, "Empires are born, attain maturity and die at a definite point of time." This inexorable law of nature also operated in case of the great Gajapati empire. The cornerstone of the empire laid down by Kapilendradeva, was designed and decorated by his successors like Purusottamadeva and Prataparudradeva. However, rnisfortune cast its ugly shadow over the empire and it dismembered preparing the way for the downfall of medieval Odisha. Nobody could check this inevitable law of nature. The empire was created by treachery and force and it was destined to be destroyed by treachery and force.

2.1.2.2. Weak successors of Prataparudradeva

With the death of Prataparudradeva, the Gajapati empire did not get a good successor. His valiant son Virabhadra had committed suicide in the court of Krishnadevaraya. So, the other

two sons of Prataparudradeva, Ramachandradeva and Purusottamadeva nicknamed as Kaludeva and Kakharudeva respectively, came to the throne in quick succession. These two brothers were killed by Govinda Vidyadhara who founded the Bhoi dynasty on the ruins of the Suryavamsi Gajapati rule. Thus, it is apparent that with the passage of time, the great Gajapati dynasty could not produce great warriors like Kapilendradeva, Hamvira and Birabhadra. So, the dynasty headed towards grave.

2.1.2.3. War between Hamvira and Purusottamadeva

The great fratricidal war between Hamvira and Purusottamadeva, the two sons of Kapilendradeva, sowed the seeds of dissension in the Gajapati empire. The claim of Hamvira as the legitimate heir for the Gajapati throne was set aside by his father Kapilendradeva. Kapilendradeva, in a diplomatic way, asserted the claim of Purusottamadeva injecting in the minds of the people of Odisha that it was the desire of Lord Jagannath. This led Hamvira to be revolutionary and prompted him to start a war of rebellion against Purusottamadeva. By this, he created a lot of problems for Purusottamadeva. Though people were silent spectators to this fatricidal war owing to their fear to Lord Jagannath, still an undercurrent of sympathy they cherished in their heart for Hamvira. This undoubtedly, undermined the prestige of the Gajapati king and gave scope to the feudatories to fish in such type of troubled water in future.

2.1.2.4. Muslim attack

The Muslim rulers posed great menace to the policy of territorial expansion of the Gajapati rulers. The Muslim invaders came during the reign of almost all the Gajapati kings, sometimes intervened in their home affairs and attacked their empire in some crucial moments, thereby crippling and reducing the power, prestige and honour of the Gajapatis. As stated earlier, the attack of Mahmud Shah, Mahmud Sharqui and Hussain Sharqui, the Sultans of Bengal had compelled Kapilendradeva to deal with them relegating his preoccupation to distant background from time to time. During the reign period of Purusottamadeva, Bahamani Sultan Muhammad Shah had sent Malik Hussain Bheiry to help Hamvira in capturing the Gajapati throne of Odisha. Prataparudradeva had to deal with Hussain Shah of Bengal and Ouli Outab Shah of Golkunda. All these Muslim invasions made huge loss of Manpower and resources of the Gajapatis, thereby weakening the internal structure of the Suryavamsi rule.

2.1.2. 5. Invasion of Krishnadevaraya

Krishnadevaraya of the Vijayanagara empire became a potent threat to the very existence of the Gajapati kingdom. His repeated attack on Odishan empire from 1512 to 1519 A.D. shattered the prestige of the empire. He defeated the Odia army in battle after battle. The fall of Kondavidu, Udayagiri, Kondapalli forts and minor fortresses like Addanki, Vinukonda, Bellamakonda, Tangenda etc. took place in quick succession and Krishnadevaraya accomplished all these conquests and broke the morale of the Odishan army. Dark clouds loomed large in the horizon of Odisha, when Gajapati Prataparudradeva signed a humiliating treaty with Krishnadevaraya, as stated earlier. This subdued and shadowed the power and personality of Prataparudradeva. This also weakened the mental strength of the Odishan army. The result of the potracted struggle of Prataparudradeva with Krishnadevaraya was politically disastrous because the far-flung Gajapati empire was greatly curtailed in the South due to Krishnadevaraya, the mightiest emperor at the Vijayanagara empire.

2.1.2.6. Adversities of Prataparudradeva

Prataparudradeva was encompassed with insurmountable problems that broke his mental strength. The territorial loss broke the imperial zeal of Prataparudra. His valiant son Birabhadra was a prisoner at the hands of Krishnadevaraya. He was a notable sword-fighter by that time. To humiliate him, Krishnadevaraya told the former to cross sword with another man of the court who belonged to a lower family. This brought disgrace to Birabhadra who plunged his sword into his heart and breathed his last. This disaster led Prataparudra to submit before Krishnadevaraya and without waging war, he concluded the humiliating treaty with the latter. Besides the territorial loss, he had to offer his own daughter Jagamohini (later on known as Tukka) to his arch enemy, Krishnadevaraya. Further, capitulation of his great military officers like Narahari Patra, Balachandra Mahapatra, Sirsachandra Mohapatra. Bodhan Mohapatra, Mallu Khan, Udanda Khan and others by Krishnadevaraya's army broke the military zeal of Prataparudradeva. The treachery of Govinda Vidyadhara led Prataparudra at his wits end. All these circumstances weakened his mind and made his health fragile. He lost all interest in warfare and took refuge in the Vaisnava faith preached by Sri Chaitanya. This gave a strategic blow to the very existence of the Gajapati kingdom.

2.1.2.7. Betrayal of Govinda Vidyadhara

The treachery of Govinda Vidyadhara was a potent factor for the decline of medieval Odisha. He was a minister of Prataparudradeva and had accompanied him as a general in his march towards Bengal for settling score with Hussain Shah. Hussain Shah took shelter in the fort of Mandaran. When Prataparudradeva besieged the fort of Mandaran, the fall of Hussain Shah seemed to be imminent. At this stage, Govinda Vidyadhara played the role of a traitor and Prataparudra was unable to assert his decisive victory over Hussain Shah. The Gajapati also pardoned Govinda Vidyadhara as there was no substitute to him in discharging the administration of the state. When Prataparudra left to deal with the affairs of the South, he entrusted the management of administration to Govinda Vidyadhara. This discouraged the Odishan army and adversely affected their morale making them weak and feeble. In later stage, this Govinda Vidyadhara became a traitor and became an usurper to the throne of Odisha by killing the sons of Prataparudradeva. He sounded the death-knell of the Suryavamsi Gajapati dynasty and brought into existence the inglorious Bhoi dynasty in the political arena of medieval Odisha.

2.1.2.8. Weak army

The medeval Odishan army which was instrumental in building the vast empire of the Gajapati's, became weak during the period of Prataparudradeva. One of its reason may be this that due to constant warfare during all the Gajapatis, they could not get ample time to be with their family. Their constant absence from Odisha and camping at distant South lost their martial spirit. The treachery of Govinda Vidyadhara during the Bengal campaign of Prataparudradeva, which turned the surest victory of the Odishan army into a failure, broke the morale of the soldiers. Further, the important military officers of the army were taken captives by Krishnadevaraya. After that no good commander was available to lead the Odishan army in proper direction. Thus, it is seen that during Mukundadeva, the Odishan army got easy defeat at the hands of the Muslim army of Bengal led by Bayazid and Kalapahada. Definitely, weak army brought the downfall of the medieval Odisha.

2.1.2.9. Role of Sri Chaitanya and Vaishnavism

Vaishnavism in Odisha under Sri Chaitanya was a great factor for the downfall of medieval Odisha. He had came to Puri in 1510 A.D. He went to South for two years after his short stay at Puri and then went to Vrindavana, stayed there for two years and returned Puri

where he stayed till his death due to the insistence of his mother Sachidevi. That was the period of growth of Vaishnavism which was gaining popularity due to the writings of *Pancha Sakhas.* Sri Chaitanya though this place congenial for the spread of Vaisnavism. Raya Ramananda, the author of *Jagannatha Vallabha Natakam* and a Governor of Prataparudradeva was impressed by the teachings and personality of Sri Chaitanya. He left the job and accepted Vaishnavism. He made an arrangement by which Prataparudradeva met Sri Chaitanya and came under his spell sometimes after 1519 A.D. By that time, Prataparudra had suffered reverses at the hands of Krishnadevaraya and had been visited by heavy tolls of life. He found panacea in Vaishnavism and accepted it and lost his martial spirit.

It is natural that when a king accepts a particular religion, his subjects accept that faith. When Prataparudradeva accepted *Vaishnavism,* many followers of this *Gaudiya* Vaisnava faith emerged during that period. The text *Chaitanya Charitamrita* states that many influential persons of Odisha like Raya Ramananda, Kanhai Khuntia, Janardana Mahanty, Tulasi Parichha, Kasi Mishra, Pradyumna Mishra and many others accepted Vaishnavism. This definitely gave a set back to the efficient administrative set up of the Gajapati as most of the followers of this *Gaudiya* Vaishnavism neglected their duties. The soldiers of the Gajapatis, now tired with warfare, came under the influence of Vaishnavism. This led to the loss of their martial spirit. Thus, some historians opine that Sri Chaitanya and his Vaishnavism contributed a lot for the downfall of medieval Odisha. Sri Chaitanya's responsibility for the downfall of medieval Odisha has allured the attention of historians.

Prof. R.D. Banerjee makes Sri Chaitanya largely responsible for this. He states, " The religious equality and love preached by Sri Chaitanya brought in its train a false faith in men and thereby destroyed the structure of society and government of Bengal and Odisha." Prof. Banerjee draws the attention of scholars of Jayananda's *Jayamangala* where in it has been stated that Sri Chaitanya once advised Prataparudradeva not to conquer Bengal but to march towards the South. Prataparudra, thus, left his deal with Hussain Shah of Bengal and marched towards Chandragiri and the result was embarrassment on the part of Prataparudradeva. Similarly, the influence of Sri Chaitanya over Prataparudradeva paved the way for the downfall of medieval Odisha. ' , Prof. Banerjee's view has been taken with a pinch of salt by many scholars like Profs. N. K. Sahu, K. C. Panigrahi, P. Mukherjee and many others. From their discussion, it becomes apparent that although, Prataparudradeva was under the spell of Sri Chaitanya, he had marched to the South to

wage war before his, death. According to Jayananda's description, Sri Chaitanya advised Prataparudradeva not to march towards Bengal and Prataparudra obeyed it. If analysis of all the existing sources will be made, it will clearly indicate that before the deal of Prataparudra with Hussain Shah, he had not met Sri Chaitanya. Further, when Prataparudra marched towards the South, why Sri Chaitanya could not stop the movement of Prataparudradeva ? So, the question of Sri Chaitanya's influence over Prataparudradeva is relegated to the distant background. The causes of the downfall, therefore, might be the weak army of Odisha and Prataparudra's inefficiency arousing out of misfortunes that befall on him. Further, Prataparudradeva had no match with Krishnadevaraya, a valiant warrior of the time that the Vijayanagara empire had ever produced. The weak successors of Prataparudradeva, treachery and confusion, attack of Kalapahada etc. might be other reasons for the downfall of the medieval Odishan empire.

2.1.2.10. Treachery and Confusion after the death of Prataparudradeva

The period that followed the death of Prataparudradeva was one of the situations, full with anarchy and confusion. It was marked with bloodshed, murder and usurption. It is known, how Govinda Vidyadhara had killed the sons of Prataparudradeva. With the death of Govinda Vidyadhara, his son Chakra Pratapa came to the throne who was killed by his own son Narasimha Jena. Mukunda Harichandan killed Narasimha Jena and Raghunatha Jena Chhotaraya, another brother of Narasimha Jena. He also imprisoned Danai Vidyadhara and ascended the throne in 1560 A.D. These murders and bloodshed made the people of Odisha grossly unhappy who remained confused always. This created anarchy and gave scope to the Muslim invasion.

2.1.2.11. Economic bankruptcy

Undoubtedly, by conducting several, war and undertaking various military campaigns, the treasury of the Gajapati kings became empty. Further, the exploits derived from the military campaigns were spent by the Odishan soldiers in luxury. Several wars resulted in heavy expenditure on military front by the Gajapati kings. This gave a death blow to the treasury of the Gajapati kings and no welfare projects could be undertaken by the kings for his subjects. This led to the gross dissatisfaction of the subjects towards the Gajapati rule and made it unpopular in Odisha. That was, perhaps, a great reason for which a good number of people left the Odishan army and concentrated on cultivation as they did not get their salary from the state in time. Thus, the financial bankruptcy paved the way for the downfall of medieval Odisha.

2.1.2.12. Laziness of the Feudatory chiefs

With the accession of Mukundadeva, the chaos and confusion in the post -Gajapati era had come to a halt. When peace was to be restored, it was the apathy of the feudatory chiefs towards Mukundadeva that prepared the way for the downfall of medieval Odisha. Taking advantage of the end of Gajapati rule and beginning of the inauspicious rule of the Bhoi dynasty, the local chieftains asserted their independence. Visvanatha Deo of Nandapur, the Bahuvalendras of Krishnakota and even the Bhanjas declared their independence. The worst example of it can be cited when Ramachandra Bhanja of Sarangagarah declared independence when Mukundadeva was fighting against the Muslim invaders of Bengal. This undoubtedly paved the way for the downfall of medieval Odisha.

2.1.2.13. Lack of unity and harmony

Lack of unity and solidarity among the chieftains after the fall of the Gajapati empire, pave the way for the Muslim invasion. When Bayazid and Kalapahada attacked Odisha, it was the duty of all the feudatory chiefs to ignore the differences among them and to offer unconditional help to Mukundadeva for averting the Muslim menace. Petty interests kept them disunited and weakened the strength of the Odia giving chance to the Muslim army of Bengal to be victorious on this soil. Had it not been so, then the Muslim army would have definitely been defeated by the combined army of Odisha under the redoubtable leadership of Mukundadeva.

2.1.2.14. Attack of Kalapahada

Taking the anarchy and confusion of Odisha into consideration, Sulaiman Karrani, the Afghan ruler of Bengal, dispatched an army under the leadership of his son, Bayazid and General, Kalaphahad. Kalapahada brought a great damage to the temple of Odisha after Mukundadeva was defeated. The death of Mukundadeva and subsequently of Ramachandra Bhanja led Kalapahada to show his barbarism on this soil and to smash the pride of this land. The people of Odisha were frightened so much by the acts of Kalapahada that nobody ventured to go against him. Thus, the invasion of Kalapahada gave a final touch to the downfall of Medieval Odisha. The medieval Odishan empire had reached the historical climax with the rule of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis.

2.1.3. Conclusion

Thus, the above causes were responsible for the decline of medieval Odisha. Besides, the degeneration of the moral conduct of the people of Odisha was no less than other causes which

contributed a lot to the fall of medieval Odisha. In due course of time, Odisha came under the control of the Afghans, Mughals, Marathas and lastly, the British with gradual succession.

2.1.4. Summary

- Different factors contributed a lot for the decline of medieval Odishan empire.
- The law of nature i.e. each dynasty has its own birth, growth and decline was also applicable in case of the Gajapati empire in medieval Odisha.
- With the death of Prataparudradeva, the Gajapati empire did not get a good successor.
- The great fratricidal war between Hamvira and Purusottamadeva, the two sons of Kapilendradeva, sowed the seeds of dissension in the Gajapati empire.
- The Muslim rulers posed great menace to the policy of territorial expansion of the Gajapati rulers.
- Krishnadevaraya of the Vijayanagara empire became a potent threat to the very existence of the Gajapati kingdom.
- Prataparudradeva was encompassed with insurmountable problems that broke his mental strength.
- The treachery of Govinda Vidyadhara was a potent factor for the decline of medieval Odisha.
- The medeval Odishan army which was instrumental in building the vast empire of the Gajapati's, became weak during the period of Prataparudradeva.
- Vaishnavism in Odisha under Sri Chaitanya was a great factor for the downfall of medieval Odisha.
- The period that followed the death of Prataparudradeva was one of the situations, full with anarchy and confusion.
- Undoubtedly, by conducting several, war and undertaking various military campaigns, the treasury of the Gajapati kings became empty.
- When peace was to be restored, it was the apathy of the feudatory chiefs towards Mukundadeva that prepared the way for the downfall of medieval Odisha.
- Lack of unity and solidarity among the chieftains after the fall of the Gajapati empire, pave the way for the Muslim invasion.

- Taking the anarchy and confusion of Odisha into consideration, Sulaiman Karrani, the Afghan ruler of Bengal, dispatched an army under the leadership of his son, Bayazid and General, Kalaphahad.
- Thus, the above causes were responsible for the decline of medieval Odisha.

2.1.5. Exercise

- **Discuss the factors responsible for the decline of medieval kingdom of Odisha.**
- **"Sri Chaitanya and his Vashnavaism was responsible for the decline of medieval kingdom of Odisha." Explain.**
- **Discuss how weak successors were responsible for the decline of medieval kingdom in Odisha?**
- **"External invasion was one of the important factor for the decline of medieval kingdom in Odisha." Justify.**
- **Highlight the causes that led to the decline and disintegration of medieval kingdom in Odisha.**

2.1.6. Further reading

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UNIT-2
Chapter-II

Sri Chaitany faith in Odisha: its impact

Structure

2.2.0. Objectives
2.2.1. Introduction

2.2.2. Sri Chaitanya faith in Odisha: its Impact

2.2.2. 1. Early life of Sri Chaitanya

2.2.2. 2. His *Sanyasa* and involvement in *Bhakti* cult

2.2.2. 3. Impact of Sri Chaitany faith in Odisha

2.2.2. 4. Jagannath as identical with Krishna

2.2.2. 5. Panchasakha and Sri Chaitanya

2.2.3. Conclusion

2.2.4. Summary

2.2.5. Exercise

2.2.6. Further reading

2.2.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss Sri Chaitanya faith in Odisha and its impact. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the early life of Sri Chaitanya*
- *understand his sanyasa life*
- *know about his coming to Odisha*
- *identify the Sri Chaitanya faith in Odisha*
- *recognise the impact of Sri Chaitanya faith in Odisha*

2.2.1.Introduction

The coming of Sri Chaitanya to Odisha opened a new chapter in the religious history of Odisha. The Vaishanavite religion which was already in existence had a deep impact in the mind of the people of Odisha. The spell of his teaching and *Sankirtan* influenced so much that the people of Odisha lost their military skill. His *Sankirtan had* spread to every nook and corner of Odisha

2.2.2. Sri Chaitanya faith in Odisha: its Impact

Sri Chaitanya faith in Odisha has a deep impact on the life and culture of the people of this land which can be discussed bellow.

2.2.2. 1. Early life of Sri Chaitanya

Sri Chaitanya (1486-1533 A.D.), who was known as Visvambhara before renouncing family life hailed from Navadvipa of Bengal He was born in a Brahmin family in 1486 A.D. which had migrated from Jaipur to Navadvipa. As a boy, Visvambhara was handsome, prodigious and naughty. He was also known as Gouranga for his fair complexion. Early in the life he became a great Sanskrit scholar and established a *tol* for imparting education. He lost his father at the age of eighteen. Soon after his father's death, he married a girl, named Lakshmidevi. Lakshmidevi died of snake bite within a short time after the marriage. Thereafter Visvambhara took a second wife, named Vishnupriya. After the second marriage, he went to Gaya to offer *pinda* to his ancestors.

2.2.2. 2. His *Sanyasa* and involvement in *Bhakti* cult

At this stage he was initiated into the cult of *Bhakti* by a Vaishnava saint, named Isvara Purl. The religious atmosphere of the Vishnu temple of Gaya, where Viswambhara offered *pinda* threw him into trance. He turned a great devotee of Vishnu or Lord Krishna. On his return from Gaya, he gave up his scholastic profession, and started living the life of religious devotion and service. He organized *Sankirtans* and attracted large number of people.

In 1509 A.D., at the age of twenty four, he left home, and taking the vow of *Sanyasa* from Keshav Bharati and the name, Sri Krishna Chaitanya, he proceeded to Puri with some of his associates.

2.2.2. 3. Impact of Sri Chaitany faith in Odisha

In Odisha Sri Chaitanya roused a great deal of religious devotion and enthusiasm. His *Sankirtan* parties attracted a large number of people at Puri. On his arrival at Purl, he had a religious discussion with the great Vedantic scholar, Vasudeva Sarbabhauma, who enjoyed the patronage of the Gajapati Prataparudra. Defeated in the discussion and impressed by the religious personality of Sri Chaitanya Sarbabhauma embraced Vaishnavism. From Puri, Sri Chaitanya proceeded to south, and in June 1509 A.D., met Roy Ramananda, the governor of Rajamahendri. They had an interesting religious dialogue which is narrated in the *Chaitanya Charitamrita* of Kaviraj Krishna Das. Both appreciated each other's religious inclination. After the interview with Sri Chaitanya, Ramananda who was already an old man resigned from the royal duty with a view to spending his time with the former at Puri. The *Chaitanya Charitamrita* tells us that Sri Chaitanya refused to grant interview to Prataparudra, the Gajapati of Odisha on the ground that he wanted to keep aloof from the worldly power and wealth. But at the instruction of Sarbabhaurna, one day the Gajapati stole into the assembly of devotees in Kasi Mishra's house where Sri Chaitanya was staying. As Sri Chaitanya fell into trance on hearing *Sankirtana.* Prataparudra touched his feet. On coming to senses, Sri Chaitanya remarked, "Woe to me, I have touched one, given to worldly power and wealth". This remarked moved the Gajapati,to tears. Impressed by the true devotion of the Gajapati, Sri Chaitanya embraced him with love.

2.2.2. 4. Jagannath as identical with Krishna

Sri Chaitanya considered Jagannath as identical with Krishna of Kurukshetra. He also popularised Krishna whom he regarded as "the complete manifestation of personal godhead in his perfect form". The Chaitanya faith heightened the importance of Radha, the consort of - Krishna. For many devotees Sri Chaitanya was considered as the living embodiment of Jagannath. He was also regarded as the dual incarnation of Radha and Krishna. By personal demonstration, Sri Chaitanya emphasised the importance of devotion. His faith roused religious devotion among all sections of society, undermined the rigours of caste distinctions and reinforced the Vaishnavism of Odisha. Sri Chaitanya died at Puri before the image of Jagannath on 29th June 1533 A,D. He spent six years of his *Sanyasa* in pilgrimage, and the remaining eighteen years of *Sanyasa* at Puri in the company of his devout followers. Here it is necessary to mention the relation of the Panchasakha and Odishan Vaishnavas with Sri Chaitanya. Vaishnavism was already popular in Odisha before the coming of Sri Chaitanya to Puri. Sri Chaitanya had high regards for the Odishan Vaishnava saints like Raya Ramananda with whom he had a dialogue on Radha-Krishna cult, and Jagannath Das and Balaram Das of Panchasakha group.

2.2.2. 5. Panchasakha and Sri Chaitanya

All the Panchasakha poets were the contemporaries of Sri Chaitanya and were initiated by him. Nevertheless the Panchasakha, instead of blindly following Chaitanya faith maintained their distinctiveness by sticking to the concept of void and identifying the same with Lord Krishna. Some scholars are of opinion that the Panchasakha outwardly professed the Chaitanya cult yet in their heart of hearts they were but sincere religion of the Mahayana school." According to Chittaranjan Das the Panchasakha were at once Buddhists, Vaishnavas and Tantriks. As a religious movement the Panchasakha emphasised the concept of void inner purity, *mantra*, *tantra* and *yoga*, instead of being guided by formalities. As social reformers, the Panchasakha sought to pull down "the hegemony of the social bigots" and raise up "the lower strata of society with the means of cultural innovations", they took disciples from all the castes and associated themselves with several lower castes of society and tried for their uplift.

2.2.3. Conclusion

Thus, Sri Chaitanya and Vaishnvaism had a long march in the religious and cultural history of Odisha. During the Ganga period, it flourished receiving royal patronage. During the Gajapati period, it reached the pinnacle of glory. The coming of Sri Chaitanya and his *Sankirtan* made Vaishanavaism more popular in all over Odisha. Sri Chaitanya popularized Radha-Krishna cult through *Kirtan* in the nook and corner of Odisha.

2.2.4. Summary

- The coming of Sri Chaitanya to Odisha opened a new chapter in the religious history of Odisha.
- The Vaishanavite religion which was already in existence had a deep impact in the mind of the people of Odisha.
- Sri Chaitanya faith in Odisha has a deep impact on the life and culture of the people of this land.
- He was born in a Brahmin family in 1486 A.D. which had migrated from Jaipur to Navadvipa. As a boy, Visvambhara was handsome, prodigious and naughty.
- He was also known as Gouranga for his fair complexion.
- He lost his father at the age of eighteen. Soon after his father's death, he married a girl, named Lakshmidevi. Lakshmidevi died of snake bite within a short time after the marriage.
- Thereafter Visvambhara took a second wife, named Vishnupriya.
- After the second marriage, he went to Gaya to offer *pinda* to his ancestors.
- At this stage he was initiated into the cult of *Bhakti* by a Vaishnava saint, named Isvara Purl.
- The religious atmosphere of the Vishnu temple of Gaya, where Viswambhara offered *panda.*
- In 1509 A.D., at the age of twenty four, he left home, and taking the vow of *Sanyasa* from Keshav Bharati and the name, Sri Krishna Chaitanya, he proceeded to Puri with some of his associates.
- In Odisha Sri Chaitanya roused a great deal of religious devotion and enthusiasm.

- His *Sankirtan* parties attracted a large number of people at Puri. On his arrival at Purl, he had a religious discussion with the great Vedantic scholar, Vasudeva Sarbabhauma, who enjoyed the patronage of the Gajapati Prataparudra.
- Defeated in the discussion and impressed by the religious personality of Sri Chaitanya Sarbabhauma embraced Vaishnavism.
- From Puri, Sri Chaitanya proceeded to south, and in June 1509 A.D., met Roy Ramananda, the governor of Rajamahendri.
- His faith roused religious devotion among all sections of society, undermined the rigours of caste distinctions and reinforced the Vaishnavism of Odisha.
- Sri Chaitanya died at Puri before the image of Jagannath on 29th June 1533 A,D.
- All the Panchasakha poets were the contemporaries of Sri Chaitanya and were initiated by him.
- Nevertheless the Panchasakha, instead of blindly following Chaitanya faith maintained their distinctiveness by sticking to the concept of void and identifying the same with Lord Krishna.
- Thus, Sri Chaitanya and Vaishnvaism had a long march in the religious and cultural history of Odisha.

2.2.5. Exercise

- **Discuss the life and teaching of Sri Chaitanya.**
- **Write a note on the Sri Chaitanya faith in Odisha.**
- **Highlight the impact of Sri Chaitanya faith on the people of Odisha.**
- **Discuss the relation between the *Panchasakhas* and Sri Chaitanya.**

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UNIT-2
Chapter-III

Panchasakhas and *Bhakti* movement

Structure

2.3.0. Objectives

2.3.1. Introduction

2.3.2. Pancha Sakhas

2.3.2. 1. Balarama Dasa

2.3.2. 2. Achyutananda Das

2.3.2. 3. Atibadi Jagannatha Das

2.3.2. 4. Yasobanta Das

2.3.2. 5. Sisu Ananta Das

2.3.2. 6. Bhakti movement in Odisha

2.3.2. 7. Radha and Krishna Bhakti

2.3.2. 8. Sri Chaitanya and *Panchasakhas*

2.3.2. 9. Panchasakhas and Bhakti movement

2.3.3. Conclusion

2.3.4. Summary

2.3.5. Exercise

2.3.6. Further reading

2.3.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss Panchasakhas and Bhakti movement. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the Panchasakhas and Bhakti movement*
- *understand the life and works of Balaram Das*
- *know about Jagannath Das*
- *identify the life and works of* Achyutananda Das, Yashobanta Das and Sisu Ananta Das
- *recognise the Bhakti movement in Odisha under the Panchasakhas.*

2.3.1.Introduction

The famous five Saints or five Friends of medieval Odisha were collectively known as Pancha Sakhas. They were Balarama Das, Jagannatha Das, Achyutananda Das, Yasobanta Das and Sisu Ananta Das. They started their own Sampradaya, preaching Bhakti for Radha and Krishna in Odisha before the arrival of Chaitanya, following a tradition that had been established by Jayadeva's Gita Govinda. Such was the popularity of Gita Govinda that, king Purushottama Deva wrote his own imitation, called Abhinava Gita Govinda, hoping to establish it as the new devotional success of his times. Many other Oriya poets such as Dinakrishna, Abhimanyu, Bhakta Charan, Baladeva and Gopala Krishna etc. composed poems about Krishna's romantic storieswhich is famous as Valis.

2.3.2. Pancha Sakhas

The Pancha Sakha have played a great role in the religious and socio-cultural history of Odisha. Towards the 16th century five poets emerged Balaram Das, Jagannath Das, Achyutananda Das, Ananta Das and Jasobanta Das. Although their dates of activity span one hundred years, they are collectively known as "Panchasakhas", since they adhered to the same school of thought, i.e. Utkaliya Vaishnavism.

2.3.2. 1. Balarama Das

He was born between 1472 and 1482 in Erabanga village at Gop (near Konarak). His father was Somanatha Mahapatra and his mother was Mahamaya Devi. Some say that he was

born in the village of Chandrapur, where he also met Chaitanya. Balarama Das became a minister of king Prataparudra Dev, but after meeting Chaitanya he left the Government service and utilized his previous knowledge of Kundalini yoga, vaidhi bhakti in the mood of Ramanuja Acharya, and jnana to propagate the chanting of the Holy Name. He is sometimes called Matta Balarama, because of his disregard for social conventions in favor of ecstatic Bhakti.

He used to participate to the discussions on Vedanta in the Mukti Mandapa in the Jagannatha temple (inspite of the resentment of the Brahmins), and it is said that anyone who touched his head would become instantly able to explain the philosophy of Vedanta. One day a beggar (who was dumb and deaf) approached him, touching his head, and he was not only cured and became able to speak, but he also started to discuss philosophy immediately. This beggar then became Balarama's foremost disciple with the name of Hari Das.

The mula mantra chanted and taught by Balarama Das was the Krishna mantra. His residence in Puri is called Gandharva Matha. Balarama Das wrote the famous Jagamohana or Dandi Ramayana, as well as a number of other works entitled Gita Abakasa, Bhava samudra, Gupta Gita, Vedanta Sara, Mriguni Stuti, Saptanga yogasara tika, Vedanta sara or Brahma tika, Baula gai gita, Kamala locana chotisa, Kanta koili, Bedha parikrama, Brahma gita, Brahmanda bhugola, Vajra kavaca, Jnana chudamani, Virat gita, Ganesh vibhuti, Amarakosha Gita, Lakshmi Purana (which is very popular in Odisha).

In his Bata Abakasa he writes hat Lord Jagannatha is served by 64 yoginis. In his Virata Gita, he describes the nirakara form of Krishna as Sunya. However, his idea of Sunya is quite particular, as it includes form and relationships. He was also a social worker and reformer, and an expert astrologer as well. He disappeared in 1540.

2.3.2. 2. Achyutananda Das

He was born in Tilakana near Nemala, Cuttack, in 1485; his father was Dinabandhu Khuntia and his mother's name was Padmavati. His grandfather Gopinath Mohanty had served in the army of the Gajapati King. As a child, he was named Agani. When he grew older, he had a mystic dream where the Lord taught him the Gita, the Upanishads and the Tantra. Immediately he went to pilgrimage and on the way he met Chaitanya and it is said he received Harinam

initiation from Him. Some other people say that he went to meet Chaitanya together with his father; he was then 18 years old.

At the time of Achyutananda's initiation, Chaitanya asked Sanatana Gosvami to take care of him and coach him in spiritual knowledge. Achyutananda married the daughter of Raghurana Champati Rai and stayed in Dhauligram. He had 12 main disciples, of whom the most prominent was Ramachandra Das. The King gave him some land in Banki Mohana. The mula mantra he chanted and taught was the Radha mantra. Achyutananda is mostly famous for the book of prophecies called Achyutananda Malika, composed of 13 chapters, describing the future destruction of the town of Puri after Jagannatha has moved out, and the appearance of Kalki avatara who will annihilate all the evildoers starting from Odisha. A few summary studies have been published in Oriya language Achyutananda also translated into Oriya and commented Harivamsa, Tattva bodhini, Sunya samhita, Jyoti samhita, Gopala Ujjvala, Baranasi Gita, Anakara Brahma Samhita, Abhayada Kavacha, Astagujari, Sarana panjara stotra, Vipra chalaka, Mana mahima.

He wrote a book about the preaching mission of the Pancha sakhas (five friends) and organized a travelling party of Rahasankirtana, for which he also wrote several bhajan songs. It is said that once he was attacked by some envious Brahmins and he manifested his laghima yoga siddhi by becoming extremely light and floating away in the air. Achyutananda's teachings present a fusion of Saguna and Nirguna worship, uniting the doctrines of Dvaita and Advaita, and knowledge from Upanishads and Kundalini yoga. He left his body on Jyestha sukla Ekadasi.

2.3.2. 3. Atibadi Jagannatha Das

He was born in Kapilesvarapur or Kapilesvar grama (one of the 16 traditional Sasana villages) at 14 kms from Puri towards Brahmagiri, on the day of Radhastami of 1487 (some say in 1490). Because he was born on Radhastami, he is considered to have a close relationship with Srimati Radhika. His mother was Padmavati Devi and his father was Bhagavan Das, from the Kaushiki Gotra. He used to recite the Bhagavata Purana in Lord's Jagannatha temple, and his explanations were so attractive that king Prataparudra gave him the title of "Purana Panda". As son of the Purana Panda, Jagannatha Das used to sit by his father and learn the Bhagavata. One day, while visiting the temple, Chaitanya noticed the 18 years old boy sitting near the Bata Ganesha Deity in Sri Mandira, reciting the Brahma stuti from Gopa lila (10th Canto), and honored him by offering him a cloth and the title of Atibadi ("very great").

Jagannatha Das also used to go to recite the Bhagavatam in the houses of people and made no discrimination on the basis of bodily identification, befriending men and women in the same way. A famous incident regarded such confidential exchanges with Medha and Sumedha, two ladies endowed with great spiritual power and who were said to be going in the night to visit Jagannatha in the temple by their mystic powers after it was closed. Some envious men complained to king Prataparudra accusing Jagannatha Das of immoral behavior (illicit relationships with women) and the King called him for questioning. Jagannatha Das replied that for him there was no difference between men and women; he said that in fact when he was associating with ladies, he actually regarded himself as a woman, too.

The King did not believe him but when Jagannatha Das was put in jail he actually manifested himself in the form of a woman and the guards, impressed, called the King to witness such an extraordinary feat. King Prataparudra realized he had committed an offense to a great devotee, so not only he released him/her from prison, but he also asked that s/he gave initiation to his chief Queen into Bhakti yoga. The Queen invited Jagannatha Das within the royal palace, where he could open his own Matha, called Bada Odiya Matha.

It is said that by the order of Narada Muni, Jagannatha Das translated Srimad Bhagavatam into Oriya. This work gave him the reputation of the best spiritual teacher in Odisha in his times, and is still extremely popular even today, being worshiped and recited in all households. In fact in Odisha this text is considered on the same level of Tulasi Das' Rama charita manasa.

Jagannatha Das wrote also Gupta Bhagavat, Tula vina, Sola chapadi, Chari chapadi, Tola bena, Daru brahma gita, Diksa samyad, Artha koili, Muguni stuti, Annamaya kundali, Goloka sarodhara, Bhakti chandrika, Kali malika, Indra malika, Niladri vilasa, Nitya gupta chintamani, Sri Krishna bhakti kalpa lata and other books. The mula mantra he chanted and taught was the Rama mantra. He established two Mathas in Puri, the Bada Odiya Matha and the Satalahari Matha. His main disciple was Baliga Das. Jagannatha Das passed away on Sukla Magha saptami (the day of Chandrabhaga Mela in Konarak) in 1557, and his Samadhi Mandira is on the beach. His main disciples were Uddhava, Ramachandra, Gopinatha, Hari Das, Nandani Acharya, Vamani Mahapatra, Srimati Gaura, Gopala Das, Akhandala Mekapa, Janardana Pati, Krishna Das, Vanamali Das, Govardhana Das, Kanai Khuntia, Jagannatha Das and Madhusudana Das.

2.3.2. 4. Yasobanta Das

He was born in 1482 near Aranga Nandi village, district of Cuttack, in a kshatriya family. His father was Balabhadra Mala, his mother was Rekha Devi. He married Anjana Devi, the sister of king Raghunath Champatti of Aranga. Later on, he took sannyasa and traveled to many holy places in India, he attained mystic powers and was able to change his form at will. The mula mantra he chanted and taught was the Shyama mantra.

He wrote Govinda chandra, Shiva sarodaya, Sasti mala, Prema bhakti, Brahma gita, Atma pariche gita, a Malika and several bhajans. The Govinda chandra became very famous in Assam, Bengal and north India; it is basically related with traditional dance and teaching of dance, connected with the Vaishnava tradition. His best disciple was Lohi Das. It is said that also the famous saint Salabega was his disciple. He left his body on Margasira sukla Sasti.

2.3.2. 5. Sisu Ananta Das

He was born in Balipatna village, near Bhubaneswara, in 1488. His father's name was Kapila, and his mother's Gaura Devi. In a dream he received from Surya Narayana in Konarak the order to go and meet Chaitanya, so he approached the party and took diksha initiation from Nityananda Prabhu. Sisu Ananta Das resided in Khandagiri, in what is today called Gadi Tapovana Ashram; through his Sadhana he attained mystic powers, and he was able to change his form at will. Usually he would take the form of a little child, hence his name as Sisu. In this form, he became the adopted son of the wife of king Prataparudra, who nursed him.

He personally found a Patita pavana (Jagannatha) murti in the Matha in Balia patana. His main disciples were Barang Das, Hamsa Das, and Sisu Das. He wrote the Bhakti mukti daya gita, one of the oldest and most important popular scriptures of Odisha, and other texts like Sisu Deva gita, Artha tarani, Udebhakara, Tirabhakana, a Malika and several bhajan songs. In Udaya bhagavata he describes Lord Jagannatha as the combined form of Radha and Krishna. However, due to general lack of interest, these books are not properly valued at present.

2.3.2. 6. Bhakti movement in Odisha

Bhakti movements had played a significant role in the religious history of ancient and medieval Odisha. Historians have subjected them to extensive scholarly scrutiny. As a result, we

know a great deal about various *bhakti* movements like the Alvar and Nayanar movements of Tamilnadu, the Virasaiva and HariDas movements of Karnataka, and the Varkari movement of Maharashtra. We also know about individual saints like Tulsidas, Kabir, Surdas, Vallabha, Ramananda, Mira, Lal Ded, Annamacharya and many others. However, *bhakti* movements in some parts of India have not received adequate attention from historians. The great *panchasakha* movement of sixteenth century Odisha is one of them.

2.3.2. 7.Radha and Krishna Bhakti

Songs on Radha and Krishna written by Vidyapati of Mithila (in north Bihar) had also become famous in Odisha, and in fact both Jayadeva's and Vidyapati's songs were deeply appreciated by Chaitanya, who had them sung again and again to him by his companions. Before meeting Chaitanya, Ramananda Raya had written the Mahabhava prakasa, in which Kanhai (Krishna) describes Radha as the embodiment of mahabhava, and the Jagannatha vallabha nataka. Another work on Krishna Bhakti that enjoyed great popularity before the arrival of Chaitanya was Markanda Das's Kesava koili.

2.3.2. 8.Sri Chaitanya and *Panchasakhas*

The five Friends all came in contact with Chaitanya, who arrived in Sri Kshetra in 1510, and often associated with him and his followers. Chaitanya Bhagavata mentions Nityananda and Ramananda Raya celebrating Sankirtana together with Balarama and Achyutananda. They found Chaitanya's preaching very near to their own ideas, because Chaitanya introduced the Nagara Sankirtana where there were no discriminations based on caste or social class, and the songs of the kirtanas were not only in classical Sanskrit but also in the popular languages such as Bengali and Oriya, encouraging ordinary and low-caste people to participate more directly. Chaitanya also accepted low-caste people as his followers, embraced fishermen and honored "ex-Muslim" devotees such as HariDas, Rupa and Sanatana etc.

2.3.2. 9.Panchasakhas and Bhakti movement

The liberality of the Pancha sakhas antagonized the Brahmins, who disparaged the Oryia translations of the Mahabharata, Ramayana, Bhagavata and Harivamsa compiled by Sarala, Balarama, Jagannatha and Achyutananda. The Oriya Bhagavatam of Jagannatha Das was even called "teli bhagavata", the "Bhagavata of the low-caste oil-maker". However, the literary work

of the Pancha sakhas was vital to the development of the Oriya language and cultural identity, uniting the people and creating a feeling of solidarity that protected the region for a long time.

The five Friends preached the Vaishnava dharma or ninefold process of Bhakti and chanting the Holy Names (Harinama), giving more importance to the realization of the soul rather than worship of the Deities. The most important aspect of their preaching was the abolition of all discriminations among Vaishnavas, no matter from which caste or background they came; Achyutananda, Yasovanta, Balarama and Ananta met a strong opposition from the caste-conscious Brahmins, who even disparagingly called Jagannatha Das's Oriya Bhagavata as "teli bhagavata" ("the Bhagavata of the oil-maker"). However, this Oriya Bhagavatam became so popular that every village had a Tunga, a hall where the villagers regularly gathered to listen to its reading.

As a reaction against the excessive ritualism of the caste Brahmins and their monopoly and control over the temples and Deity worship, the Pancha Sakhas preached that Lord Krishna/Jagannatha could be worshiped as Sunya, "void", a particular "non-shape" that transcended the Deity in the temple and therefore could be accessible by everyone at all times. It is important to understand that such "void" is not an impersonal emptiness devoid of sentiments, qualities and relationships – in fact quite the opposite, as Jagannatha Das preached the Rasa krida, Acyutananda preached the Nitya Rasa, Yasovanta preached the Prema bhakti brahma gita and Ananta the Tula sunya rasa.

They accepted Radha Krishna as Paramatma and Jagannatha as Radha Krishna yugala murti or bhava murti, and taught that Guru is the manifestation of Brahma, Vishnu and Mahesvara. According to their doctrine (that is also shared by many other groups, including the Natha yogis and several traditions of Bhakti in Bengal), the human body is a microcosm where the Supreme Lord resides and manifests His pastimes, including the most intimate lilas of Radha Krishna, where Radha is the pure devoted soul and Krishna is Paramatma. The Pancha sakhas followed the path of Bhakti adopting mantra, tantra and yantra in their sadhana; they manifested mystic power and could change their body into different forms.

For many generations, there has been a serious rift between the followers of the Atibadi Sampradaya and the Bengali followers of Chaitanya, and especially the Sarasvata Gaudiyas, sometimes with excessive emphasis on marginal details such as the order of the two verses of the Maha mantra sloka:

“Hare Krishna Hare Krishna, Krishna Krishna Hare Hare
Hare Rama Hare Rama, Rama Rama Hare Hare,”

While the Atibadi Sampradaya and several other ancient Gaudiya Mathas in Puri chant the mantra starting with the “Rama line”, the Sarasvata Gaudiya insist that the mantra should start with the “Krishna line” in order “not to be offensive by reversing the lines”. It is not clear how sincere followers of Chaitanya could find “offensive” the recitation of the Holy Names simply because one verse is put before the other - also considering that by continued recitation, neither of the two verses appears to come first, but they form a circle.

In fact, we have heard that Narada Muni tricked Valmiki into chanting the name of Lord Rama by instructing him to chant the name of Death (Mara); the constant chanting “in circles” of the syllables Ra and Ma was nevertheless so powerful that it turned a highway robber into the greatest devotee of Sri Ramachandra. Besides, we should remember the clear teaching of a verse of the Sikshastakam, the short ideological summary considered the only text actually written by Chaitanya:

“namnam akari bahu-dha nijasarva-saktis tatrarpita niyamitah smarane na kalah”

“O my Lord, Your holy name alone can render all benedictions to living beings, and thus You have hundreds and millions of names. In these transcendental names You have invested all Your transcendental energies. There are not even hard and fast rules for chanting these names.”

The Jagannatha charitamrita, a biography of Jagannatha Das written by Divakara Das, states that the difference between the Oriya (Utkali) and the Bengali (Gaudiya) Vaishnavas is that the Oriyas consider Jagannatha as the avatari, the source of all avataras, while the Bengalis say that Krishna is the avatari.

Such distinction could be easily overcome by considering that Jagannatha is Krishna Himself, and especially in the light of the acintya bhedabheda tattva taught by Chaitanya. The rift between the Bengali and Oriya Vaishnavas has lasted long enough, and is based on very flimsy grounds, more emotional than philosophical or theological. Divakar Das wrote that the Bengali devotees were jealous of the Oriya devotees, and in fact still today we find people from the Sarasvata Gaudiya line writing that the title “Atibadi” given by Chaitanya to Jagannatha Das was meant in an offensive and sarcastic way, while we know that Chaitanya strictly taught and demonstrated the utmost humility towards all groups of people.

Some also say that the powerful influence of the Atibadi Sampradaya, challenging the excessive ritualism and casteism of the orthodox society, was carried to the extreme consequences by the antibrahminic and iconoclastic movement called Mahima Dharma in more recent times. However, this would be an exaggeration considering that the Mahima Dharma actively opposed the worship of Jagannatha, to the point of attacking the Puri temple with the intent of destroying the Deities. This seems to be quite far fetched, as all the Atibadi Mathas worship the form of Jagannatha as well as other divine forms, and uphold the sacredness of the Shastra, which the Mahima sect do not recognize.

The Acharya in the sixth generation of the disciplic succession from the Atibadi Sampradaya, Purushottama Das, had five prominent disciples, the first of which, Mukunda Das, became the Mahanta of the Bodo Oriya Matha, and the other four established new branches of the Matha in Puri, called Sana Oriya Matha, Rama-Hari Das Matha, Vanamali Das matha and Bhagavata Das Matha.

2.3.3. Conclusion

The five great Oriya saints (*panchasakhas*) from the sixteenth century, Balarama Das, Jagannatha Das, Achyutananda Das, Yasovanta Das and Sisu Ananta Das, were contemporaries and associates of Chaitanya. They were devotees of Lord Jagannatha and lived in the town of Puri. The role played by them in the socio-religious developments of sixteenth century Odisha had a lasting impression on the subsequent religious and literary history of the region. As a result of their close association with the Suryavamsi Gajapati state, they were successful in bringing about several reforms in the Jagannatha cult. The *panchasakhas* also developed a unique philosophy of their own and produced some of the greatest masterpieces of literature in Oriya. The popularity of these works is attested by the fact that some of their works, like Jagannatha Das's *Bhagavata* and Balarama Das's *Lakshmi Purana* have survived in hundreds of manuscripts in different parts of Odisha.

2.3.4. Summary

- The famous five Saints or five Friends of medieval Odisha were collectively known as Pancha Sakhas.
- They were Balarama Das, Jagannatha Das, Achyutananda Das, Yasobanta Das and Sisu Ananta Das.

- They started their own Sampradaya, preaching Bhakti for Radha and Krishna in Odisha before the arrival of Chaitanya, following a tradition that had been established by Jayadeva's Gita Govinda.
- The Pancha Sakha have played a great role in the religious and socio-cultural history of Odisha.
- Balaram Das was born between 1472 and 1482 in Erabanga village at Gop (near Konarak).
- His father was Somanatha Mahapatra and his mother was Mahamaya Devi.
- He is sometimes called Matta Balarama, because of his disregard for social conventions in favor of ecstatic Bhakti.
- He used to participate to the discussions on Vedanta in the Mukti Mandapa in the Jagannatha temple (inspite of the resentment of the Brahmins), and it is said that anyone who touched his head would become instantly able to explain the philosophy of Vedanta.
- Balarama Das wrote the famous Jagamohana or Dandi Ramayana.
- He had also written Gita Abakasa, Bhava samudra, Gupta Gita, Vedanta Sara, Mriguni Stuti, Saptanga yogasara tika, Vedanta sara or Brahma tika, Baula gai gita, Kamala locana chotisa, Kanta koili, Bedha parikrama, Brahma gita, Brahmanda bhugola, Vajra kavaca, Jnana chudamani, Virat gita, Ganesh vibhuti, Amarakosha Gita, Lakshmi Purana (which is very popular in Odisha).
- Achyutananda Das was born in Tilakana near Nemala, Cuttack, in 1485; his father was Dinabandhu Khuntia and his mother's name was Padmavati.
- Achyutananda also translated into Oriya and commented Harivamsa, Tattva bodhini, Sunya samhita, Jyoti samhita, Gopala Ujjvala, Baranasi Gita, Anakara Brahma Samhita, Abhayada Kavacha, Astagujari, Sarana panjara stotra, Vipra chalaka, Mana mahima.
- Jagannath Das was born in Kapilesvarapur or Kapilesvar grama (one of the 16 traditional Sasana villages) at 14 kms from Puri towards Brahmagiri, on the day of Radhastami of 1487 (some say in 1490).
- Jagannatha Das wrote also Gupta Bhagavat, Tula vina, Sola chapadi, Chari chapadi, Tola bena, Daru brahma gita, Diksa samyad, Artha koili, Muguni stuti, Annamaya kundali, Goloka sarodhara, Bhakti chandrika, Kali malika, Indra malika, Niladri vilasa, Nitya gupta chintamani, Sri Krishna bhakti kalpa lata and other books.

- His main disciples were Uddhava, Ramachandra, Gopinatha, Hari Das, Nandani Acharya, Vamani Mahapatra, Srimati Gaura, Gopala Das, Akhandala Mekapa, Janardana Pati, Krishna Das, Vanamali Das, Govardhana Das, Kanai Khuntia, Jagannatha Das and Madhusudana Das.
- Yashobanta Das was born in 1482 near Aranga Nandi village, district of Cuttack, in a kshatriya family.
- He wrote Govinda chandra, Shiva sarodaya, Sasti mala, Prema bhakti, Brahma gita, Atma pariche gita, a Malika and several bhajans.
- Sisu Ananta Das was born in Balipatna village, near Bhubaneswara, in 1488. His father's name was Kapila, and his mother's Gaura Devi.
- He wrote the Bhakti mukti daya gita, one of the oldest and most important popular scriptures of Odisha, and other texts like Sisu Deva gita, Artha tarani, Udebhakara, Tirabhakana, a Malika and several bhajan songs.
- *Bhakti* movements had played a significant role in the religious history of ancient and medieval Odisha.
- The five Friends all came in contact with Chaitanya, who arrived in Sri Kshetra in 1510, and often associated with him and his followers.
- The liberality of the Pancha sakhas antagonized the Brahmins, who disparaged the Oryia translations of the Mahabharata, Ramayana, Bhagavata and Harivamsa compiled by Sarala, Balarama, Jagannatha and Achyutananda.
- The five Friends preached the Vaishnava dharma or ninefold process of Bhakti and chanting the Holy Names (Harinama), giving more importance to the realization of the soul rather than worship of the Deities.
- The most important aspect of their preaching was the abolition of all discriminations among Vaishnavas, no matter from which caste or background they came.
- Achyutananda, Yasovanta, Balarama and Ananta met a strong opposition from the caste-conscious Brahmins.
- The Pancha Sakhas preached that Lord Krishna/Jagannatha could be worshiped as Sunya, "void", a particular "non-shape" that transcended the Deity in the temple and therefore could be accessible by everyone at all times.
- Thus, the Panchasakhas and Bhakti movement had a great impact on the socio-religious and cultural life of the people of Odisha.

2.3.5. Exercise

- **Write a note on the *Panchasakhas* and *Bhakti* movement in Odisha.**
- **Discuss the life and works of Jagannath Das.**
- **Make an analysis on the life and literary works of Balaram Das.**
- **Give an account on the works of Achyutananda Das.**
- **Give a note on the works of Sisu Ananta Das and Yashobanta Das.**
- **Write a note on the *Bhakti* movement in Odisha under the *Panchasakhas*.**

2.3.6. Further reading

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Unit-3
Chapter-I

Muslim conquest of Odisha: Mughal -Afghan Conflict

Structure

3.1.0. Objectives
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3.1.0.Objectives

In this lesson, students investigate about the Muslim conquest of Odisha and Mughal-Afghan conflict. After studying this lesson you will be able to:

- *to learn the Muslim conquest of Odisha*
- *to analyze Mughal-Afghan conflict*
- *to investigate the beginning of Mughal rule in Odisha*
- *to trace the steps taken by Akbar to crush the Afghan rebells*

3.1.1. Introduction

The Muslim conquest of Odisha created a new chapter in the medieval history of Odisha. The treachery and murder which was the order of the day came to a close down when Mukundar Harichandana took the charge of administration. In the mean while the diplomacy of Akbar to ehelp Mukundadeva against any possible attack from Bengal, gave impression to the latter that Bengal would not pose a problem for him. When Akbar was busy in the conquest of Chittor, Sulaiman Karrani dispatched his son Bayazid and General Kalapahada to attack Odisha. Mukundadeva had advanced up to Kotasima to face the enemy, but he had to retreat to deal with Ramachandra Bhanja, the rebellious chief of Sarangagarh. However, Mukundadeva, the last independent Hindu king of Odisha was killed by the Afghans in 1568 A.D. With this the independence of medieval Odisha came to an end. After that the local rulers became mere puppets in the hands of the Afghan Governors of Bengal.

3.1.2. Muslim conquest of Odisha

The Afghan attack on Odisha established a new era in the medieval history of Odisha. It opened the way for the Muslim rule in Odisha. The invasion of Bayazid and Kalapahada in 1568 A.D. established Muslim rule over Odisha for the first time under the Afghans and then under the Mughals. Before consolidation of the Afghan hold over Odisha, Sulaiman Karrani breathed his last in 1572 A.D. He was succeeded by Bayazid who, by his arrogant nature, incurred the displeasure of the Afghan chiefs. This caused his death at the hands of Hansu, the nephew and son-in-law of Sulaiman Karrani. The *Riyazus- Salatin* describes that after the death of Bayazid, his younger brother Daud Karrani, with a big force, marched against Hansu and killed him who had taken shelter with Qutlu and other Lohanis. Daud defied the authority of Akbar and ordered *Khutba* to be read and coins to be struck in his name. Further, instigated by Qutlu Lohani, the Governor of Odisha, Daud killed other Afghan veterans whom he thought a rival to the throne of Bengal.

3.1.3. Mughal-Afghans conflict

Emperor Akbar took a note of it and sent Raja Todarmal to Bihar to join Munim Khan. Though Munim Khan besieged Daud in Patna, he could not defeat him. With the arrival of Akbar, Daud left Bihar and returned to Bengal. Patna fell in the clutch of the Mughals. Munim Khan pursued Daud upto Bengal and occupied it. Daud fled again to Cuttack and remained unsubdued in Odisha. He moved forward and backward between Cuttack and Jaleswar keeping a close watch on the advance of the Mughal army. The combined army of Munim Khan and Todarmal crossed sword with Daud in 1575 A.D. The fight took place on the plain of Tukaroi, six miles west of Jaleswar on the bank of river Suvarnarekha. Munim Khan was wounded by Gujar Khan, an able commander of Daud. After sometime, when Munim Khan returned to the battle field again, Raja Todarmal, Laskar Khan, Mir-bakshi and others discharged showers of arrows upon the soldiers of Daud. An arrow struck Gujar Khan who met his end in the battle field. The battle of Tukaroi decreed in favour of the Mughals and Daud had no alternative but to rush towards Cuttack.

3.1.3. 1. Continuation of Mughal-Afghan conflict

Under the leadership of Todarmal, the Mughal army followed Daud and did not halt on the way until they reached Kaikalghati (Bhadrak) which is described the *Ain-i-Akbari*. In the mean while, Daud and other Afghans gathered inside the fort of Barabati at Cuttack. Munim Khan, being cured fully, came and joined with Todarmal. He, then, held a grand council on the bank of river Mahanadi with his Amirs in chalking out the plan for besieging the fort.

3.1.3.2. Temporary surrender of Daud to the Mughal army

The situation was now crystal clear to Daud. He sent a message to Munim Khan and the *Tabaqat-i-Akbari* records it as follows: "The striving to crush a party of Musalmans is no noble work. I am ready to submit and become a subject, but I beg that a corner of this wide country of Bengal sufficient for my support may be assigned to me. If this is granted, I will rest content, and never after rebeL" After this, Munim Khan called Daud to his court on 12 April, 1557 A.D. who went with his Afghan nobles and officers. He submitted before Munim Khan and promised not to take any hostile action against emperor Akbar. He presented his best elephants to Munim Khan and sent his nephew Shaikh Muhammad, son of Bayazid who accompanied Munim Khan to the Mughal court later on. Munim Khan presented a sword with a jeweled belt to Daud and said :

"You have now become a subject of imperial throne, and have promised to give it your support. I have, therefore, requested that the country of Odisha may be settled upon you for your support, and I feel assured that His Majesty will confirm my proposition granting this to you as my *'tankhwah'* has been granted to me. I now greet you afresh with this war like sword." *(Tabaqat-i-Akbari)* Akbar approved the deed of Munim Khan. Daud got Odisha. Munim Khan becarne the Governor of Bengal. After this arrangement, Todarmal returned to Delhi. .

3.1.3. 3. Revenge of Daud Karrani

The surrender of Daud Karrani was a mere eye-wash. He was in search of an opportunity to launch a war against the Mughals. The chance came to him with the death of Munim Khan on 23 October, 1575 A.D. Daud ignored the humiliating treaty made with Munim Khan, the *Khan-i-Khanan* and unfurled the banner of revolt against the Mughals. With a lightning march, he proceeded to Bhadrak and killed Nazar Bahadur, the Governor of Akbar, posted there. After bringing Bhadrak under his grip, he marched towards Jaleswar and smelling a scent of it. Murad Khan the Mughal officer of Jaleswar fled away to Tanda. Jaleswar was reoccupied by Daud who immediately proceeded to Bengal. The Mughal officers and army returned to Bhagalpur *en route* to Delhi at the approach of Daud. Now, Daud consolidated his position over Bengal and Odisha.

3.1.3. 4. Akbar's step to crush the rebels

Having heard this news, Akbar appointed Husain Quli Beg entitled *Khen-i-Jenen,* to lead an expedition against the Afghans assisted by Todarmal. He proceeded with a grand Mughal army towards Bengal via Bihar. At Bhagalpur, *Khen-i-Jenen* waited. He talked with the Amirs of Bengal who met him there. Then marching ahead, the imperial army easily recovered the Teligarhi pass. Daud Karrani, supported by his uncle Junaid and other Afghan chiefs, offered strong resistance to the imperial army at Rajmahal. In the mean while, Muzaffar Khan was sent by Akbar who collected forces from Bihar, Hajipur and Patna and joined the imperial army led by *Khen-i-Jehet:* on 10 July, 1576 AD. A fierce battle took place between the Mughals and Afghans on 12 July, 1576 AD. The Afghans were utterly defeated and almost all their great leaders met their end. A Cannon-ball wounded Junaid and his leg was broken. Daud was captured and imprisoned for his disloyalty to emperor Akbar. Kalapahada and Qutlu Lohani could survive by flight, though the former was severely wounded.

3.1.3. 5. The beginning of the Mughal rule in Odisha

From 1576 A.D. to 1605 AD., nearly thirty years were spent by the Mughal officers of Bengal to drive away the Afghans from Odisha but they were very much unsuccessful in their mission. Though, after the fall of Daud, Odisha was annexed to Akbar's empire but Mughal administration could not be implemented effectively in the province till the death of Akbar. With the death of Hussain Quli Khan in 1578 AD. Muzaffar Khan Turbati was appointed as the Governor of Bengal and Mausum Khan Afghan was appointed as the Governor of Odisha. The Mughal government now appointed some Afghan *Jagirdars* in Odisha who were constantly being harassed by Muzaffar Khan. Masum Khan, the administrator of Odisha now got a chance to organise the Afghans of Odisha and became ready to have a show down with Mughals.

3.1.3. 6. Akbar and the Afghan rebels

After regularizing the administration of Odisha, Todarmal returned to Delhi in 1582 AD. In the meanwhile, *Khen-i-Azetn* was appointed as the Governor of Bengal. Qutlu Lohani, another great supporter of Daud Karrani, now appeared in the political scene and established his authority over Odisha supported by Masum Khan. He advanced towards Hoogly and defeated Muhammad Nizat Khan, the Mughal Fauzdar of the place at Salimabad. On hearing this, Akbar dispatched a vast army at the command of *Ktien-i-Azem* who proceeded to Katigang to teach a lesson to the Afghan rebels.

3.1.3. 7. Preparation for the war

The Afghan rebels, led by Masum Khan and Qutlu Lohani, met the Mughal army on 27 March, 1583. The Afghans were defeated at the hands of the Mughals. The Afghans now had no alternative but to conclude peace with the Mughals. At this juncture, *Khani- Azem* was transferred from Bengal as its climate did not suit him and Shahbaz Khan was appointed as his successor. Qutlu Lohani broke the peace treaty with the Mughals and as a natural corollary, a fight took place between Qutlu and the Mughals on 15 July, 1583 A.D. near Burdwan. In this battle, the Afghan commander Bahadur Kuruh was defeated. After that, the Afghans rushed towards Odisha.

3.1.3. 8. Submission of Lohani

In the meanwhile, Akbar sent an army to keep an eye on the frontier of Odisha. Qutlu Lohani organised the Pathans and met the Mughals of Burdwan. Wazir khan led the Mughal army and defeated the Afghan chief. Being defeated, Qutlu Lohani marched towards Jaleswar

and there, he surrendered himself before the Mughal army by presenting sixty elephants to the Mughals. T'iat situational surrender was diplomatic strategy by Qutlu Lohani. After regaining strength, the Afghans renewed their attack and plunder over Burdwan. By pursuation of the Mughals, Isa Khan, Masum Khan and other Afghan leaders left the companion of Qutlu Lohani and surrendered to Akbar. Qutlu Lohani enjoyed his days in Odisha unperturbed by Mughal attacks. No doubt, the Mughals had their sway over Bengal but Odisha remained the stronghold of the Afghan Chiefs until it was finally conquered by Man Singh in 1593 A.D.

3.1.3. 9. The Mughal-Afghan Treaty

When Qutlu Khan Lohani was enjoying his days in Odisha, Akbar sent one of his ablest general Raja Man Singh to deal with the Afghans. The march of the imperial army prompted Qutlu Khan to make himself ready for the fight with the Mughals. To that effect, he sent Bahadur Kuruh, an Afghan General. Assisted by Umar Khan, Khwaja Isa and others Bahadur Kuruh inflicted a crushing defeat upon the Mughal army led by Jagat Singh, the son of Man Singh at Raipur. In the meanwhile, Qutlu Khan Lohani breathed his last and his son succeeded him. As he was a weak ruler, his *Wazir* Khwaja Isa sued for peace with the Mughals which was accepted by Man Singh. The treaty between the Afghans and Mughals was signed on 15 August, 1590 A.D. The terms of the treaty were as follows:

- The name of the emperor should be used on the coins and the Khutba is to be read in his name.
- The Afghan ruler of Odisha should be both obedient and loyal vassal of the emperor.
- Jagannath (at Puri) and its surrounding districts would be ceded to the emperor.

3.1.3. 10. Condition of Raja Ramachandradeva

From the treaty, it appears that it neither satisfied the Afghans nor Ramachandradeva, the then king of Odisha. Very cunningly by influencing Akbar, Man Singh had inserted a clause in the treaty for the protection of the principal Hindu religious institution of Jagannath against any Afghan oppression. This was a diplomatic trick to encourage the support of the Hindus of Odisha towards the benevolent Mughal rule based on the principle of toleration. Then, why Ramachandradeva was not satisfied? It was only because his power and position as the custodian of God Jagannath had not been at all reflected in the treaty. On the other hand, the Mughals became the custodian of God. Of course, the conquest of Odisha by Man Singh never put an end to the Afghan hostility. Now, Khwaja Isa, the *Wazir* of Nasir Khan, paid allegience to emperor

Akbar and ruled for two years according to the terms of the treaty. With his death in 1592 A.D., Nasir Khan, with his followers, captured the temple of God Jagannath defying Mughal authority and seized the crown land of Puri. Undoubtedly, Raja Ramachandradeva backed the Afghans. Again, Man Singh marched with a grand Mughal army to deal with the Afghans. On 10 April,J 592 A.D., a stiff resistance the Mughal army faced from the Afghans on the bank of river Suvarnarekha. However, a determined Mughal army defeated the Afghans and chased them towards Cuttack via Jaleswar and Bhadrak.

3.1.3. 11. Fall of Sarangagarh fort in the hands of the Mughal army

Being hard pressed by the Mughal army, the Afghans could not maintain their stand at Cuttack. Their stronghold, Cuttack fell into the hands of the Mughals. The Afghans fled away to the fort of Sarangagarh. At this juncture, Man Singh first started towards Khurda and Raja Ramachandradeva shut himself at the fort. It was difficult on his part to send any help to the Afghans at Sarangagarh. After a weak resistance, the Afghans surrendered and Sarangagarh fell.
Man Singh besieged Khurda Ramachandradeva showed his loyalty at Akbar and made peace with Man Singh in 1593. He was recognised as the ruler of Khurda by Akbar and the protector of the Jagannath temple at Puri. He was offered a rank of a *Mansabdar* of three thousands and five hundreds. With the surrender of Ramachandradeva in 1593, the Mughal conquest of Odisha was complete and that put an end to the Afghan rule in Odisha. Hence, Odisha permanently formed a part of the Mughal empire till it was conquered by the Marathas.

3.1.4. Conclusion

Thus, the Muslim conquest of Odisha created a new chapter in the medieval history of Odisha. Mukundadeva, the last independent Hindu king of Odisha was killed by the Afghans in 1568 A.D. With this the independence of medieval Odisha came to an end. After that the local rulers became mere puppets in the hands of the Afghan Governors of Bengal. However, it was Akbar who defeated these Afghan rulers and established Mughal rule in Odisha.

3.1.5. Summary

- The Muslim conquest of Odisha created a new chapter in the medieval history of Odisha.
- Mukundadeva, the last independent Hindu king of Odisha was killed by the Afghans in 1568 A.D.
- With this the independence of medieval Odisha came to an end. After that the local rulers became mere puppets in the hands of the Afghan Governors of Bengal.

- The invasion of Bayazid and Kalapahada in 1568 A.D. established Muslim rule over Odisha for the first time under the Afghans and then under the Mughals.
- With the arrival of Akbar, Daud left Bihar and returned to Bengal.
- Patna fell in the clutch of the Mughals. Munim Khan pursued Daud upto Bengal and occupied it. Daud fled again to Cuttack and remained unsubdued in Odisha.
- Under the leadership of Todarmal, the Mughal army followed Daud and did not halt on the way until they reached Kaikalghati (Bhadrak) which is described the *Ain-i-Akbari*.
- In the mean while, Daud and other Afghans gathered inside the fort of Barabati at Cuttack.
- The surrender of Daud Karrani was a mere eye-wash. He was in search of an opportunity to launch a war against the Mughals.
- The chance came to him with the death of Munim Khan on 23 October, 1575 A.D.
- The Mughal officers and army returned to Bhagalpur *en route* to Delhi at the approach of Daud. Now, Daud consolidated his position over Bengal and Odisha.
- Having heard this news, Akbar appointed Husain Quli Beg entitled *Khen-i-Jenen,* to lead an expedition against the Afghans assisted by Todarmal.
- From 1576 A.D. to 1605 AD., nearly thirty years were spent by the Mughal officers of Bengal to drive away the Afghans from Odisha but they were very much unsuccessful in their mission.
- After the fall of Daud, Odisha was annexed to Akbar's empire.
- After regularizing the administration of Odisha, Todarmal returned to Delhi in 1582 AD.
- The Mughals had their sway over Bengal but Odisha remained the stronghold of the Afghan Chiefs until it was finally conquered by Man Singh in 1593 A.D.
- The treaty between the Afghans and Mughals was signed on 15 August, 1590 A.D.
- Being hard pressed by the Mughal army, the Afghans could not maintain their stand at Cuttack.
- Their stronghold, Cuttack fell into the hands of the Mughals.
- The Afghans fled away to the fort of Sarangagarh.
- After a weak resistance, the Afghans surrendered and Sarangagarh fell.

- Man Singh besieged Khurda Ramachandradeva showed his loyalty at Akbar and made peace with Man Singh in 1593.
- With the surrender of Ramachandradeva in 1593, the Mughal conquest of Odisha was complete and that put an end to the Afghan rule in Odisha.
- Hence, Odisha permanently formed a part of the Mughal empire till it was conquered by the Marathas.

3.1.6. Exercise

- **Write a note on the Muslim conquest of Odisha.**
- **Give an account on the Mughal-Afghan conflict in Odisha.**
- **Discuss the steps taken by Akbar to crush the Afghan rebels in Odisha.**
- **Make an analysis on the Mughal victory over the Afghans in Odisha.**

3.1.7. Further reading

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Unit-3

Chapter-II
Odisha under the Mughal rulers: Akbar, Jahangir, Shahjahan and Aurangzeb

Structure

3.2.0. Objectives
3.2.1. Introduction
3.2.2. Odisha under Akbar's rule
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3.2.3.3. Kalyanmal's Khurda occupation
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3.2.6. Conclusion
3.2.7. Summary
3.2.8. Exercise
3.2.9. Further Reading

3.2.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students explore the Odisha under the Mughal rulers: Akbar, Jahangir, Shahjahan and Aurangzeb. After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- *trace* Odisha under the Mughal rulers
- *identify* Odisha under the rule of Akbar
- *recognize* Odisha under the rule of Jahangir
- *know* Odisha under the rule of Shahjahan and Aurangzeb

3.2.1. Introduction

The prolonged fight between the Afghans and Mughals came to an end in 1593 *A.D.* by Man Singh, one of the ablest General of Akbar. This brought a complete subjugation of the Afghans. Of course, prior to it, Akbar had taken steps to implement Mughal administration in Odisha.

3.2.2. Odisha under Akbar's rule

With the death of Daud Karrani, Raja Todarmal had arranged peaceful administration in Odisha. By the will of Akbar, peace with Ramachandradeva was made. Man Singh recognised him as the true successors of the Gajapatis of Odisha. Due to this recognition, the position of Ramachandradeva was asserted on Odishan soil who took up the title 'Gajapati'. In a diplomatic way, Man Singh also satisfied two sons of Mukundadeva by giving them the *zamindari* of Aul and Patia, as stated earlier. Normalcy was restored to this land with active intervention of Raja Man Singh. He implemented Todarmal's revenue system 'in Odisha. There was no intervention in the temple administration of Puri during Akbar's time. Odisha was attached to Bengal *Suba* and ruled from Head Quarters located in Bengal.

3.2.3. Odisha under Jahangir's rule

With the death of Akbar, Jahangir ascended the throne in 1605 A.D. He did not follow the liberal policy pursued by Akbar. He intervened in the internal administration of Khurda and the temple of God Jagannath. Odisha became a separate *Suba.* Hasim Khan was appointed as the Governor of Odisha. He prepared a plan to march against Purusottamadeva, the Raja of Khurda. Before he implemented this plan, his subordinate Raja Keso Das Maru Marched against Purusottamadeva for materialising the dream of his master.

3.2.3.1. Occupation of Puri

At the time of Car festival, when the images of God Jagannath, Balabhadra and Subhadra were in the *Gundicha* house, Keso Das Maru entered into the Jagannath temple with his Rajput

soldiers having a plea to visit the temple. He tortured the priests of the temple and seized property estimated more than two crores of rupees. At this shocking news, Purusottamadeva of Khurda marched with his grand army consisting of infantry, cavalry and chariots. Though, the temple was besieged by the soldiers of Purusottamadeva, the Rajput soldiers of Keso Das Maru threw rags soaked with oil and ghee setting fire in these materials. All in a sudden, the chariots of Purusottam caught fire and soldiers on their top were burnt alive.

3.2.3.2. Conditions of the Treaty

At last, the King of Khurda surrendered before Keso Das Maru with the following humiliating conditions:

1. To send his daughter to the imperial *harem.*
2. To pay three lakhs of rupees as *Peshkash* to the imperial exchequer.
3. To give his own sister in marriage to Keso Das Maru.
4. To pay one lakh rupees as *Nal Bandi* (light tribute or present) to the Raja and his followers.

Purusottamadeva had no alternative but to agree to these proposals. Accordingly, Keso Das married the sister of Purusottamadeva and went to Puri. From that place he sent news to Khurda to send other articles of demand which Purusottam fulfilled immediately. This exalted his position before emperor Jahangir who prompted Keso Das to the rank of four thousand horses and offered a robe of honour, a jewelled sword with belt, a horse etc.

3.2.3.3. Kalyanmal's Khurda occupation

With the termination of the governorship of Hasim Khan, Raja Kalyanmal was appointed by Jahangir as the Governor of Odisha in 1611 A.D. He cast his glances over the kingdom of Khurda which was ruled by Purusottamadeva who was guided by Rajaguru Vidyadhara. With diplomacy, Kalyanmal invited Vidyadhara to Ghantasila Tangi and made him a captive. All in a sudden, he attacked Khurda. Hard pressed by the situation, Raja Purusottama sued for peace.

3.2.3.4. Terms of the Treaty

The terms of the treaty were as follows:

1. The Raja would surrender to him.
2. The daughter of the Raja would be sent to the imperial harem.
3. The king should agree to pay three lakhs of rupees as *Peshkash* to the imperial treasury along with Sesha Naga, the renowned elephant for the use of the emperor.

4. The king must attend the emperor in person.

Purusottamadeva agreed to all these proposals. However, Raja Kalyanmal was removed from his service in 1617 A.D. by Jahangir.

3.2.3.5. Khurda occupation by Mukarram Khan

After kalyanmal, Mukarram Khan was appointed by Jahangir as Governor of Odisha in 1617 A.D. After the assumption of charges, he was grossly indulged in iconoclastic activities. He injured the statue of Sakhi Gopal. At his approach, the *Sevakas* removed the idols from the temple of Puri and took them to Gobapadar. Purusottamadeva, the king of Khurda became furious and wanted to deal with this whimscal Governor. The attack of Mukarram Khan was so vigorous and fatal that the king fled away from Khurda and sought asylum with the king of Rajahmundry. It appears that Khurda was termporarily annexed to the Mughal empire. His conquest of Khudra was highly appreciated in the Mughal court and emperor Jahangir rewarded him by sending valuable gifts.

3.2.3.6. Death of Purusottamadeva

With his removal in 1620 A.D. Husain Ali Khan became the Governor of Odisha for a short while. After him, Ahmad Beg was appointed in the same post in 1621 A.D. Purusottamadeva gathered support from the local chiefs of Banapur, Ranapur and ruler of Rajahmundry. At this, Ahmad Beg proceeded up to Banapur via Khurda. While holding a camp near Banapur, Purusottamadeva breathed his last. He was succeeded by his son Narasimhadeva.

3.2.3.7. Khurram's visit to Odisha

When Narasimhadeva proceeded towards Garah Manitri for the safety of royal family, Ahmad Beg invaded Khurda. By this time Prince Khurram (Shah Jahan) revolted against Jahangir and from the Deccan he came to Odisha via Golkunda. At his approach,Ahmad Beg fled to Burdwan and then to Akbar Nagar. Narasimhadeva and his supporters greeted Shah Jahan with humility. Being overpleased at the behaviour of the king, Shah Jahan left for Bengal. His plan to conquer Allahabad and Oudh was foiled due to the alertness of Mahabbat Khan. So, suddenly he returned to Golkunda via Odisha. After his return, Ahmad Beg again became the Governor of Odisha and remained in that charge till 1628 A.D. Jahangir's rule is important for two reasons so far as Odisha is concerned. Firstly, Odisha became a separate administrative unit free from Bengal. Secondly, the king of Khurda lost the sympathy of the Mughal emperor and thus, was under the direct rule of the Mughal authority.

3.2.4. Odisha under Shah Jahan

After the accession of Shah Jahan to the Mughal throne in 1628 AD. Muhmmad Baqar Khan was appointed as the Governor of Odisha. In the meanwhile, Qutb Shahi soldiers had invaded Khurda. After assuming his charge as Governor, Baqar Khan marched with his soldiers to Khira Pahar, four miles from Chhattarduar on the frontier of the Mughal province of Odisha in the winter and invaded Qutb Shahi empire in 1629-30 AD. However, his plundering of the Qutb Shahi territory took a halt at the advent of the rainy season that compelled him to return Cuttack.

3.2.4.1. Baqar Khan's occupation of Mansurgarh

With the end of rainy season, Baqar Khan again marched to the Deccan with his soldiers and reached the fort of Mansurgarh. The Qutb Shahi soldiers gave a toe fight but were defeated by the Mughal soldiers and the fort fell in the hands of Baqar Khan who returned to Cuttack with a smile. After his return, the Qutb Shahi soldiers reassembled themselves and tried to reassert their hold over the fort. This act forced an aggressive Baqar who returned with vengeance and defeated the Golkunda soldiers, thereby annexing some Qutb Shahi territories to the Mughal empire of Odisha. For his act of bravery, he received a letter of appreciation from the Mughal emperor Shah Jahan. However, his atrocities over the zamindars of Odisha was viewed adversely and the emperor recalled him from Odisha in 1632 AD. He was forced by the emperor to expiain about the realization of forty lakhs of rupees which he had collected forcibly from the zamindars of Odisha.

3.2.4.2. Mutaqad Khan as Governor

Baqar Khan was succeeded by Mutaqad Khan as Governor of Odisha in 1632 AD. He granted permission to Captain Ralph Cartwright to establish English factory at Hariharpur where there was a colony of weavers. From the accounts of William Burton, it is known that the British East India Company had its factories in Balasore and undivided Cuttack districts during this time. Mutaqad Khan constructed Lalbagh palace at Cuttack. His rule as *Subahdar* in Odisha was marked with peace and glory. He remained in this charge upto 1641 AD.

3.2.4.3. Other Governors of Odisha

After him, there were seven Governors of Odisha among whom' the rule of Muhammad Zaman Teherani from 1642-1645 A.D. was significant. Prince Shuja had sent him as a Deputy to Odisha on his own behalf. During his governorship, the factories of the English East India Company were established in Odisha at Balasore. A notable achievement during his regime was

that he dealt with Bhadur Khan, the Zamindar of Hijli who held power over an extensive coastal district stretching from Rupnarayan to the river Suvarnarekha of Odisha. He ruled like an independent Sultan as if his empire was "unsubdued and uncared for *Subah* of Odisha." Muhammad Zaman led an expedition against Bahadur Khan who was defeated and imprisoned at Dacca in 1657 A.D., Shah Jahan fell ill and was imprisoned by Aurangzeb who ascended the Mughal throne in 1658 A.D. The period of Shah Jahan was remarkable in Odisha mainly for three reasons. Firstly, there was no invasion on Khurda on behalf of the Mughal Governor of Odisha. Secondly, the Mughal army never invaded the Jagannath temple at Puri. Lastly, factories were established by English in Odisha facilitating commercial prosperity of this land.

3.2.5. Odisha under Aurangzeb

The chaos and confusion that prevailed in Odisha during the rule of Prince Shujah, came to drastic end with the accession of Aurangzeb in 1658 A.D. During his initial years of administration, Mir Jumal established law and order in Bengal and sent Ihtishan Khan to assume the authority of Odisha. After taking over the charge as the *Subahdar* of Odisha, he issued a proclamation that *Khutba* should be read in the name or Aurangzeb in all the mosques of Odisha. Next, he intimated, by order, to all the *Mansabdars, Choudhuries, Quanungoes* and *Zamindars* ragarding his own appointment. Further, he ordered the officers and Zamindars to meet him at Narayangarh. Of course, as it appears, this order fell in deaf ears. Within a very short span of time, he was replaced by Khan-i-Dauran as *Subahdar* of Odisha.

3.2.5.1. Murder of Krushna Chandra Bhanja

The rule of Khan-i-Dauran in Odisha began with a dismal note. The refractory Zamindars of Odisha had ceased to pay revenues to the Mughals. Coming to Jaleswar via Narayanagarh, he sent order to zamindar Bahadur Khan of Hijli and Krushna Chandra Bhanja of Hariharpur to pay him homage. When Krushna Chandra Bhanja talked defiantly to the *Subahdar,* the former was put to death by the latter. All the followers of Krushna Chandra Bhanja suffered the same fate by the order of Khan-i-Dauran.

3.2.5.2. Supression of Zamindars

Then began the drama of supression of the local zamindars. The *Subahdar* marched against zamindars like Uddanda of Narasimhapur, Chhatreswar Dhal of Ghatasila and Harichandan Krishna Bhanja of Nilgiri and subdued them. He proceeded to Remuna to look into the chaotic condition that had taken place at Mayurbhanj after the death of Krushna Chandra

Bhanja. However, the surrender of Jayachandra Bhanja, the brother of deceased Rama Chandra Bhanja led the *Subahdar* to recognize him as the Raja of Hariharapur and to offer his son the title of *Tikayat.*

3.2.5.3. Rebellion of Mukundadeva

The next target of Khan-i-Dauran was Khurda. Raja Mukundadeva had turned rebellious against the Mughals by joining his hands with the zamindars of Banki, Ranapur, Sarangagarh, Damapara and the nearby locality. After reaching Cuttack, Khan-i-Dauran fell ill for two months. Being recovered, he marched ahead to settle score with Mukundadeva of Khurda in February 1661 A.D. He first captured the seven hill forts and ravaged Khurda. Out of fear, Mukundadeva fled away and his younger brother Kapila Bhramaravara Raya surrendered to the *Subahdar* without any resistance. Other zamindars, mentioned above, followed the same path. At last, Mukundadeva, surrendered himself before Khan-i-Dauran.

3.2.5.4. Khan-I-Dauran's harsh steps

Without halting a little, Khan-i-Dauran proceeded to Keonjhar, defeated Raja Laxminarayana Bhanja and snatched away from him the fort or Panchira which he had occupied during the misrule of Prince Sujah. With gradual succession, the *Subahdar* suppressed the zamindars of Ranapur, Damapara, Sarangagarh, Patia, Kanika, Kujanga, Maluda and other smaller ones. By such rash activities on the part of the *Subahdar*, the imperial authority in Odisha was thoroughly reasserted restoring peace and stability in the land once again. After accomplishing the task, he wrote a letter to Aurangzeb thus: "I have punished all the usurpers, oppressors ..... of the province and made them obedient. The revenue is being collected by our officers. The people are enjoying peace and happiness and playing their trades." Within a short span of time, he collected and remitted revenue amounting fifteen lakhs of rupees alongwith many valuable Jewells to the court of Aurangzeb that made him happy.

3.2.5.5. Other Governors

Khan-i-Dauran breathed his last in September 1667 A.D. He was succeeded by Tarbiyat Khan who remained in this charge till 1669 A.D. He was succeeded by Safi Khan known as 'Ruffee Ckanna Naboob,' of Odisha by the English writers. Safi Khan gave way to Rashid Khan who was replaced by Shayista Khan, the maternal uncle of Aurangzeb. Then Governors like Salih Khan, Abu Nasar Khan, Akrarn Khan, Ghaznafar Khan, Askar Khan, Kamgar Khan, Azim-us-Shan, the grand-son of Aurangzeb ruled Odisha in gradual succession till 1704 A.D.

After that, Murshid Ouli Khan was appointed as *Subahdar* of Odisha who remained in the post till 1707 A.D., when Aurangzab breathed his last. After that Odisha came under the rule of the Nizams of Bengal.

3.2.5.6. Junaid's bigotry

Aurangzeb was a staunch Sunni Musim and a religious bigot out and out. He appointed Junaid as the *Muhtasib* for the propagation of Islam in Odisha. Several Hindu temples including goddess Sarala at Jhankada in the present Jagatsinghpur district and a good number of temples at Jajpur were demolished by his order. In 1662 A.D., Aurangzab issued order for the destruction of Jagannath temple at Puri. However, Raja Divyasimhadeva of Khurda bribed the *Subahdar* who not only reported a pretended destruction of the Jagannath temple at Puri before Aurangzeb but also sent a fake image of Lord Jagannath to him. By these iconoclastic activities of Junaid, Aurangzeb was elated. Anyway, the rule of Aurangzeb in Odisha was marked for four distinct features. Firstly, the recalcitrant zamindars were dealt with iron hands. Secondly, law and order were restored. Thirdly, Hindu religion was not allowed to spread due to massive iconoclastic activities which brought ruin to many important temples of Odisha. Lastly, the Naib Nizams of Bengal played a dominant role in discharging the administration of Odisha.

3.2.6. Conclusion

Thus, with the defeat of the Afghans in 1593 *A.D.*, the Mughals under the rule of Akbar, Jahangir, Sahajahan and Aurangzeb created a new history in the history of medieval Odisha. Prior to that Akbar had taken steps to implement Mughal rule in Odisha. With the death of Daud Karrani, Raja Todarmal had arranged peaceful administration in Odisha. With the death of Akbar, Jahangir ascended the throne in 1605 A.D. He did not follow the liberal policy pursued by Akbar. After the accession of Shah Jahan to the Mughal throne in 1628 AD. Muhmmad Baqar Khan was appointed as the Governor of Odisha. The chaos and confusion that prevailed in Odisha during the rule of Prince Shujah, came to drastic end with the accession of Aurangzeb in 1658 A.D. However, except Akbar, the rule of other Mughal sultans witnessed chaos, confusion and destruction of temples in Odisha.

3.2.7. Summary

- The Mughals established their rule in Odisha in 1593 *A.D.*
- Prior to it, Akbar had taken steps to implement Mughal administration in Odisha.

- With the death of Daud Karrani, Raja Todarmal had arranged peaceful administration in Odisha.
- By the will of Akbar, peace with Ramachandradeva was made.
- With the death of Akbar, Jahangir ascended the throne in 1605 A.D. He did not follow the liberal policy pursued by Akbar.
- He intervened in the internal administration of Khurda and the temple of God Jagannath. Odisha became a separate *Suba.*
- At the time of Car festival, when the images of God Jagannath, Balabhadra and Subhadra were in the *Gundicha* house, Keso Das Maru entered into the Jagannath temple with his Rajput soldiers having a plea to visit the temple.
- He tortured the priests of the temple and seized property estimated more than two crores of rupees.
- With the termination of the governorship of Hasim Khan, Raja Kalyanmal was appointed by Jahangir as the Governor of Odisha in 1611 A.D.
- After kalyanmal, Mukarram Khan was appointed by Jahangir as Governor of Odisha in 1617 A.D.
- After the assumption of charges, he was grossly indulged in iconoclastic activities.
- By this time Prince Khurram (Shah Jahan) revolted against Jahangir and from the Deccan he came to Odisha via Golkunda.
- After the acession of Shah Jahan to the Mughal throne in 1628 AD. Muhmmad Baqar Khan was appointed as the Governor of Odisha.
- Baqar Khan was succeeded by Mutaqad Khan as Governor of Odisha in 1632 AD.
- Baqar Khan was succeeded by Mutaqad Khan as Governor of Odisha in 1632 AD.
- He granted permission to Captain Ralph Cartwright to establish English factory at Hariharpur where there was a colony of weavers.
- From the accounts of William Burton, it is known that the British East India Company had its factories in Balasore and undivided Cuttack districts during this time. Mutaqad Khan constructed Lalbagh palace at Cuttack.
- After him, there were seven Governors of Odisha among whom' the rule of Muhammad Zaman Teherani from 1642-1645 A.D. was significant.

- The chaos and confusion that prevailed in Odisha during the rule of Prince Shujah, came to drastic end with the accession of Aurangzeb in 1658 A.D.
- During his initial years of administration, Mir Jumal established law and order in Bengal and sent Ihtishan Khan to assume the authority of Odisha.
- After taking over the charge as the *Subahdar* of Odisha, he issued a proclamation that *Khutba* should be read in the name or Aurangzeb in all the mosques of Odisha.
- Khan-i-Dauran breathed his last in September 1667 A.D. He was succeeded by Tarbiyat Khan who remained in this charge till 1669 A.D.
- He was succeeded by Safi Khan known as 'Ruffee Ckanna Naboob,' of Odisha by the English writers.
- Aurangzeb was a staunch Sunni Musim and a religious bigot out and out.
- He appointed Junaid as the *Muhtasib* for the propagation of Islam in Odisha. Several Hindu temples including goddess Sarala at Jhankada in the present Jagatsinghpur district and a good number of temples at Jajpur were demolished by his order.
- In 1662 A.D., Aurangzab issued order for the destruction of Jagannath temple at Puri.
- However, Raja Divyasimhadeva of Khurda bribed the *Subahdar* who not only reported a pretended destruction of the Jagannath temple at Puri before Aurangzeb but also sent a fake image of Lord Jagannath to him.
- Lastly, the Naib Nizams of Bengal played a dominant role in discharging the administration of Odisha.

3.2.8. Exercise

Write a note on the Mughal rule in Odisha.

Give an account on the rule of Akbar and Jahangir in Odisha.

Make an analysis on the administration of Jahangir in Odisha.

Discuss the Mughal administration in Odisha under Aurangzeb.

3.2.9. Further Reading

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Unit-3

Chapter-III

Odisha under the Naib-Nizams

Structure

3.3.0. Objectives

3.3.1. Introduction

3.3.2. Odisha under the Naib-Nizams

3.3.2. 1.Naib Nizam Murshid Quli Khan-I

3.3.2. 2.Naib Nizam Suja**-ud-din Muhammad Khan of Bengal**

3.3.2. 3.Naib Nizam Muhammad **Taqi Khan**

3.3.2. 4.Naib Nizam Murshid **Quli Khan II of Bengal**

3.3.2. 5.Naib Nizam Alivardi Khan of Bengal

3.3.2. 6.Administration of the Naib Nizams of Bengal

3.3.3. Conclusion

3.3.4. Summary

3.3.5. Exercise

3.3.6. Further Reading

3.3.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students investigate about Odisha under the Naib-Nizams. After studying this lesson you will be able to:

- *to learn about the rule of Naib-Nizams in Odisha*
- *to analyze the rule under Murshid Quli Khan I*
- *to investigate administration under Suja-ud-din Muhammad Khan*
- *to trace the rule of other Naib-Nizams of Bengal*

3.3.1. Introduction

During the early rule of the Mughals, *Subahdars* from Delhi came to rule over Odisha. Todarmal, Man Singh, Mukram Khan, Muhammad Baqar Khan, Muhammad Zaman, Khan-i-Dauran etc. took the charge as the Governor of Odisha. However, during Aurangzeb's reign period, the Mughal empire passed through many threatening circumstances caused by the Qutb Shahis and Adil Shah is of Deccan, Sikhs, Rajputs and several other local chiefs. So, it was not possible on his part to sent Governors from Delhi to maintain the administration in Odisha. When Murshid Quli Khan took over the charge of the administration of Odisha, virtually, passed into the hands of the Naib Nizams of Bengal.

3.3.2. Odisha under the Naib-Nizams

With the death of Aurangzeb in 1707 A.D., his weak successors could not pay attention towards the administration of Odisha. They existed by name but could not exert their influence over the Nizams of Bengal. At that juncture, it was but natural that Odisha was governed by the Naib Nizams of Bengal until the Marathas established their sway over it.

3.3.2. 1.Naib Nizam Murshid Quli Khan-I

Emperor Aurangzeb was quite aware of the ability of Murshid Quli Khan. The former had appointed the latter as the *Diwan* of Bengal and Odisha. The *Subahdar* of Bengal by that time, was Prince Muhammad Azim-us-Shah (son of Bahadur Shah-I and grandson of Aurangzeb). He did not pull well with Murshid Quli and hatched a plot to kill the latter. Murshid Quli foiled the attempt of the prince and wrote a letter to Aurangzeb. With the death of Askar Khan, Murshid Quli was entrusted with the charge of *Naib Subahdar* and *Faujdar* of Odisha and finally in 1703 A.D., he was given the independent charge as *Subahdar* of Odisha. However, his governorship in Odisha was not a smooth sailing one. After the death of Aurangzeb, when Bahadur Shah I became the Mughal emperor, Prince Azim-us-Shah was successful in taking revenge on Murshid

Quli. As per the order of the emperor, Murshid Quli's position was degraded and he was sent as *Diwan* to look after the Deccan affair in 1708 A.D. He swallowed this bitter pill. In 1712 A.D., Azim-us-Shah was killed. Bahadur Shah also breathed his last. After the war of succession that continued among his sons, Jahandar Shah became the emperor of Delhi. His claim was challenged by Farrukh Shiyar who ascended the throne in 1713 A.D. He could not take Murshid Quli into confidence at first. When the latter sent presents and provincial tribute to the former, it prompted Farrukh Shiyar to appoint Murshid Quli as deputy *Subahdar* of Bengal in 1731 A.D. and finally, as *Subahdar* of Odisha in 1714 A.D.

The long cherished desire of Murshid Quli Khan was fulfilled. In 1717 AD., another feather to the crowned cap of Murshid Quli was added when he was declared as the *Subahdar* of Bengal in addition to his usual charge of Odisha. Owing to the pressure of work, he appointed his son-in-law, Suja-ud-din Muhammad Khan as deputy Governor of Odisha. However, Murshid Quli had to change his mind when he found that Suja-ud-din as not pulling well with his daughter Zynat-un-Nisa (wife of Suja-Uddin). He appealed to the emperor of Delhi to replace Suja-ud-din from Odisha and to appoint his grand-son Sarfaraz Khan (the son of Suja-Uddin) in his place. By that time, Suja-ud-din had exerted his influence in the royal court at Delhi and the proposal of Murshid Quli was turned down. Out of frustration, he died in 1727 AD. His revenue reform (discussed in foregoing pages) in Odisha was a notable step in the field of financial reform.

3.3.2. 2.Naib Nizam Suja-ud-din Muhammad Khan of Bengal

With the death of Murshid Quli Khan, the throne of Bengal was occupied by his sonin- law Suja-ud-din Muhammad Khan. As he was very apt in dealing with the Mughals, immediately after his accession to the throne of Bengal in 1727 AD., he sent valuable presents along with forty lakhs of rupees, which was a part of the private property of his father-in-law Murshid Quli to the court of Muhammad Shah, the new Mughal emperor. This stabilized the position of Suja-ud-din Muhammad Khan as the *Subahdar* of Bengal and Odisha. He appointed his son Sarfaraz Khan as the *Diwan* of Bengal. His other son, Muhammed Taqi Khan and after him his son-in-law, Murshid Quli Khan-II were appointed as Deputy Governors of Odisha to rule the land on his own behalf.He was a hard task master in collecting revenue from the people of Odisha. The revenue collection from the people of Odisha was an exploitative measure of Suja-ud-din Muhammad Khan, who sent a large chunk of it to the Delhi Court for securing his position.

During the governorship of Suja-Uddin, the territorial extent of Odisha shrinked. On the north, Jeleswar division was annexed to Bengal and on the south, the Nizam of Hyderabad occupied Odishan territory upto Tekkali-Raghunathpur and the adjoining villages. Suja-ud-din always looked after the interests of mechant community. Thomas Motte, in his monumental book, *Early European Travellers in Nagpur Territories* states that Suja-ud-din advised the merchants to leave Pipli and to establish their factories in Balasore because a greater part of Pipli was being washed away by the water. To facilitate the merchants, he built bridges over the rivers on the way that connected Cuttack with Murshidabad. He built Qadam Rasul Mosque, a beautiful Muslim shrine at Cuttack. Besides the burden of tax over the people of Odisha, his reign period was marked with peace and tranquility.

3.3.2. 3.Naib Nizam Muhammad Taqi Khan

It has been stated that Suja-ud-din remained busy in the affairs of Bengal and sent Taqi Khan, his son to look after the administration of Odisha. Taqi Khan became the deputy Governor of Odisha and he dealt with Raja Ramachandradeva of Khurda scorn and contempt. During his deputy governorship, Raja Ramachandradeva was converted to Islam faith and was also kept captive in the fort' of Barabati. His longing towards God Jagannath and desire to perform the festivals of the God, led Taqi Khan to invade Khurda time and again.During his period, the images of the Lords were transferred from the grand temple of Puri and secretly taken to Banapur and to Tekkali to save them from the wrath of Taqi Khan. The visit of Pilgrims to the temple of God Jagannath decreased considerably during this period as fear dominated their mind regarding their safety and security from the clutches of the Muslim officers. Taqi Khan was instrumental in building a Qadam Rasul at Balasore having a pond and a garden attached to it. He was an anti-Hindu out and out. The Hindus of Odisha took revenge on him. It has been stated, how by the instruction of Ramachandradeva, Taqi Khan was poisoned inside the fort of Barabati.

3.3.2. 4.Naib Nizam Murshid Quli Khan II of Bengal

At the death of Taqi Khan in 1735 A.D., Murshid Quli Khan II was sent immediately by Suja-ud-din as deputy *Subahdar* to look after the administration of Odisha. He was the son-in-law of Suja-Uddin. With the death of Taqi Khan, Odisha was relieved from the clutches of his oppressive rule. The coming of Murshid Quli Khan II offered a soothing balm to the maladies

faced by the people of Odisha during Taqi Khan's rule. With his arrival, Murshid Quli Khan II wanted to be popular among the people of Odisha.

He revived the worship of Lords in the grand temple at Puri under the leadership of the king of Khurda. Now, there was influx of pilgrims from all corners of India to Puri. By this nobel acts, he incurred the good will of the people of this land. However, his rule was very short in Odisha. He fell a prey to the internal squabble of the royal family at Murshidabad and left Odisha for good. The circumstances have been described below. The death of Nawab Suja-ud-din in 1739 A.D. led his son Sarfaraz Khan to succeed his father. In 1740 A.D., he was defeated and killed in the battle of Giria by Alivardi Khan, one of the trusted officers of Suja-Uddin. To secure tus position, Alivardi wanted to put an end to all the followers and supporters of Sarfaraz among whom the name of Murshid Quli Khan II figured prominently.

To subdue him, Alivardi raised a grand army. Aided and advised by Mirza Baqar, (son-in-law of Murshid Quli II) Murshid Quli proceeded to combat with the army of Alivardi. In 1741, the battle took place between the two groups near Phulwari beyond the river Budhabalanga. Victory was to kiss the feet of Murshid Quli II but at this juncture, his miltary officers like Mukhail Ali Khan and Muqarrab Khan made treachery and went to the side of Alivardi. Though Mirza Baqar, with his trusted soldiers fought valiantly, he fell wounded in the battle field. Murshid Quli acted promptly and with his wounded son-in-law and trusted friends, he rushed towards Balasore. In the ship of his merchant friend Haji Moshin, Murshid Quli and his party reached Masulipatam. Birakishoredeva, the king of Khurda rescued the family of Murshid Quli Khan II and sent all of them to Icchapuram. There Anwar-ud-din Khan received that family and Mirza Baqar brought them to Masulipatam. Now, Odisha passed into the hands of Alivardi Khan.

3.3.2. 5.Naib Nizam Alivardi Khan of Bengal

With the victory at Phulwari, Odisha was virtually under the grip of Alivardi. Without following Murshid Quli Khan II, Alivardi proceeded towards Cuttack to capture the family of Murshid Quli. However, that family had been rescued by the Raja of Khurda. The fort of Barabati and the wealth abandoned by the family or Murshid Quli fell in his hands. Alivardi appointed Sayyid Ahmad as the Governor of Odisha and left Gujar Khan, one of his trusted generals to assist the

Governor in discharging the administration. Sayyid Ahmad was never a good ruler. He extracted money from the local zamindars and curtailed the salary of his soldiers. By his indulgence in wine and women, he earned a bad name in Odisha. At this juncture, Mirza Baqar, the son-in-law of Murshid Quli Khan II invaded Odisha with his soldiers and inflicted a crushing defeat upon Sayyid Ahmad. The people of Cuttack supported Mirza Baqar so also some soldiers in the army of Ahmad who were loyal to Murshid Quli II. Sayyid Ahmad with his family was confined inside the fort of Barabati.

By this, the unpopularity of Alivardi increased to a greater extent. With revengeful mind, he stepped towards Cuttack to deal with Mirza Baqar and rescue Sayyid Ahmad. A toe fight took place between them in Cuttack and Mirza Baqar fled away from the battle field towards the Deccan. Sayyid Ahmad was rescued. Alivardi punished the local chiefs who had rendered their help to Mirza Baqar. He appointed Shaikh Masum as deputy Governor of Odisha and left for Murshidabad. However, his administrative arrangement in Odisha failed utterly with the invasion of the Marathas. At last, Alivardi failed to check the Maratha inroad and Odisha passed into the hands of the Marathas in 1751 A.D.

3.3.2. 6.Administration of the Naib Nizams of Bengal

The Mughal system of revenue administration under went a change in Odisha during Murshid Quli Khan's *Subahdarship.* For the administrative point of view, he separated Midnapur from the *Subah* of Odisha. He made revenue settlement in six *Sarkars* namely. Jaleswar, Remuna, Basta, Golapara, Malghetia and Mazkuri. He appointed honest and efficient revenue officers to collect revenue. He measured waste lands and offered them to the farmers. He also advanced *taqavi* (agriculture) loans to farmers for the improvement of lands. He imposed two new imports *(abwabs)* namely, *Abwab Jaffar Khan and Abwab Khasnawisi,* Suja-ud-din Muhammad Khan imposed four kinds of *abwabs* upon the people of Odisha *Viz.Nazar Pooniah* (Annual presents from the zamindars), *Baha-i-Khilat* (price for robes offered to zamindars), *Pustabandi* (For upholding the river banks near Lalbagh and the fort of Murshidabad) and *Russom Nazarat* (realisation from rural area). All these above four *abwabs* came under the main head *Zar Mathaut.*

He also collected three other *abwabs* like *Nazrana Mokurrari* (fixed amount paid by zamindar for the privileges he enjoyed), *Mathut-Fil-Khana* (contribution to meet the feeding expense of elephants of *Nizam* and *Diwan* of Murshidabad). Murshid Quli II was very liberal in collecting revenue. He exempted many *abwabs* to the zamindars and earned good name. During the rule of the Naib Nizams of Bengal, the administration of God Jagannath also received attention. During Taqi Khan, a great disturbance took place in the management of temple administration. The idols of the Gods were removed from the temple and were taken to Banapur and subsequently to Tekkali. However, during Murshid Quli Khan II's period, the idols were brought back to the temple and the pilgrims visited the temple in large number.

After Taqi Khan, others did not pay much attention to it. During the rule of the Naib Nizams, the Muslim monuments were built in Cuttack and Balasore. Local zamindars were instructed to look after the festivals of the Hindus and Muslims as well. This clearly shows that religious harmony was maintained perfectly in Odisha during the Naib Nizams of Odisha. Balasore, Jajpur and Cuttack were the main centres of the Islamic faith and their improvement was made during the Naib Nizams of Odisha.

The local participation in the administration was a general feature during this period. In military administration, the soldires were recruited from this land. The local officers were chosen on the basis of their efficiency who collected revenue and maintained peace in the locality. Very often the local zamindars were empowered to look after the local problems and to solve the crisis in their own locality. In toto, in discharging the administration efficiently, the Naib Nizams of Bengal depended, to a greater extent, upon the people of this land.

3.3.3. Conclusion

Thus, the incapability on the part of the Mughal rulers led the Naib Nizams of Bengal to look after the administration of Odisha. Close to the boarder of Odisha, from Bengal, they could pay close attention towards the administration that prevailed in this land. At times, they suppressed the rebellion and warned the local chiefs of Odisha for dire consequences. The people of Odisha wanted to be free from the clutch of Alivardi Khan. At that time, the appearance of the Marathas in the political scenario of Odisha fulfilled their desire and Odisha passed into the hands of the Marathas.

3.3.4. Summary

- During Aurangzeb's reign period, the Mughal Empire passed through many threatening circumstances caused by the Qutb Shahis and Adil Shah is of Deccan, Sikhs, Rajputs and several other local chiefs.
- So, it was not possible on his part to sent Governors from Delhi to maintain the administration in Odisha.
- When Murshid Quli Khan took over the charge of the administration of Odisha, virtually, passed into the hands of the Naib Nizams of Bengal until the Marathas established their sway over it.
- Emperor Aurangzeb was quite aware of the ability of Murshid Quli Khan. The former had appointed the latter as the *Diwan* of Bengal and Odisha.
- The *Subahdar* of Bengal by that time, was Prince Muhammad Azim-us-Shah (son of Bahadur Shah-I and grandson of Aurangzeb).
- The long cherished desire of Murshid Quli Khan was fulfilled.
- In 1717 AD., another feather to the crowned cap of Murshid Quli was added when he was declared as the *Subahdar* of Bengal in addition to his usual charge of Odisha.
- With the death of Murshid Quli Khan, the throne of Bengal was occupied by his sonin-law Suja-ud-din Muhammad Khan.
- As he was very apt in dealing with the Mughals, immediately after his accession to the throne of Bengal in 1727 AD.
- It has been stated that Suja-ud-din remained busy in the affairs of Bengal and sent Taqi Khan, his son to look after the administration of Odisha.
- Taqi Khan became the deputy Governor of Odisha and he dealt with Raja Ramachandradeva of Khurda scorn and contempt.
- During his deputy governorship, Raja Ramachandradeva was converted to Islam faith and was also kept captive in the fort' of Barabati.

- His longing towards God Jagannath and desire to perform the festivals of the God, led Taqi Khan to invade Khurda.
- At the death of Taqi Khan in 1735 A.D., Murshid Quli Khan II was sent immediately by Suja-ud-din as deputy *Subahdar* to look after the administration of Odisha.
- With the victory at Phulwari, Odisha was virtually under the grip of Alivardi.
- Without following Murshid Quli Khan II, Alivardi proceeded towards Cuttack to capture the family of Murshid Quli.
- However, that family had been rescued by the Raja of Khurda. The fort of Barabati and the wealth abandoned by the family or Murshid Quli fell in his hands.
- Alivardi appointed Sayyid Ahmad as the Governor of Odisha and left Gujar Khan, one of his trusted generals to assist the Governor in discharging the administration. Sayyid Ahmad was never a good ruler.
- The Mughal system of revenue administration under went a change in Odisha during Murshid Quli Khan's *Subahdarship.*
- For the administrative point of view, he separated Midnapur from the *Subah* of Odisha.
- During the rule of the Naib Nizams of Bengal, the administration of God Jagannath also received attention.
- During Taqi Khan, a great disturbance took place in the management of temple administration.
- During the rule of the Naib Nizams, the Muslim monuments were built in Cuttack and Balasore.
- Local zamindars were instructed to look after the festivals of the Hindus and Muslims as well.
- The local participation in the administration was a general feature during this period. In military administration, the soldires were recruited from this land.

- Thus, the incapability on the part of the Mughal rulers led the Naib Nizams of Bengal to look after the administration of Odisha.

3.3.5. Exercise

- **Give an account on Odisha under the Naib-Nizams.**
- **Write a note on Odisha under Naib Nizam** Murshid **Quli Khan II of Bengal.**
- **Discuss the administration of Odisha under Naib Nizam** Muhammad **Taqi Khan.**
- **Highlight the administration of Odisha Naib Nizam Suja-ud-din Muhammad Khan of Bengal.**
- **Write a note on the administration of Odisha Naib Nizam Murshid Quli Khan-I**

3.3.6. Further Reading

- A.C. Pradhan, *A Study of History of Odisha*, 2006.
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Unit-3
Chapter-IV
Muslim Administration in Odisha

Structure

3.4.0. Objectives

3.4.1. Introduction

3.4.2. Muslim Administration in Odisha

3.1.2.1. Sarkars in Mughal administration

3.4.2.2. Revenue Administration of the Mughals

3.4.2.3. Revenue administration by Aurangzeb

3.4.2.4. Revenue Officers of the Mughals

3.4.2.5. Other Officers in Mughal administration

3.4.2.6. Administration in Garjat states

3.4.2.7. Attitude towards the religions of Odisha

3.4.3. Conclusion

3.4.4. Summary

3.4.5. Exercise

3.1.6. Further Reading

3.4.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students investigate about the Muslim administration in Odisha. After studying this lesson you will be able to:

- *to learn the division of Muslim administration*
- *to analyze the revenue administration*
- *to investigate administration in the Garjat states of Odisha*
- *to trace the attitude towards the religions of Odisha*

3.4.1. Introduction

During the Afghan period no change in the administration took place as they were always busy in fighting with the Mughals. They only confined themselves in collecting revenue. But the Mughals introduced some changes in the administration, particularly revenue administration. Under them Odisha was divided into two political zones. The princely states, mostly hilly, which were ruled by the tributary chiefs and Rajas were called Garjats. Besides that the areas in coastal belt under the direct administration of the Mughals were called as Moghulbandi area.

3.4.2. Muslim Administration in Odisha

The Mughals introduced an efficient administrative system. The Mughal officers discharged their duties and responsibilities according to the Mughal administrative system.

3.1.2.1. Sarkars in Mughal administration

The Mughals introduced an elaborate system of administration in Odisha. Todarmal divided Odisha into *five Sarkars* in 1582 A.D. namely- Jaleswar *Sarkar* (extending from river Rupnarayan to Budhabalanga), Bhadrak *Sarkar* (extending from river Budhabalanga to Brahmani), Cuttack *Sarkar* (extending from river Brahmani to Chilika lake), Kalingadandapat (South Odisha) and Rajahmundry (North Andhra).

3.4.2.2. Revenue Administration of the Mughals

The prime *motive* of the Mughals was to get a huge amount of revenue from Odishan soil. Keeping that end in *view*, Todarmal, the great revenue minister of Akbar introduced his *bandobast* (settlement) in Odisha which was famous as *Tankhwah Raqmi*. Accordingly, Odisha was divided into two parts- the *Mughalbandi* and *Garjat.* The area which remained under the direct administration of the Mughals was called *Mughalbandi.* The *Garjats* were the area which remained under the direct administration of the native kings, who submitted to the Mughals by paying a fixed annual Peshkash. This settlement acknowledged the hereditary chiefs of the Garjats as hereditary *fiefs* in zamindari tenure. Raja Man Singh *gave* a final shape to this system of Todarmal in 1593 A.D. The Raja of Khurda held a key position among the zamindars of

Odisha. Under him were thirty small zamindars. Very famous among them were the zamindars of Banki, Damapada, Badamba, Tigiria, Narasinghpur, Athgarh, Angul, Talcher, Khandapada, Ranapur, Dasapalla, Ghumsar etc.

3.4.2.3. Revenue administration by Aurangzeb

A change in the *revenue* administration of Odisha drastically took place during the reign period of Aurangzeb. In 1728 A.D. Murshid Quli Khan introduced a new system in Odisha known as *Jamma Kamal.* In this settlement, the rate was specified in terms of cowrie currency During his time, Odisha was divided into 12 *Sarkars* ~aving 258 *Mahals.*

3.4.2.4. Revenue Officers of the Mughals

Among the *revenue* officers of the Mughals, the *Choudhuries, Muqaddams,* and *Quanungoes* played dominant role in revenue collection. Misappropriation of the revenue was rampant. As the Mughals remained at Delhi, far away from Odisha, they could not cast their eyes on the *revenues* collected. Under this circumstance, it was quite natural of being misappropriated.

3.4.2.5. Other Officers in Mughal administration

The Mughal revenue administration divided Odisha into *Sarkars* which were again divided into *Mahals.* The *Mahals* were again subdivided into *Taluqs* and *Mauja* was the last unit of revenue division under the Mughals. The head of the *Sarkar* was *Faujdar. Choudhury* became the head of *Mahal, Taluqdar* became the head of the *Taluq* and the head of the *Mauji* was *Muquddam.*

3.4.2.6. Administration in Garjat states

In the *Garjat* administration, however, very little changes were made. The feudatory kings were called zamindars. The head of the *Garh* was conferred with the title of *Quilladar.* By frequent transfer of governors, the Mughals put a check on the officers associated with the administration of Odisha. This Mughal model of administation was followed subsequently by others, to a greater extent, in Odisha.

3.4.2.7. Attitude towards the religions of Odisha

Though, in the field of religion, Mughal administration had taken a tolerant view during Akbar and Shah Jahan's period, this was not the same during Aurangzeb's regime. He was a hardcore Sunni Muslim and he wanted to deal with the Hindu subjects of Odisha scorn and contempt. He imposed pilgrim tax upon the Hindus who visited the temple of God Jagannath.

Jadunath Sarkar in his book, *History of Aurangzeb,* mentions about the temple destruction order of Aurangzeb to be implemented in Odisha as such : ".... the Emperor learning from news letters of the province of Odisha that at the village of Tilkuti at Medinapura temple has been newly built, he issued his august mandate for its destruction and the destruction of all the temples built anywhere in this province by the worthless infidels.

Therefore you are commanded with extreme urgency that immediately on the receipt of this letter you should destroy the above mentioned temples. Every idol house built during the last 10 or 12 years whether with brick or clay should be demolished without delay. Also do not allow the crushed Hindus and the infidels to repair their old temples. Reports of the destruction of the temples should be sent to the court under the seal of the quzis and attested by pious Shaikhs." This clearly shows that Aurangzeb ordered for the destruction of newly built temples. It further suggests that the building of new temples should be stopped in Odisha.

During his reign period, the administration of the temple of God Jagannath at Puri got a set back and some festivals of the temple could not be performed in proper time. Aurangzeb championed the cause of the Muslims in Odisha. During his reign huge lands were granted to the *Ulemas, Maulavis,* holy men and downtrodden Muslims in Odisha. During his reign period, Shaikh Abul Khair of Golpara and Shaikh Barkhudar of Cuttack received *Madad-i-mash* (grant of land for religious purposes) lands.

3.4.3. Conclusion

Thus, the Muslim administration in Odisha was not marked with much worth. No doubt, Odisha was well divided into different *Sarkars;* however, the administration was not smoothly discharged due to frequent change of governors. A peaceful co-existence of both Hindus and Muslims was effected during this phase of the Mughal rule in Odisha. Economically, Odisha was not prosperous in comparison to the Hindu period, still then it was better than the Maratha period. However, Odisha came under the orbit of a uniform Mughal administration which prevailed throughout the country. After Mughals, the Nizams of Bengal ruled Odisha till it was occupied by the Marathas.

3.4.4. Summary

- During the Afghan period no change in the administration took place as they were always busy in fighting with the Mughals.

- They only confined themselves in collecting revenue. But the Mughals introduced some changes in the administration, particularly revenue administration.
- Under them Odisha was divided into two political zones.
- The princely states, mostly hilly, which were ruled by the tributary chiefs and Rajas were called Garjats.
- Besides that the areas in coastal belt under the direct administration of the Mughals were called as Moghulbandi area.
- The Mughals introduced an efficient administrative system.
- Todarmal divided Odisha into *five Sarkars* in 1582 A.D.
- The prime *motive* of the Mughals was to get a huge amount of revenue from Odishan soil.
- Keeping that end in *view,* Todarmal, the great revenue minister of Akbar introduced his *bandobast* (settlement) in Odisha which was famous as *Tankhwah Raqmi.*
- Accordingly, Odisha was divided into two parts- the *Mughalbandi* and *Garjat.*
- The area which remained under the direct administration of the Mughals was called *Mughalbandi.*
- The *Garjats* were the area which remained under the direct administration of the native kings, who submitted to the Mughals by paying a fixed annual Peshkash.
- In 1728 A.D. Murshid Quli Khan introduced a new system in Odisha known as *Jamma Kamal.*
- Among the *revenue* officers of the Mughals, the *Choudhuries, Muqaddams,* and *Quanungoes* played dominant role in revenue collection.
- In the *Garjat* administration, however, very little changes were made. The feudatory kings were called zamindars.
- Though, in the field of religion, Mughal administration had taken a tolerant view during Akbar and Shah Jahan's period, this was not the same during Aurangzeb's regime.
- During his reign period, the administration of the temple of God Jagannath at Puri got a set back and some festivals of the temple could not be performed in proper time. Aurangzeb championed the cause of the Muslims in Odisha.
- Thus, the Muslim administration in Odisha was not marked with much worth.

3.4.5. Exercise

- **Give an account on the Muslim administration in Odisha.**
- **Write a note on the revenue administration in Odisha during the Muslim period.**
- **Discuss the attitude of the Muslim administrators towards the Garjat states.**
- **Highlight the attitude of the Muslim rulers towards the religions of Odisha.**

3.1.6. Further Reading

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Unit-3
Chapter-V
Muslim-Maratha Conflict
Maratha Occupation of Odisha

Structure

3.5.0. Objectives

3.5.1.Introduction

3.5.2. Muslim-Maratha conflict

3.5.3. Maratha occupation of Odisha

3.5.3.1. Capture of Barabati fort

3.5.3.2. Reoccupation of Cuttack by Alivardi Khan

3.5.3.3. Alliverdi's betrayal

3.5.3.4. Recapture of Cuttack by the Marathas

3.5.3.5. The peace treaty of 1751

3.5.3.6. Mir Habib (1751-1752)

3.5.3.7. Mirza Saleh (1752-1759)

3.5.3.8. Sheo Bhatt Sathe (1760-1764)

3.5.3.9. Bhawani Pandit (1764-1768)

3.5.3.10. Shambhaji Ganesh (1768-1770)

3.5.3.11. Babuji Naik (1771-1773)

3.5.3.12. Madhoji Hari (1773-1777)

3.5.3.13. Rajaram Pandit (1778-1793)

3.5.3.14. Sadashiv Rao (1793-1803)

3.5.4. Conclusion

3.5.5. Summary

3.5.6. Exercise

3.5.7. Further Reading

3.5.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students investigate about the Muslim-Maratha conflict and Maratha occupation of Odisha. After studying this lesson you will be able to:

- *to learn the Muslim-Maratha conflict*
- *to analyze the Maratha occupation of Odisha*
- *to investigate administration in the Garjat states of Odisha*
- *to trace the attitude towards the religions of Odisha*

3.5.1.Introduction

The disintegration of the Mughal empire cast an evil shadow upon Odisha. The Muslims failed to enjoy any political peace during 18th century. The aggressive Marathas used this as a springboard to launch repeated attacks against the rich Bengal in their quest for wealth. Such predatory incursions were mostly designed and executed by the Bhonsles of Nagpur.

3.5.2. Muslim-Maratha conflict

With the decline of the Mughal administration in India, the Nizams of Bengal built up their rule in Odisha. On the otherhand, the Marathas became powerful and wanted to assert their power all over the country. The Bhonsles of Nagpur under Raghuji gave a new guidance to the Marathas over Odisha thereby directly bringing a rift with Alivardi Khan, the Nawab of Bengal. In the long run, the Marathas became successful in establishing their sway over Odisha. However, their rule in this land from 1751 A.D. to 1803 A.D. made people of Odisha dissatisfied.

3.5.3. Maratha occupation of Odisha

The causes of the Maratha invasion of Odisha were not too far to seek. Raghuji Bhonsle of Nagpur failed to dominate over Sahu due to the superior strength of Baji Rao and contemplated plunder in the direction of north-east of his dominion. His desire was strengthened when Mir Habib, being expelled by Nawab Alivardi Khan of Odisha, stepped towards Nagpur and extended his help to Raghuji thereby encouraging him to invade Odisha. At last, the willingness of his Prime Minister Bhaskar Pandit prompted him to launch an attack on Odisha.

3.5.3.1. Capture of Barabati fort

By that time, Odisha was under the control of Alivardi Khan, the Nawab of Bengal. Bhaskar Pandit, with the help oi Mir Habib, crossed Baramula Pass and entered into Odisha with a grand Maratha army. The galloping march of the Maratha cavalry stuck terror in the minds of Nawab's army. Within no time, on 19 April 1742, Barabati fort fell in the clutch of the Marathas. Mir Habib, through Midnapur, marched to Burdwan and then to Murshidabad to settle the score with

Alivardi. Though Murshidabad was saved from the plunder of the Marathas by the payment of a huge amount of money to Bhaskar Pandit by Alivardi Khan, the fate had reserved certain misfortunes for it in near future.

3.5.3.2. Reoccupation of Cuttack by Alivardi Khan

With the return of Bhaskar Pandit, Alivardi Khan appealed to the shadowy Mughal emperor Muhammad Shah to render him possible help for meeting the Maratha menace. The emperor intimated the plights of Alivardi to the Nawab of Oudh and Peshwa Balaji Baji Rao of Poona who helped Alivardi to recapture Cuttack by defeating the Maratha contingents when Bhaskar Pandit had left for Nagpur via Chilika with the huge booty which he had obtained from plunder.

3.5.3.3. Alliverdi's betrayal

When Alivardi came back to Murshidabad, Raghuji Bhonsle fell upon Odisha like a meteor and proceeded towards Bengal to realise *Chauth* from Alivardi after plundering Cuttack. At this juncture, Alivardi was forced to form an alliance with Peshwa Balaji Baji Rao by paying him twenty-two lakhs of rupees to save him from the clutch of Raghuji which compelled Raghuji to retreat his steps towards Nagpur. However, a treaty between the Bhonsles and the Peshwas again brought back the Maratha troops to Odisha under the leadership of Bhaskar Pandit who was invited by Alivardi to a meeting at Mankora with his twenty-two generals and all of them were treacherously killed with their leader. This made the Marathas fearful who returned back to Nagpur immediately.

3.5.3.4. Recapture of Cuttack by the Marathas

This treacherous deed of Alivardi Khan made Raghuji furious who led his vigorous campaign against Odisha. On 12 May, 1745, the fort of Barabati fell in the hands of Raghuji. Of course, Raghuji was defeated at the hands of Alivardi. While retreating towards Nagpur, he instructed Mir Habib to bring the possession of Odisha under the Maratha control. As a loyal servant, Mir Habib proceeded towards Bengal with his troops and occupied Midnapur. Alivardi appointed Sayyid Ahmad Khan as the Governor of Odisha who defeated the Marathas at Midnapur. At this critical juncture Januji, the son of Raghuji came to the aid of Mir Habib. The rebellious Afghan chiefs supported Januji. Alivardi could not recover Midnapur from the Marathas. In March 1749, Alivardi took the final decision to oust the Marathas from Odisha. Being unopposed by Mir Habib, Alivardi proceeded upto Cuttack and captured it. He then appointed Shaikh Abdul

Subhan as the Governor of Odisha. Only after one week of his departure, Mir Habib came out from the hidings and reoccupied Cuttack.

3.5.3.5. The peace treaty of 1751

This shocking news made Alivardi more fragile. By that time, Alivardi was old, weak and feeble. Taking a grand army of 40,000 soldiers, Mir Habib proceeded towards Bengal. Alivardi gathered his army to oust the Marathas from Bengal. The Marathas resorted to the *guerilla* warfare. In order to teach them a lesson, Alivardi established a permanent military outpost at Midnapur under the command of Ali Quli Khan. He sent his grandson Siraj-ud- Daullah to deal with the Marathas and he chased them as far as Balasore. The Marathas left Alivardi in a cross-road of puzzle. When Alivardi was at Midnapur, the Marathas attacked upon Murshidabad. When Alivardi marched towards Burdwan, the Marathas fell upon Midnapur. Owing to the old age, Alivardi needed respite from warfare. Mirjafar and Mirza Saleh negotiated from the side of the Nawab and Mir Habib respectively and at last, peace was concluded in 1751. The terms of the treaty were as such: Mir Habib was to be regarded as a servant of Alivardi Khan (the Naib Nizam) to rule over Odisha on his behalf. He would pay the surplus revenue of the province as arrears to Raghuji's troops. Twelve lakhs of rupees should annually be paid to Raghuji on condition that "the Marathas would not set their foot within the dominions of Alivardi." River Sonamukhi (Suvarnarekha) which runs near Balasore was to form the demarcating line between the boundaries of Odisha and Bengal. The treaty between Mir Habib and Alivardi was highly politically motivated. Highlighting its importance, prof. B.C. Ray writes:

"The treaty was a triangular compromise amongest three sets of forces in the name of Raghuji, Mir Habib and Alivardi, Raghuji for money, Mir Habib for honour and revenge, and Alivardi for rest without being unmindful for retaining his nominal overlordship over Odisha." The treaty, as it appears, established the authority of the Marathas over Odisha. Alivardi, though appeared as the overlord of Odisha, he was not so in actual practice. He remained under the clutch of the Marathas who, with the gradual march of time, established their authority over Odisha independent of the Nawabs of Bengal.

The Maratha governors of Odisha

The Maratha governors of Odisha are as follows:

3.5.3.6. Mir Habib (1751-1752)

Mir Habib met Raghuji when Alivardi Khan killed Murshid Quli Khan II. Right from that time, he determined to avenge the death of his master Murshid Quli. Keeping that end in view, he sided with Raghuji till the treaty was concluded between him and Alivardi Khan in 1751. The treaty was concluded in such a manner that Mir Habib was indispensable for both the parties who recognised him as the Governor of Odisha. On the one hand, the Marathas choose him to get back their arrear revenue and on the other, Alivardi got a respite from the turbulent politics of Odisha. Mir Habib was stable man and as *Subahdar*, he took prudent decision whenever required. For example, after the death of Ramachandradeva II of Khurda, Padmanavadeva of Patia appealed Mir Habib who decided to place him on the throne of Khurda. However, when the courtiers convinced him regarding the legitimacy of Bhagirathi Kumar who termed himself as Birakishoradeva, later on, Mir Habib ungrudgingly accepted it. As an administrator, Mir Habib always enforced strict discipline in the field of administration. For successful implementation of his plan, he kept an Afghan force and a Maratha force ready under his command. He had promised to pay the Marathas an annual tribute of rupees four lakhs. He also received twelve lakhs of rupees from Bengal. Unfortunately, he fell into the wrath of Januji who could not get satisfactory explanation from him regarding the alleged misappropriation of a certain amount of rupees that led to the death of Mir Habib.

3.5.3.7. Mirza Saleh (1752-1759)

Mirza Saleh, the nephew of Mir Habib, was instrumental in the treaty that took place in 1751 between his uncle and Alivardi. When he succeeded Mir Habib as the Governor of Odisha in 1752, he found himself between two giant masters, Alivardi, on the one hand and Raghuji, on the other. However, he was not a man to be sandwitched between the two contending forces, rather, he wanted to outwit both the parties. When Raghuji demanded more money from him, he committed to pay four laks rupees more and demanded the same from Alivardi who denied to pay that amount.This led Saleh to coerce the people of Odisha occasionally for realisation of more money and to collect some money from the British merchants who had estabiished their factories at Hariharpur, Pipli and Balasore. The Britishers also offered suitable presentations to Mirza Saleh for the prosperity in their business.

With the death of Alivardi, his grandson Siraj-ud-daulah ascended the throne of Bengal in 1756. The new Nawab instructed Saleh not to render any help to the British people. Though Saleh

showed his allegiance to Siraj, he secretly helped the British. When British factories in Bengal fell one after.another, their factories in Odisha grew more and more by the blessings of Saleh. Further, defying the order of Siraj, he helped the Britishers secretely in raising 1,000 gunmen that made their position secure in Odisha. He not only helped them but conspired with them to oust Siraj from the throne of Bengal. When that was detected, he took refuge with Raghuji at Nagpur who did not recommend his cowardice activities. During the absence of Saleh, his son Dadar Ali remained in charge of the administration of Odisha.

In the meanwhile, Siraj was killed in 1757 after his defeat in the battle of Plassey. Dadar Ali, failing to discharge his duty, was imprisoned by the Marathas. Mirza Saleh returned to Cuttack and resumed his charge. Now, Mirzafar, the new Nawab, stopped the payment of *Chauth* to the Marathas and this brqught discredit to Saleh. So he was forced to resign in 1759. He was the last Muslim *Subahdar* of Odisha to serve the cause of both the Marathas of Nagpur and Nawab of Bengal. After him, Odisha was under the direct control of the Maratha administration.

3.5.3.8. Sheo Bhatt Sathe (1760-1764)

Sheo Bhatt Sathe was the first Maratha *Subahdar* in Odisha. With the death of Raghuji Bhonsle, his son Januji ascended the throne of Nagpur. He appointed Shea Bhatt Sathe as the *Subahdar* of Odisha. Shea took over the charge of the province from Chimna Sau. After the assumption of power as the Governor of Odisha, the first task before Shea Bhatt Sathe was to collect *Chauth* from the Nawab of Bengal. By that time, Mirjafar had been replaced by Mir Qasim as the Nawab of Bengal. Shea Bhatt demanded Chauth from him and Mir Qasim, could not pay any heed to that. At this Shea attacked Bengal and plundered Burdwan. He further claimed that Midnapur and Burdwan were under the Marathas as parts of Odisha. In 1761, his attack to plunder Bengal was foiled by the British garrison. The Britishers took precautionary measure by stationing British troops in Midnapur and Bengal. For that reason, the Marathas could not succeed in their mission. This enraged Sheo Bhatt who kept Kushal Chand, the British agent at Cuttack, under custody. Now the Britishers persuaded Mir Qasim to drive out the Marathas from Odisha. Mir Qasim kept mum and started negotiation with Sheo Bhatt assuring him the payment of *Chauth* if Sheo extended his cooperation to the former. To this end, Qasim sent a *sanad* of Jaleswar and Midnapur to Sheo Bhat who sent his own younger brother Bhaskar Pandit and Butl Khan to march to Jaleswar for assisting Mir Qasim. This alarmed the British East India Company which sent its agent Aga Muhammad AIi, an inhabitant of Balasore and Ghulam Mustafa, the

company's *gumastah* at Balasore to meet the Maratha governor for not going against the Britishers. Vansittart, the British governor of Bengal confirmed that the arrears of *Chauth* would be given to the Marathas if they would side with the company against Mir Qasim. This led to Shea Bhatt to discontinue his allegiance to Mir Quasim. In the battle of Buxar, Mir Qasim was defeated in 1764. After victory in that battle, the Britishers befooled Shea Bhatt not paying any arrear of *Chauth.* As Sheo Bhatt failed to pay his arrear to Januji, he was dismissed in 1764. Januji appointed Chimna Sau as the Governor of Odisha. Shea Bhatt was imprisoned on 12 April, 1764 and sent to Nagpur. After being pardoned, Shea tried his best to regain the governorship of Odisha but he failed stupendously in his mission. He played the game of double dealing with Mir Qasim and so, he was paid back in his own coins.

3.5.3.9. Bhawani Pandit (1764-1768)

The authority of Chimna Sau was challenged by Shea Bhatt Sathe. So, the former sought the help from Nagpur to quell the uprising of the zamindars instigated by Shea Bhatt. Accordingly, Bhawani Pandit reached Odisha with a grand army of five thousand cavalry in July, 1764 and took over the charge as the Governor of Odisha. He took drastic action against the refractory zamindars of Dhenkanal, Nilgiri and Mayurbhanj. Being subdued, they submitted to Bhawani Pandit and paid handsomely for the maintenance of the Maratha troops in Odisha.

The threat of Shea Bhatt invade Odisha prompted the Britishers to ask Bhawani Pandit to send some troops for suppressing Shea. Shea helped them in this matter. He entered into a treaty with Lord clive by which he promised to hand over the salt produced from the salt lands won by the zamindars of Balasore and neighbouring districts to the British merchants only. Through him, negotiation took place between the British and Januji for the payment of *Chauth.* Finally, when Mir Zainul Abadin reached the court of Jaunji at Nagpur on behalf of the British, he expressed his resertment against the government of Bhawani Pandit. At this, Januji became angry and dismissed Bhawani Pandit for his inefficiency in the realisation of *Chauth.*

3.5.3.10. Shambhaji Ganesh (1768-1770)

The motive behind the appointment of Shambhaji Ganesh as the *Subahdar* of Odisha was only to collect *Chauth* from Bengal. He strengthened his friendship with the British with a hope to realise *Chauth.* He offered 50,000 Maratha horses to the British, if the latter wanted to utilise them. Further, he allowed the British troops under the command of Major Achmuty to march through Odisha. The negotiation for *Chauth* which had started in a very congenial atmosphere

between Shambhaji and the British ended in a failure because the latter did not help Januji in his conflict with the Peshwa. During his period, there was news of the arrival of alleged French ships of the coast of Ganjam for which the British authority misunderstood him. The purpose for which Shambhaji Ganesh was sent, could never be fulfilled. However, Shambhaji had taken keen interest in encouraging the pilgrims from all parts of India to visit the temple of Lord Jagannath at Puri. He also took steps to remove the oppression of the *amla* over the *mutassadis.* He died in September, 1770.

3.5.3.11. Babuji Naik (1771-1773)

After the death of Shambhaji Ganesh, Rajaram Pandit remained in the charge of Governor of Odisha for a short while. Babuji Naik was sent as the *Subahdar* of Odisha in 1770. He continued his friendly relation with the British. Allyn, a servant of the company and in charge of a factory at Cuttack had lent money to many persons. He appealed Babuji for the realisation of the same and was helped by the latter in that matter. Further, as there was shortage of grains at Calcutta, he instructed Abdullah Khan, the *faujdar* of Balasore to sell rice for the company when he was requested by the Englishmen. The Britishers also showed their cordial gesture by providing the assistance of an English battalion to Babuji Naik for suppressing the border zamindars who created distrubance. His tenure as the *Subahdar* of Odisha was peaceful.

3.5.3.12. Madhoji Hari (1773-1777)

The governorship of Madhoji Hari witnessed a new kind of development in the coastal strips of Balasore and Cuttack. During his period, there were many ship-wrecks, particularly in the middle part of the coastal Odisha like Kujang, Kanika and Ali (Aul). The people of these area were plundering the wrecked ships with the full support of the local kings who ill-treated and sometimes, imprisoned the ship-wrecked persons. Keeping this in view, the British authorities appealed to the Raja of Nagpur to provide safety and security to the merchants, travellers and wayfarers and award punishment to the king of Kujang who was very notorious. As a remedial measure, the British authority wanted a *sanad* from the Maratha chief of Nagpur granting them "a perpetual possession of a strip of land which lies between the river Kanika and Mc1hanadi running in line with the sea coast." Further, the power vested on the king of Kujang was to be taken away and delegated to the British. The Maratha chief of Nagpur did not agree to the first proposal of the Britishers. However, he ordered Madhoji Hari to enquire the matter relating to the king of Kujang. When summoned by the *Subahdar,* the king expressed his sorrow for the acts

done in the past and thus, was pardoned by Madhoji. This act of Madhoji was grossly disliked by the Raja of Nagpur and he was recalled from Odisha.

3.5.3.13. Rajaram Pandit (1778-1793)

The governorship of Rajaram Pandit in Odisha witnessed the Anglo-Maratha conflict during the Governor-Generalship of Warren Hastings. The Raja of Nagpur had joined with Poona, Hyderabad and Mysore, forming an anti-British confederacy. The conflict with these four powers demanded the movement of British army to Madras via Odisha to deal with Hyder Ali of Mysore. The Bhonsle chief of Nagpur thought it prudent not to have a clash with the British power. Accordingly he instructed Rajaram Pandit to extract *Chauth* from the British authorities, if the Governor-General asked for the passage of the British troops through Odisha. Warren Hastings dispatched a detachment under Colonel Pearse upto Balasore in 1781 and sent Anderson to obtain necessary permission from the Maratha Governor of Odisha for the same purpose through the payment of twelve lakhs of rupees. Rajaram Pandit went personally to Calcutta to settle the amount with the Governor-General and demanded twenty-five lakhs of rupees as loan with the immediate payment of twelve lakhs. After due negotiation, a sum of rupees thirteen lakhs along with a loan of rupees ten lakhs was handed over to him. With the help of some Maratha officers like Harihar Mahadeo and Magun Choudhury, Colonel Pearse marched with his army through Odisha and crossed the border of Ganjam, receiving an assistance of 2,000 horses from the Marathas. This act of Rajaram brought British closer to the Bhonsles of Nagpur. Rajaram Pandit was very firm in his action. After receiving information from Wilkinson, the British resident at Balasore regarding the oppression of the Maratha *faujdar* Bhawani Das Choudhury over a merchant of Barabati named Gangadhar, Rajaram dismissed him. In his place, Murar Pandit was sent as the *faujdar* of Balasore. Further, he took steps to crush the recalcitrant zamindars. Snodgrass, the British Chief of Ganjam, informed Rajaram Pandit that Balarama Maharatha a refractory land-holder of the British company at Ganjam absconded and entered into the territory of King Divyasimhadeva, who gave asylum to him Rajaram Pandit seized him and his followers in the neigh bourhood of Cuttack. Divyasimhadeva, then, was handed over to Snodgrass. Of course, Balarama Maharatha tried to escape from the hands of Snodgrass and was killed. However, Rajaram Pandit chastised the king ot Khurda who humbly submitted before him. Not only Rajaram Pandit was shrewd diplomat but he was equally a good administrator. He brought all the refractory forces under his control. He also showed a great deal of interest for the

influx of pilgrims to Puri from all parts of India.The prior practice of collecting revenues through hereditary *talukdars* was disbanded and he appointed his own men for the same purpose. He discharged his duty very well as the *Subahdar* of Odisha and breathed his last in 1793.

3.5.3.14. Sadashiv Rao (1793-1803)

The death of Rajaram Pandit led his son Sadashiv Rao to be the *Naib Subahdar* of Odisha. He was quite friendly to the British like his father. With abolition of the British Residency at Balasore, Barabati slipped away from the clutch of British East India Company. However, Sadashiv Rao showed his cordial gesture to the company and offered Barabati to them which was attached to the British factory. Sadashiv also suppressed the local Rajas who acted against the British. In 1795, a mutinous British battalion refused to lay down their arms and were attacked by another battalion which imprisoned some sepoys of the former battalion. Other sepoys of the mutinous battalion took shelter with the king of Mayurbhanj, who did not deliver them to the British when demanded. At this stage, the British authorities approached Sadashiv Rao. Sadashiv wrote a letter to the king of Mayurbhanj who obeyed the order and drove out the rebellious sepoys from his territory. Sadashiv Rao also facilitated the march of British troops from Bengal to Madras. His cordial gesture encouraged the British to improve thier postal system in Odisha. The British correspondence from Calcutta to Puri increased considerably. However, his friendly relation with the English people never marred his spirit to fight for a lust cause. When Divyasimhadeva II, the king or Khurda 'died, there was contest for the throne of Khurda between Mukundadeva, the son of Divyasimhadeva and Shyamsundar, the second son of Birakishoradeva. Though the Britishers helped Shyamsundar, Sadashiv opposed it tooth and nail. At last, Mukundadeva asserted his legitimate claim over the throne of Khurda.

3.5.4. Conclusion

Thus, the British people betrayed the friendship of Sadashiv. Lord Wellesley was an imperialist out and out. He wanted to engulf the coastal strip of Odisha under the British hegemony. Taking the absence of Sadashiv Rao from Cuttack in October 1803, the British General Harcourt occupied coastal Odisha. Thus, ended the rule of the Marathas over this land.

3.5.5. Summary

- The disintegration of the Mughal empire cast an evil shadow upon Odisha.
- On the otherhand, the Marathas became powerful and wanted to assert their power all over the country.

- The Bhonsles of Nagpur under Raghuji gave a new guidance to the Marathas over Odisha thereby directly bringing a rift with Alivardi Khan, the Nawab of Bengal.
- The causes of the Maratha invasion of Odisha were not too far to seek.
- Raghuji Bhonsle of Nagpur failed to dominate over Sahu due to the superior strength of Baji Rao and contemplated plunder in the direction of north-east of his dominion.
- On 19 April 1742, Barabati fort fell in the clutch of the Marathas.
- When Alivardi came back to Murshidabad, Raghuji Bhonsle fell upon Odisha like a meteor and proceeded towards Bengal to realise *Chauth* from Alivardi after plundering Cuttack.
- This treacherous deed of Alivardi Khan made Raghuji furious who led his vigorous campaign against Odisha.
- On 12 May, 1745, the fort of Barabati fell in the hands of Raghuji.
- The peace treaty was concluded in 1751 between the Marathas and Muslims.
- Mir Habib met Raghuji when Alivardi Khan killed Murshid Quli Khan II.
- Right from that time, he determined to avenge the death of his master Murshid Quli.
- Mirza Saleh, the nephew of Mir Habib, was instrumental in the treaty that took place in 1751 between his uncle and Alivardi.
- Sheo Bhatt Sathe was the first Maratha *Subahdar* in Odisha.
- With the death of Raghuji Bhonsle, his son Januji ascended the throne of Nagpur. He appointed Shea Bhatt Sathe as the *Subahdar* of Odisha.
- Bhawani Pandit reached Odisha with a grand army of five thousand cavalry in July, 1764 and took over the charge as the Governor of Odisha.
- The motive behind the appointment of Shambhaji Ganesh as the *Subahdar* of Odisha was only to collect *Chauth* from Bengal.
- He strengthened his friendship with the British with a hope to realise *Chauth.*
- After the death of Shambhaji Ganesh, Rajaram Pandit remained in the charge of Governor of Odisha for a short while.
- Babuji Naik was sent as the *Subahdar* of Odisha in 1770. He continued his friendly relation with the British.

- The governorship of Madhoji Hari witnessed a new kind of development in the coastal strips of Balasore and Cuttack.
- During his period, there were many ship-wrecks, particularly in the middle part of the coastal Odisha like Kujang, Kanika and Ali (Aul).
- The governorship of Rajaram Pandit in Odisha witnessed the Anglo-Maratha conflict during the Governor-Generalship of Warren Hastings.
- The death of Rajaram Pandit led his son Sadashiv Rao to be the *Naib Subahdar* of Odisha.
- He was quite friendly to the British like his father.
- With abolition of the British Residency at Balasore, Barabati slipped away from the clutch of British East India Company.
- Thus, the British people betrayed the friendship of Sadashiv. Lord Wellesley was an imperialist out and out.
- Taking the absence of Sadashiv Rao from Cuttack in October 1803, the British General Harcourt occupied coastal Odisha.

3.5.6. Exercise

- **Write a note on the Muslim-Maratha conflict in Odisha.**
- **Give an account on the Maratha occupation of Odisha.**
- **Make an analysis on the rule of Maratha governers in Odisha.**
- **Highlight the achievements of Maratha governers of Odisha.**

3.5.7. Further Reading

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Unit-3

Chapter-VI
Maratha Administration in Odisha

Structure

3.6.0. Objectives

3.6.1. Introduction

3.6.2. Maratha administration in Odisha

3.6.2.1. Division of the Maratha Empire in Odisha

3.6.2.2. Maratha Administration in Garjat states

3.6.2.3. Administration in Mughalbandi areas of Odisha

3.6.2.4. Civil and Millitary administration of the Marathas

3.6.2.5. Export of Paddy

3.6.2.6. Trade connection with other parts of India

3.6.2.7. Policy towards Jagannath temple of Puri

3.6.3. Conclusion

3.6.4. Summary

3.6.5. Exercise

3.6.6. Further Reading

3.6.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students explore the Maratha administration in Odisha. After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- *trace the history of the Maratha administration*
- *identify the division of the empire*
- *recognize the Maratha administration in Garjat states*
- *judge the administration in Moghulbandi areas*
- *know the Maratha policy towards Jagannath temple of Puri*

3.6.1. Introduction

During the Maratha period, as in the Mughal period, there were Garjat states who paid tribute to the Raja of Nagpur. The rest of Odisha i.e. the coastal plain areas from Suvarnarekha in the North to Chilika in the South popularly known as Moghulbandi were ruled by the Marathas.

3.6.2. Maratha administration in Odisha

The Maratha administration in Odisha was a replica of the Mughal administration. They wanted to retain the fabric of Mughal pattern. However, massive exploitation by the Maratha Governors made their rule unpopular in Odisha.

3.6.2.1. Division of the Maratha Empire in Odisha

The Maratha administration in Odisha was a legacy of the Mughal rule. The Maratha possessions in Odisha were bounded by sea on the east, the province of Chhatisgarh on the west, the Chilka lake and undivided Ganjam district on the south and Jaleswar, Midnapur and Birbhum on the north. Odisha was divided into two political division-viz, the *Garjat* consisting of twenty-four' tributary chieftains and *Mughalbandi,* the coastal tract extending from Suvarnarekha in the north to the Chilka lake in the south.

3.6.2.2. Maratha Administration in Garjat states

Among the twenty-four feudatories, the most powerful was. the king of Khurda, the Rajas of Kanika, Dhenkanal,Ranapur, Baramba, Athagarh, Kujang, Aul (Ali) and Mayurbhanj had also retained their relative importance during the regime of the Marathas. The Maratha governors did not poke their nose in the internal administration of those chiefs. The feudatories were also not regular in their payment to the Maratha *Subenders.*

3.6.2.3. Administration in Mughalbandi areas of Odisha

.The *Mughalbandi* was divided into 150 *Paraganas* under the management of 32 *Amils.* Each *Paragana* was subdivided into two, three, four or more *Mahalas* or allotments. The *Amil* or Revenue Commissioner was responsible for the assessment of revenue and entrusting charge to

different officers for the collection of revenue. The hereditary revenue collectors under him were termed as *Chaudhuries, Kanungoes,* or *Talukdars* each in charge of a *taluk* or sub-division. These officers were given rent-free lands known as *Nankar.* Their duty was not only to collect revenue from the subjects but to keep them happy andcontended. The settlement known as *Hustabud* was prevalent. The demand of the government was based on the amount of land actually under cultivation.

3.6.2.4. Civil and Millitary administration of the Marathas

The *Subahdar* was the head of both civil and military administration of this land. The *Kiladar* served under him who was in charge of the fort of Barabati at Cuttack. Under the control of the *Subahdar,* there were some *faujdars* who controlled some *chaukis* (outposts). A *thanadar* was the head of a *cneuk:* The *Amil* was empowered to investigate and try both civil and criminal cases.

3.6.2.5. Export of Paddy

Like the present day, paddy was produced in huge amount and was a great item of export to Bengal and Madras through small ports of Golrah, Harishpur, Bishenpur and Manikpatna. Salt was plentily manufactured along the sea coast of Odisha.

3.6.2.6. Trade connection with other parts of India

During the Maratha rule, Odisha was well connected through roads with Bengal, Madras and Nagpur. From Cuttack, a well-known road connected Bengal through Bhadrak, Balasore, Jaleswar and Midnapur. There were two roads from Nagpur to Sambalpur. Madras was connected through a road from Cuttack passing through Puri, Ganjam, Burgun, Tekkali, Kalingapatanam, Chicacole and Visakhapatanam.

3.6.2.7. Policy towards Jagannath temple of Puri

In the field of religion, the Marathas brought regeneration. The worship of God Jagannath and the maintenance of the grand temple at Puri was the prime duty of the Maratha *Subahdars.* Puri, a deserted place during the rule of the Mughals was studded with pilgrims from all over India who came to pay homage to the God of Gods. The Marathas managed the temple efficiently and the pilgrims faced no difficulty at Puri. No doubt, pilgrim tax was collected by the Marathas but a large' slice of that income was spent in different festivals of the temple. Under Mar.atha patronage, the fame of God Jagannath spread in the nook and corner of India.Ttie Marathas opened *Annachhatras* (free food-distribution camps) and granted rent-free lands to the Brahmins.

They offered money to monks and offered suitable grants to the *mathas* for the performance of various festivals.

3.6.3. Conclusion

Thus, the Maratha rule in Odisha was, by and large, military in nature. The one and single aim of the Bhonsles of Nagpur was to treat this land as a milch cow and to extract much more revenue from the people. The frequent change of governors made the administration of this land precarious and ustable. Anarchy prevailed and people gradually became disinterested towards the Maratha rule. The frequent march of the British troops through Odisha germinated a fear psychosis in the minds of the people. Further, the extraction of more and more revenue by the Maratha governors enraged them who hated the Maratha rule over this land. That was perhaps, one of the chief reasons for which the people welcomed British hegemony over this land and wanted to expell the Marathas. One thing made the Maratha rule unique in Odisha and that was the maintenance of the temple of God Jagannath at Puri, which was so ruthlessly ignored by the Mughals in the past.

3.6.4. Summary

- During the Maratha period, as in the Mughal period, there were 30 Garjat states who paid tribute to the Raja of Nagpur.
- The rest of Odisha i.e. the coastal plain areas from Suvarnarekha in the North to Chilika in the South popularly known as Moghulbandi were ruled by the Marathas.
- The Maratha administration in Odisha was a replica of the Mughal administration.
- Among the twenty-four feudatories, the most powerful was. the king of Khurda, the Rajas of Kanika, Dhenkanal,Ranapur, Baramba, Athagarh, Kujang, Aul (Ali) and Mayurbhanj had also retained their relative importance during the regime of the Marathas.
- The *Mughalbandi* was divided into 150 *Paraganas* under the management of 32 *Amils.*
- Each *Paragana* was subdivided into two, three, four or more *Mahalas* or allotments.
- The *Amil* or Revenue Commissioner was responsible for the assessment of revenue and entrusting charge to different officers for the collection of revenue.
- The hereditary revenue collectors under him were termed as *Chaudhuries, Kanungoes,* or *Talukdars* each in charge of a *taluk* or sub-division.
- The *Subahdar* was the head of both civil and military administration of this land.
- The *Kiladar* served under him who was in charge of the fort of Barabati at Cuttack.

- Like the present day, paddy was produced in huge amount and was a great item of export to Bengal and Madras through small ports of Golrah, Harishpur, Bishenpur and Manikpatna.
- During the Maratha rule, Odisha was well connected through roads with Bengal, Madras and Nagpur.
- In the field of religion, the Marathas brought regeneration. The worship of God Jagannath and the maintenance of the grand temple at Puri was the prime duty of the Maratha *Subahdars.* Puri, a deserted place during the rule of the Mughals was studded with pilgrims from all over India who came to pay homage to the God of Gods.
- Thus, the Maratha rule in Odisha was, by and large, military in nature. The one and single aim of the Bhonsles of Nagpur was to treat this land as a milch cow and to extract much more revenue from the people.

3.6.5. Exercise

- **Give an account on the Maratha administration in Odisha.**
- **Make a note on the division of the Maratha empire in Odisha.**
- **Make an analysis on the civil and military administration of the Marathas in Odisha.**
- **Discuss the attitude of the Marathas towards the Jagannath temple of Puri.**

3.6.6. Further Reading

- B.C. Ray, *Orissa under the Marathas (1751-1803),* Allahabad, 1960.
- A.C. Pradhan, *A Study of History of Odisha*, 2006.
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Unit-3
Chapter-VII
Anglo-Maratha Conflicts

Structure

3.7.0. Objectives

3.7.1.Introduction

3.7.2.Anglo-Maratha conflict

3.7.2.1. Causes of the Anglo-Maratha Conflict in Odisha

3.7.2.2. British diplomacy to occupy Odisha

3.7.2.3. Anglo-Maratha conflict during the governorship of Rajaram Pandit

3.7.2.4. Anglo-Maratha Conflict during Sadashiv Rao

3.7.3. Conclusion

3.7.4. Summary

3.7.5. Exercise

3.7.6. Further Reading

3.7.0. Objectives

In this lesson, students investigate about the Anglo-Maratha conflicts. After studying this lesson you will be able to:

- *to learn the history of Anglo-Maratha conflict*
- *to analyze the causes of the Anglo-Maratha conflict*
- *to investigate relation between the Marathas and the British*
- *to trace the course of the Anglo-Maratha conflict*

3.7.1.Introduction

The decline of Mughal Empire led to the rise of many small powers like the Marathas to declare themselves as independent powers. Some of them also started establishing themselves as important power in the political horizon of India by subduing the some states of India including Odisha either through war or diplomacy. In meanwhile, the Marathas had to struggle with the English.

3.7.2.Anglo-Maratha conflict

The Anglo-Maratha conflicts constitute an important chapter in the history of Odisha which can be discussed bellow.

3.7.2.1. Causes of the Anglo-Maratha Conflict in Odisha

The most important reason for the Anglo-Maratha conflict was the strategic location of Odisha. Odisha lay between the already occupied British territories of Bengal and Madras Presidencies. The line of communication ran through Odisha. It is irksome, expensive and sometimes difficult to get a safe passage through Odisha from the Maratha authorities. Secondly, Odisha had been considered as a part of Bengal from the day of Muslim conquest in 1568 A.D. The fertile land was a revenue earning proposition. Thirdly, the right of obtaining revenue collection by the British after the Battle of Buxar made them covetous of establishing political authority. Fourthly, the Matarha incursions into outlying British districts in the Northern as well as the Southern Sarkars of the Mughalbandi region caused harassment. Last but not the least was the British objective of extending their dominion over the whole of India. In addition to those, trade interest particularly that of salt of the two dashed with each other's. So to achieve the manifold interests the British East India Company decided to occupy Odisha. Spadework for the conquest started, properly speaking since 1633 when they established their first factory at Hariharpur (Jatsinghpur district) and a second at Balasore sometime after.

3.7.2.2. British diplomacy to occupy Odisha

The Maratha rule was against the British interest. The British tried to persuade the Bengal Nawab to drive the Marathas out of Odisha but failed. After getting Diwani in J765, Clive wanted the Maratha territories in Odisha through negotiations instead of force. In J767, he sent Thomas Motte to Nagpur with an offer of money to the Bhonsala but it failed. Warren Hastings had to pay 13 lakhs as well as a loan of 12 lakhs of rupees to the Marathas to secure a passage through Odisha for operations against Hyder Ali of Mysore.

Lord Cornwallis's negotiations to get Odisha also failed. Ultimately Lord Wellesley, who had set the goal of extending British dominion as wide as possible in India, succeeded in the attempt. When Bhonsala refused to give away Odisha for a sum of money or accept the subsidiary alliance, preparations were made for the showdown. First of all, the British wanted to win over the Maratha army officials and soldiers. Secondly, they declared that occupation would be followed by conciliation and good administration. Thirdly, they entered into negotiations with native states (Garhjats). Fourthly, they realised the inability of the Marathas to raise the strength of their small army. Finally, there was the necessity to have Odisha at any cost for maintaining a line of communication between the Presidences of Bengal and Madras. In the mean time, they acquired a thorough knowledge of the topography of Odisha

3.7.2.3. Anglo-Maratha conflict during the governorship of Rajaram Pandit

The governorship of Rajaram Pandit in Odisha witnessed the Anglo-Maratha conflict during the Governor-Generalship of Warren Hastings. The Raja of Nagpur had joined with Poona, Hyderabad and Mysore, forming an anti-British confederacy. The conflict with these four powers demanded the movement of British army to Madras via Odisha to deal with Hyder Ali of Mysore.

The Bhonsle chief of Nagpur thought it prudent not to have a clash with the British power. Accordingly he instructed Rajaram Pandit to extract *Chauth* from the British authorities, if the Governor-General asked for the passage of the British troops through Odisha. Warren Hastings dispatched a detachment under Colonel Pearse upto Balasore in 1781 and sent Anderson to obtain necessary permission from the Maratha Governor of Odisha for the same purpose through the payment of twelve lakhs of rupees. Rajaram Pandit went personally to Calcutta to settle the amount with the Governor-General and demanded twenty-five lakhs of rupees as loan with the immediate payment of twelve lakhs.

After due negotiation, a sum of rupees thirteen lakhs along with a loan of rupees ten lakhs was handed over to him. With the help of some Maratha officers like Harihar Mahadeo and Magun Choudhury, Colonel Pearse marched with his army through Odisha and crossed the border of Ganjam, receiving an assistance of 2,000 horses from the Marathas. This act of Rajaram brought British closer to the Bhonsles of Nagpur. Rajaram Pandit was very firm in his action. After receiving information from Wilkinson, the British resident at Balasore regarding the oppression of the Maratha *faujdar* Bhawani Das Choudhury over a merchant of Barabati named Gangadhar, Rajaram dismissed him. In his place, Murar Pandit was sent as the *faujdar* of Balasore.

Further, he took steps to crush the recalcitrant zamindars. Snodgrass, the British Chief of Ganjam, informed Rajaram Pandit that Balarama Maharatha a refractory land-holder of the British company at Ganjam absconded and entered into the territory of King Divyasimhadeva, who gave asylum to him Rajaram Pandit seized him and his followers in the neigh bourhood of Cuttack. Divyasimhadeva, then, was handed over to Snodgrass.

Of course, Balarama Maharatha tried to escape from the hands of Snodgrass and was killed. However, Rajaram Pandit chastised the king ot Khurda who humbly submitted before him. Not only Rajaram Pandit was shrewd diplomat but he was equally a good administrator. He brought all the refractory forces under his control. He also showed a great deal of interest for the influx of pilgrims to Puri from all parts of India.The prior practice of collecting revenues through hereditary *talukdars* was disbanded and he appointed his own men for the same purpose. He discharged his duty very well as the *Subahdar* of Odisha and breathed his last in 1793.

3.7.2.4. Anglo-Maratha Conflict during Sadashiv Rao

After Rajaram Pandit, his son Sadashiv Rao became the *Naib Subahdar* of Odisha. He was quite friendly to the British like his father. With abolition of the British Residency at Balasore, Barabati slipped away from the clutch of British East India Company. However, Sadashiv Rao showed his cordial gesture to the company and offered Barabati to them which was attached to the British factory. Sadashiv also suppressed the local Rajas who acted against the British. In 1795, a mutinous British battalion refused to lay down their arms and were attacked by another battalion which imprisoned some sepoys of the former battalion. Other sepoys of the mutinous battalion took shelter with the king of Mayurbhanj, who did not deliver them to the British when demanded.

At this stage, the British authorities approached Sadashiv Rao. Sadashiv wrote a letter to the king of Mayurbhanj who obeyed the order and drove out the rebellious sepoys from his territory. Sadashiv Rao also facilitated the march of British troops from Bengal to Madras. His cordial gesture encouraged the British to improve thier postal system in Odisha.

The British correspondence from Calcutta to Puri increased considerably. However, his friendly relation with the English people never marred his spirit to fight for a lust cause. When Divyasimhadeva II, the king or Khurda died, there was contest for the throne of Khurda between Mukundadeva, the son of Divyasimhadeva and Shyamsundar, the second son of Birakishoradeva. Though the Britishers helped Shyamsundar, Sadashiv opposed it tooth and nail. At last, Mukundadeva asserted his legitimate claim over the throne of Khurda. However, the British occupied odisha in 1803 A.D.

3.7.3. Conclusion

Thus, the British people deceived the friendship of the Marathas. Lord Wellesley was imperialist in nature. Taking the absence of Sadashiv Rao from Cuttack in October 1803, the British General Harcourt occupied coastal Odisha. Thus, the Maratha rule came to an end in Odisha.

3.7.4. Summary

- The Anglo-Maratha conflicts constitute an important chapter in the history of Odisha.
- The most important reason for the Anglo-Maratha conflict was the strategic location of Odisha. Odisha lay between the already occupied British territories of Bengal and Madras Presidencies.
- The line of communication ran through Odisha. It is irksome, expensive and sometimes difficult to get a safe passage through Odisha from the Maratha authorities.
- Secondly, Odisha had been considered as a part of Bengal from the day of Muslim conquest in 1568 A.D. The fertile land was a revenue earning proposition.
- Thirdly, the right of obtaining revenue collection by the British after the Battle of Buxar made them covetous of establishing political authority.
- Fourthly, the Matarha incursions into outlying British districts in the Northern as well as the Southern Sarkars of the Mughalbandi region caused harassment.

- Last but not the least was the British objective of extending their dominion over the whole of India.
- The Maratha rule was against the British interest.
- The British tried to persuade the Bengal Nawab to drive the Marathas out of Odisha but failed.
- After getting Diwani in J765, Clive wanted the Maratha territories in Odisha through negotiations instead of force.
- The governorship of Rajaram Pandit in Odisha witnessed the Anglo-Maratha conflict during the Governor-Generalship of Warren Hastings.
- The Raja of Nagpur had joined with Poona, Hyderabad and Mysore, forming an anti-British confederacy.
- The Bhonsle chief of Nagpur thought it prudent not to have a clash with the British power.
- After Rajaram Pandit, his son Sadashiv Rao became the *Naib Subahdar* of Odisha.
- He was quite friendly to the British like his father. With abolition of the British Residency at Balasore, Barabati slipped away from the clutch of British East India Company.
- However, Sadashiv Rao showed his cordial gesture to the company and offered Barabati to them which were attached to the British factory. Sadashiv also suppressed the local Rajas who acted against the British.
- Taking the absence of Sadashiv Rao from Cuttack in October 1803, the British General Harcourt occupied coastal Odisha.
- Thus, the Maratha rule came to an end in Odisha.

3.7.5. Exercise

- **Write a note on Anglo-Maratha conflicts in Odisha.**
- **Highlight the causes of the Anglo-Maratha conflicts in Odisha.**
- **Discuss the Anglo-Maratha conflict during the governorship of Rajaram Pandit in Odisha.**

- **Make an analysis on the Anglo-Maratha Conflict in Odisha during governorship of Sadashiv Rao.**

3.7.6. Further Reading

- B.C. Ray, *Orissa under the Marathas (1751-1803),* Allahabad, 1960.
- A.C. Pradhan, *A Study of History of Odisha*, 2006.
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UNIT-4
Chapter-I

Socio-Economic life in Medieval Odisha

Structure

4.1.0. Objectives
4.1.1. Introduction

4.1.2. Social life in medieval Odisha

4.1.2. 1. The Social Structure: Caste system

4.1.2. 2. The Brahmins

4.1.2. 3. The Kshatriyas

4.1.2. 4. The Vaisyas

4.1.2. 5. The Sudras

4.1.2. 6. The Aboriginals

4.1.2. 7. The Kayasthas or Karanas

4.1.2. 8. Proliferation of castes

4.1.2. 9. Position of women

4.1.2. 10. Dress and ornament

4.1.2. 11. Food and drink

4.1.2. 12. Hobby

4.1.3. Economic Life in Medieval Odisha

4.1. 4. Conclusion

4.1.5. Summary

4.1.6. Exercise

4.1.7. Further Reading

4.1.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Socio-Economic life in Medieval Odisha. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the social life in medieval Odisha*
- *understand the economic life in medieval Odisha*
- *know about the changes in the social structure during medieval Odisha*
- *identify the position of women in medieval society*

4.1.1. Introduction

Change and continuity became the way of social life in medieval Odisha. The glorious rule of the Gajapatis, contributed a lot to preserve the social structure of Odisha. In course of time, besides the four traditional castes, many sub-castes have emerged in the Odishan society. The *agrahara* villages granted to Brahmins by different kings provided path for the progress of education. The villages of Odisha became the centers around which evolved the social life of its people. Their dress, profession, hobby, learning etc. form the main theme of the social life in medieval Odisha.

4.1.2. Social life in medieval Odisha

The social life under went many changes during medieval Odisha. The basic structure of the society has been discussed bellow.

4.1.2. 1. The Social Structure: Caste system

The most remarkable aspect of medieval Odishan society was the caste system. It consisted of numerous castes and sub-castes and the interaction among them brought social harmony bringing peace and tranquility in the medieval Odishan society. The caste structure of the medieval society can be discussed bellow.

4.1.2. 2. The Brahmins

The Suryavamsi Gajapatis accepted the *Varnashrama* system. The Brahmins continued to enjoy ascendancy in social life, administration, religion and learning during their rule. They held

important positions in the government and were liberally patronized by the Gajapatis. Kapilendra wanted to give away the whole world to the Brahmins. The Brahmins enjoyed the highest position in the society of belonging to the first order in the *Varna* system. By their learning, prudence, pious character and other virtuous qualities, they commanded respect from the people in the society. From many inscriptions, particularly of the Bhauma-Karas, Brahmins belonging to several *gotras* like Kashyapa, Atreya, Bharadwaja, Kausika, Visvamitra, Sandilya, Vatsa etc. settled in Odisha.

They settled in the *Shasanas (agrahara* villages) as is known from numerous inscriptions belonging to the Ganga and Suryavamsi Gajapati period. They received land-grants from the kings and other landed aristocrats to worship gods and goddesses in different temples. Those lands were tax free lands. Further, they were also indispensable for many important ceremonies like the *Abhiseka* (coronation ceremony) of the king, marriage, *upanayana* (sacred thread ceremony) etc. By their noble works as priests, they commanded respect of the society and were placed in the highest position in the caste structure. ·

Besides discharging their duties as priests, the Brahmins also got lucrative posts in the court of the king. The Ganga inscriptions show that the Brahmins like Vanapati, Govinda and Vishnu worked under the Ganga kings Raja Rajadeva I, Anangabhimadeva II and Anangabhimadeva III respectively as ministers having high reputation. The inscriptions at Srikurmam and Simhachalam refer to Narahari Tirtha who acted as a regent when Bhanudeva I, was a minor. The Gopinathpur inscription refers to a Brahmin named Gopinath Mohapatra who was a constant adviser fo Kapilendradeva in matters of war and religion. The Ganga inscriptions states that some Brahmins served as military officers using titles like Vahinipati, Chamupati and Senapati. Further, the Brahmins were also appointed in the posts of *Sandhivigrahi (Ka),*

Sasanadhikarin, record- keeper etc. The Brahmins during that period were also engaged in several other professions besides the above mentioned works. The inscriptional and literary sources of the period reveal that they resorted the agriculture, trade, temple building activity and so on.

The Brahmins performing higher works like the priests, *guru*, *Mahasandhivigrahika* etc. were known as the *Shasani* Brahmins. The Brahmins who resorted to lower professions like agriculture, trade etc. was known as *Halua* or *Jharua* Brahmins. Whatever the fact might be, learning and imparting education were the main .functions of the Brahmins in the society. They were well-versed in the *Vedas* and other *Sastras*. They grew under the patronage of kings and maintained their educational institutions. The court of the Suryavamsi kings basked with the learned Brahmins. They contributed a lot of *Smriti*, *Vyakarana*, poetry, drama and other branches of knowledge. Due to their high education-they were respected by the people in the Odishan society.

4.1.2. 3. The Kshatriyas

The Kshatriyas occupied their position in the society next to the Brahmins. They were warrior class and shouldered the responsibility to protect the country from internal rebellion and external aggression. Besides fighting they administered the land. As the inscriptions and literary sources of this land refer, they were benevolent rulers not despots or autocrats. They had great veneration towards the Brahmins from whom they sought advice to carry on administration. They were great builders. By receiving their patronage, a good number of temples were - built up in the nook and corner of Odisha. They were famous for their charity. The digging of tanks, establishment of *Shasanas*, educational institutions etc. were also their look out. They also took interest in the promotion of learning in the society. Besides the kings and members of the royal

family, the army chiefs, soldiers and other officials belonged to the Kshatriya *caste.* The *Khandayats* or Paiks were Kshatriyas who resorted, to cultivation at the time of peace and jumped into the battle when the war drums were heard. The ruling families cemented matrimonial alliances with other kings and feudatory chiefs to secure their position. Whenever there was any external aggression they .joined hands to oust the army.

4.1.2. 4. The Vaisyas

The Vaisyas belonged to the trading class who resorted to cultivation, cowherdship, trade and commerce. Generally, prosperity of the land depended largely upon the people of this community. They organized *hatas* (local markets) and controlled both inland and maritime trade. The Vaisyas of Odisha carried on oversea trade with the countries like Ceylon, Siam, Burma, Suvarnadvipa etc. and brought wealth to this land. They also helped in spreading the Odishan culture in South-East Asia. The Kshatriyas also paid attention for the growth of the Vaisyas. The kings granted special villages for them known as the' *Vaisya agrahara'.* Their sound economic condition led them to donate villages to the Brahmins and the temples. Among them were the *Gopalas* (milkmen) who looked after cattle-rearing and they traded in milk, butter, ghee etc.

4.1.2. 5. The Sudras

In the traditional class structure, the Sudras occupy the lowest position in the society of Odisha. The Sudras were drawn from the community that consisted of artisans, craftsmen, petty agriculturists, servants etc. They also changed their professions and absorbed within the fold of Kshatriyas and Vaisyas. Even, they were attached to the temples to serve the gods and goddesses. They were also not detached from the sphere of education and learning. *Sudra Muni* Sarala Dasa composed the Odia *Mahabharata,* Balarama Dasa, another great poet of *Panchasakha* period composed *Dandi Ramayana.* Besides the above mentioned professions,

some Sudras were untouchables. They were untouchables and remained outside the village. However, they served the society in various capacities. Among them were the washerman *(rajaka),* fisherman , *(kaivartta),* shoe-maker *(charmakara),* basket-maker *(doma)* etc. There were efforts by the -*Panchasakhas* through their writings to absorb these untouchables within the traditional structure of the caste system. Through their literature, these poets brought a protest against caste system, superstition, corrupt practices and so on and tried to free society from the clutch of rigidity. In due course of time, the Sudras gave up their duties and from among them emerged many *Siddhacharyas* and tantric *gurus* who belonged to basket maker, fisherman and leather worker communities. Besides Sudras, other sub-castes in the society were *saundikas* (brewers), *tantuvayas* (weavers), *kumbhakaras* (potters), *ma/akaras* (gardeners), *napita* (barber), *tambarakara* (coppersmith), *tathakara* (metal worker), *kamara* (blacksmith) etc. who rendered their habitual service to the medieval society of Odisha.

4.1.2. 6. The Aboriginals

Among the aboriginals of the time, references very often occur in the literary and inscriptional sources. Sarala Dasa's *Mahabharata* refers to the meeting of God Krishna with a Kandha (Khond) king Bhaskara, who promised to supply the meat of deer, wild-pig etc. for the *Rajasuya yajna* organized by Yudhisthira. With the gradual march of time, efforts were made to bring these aboriginals to the fold of Hindu society. The *Daita Patis*, a group of *Sevakas* of God Jagannath in the majestic temple at Puri can be cited as an example which was the result of such effort.

4.1.2. 7. The Kayasthas or Karanas

The Kayasthas or the Karanas occupied a dominant position in the medieval Odisha. Though, the formation of this sub-caste cannot be traced back to an exact year, still in the 10th-11th century

A.D. references to them were made in the inscriptions. The Kshatriya and Vaisya descent of the Kayastha or Karana is known from inscription. They became hereditary class of writers and became indispensable for maintaining royal records owing to their superior knowledge in accountancy and day to day administration. Not only they were the keeper of the records, but they also occupied high position in revenue department, army and other departments.

4.1.2. 8. Proliferation of castes

Nevertheless, the Brahmanical monopoly in the field of religion and learning was broken during the Suryavamsi rule by the emergence of a reformist religious leadership among the non-Brahmins. The Vaishnavite movement which preached the doctrine of love and equality and the literary awakening in Odia language brought about a transformation in the social life and brought to prominence in religious and literary fields a number of non-Brahmins. Sarala Das, the author of Odia *Mahabharat* was a Sudra. Four Vaishnava saints of Prataparudra's reign - Achyutananda Khuntia, Balaram Mahapatra, Yasovanta Mallik and Ananta Mohanty were non-Brahmins. King Prataparudra extended patronage to Balaram and Achyutananda, for which the Brahmins became jealous. The Vaishnava saints went to the extent of challenging the practice of untouchability. The story of Sriya Chandaluni, depicted in *Lakshmi Purana* of Balaram Das (Mahapatra) shows how goddess Lakshmi came down to accept the worship of Sriya, the Chandal woman Simply because of her devotion.

4.1.2. 9. Position of women

Woman's status in society appeared to have degenerated, as compared to the earlier period. The Suryavamsi monarchs were polygamous. They had a number of queens and concubines. Gajapati Purushottama was born of a concubine. *Purdah* (veil) system was prevailing in the Suryavamsi period. It is written in *Chaitanya Charitamruta,* that when Chaitanya passed through Cuttack on his way to Vrindavana in 1514 A.D, "The king mounted his wives in covered litters on the back of elephants which were drawn up in a line along the route.' Women were expected to be given in

marriage before the age of seven. *Sat;* practice, though not very popular, was prevalent among. the upper class Hindus. *Devadasis* were being employed as before for the purpose of Singing and dancing in the temples. The Gajapati kings and other nobles could keep concubines. A reference can be made in this matter to Gajapati Purusottamadeva who was the son of a concubine of Gajapati Kapilendradeva. Inspite of the high position enjoyed by the women in the society, the practice of *Devadasi* was a veritable stain in this regard. In different Buddhist Viharas and in the Jagannath temple at Puri, this ugly practice was prevalent which undermined the position of women in society. In general, women enjoyed high position in the society. Women were treated as objects of adornment and wore various ornaments.

4.1.2. 10. Dress and ornament

The sculptures and literature of the period give clues to form an idea about the dress and ornaments of the people. The male persons used *dhoti* as lower garment and *Chaddar* as upper garment. Female dress consisted of two garments, upper and lower. They seemed to have worn sarees. The folds of sarees, sometimes, were gathered, carried on to back between the legs and tucked. The garments of the higher class people were ornamented with embroidery showing their status. The *Devadasis* (dancing girls) also used ornamented dress and richly decorated caps. The females took particular care in dressing their hairs. The sculptures of the period show that both male and female used ornaments like *Kundala* (ear-ring), *Keyura* (armlet) and *hara* (neck-lace). Besides, the women used ornaments like *mekhala* (girdle), *Karnafula* (ear-flower), *Kankana* (bracelet), *manjira* (foot ornament). *nupura* (anklet), *Katisutra* or *Katibandha* (waistlet) etc. The female prepared beautiful hair locks and decorated them with flowers.

4.1.2. 11. Food and drink

The inscriptions and literature of the period throw welcome light on the food and drink of the society. The inscriptions narrate how rice, ghee, curd, milk, pulse, curries and *payasa* (rice cooked with milk) etc. were offered as bhoga (offerings) to the deities in the temples. These

descriptions give an idea regarding the vegetarian food pattern in the society. Non-vegetarian meals were also prevalent inside the society. Drinking of wins was not unknown to the people.

4.1.2. 12. Hobby

Nothing definite is known about the hobbies of the people by that time. Sarala Das's *Mahabharata* projects certain hobbies of the time. Among them, hunting and *pa* (chess) formed the pass time resorts of the royal families. The common people might have resorted to certain games, learning, archery and fighting, music, writing etc. as gleaned from the description of literature. Thus conceived, the social structure did not remain the same throughout the period.

4.1.3. Economic Life in Medieval Odisha

Land revenue, paid in kind, was the major source of income for the Gajapatis. Besides this they collected other taxes, such as tax on salt and cowry, tax on squeezing oil out of seed, and tax on marriage. The Brahmins were generally exempted from the payment of taxes and the burden of taxation fell on the peasants and traders. According to the *Madalapanji*, there were a number of famines in Orissa during the Suryavamsi period. Gold, Silver and Cowry coins were used during this period. Contemporary sources indicate that Odisha carried on her overseas trade during the Suryavamsi rule as before.

4.1. 4. Conclusion

Thus, the glorious rule of the Gajapatis, contributed a lot to preserve the social structure of Odisha. In course of time, besides the four traditional castes, many sub-castes have emerged in the Odishan society. The most remarkable aspect of medieval Odishan society was the caste system. The Suryavamsi Gajapatis accepted the *Varnashrama* system. The Brahmins continued to enjoy ascendancy in social life, administration, religion and learning during their rule. Nevertheless, the Brahmanical monopoly in the field of religion and learning was broken during the Suryavamsi rule by the emergence of a reformist religious leadership among the non-Brahmins like the *Panchasakhas* of medieval Odisha. Land revenue, paid in kind, was the major source of income for the Gajapatis. Thus, the social and economic life of the people of Odisha did not remain the same throughout the medieval Odisha.

4.1.5. Summary

- Change and continuity became the way of social life in medieval Odisha.

- The glorious rule of the Gajapatis, contributed a lot to preserve the social structure of Odisha.
- In course of time, besides the four traditional castes, many sub-castes have emerged in the Odishan society.
- The most remarkable aspect of medieval Odishan society was the caste system.
- It consisted of numerous castes and sub-castes and the interaction among them brought social harmony bringing peace and tranquility in the medieval Odishan society.
- The Suryavamsi Gajapatis accepted the *Varnashrama* system.
- The Brahmins continued to enjoy ascendancy in social life, administration, religion and learning during their rule.
- They held important positions in the government and were liberally patronized by the Gajapatis.
- Kapilendra wanted to give away the whole world to the Brahmins.
- The Kshatriyas occupied their position in the society next to the Brahmins.
- The Vaisyas belonged to the trading class who resorted to cultivation, cowherdship, trade and commerce.
- Generally, prosperity of the land depended largely upon the people of this community.
- The Vaisyas belonged to the trading class who resorted to cultivation, cowherdship, trade and commerce.
- Generally, prosperity of the land depended largely upon the people of this community.
- The Kayasthas or the Karanas occupied a dominant position in the medieval Odisha.
- Nevertheless, the Brahmanical monopoly in the field of religion and learning was broken during the Suryavamsi rule by the emergence of a reformist religious leadership among the non-Brahmins.
- The Vaishnavite movement which preached the doctrine of love and equality and the literary awakening in Odia language brought about a transformation in the social life and brought to prominence in religious and literary fields a number of non-Brahmins.
- Woman's status in society appeared to have degenerated, as compared to the earlier period.

- The Suryavamsi monarchs were polygamous. They had a number of queens and concubines.
- Gajapati Purushottama was born of a concubine. *Purdah* (veil) system was prevailing in the Suryavamsi period.
- Inspite of the high position enjoyed by the women in the society, the practice of *Devadasi* was a veritable stain in this regard.
- Land revenue, paid in kind, was the major source of income for the Gajapatis.
- Besides this they collected other taxes, such as tax on salt and cowry, tax on squeezing oil out of seed, and tax on marriage.
- According to the *Madalapanji*, there were a number of famines in Orissa during the Suryavamsi period.
- Gold, Silver and Cowry coins were used during this period.
- Contemporary sources indicate that Odisha carried on her overseas trade during the Suryavamsi rule as before.
- Thus, the social and economic life of the people of Odisha did not remain the same throughout the medieval period.

4.1.6. Exercise

- **Give an account on the socio-economic life of the people of Odisha during the medieval period.**
- **Highlight the social life of the people of medieval Odisha.**
- **Write a note on the economic life of the people of medieval Odisha.**
- **Make an analysis on the changes in social structure in medieval Odisha.**

4.1.7. Further Reading

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UNIT-4
Chapter-II

Cultural life: Religion, Art and Architecture and Literature

Structure

4.1.0. Objectives

4.1.1. Introduction

4.1.2. Cultural life

4.1.2.1. Religion

4.1.2.2. Art and architecture

4.1.2.2. 1. Art and architecture during Kapilendradeva

4.1.2.2. 2 Art and architecture during Purusottamadeva

4.1.2.3. Literature

4.1.2.3. 1. Sanskrit Literature during Kapilendradeva

4.1.2.3. 2. Sanskrit Literature during Purusottamadeva

4.1.2.3. 3. Sanskrit Literature during Prataprudradeva

4.1.2.3. 4. Odia Literature during Kapilendradeva

4.1.2.3. 5. Sarala Das and his literary works

4.1.2.3. 6. Odia Literature during Purusottamadeva and Prataprudradeva

4.1.2.3. 7. Odia literature during the age of *Panchasakhas*

4.1.2.3. 8. Balarama Das's literary works

4.1.2.3. 9. Jagannatha Das's literary creations

4.1.2.3. 10. Yasobanta Das's literary creations

4.1.2.3. 11. Sisu Ananta Das's literary works

4.1.3. Conclusion

4.1.4. Summary

4.1.5. Exercise

4.1.6. Further Reading

4.1.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Cultural life: Religion, Art and Architecture and Literature. *After studying this lesson the students will be able to:*

- *know the cultural life of Odisha during the Gajapati period*
- *understand the religion during this period*
- *know about the art and architecture during Gajapati rulers.*
- *identify the development of literature during this period*

4.1.1. Introduction

The cultural life of the people of Odisha during this period was rich and glorious. In the field of religion *Vaishanavaism* dominated the religious life of the people. The architectural splendour of Odisha which reached the zenith during the glorious days of the Gangas tended to decline during the Gajapati period. However temple building activities continued unabated. On the other hand, there was a tremendous growth of literature particularly Odia literature.

4.1.2. Cultural life

The Gajapati kings had enriched the cultural life of the people by patronizing religion, art and architecture and literature which can be discussed bellow:

4.1.2.1. Religion

Religion played a great role in the cultural life of the people of Odisha. Odisha has witnessed the growth of various religions like Jainism, Buddhism, Saivism, Vaishanavaism, Saktism, etc. However, with the gradual march of time, all these faiths have been assimilated in one cult i.e. the Jagannath cult. *Vaishnavaism* flourished in a more vigorous way during this period along with other religions. During the Gajapati period, Vaishnavism in Odisha had been centred round the worship of Jagannath This cult was gaining popularity because of the efforts of five Odia poets known as the Pancha-Sakhas. They were Jngannath, Balaram, Achyutananda, Yasovanta and Sisu Ananta. Jagannanth Das translated the Bhagavata-Purana before he met Chaitanya. These five Vaishnava poets described Lord Jagannath as personified void (Sunya) which they identified with Krishna. The Krishna cult had already been popular in Odisha through Gita Govlnda of Joyadeva. Even Purusottamadeva, father of king Prataparudradeva composed" Abhinava Gita- Govinda in praise of Krishna. Chitanya therefore, found Odisha very receptive to his teaching of Radha-Krishna creed through *Samkritana*. His extraordinary religious personality very mnch impressed the people who came in contact with him. His devotional *samkirtan* appealed to all. He accepted people of different castes into his group and gave them the massage of love and fraternity. In a short time, he became prominent and popular. Even the Pancha-Sakhas regarded him as their religious leader.

The Suryavamsi rulers were Vaishnavities and professed great devotion to Lord Jagannath as the state deity and called themselves the *Sevaks* or servants of Jagannath. They lavishly endowed the Jagannath temple with gifts of lands, jewels, money and luxurious articles. Besides the religious factor, the first two Suryavamsi rulers- Kapilendra and Purushottama had an ulterior political motive behind the profession of devotion to Jagannath. As both of them had no legitimate claims over the throne, they sought to legitimize their position by invoking the so-called will of Jagannath in their favour with the help of priests. Though primarily Vaishnavites, the Suryavamsi Gajapatis also took interest in the worship of other deities such as Siva and Durga.

4.1.2.2. Art and architecture

The Surya Vamsi rulers of Odisha ruled for hundred and five years only. Yet under this short-lived rule Odisha had reached the pinnacle of its success. They were not only great monarchs but also great lovers and patrons of art, architecture and literature.

4.1.2.2. 1. Art and architecture during Kapilendradeva

The half-ruined temple, near the Papanasini tank in Bhubaneswar, contains an inscription of Kapilendradeva testifying to the fact that it was build during the reign of Kapilendradeva. The elegance, balance and beauty had departed from the Kalingan style of art as the half-ruined Porch of that temple containing decorative female figures represents a curde design in comparison to the finished figures earlier than this. The image of Nataraja carved on the northern wall of the temple present the finest specimen of the Gajapati rule. Another great temple during that time was Kapilesvara temple at Bhubaneswar. The shrine contains an image of Kartikeya who holds a *dambaru* and a trident which is very peculiar during the rule of the Gajapati rulers. Another interesting figure of the temple is the image of Nataraja dancing on the back of the bull.

4.1.2.2. 2 Art and architecture during Purusottamadeva

Purusottamadeva had built the temple of Sundara Madhava at Purusottampur in the Ganjam district. During his reign, it is presumed that one black horse and another white horse with their riders Jagannatha and Balabhadra respectively were placed near the southern gate of the Jagannath temple. Similarly, the figures of these two brothers with their horses with Manika, the milk-maid with her pot were carved in the *Jagamohana* of the Puri Jagannath temple. All these figures definitely have been incorporated in the temple after the expedition of Purusottamadeva to the Chandragiri-rajya. Nothing more distinct or notable aspect in the Odishan architecture took place during the reign of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis.

4.1.2.3. Literature

Shortness of time had never diminished the greatness of glory of the Gajapati period. The Gajapati kings were not only great patrons of learning and literature but they were also accomplished scholars. Their court basked in the sunshine of literary talents whose works were worthy of immortal fame. No such vast literature had been produced in any age preceding or succeeding the Gajapati era till the British conquest of India as is evidenced from the vast treasure of literature of that period. The Odia literature which virtually began with the *Sarala Mahabharata* during the reign of Kapilendradeva progressed tremendously during the time of

subsequent rulers of that dynasty. From that stand point, the literature of the Gajapati period deserves special treatment.

4.1.2.3. 1. Sanskrit Literature during Kapilendradeva

The Sanskrit literature made its progress during the reign of Kapilendradeva. He was an accomplished scholar in Sanskrit. His play *Parasurama Vijaya* describes how Parasurama killed Kartaviryarjuna. During his reign, Nrushimha Vajapayee composed Kasimimamsa and wrote a commentary named *Samkshepa Saririka Vartika* on Sankaracharya's work *Samkshepa Saririka.* Narayana Mishra's commentaries on *Pwvamimamsa* and *Uttaramimamsa* of Sankaracharya and his younger brother Jalesvara's notable work *Jalesvara Paddhati* belonged to this period, However, scholars are not unanimous on the fact that the works of these two celebrated writers belonged to the period of Kapilendradeva.

4.1.2.3. 2. Sanskrit Literature during Purusottamadeva

Purusottamadeva's monumental work *Abhyinava Gitagovinda* that contained 800 *slokas* was a *Kavya* of no mean order. However, some scholars give credit to poet Divakara for the composition of *Abhinava Gitagovinda.* Purusottama also composed *Namamalika Gopalarchanavidhi* and *Bhuvanesvari stotram.* He also composed dramas entitled *Abhinava Veni Samharam, Ananda Vilasa, Janaki Pramoda* and *Kuvalayasvacharitam.* He is also credited with the composition of other workers such as the *Mukti Chintamani, Dasgriva Vadha, Durgotsava, Dipika Chhanda* and *Vishnubhakti Kalpadruma.* He also wrote two Sanskrit lexicons the *Haravaii* the *Trikandasesam.* During his reign period, Ananta Guru composed the *Sahitya Kalpavali,* a work on poetics.

4.1.2.3. 3. Sanskrit Literature during Prataprudradeva

Prataparudradeva, the last Gajapati king of Odisha was a great poet and writer. His *Sarasvativilasam, Kautuka Chintamani, Nirnya Samgraha and Praudha Pratapa Martanda* were flamboyant literary creations of that period. An important scholar Sarvabhauma wrote a commentary on Laxmidhara's *Advaita-makaranda.* Lolla Laxmidhar Pandit was another important luminary of the court of Prataparudra who composed saveral works such as *Vachaspativilasa, Yogadipika, Manva Dharmasastra Dipika, Karnavatamsa* and *Saundaryalahari Vyakhya.* Divakara, a grammarian and poet who wrote *Lakshnadarsa, Ohurtacarita, Parijataharana Nataka* and *Rasamanjari.* Jivadava's *Bhakti Bhagavata* was a milestone in Sanskrit literature during that period. Ramananda Raya wrote *Jagannatha Vallabha*

Natakam Paramananda wrote a *Kavya* entitled *Chaitanya Charitamrita* and a play entitled *Chaitanya Chandrodaya.* Prataparudra's daughter Jagamohini wrote *Tukka Panchakam.* Besides, Rai Champati, Markandeya, Ramakrishna Bhatta, Balabhadra Mishra etc. were other Sanskrit scholars during the glorious days of the Gajapatis. Further, the inscriptions of that period exhibit high literary expression. in Sanskrit language.

4.1.2.3. 4. Odia Literature during Kapilendradeva

The keen interest of the Gajapati kings, patronization of poets and the influence of Vaisnavism prepared the ground for the progress of Vernacular language and literature.

4.1.2.3. 5. Sarala Das and his literary works

The contribution of Sarala Das was no illuminating that the literary works produced during that time were known as the literature of *'Sarala Yuga'.* Sarala Das's *Mahabharata* is the *magnum opus* of his creation. Though Sarala accepts the main theme of Vyasa's *Mahabharata* but at many places, he distorts the original description of the epic by his personal imagination. He excludes many episodes of the original *Mahabharata.* For example, the killing of two demons, Sova and Kirmira by the pandavas at the first part of their living in the forest, the sermons of Gita preached by Lord Krishna to Arjuna (which Sarala finishes in a few lines), Vyasadeva's solace to the Pandavas after the death of Abhimanyu, *Sarasotopakhyana* in the context of breaking of thigh of Duryodhana by Bhima etc. have been excluded by Sarala Das. Sarala not only excludes certain original facts of the *Mahabharata* but inserted new facts too. Among those, the departure of Ganga from Shantanu when the contract is broken and 'Ganga' is addressed as 'Gangi' by Shantanu, marriage of Gandhari to *Sahara* tree, touching of the feet of an ass by God Krishna for the killing of Jarasandha by Bhima, the curse of mountain Satasringa to Bhima for defeat in a war for the first time, the address of Bhima to Duryadhana as 'Golakaputra' and other facts like the meeting of Arjuna and Hanumana, the worship of Krishna's *pinda* at Nilagiri (blue hill), the episode of Belalasena, Belavali, Sobhavati, incarnation of Nrusimha, entrance of the Pandavas in Jajpur, Bali-Vamana, swimming of Ouryodhana in the river of Blood, burning of Durdhaksha by opening the cloth from the eyes of Gandhari etc. are the creation of Sarala Das from his own mind that show his genius and creativity. Sarala's *Mahabharata* is not only an epic but also a mirror of political, social, historical and cultural traditions of Odisha. Prof K. C. Panigrahi has given a vivid description about it in his monumental work *Sarala Sahityara Aitihasika Chiltra* written in Odia. The war or Kapilendradeva with Bahamani kingdom has been reflected in it in a

very indirect way. In the Digvijaya episode of the *Sabha Parva* of *Mahabharata,* Bhima is said to have defeated the king of Kundinagara which is no other name of Kondavidu. Similarly, the war of Kapilendra with Bahaman! kingdom and Bengal have been narrated by him in a round about way. The Kurma *Parvata* and Krushnabhadra (river Krishna) are described in his *Mahabharata* as *Karana Parvata* and Gunabhadra respectively. Examples can be multiplied in this context. Many geographical places like Garjan (Ghazni), Bhutana (Tibet), Matshyadesa (Rajasthan), Malaya (Malua), (Malwa), Kamakshi (Assam), Belabalipura (Dacca and Maimansing region), Gunjara (Kalinjar), Saurastra (Kathiawar), Kasi (Varanasi), Kanyakubja (Kanauj) etc. have been described in his *Mahabharata.* These descriptions leave no room for doubt that Sarala Das definitely served as a military man in the army of Kapilendradeva. Not only Sarala Das depicts contemporary geograpical scene and historical facts but he has also described the life, customs and traditions of the contemporary society in his *Mahabharata* like marriage, post-marriage rites, the position of women in family and society, monogamy, polygamy, tradition relating to widow, education etc. and several festivals like *Ganesh Puja, Kartika Vrata, Siva Ratri, Kumara Pumima, Akshaya Trutiya* etc. Besides, the epic also contains description of gods, goddesses and places of pilgrimage in Odisha. He describes about *Yamanika Tirtha* (Puri-Srikshetra), *Arka Kshetra* (Konarka), *Krutivasa Kshetra* (Bhubaneswar), Sabari-narayani and Gomukha Hari of Jajpur and even village goddesses of Odisha like Dakesvari, Hingula and many others. Sarala Das also composed *Chandi Purana* and *Vilanka Ramayana.*

4.1.2.3. 6. Odia Literature during Purusottamadeva and Prataprudradeva

Chaininka Chakada Pustaka was another Odia work composed during Purusottamadeva's reign by Fakira Chaini. Another famous poet of the Sarala age was Arjuna Das who was famous for his works *Kalpalata* and *Rama Vibaha.* Sisu Sankara Das's *Ushabhilasa,* Markanda Das's *Kesaba Koili,* Damodara's *Rasakoili Chautisa* etc, were other creations of that time.

4.1.2.3. 7. Odia literature during the age of *Panchasakhas*

The age that immediately followed Sarala Das, is famous as the *Panchasakha Yuga* (Age of the Panchasakhas). The age has been so called after the name of five celebrities like Balarama Das, Jagannatha Das, Ananta Das, Achyutananda Das andYasobanta Das who flourished during the reign period of Prataparudradeva.

4.1.2.3. 8. Balarama Das's literary works

Among the creations of Balarama Das, the *Dandi Ramayana* or *Jagamohana Ramayana, Bata Abakasa, Bhava Samudta, Laxmi Purana, Baula Adhyaya, veaemesere Gupta Gita, Amarakosa Gita, Brahmanda Bhugola, Bedha Parikrama, Panasa Chon, Gupta Tika* etc. were very important.

4.1.2.3. 9. Jagannatha Das's literary creations

Jagannatha Das's immortal creations included Odia *Bhagavata, Tulabhina, Brahma Gite, Gupta Bhagavata, Rasakrida, Mruguni Stuti, Gaja Stuti, Bhavisya Malika, Gundicha Vije, Dutibodha, Rukmini Malika, Pramoda Chintamani etc.* Achyutananda composed *Harivamsa, Sunya Samhita, Gopala Ugala, Anakara Samhita, Bipra Chalaka, Chaurasi Yantra, Bhavanabara, Tattvabodhini, Gurubhakti Gite, Amara-Jumara Samhita, Nitya Rahasa, Varuna Charita etc.*

4.1.2.3. 10. Yasobanta Das's literary creations

The writings of Yasobanta Das included *Siva Svarodaya, Premabhaktibrahma Gita. Tika Govindachandra, Chaurasi Ajna, Atma Parache Gite, Mantraboli, Yantraboli, Bagha Leela, Dhana Chori* etc.

4.1.2.3. 11. Sisu Ananta Das's literary works

The last among the *Pancha Sakhas* was Ananta Das famous for his works like *Hetu Udaya Bhagavata, Garuda Kesaba Chautisa, Ude Bhaskara, Bhavisya Purana, Vaisnava Purana* etc. Among other poets of the *Pancha Sakha* age, Chaitanya Das's *Vishnugarbha Purana* and *Nirguna Mahatmya;* Kanhai Khuntia's *Mahabhava Prakasa* and *Chaitanya Vilasa;* Partha Srichandana's Kalavati; Banamali Das's *Chata Icchavati;* Purusottama Das's *Ganga Mahatmya* and *Kanchi- Kaveri* etc. were some of the immortal creations of Odia literature.

The writings of the *Pancha Sakhas* were revolutionary in nature. Through their writings, the *Pancha Sakhas* wanted to abolish caste distinction from the society and bridge the gap between the higher class and lower class. The flow in Odia literature that started from the age of Sarala Das was kept in tact with progressive trends during the *Panchasakha* age. The rule of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis was a landmark in the history of medieval Odisha. No doubt, the rule of the Gajapati kings was marked for the creation of a vast empire but it also constituted a golden epoch in the field of Odia literature. As already stated, feudalism which became an ugly feature of the Gajapati rule, reached its nadir point of degeneration. The discomfiture of Pratapaparudradeva in several wars due to the weakness of Odishan army and treachery prevailing inside it broke his morale and paved the way for the downfall of medieval Odisha.

4.1.3. Conclusion

The cultural life of the people of Odisha was a glorious during the Somavamsi Gajapati rulers. Although, the architectural splendour of Odisha tended to decline during the Gajapati period but the temple building activities continued unabated. On the other hand, there was a remarkable development of literature particularly Odia literature. The renaissance in Odia literature is traced from this period. The rulers of Gajapati Dynasty encouraged local language and introduced Odia in their stone inscriptions and copper plates. A number of poets, dramatists and erudite scholars flourished under their noble patronage whose contribution to Sanskrit and Odia Literature is great. Thus, the rule of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis was a landmark in the history of medieval Odisha.

4.1.4. Summary

- The cultural life of the people of Odisha during this period was rich and glorious. In the field of religion *Vaishanavaism* dominated the religious life of the people.
- The Gajapati kings had enriched the cultural life of the people by patronizing religion, art and architecture and literature.
- Religion played a great role in the cultural life of the people of Odisha.
- *Vaishnavaism* flourished in a more vigorous way during this period along with other religions.
- At that time, Vaishnavism in Odisha had been centred round the worship of Jagannath
- This cult was gaining popularity because of the efforts of five Odia poets known as the Pancha-Sakhas.
- The Surya Vamsi rulers of Odisha ruled for hundred and five years only.
- Yet under this short-lived rule Odisha had reached the pinnacle of its success.
- They were not only great monarchs but also great lovers and patrons of art, architecture and literature.
- The half-ruined temple, near the Papanasini tank in Bhubaneswar, contains an inscription of Kapilendradeva testifying to the fact that it was build during the reign of Kapilendradeva.
- Purusottamadeva had built the temple of Sundara Madhava at Purusottampur in the Ganjam district.

- During his reign, it is presumed that one black horse and another white horse with their riders Jagannatha and Balabhadra respectively were placed near the southern gate of the Jagannath temple.
- The Odia literature which virtually began with the *Sarala Mahabharata* during the reign of Kapilendradeva progressed tremendously during the time of subsequent rulers of that dynasty.
- The Sanskrit literature made its progress during the reign of Kapilendradeva. He was an accomplished scholar in Sanskrit.
- Purusottamadeva's monumental work *Abhyinava Gitagovinda* that contained 800 *slokas* was a *Kavya* of no mean order.
- Prataparudradeva, the last Gajapati king of Odisha was a great poet and writer. His *Sarasvativilasam, Kautuka Chintamani, Nirnya Samgraha and Praudha Pratapa Martanda* were flamboyant literary creations of that period.
- The age that immediately followed Sarala Das, is famous as the *Panchasakha Yuga* (Age of the Panchasakhas).
- The age has been so called after the name of five celebrities like Balarama Das, Jagannatha Das, Ananta Das, Achyutananda Das andYasobanta Das who flourished during the reign period of Prataparudradeva.
- The writings of the *Pancha Sakhas* were revolutionary in nature.
- Through their writings, the *Pancha Sakhas* wanted to abolish caste distinction from the society and bridge the gap between the higher class and lower class.
- The flow in Odia literature that started from the age of Sarala Das was kept in tact with progressive trends during the *Panchasakha* age.
- Thus, the rule of the Suryavamsi Gajapatis was a landmark in the history of medieval Odisha.

4.1.5. Exercise

- **Give an account on the Cultural life of the people of Odisha during the Suryavamsi Gajapatis.**
- **Write a note on the development of art and architecture during the Gajapati rulers of Odisha.**
- **Discuss the development of Sanskrit literature during the Gajapati rulers.**
- **"Gajapati rulers were great patron of art and literature". Justify.**

- **Highlight the development of Odia literature during the Gajapati rulers of Odisha.**

4.1.6. Further Reading

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UNIT-4
Chapter-III

Impact of Islam on Odia language and literature

Structure

4.3.0.Objectives

4.3.1. Introduction

4.3.2. Influence of Islam on socio-cultural life of Odisha

4.3.3. Influence of Islam on Odia language and literature

4.3.4. Tamasa and Jatra

4.3.5.Conclusion

4.3.6.Summary

4.3.7. Exercise

4.3.8. Further Reading

4.3.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the impact of Islam on Odia language and literature. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the different causes responsible for the decline of medieval Odishan kingdom*
- *understand the factors that led to the disintegration of medieval Odishan kingdom*
- *know about the political causes for the decline*
- *identify the socio-economic causes for the decline*
- *recognise the other causes for the decline of medieval Odishan kingdom*

4.3.1. Introduction

Muslim rule was confined to coastal districts. Odisha was far away from the Muslim Centers of North India. So although Muslims came to Odisha after establishment of their rule, their number was marginal. "Odisha was defeated but not conquered in the sense of Bengal or other parts of North India." Yet it had its effects on the socio-cultural life of Odisha. There were attempts at establishing cordial Hindu-Muslim relation especially in the times from Akbar to Shahjahan.

4.3.2. Influence of Islam on socio-cultural life of Odisha

One Bhatta Mahapatra was a musician in Akbar's court. Another Viswanatha Samantaraya pleased Mansingh, came to Mughal court and received rewards for his poetic talent. Odia language and literature was influenced by Perso-Arabic vocabulary. More than 2,000 words of Islamic languages entered into Odia literature. The Muslims turned their mind toward Odia and poets like Salabaig composed excellent devotional songs for Lord Jagannatha. The harmony and interaction between the Hindu and the Muslim communities resulted in some syncretic religious rituals like Satyapiri cult in 18th century. The Kadam Rasul of Cuttack, tombs of Baba Bukhari in Puri and Bhogakhia Pir of Balasore etc. got equal veneration from both the communities. The popular music show of Bhadrak called Mughal Tamasa were participated and enjoyed by people of both the communities. Not only that in dress, customs and manners they adopted each other's style. Whereas the Hindus wore lungi, kurta, pijjama, took birani, halwa and Muslim delicacies and said Id-mubaraka to Muslims; the Muslim used dhoti, gamuchha, wrapper-cloth, took Hindu foods and visited Hindu neighbours during festivals. An atmosphere of love and affection came to prevail down the times.

4.3.3. Influence of Islam on Odia language and literature

A number of Islamic literatures took shape in Orissa. The original works of Arabic, Parsi, Turkish and even Urdu were translated into Oriya Language. Khwaja Mainuddin- Chisti (Sufi Saint) of Ajmer primarily encouraged the spread of Parsi language in India. During Muslim rule in Orissa Parsi language was spoken and official records maintained in Parsi. Poems of poet Abhimanyu Samant Singhar, Baldev Rath, Upendra Bhanja mark the influence of Parsi, Arabic and Urdu languages. Islam had direct impact on Fakir Mohan. He was named Fakir because his Grand mother symbolically sold him to a Muslim Fakir or Dervishes. In his childhood Fakir Mohan used to collect alms as a Fakir boy and from the begged he used to prepare Sirni and distributed to the poor in the name of Satyapir. 18th Century marks the growth of Satyapir sect. It was manifestation of Hindu-Muslim unity. This century also witnessed the rise of Pala. Kabi Karna was the founder of Pala literature. It had a series of 16 books one of which depicted the miracle of Satyapir. Pala is divided into two types viz. I. Baithaki Pala and II. Thia Pala.

4.3.4. Tamasa and Jatra

In the second quarter of the 18th Century poet Bansiballav Goswami wrote the Tamasa. He synthesized Islamic tenet with Oriya literature. The tradition of Jatra was very much prevalent in Orissa. Historians believed that, Jatra is the sound impact of Islamic literature over Orissa. Poet Salabeg and Uzir Bag wrote hundreds of Bhajana on Jagannath and Radhakrishna Cult in Oriya literature. Parsian poet Saikh Sahdis (1194-1282) Pand Nama was translated into Oriya by Abdul Majid Saheb of Balasore in Prabodha Bakya or Hitapodesh Mala edited and published in 1869. Madhusudan Roy has written a series of books on Muslim Prophet and Saints. Qawali and Ghazal are examples of the impact of Islam in Oriya literature and language. Countless words of Parsian, Arabic, Urdu and Turkish entered into Oriya Vocabulary and were assimilated in the spoken language of the common mass. Oriya poets used the work in their Kavya or poems. Orissan society reflected a sense of hospitality to the strangers which deserves merits. Culturally, Islam had its unique and remarkable contribution. It brought some new idea and some new problems, but left a legacy, that is successfully utilized by the succeeding generation for ever.

4.3.5. Conclusion

Thus, the Muslim rule it had its impact on the socio-cultural life of Odisha. Odia language and literature was influenced by Perso-Arabic vocabulary. More than 2,000 words of Islamic languages entered into Odia literature. The Muslims turned their mind toward Odia and poets

like Salabaig composed excellent devotional songs for Lord Jagannatha. The harmony and interaction between the Hindu and the Muslim communities resulted in some syncretic religious rituals like Satyapiri cult in 18th century. A number of Islamic literatures took shape in Orissa. The original works of Arabic, Parsi, Turkish and even Urdu were translated into Oriya Language. In this way, the there was great influence of Islamism on the Odia language and literature.

4.3.6.Summary

- Muslim rule was confined to coastal districts.
- Islamism had its effects on the socio-cultural life of Odisha.
- One Bhatta Mahapatra was a musician in Akbar's court.
- Odia language and literature was influenced by Perso-Arabic vocabulary.
- More than 2,000 words of Islamic languages entered into Odia literature.
- The Muslims turned their mind toward Odia and poets like Salabaig composed excellent devotional songs for Lord Jagannatha.
- The harmony and interaction between the Hindu and the Muslim communities resulted in some syncretic religious rituals like Satyapiri cult in 18th century.
- The Kadam Rasul of Cuttack, tombs of Baba Bukhari in Puri and Bhogakhia Pir of Balasore etc. got equal veneration from both the communities.
- The popular music show of Bhadrak called Mughal Tamasa were participated and enjoyed by people of both the communities.
- A number of Islamic literatures took shape in Orissa.
- The original works of Arabic, Parsi, Turkish and even Urdu were translated into Oriya Language.
- Khwaja Mainuddin- Chisti (Sufi Saint) of Ajmer primarily encouraged the spread of Parsi language in India.
- During Muslim rule in Orissa Parsi language was spoken and official records maintained in Parsi.
- Poems of poet Abhimanyu Samant Singhar, Baldev Rath, Upendra Bhanja mark the influence of Parsi, Arabic and Urdu languages.

- Islam had direct impact on Fakir Mohan. He was named Fakir because his Grand mother symbolically sold him to a Muslim Fakir or Dervishes.
- Poet Salabeg and Uzir Bag wrote hundreds of Bhajana on Jagannath and Radhakrishna Cult in Oriya literature.
- Parsian poet Saikh Sahdis (1194-1282) Pand Nama was translated into Oriya by Abdul Majid Saheb of Balasore in Prabodha Bakya or Hitapodesh Mala edited and published in 1869.
- Countless words of Parsian, Arabic, Urdu and Turkish entered into Oriya Vocabulary and were assimilated in the spoken language of the common mass. Oriya poets used the work in their Kavya or poems.
- A number of Islamic literatures took shape in Orissa.
- The original works of Arabic, Parsi, Turkish and even Urdu were translated into Oriya Language.
- In this way, the there was great influence of Islamism on the Odia language and literature.

4.3.7. Exercise

- **Give an account on the influence of Islam on Odia language and literature.**
- **Discuss the influence of Islam on society and culture of Odisha.**
- **Highlight the impact of Islam on the people of Odisha.**
- **Write a note on Mughal Tamasha on the language and literature of Odisha**

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HISTORY OF ODISHA
(FROM 1803 TO 1948 A.D.)

By

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HISTORY OF ODISHA (From 1803 TO 1948 A.D.)

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UNIT-1
Chapter-I

British Occupation of Odisha

Structure

1.1.0. Objectives

1.1.1. Introduction

1.1.2. British occupation of Odisha

1.1.2.1. Weakness of the Maratha rulers

1.1.2.2. Oppression of the land lords

1.1.2.3. Establishment of British factories

1.1.2.4. Military importance of Odisha

1.1.2.5. Capture of Ganjam

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1.1.2.9. Occupation of Puri

1.1.2.10. Diplomacy of Lord Wellesley on Jagannath

1.1.2.11. Bribe to the Marathas

1.1.2.12. Strategy of Campbell

1.1.2.13. Operation of Harcourt

1.1.2.14. Conquest of Cuttack

1.1.2.15. Capture of Balasore

1.1.2.1.6 Occupation of Sambalpur

1.1.3. Conclusion

1.1.4. Summary

1.1.5. Exercise

1.1.6. Further Reading

1.1.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the British Occupation of Odisha. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the causes of the British occupation of Odisha*
- *understand the British occupation of Puri*
- *know about capture of Cuttack by the British*
- *evaluate the occupation of Sambalpur and Balasore*

1.1.1. Introduction

The foundation of British Empire in India with the victory over battle of Plassey and its subsequent confirmation in the battle of Buxar, encouraged them to occupy other parts of India. Orissa (now Odisha) as a part of India and a neighbor of Bengal had attracted the British to occupy it. The mal-administration of the Maratha rulers, their atrocities and exploitation had made the Maratha rule quite unacceptable to the Oriyas (now Odias). Right from the days of the grant of Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha to the East India Company, the British wanted to establish their supremacy on the soil of Odisha. However, the fragile and weak Maratha administration gave the British a good opportunity to fulfill their dream of establishing their authority over Odisha. In this regard, steps were taken to occupy Odisha and finally in 1803 it was occupied by the British.

1.1.2. British occupation of Odisha

The following causes were responsible for the British occupation of Odisha

1.1.2.1. Weakness of the Maratha rulers

The internal conflict among the Bhonsles of Nagpur after the death of Januji created weakness among the Marathas which had an impact on the Maratha rulers of Odisha. As the decline had started among the Marathas, their powers gradually declined away and for which they could not get sufficient help from Nagpur. Even for suppressing the unruly land lords, they had to look for the British help.

1.1.2.2. Oppression of the land lords

Taking the mileage of the weak administration of the Marathas in Odisha, the regional land lords became irresponsible and oppressive. They involved themselves in various lawless activities and their oppression over the subjects knew no bound. The political condition of Odisha was full of chaos and confusion. The zamindars exploited the poor common man of Odisha according to their whims and fancies. Their miserable plights aggravated and they drank

tea cup of misery. So, the people were in need of ousting those oppressive Marathas as well as the zamindars.

1.1.2.3. Establishment of British factories

The British in order to establish a strong economic and military base in Odisha, established factories in different parts of Odisha. With the grant of *Dewan*, of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha to the East India Company in 1765, the British realised the importance of Odisha from the economic point of view. When the British built up their factories at Hariharpur, Pipli and Balasore, they felt the necessity of this province from the commercial point of view. The Britishers also obtained permission from the Marathas to have their monopoly over the manufacturing of salt in Odisha. The trade-routes, which passed from Cuttack to Bengal, Madras and Nagpur, facilitated their business to a greater extent.

1.1.2.4. Military importance of Odisha

The British authorities felt the importance of Odisha from the military point of view. As stated earlier, Warren Hastings had to give *Chauth* and loan in advance to the Maratha governors for the passage of British army from Calcutta to Madras through Odisha. With the coming of Lord Wellesley as the Governor-General of India in 1768, the cold touch of the British imperialism was greatly felt by the Indian powers. He took no time to annex Odisha and included it in the British Empire.

1.1.2.5. Capture of Ganjam

With the grant of Dewani in 1765, Lord Clive obtained from Emperor Shah Alam the Northern Circars consisting of Chicacole, Rajahmudry, Ellore and Guntur as free gift in which the present undivided Ganjam district was included. The British East India Company also got Midnapur which was a part of Odisha. Thus, the British authorities acquired Oriya speaking tracts, both in South and in the North. This facilitated them to conquer Odisha with ease.

1.1.2.6. The contract of 1765

The *firman* issued to the British East India Company on 12 August, 1765, was put into practice on 12 November, 1766 when another treaty was concluded between Nizam Ali, the ruler of Hyderabad and Colonel Forde. Accordingly, letters were issued to all zamindars of Northern Circars suggesting them to regard the British East India Company as their sovereign in future. Henceforth, they should pay their rents and show respect to the British authorities.

1.1.2.7. Inquiry of Cotsford

In this way, the Northern Circars consisting of the Chicacole circar of which the undivided Ganjam district then formed a part, *came* under the British occupation. The English administrative officers moved from Madras immediately to secure Ganjam and Icchapur. Cotsford, an English engineer, was appointed as the Resident of Ganjam by an order in the council passed on 2 December, 1766. Cotsford viewed the political situation of the area and found that territories lying north of Visakhapatnam, were in a state of turmoil on account of the grand design of Narayanadeva of Paralakhemindi. He intimated this fact to Madras.

1.1.2.8. Contract with Narayanadeva

The Madras Government now wanted to deal with Narayanadeva scorn and contempt. Colonel Peach was sent from Masulipatam to deal with that refractory chief. At this arrival, Narayanadeva became panic-stricken and fled away from Paralakhemundi, after being defeated at the hands of the British troops at Jalmur in May 1768. He then went to Maliahs and was forced to take shelter there. The administration of Paralakhemundi was entrusted upon his Dewan. Cotsford safely arrived and took over his charge as the Resident in July 1768. In this way, Ganjam was annexed to Madras province and came under the sway of the British administration.

1.1.2.9. Occupation of Puri

The British then occupied Puri. For that they adopted the following steps.

1.1.2.10. Diplomacy of Lord Wellesley on Jagannath

Lord Wellesley wanted to capture Puri and Cuttack by sheer display of his diplomacy. Letters were dispatched to the feudatories of Odisha, conveying them that it was the desire of Lord Jagannath to oust the Marathas from the land by the Britishers who would rule there. The desire of the Governor-General was conveyed to the people that it was the time to free the land from the oppression and tyranny of the Marathas. The priests of the Puri Jagannath temple were also assured that they would be respected by the Britishers and the British authorities would follow the policy of non-intervention so far as the temple administration was concerned.

1.1.2.11. Bribe to the Marathas

When the people of Odisha were psychologically won over, it was not a great task for the British authorities to occupy the land. In the next turn, Wellesley resorted to a filthy practice like bribing the Maratha officers handsomely. Letters of commitment regarding the payment of high amount

as bribe were sent to Bhanuji Pandit, the *Naib* of Cuttack, Haribansa Ray, the *Dewan*, Balaji Kuanr, the Commander-in-Chief and Moro Pandit, the *Faujdar* for their help to the British force. Being confident of their support, Wellesley entrusted the task of conquering Puri and Cuttack to Lt. Colonel Campbell of 74 Regiment of the Northern division of the army under the Madras Government.

1.1.2.12. Strategy of Campbell

As per the strategy, Campbell had to proceed to Puri from Ganjam. After the occupation of Puri, the fort of Barabati, a stronghold of the Marathas in Odisha was to be brought under the British control. Suddenly, after the conquest of the Barabati fort, a detachment was to be sent to Baramul Pass (near Baud) to remain alert for checking the advancement of the Maratha troops from Nagpur. The serious illness of Campbell, before the strategic operation, led Colonel Harcourt of the 12th Regiment to command the army again.st ~uri and Cuttack. .

1.1.2.13. Operation of Harcourt

After assuming the responsibility on 11 September, 1803, Harcourt started his operation. He was accompanied by a civil officer named John Melville for organising cIvil administration, immediately after the occupation of the province. When the British troops left Ganjam, it was very difficult on their part to cross a narrow and hazardous path near the mouth of Chilka lake for reaching the Maratha territory in Odisha. It was only because Fateh Muhammad, the Maratha *Faujdar* was keeping his vigilant eyes over this strategic position. However, he was won over to the side of the British by heavy bribe. Now, the British troop crossed the narrow passage by the help of Fateh Muhammad and occupied Manikpatna. From Manikpatna, Harcourt sent message to the priests of Puri for full protection of the temple of Lord Jagannath and not to infringe the facilities of the priests. The king of Khurda was also pursuaded for renderihg his help to Harcourt on payment of rupees one lakh. The Raja of Khurda and the priests of the temple of God Jagannath were wanting to get rid of the Maratha rule. Unhesitatingly, they welcomed the British troops. Without any resistance, Puri was captured on 18 September, 1803. This encouraged Harcourt to a great extent

1.1.2.14. Conquest of Cuttack

The occupation of Puri encouraged the British to process further. They made elaborate plan to occupy Cuttack. Making necessary arrangement to check the possible advancement of the Maratha army from Nagpur, Harcourt planned about his march to Cuttack. He posted Lieutenant

Ogilvie and Major Fletcher at Manikpatna and Puri respectively to deal with the Maratha troops. On 24 Septemper, 1803 began the march of Harcourt towards Cuttack. Of course, the Marathas resisted the advancement of the British soldiers and it became toe in Ahmadpur and Mukundapur. However, the mobilisation of Harcourt's artillery force defeated the Marathas and by 10 October, 1803, the entire Cuttack town except fort Barabati was under the British ctutch.

The fort of Barabati seemed invincible. Harcourt tried to bribe Shiv Prasad, the Maratha officer in charge of the Barabati fort but that mission failed stupendously. At the night of 13 October, 1803, the British troops set up a battery with one 12-pounder, two 6- pounder and 2 howitzers at a distance of 500 yards from the outer gate of the fort. The operation for the capitulation of fort Barabati began on 14 October, 1803, early in morning with heavy bombardment from all the canons at the outer gate of the fort which cracked. A group of soldiers and artillery-men led by Lt.Colonel Clyton rushed into the fort amidst heavy fire from the side of the Marathas and occupied it.

The Marathas fled away from the fort out of fear and many of them were drawned in the ditch while trying to escape from the clutches of the British army. During the operation, only two European and three Indian soldiers were killed, sixteen European and thirteen Indian soldiers were injured. With the capitulation of the Barabati fort, ended the Maratha rule in Odisha. Major Forbes chases the Marathas was retreated to Nagpur through Baramula Pass, captured it by 2 November, 1803 and that closed the entry of the Marathas to Odisha for all time to come. After possession of the Barabati fort, Lord Wellesley appointed a commission consisting of Harcourt, Melville and Earnst (the magistrate of Midnapur) to deal with the local chiefs who were the feudatories of the Marathe chiefs of Nagpur. After due negotiation, the Rajas and zamindars of Khurda. Kujang, Kanika, Aul, Mayurbhanj, Angul, Hindol, Darpan, Sukinda, Madhupur etc. acknowledqed the British suzerainty and promised to pay the annual tribute to the British authority. In this amicable manner, the British power made the solution with the local chiefs at the beginning of its administration in Odisha.

1.1.2.15. Capture of Balasore

In the meanwhile, the strategy of Captain Morgan at Balasore met with success in driving away the Marathas. A detachment under his command in seven vessels, namely, Alexander, Anne, George, Fairdie, Lizard, Scourage and a gun boat reached Balaramgarhi after crossing river Budhabalanga. Balaramgarhi was a small Maratha port. Without any resistance, the Marathas

allowed the British army to advance towards Balasore town. Although the British vessel sailed up the river with the help of local pilots, but their progress became very slow due to heavy rain. The rumour of the coming of Maratha troops to oppose the British army, prompted Morgan to proceed with two light canons and three hundred soldiers in small boats. The party, while marching inside the town, got feeble resistance from the Marathas. However, Morgan reached the British factory at night. He tried to bribe Moro Pandit, the Maratha *Faujdar* of Balasore but the Marathas got its small and imprisoned him. Captain Morgan's mobilisation of the British troops, created panic in the hearts of the Marathas who fled away from the town at night on 21 September,1803. In the next morning i.e. 22 September,1803. Captain Morgan occupied Balasore with ease. He stationed the British troops outside the town to face possible Maratha attack. After a week, whe the British posltion in Balasore became stable; Morgan sent reinforcement to Soro under the leadership of Slye to drive out the Marathas. Futher, troops were sent to strengthen his hand. The Marathas were defeated at Soro and fled towards Bhadrak. Now, the path was clear from Balasore to Cuttack. In the meanwhile, Colonel Ferguson marched from Jajeswar and reached Balasore 4 October, 1803. After that, he went Cuttack to join with Harcourt. Then began the operation on the north-east of the river Suvarnarekha. Captain Lamb, by the order of Colonel Fenwick, occupied Pataspur, Kamarda, Bhograi, Shahbandar, Jamukunda etc. and brought the zamindars under British control by applying both conciliatory and coercive policy. However, on 17 December, 1803, by the treaty of Deogaon, Raghuji Bhonsle ceded Cuttack and Balasore to the East India Company.

1.1.2.1.6 Occupation of Sambalpur

The occupation of Baramula Pass on 2 November, 1803 by Major Forbes prompted Harcourt to write conciliatory letters to the Rajas of Baud. Sonepur and Sambalpur tom acknowledge the authority of the British which they cordially reciprocated by paying annual tributes. However, Sambalpur remained an exception to it. In January, 1804, Major Broughton,conquered Sambalpur defeating Maratha Governor Tantia Pharnavis. He concluded friendly treaty with queen Ratnakumari of Sambalpur and the local chiefs of Raigarh, Gangapur, Bamara, Bonai etc. Broughton was, of course, ignorant about the treaty of Deogaon. Further, the treaty of Deogaon did not mention anything about Sambalpur. The local chiefs also never wanted to stay under the Maratha suzerainty of Nagpur. When pursuaslon failed in connection with the handing over of Sambalpur to the British authority, Wellesley threatened Ragtiuji Bhonsle for war. This acted as

tonic and the Maratha authority of Nagpur handed over Sarnbalpur to the British. With the departure of Lord Wellesley, Governor, General Barlow, a pacifist, restored . Sambalpur to the Marathas. Again, the Maratha rule was reimposed on Sambalpur from 1806 and continued till 1817. Again, the British authority drove away the Marathas from Sambalpur in 1817. From 1818 to 1849, the Chauhans ruled over Sambalpur. It was again annexed to the British authority in 1849 with the application of the Doctrine of Lapse of Lord Dalhousie.

1.1.3. Conclusion

Thus, the British occupation of Odisha opened a new era in the history of modern Odisha. It put an end to the long administration of the Marathas under whose administration the people of Odisha were suffering. With the British occupation of Odisha, the English became the sole authority to rule Odisha. It also brought many changes in the existing administrative set up when the British introduced their own system of administraion

1.1.4. Summary

- The mal-administration of the Maratha rulers, their atrocities and exploitation had made the Maratha rule quite unacceptable to the people of Odisha.
- Right from the days of the grant of Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha to the East India Company, the British wanted to establish their supremacy on the soil of Odisha.
- However, the fragile and weak Maratha administration gave the British a good opportunity to fulfill their dream of establishing their authority over Odisha.
- With the grant of Dewani in 1765, Lord Clive obtained from Emperor Shah Alam the Northern Circars consisting of Chicacole, Rajahmudry, Ellore and Guntur as free gift in which the present undivided Ganjam district was included.
- The British East India Company also got Midnapur which was a part of Odisha.
- Lord Wellesley wanted to capture Puri and Cuttack by sheer display of his diplomacy.
- Letters were dispatched to the feudatories of Odisha, conveying them that it was the desire of Lord Jagannath to oust the Marathas from the land by the Britishers who would rule there.
- The occupation of Puri emboidened the British to process further.

- They made elaborate plan to occupy Cuttack. Making necessary arrangement to check the possible advancement of the Maratha army from Nagpur, Harcourt planned about his march to Cuttack.
- In the meanwhile, the strategy of Captain Morgan at Balasore met with success in driving away the Marathas.
- On 22nd September,1803 Captain Morgan occupied Balasore.
- In January, 1804, Major Broughton,conquered Sambalpur defeating Maratha Governor Tantia Pharnavis.
- He concluded friendly treaty with queen Ratnakumari of Sambalpur and the local chiefs of Raigarh, Gangapur, Bamara, Bonai etc.
- Thus, the British occupation of Odisha opened a new era in the history of modern Odisha. It put an end to the long administration of the Marathas under whose administration the people of Odisha were suffering.

1.1.5. Exercise

- **Give an account on the British occupation of Odisha.**
- **Discuss the causes responsible for the occupation of Odisha.**
- **Write a note on the occupation of Cuttack by the British.**
- **Make an analysis on the British occupation of Puri.**
- **Write a note on the British occupation of Sambalpur and Balasore.**

1.1.6. Further Reading

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UNIT-1
Chapter-II

British Administration of Odisha: Land Revenue Settlements, Administration of Justice

Structure

1.2.0. Objectives

1.2.1. Introduction

1.2.2. British Administration of Odisha

1.2.2. 1. Land Revenue Settlement

1.2.2. 1. 1. Zamindari system

1.2.2. 1. 2. Temporary settlements

1.2.2. 1. 3. Zamindaries under regulation

1.2.2. 1. 4. Bad effects of short term settlements

1.2.2. 1. 5. Exploitation of Bengali zamindars

1.2.2. 1. 6. Ryotwari system

1.2.2. 1. 7. Mahalwari system

1.2.2. 2. Administration of justice

1.2.3. Conclusion

1.2.4. Summary

1.2.5. Exercise

1.2.6. Further Reading

1.2.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss the British administration of Odisha. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the causes of the British administration of Odisha*
- *understand the Land Revenue Settlement*
- *know about the administration of justice*

1.2.1. Introduction

The British occupation of Odisha in 1803 created a new chapter in the history of Odisha. Before that, Odisha had been under an alien rule for such a long period. They introduced British administration in Odisha which brought far-reaching changes in Odisha. In fact, the British administration had changed the life of the people of Odisha to a great extent.

1.2.2. British Administration of Odisha

Odisha was divided into three administrative units under British administration.' 'Province of Cuttack' was under Bengal Presidency, Ganjam and Koraput were under Madras Presidency and Sambalpur was under Central Provinces. Besides, there were princely states. The administration under such conditions naturally could not become uniform. Further 'Province of Cuttack' was divided into two divisions viz., Northern and Southern with head quarters at Balasore and Jagannath (Puri) respectively in 1804. Subsequently for administrative reasons, head quarter at Puri was shifted to Cuttack in 1816. Cuttack also became the seat of the Commissioner, the Board of Revenue and the Provincial Appeal Court in 1818. The Commissioner became the Superintendent of Feudatory States. Cuttack Province was divided into Balasore, Cuttack and Puri districts in 1828.

1.2.2. 1. Land Revenue Settlement

In the administration, revenue aspects were considered most important. All the three kinds of land settlement, viz., Zamindari, Ryotwari and Mahalwari were implemented in different parts to assess and collect land revenue.

1.2.2. 1. 1. Zamindari system

The British occupied Odisha in 1803. At that time permanent Settlement had been in force in Bengal for a decade. The Permanent Settlement recognized the zamindars as the hereditary proprietors of the soil in perpetuity, provided they paid to the government, the latter's share of the revenue, collected from the cultivators. The same system was not introduced in entirety in Odisha.

1.2.2. 1. 2. Temporary settlements

The English introduced temporary settlements in most areas and extended Permanent Settlement to some zamindaries of the Maratha period. Under the Regulation XII of 1805, short term settlements were introduced for eleven years in the following order - one year settlement of 1804-5, three years' settlement from 1805-6 to 1807- 8, four years' settlement from 1808-9 to 1811-12 and three years' settlement from 1812-13 to 1814-15. At the end of these short term experiments, Permanent Settlement was proposed to be introduced in such lands which were "in a sufficiently improved state of cultivation to warrant the measure on such terms as the government shall deem fair and equitable".

1.2.2. 1. 3. Zamindaries under regulation

Under the above regulation, settlement of land revenue was made with the following zamindaries at a fixed *jama* in perpetuity - Darpan, Sukinda, Madhupur, Aul, Kanika, Kujang, Harishpur, Marichpur, Bishnupur, Dampara, Patia, Kalkalla, Chhedra and Parikud. East India Company wanted to treat the raja of Khurda as a zamindar on the basis of Permanent Settlement like the zamindars of the above-mentioned estates but due to the rebellion of the raja in 1804 his estate was converted into a government estate.

In 1805 the Government promised that Permanent Settlement would be introduced in the temporarily settled areas at the end of eleven years' experimental short term settlements. But the promise could not be actually fulfilled because in 1811 and 1812 the Court of Directors of East India Company, in their despatches to the Government in India, disapproved of the introduction of Permanent Settlement in 'ceded and conquered territories' including Odisha.

1.2.2. 1. 4. Bad effects of short term settlements

The short term settlements proved ruinous to the Oriya tenants as well as zamindars. While the tenures of proprietors of land were frequently changed, no method was devised to protect the rights of the peasants over tile land. Revenue was often fixed and increased without taking into proper consideration the real value and capability of estate. Subsequently S.L. Maddox held that the early revenue settlement in Odisha was an "unfortunate record of assessment on insufficient enquiry and of the enforcement of inelastic rules for the realization of inequitable revenues."

The British allowed no reduction or remission of revenue, in the event of the peasants' inability to pay since 1804, there were numerous floods and droughts, causing famine or scarcity of food, but collection of revenue went on as per the Bengal Regulations. The early land revenue policy of the British was considered more repressive than that of the Marathas, because the latter allowed remission or reduction of revenue, when there was loss of crops caused by the natural calamities.

Because of heavy assessment and failure of crops, the landlords could not pay revenue to the Government for their estates. The arrears of revenue led to sale of estates. In 1807, 266 estates with a total *jama* of more than 3 lakhs were sold. Estates with a higher *jama* of Rs. *5,000/-* or more were sold at Fort Wiiliam, Calcutta. Consequently many Odia zamindars lost their estates and those estates were purchased by the Bengali speculators. Since Permanent Settlement was not introduced, many zamindars gave up their estates in 1816-17 to get rid of the troubles, caused by the short term settlements.

1.2.2. 1. 5. Exploitation of Bengali zamindars

The Bengali zamindars who purchased estates stayed away from the estates and appointed *amlas* to collect revenue. Those *amlas* took advantage of the peasants' ignorance of Regulations and collected more than the legal rent. About their oppression Trower the Collector of Cuttack observed: "This system must have .been most ruinous to the country destructive to the prosperity of the *ryots,* and one of the greatest evils which the foreign *amlas* have entailed on the district since it came under the British Government.

The short term settlement did not end in 1814-15 as had been originally proposed. There were ten more short term settlements which ended in 1837. A thirty years settlement was

introduced in 1837 and the question of Permanent Settlement was finally rejected. This long term settlement was made on the basis of careful field survey and investigation into the individual rights of each landholder and under-tenant but the people had already been subjected to much hardship due to the short term settlement of preceding thirty three years.

1.2.2. 1. 6. Ryotwari system

The Ryotwari system was introduced in place of Zamindari in 'Ganjam plains' of Chhatrapur, Berhampur and Ghumsar in early part of 19th century. Under the system, revenue collection was made by officials appointed by the Company. It ensured the tenants of their rights over land on condition of a fixed amount of rent annually. The rent was fixed at half of net production on the basis of assessment. The ryot (peasant-cultivator) felt secured about his possession. He was given a document called 'Patta' containing amount and kind of land and the rent he had to pay. He could deal with his land in any manner without putting any liability on the state.

1.2.2. 1. 7. Mahalwari system

The System was introduced in Sambalpur district. It was a modified version of the Zamindari System. Both the Zamindars and the village headmen played an important role in the System. They were standing mid-way between the chiefs of a feudatory state and proprietor of the Mughalbandi area. Sambaipur district was divided into two tracts-Khalsa and Zamindari. Whereas the former refers to such land held by village headmen directly from government, the latter was a feudal organization headed by Zamindars. Khalsa consisted of 119 Malguzari, 870 Gauntia and 16 Ryotwari villages comprising of an area of 1657 sq miles. Whereas Zamindars were 17 in number with 3,248 sq miles.

The lease of land was granted to Zamindars or Gauntias or Birtias or Umra, as the ease may be, for collection of revenue. There was some tax-free land called Bhogra, Devottara or Brahmottara. Bhogra was enjoyed by those Zamindars, Gauntias etc. and some classes of village servants like Jhankar (village priest) Chaukidar (watchman) and Nariha (water-carrier) etc. Brahmottara and Devottara were land granted to Brahmins and religious institutions respectively. The System had some demerits. The short term settlement of the System proved to be harassing and expensive for the tenants. Further, the Zamindars and Gauntias exploited tenants in various ways. Free labour known as Bethi- Begar was taken from them. They had to pay Nazarana (present) to secure Zamindar's consent for transfer of land. As Sambalpur district was declared to

be "a partially excluded area" under Govt. of India Act of 1935, it was difficult to amend the tenancy laws.

1.2.2. 2. Administration of justice

The judicial administration, adopted by the British government in Odisha, was efficient. One judge was appointed to look after the administration of justice. The people of Odisha could not follow the clumsy judicial procedure of the court. Sometimes, laws were tilted in favour of the culprit who bribed the *am/as* and other servants of the court and even the pleaders of the opposite party. The people of Odisha gradually lost faith from the judiciary, run by the British government in this land. The same judge also acted as magistrate. The conquered territories were divided into several *thanas* under the control of the *darogahs*.. The police, to a greater extent, was oppressive.

1.2.3. Conclusion

Thus, the introduction of British administration in Odisha brought far-reaching changes in the life of the people of Odisha. Odisha got divided into three administrative units under British administration. In the administration, revenue aspects were considered most important. All the three kinds of land settlement, viz., Zamindari, Ryotwari and Mahalwari were implemented in different parts to assess and collect land revenue. The short term settlements proved ruinous to the Oriya tenants as well as zamindars. The Bengali zamindars exploited the tenants of Odisha. The people of Odisha could not follow the clumsy judicial procedure of the court. The police, to a greater extent, was oppressive in nature.

1.2.4. Summary

- The British occupation of Odisha in 1803 created a new chapter in the history of Odisha.
- Introduction of British administration in Odisha brought far-reaching changes in Odisha.
- Odisha was divided into three administrative units under British administration.
- 'Province of Cuttack' was under Bengal Presidency, Ganjam and Koraput were under Madras Presidency and Sambalpur was under Central Provinces.

- Besides, there were princely states. The administration under such conditions naturally could not become uniform.
- In the administration, revenue aspects were considered most important.
- All the three kinds of land settlement, viz., Zamindari, Ryotwari and Mahalwari were implemented in different parts to assess and collect land revenue.
- The English introduced temporary settlements in most areas and extended Permanent Settlement to some zamindaries of the Maratha period.
- The short term settlements proved ruinous to the Oriya tenants as well as zamindars.
- The British allowed no reduction or remission of revenue, in the event of the peasants' inability to pay since 1804, there were numerous floods and droughts, causing famine or scarcity of food, but collection of revenue went on as per the Bengal Regulations.
- The Bengali zamindars who purchased estates stayed away from the estates and appointed *amlas* to collect revenue.
- Those *amlas* took advantage of the peasants' ignorance of Regulations and collected more than the legal rent.
- The Ryotwari system was introduced in place of Zamindari in 'Ganjam plains' of Chhatrapur, Berhampur and Ghumsar in early part of 19th century.
- The Mahalwari System was introduced in Sambalpur district.
- The judicial administration, adopted by the British government in Odisha, was efficient.
- One judge was appointed to look after the administration of justice.
- The people of Odisha could not follow the clumsy judicial procedure of the court.

- The people of Odisha could not follow the clumsy judicial procedure of the court. The police, to a greater extent, was oppressive in nature.

- Thus, the introduction of British administration in Odisha brought far-reaching changes in the life of the people of Odisha.

1.2.5. Exercise

- **Write a note on the British administration in Odisha.**
- **Give an account on the land revenue settlement in Odisha.**
- **Highlight the bad effects of land revenue settlement in Odisha.**
- **Write a note on the administration of justice in Odisha.**

1.2.6. Further Reading

- A.C. Pradhan, *A Study of History of Odisha*, 2006.
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UNIT-1

Chapter-III

Economic Development- Agriculture and Industry, Trade and Commerce

Structure

13.0. Objectives

13.1. Introduction

13.2. Economic development

1.3.2.1. Agriculture and Industry

1.3.2.2. Agrarian changes

1.3.2. 3. Land settlement

1.3.2. 4. Introduction of commercial agriculture

1.3.2. 5. Failure of commercial crops

1.3.2. 6. Rent and wages

1.3.2. 7. Agricultural production

1.3.2. 8. Trade and Commerce

1.3.2. 9. Salt Trade

1.3.2. 10. Establishment of trade monopoly

1.3.2. 11. Huge profit out of Salt monopoly

1.3.2. 12. Sufferings of general public

1.3.2. 13. End of indigenous salt factories in Odisha

1.3.2. 14. Trade centers

1.3.2. 15. Trade centers at Balasore and Pipili

1.3.2. 16. Currency Policy

1.3.3. Conclusion

1.3.4. Summary

1.3.5. Exercise

1.3.6. Further Reading

13.0.Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Economic Development- Agriculture and Industry, Trade and Commerce. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the causes of the economic development during the Britisha period*
- *understand the development of agriculture and industry during British rule*
- *know about the development of trade and commerce in Odisha under the Brtish rule*

13.1. Introduction

The British rule was a long story of the systematic exploitation by an imperialistic government of a people whom they had enslaved by their policy of divide and rule. The benefits of British rule were only accidental and incidental, if any. The main motive of all British policies was to serve the interests of England. Thus, in 1947 when the British transferred power to India, we inherited a crippled economy with a stagnant agriculture and a peasantry steeped in poverty. As Jawaharlal Nehru put it, "India was under an industrial capitalist regime, but her economy was largely that of the pre-capitalist period, minus man). Of the wealth producing elements of that pre-capitalist economy. She became a passive agent of modern industrial capitalism suffering all its ills and with hardly any of its advantages.

13.2. Economic development

The British economic policy was exploitative in nature. As they had came with the sole purpose to do trade and commerce and to rule by taking the mileage of political disturbance in India, so their intention was not the economic development of the colonies rather the economic exploitation.

1.3.2.1. Agriculture and Industry

Starting from the last quarter of the eighteenth century to the end of nineteenth century, the British administration was mainly confined to the revenue administration, and augmentation of land revenue was the first target. Since the land revenue was the major source of income to the British Government, it gave early attention to the question of land ownership and its revenue settlement. Until then, the multiplicative relationships between the tenants and the landowners

and between the landowners and the Governemnt were so complicated and confusing that the British Goverement took about half a century to understand the problem especially in Northern Odisha. For this reason, the problem of land revenue settlements, in their diverse manifestations, continued to be baffling till the end of the nineteenth century. All types of experiments were made and many mistakes were committed.

1.3.2.2. Agrarian changes

The period 1776 to 1947 was full of many agrarian changes. There were numerous agrarian problems in which Odisha had been suffered a lot. This gives a broad historical overview of the major developments concerning land revenue administration, tenancy system, stratification of peasantry, size of holding and productivity of land, cropping pattern, irrigation, technology, agricultural credit and marketing, rate of rent and wage, etc. Such a review should apprise us of the type of agrarian structure that Odisha inherited on the eve of Independence; in particular, an inventory of the inherited historical problems should become evident from such a review so that the whole gamut of post-Independence policies and programmes could be critically analyzed in the light of historical constraints typically faced by the agrarian economy of Odisha.

1.3.2. 3. Land settlement

The British Government in Odisha initiated the first settlement 1n 1804. This was followed by a package of alternative solutions to the inherited problems of land revenue settlement. Out of these alternatives, *a* few stand out namely: (i) to farm out land to the zamindars under a permanent arrangement as was done earlier in Bengal; (ii) to farm out land to the Zamindars on short- term arrangement and to employ collectors to collect the land revenue and hold the land under direct (Khas) management the land revenue settlement was not less than a farce throughout the British Rule in Odisha. Some of the British experts like Edmonstone, Cecil Beadon, John Lawrence supported the permanent settlement; whereas others like Charles Wood were in a dilemma with respect to its result. Those who were in favour of such a settlement argued that the permanent settlement would create a number of middlemen, in course of time, where the profits of landlords were being distributed among them, and as a result, a large number of affluent groups including zamindars would be subjected to pay income tax and customs, and

state would be a net gainer. The argument against the permanent settlement was that the inelasticity of land revenue under such a system would bring a great loss to the government in the future.

Soon after the conquest of Odisha, the British found that the cultivated lands of the Mughalbandi areas were tilled by two classes of ryots: 'thani' or resident cultivators, and 'pahi' or non-resident cultivators. The thani ryot had a hereditary right of occupancy in their lands, whereas the pahi ryots were mere tenants-at-will. The thani ryots had many advantages over the pahi ryots. The thani ryots could posses the best land in the areas were allowed to enjoy communal rights to pasture, firewood and thatching grass. They held their homestead and garden land free of rent. They could not be ousted so long rent was paid regularly. The pahi ryots paid a much lower rent than their thani brethren, but on the other hand, they were liable to be turned out of their holding at any moment.

1.3.2. 4. Introduction of commercial agriculture

The British Raj had endeavoured to introduce commercial agriculture in Odisha. In addition to rice, sugar-cane was one of the principal food crops. But, due to unsuitable soil, lack of adequate capital investment by the private enterprise and lack of encouragement from government or from the landlords, the sugarcane cultivation remained a crop only for local requirement. For example, by 1883, in Cuttack district, a mere 2,000 acres were sown with cane, and in Sambalpur, it occupied one percent of total cropped area. Towards the end of the 19th century, there was an improvement only in Balasore district due to private initiatives. Grams, pulses and oilseeds were among the principal rabi crops of Odisha in the 19th century. It occupied around 7.0 per cent of total cropped area in Cuttack district in the year 1900.

1.3.2. 5. Failure of commercial crops

The cultivation of jute, tobacco and indigo not very popular. A muslim merchant introduced indigo cultivation in Cuttack. The cultivators in Balasore district adopted jute cultivation towards the last decade of the nineteenth century. However, jute cultivation failed to become popular as there was no jute mill to use the raw material. Tobacco cultivation, which required rich alluvial soil, was largely undertaken in Cuttack and Puri districts. In Cuttack, it occupied 200 acres in 1873, which rose to 10, 140 acres in 1891-92.17. But the poor quality of tobacco discouraged

capital investment. The soil in Odisha proved unsuitable for extensive cotton cultivation, where largely inferior quality was cultivated. Moreover, with the increasing popularity of imported clothes, because of its fine yarn and cheapness, the cotton cultivation reached the lowest ebb. Besides, failure to irrigate land for commercial crops (in many cases, the zamidars did not allow the tenants to use canal water for cash crops production), it led towards monoculture instead of diversified agriculture. The absence of outside market for agricultural produce except rice and limited internal market, did not provide any incentive to peasants to produce commercial crops on a big scale.

1.3.2. 6. Rent and wages

With respect to rent and wages, we notice that between 1837 and 1897, the rent enhancement by the Government was the highest in Cuttack and lowest in Puri districts. For example, the increase in the rate of rent per acre 1n 1897 over the year 1837 was 43.32 per cent in Cuttack district, 26.00 per cent in Puri district and was 37.00 per cent in Balasore district. 18 In response, the zamindars and other in termediaries enhanced the rate of rent per acre arbitrarily and it had no linkage with the Governemnt rates. Since a majority of tenants were poor, the incidence of increased rent rates coupled with various other cesses and fines imposed by the zamindars was much higher than that in most other states. The Governemnt rarely interfered to check the arbitrary enhancement of rent and extraction of different cesses by the zamindars. In the early years of the British rule, remission of revenue was granted to the zamindars in the years of bad harvest with instructions to discontinue collection of rent. But, in spite of Government order, the zamindars continued to collect rent from the cultivators. Not only that, the timid tenants were also compelled to pay a number of extra cesses known as ·awab' on items, such as growing grass, bettlenuts, mango, cotton, and even on celebrating marriage. Then taxes like 'derivalla', 'Najaya' and 'Palatak' worked as penalty taxes imposed on the tenants. Over-burden of such penalty taxes compelled many a tenant to desert his land and migrate to other areas. The wage to the agricultural labour and rural artisans was in the form of kind or in cash. In the rural sector, the most preferred mode of wage was in kind.

1.3.2. 7. Agricultural production

Agricultural production was largely based on labour-intensive technology. The farmers were using certain implements such as spade, axe, chopper, cloud breaker and harrow, etc. which were made of iron extracted out of the native charcoal furnance by the local blacksmiths. However, towards the end of the century, due to availability of imported steel, utilisation of native iron declined. During the British period, the traditional money institutions were the source of borrowing for the cultivators. The cultivators borrowed mostly for paying wages to daily labourers, reclamation of land, minor irrigation, purchasing seeds from landlords, payment of rent to the zamindars (especially, during the failure of crop), and so on. The small and marginal tenants resorted to borrowing from the village moneylenders, mahajans, big tenants etc. to defray their family expenditure on food grains and other necessaries for life.

1.3.2. 8. Trade and Commerce

As the basic purpose of the British was trade and commerce, so they involved themselves in trade and commerce in the colonies. In case of Orissa, they looked for the enrichment of their treasury rather looking the benefit of the people of Orissa.

1.3.2. 9. Salt Trade

Like the British land revenue policy, the British policy of salt monopoly proved ruinous to the economic life of the people. It is the sad story of the systematic destruction of an indigenous industry. During the Maratha period a large quantity of salt was manufactured in the sea coast of Orissa. Salt manufacture was a private concern of the *malangis* (salt manufacturers). The merchants were purchasing salt from the *Malangis* and exporting the same to the neighbouring states.

The Maratha Government did not interfere with the manufacture of salt but collected duties from the salt merchants. The East India Company had established its monopoly over salt trade in Bengal as early as 1765. Under East India Company's monopolistic salt trade the salt price of Bengal was higher than that of Orissa. Consequently large quantity of salt was smuggled from Orissa to Bengal. So the East India Company had tried to secure control over the salt trade of Orissa by an agreement with the Marathas long before they actually occupied Orissa, but the Marathas had refused to give this concession to them.

1.3.2. 10. Establishment of trade monopoly

After the occupation of Orissa the East India Company decided to establish its monopoly over the salt manufacture and trade of Orissa. According to the Regulation of 1804, the manufacture of salt became the monopoly of the Company's Government. The private manufacture of salt was allowed only under license from the Government and the sale of the commodity was made subject to the payment of a duty of twelve annas per maund. The Regulation XXII of 1814 made the manufacture and sale of the salt an exclusive monopoly of the Company's Government. In 1806, James King took charge of the salt department as tile salt agent. Under his supervision salt was manufactured in the *aurangs* of Balasore, Cuttack and Puri districts by the *malangis.* Large quantity of salt was exported from Orissa by the East India Company, resulting in securing to the Company huge revenue. At the end of East India Company's rule, the net revenue derived from local sale and export of salt was 45 lakhs of rupees, which was much higher than the income, derived from the land revenue.

1.3.2. 11. Huge profit out of Salt monopoly

While the East India Company made huge profit out of monopoly in manufacture and sale of salt, the *malangis* and common consumers suffered. The *malangis* who were employed by the British Government were paid low wages, and yet they were required by the zamindars in whose land salt was manufactured to pay the latter's due as was the case before the establishment of the British monopoly. In 1808, the salt agent James proposed that the salt lands within the zamindar's jurisdiction should be transferred to that of the salt department. The proposal was worked out, subject to the payment of 1 1/2 annas per maund of the manufactured salt and certain amount of salt as *Khorakee* (dietary allowance) to the zamindars in whose estates salt was manufactured.

1.3.2. 12. Sufferings of general public

The general public had to purchase salt at a much higher rate under the British monopoly than during the Maratha period because of the higher taxes imposed on salt. The price of salt, manufactured under the monopoly system, was deliberately raised to help the sale of imported salt, and ultimate replacement of indigenous salt by the imported salt.

By 1860, the fine and cheap Liverpool salt was being sold in large scale in Ortssa; as by that time the native prejudice against the foreign salt had disappeared. The British Government stopped manufacture of salt and abolished monopoly over salt trade in 1863. The manufacture of

salt was hereafter allowed to be carried on through private enterprise under the excise rules of Act VII (B.C.) of 1864. Under these excise rules, a salt manufacturer was required to pay duty to the Government. The salt industry could not be revived any more, because indigenous salt could not compete with the imported salt of superior quality. The indigenous salt industry virtually ended with the abolition of the British salt monopoly and discontinuance of Government manufacture of salt resulted in depriving 26 thousands of *malangis* of the means of their livelihood.

The British Government was not even favourably inclined towards the local manufacture of salt under excise system, and was keen on suppressing illicit manufacture of salt, as it deprived the Government of excise revenue on salt. In 1889 the Government prohibited the manufacture of *Panga* salt (salt boiled out of salt earth scraped up in saliferous soil).

1.3.2. 13. End of indigenous salt factories in Odisha

In 1891 the Government made an attempt to manufacture salt on a monopoly basis by establishing salt factory at Tua and Gurubai on the Chilika lake (in Puri district). The *Tua* and Gurubai factories were closed in 1902. The failure of these two factories was due to the lack of proper official supervision and inadequate sale. From the stoppage of Government's salt manufacture in 1863 upto the beginning of the twentieth century, Liverpool salt dominated Orissa salt market. From the beginning of the present century, due to the facilities of railway transport the Madras salt became a serious competitor for the Liverpool salt.

1.3.2. 14. Trade centers

The Battle of Plassey and Buxar helped the British to establish their colony in India. Thereafter they acquired as much of Indian territories as possible, and Orissa being close to Bengal automatically came under their control. As early as 1633, the British established a trade centre at Hariharpur (present Jagatsingpur district), one of their first settlements in India.

1.3.2. 15. Trade centers at Balasore and Pipili

Their subsequent trade establishment at Baleshwar (or Balasore) on river Burhabalanga and at Pipili developed into flourishing centers of trade as well as of power. According to William Wilson Hunter, the English historian, it was those two Orissa harbours which became the basis of the future greatness of the British in Bengal.

Balasore district was part of the ancient Kalinga which later became a territory of Toshala or Utkal, till the death of Mukunda Dev. It was annexed by Moghuls in 1568 and remained as a part of their suzerainty up to the middle of eighteenth century (up to 1750-51). Then the Marahattas occupied this part of Odisha and it became a part of the dominion of the Marahatta Rajas of Nagpur. The East India Company ceded this part through a treaty called treaty of Deogaon in 1803 and it became a part of Bengal Presidency up to 1912. But the first English Settlement came into existence in Balasore region in 1634 while Sahajahan was the emperor at Delhi. The first of English factories was established in this region in 1640.

The English settlement of Balasore, formed in 1642, was an early trading port for British, French and Dutch ships in the early age of Enlightenment and became a colonial part of first Danish India, later British India. In 1763 Balasore became a Danish possession, governed from Tranquebar, as part of Danish India. Due to the shallowness of its bay, the trading post was abandoned, leaving behind only a small settlement in the area. Balasore as a separate district was created in October 1828 while it was in the Bengal Presidency. On 7 November 1845, all Danish India was sold to the British, who made it part of British India.

1.3.2. 16. Currency Policy

British currency policy adversely affected the economic life of the people of Orissa. In Orissa *Kauri* currency was prevalent during the Maratha period. But the British Government wanted the payment of revenue in sicca rupee, the standard silver coin, then prevalent in Bengal. The British allowed payment in *Kauri* currency till the end of 1807-08. Thereafter, they depreciated *Kauri* to a considerable extent in relation to *Sicca* rupee. Consequently the price of commodities rose very high in terms of *Kauris,* causing much distress to the people. At the same time payment of revenue in silver became difficult due to the scarcity of silver which had been caused by the remittance of a huge amount of silver to the Calcutta treasury. The hardship, caused by depreciation of *Kauri* became a cause of profound mass unrest against the British rule.

1.3.3. Conclusion

Thus, the British economic policy was exploitative in nature. As they had came with the sole purpose to do trade and commerce and to rule by taking the mileage of political disturbance in India, so their intention was not the economic development of the colonies rather the economic exploitation. Starting from the last quarter of the eighteenth century to the end of nineteenth

century, the British administration was mainly confined to the revenue administration, and augmentation of land revenue was the first target. Thus, British economic policy adversely affected the economic life of the people of Orissa.

1.3.4. Summary

- The British rule was a long story of the systematic exploitation by an imperialistic government of a people whom they had enslaved by their policy of divide and rule.
- The benefits of British rule were only accidental and incidental, if any.
- The British economic policy was exploitative in nature.
- Since the land revenue was the major source of income to the British Government, it gave early attention to the question of land ownership and its revenue settlement.
- The period 1776 to 1947 was full of many agrarian changes.
- There were numerous agrarian problems in which Odisha had been suffered a lot.
- This gives a broad historical overview of the major developments concerning land revenue administration, tenancy system, stratification of peasantry, size of holding and productivity of land, cropping pattern, irrigation, technology, agricultural credit and marketing, rate of rent and wage, etc.
- The British Government in Odisha initiated the first settlement 1n 1804.
- This was followed by a package of alternative solutions to the inherited problems of land revenue settlement.
- The British Raj had endeavoured to introduce commercial agriculture in Odisha. In addition to rice, sugar-cane was one of the principal food crops.
- But, due to unsuitable soil, lack of adequate capital investment by the private enterprise and lack of encouragement from government or from the landlords, the sugarcane cultivation remained a crop only for local requirement.

- The cultivation of jute, tobacco and indigo not very popular.
- As the basic purpose of the British was trade and commerce, so they involved themselves in trade and commerce in the colonies.
- In case of India, they looked for the enrichment of their treasury rather looking the benefit of the people of Orissa.
- Like the British land revenue policy, the British policy of salt monopoly proved ruinous to the economic life of the people.
- It is the sad story of the systematic destruction of an indigenous industry.
- The East India Company had established its monopoly over salt trade in Bengal as early as 1765.
- Under East India Company's monopolistic salt trade the salt price of Bengal was higher than that of Orissa.
- According to the Regulation of 1804, the manufacture of salt became the monopoly of the Company's Government.
- While the East India Company made huge profit out of monopoly in manufacture and sale of salt, the *malangis* and common consumers suffered.
- The general public had to purchase salt at a much higher rate under the British monopoly than during the Maratha period because of the higher taxes imposed on salt.
- By 1860, the fine and cheap Liverpool salt was being sold in large scale in Ortssa; as by that time the native prejudice against the foreign salt had disappeared.
- In 1891 the Government made an attempt to manufacture salt on a monopoly basis by establishing salt factory at Tua and Gurubai on the Chilika lake (in Puri district).
- The *Tua* and Gurubai factories were closed in 1902.
- As early as 1633, the British established a trade centre at Hariharpur (present Jagatsingpur district), one of their first settlements in India.

- Their subsequent trade establishment at Baleshwar (or Balasore) on river Burhabalanga and at Pipili developed into flourishing centers of trade as well as of power.
- British currency policy adversely affected the economic life of the people of Orissa.
- Thus, the British economic policy was exploitative in nature. It adversely affected the economic life of the people of Orissa.

1.3.5. Exercise

- **Write a note on the economic development in Odisha during the British period.**
- **Give an account on the development of agriculture and industry in Odisha during the British period.**
- **Make an analysis on the development of trade and commerce in Odisha during the British period.**
- **Discuss how the British economic policies had adversely affected the economic life of the people of Odisha.**

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UNIT-2
Chapter-I

Resistance Movements in the 19th century: Khurda rising of 1804-05, Paik rebellion of 1817

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2.1.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Resistance Movements in the 19th century- Khurda rising of 1804-05, Paik rebellion of 1817. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the causes of the resistance movement in the 19th century*
- *understand the Khurada rising of 1804-05*
- *know about Paik rebellion of 1817*
- *evaluate the causes and results of the Paik rebellion of 1817*

2.1.1. Introduction

The 19th century Odisha witnessed a number of resistance movements of the common people, landholders, Zamindars and Feudatory Chiefs against the British Raj. Among those resistance movements, four were very severe and posed great threat to the British rule in Odisha. All those resistance movements occurred in Odisha due to a strong dislike for the new rule, the oppressive revenue system and high rent, threat to traditional privileges of vested landed-interests etc which had endangered the life and property of the people of Odisha.

2.1.2. Resistance Movements in 19th Century

Unlike other parts of India, the Birtish occupation of Odisha was immediately followed by sharp public reaction giving rise to resistance movement in the 19th century.

2.1.3. Resistance movements of Khurda

The resistance movement started in the form of insubordination against the British authorities by Nilakantha Mangaraj, the Raja of Harispur with whom the special Commissioner for Odisha had signed treaty engagement on December 1803. He was dismissed for defying the British authorities and placed under confinement till April 1805, and released on condition of good behaviour and regular payment of tribute. From the Maratha period the relationship between the British and Raja of Kanika was strained on account of practical activities on the coast of Odisha under the latter's patronage. Very often the British traders had complained against the Raja of

Kanika for the harassment they suffered. With the change of authorities governing Odisha in 1803, the Raja entered into an engagement with the British agreeing to pay tribute. There were signs of an improvement in relationship. But in 1804 troubles started concerning the Raja of Khurda and British apprehended a secret alliance between Khurda and Kanika. Even the Raja of Kujanga was expected to join this alliance against the British.

2.1.3. 1. Causes of conflict with the Raja of Khurda

There were many causes which led to the Khurda rising which can be discussed bellow.

2.1.3. 2. Deceit of the British towards the Raja of Khurda

The Raja of Khurda had surrendered the Mahals of Lambai, Rahang and Puri to the Marathas in lieu of some military help he had received for his war against the Raja of Paralakhemundi. After the expulsion of the Marathas, the Raja expected and Mahlas would be restored to him by the British. But the unwillingness of the British to oblige naturally angered the Raja. Colonel Harcourt categorically denied restoration of the Mahals.

2.1.3. 3. Difference between Raja of Khurda and the British

During his march from Ganjam towards Puri in September I803 Harcourt and availed of the good-will of the Raja of Khurda for provision of troops and movement of convoys. He had assured the payment of Rupees one lakh to the Raja for allowing him smooth passage. The Raja received Rupees seventy thousand in two installments, but the payment of the balance of Rs. 30.000 was deferred indefinitely.

2.1.3. 4. Attempt of Jayi Rajguru to restore the Parganas

Mukundadeva-II, the Raja of Khurdha (1795-1817) welcomed the British after their conquest of Orisssa in 1803. He hoped that the four Pargans (Rahang, Serain, Chaubiskud and Lembai) lost to the Marathas would be restored to him by the British. Since the king was a minor, his regent Jayakrisna Rajguru or Jayi Rajguru went to Cuttack to present his case for the restoration of the Parganas and a reduction of annual Peshkash. They refused both the demands. Instead, they pressurised the king to execute an agreement on lines dictated by them. They

wanted the king to dismiss Rajguru. Jayi Rajguru read the evil designs of the British. He made an alliance among the Chiefs of Khurdha, Kujanaga and Kanika states. The king of Khurdha made all preparations for confrontation with the British. The personal approach of Jayi Rajguru, the Dewan of Khurda proved unavailing. Rajguru's request for a reduction of the amount of annual tribute was also summararily, rejected by Harcourt.

2.1.3. 5. Efforts made by the King of Khurda and his associates

The above factors were responsible in compelling the Raja of Khurda to adopt a hostile attitude against the British in 1804. He felt reluctant to sign the treaty engagement with the Commissioners and did not hesitate to vent his feelings. In a bid to recover the Mahals from British possession. He even sought the help of the Marathas. He engaged Sambhu Bharati, a mendicant to go round the Odia zamindars persuading them to make a, common cause against the foreign Government. The Rajas of Kujang and Kanika responded to the call. The Raja of Kanika violating the agreement on the production and sale of salt seized the British Store houses and funds and declined to attend the Commissioners Cuttack as a tributary. He even raised a large army under a Maratha Commander for self defence.

2.1.3. 6. British measures to suppress the resistance movement

Harcourt was naturally worried lest such disaffection might spread among other tributaries and sought the Governor General's permission for a stern exemplary action against the Raja of Khurda so as to dissuade others turning hostile to the British. Under pressure, of the Home Government Lord Wellesley did not agree to escalate a conflict in Odisha. His war against the Maratha Confederacy was not yet over. He, therefore, suggested Harcourt to adopt conciliatory measures. Sambhu Bharati, the Agent provocateur was seized. An attempt to negotiate through Captain Blunt with the Raja of Khurda proved futile on account of the intervention of Jayi Rajguru. A contingent of 250 cavalry soldiers and 900 Barkandazes from Khurda entered into Lembai, Rahang and Puri. On hearing this news Captain Hickland, who was stationed at Pipili marched with an army of 120 Sepoys and defeated the Raja's force on 22 November 1804. Harcourt also proceeded from Cuttack against the Raja of Khurda. The fort of the Raja was besieged by Capt. Storey. Harcourt engaged Shaikh Waz Muhmmad, a native of Cuttack to reduce the fort of Banpur and through him captured the Raja's brothers and son.

Subsequently, the Raja was also captured on 3 January 1805 and taken to Cuttack. After subduing Khurda, Harcourt despatched a small contingent towards Nayagarh to capture Antaji and Kannoji. Two Maratha agents of Nagpur through whom the Raja of Khurda sought help and himself proceeded towards Kujang and Kanika via Gop.

2.1.3. 7. Support of the people and the chiefs to the Raja of Khurda

The Zamindars of Marichpur and Harispur were sympathetic to the cause of Khurda; they were even preparing to render help. But the arrival of Harcourt with army dissuaded them from such a course of action. Chandradhwaja Sendh, Raja of Kujang took to flight on hearing the approach of the Commissioner. He was arrested in May 1805. His brother Madhusudan Sendh was installed on the Guddi on condition that the Raja would account for all properties collected from wrecks of ships on the coast and would remain loyal to the British.

Thereafter, Harcourt moved towards Kanika. Robert Ker, the Collector of Balasore was also asked to proceed with a force and arrest the Raja on grounds of mere, suspicion. Harcourt asked, to take over the charge of Kanika estate for direct administration. Major Andrew and Captain Blunt were detailed to assist Ker in settling the affairs in Kanika. The Raja was taken a prisoner and shifted to Balasore. He was kept there till September 1805 and subsequently removed to Midnapure.

The removal of the Raja of Kanika, apparently for no reason, provoked the people of the estate to rebel. The uprising was lad by the Diwan. But it could be suppressed by the British through Subadar Shib Prasad who seized all the weapons of the rebels. It is difficult to justify the military action against Kanika. The Chief and his people were taken to task for resisting the British who considered the Raja as notorious for his earlier non-cooperation in trading activities and hostile antecedents. They suspected his connivance with the Rajas of Kujang and Khurda and were not prepared to leave anything to chance.

2.1.3. 8. Results of the Khurda rising

- As a result of which the British captured the fort of Khurdha in December 1804.
- The fugitive king was arrested by the treachery of one Fateh Muhammad in January 1805.

- The Raja of Kanika, Balabhadra Bhanja was made a prisoner.
- The Raja of Kujang was replaced by his elder brother.
- The regent of the king of Khurda, Jayakrisna Rajguru or Jayi Rajguru was hanged.
- Khurdha was confiscated and brought under the direct (khas) management of the British.
- The Raja was given an allowance for the administration of Jagannath temple.
- His headquarters was fixed at Puri.
- He retained the title of Maharaja without any kingdom.

Conclusion

Thus, resistance movement of Khurda was a significant event in the history of modern Odisha. This was the first resistance movement in the country and Jai Rajguru was the first martyr of India. Although the movement was suppressed by the British Raj but it provided fuel to the future movements happened in the country.

2.1.4. Paik rebellion in 1817

The Paik rebellion of 1817 was one of the significant event in the history of modern Odisha. The people of Odisha had welcomed the British Government in order to get relief from the exploitation of the Marathas. However, their hopes and aspirations were shattered on the rock of frustration when they experienced the administrative structure and economic exploitation, the two tentacles of the British imperialism. Added to these miseries were the faulty land revenue policy, salt monopoly, deprivation of the local servants from the British administration, the unsympathetic attitude of the rulers towards the ruled etc. which discharged poison in the mind of the people of Odisha. The British rule reached the nadir point of its degeneration when Jayi Rajaguru, the indomitable minister of Raja Mukundadeva 11 of Khurda was hanged and the estate of Khurda was confiscated permanently. The direct management of Khurda from 1805 by the British authority, not only flared up the anger of the native people but prepared the ground for an armed rebellion by the Paiks that took place in 1817 under the leadership of the commander of the Raja of Khurda, Buxi Jagabandhu Bidyadhar Mahapatra Bhramarabara Ray. This rebellion is famous as the Paik rebellion.

2.1.4. 1. Causes of the Paik rebellion

There were many causes which led to the outbreak of the Paik Rebellion of 1817 which can be discussed as follows.

2.1.4. 2. British exploitative policies

With the removal of the Raja of Khurda, Major Fletcher took over the charge of the entire administration of the estate. Thus started the exploitative policies of the British administration which became increasingly intolerable for the people of Odisha. They failed to understand the British regulations because those were translated into Bengali and Persi and were not available in Odia. Their ignorance was exploited by the clerks who were not native people rather Bengalies who crowded the offices in Odisha. In various important matters like payment of revenue, court cases etc. the local people were very much dependent upon the Bengali clerks who collected much money from them. Still then, to get fare judgement from the court became a dream for the local people. They could not ventilate their grievances before the British authority due to the gulf between the general mass and the British government.

2.1.4. 3. Faulty revenue policy

The faulty revenue policy of the British government adversely affected the local zamindars and the royats. The short term land revenue settlements hit the zamindars who failed to pay their due to the British authority. The Britishers never allowed remission or time to the local zamindars for the payment of revenue. The zamindars who failed to pay revenue to the British government at Calcutta in proper time, lost their zamindaries due to several reasons like failure of crops, draught, flood and other natural calamities. The assessments and over assessments of the short-term settlements added misery to the already miserable life of the peasants. This faulty land revenue policy of the British government disappointed not only the zamindars but also the royats.

2.1.4. 4. British salt policy

The British salt monopoly was another cause of the rebellion. It had caused immense hardship to the common people of Odisha. The long sea coast of Odisha produced a huge quantity of salt which was used by the people of this land freely. However, the British authority deprived the

zamindars and the local people of coastal region of their traditional rights to manufacture salt. The rise in the price of salt was generally felt by every house of this land due to the heavy import of Liverpool salt.

2.1.4. 5. Difficulties of the Khurda people

The *amlas* involved in the administration smuggled out vast quantity of salt and got huge profit. The common people of Khurda, who depended on smuggled salt, found themselves in utter hardship. They violated the British salt laws and manufactured salt. For this breach of laws, they had to suffer imprisonment which was a social stigma at that time. The persons who were imprisoned, were excommunicated from the society after their release from the jail. People tried to attract the attention of the British government against the oppressive nature of the salt laws which fell in deaf ears which enraged the people of Odisha.

2.1.4. 6. The new currency system

The introduction of new currency- system of the British authority in Odisha was another factor for the Paik rebellion. During the Maratha period, cowrie formed the chief medium of exchange in Odisha. It had its rate of exchange with the silver coins. Scarcity of cowrie currency was greatly felt during the early stage of British administration in Odisha. As a result, it became very much difficult on the part of the British troops to procure small articles of daily consumption from the local market. So, in November 1804, the British government introduced *sicca* rupees in Odisha. The zamindars, the peasants, the Talukdars etc. felt difficulty for paying revenue in cowrie currency. The villagers faced a lot of problems in handling the new currency and they were grossly exploited by the local *mahajanas.*

2.1.4. 7. Contemporary political condition of Khurda

The then political condition of Khurda, made its people rebellious. The hanging of Jayi Rajaguru, the deposition of Raja Mukundadeva II and the reorganization of administration in Khurda by Major Fletcher, enraged the people of Khurda a lot. They wanted to oppose the British rule in Khurda at any cost.

2.1.4. 8. Displeasure of Buxi Jagabandhu

The displeasure of Buxi Jagabandhu was the immediate cause for the outbreak of the Paik rebellion. He was the Commander of the Raja of Khurda and his office was hereditary. He commanded respect next to the king from the people. For his service he got *jagir* lands from the Raja which was known as *Buxibari*, consisting of the quilla of Rorung and four *paraganas* viz- Rahang, Lembai, Sarai and Chabiskud. When Major Fletcher organised new administration in Khurda, he dispossessed Buxi of the quilla Rorung. Further, by the mischievous role of Chandra Prasad Singh, the above mentioned four *paraganas* of Buxi were sold to Lakshmi Narayan who ultimately gave it to Krishna Chandra Singh, a relation of Chandra Prasad Singh. When the fact was revealed, Buxi represented to Richardson, the Commissioner, regarding this clandestine deal. The challange of Krishna Chandra in the court against Jagabandhu's right over these *paraganas* and Buxi's own cousin Gadadhar Vidyadhara's ciaim over such property, led Richardson to dispossess Jagabandhu of his right over these *paraganas* and as such, over all sources of income. This made Buxi a beggar. Added to this misfortune, the *Daroga* of Khurda tried to take Buxi into custody on a false information supplied to him by Charan Patnaik, the *Sarbarakar* of Khurda who reported the *Daroga* about Buxi's secret link with the Pindaris. This led Buxi Jagabandhu to be rebellious.

2.1.4. 9. The beginning of the Rebellion of 1817

The above factors prompted the Paikas to declare rebellion against the British. On 29 March, 1817, began the Paik rebellion in Khurda. On that day a group of 400 men, denominated Kandh of Ghumsur in Ganjam, had entered the district of Cuttack, where they have been joined by the Paiks and Dulbeheras of Pergunnah Khurda under the guidance of a person named Jagabandhu and had committed various acts of rebellion. The insurgents attacked the police station and government buildings at Banapur and killed more than 100 men and looted government money amounting to Rs. 15,000. They attacked Charles Becher, the Salt Agent of Southern Division and plundered his boats on the Chilka lake.

2.1.4. 10. Rebellion in Khurda

The Paiks of Khurda under the leadership of Buxi Jagabandhu joined the Chuhars Kandhs of Ghumsur. They burnt the government buildings and sacked the government treasury of Khurda. The insurgents proceeded towards Lembai and murdered Charan Patnaik at Rathipur. Within no

time, Khurda and the neighbouring areas were at the mercy of these rebels. Barricades were erected by them and Gangapara Pass, the main line of communication between Cuttack and Khurda, was guarded by the rebellious Paiks.

2.1.4. 11. Steps of Edward Impey

The activities of the insurgents made the British authorities aware about the alarming situation at Khurda. To meet the emergency, Edward Impey dispatched troops to Khurda and Pipli under Lieutnants Prideaux and Faris respectively. Accompanied by Lieutnant Travis, he marched with a detachment of sepoys towards Gangapara on 1 April 1817. It was impossible on the part of the British troops to cross the barricade and advance towards Khurda. On the otherhand, the hidden Paiks inside the jungle attacked the British sepoys off and on and forced them to retreat.

2.1.4. 12. Assaults of the revolutionaries

Instructed by Captain Wellington, Lieutenant Faris chased the insurgents and consequently, he was shot dead along with one Indian Subahdar. Pipli fell into the hands of the rebellious Paiks. The police stations and government offices were burnt down. On 7 April, 1817, some insurgents under the leadership of Rajballav Chhotrai attacked Hariharpur and beat the Tahasildar of Kothdes black and blue. They also drove away the new zamindars of Balarampur and Budhakera. A large number of common people of Lembai, Pipli and Kothdes joined the insurgents and penalized the zamindars who sided with the British. They also burnt the villages and destroyed the crops. The insurgents captured Rani Mukta Dei of Sambalpur who had settled in her Panehgarh Jagir under British shelter and looted her house. Further, by the instruction of Buxi, they murdered Jagabandhu Patnaik and the members of his family who were spying against Buxi.

2.1.4. 13. Proclamation of Mukundadeva as the king

Being successful in different places like Khurda, Lembai, Pipli, Gangapara, Kothdes, Hariharpur etc., the insurgents entered into Puri town. They burnt and broke down the public and private buildings as well. On 14 April, Buxi, with a large number of his followers, reached Puri. The priests of the temple welcomed him. They denounced the British authority and proclaimed Raja

Mukundadeva as their ruler who was indifferent to this sort of affair. The correspondences of Impey to the Government at Bengal reveals that the revolt gradually spread to Gope, Kujang, Pattamudai, Golra, Harishpur, Praharajpur etc.

2.1.4. 14. Measures taken by Le Fevre

Looking at this, the British government opened its Pandora's box for suppressing the rebellion. Martial law was extended to Puri, Pipli, Lembai etc. Captain Le Fevre, with strong military detachments marched towards Puri and on the way, he burnt several Paik villages. The Raja and his son Ramachandradeva were captured and brought to Cuttack by Le Fevre. This action of the British government broke down the morality of the insurgents. However, the reaction against the British government became rampant at Pattamundai, Kujang, Gope and other places. Captain Wellington now directed the troops to suppress the revolt. Captain C.R. Kennet was dispatched with a detachment to suppress the revolt at Gope, Golra and surrounding areas nearby. Captain A.Macleod proceeded to Pattamundai to control the rising tide of the insurrection at Pattamundai. At last, the Raja of Kujang surrendered and Captain Kennet was successful in capturing Narayana Paramaguru and Bamadeva Patajoshi and their followers who were other key leaders of the Paik rebellion. They were sent to the fort of Barabati. With this, normalcy was restored in Pattamundai, Asureswar, Praharajpur and other places.

2.1.4. 15. New tactics of the revolutionaries

The suppressive measures of the British authority led Buxi and his followers to take shelter at Nayagarh and Ranapur. But the combined military operation from Ganjam and Cuttack made Buxi and his followers to change places of their hiding very frequently. At last, Buxi gave a new proposal to his followers like Krushnachandra Bhramarabara Rai, Damu Subudhi, Gopal Chhotrai to go the jungles and to fight from there. The insurgents prevented the *Sarbarkars* to enter into any revenue deal with the British. The resistance to the British authority, first came from the Khonds of Banapur who ransacked the camps of the British officers. From Banapur, the fire spread to Khurda, Puri, Balakati, Gope, tiran, Bolgarh etc. The government tried to suppress this insurrections. Attempts were taken to capture Buxi Jagabandhu. Major E. Roughsedge, with the assistance of Lieutnant D. Ruddell, tried to capture Buxi and his followers who escaped from Baud by the help of the Raja of Dasapalla in September, 1818, with his faithful followers like

Biswanath Harichandan, Adikanda Bidyadhara, Dinabandhu Santara, Gopal Chhotrai, Padmanava Chhotrai and others.

2.1.4. 16. Measures taken to capture Buxi

As a precautionary measure, the British authorities threatened the Raja of Nayagarh with the warning that his estate would be confiscated, if he helped the insurgents. In the meanwhile, some followers of Buxi were captured. Rewards of Rs. 5,000 and Rs. 2,000 for capturing Buxi Jagabandhu and Krushnachandra Bhramarabara Rai respectively, were announced by the British authority but in vain. Lastly, by the suggestion of the Commissioner of Cuttack, it was proclaimed by the Governor-General-in-Council that an allowance of Rs. 200 per month would be given to Buxi, if he surrenders. Buxi responded to it by sending a representation through his adopted son to the government stating the foul ways by which he was dispossessed of his property, the whimsical rule of major Fletcher at Khurda, salt monopoly of the British government in causing widespread discontentment among the people of Khurda etc. but the government paid deaf ears to it.

2.1.4. 17. Creation of circumstances for Buxi's surrender

In the meanwhile, two wives of Buxi and many of the followers of Buxi were captured. However, Buxi did not surrender. W. Blunt, the Commissioner of Cuttack recommended to pardon Buxi and his. staunch supporter Krushnachandra Bhramarabara Rai. Basing upon the report of Blunt, the Governor-General-in-Council ordered that if Buxi and his friend would surrender, they would be pardoned and their pension would be fixed at Rs. 100 and Rs. 50 respectively per month and they would live near Cuttack and could not go outside without the permission of the magistrate. Wilkinson, the magistrate of Khurda, communicated this to Buxi and his friend through the adopted son of the rebellious leader to surrender within two months with effect from 1 December, 1822. Though, the order was received by Buxi in January 1823, he did not agree to the proposal. For long two years, he maintained silence. His friend Krushnachandra deserted him. His followers were captured or surrendered with the hope to get government service. At last, Buxi decided to surrender.

2.1.4. 18. Negotiation between the British Government and Buxi Jagabandhu

During this period, W. Blunt, the Commissioner of Cuttack, sent Waz Mohammed, the *Sheristadar* of the Office Superintendent of Tributary Mahals, to negotiate with Buxi. At Nayagarh, both of them talked and Buxi surrendered with his followers at Cuttack on 27 May, 1825. Buxi was pardoned along with his followers. His monthly allowance was fixed at Rs. 150. He lived, virtually as a prisoner at Cuttack. He prayed for the restoration of his former possessions and to allow him to reside at Rorang but the prayer was not granted by the Governor-General-in-Council. Buxi breathed his last on 24 January, 1829 at Cuttack

2.1.4. 19. Consequences of the Paik Rebellion

The Paik rebellion of 1817 had far reaching consequences which are given bellow.

2.1.4. 20. Administrative changes in Odisha

Accordingly, in administrative field, changes were made. Odias were employed in the government services and entrusted with responsible works. This facilitates the local people to come closer to the British authority through these employees.

2.1.4. 21. Changes in the judicial procedure

Changes were also introduced in the field of judiciary. Since Persi was the court language, the Odias could not know a little of it and failed to understand the judicial procedure and verdict. Now, the judges were instructed to visit even the interior villages of a district accompanied by the Odia *Amlas* and receiving petitions from the people there and then, they redressed the grievances of the people.

2.1.4. 22. Reduction in the price of the salt

The price of the salt was reduced and more salt was made available for the smooth purchase of the people. This measure of the British government pacified the common people of Odisha in general and the people of Khurda, in particular.

2.1.4. 23. Management of the Jagannath temple of Puri

When Raja Mukundadeva II died on 30 November 1817, his son Ramachandradeva III was allowed to move to Puri. He was allowed an annual pension of Rs. 24,000 and to take over the charge of the management of the Jagannath temple of Puri. By this arrangement, the British government won the mind and sentiment of the people of Odisha.

2.1.4. 24. Reduction in the revenue burdens of the local zamindars

The British government reduced the revenue burdens of the local zamindars. The dealing with the properties was changed. In several cases, the government purchased the estates of the defaulters and restored them to the original proprietors. The Paiks, on the other hand, were dealt with scorn and contempt. They were forced to leave the profession of militial men of the king and to adopt cultivation and other works as means to earn livelihood.

2.1.4. 25. Reorganization of the British administrative structure in Odisha

The British government took adequate step to reorganize the British administrative structure in Odisha. The commissioner was appointed and vested with special powers to implement various reformative measures. Board of Revenue, Board of trade, Provincial Court of Appeal, Circuit Courts, etc. all remained under his supervision. No military administration but amity and cooperation with the local bulk, became his motto to run the administration in Odisha smoothly.

2.1.5. Conclusion

. Thus, the Paik rebellion of 1817 opened the eyes of the British government. A committee, consisting of two members, was appointed to enquire the causes and suggest remedies of the rebellion. Impey, the Magistrate of Cuttack and his successor Waiter Ewer with General Martindell looked into the factors regarding such rebellion. The economic factors, judicial maladies and mal-administration were prominent causes, as per their suggestions, that had prompted people to be rebellious. The Paik rebellion brought many changes in the administrative, judicial, economic and religious life of the people of Odisha.

2.1.6. Summary

- The 19th century Odisha witnessed a number of resistance movements of the common people, landholders, Zamindars and Feudatory Chiefs against the British Raj. Among those resistance movements, four were very severe and posed great threat to the British rule in Odisha.

- All those resistance movements occurred in Odisha due to a strong dislike for the new rule, the oppressive revenue system and high rent, threat to traditional privileges of vested landed-interests etc which had endangered the life and property of the people of Odisha.

- With the change of authorities governing Odisha in 1803, the Raja entered into an engagement with the British agreeing to pay tribute.

- There were signs of an improvement in relationship. But in 1804 troubles started concerning the Raja of Khurda and British apprehended a secret alliance between Khurda and Kanika. Even the Raja of Kujanga was expected to join this alliance against the British.

- The Raja of Khurda had surrendered the Mahals of Lambai, Rahang and Puri to the Marathas in lieu of some military help he had received for his war against the Raja of Paralakhemundi. Mukundadeva-II, the Raja of Khurdha (1795-1817) welcomed the British after their conquest of Orisssa in 1803.

- He hoped that the four Pargans (Rahang, Serain, Chaubiskud and Lembai) lost to the Marathas would be restored to him by the British. Since the king was a minor, his regent Jayakrisna Rajguru or Jayi Rajguru went to Cuttack to present his case for the restoration of the Parganas and a reduction of annual Peshkash.

- They refused both the demands. Instead, they pressurised the king to execute an agreement on lines dictated by them. They wanted the king to dismiss Rajguru.

- Jai Rajguru read the evil designs of the British. He made an alliance among the Chiefs of Khurdha, Kujanaga and Kanika states. The king of Khurdha made all preparations for confrontation with the British.

- An attempt to negotiate through Captain Blunt with the Raja of Khurda proved futile on account of the intervention of Jayi Rajguru. A contingent of 250 cavalry soldiers and 900 Barkandazes from Khurda entered into Lembai, Rahang and Puri.
- On hearing this news Captain Hickland, who was stationed at Pipili marched with an army of 120 Sepoys and defeated the Raja's force on 22 November 1804.
- Harcourt also proceeded from Cuttack against the Raja of Khurda. The fort of the Raja was besieged by Capt. Storey. Harcourt engaged Shaikh Waz Muhmmad, a native of Cuttack to reduce the fort of Banpur and through him captured the Raja's brothers and son. Subsequently, the Raja was also captured on 3 January 1805 and taken to Cuttack.
- After subduing Khurda, Harcourt despatched a small contingent towards Nayagarh to capture Antaji and Kannoji. Two Maratha agents of Nagpur through whom the Raja of Khurda sought help and himself proceeded towards Kujang and Kanika via Gop.
- As a result of which the British captured the fort of Khurdha in December 1804. The fugitive king was arrested by the treachery of one Fateh Muhammad in January 1805.
- The Raja of Kanika, Balabhadra Bhanja was made a prisoner. The Raja of Kujang was replaced by his elder brother.
- The regent of the king of Khurda, Jayakrisna Rajguru or Jayi Rajguru was hanged. Khurdha was confiscated and brought under the direct (khas) management of the British.
- The Raja was given an allowance for the administration of Jagannath temple. His headquarters was fixed at Puri. He retained the title of Maharaja without any kingdom.
- Thus, resistance movement of Khurda was a significant event in the history of modern Odisha.
- The Paik rebellion of 1817 was one of the significant event in the history of modern Odisha.
- There were many causes which led to the outbreak of the Paik Rebellion of 1817.
- The exploitative policies of the British administration which became increasingly intolerable for the people of Odisha.
- The faulty revenue policy of the British government adversely affected the local zamindars and the royats. The British salt monopoly was another cause of the rebellion.

- The introduction of new currency- system of the British authority in Odisha was another factor for the Paik rebellion.
- The then political condition of Khurda, made its people rebellious.
- The displeasure of Buxi Jagabandhu was the immediate cause for the outbreak of the Paik rebellion.
- On 29 March, 1817, began the Paik rebellion in Khurda.
- At Nayagarh, Buxi surrendered with his followers at Cuttack on 27 May, 1825. Buxi was pardoned along with his followers. His monthly allowance was fixed at Rs. 150. He lived, virtually as a prisoner at Cuttack.
- The Paik rebellion of 1817 had far reaching consequences which are given bellow.
- Accordingly, in administrative field, changes were made. Odias were employed in the government services and entrusted with responsible works.
- Changes were also introduced in the field of judiciary.
- The price of the salt was reduced and more salt was made available for the smooth purchase of the people.
- The British government reduced the revenue burdens of the local zamindars.
- The British government took adequate step to reorganize the British administrative structure in Odisha.
- . Thus, the Paik rebellion of 1817 opened the eyes of the British government.
- The Paik rebellion brought many changes in the administrative, judicial, economic and religious life of the people of Odisha.

2.1.7. Exercise

- **Discuss the resistance movement of Khurda in 19th century.**
- **Make an analysis on the course of the revolt of khurda.**
- **Discuss the causes and results of the Khurda revolt.**
- **Write a note on the causes and consequences of the Paik rebellion of 1817.**

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UNIT-2

Chapter-II

Odisha during the Revolt of 1857: Role of Surendra Sai

Structure

2.2.0. Objectives

2.2.1. Introduction

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2.2.4. Summary

2.2.6. Exercise

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2.2.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss Odisha during the Revolt of 1857- role of Surendra Sai. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the causes of the revolt of Surendra Sai*
- *understand the British measures to suppress the revolt*
- *know about the results of the revolt*
- *evaluate the revolt of Surendra Sai against the British Government*

2.2.1. Introduction

The Revolt of Surendra Sai was another landmark in the history of the resistance movement in Odisha. The British imperialism was visible with the arrival of Lord Delhousie as the Governor-General of India who wanted to grab as much as native states by the implementation of the 'Doctrine of Lapse'. When Narayan Singh was placed on the throne of Sambalpur after Mohan Kumari, Surendra Sai revolted. He was captured with his brother Udanta and uncle Balararna and they were sent to the Hazaribagh jail. Sambalpur was annexed to the British territory in 1849 with the implementation of the 'Doctrine of Lapse'. At this juncture, the Great Revolt of 1857 created circumstance for the release of Surendra Sai from that jail who gave a tough fight to the British authorities in order to assert his claim over-the throne of Sambalpur which shook the British administration in Odisha.

2.2.2. Role of Surendra Sai in the Revolt of 1817

Surendra Sai played the key role in the Revolt of 1817. As it is known that Balaramadeva, the scion of the Chauhan dynasty of Patnagarh, was instrumental in establishing the kingdom of Sambalpur in the second half of the sixteenth century. The Bhonsles of Nagpur imprisoned Jayanta Singh ans his son Maharaj Sai of the same dynasty and established their authority over the kingdom.The British occupied the land in 1804 and after due negotiation, the Maratha rule was again re-established their until 1817 when during the third Anglo-Maratha War, it was

surrendered to the British who released Jayanta Singh and his son Maharaja Sai from the Maratha clutch and placed the former on the throne of Sambalpur. After his death, Maharaja Sai was placed over the throne in 1820 because Rani Mukta Dei recommended him as the successor. Maharaja Sai died in 1827 without a son. Now the Britishers nominated, the widow of the deceased king named Rani Mohan Kumari whose claim over the throne of Sambalpur was challenged by Surendra Sai, a descendant of Raja Madhukara Sai, the fourth Raja of the Chauhan dynasty of Sambalpur.

2.2.2. 1. About Surendra Sai

Under the above circumestances, the revolt was launched by Surendra Sai. His fight against the British Governement shows his bravery and heroism. He gave a tough fight to British imperialism at Sambalpur. Born at village Khinda of Sambalpur town, he had six brothers namely, Udanta, Dhruba, Uliala, Chhabila, .Jajjla and Medini and the only sister named Anjana. The accomplished manner of Surendra popularized him among the people including the tribals such as Gonds and Binjhals. He came to eminence in 1828 when he challenged the claim of Rani Mohan Kumari to the throne of Sambalpur. Though he had gathered the popular support behind him, his claim was rejected by the British authority. The chain of events that followed one another in the following sequence, led him to raise revolt against the British Government.

2.2.2. 2. Support of Zamindars and his brothers in the revolt

Being supported by the zamindars of Khinda, Barapali, Sonepur and Gauntias and his brothers Udanta, Surendra revolted against queen Mohan Kumari. Though, Captain Wilkinson started military operation against them he was unsuccessful in quelling the rebellion. To solve the problem immediately, Wilkinson removed the queen from the throne of Sambalpur and placed one Narayan Singh, an old man of the Chauhan dynasty as king in 1833. His accession to the throne brought a great discontentment among the people of that region. In September 1837, Balabhadra Deo was killed in a skirmish at Debrigarh hills with the British sepoys and Surendra Sai escaped. Durjaya Singh, the only zamindar of Rampur was supporting Narayan Singh. Surendra attacked his house and killed his father and son. Surendra, his brother Udanta and uncle

Balarama Singh were captured in 1840. They were sent to the Hazaribag jail as political prisoners where Balarama Singh breathed his last.

2.2.2. 3. Application of the Doctrine of Lapse in Sambalpur

The death of Raja Narayan Singh on 10 September, 1849 without a male successor brought Sambalpur under the direct control of the British authority by the application of the 'Doctrine of Lapse'. J.H. Crawford, the Agent to the Governor-General, assumed the charge of the administration of Sambalpur. The economic grievances of the people of that region multiplied. With new revenue settlements, the revenue levied upon the people of that area increased. Without giving preference to the natives of the locality, the British authority settled some villages in favour of the Europeans, particularly the English people who by their tyrannical measures extracted more revenue from the people of those villages. This created gross dissatisfaction among all sections of People in Sambalpur. The tribals like Gonds, Binjhals, the feudal chiefs, the business community and the common people, etc. became enemy of the British Raj.

2.2.2. 4. Impact of the Great Revolt of 1857

When the sepoys of the Great Revolt of 1857 reached Hazaribag, they broke the two jails of Hazaribag open and liberated many prisoners in August 1857. Among the prisoners Surendra Sai and his brother Udanta were released from the jail and fled away towards Sambalpur which created political storm in Sambalpur. Both of them were welcomed by their relatives and the people of Sambalpur at large. Captain R.T. Leigh, the senior Assistant Commissioner of Sambalpur wanted to capture Surendra and his followers. The detachment which he had to receive from 40th Regiment, M.N.I., majority of that joined hands with the rebellious persons under the guidance of Surendra Sai.

2.2.2. 5. Negotiation between Surendra Sai and the British authority

Under the above circumstances, Captain Leigh was compelled to send *Parwanas* to Surendra for negotiation with the British authority. The negotiation between the two parties took place on 7 October, 1857, Surendra promised not to revolt, if the British authority would cancel the remaining terms of imprisonment awarded to him and his brother Udanta. Secondly, he should

be recognized as the king of Sambalpur. Captain Leigh agreed to the first proposal and told Surendra to stay at Sambalpur with twenty followers for the consideration of the second proposal of the latter.

2.2.2. 6. Declaration of the revolt

In the meantime, Surendra Sai sent two petitions to the Commissioner of Chhotnagpur with the same prayer. The Commissioner rejected his prayer for the throne and suggested him to stay as a political prisoner at Sambalpur. However, Captain Leigh suggested to deport the Sai brothers to Cuttack. In the meanwhile, detachments were sent to Sambalpur under Captain J. B. Knocker and Captain Hadow. Smelling something odd, Surendra Sai declared open revolt against the British authority on 1 November, 1857.

2.2.2. 7. Strategy for the revolt by Surendra and his associates

The tribal zamindars of Ghens, Kolabira, Paharsirgira, Laida, l.olsinqa, Lakhanpur, Machida, Kodabaga, Bheden, Patkulanda etc. had joined with Surendra, supporting his cause Surendra stationed his supporters in two strategic places-Jharghati and Khinda. One such party attacked captain Knocker at Jharghati, twelve miles away from Sambalpur and killed one sepoy and wounded another. Another party stopped postal communications on the Cuttack road from Nagpur to Bombay and from Sambalpur to Burma. They brought serious dislocation in the British administration.

2.2.2. 8. Operation against Surendra Sai

Looking at this, the British authority started operation against Surendra Sai. The British troops became sick while fighting with the followers of Surendra in forests. So, G.F. Cockburn, the Commissioner of Cuttack sent two medical officers namely Dr. T. Moore and Dr. D. Hanson with a small troop to look after the health of the British sepoys at Sambalpur forest areas. On 17 November, 1857 the rebels, under the leadership of Madhu Gauntia and Srikrishna Bora, attacked the two doctors and their party near Jujumura. Dr. Moore fought with the rebels and was killed. Dr. Hanson entered into the jungle and was rescued two days later by the British troops. Of course, captain Leigh visited the spot with fifty soldiers but most of his soldiers were killed and injured by the insurgents.

2.2.2. 9. Measures taken by Cockburn against Surendra

After this incident Cockburn sent military officers from Cuttack like Captions Wood, Woodbridge, Sweeny, Valiance and others to Sambalpur to help, Captain Leigh. Later on, Cockburn and Major Wyndham reached Sambalpur to carry on direct operation against the insurgents. On the other hand, the rebels took possible measures to oppose the British troops. The British authority threatened the local zamindars and Rajas to be prepared for the confiscation of their property and title if they helped the rebels. Simultaneously, they were also given the offer of several rewards to be conferred upon them, if they helped the British in suppressing the revolt. By the second week of December, 1857, 1500 rebels gathered at Sambalpur. Captain Saxton, the assistant Surveyor General was violently attacked by the rebels. On 17 December, they laced the combined attack of Lieutenant Hadow, Lieutenant Chisttlen and Hannath Singh. The insurgents fled away to jungle being unable to face the cannons of the British troops.

2.2.2. 10. Attack of Captain E.G. Wood

On 30 December, 1857, Captain E.G. Wood attacked the insurgents at Kudopali. Making the detachment under him fully prepared, Wood showed his retreat. The rebels, being unable to understand the strategy of the Captain, came out from their hiding places and attacked the retreating party. Captain Wood turned back charged his cavalry and killed 53 rebels. Surendra Sai escaped but his brother Chhabila Sai was shot dead. This encouraged the British authority to deal with the rebels more vigorously. On 7 January, 1858, Major Bates besieged the Jharghati Pass and then, attacked Kolabira, a stronghold of the insurgents. Later on, he was joined by Captain Wood.

2.2.2. 11. Murder of Wood bridge

The insurgents were thinking to avenge the murder of Chhabila Sai. Such a chance came on 12 February, 1858. Captain Woodbridge, on that particular day, besieged the fort of Paharasirgida hills. In the battle, Woodbridge was shot dead by the insurgents. Immediately, Captain Leigh, Captain Wood and Captain Dyre marched to the spot. The insurgents avoided fighting with the British troops and fled away to the jungles. Surendra Sai did not lose heart. He moved with his followers to the hills near Dewaree but the British troops appeared there promptly and brought

under their control the large store of arms and supplies of the rebels who had left the place with the approach of the British troops.

2.2.2. 12. Measures taken by Colonel Forster

The arrival of Colonel Forster who took over the charge of Sambalpur from Captain Leigh in March 1857, changed the situation dramatically. He arrested the people at random and gave them punishment. The Raja of Patna was remitted the fine of Rs. 1,000 imposed upon him previously for giving asylum to Ujjala Sai whom he captured and surrendered to Colonel Forster. He arrested and court martialled a large number of suspected rebels. The zamindaries of Kolabira, Karkutta, Bheden, Khorsal, Patkutunda and Rampur were confiscated and offered to zamindar Rai Rup Singh Bahadur as rewards who helped the British to trace out the rebels. Surendra Sai fled to the central provinces and in 1860 encamped in the zamindari of Khurral supported by the *Garjat* chiefs of Raipur. Colonel Forster did not leave his repressive measures in Sambalpur and nearby areas. So, the insurgents did not get any scope to enter into Sambalpur.

2.2.2. 13. Action of the rebels

Inspite of the efforts of Colonel Forster, the rebels under the leadership of Khageswar Deo, killed Trikait Deo of Kusumunda who acted as spy for the British. Receiving help from the *Khalsa* villages of Sambalpur, they made their camp at Barapahar. In the last week of January 1861, they attacked the village Manpura. It was only because, the people of that village had supported the British authority. The joint operation of Captain J. Smith, Lieutenant R. Dundas, Captain John Dyre and Lieutenant Cornish foiled their attempt and the rebels fled to the territory of Bamara.

2.2.2. 14. Proclamation of amnesty

Major H.B. Impey succeeded to W.R. Forster as the Deputy Commissioner of Sambalpur in April, 1861. Now, he adopted a conciliatory policy towards the rebels. He restored the zamindars their confiscated zamindaries. On 24 September and 11 October, 1861, the proclamation of amnesty were issued granting pardons to all rebels who would surrender. Many rebels and their supporters like the Rajas of Bamara, Sarangagarh and Patna, now came to help the British. Persuasion was made to Surendra Sai for his surrender but he did not pay any heed to it. Since, the plans on Impey bore no fruit, R.N. Shore the Commissioner of Cuttack moved to Sambalpur

for military operation against the rebels. Impey's persuation to Surendra for refraining from such activity, led another proclamation of amnesty in favour of the rebels. This acted like magic and many more rebels surrendered. Still then, rebels like Kartika, Sindhu, Bhuboo, Udanta, Dayal Singh and many others including Surendra Sai did not surrender. They tried to gain public sympathy for the rightful claim of Surendra to the throne of Sambalpur.

2.2.2. 15. Operation of Rattray

The operation of Major Rattray against the rebels in the last week of December, broke the spirit of the rebels to a greater extent. This led Surendra Sai to write to Impey about his surrender if his claim for the *gadi* (throne) would be considered which Impey denied. On the other hand, he assured Surendra of liberal provision for his maintenance. Thus, on the historic day of 16 May, 1862, Surendra Sai with his 40 followers, surrendered before Major Impey who guaranted him free pardon. A pension of Rs. 1,200 and an amount of Rs. 4,600 per annum were granted to Surendra Sai and his family respectively. It was decided that Surendra would stay in the village Bargaon.

Peace and tranquillty now prevailed over Sambalpur. Kunjal Singh and Kamal Singh, the two rebellious leaders did not surrender. In March 1863, the Chief Commissioner Richard Temple visited Sambalpur. The prominent persons of the district appealed Richard Temple to restore the Chauhan dynasty to the throne of Sambalpur and that prayer was outrightly rejected by the Chief Commissioner J.N. Berrill, the Superintendent of Police of Sambalpur, revealed that Surendra had link with the dacoits. It was also suggested that Surendra had instigated the people to make such representation to the Chief Commissioner for his restoration to the *gadi* of Sambalpur. Now, Impey was pressurised to imprison Surendra Sai. However, he rejected that plea and retained his full faith in the honesty and integrity of Surendra Sai.

2.2.2. 16. Ruthless measures taken by Major A.B. Cumberledge

After the death of Major Impey, Major A.B. Cumberledge took over the charge of the administration of Sambalpur as the Deputy Commissioner. He had no faith on the conciliatory policy of Impey. Some British officers like Captain Stewart, the Deputy Inspector General of Police of Chhatisgarh Division and J.N. Berill, the Superintendent of Police of Sambalpur impressed Cumberledge that Surendra Sai and his followers had been planning to wage war

against Her Majesty's government. Charged with anger, a party headed by Cumberledge, surrounded the house of Surendra Sai at Bargaon in the night of 23 January, 1864. Of course, Surendra had left the house by that time only to be captured at Sambalpur by the treachery of Dayanidhi. Subsequently, Mitrabhanu Sai, the son of Surendra, Dhruba Sai, Udanta Sai, Dharanidhara Misra and others were captured and imprisoned.

2.2.2. 17. Trial of Surendra Sai

The trial of Surendra Sai and others began at the Sessions Court at Raipur on 23 June, 1864. J.B: Balmain examined the reports and held Surendra Sai, Udanta, Dhruba, Khageswar Deo and many others guilty for the treason and sentenced them to transportation for life with the confiscation of their all property. The accused rebel leaders appealed to John Scarlett Campbell the judicial Commissioner of the Central Provinces against the verdict of the Sessions Court. After hearing the petition, Campbell delivered his judgement on 18 August, 1864 completely reversing the judgment of the Sessions Court. The court found the judgment of the sessions court as unacceptable.

2.2.2. 18. Last days of Surendra

The order of the judicial commissioner completely exposed the malafied intention of the government officers of Sambalpur. However, Richard Temple justified the arrest of Surendra Sai and other rebels by the administrative and police action of the government officers at Sambalpur. Under Regulation III of 1818, Surendra Sai and other six prisoners like Udanta, Dhruba, Medini, Mitrabhanu, Khageswer Deo and Lokanath Panda were ordered to be detained in the Nagpur jail being transferred from Raipur. In 1866, Surendra and others appealed through Attorney M.T. Pearson to the Governor-General-in-Council against their illegal detention even after their acquittal by the Judicial Commissioner of the Central Province. The petition was rejected by the Governor-General-in-Council. Petitions were filed again in 1871 and 1876. By that time, Medini Sai and Lokanath Panda had already breathed their last. On 22 November, 1876, Dhruba Sai and Mitrabhanu Sai were released by the surety given by the king of Bonai. on 28 February, 1884, Surendra Sai died in the cell of Asirgarh. With his death, ended the Sambalpur revolt.

2.2.2. 19. Results of the revolt of Surendra Sai

Although Surendra Sai got failed to get the *Gadi* , but the effects of the revolt, launched by Surendra Sai were far reaching.

2.2.2. 1. Peace and stability established in Sambalpur

With the arrest of Surendra Sai and his subsequent imprisonment, peace, tranquility and political stability were restored in Sambalpur. The government officers got a fresh relief from the task of dealing with the rebels. The sleepless nights they had passed inside the jungles and the encounters they had with the rebels, now ended for them.

2.2.2. 20. Impositions of restrictions on the local zamindars

The British authority imposed restrictions on the local zamindars and regulated their activities. Henceforth, they never become the undisputed masters of their localities. The system of *bethi* and *begari* was abolished. Besides, effective measures were taken in regard to a regular land revenue settlement in Sambalpur.

2.2.2. 21. Transfer of Sambalpur into the Central Province and Odisha Division

In 1864, Sambalpur was transferred to the Central Province. It created a lot of problems for the administrative authority due to the ethnic and linguistic differences of Sambalpur with the districts of the Central Provinces. As a result of which, Sambalpur was again transferred to the Odisha Division of Bengal in 1905.

2.2.2. 22. British imperialism

Further, the British imperialism was totally felt by the people of that region. The manner in which the claims of Surendra Sai was set aside, the way Surendra and his supporters were allegedly captured and imprisoned after the verdict of the judicial commissioner etc. exposed the British authoritative attitude towards the people of that region. Of course, by these coercive methods, the British government was successful in suppressing the revolt launched against it by Surendra Sai.

2.2.2. 23. Sambalpur remained permanently under the British control

With the suppression of the revolt, Sambalpur remained permanently under the British clutch. No cry for the restoration of the Chauhan dynasty to the *gadi* of Sambalpur was heard hereafter. The revolt proved that whatever powerful might be the local rebels, they could not withstand the British power that ultimately suppressed them.

2.2. 3. Conclusion

Thus, the revolt by Surendra Sai was anti-British in nature as he could not get the *Gadi*. It was rebellion against the unlawful annexation of Sambalpur under 'Doctrine of Lapse' to the British suzerainty ignoring the rightful claim of Surendra Sai. In course of time, not only the local people, zamindars, the kings but the tribal people of Sambalpur and the nearby area at large, supported the cause of Surendra Sai. Primarily, it was an uprising, a resistance movement where the tribal bulk played a dominant role. Although, the revolt of Surendra Sai got failure, but it had stirred the British administration in Odisha.

2.2.4. Summary

- The Revolt of Surendra Sai was another landmark in the history of the resistance movement in Odisha.
- The British imperialism was visible with the arrival of Lord Delhousie as the Governor-General of India who wanted to grab as much as native states by the implementation of the 'Doctrine of Lapse'.
- When Narayan Singh was placed on the throne of Sambalpur after Mohan Kumari, Surendra Sai revolted.
- He was captured with his brother Udanta and uncle Balararna and they were sent to the Hazaribagh jail. Sambalpur was annexed to the British territory in 1849 with the implementation of the 'Doctrine of Lapse'.
- At this juncture, the Great Revolt of 1857 created circumstance for the release of Surendra Sai from that jail who gave a tough fight to the British authorities in order to assert his claim over-the throne of Sambalpur which shook the British administration in Odisha.

- Surendra Sai played the key role in the Revolt of 1817.
- The accomplished manner of Surendra popularized him among the people including the tribals such as Gonds and Binjhals.
- He came to eminence in 1828 when he challenged the claim of Rani Mohan Kumari to the throne of Sambalpur.
- Being supported by the zamindars of Khinda, Barapali, Sonepur and Gauntias and his brothers Udanta, Surendra revolted against queen Mohan Kumari.
- When the sepoys of the Great Revolt of 1857 reached Hazaribag, they broke the two jails of Hazaribag open and liberated many prisoners in August 1857.
- Among the prisoners Surendra Sai and his brother Udanta were released from the jail and fled away towards Sambalpur which created political storm in Sambalpur.
- The negotiation between the two parties took place on 7 October, 1857, Surendra promised not to revolt, if the British authority would cancel the remaining terms of imprisonment awarded to him and his brother Udanta.
- Surendra Sai declared open revolt against the British authority on 1 November, 1857.
- Looking at this, the British authority started operation against Surendra Sai.
- On the historic day of 16 May, 1862, Surendra Sai with his 40 followers, surrendered before Major Impey who guaranted him free pardon.
- However, due to the effort of Major A.B. Cumberledge, Surendra was arrested and after trial he was sent to Asirgarh jail.
- On 28 February, 1884, Surendra Sai died in the cell of Asirgarh jal.
- Thus, the revolt by Surendra Sai was anti-British in nature as he could not get the *Gadi*.
- It was rebellion against the unlawful annexation of Sambalpur under ‘Doctrine of Lapse’ to the British suzerainty ignoring the rightful claim of Surendra Sai.
- Although, the revolt of Surendra Sai got failure, but it had stirred the British administration in Odisha.

2.2.6. Exercise

- **Write a note on the revolt of 1857 and the role of Surendra Sai in the revolt.**
- **Discuss the causes and results of the Revolt of Surendra Sai.**
- **Highlight the measures taken by the British to suppress the rebellion of Surendra Sai.**
- **Make an analysis on the Revolt of Surendra Sai.**

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UNIT-2

Chapter-III

Tribal uprising- Ghumsar Rising under Dora Bisoi, Khond Rising under Chakra Bisoi, Bhuyan Rising Under Ratna Naik and Dharani Dhar Naik

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2.3.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss Tribal uprising- Ghumsar Rising under Dora Bisoi, Khond Rising under Chakra Bisoi, Bhuyan Rising Under Ratna Naik and Dharani Dhar Naik. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the Ghumsar Rising under Dora Bisoi*
- *understand the Khond Rising under Chakra Bisoi*
- *know about the Bhuyan Rising Under Ratna Naik and Dharani Dhar Naik*

2.3.1. Introduction

The 19th century witnessed a number of tribal rebellions against the British rule in India as well as Odisha. All those rebellions occurred due to strong dislike for the new rule, the oppressive revenue system, high rent, threat to traditional privileges of the tribal people, etc. Besides that the British policy of intervention in their religion, social reforms further aggravated the situation. The missionary activities carried on massively in different tribal area and steps taken against their ruler largely contributed to the tribal uprising. The Ghumsur rebellion under the leadership of Dora Bisoi and Chakra Bisoi, Bhuyan rising under the leadership of Ratna Naik and Dharanidhar Naik and the Munda uprising under the leadership of Birsa Munda are some of the important tribal uprisings of Odisha against the British authority.

2.3.2. Ghumsur rising under Dora Bisoi

The growing discontent among the tribals of Ghumsur from the beginning of British rule under the Madras authority. The British did not pay proper attention for the administration of

Ghumsur. In due course of time, the tribals of Ghumsur led by Dora Bisoi started rebellion against the British authority.

2.3.2. 1. Factors responsible for the discontent of Dora Bisoi

There were many factors which led Dora to revolt against the British. First, the suppression of *Meriah* in the Kandha dominated area of Ghumsur was a direct attack of British on the traditional religious faith of the Kandhas. Along with that the activities of the Christian missionaries, infuriated the Kandhas and made them rebellious. Secondly, the land revenue up to 50% was collected from the people through forceful method which wounded the sentiment of the tribals. So, the tribal people became irritated and wanted to take revenge against the British. Thirdly, the Bhanja rulers of Ghumsur had no friendly relation with the British. Being apprehensive to be captured by the British authority, Dhananjay Bhanja the ruler of Ghumsur fled to the jungle and sought the assistance of the Kandhas. The Kandhas wanted to help him as he was their ruler. Lastly, the dissolution of the Bhanja ruling family after the death of Dhananjay Bhanja in 1835 became the immediate cause of the rebellion. After his death, Brundaban Bhanja and Jagannath Bhanja, two members of the royal family became rebellious and got the supported by Dora Bisoi, the tribal chief of the Kandhas of Ghumsur.

2.3.2. 2. Revolt of Dora Bisoi

The Kandha tribe rose in rebellion under the leadership of Kamal Lochan Dora Bisoi. He was Benniah Kandha born in the village Binjigiri, located near Kullada of the lower Ghumsur area. He was a 'Maliah Bisoi' or 'Head Agent' of the Kandhas of Ghumsur area of Odisha. He was a good sword-fighter and a wrestler of high quality. Therefore, he became the leader of the Kandhas and 'Agent of Kandha attairs' to the king of Ghumsur. He was appointed as the Commander-in-chief of the Ghumsur army. He had managed the military affairs of Ghumsur in a good manner. While fighting with the British army, he had given a top fight to the British authority at Ghumsur.

2.3.2. 3. British measures to stop the rebellion

In order suppress the rebellion of Dora Bisoi, the British authorities took several measures. When the rebellion of Dora Bisoi became intolerable, the British authority under the

Madras Presidency sent George Edward Russel to suppress the rebellion under Dora. During this time, Dhananjay Bhanja who had left Ghumsur had taken shelter under the Kandhas of Ghumsur. However, it is supposed that instead of paying revenue to the British Government, he had taken much amount of money with him to continue and support the rebellion in association with the Kandhas of Ghumsur. In the mean while Russel reached Ghumsur on 11 January 1836 to suppress the rebellion. He had a grand army with him to fight with the Kandhas. In spite of that the British Government of India had ordered the superintendents of the Tributary Mahals to render habitual help to Russel to suppress the rebellion.

2.3.2. 4. Preparation of Dora Bisoi for the rebellion

During this critical time Raja Dhananjay Bhanja died on 31 December, 1835 leaving his family to the care of the Kandhas of Ghumsur. At this critical hour, persons like Brundaban Bhanja, Jagannath Bhanja, Madhu Bhanja, Baliar Singh, Sundaray Bisoi, Sangram Singh, Nanda Bisoi and many others came forward to strengthen the hands of Dora in the rebellion against the British authority. As these tribal leaders were residing in the forest, they were quite acquainted with the jungle area. They took the benefit of it and resorted to Guerrilla warfare in this rebellion. Now Dora as the leader of the rebellion planned to fight against the British by concealing themselves in the jungles and ghaties and to make sudden attacks on the British army.

2.3.2. 5. The British operation

In order to capture the family members of Dhananjay Bhanja, Captain Butler on 14th February, 1836, led the British troop to the Ghats He had two point responsibilities to perform (1) to capture the royal members and (2) to rescue to treasury which had been taken by Dhananjay Bhanja. Dora had instigated the Kandhas to resort to aggression against the British troop. When the British troop reached the Ghats to make a head way to Udaygiri, they faced resistance from the Kandhas. When the British troops forcibly took away the fowls of the Kandha villages, they invited the hostility with the Kandhas of Ghumsur.

2.3.2. 6. Resistance by the Kandhas

In the mean time, the rebellious Kandhas attacked a British detachment between Udaygiri and Durga Prasad. In that encounter, thirteen soldiers (sepoys) and two European officers named

Lieutenant Bromly and Ensign Gibbon were killed. Prior to that the British forces had captured some Kandhas and took others as prisoners after this incident. On the other hand, the Kandhas under Dora Bisoi gave a tough resistance to the British forces. By this, the British also became cruel to suppress the rebellious Kandhas of Ghumsur.

2.3.2. 7. Special operation of British forces to arrest Dora Bisoi

In order to arrest Dora, the British entered into Ambhajhara and Jiripada but they could not get success. Till that time Dora was playing as the key leader of the movement. The British searched in many places to arrest him. He moved from place to place and at last sought refuge at Angul. Being failure to capture Dora Bisoi, the British, declared a prize of 5,000 rupees who would capture him. In this connection, the Tributary Chief of Angul betrayed him. At the instruction of Henry Ricketts, the Commissioner of Odisha, Raja Somnath Singh of Angul had played a very important role in surrendering Dora Bisoi. Lastly, Raja Somanath Singh of Angul handed over Dora Bisoi to the British forces in 1837.

2.3.2. 8. Results of the revolt

After the capture of their leader Dora Bisoi, other rebellious leaders were captured later. They were tried and awarded severe punishment. As a result of which Dora received life imprisonment and died inside the Ooty prison in 1846. 40 rebellious persons were awarded death sentences, 29 received confinement for life and 2 others received the same sentence for 8 years. Similarly, others got imprisonment who were involved in the rebellion of Ghumsur.

After the arrest of Dora Bisoi and other rebellious leaders, the British Government made new agreement with the Kandhas. The British appointed Sam Bisoi as the Chief of the Kandhas who had played a great role to capture of Kamal Lochan Dora. After this, the rebellion organized Dora Bisoi ended.

2 .3. 3. Kandha rebellion under Chakra Bisoi

The Kandha rebellion did not stop after Dora's imprisonment and death. His nephew, Chakra Bisoi, took Dora's place and resolved to take revenge for his uncle's imprisonment and death. He posed a great threat to the British authority.

2 .3. 3.1. Factors responsible for the rebellion under Chakra

The Kandhas under Chakra Bisoi were instigated to make rebellion against the British Raj. The following factors were responsible for this rebellion. (1) the death of Dora Bisoi, had left a scar in the mind of Chakra. He wanted to take revenge of the death of his uncle Dora Bisoi. (2) the actions of S.C. Macpherson, the Meriah Agent disturbed the Kandhas a lot as he had interfered in the religion of the Kandhas. He rescued *Meriahs* and threatened the Kandhas of dire consequences who violated the law regarding Meriah. Further, he punished the Kandhas mercilessly. (3) on the other hand, Captain Macpherson was humiliated in his camp at Bisipara in 1846. He was forced by the Kandha revolutionaries to surrender the Meriahs whom he had rescued from the Kandha area. Otherwise the Kandhas would have killed him. This achievement of the Kandhas under the leadership of Chakra made them courageous. Finally, the Kandhas installed Pitambar, the minor son of Dhananjay Bhanja as the king of Ghumsur. This emboldened them and being surcharged with enthusiasm, they looted the British camp. The above factors forced the British Government to plan to supress the rebellion of the Kandhas under Chakra Bisoi.

2 .3. 3.2. British plan to capture Chakra Bisoi

Looking into the above factors, Macpherson did not follow the policy of appeasement with the Kandhas. The British Government realized that his presence as a Meriah agent was detrimental to the smooth functioning of British administration at Ghumsur. In order to bring the situation under control, the Madras Presidency appointed Lt. Col. Campbell as the Meriah Agent who succeeded Macpherson. However, Campbell was a man of different attitude. He followed a convincing policy and tried to win over the Kandhas of Ghumsur. So, the Kandhas promised to abstain from Meriah sacrifice. In this way trial was made to persuade the Kandhas and to make unfriendly with Chakra Bisoi.

2 .3. 3.3. Role of Somnath Singh in the rebellion

By his strategy Campbell won most of the Kandhas to his side. However, Chakra Bisoi did not come under the influence of the British authority. He organized rebellions of the Kandhas against the British forces. It was alleged that Chakra Bisoi and Nabghan Konhoro were assisted by Somnath Singh, the King of Angul. After this, the British Government followed a new policy towards the rebellion. He pardoned both Chakra and Nabghan in order to suppress the rebellion. The policy bore fruit and Nabghan surrendered. However, Dora did not surrender to the British authority. This made the British authority to become skeptic about Somnath Singh and wanted to take severe actions against Somanath Singh of Angul.

As a result of which Somnath picked up his quarrel with the British in 1846. He forcibly took possession of a village of Hindol. For that offence he was fined Rs. 3,000/-. The King tried to protest but he could not get success. On the other hand, Lt. Col. Campbellwas authorized to march towards Angul to suppress Somnath Singh. In 1848, Angul was confiscated and Somnath Singh was sent as a prisoner to the Hazaribagh Jail. He had to pay heavy price for supporting Chakra Bisoi in the rebellion against the British authority.

2 .3. 3. 4. British attempt to Capture Chakra

Then the British made many attempts to capture Chakra Bisoi. The capture of Rendo Majhi, the leader of the Borikiya Kandhas of Kalahandi and the successive attack on the camp of A.C. Mac Neill who succeed Campbell as Meriah Agent led British to conclude that Chakra Bisoi was behind the attack. Meanwhile G.F. Cockburn who succeeded Samuells as the Superintendent of the Tributary Mahals wanted to take steps against Chakra. In the meanwhile, the Zamindar of Madanpur was accused of giving shelter to Chakra. So, he was removed from his zamindary. Although, R.M. Macdonald sent troop to capture Dharam Singh Mandhata of Athagaon who had given shelter to Chakra, was arrested.

2 .3. 3. 5. Chakra's strategy

Looking at the strategy of the British forces, Chakra never stopped in his mission against the British. He could know that the Savaras of Parlakhemundi were rising against the British under the leadership of Dandasena of Gaiba. Taking this opportunity, Chakra united the Savaras and Kandhas and instigated them to set fire and plunder those villages which did not support Dandasena. Captain Wilson moved to suppress this rebellion and captured Dandasena who was

captured and hanged. After that Chakra moved from Parlakhemundi to the area of Tel valley. Looking at the threat of the British authority, the king of Patna could not help Chakra Bisoi. So, in order to save himself, Chakra entered into the forests of Kandhamal. The Govt. of Bengal learnt the connection of Baud and ordered for the annexation of Kandhamal into the British territory in 1855. From that time nothing was known about Chakra Bisoi. He was never captured. He died in 1856. However, in 1857 G.F. Cockburn, the Commissioner of Odisha wrote to the Government regarding Chakra that perhaps he has abandoned this country. For a decade from 1846 to 1856, the activities of Chakra became a severe headache to the British authority.

2 .3. 3.6. Conclusion

Thus, the Kandha rebellion under Dora Bisoi and Chakra Bisoi is significant in the history of Odisha in particular and India in general. The role played by both Dora Bisoi and Chakra Bisoi in this Tribal uprising was commendable. The British failed to capture him even though efforts were made to capture Chakra Bisoi. However, it is beyond doubt that this tribal rebellion under the Kandha leaders like Dora Bisoi and Chakra Bisoi had given a tough challenge to the British authority in the early part of the British administration in Odisha. Although, the rebellion could not bring much result, but it had the shaken the British authority in Odisha.

2 .3. 4. Bhuyan rising under Ratna Naik

One of the prominent rising of the tribal in Odisha history was the Bhuyan rising of Ratna Naik of Keonjhar. Ratna Naik organized the tribal of Keonjhar to fight against the British Governement.

2 .3. 4. 1. Quarrel for succession to the throne

After the death of Maharaja, Gadadhar Bhanja of Keonjhar, his eldest son Dhanurjay became the king in 1861. At that time he was minor. He was the son of his *phulabivahi* or concubine wife. This was taken with a pinch of salt by Pattamahadei (chief queen) Bishnupriya. She submitted a petition before T.E. Ravenshaw that before his death, the king of Keonjhar had proposed to accept Brundaban Bhanja as the legal hair to the throne of Keonjhar.

2 .3. 4. 2. British approach towards the issue

T.E. Ravenshaw went through the petition of queen Bishnupriya and rejected it. The queen sent a petition to the Calcutta High Court but it was also rejected. Being depressed the queen appealed to the Privy Council at London. It also went unheard. After this incident, the queen got revolted.

2 .3. 4. 3. Queen's request to the tribal leaders

Being disgusted, the queen appealed to Ratna Naik to do the needful. The Bhuyans and the Juangs were now ready to fight for the cause of the queen. This was a great challenge to the British authority. The queen's appeal was well responded.

2 .3. 4. 4. Leadership of Ratna Naik

Ratna Naik was born at Tarpur village of Keonjhar district in 1820. He was very brave from the beginning. He was quite aware about the autocratic rule of Dhanurjay. As the leader of the Bhuyans, he organized them and raised them to fight against Dhanurjay. The new king had taken away their rights and privileges. Their plights were not heard by the king. They suffered a lot under the new regime. As, T.E. Ravenshaw had performed the coronation ceremony of Dhanurjay, he had no fear to anybody. Ratna Naik emerged to put an end to the regime of Dhanurjay.

2 .3. 4. 5. Plan of Bhuyans

Ratna Naik organised the Bhuyans. All of them with the queen Bishnupriya wanted to have a plan. So, the queen left the palace of Keonjhargarh and came to Basantpur. She met Ratna Naik and other Bhuyans and Juangs. All of them took a vow to oust Dhanurjay Bhanja from the throne of Keonjhar. They became ready to have a tough fight with the king.

2 .3. 4. 6. T.E. Ravenshaw's mediation for negotiation

The informers gave news to T.E. Ravenshaw that a *meli* was going to take place against Dhanurjay. T.E. Ravenshaw was very clever. He wanted to settle the dispute of the royal family in a peaceful means. He persuaded the king and the queen to come to a negotiation. Accordingly, the queen came to Keonjhargarh palace. Dhanurjay was again coronated and the queen blessed him.

2 .3. 4. 7. Revolt of Ratna Naik

This activity of the queen appeared as a betrayal to Ratna Naik. He organized the Bhuyans, Juangs, Kohlas and declared that until they place King Brundaban Bhanj, they would not leave the fight. In his venture other leaders like Nanda Naik, Nanda Pradhan, Babu Naik, Dasarathi Kuanr, Padu Naik and others helped him. On 28 April 1868, he entered into the palace with his supporters and kidnapped the Dewan and many officers of the Court of Dhanurjay Bhanja.

2 .3. 4. 8. British measures to suppress the rebellion

The British Government took steps to putdown the rebellion. Dr. W. Hayes, the Deputy Gommissioner of Singhbhum visited Keonjhargarh on 7 May 1768 with a contingent of armed forces. The followers of Ratna Naik had killed the Dewan. Dr. Hayes shouted for the surrender of the rebels. Ratna Naik did not care for that and escaped the notice of the Deputy Commissioner. On the other hand, they captured some policemen. They cut off the postal service between Chaibasa and Cuttack. This move of the rebellious leader put the British administration in trouble. Now Colonel E.T. Dalton, the Commissioner of Chhotnagpur marched with contingent to Keonjhargarh palace. He was opposed on the way and it became difficult on his part to reach Keonjhargarh in June. Then Dalton opened the Pandora’s box. The Bhuyan houses were sat on fire. On the demand of the British Government, the kings of Bonai, Mayurbhanj, Pal Lahara and Dhenkanal sent their Paiks to help Dalton. The Bhuyans under the leadership of Ratna Naik fought back to the wall. T.E. Ravenshaw also reached Keonjhargarh. Ratna Naik and Nanda Naik surrendered and the 'Ratna meli came to an end.

2 .3. 4. 9. Result of Ratna’s revolt

The result of the Ratna Naik's rebellion was far reaching. It enraged the Bhuyans of Keonjhar. Queen Bishnupriya lived at Cuttack for the rest of her life. Ratna Naik was awarded capital punishment with six others. Thus, Ratna meli came to an end. Thus, the Bhuyans under Ratna Naik gave a toe challenge to the British regime. Although Ratna Naik's rebellion ended in a smoke but the Bhuyans did not stop there. They revolted against the British authority more vigorously under the leadership of Dharani Naik.

2 .3. 5. Bhuyan rising under Dharanidhar Naik

The revolt of Dharanidhar Naik, a Bhuyan leader of Keonjhar against Dhanurjay Bhanja constitutes another inglorious chapter during the British rule in Odisha. The Bhuyans became more organised under his leadership and challenged the king. Of course, the British Government ruthlessly suppressed it.

2 .3. 5. 1. Factors responsible for the revolt of Dharani Naik

The causes of the discontentment of the Bhuyans were many. They had to render *bethi* to the king. This was a burden which the Bhuyans had to suffer. They wanted to discard this practice. Secondly, King Dhanurjay Bhanja was a tyrannical ruler. His administration was the other name of exploitation. The tribal people were grossly exploited by the king which made them violent in later stage. Thirdly, the appointment of Fakir Mohan Senapati as a Diwan of Keonjhargarh was not liked by Dharanidhar Bhuyan, the leader of the Bhuyans. Somehow or other, they thought that Fakir Mohan Senapati was a stumbling block to their progress. Fourthly, the role of Bichitrananda Das, a constant adviser to King Dhanurjay precipitated the situation. For building a dam across the stream Machha Kandana, he ordered the Bhuyans and other tribes to engage themselves in the building of this dam. It was difficult on their part to do this forced labour after maintaining their family through a little earning. This gave a spark to the outbreak of the revolt. Finally, the dissatisfaction of Dharani Naik gave a final shape to the Bhuyan uprising in Keonjhar. The way he had to lose his job through treachery led him to be rebellious and they began the 'Dharani meli'.

2 .3. 5. 2. Life and work of Dharanidhar Naik

Dharanidhar Naik was born on 5 May 1864 at Kusumita village from Baigani Devi and Laichhan Naik. After receiving education in the locality, Dharanidhar was sent to Tulsipur at Cuttack to receive survey overseer training. After completion of training he returned to Keonjhar and at last he was absorbed in the service of the State of Dhanurjay Bhanja. His regards for work drew nearer to the administration. However, Bichitrananda Das could not tolerate Dharanidhar. Meanwhile, Dharanidhar was entrusted with the task of settling a dispute between Lungikud and Godhuli. He accomplished the task and sent the map and other records with a Paik to handover it to King Dhanurjay. He then went to the house of his sister at Padmapur. The clever Bichitrananda managed to get all these papers from the Paik and endorsed it from an English

officer that he had done the work. He submitted the papers to Dhanurjay who was dissatisfied with Dharanidhar and dismissed him from service. This treachery made Dharanidhar furious who wanted to settle score with Dhanurjay Bhanja and Bichitrananda.

2 .3. 5. 3. Revolt of Dharanidhar

Now Dharanidhar gathered around him the Ehuyans, Kohlas and Juangs around him and became their leader. Dharanidhar proceeded with him to Champakpur and killed Nanda Dhal, the former Diwan of the king. After receiving this news the king left the palace and went to Anandpur. Fakir Mohan Senapati, the Dewan of Keonjhargarh proceeded to meet G.Toynbee, the Commissioner at Cuttack, but he was captured by Dharanidhar on the way. Now H.Dowson, the Deputy Commissioner of Chaibasa marched Keonjhargarh to putdown the rebellion. Dhanurjay went to Cuttack to meet the Commissioner. Being furious, the rebels looted the houses of the officers who did not support them. They broke the gates of the royal prison and freed the prisoners. Fakir Mohan Senapati, who was captive by Dharanidhar now by the latter's permission wrote a letter to his friend Bholanath Dey, a Court Surveyor at Anandpur to send 100 betel leaves and 200 betel nuts for the Queen's son Dharanidhar who was very fond of betel. The sugarcane field is to be irrigated by digging canal from the north. Otherwise, the sugarcane field will be destroyed. A wire was attached with the letter. Meanwhile, Dharanidhar had declared himself as the adopted son of the queen of Keonjhargarh who never wanted Dhanurjay to continue as the king of Keonjhar. This letter was well interpreted and instruction was given to attack the palace from northern side by bullets of the sepoys. Dharanidhar was advised by Fakir Mohan to meet Dawson Sahib to obtain his grace. Dharanidhar obeyed it and met Dawson near Ruchir village. As per the previous plan, he was captured and arrested.

2 .3. 5. 4. Consequences of the revolt

With the capitulation of Dharanidhar and other rebels, the *meli* came to an end. Dharanidhar was tried and sent to Cuttack Central Jail for 7 years. Other rebels also got imprisonment. Being released from Cuttack Jail in 1897, Dharanidhar changed the way of his life. He lived at Banki Muhana nearer to Puri in a hermitage and breathed his last in 1944. With him ended a chapter of revolt associated with Keonjhar which was aimed against the British Raj.

The result of the Dharani *meli* were far reaching. At first, the British Government realised the discontentment of the subjects of Keonjhargarh. So, the British agent H.P. Wylly came and took over the charge of Keonjhargarh. Secondly, Fakir Mohan resigned and left Keonjhargarh. Durga Das Mukherjee was appointed in his place. He concentrated on the developmental projects of the kingdom Thirdly, the administration at Keonjhar now became humane. The subjects were not treated with scorn and contempt. Their grievances were heard with due justice. The revolt of Dharanidhar opened the eyes of the authority who now took keen interest to solve the problem of the subjects. Fourthly, Dhanurjay Bhanja submitted a petition to the Commissioner to restore him to the throne of Keonjhargarh. After much consideration his petition was accepted and he got back his throne. However, a Political Agent was to be appointed there to have a check on his authority. Accordingly, Ray Bahadur Nanda Kishore Das was appointed as the Political Agent.

Fifthly, the followers of Dharanidhar Bhuyan like Mani Mohapatra, Aguan Singh and Banamali MahaNaik were sentenced to transportation for life. Others were given sentences of imprisonment.

Finally, this rebellion opened the eye of the British Government. They wanted to make their rule by effectively implementing their administration with a touch of humanity. In this way, the Dharani *meli* of Keonjhar came to a dead end by the British intervention. Of course, the injustice done to Dharanidhar Naik was not met with justice. His effort was commendable and his name still glitters as a great son of the soils.

2 .3. 6. Conclusion

Thus, the tribal uprisings were due to strong dislike for the new rule, the oppressive revenue system, high rent, threat to traditional privileges of the tribal people, etc. Moreover, the British policy of intervention in their religion, social reforms further aggravated the revolutionary condition among the tribal people of Odisha. The missionary activities in different tribal areas further aggravated the situation for the tribal uprising. The Ghumsur rising under the leadership of Dora Bisoi and Chakra Bisoi, Bhuyan rising under the leadership of Ratna Naik and Dharanidhar Naik against the British government were some of the burning examples of it.

2 .3. 7. Summary

- The 19th century witnessed a number of tribal rebellions against the British rule in India as well as Odisha.
- All those rebellions occurred due to strong dislike for the new rule, the oppressive revenue system, high rent, threat to traditional privileges of the tribal people, etc.
- The Ghumsur rebellion under the leadership of Dora Bisoi and Chakra Bisoi, Keonjhar rebellion under the leadership of Ratna Naik and Dharanidhar Naik and the Munda uprising under the leadership of Birsa Munda are some of the important tribal uprisings of Odisha against the British authority.
- The Kandha tribe rose in rebellion under the leadership of Kamal Lochan Dora Bisoi. In order suppress the rebellion of Dora Bisoi, the British authorities took several measures.
- When the rebellion of Dora Bisoi became intolerable, the British authority under the Madras Presidency sent George Edward Russel to suppress the rebellion under Dora.
- At the instruction of Henry Ricketts, the Commissioner of Odisha, Raja Somnath Singh of Angul had played a very important role in surrendering Dora Bisoi. Lastly, Raja Somanath Singh of Angul handed over Dora Bisoi to the British forces in 1837.
- The Kandha rebellion did not stop after Dora's imprisonment and death.
- His nephew, Chakra Bisoi, took Dora's place and resolved to take revenge for his uncle's imprisonment and death.
- He posed a great threat to the British authority.
- Thus, the Kandha rebellion under Dora Bisoi and Chakra Bisoi is significant in the history of Odisha in particular and India in general.
- One of the prominent rising of the tribal in Odisha history was the Bhuyan rising of Ratna Naik of Keonjhar.
- Ratna Naik organized the tribal of Keonjhar to fight against the British Governement.

- After the death of Maharaja, Gadadhar Bhanja of Keonjhar, his eldest son Dhanurjay became the king in 1861.
- Pattamahadei Bishnupriya submitted a petition before T.E. Ravenshaw that before his death, the king of Keonjhar had proposed to accept Brundaban Bhanja as the legal hair to the throne of Keonjhar.
- T.E. Ravenshaw went through the petition of queen Bishnupriya and rejected it.
- Being disgusted, the queen appealed to Ratna Naik to do the needful. The Bhuyans and the Juangs were now ready to fight for the cause of the queen.
- As the leader of the Bhuyans, he organized them and raised them to fight against Dhanurjay.
- Ratna Naik organised the Bhuyans. All of them with the queen Bishnupriya wanted to have a plan. So, the queen left the palace of Keonjhargarh and came to Basantpur.
- She met Ratna Naik and other Bhuyans and Juangs. All of them took a vow to oust Dhanurjay Bhanja from the throne of Keonjhar.
- In the meanwhile T.E. Ravenshaw negotiated with the queen who came to Keonjhargarh palace to attend Dhanurjay,s coronation.
- This activity of the queen appeared as a betrayal to Ratna Naik. He organized the Bhuyans, Juangs, Kohlas and declared that until they place King Brundaban Bhanj, they would not leave the fight.
- The British Government took steps to putdown the rebellion.
- When T.E. Ravenshaw reached Keonjhargarh, Ratna Naik and Nanda Naik surrendered and the Ratna meli came to an end.
- The revolt of Dharanidhar Naik, a Bhuyan leader of Keonjhar against Dhanurjay Bhanja constitutes another inglorious chapter during the British rule in Odisha.

- The Bhuyans became more organised under his leadership and challenged the king. Of course, the British Government ruthlessly suppressed it.

2 .3. 8. Exercise

- **Write a note on the tribal uprising in Odisha.**
- **Give an account on the Ghumsur rising under Dora Bisoi.**
- **Discuss the role of Chakra Bisoi in the Kandh rebellion of Ghumsur.**
- **Make an analysis on the Bhuyan rising under Ratna Naik.**
- **Describe the role of Dharanidhar Naik in the Bhuyan rising of Keonjhargarh.**

2 .3. 9. Further Reading

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UNIT-3
Chapter-I

Growth of Modern Education, Growth of Press and Journalism

Structure

3.1.0. Objectives

3.1.1. Introduction

3.1.2. Growth of modern education

3.1.2. 1. Education in Odisha during Pre-British Period

3.1.2. 2. Factors responsible for the spread of English Education

3.1.2. 3. Macauley's Minutes and education in Odisha

3.1.2. 4. Growth of education under Wood's Despatch

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3.1.2. 9. Technical Education in Odisha during the British period

3.1.2. 10. Approach of British Government towards Education in Odisha

3.1.3. Growth of Press and Journalism

3.1.3. 1. Beginning of Press and journalism

3.1.3. 2. Development of Press in Odisha

3.1.3. 3. Growth of vernacular Journals and Newspapers in Odisha

3.1.3. 4. Development of English Journals and Newspapersin Odisha

3.1.3. 5. Impact of press and journalism

3.1.4. Conclusion

3.1.5. Summary

3.1.6. Exercise

3.1.7. Further Reading

3.1.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss the growth of modern education and growth of press and journalism. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the growth of modern education in Odisha*
- *understand the steps taken by the British administrators for the growth of education*
- *know about the growth of press in Odisha*
- *evaluate the growth of journalism in Odisha*

3.1.1. Introduction

In Odisha the traditional education system was prevailed in the ancient and medieval period. But the modern education was started during the British period which led to the collapse of the traditional education system in Odisha. Under the East India Company, Christian missionaries made the beginning of modern education in Odisha by printing the Old and New Testaments in Odia. The first primary school was created in 1822 by missionaries. One of the long-term impacts of the British rule in Odisha was the introduction of English education in the land. This attempt of the British put Odisha on the path of modernization through the growth of education in Odisha

3.1.2. Growth of modern education

The attempt of the British Government to introduce modern education, put Odisha on the path of modernization and progress. In a sense, it created a milestone in the history of education system in Odisha.

3.1.2. 1. Education in Odisha during Pre-British Period

Prior to 1803 (the year British occupied Odisha) education was controlled by the private initiative. The schools *(Pathasala)* ran in temples, Sanskrit *Tols* , Bhagavat Tungis and in the house of some rich men. The *Avadhanas* (teachers) put emphasis on reading, writing and working out simple mathematics or traditional knowledge. The Odia literature was taught to the pupils including the *Bhagavata* of Jagannatha Das and puranas etc. There was no Odia school managed by the Kings of Odisha by that time. Thus, education in the Pre-British period was quite annoying in Odisha.

3.1.2. 2. Factors responsible for the spread of English Education

The following factors were responsible for the growth of English education.

- In the beginning, the East India Company was much apathetic to the growth of English education in Odisha. In course of time, they realized that if the people will not be well acquainted with English, their administration and the entire system will not work properly. So they took interest for the growth of English education in Odisha.
- On the other hand, Charles Grant, the member of the British Parliament and Lord Minto, the Governor-General took keen interest for the spread of English education among the Indians who will understand the British administration and will help the officials in discharging their duties.
- The Christian missionaries wanted to uplift the Odishan people through the spread of education with the view to spread Christianity. The main aim of these missionaries was to preach the natives the words of Jesus Christ. The missionaries prepared the Odia letters and printed the first Odia Bible in 1804. The New Testament was translated in 1809 by Pandit Mrutyunjay Vidyalankar. This translation was possible due to the efforts of three missionaries namely Me.Carry, Marshman and Ward.
- The British thought that the appointment of the Odias in the Govemment service would be beneficial to them because they would get very less salary in comparison to others.
- The need of educated elites to help the British administration was a need at that time. It was true for all the provinces of India and Odisha was not exclusion to it. So, the British Government wanted to introduce modern education in Odisha.

3.1.2. 3. Macauley's Minutes and education in Odisha

It was Lord Macauley, the President of the General Committee of Public instruction and Law Member of the Governor-General's Council who prepared his Minute in 1835. After much debate between the Anglicists and the Orientalists over the issue of medium of instruction, English was accepted the medium of instruction to impart European knowledge to the people of India. As a result the British took steps to open English Schools in Odisha.

Before that the Christian missionaries had established English medium schools. The missionaries had opened a few schools and they had proved successful. The mission school in

northern Odisha was opened on 1st June 1822. And after that the government took over the responsibility of fifteen native schools.

In 1836, the British opened the first English School at Puri. Although the Cuttack English School was established in 1823-24 by the Christian missionaries, its management was transferred to the Government in 1836. That is why Cuttack Missionary School became popular and Puri English School was closed after two years of its inception. In 1853 Government founded an English School at Balasore and restored the Puri School. Subsequently, Zilla Schools were established at Balasore, Puri and Cuttack to create a class of English educated people to help in the work of the British Government in Odisha.

3.1.2.4. Growth of education under Wood's Despatch

The Wood's Despatch was another milestone in the history of educational progress in the state of Odisha. In 1854 during the Governor-Generalship of Lord William Bentinck Sir Charles Wood, the President of the Board of Control drafted a scheme which became famous as Wood's Despatch. It became the 'Magnacarta' in the history of English system of education in India. It recommended for the opening of new schools and for retain old schools. Accordingly, another Zilla School was established at Berhampur in 1855. This despatch dated 19''' July 1854 was to analyse the history and progress of education in the region. I

It offered a number of valuable suggestions and after that there were a number of changes, which brought the condition of education in this region to a higher position. In 1858-59, there were 30 schools, in 1868 the number was 63 and it rose to 95 in 1870. The period following Wood's despatch, schools started functioning in the remote areas of the province. A school had come at Kendrapara with 35 students; there was a school at Puri with students. Similarly, schools had sprung at Bhadrak, Balasore, Mahanga, Hariharpur and other places. One obstacle in the educational system was the fee structure of the schools. Even there were cases of students dropping out of schools due to the high fee structure.

3.1.2.5. Spread of Vernacular Education in Odisha

Due to the Wood's Despatch, the Zilla School at Sambalpur assumed the status of the Anglo-Vernacular School. The policy of placing Middle English School in a vernacular basis helped the Odias for the spread of English Education. On the other hand, T. E. Ravenshaw looked after the 832 Pathasalas or indigenous village schools. Thus it galvanized the process of the growth of primary education in Odisha. Maharaja Krushna Chandra Gajapati of

Paralakhemundi gave impetus for the spread of Primary education in Odisha. By 1947 the number of primary schools increased to 6998 in Odisha.

3.1.2. 6. Secondary Education in Odisha during British rule

Besides primary education, the secondary education also received a fresh impetus by the Wood's Despatch. The Middle Vernacular Schools, Middle English Schools and the High Schools were established for the growth of education in Odisha. In the Middle Vernacular School, English was not a compulsory subject. The Middle Vernacular Schools added two years of education after upper primary stage. In the Middle English School, English was a compulsory subject in the curriculum. M.E. School also had four years of courses of study. High Schools also provided four years of courses of study after the M.E. School. Accordingly, private High Schools were established at Cuttack. The Pyari Mohan Academy which began as a ME School in 1875 assumed the status of a High School in 1879. The Victoria School at Cuttack also assumed the status of a High School in 1888. By the end of Nineteenth century there were 12 High Schools and 82 M.E. Schools in North Odisha and 4 High Schools and 26 ME Schools in South Odisha.

3.1.2. 7. Lord Ripon and the Hunter Commission

Lord Ripon, the Viceroy of India, appointed a commission under W.W. Hunter which famous as Hunter Commission in 1882. According to its recommendations, private schools and colleges were opened in different towns of Odisha. In the full spirit for amalgamation of Odia speaking tracts, Pandit Gopabandhu Das established Satyavadi Bakula Vanvidyalaya at Sakshigopal in 1909. The *Panchasakhas* of modern Odisha like Pandit Gopabandhu Das, Acharya Harihara, Pandit Nilakantha Das, Pandit Godavarish Mishra and Pandit Krupasindhu Mishra took over the charge of this school for the growth of education in Odisha. The creation of Odisha as a separate province created an urge in the mind of the leaders of Odisha for spreading edutati6n in Odisha. By 1947 there were 42 High Schools and 61 M.E. Schools existed in odisha.

3.1.2. 8. Growth of higher education in Odisha

After the end of the disastrous Famine of 1866, the British Government thought for giving attention for the development of higher education in Odisha. The establishment of Ravenshaw College in 1868 began a new epoch in the field of higher education in Odisha, In 1968, the Cuttack Zilla School was converted into Collegiate School with the opening of FA (First Arts) class only having facility for teaching of Intermediate standard.

After that by the recommendation of T.E. Ravenshaw, it was converted to a Degree College. In 1878 Maharaja Krushna Chandra Bhanja donated 20,000 rupees for the construction of a new college building. Till 1878, Ravenshaw College was the only college in Odisha which was giving higher education. The Berhampur Zilla School was converted into a collegiate School with the addition of FA classes in 1878. By the recommendation of Hunter Commission, privatization was encouraged and that school became Berhampur Native College and in 1893 it became Khallikote College when Raja Harihar Mardaraj Dev granted land for it. In 1896 another college was established at Parlakhernundi by Maharaja Gourachandra Dev: It was a Junior (Second Grade) college till 1936. In 1937 it was upgraded. S.B. Women's College was also established at Cuttack. There were only seven reputed colleges in Odisha- Ravenshaw College, Cuttack, Khalikote College, Berhampur; S.K.C.G. College, Parlakhemundi, S.B. Women's College, Cuttack; G.M. College, Sambalpur and S.C.S. College, Puri and F.M. College, Balasore. Besides the above colleges, one Training College had been established at Cuttack which latter on became famous as Radha Nath Training College. All these colleges were established in Odisha during the British period for providing higher education in the state.

3.1.2. 9. Technical Education in Odisha during the British period

The technical education was also provided by the British in course of time in order to full fill the need of the British Government. In 1923, the Odisha School of Engineering was opened at Cuttack which at present known as the Bhubanananda Engineering School. On the other hand, the Boys' Industrial School at Balasore was started in Balasore by the American Baptist Mission and education was imparted in carpentry, book-binding, cane work, painting, cement work etc. Two weaving institutes were opened at Sambalpur and Cuttack districts. The Odisha Medical School was established in 1876 which worked with galvanizing effect from 1917 which is recognized as the S.C.B. Medical College and Hospital. The Sanskrit *tols* (schools) offered *Prathama* and *Madhyama* studies. Some special schools were established. 35 special schools for Scheduled castes and 19 schools for Scheduled tribes were established at Angul and Sambalpur in 1917. After that a training college to impart the process of teaching was established at Cuttack, which later on became Radha Nath Training College.

3.1.2. 10. Approach of British Government towards Education in Odisha

Although, the British had initiated the modern education in Odisha. But it did not progress fast. There are Several reasons for the above approach of the British towards the

education in Odisha.(1) the British was quite apathetic towards the spread of higher education in Odisha. (2) although it wanted that the people of Odisha should learn English, but it never wanted to make them highly educated. It simply wanted a working knowledge of English only to create a clerical class of people as it wanted in case of India also.(3) higher education was very expensive. The British Government never wanted to spend more on education which will benefit the native people. In 1858, when the Bombay, Madras and Calcutta Universities were established, there was not a single college by that time in Odisha. (4) the number of schools and colleges was quite insufficient in Odisha. So the rise of elite class became delayed in case of Odisha. (5) the conservative ideas regarding education of the people of Odisha was exploited by the British, So, they did not encourage the English education in Odisha. Lastly, the British did not encourage the Engineering education particularly related to agriculture although Odisha was a land having agriculture as the chief profession of the people. These were factors which also hindered in the growth of education in Odisha.

Conclusion

Thus, the modern education in the form of English education in Odisha started during the British period. The beginning in this regard was made by the Missionaries for the evangelical purpose. In course of time, the British government took the initiative for the introduction of modern education in the form of English education in Odisha for their administrative convenience and to keep the people of Odisha silent by giving small employments and other facilities. However, the growth of education was not as progressive as it has been seen in case of other parts of India. With the end of the British rule in India, English education grew in Odisha.

3.1.3. Growth of Press and Journalism

The growth of press and journalism in Odisha created a landmark in the history of modern Odisha. The initiative was taken by the Christian missionaries who made great contribution in this field. With the establishment of printing press by them, started the story of press and journalism in Odisha. In due course of time vernacular press emerged in Odisha. It also prepared the way for the growth of journalism. The growth of press and journalism in Odisha led to the growth of socio-political consciousness among the people of Odisha.

3.1.3. 1. Beginning of Press and journalism

The Baptist missionaries were the pioneers of establishing printing press in Odisha. At first, they printed religious texts in Odia for the propaganda of Christian ideas. For the first time in 1837, they established a press in Cuttack named the 'Cuttack Printing Press' and published the earlier Odia journals. They were the pioneers of press in Odisha.

3.1.3. 2. Development of Press in Odisha

In 1866, the second printing press in Odisha was established which was named as the Cuttack Printing Company. Only after two years in 1868, the third printing press was established at Balasore by the efforts of Fakir Mohan Senapati with the help of local Zamindar and people. After five years of the establishment of that press by Fakir Mohan, another press was established in Balasore in 1873. Between 1873 and 1899 establishment of press in Odisha became rapid.

3.1.3. 3. Growth of vernacular Journals and Newspapers in Odisha

The establishment of the press was a landmark in the history of journalism in Odisha. As stated earlier, the Missionaries had established press in 1837. In the same year the first Odia newspaper named *Kujibara Patrika* was published by a monk named Sadhu Sundar Das. Then the missionaries published the journal named *Jnanaruna* in 1849 for the propagation of their religious ideas. They also published two other journals named *Prabodha Chandrika* and *Arunodaya.*

A milestone was established in the field of Odia journals when Bichitrananda Das being inspired by T.E. Ravenshaw, the Commissioner of Odisha established the Cuttack Printing Press in 1866. From that press was published *Utkala Dipika* edited by Gauri Shankar Ray. He was the editor of this journal till his death in 1917. Fakir Mohan Senapati, the 'Father of Odia Prose' established a press at Balasore and by the inspiration of John Beams, the Collector of Balasore published two monthly journals named *Bodhadayini* and *Balasore Sambad Vahika.*

Later on *Sambad Vahika* became a weekly journal. This journal remained as an influential journal of Odisha in the last quarter of the Nineteenth century. Cuttack Mission Press launched two periodicals *Sevak* and *Samskaraka.* The *Sevak* was a monthly journal and *Samskaraka* was a weekly journal.

In 1889, *Sambalpur Hitaisini* was published under the patronage of King Sudhaladev. It reflected the news and views of the people of Western Odisha. It was edited by Nilamani Vidyaratna. It played a vital role in giving wing to the language agitation in Sambalpur.

Similarly receiving the royal patronage of Harihara Mardaraj of Khallikote *Prajabandhu* was published under the editorship of Vidyaratna. It was meant to check the dominance of the Telgus. Raja Baikuntha Nath De of Balasore set up another press at Balasore and brought out a journal *Utkala Darpana* in 1873. *Utkala Madhupa, Utkala Putra, Kohinur Utkal Sahita, Dainika Asha, Samaj etc.* were other journals and newspapers.

3.1.3. 4. Development of English Journals and Newspapersin Odisha

In due course of time, the English journals and newspapers were published in Odisha. Among the leading newspapers and journals, *Cuttack Argus* (1869), *Cuttack Star* (1869), *Cuttack Standard Odisha Patriot* (1866·, *Geruem News* (1896) and *Star of Utkal* (1906-1912) were prominent.

3.1.3. 5. Impact of press and journalism

The above publications had far reaching impact upon the people of Odisha which can be discussed bellow:

- The language agitation at Sambalpur gained momentum due to the *Sambalpur Hitaisini.* Other Odia journals came forward to give vent to this.
- The newspapers and journals exposed the black spots of the British administration and made the people cautious. The British Government also became cautious in dealing the public of Odisha. It created the sense of nationalism among the people of Odisha. Through these newspapers and journals, the message of nationalism was spread. The idea of nationalism was injected into the body, mind and soul of the people of Odisha through these writings.
- The publication of newspaper and journals played a vital role in the amalgamation of Odia speaking tracts. The *Utha Kankala* poem of Godabarish Mohapatra was a pointer in this direction.
- The national programmes associated with different Gandhian movements, atrocities during the Salt Satyagraha and Quit India Movement *etc.* were published in the pages of the newspapers and journals. It flared up nationalism and dragged the people of Odisha to the fold of national movement.
- Sixthly, the Christian Missionaries and the Brahmo Samajists propagated their religion through the journals and newspapers. These journals and newspapers helped in the spread of Christianity and Brahmo movement.

- These newspapers and journals made people vigilant regarding the day-to-day happenings. They could know various programmes and information regarding many things from these newspapers and journals.

3.1.4. Conclusion

Thus, the growth of press and journalism during British period brought many changes in the life of the people of Odisha. The development of press and growth of journals and newspapers in Odisha made the people aware of different aspects of life like social, political, economic and cultural etc. It created awareness about the evil rules of British Government in Odisha. It also developed the sense of nationalism in the minds of the people of Odisha.

3.1.5. Summary

- The modern education started during the British period led to the collapse of the traditional education system in Odisha.
- Under the East India Company, Christian missionaries made the beginning of modern education in Odisha by printing the Old and New Testaments in Odia.
- The first primary school was created in 1822 by missionaries. One of the long-term impacts of the British rule in Odisha was the introduction of English education in the land.
- This attempt of the British put Odisha on the path of modernization through the growth of education in Odisha.
- Prior to 1803 (the year British occupied Odisha) education was controlled by the private initiative.
- The schools *(Pathasala)* ran in temples, Sanskrit *Tols* , Bhagavat Tungis and in the house of some rich men.
- The *Avadhanas* (teachers) put emphasis on reading, writing and working out simple mathematics or traditional knowledge.
- It was Lord Macauley's Minute in 1835 under which the British took steps to open English Schools in Odisha.
- In 1836, the British opened the first English School at Puri.

- Although the Cuttack English School was established in 1823-24 by the Christian missionaries, its management was transferred to the Government in 1836.
- The Wood's Despatch was another milestone in the history of educational progress in the state of Odisha. Due to the Wood's Despatch, the Zilla School at Sambalpur assumed the status of the Anglo-Vernacular School.
- Besides primary education, the secondary education also received a fresh impetus by the Wood's Despatch.
- Under Hunter Commission in 1882, private schools and colleges were opened in different towns of Odisha.
- The establishment of Ravenshaw College in 1868 began a new epoch in the field of higher education in Odisha.
- In 1968, the Cuttack Zilla School was converted into Collegiate School with the opening of FA (First Arts) class only having facility for teaching of Intermediate standard.
- The technical education was also provided by the British in course of time in order to full fill the need of the British Government.
- In 1923, the Odisha School of Engineering was opened at Cuttack which at present known as the Bhubanananda Engineering School.
- Thus, the modern education in the form of English education in Odisha started during the British period.
- The growth of press and journalism in Odisha created a landmark in the history of modern Odisha.
- The initiative was taken by the Christian missionaries who made great contribution in this field.
- With the establishment of printing press by them, started the story of press and journalism in Odisha.
- In due course of time vernacular press emerged in Odisha. It also prepared the way for the growth of journalism.

- The growth of press and journalism in Odisha led to the growth of socio-political consciousness among the people of Odisha.
- For the first time in 1837, they established a press in Cuttack named the 'Cuttack Printing Press' and published the earlier Odia journals.
- In 1866, the second printing press in Odisha was established which was named as the Cuttack Printing Company.
- Only after two years in 1868, the third printing press was established at Balasore by the efforts of Fakir Mohan Senapati with the help of local Zamindar and people.
- In 1837 the first Odia newspaper named *Kujibara Patrika* was published by a monk named Sadhu Sundar Das.
- Then the missionaries published the journal named *Jnanaruna* in 1849 for the propagation of their religious ideas.
- They also published two other journals named *Prabodha Chandrika* and *Arunodaya.*
- In 1889, *Sambalpur Hitaisini* was published under the patronage of King Sudhaladev.
- *Utkala Madhupa, Utkala Putra, Kohinur Utkal Sahita, Dainika Asha, Samaj etc.* were other journals and newspapers.
- Among the leading newspapers and journals, *Cuttack Argus* (1869), *Cuttack Star* (1869), *Cuttack Standard Odisha Patriot* (1866·, *Geruem News* (1896) and *Star of Utkal* (1906-1912) were prominent.
- Thus, the growth of press and journalism during British period brought many changes in the life of the people of Odisha.

3.1.6. Exercise

- **Write a note on the growth of modern education in Odisha.**
- **Discuss the steps taken by the British Government for the development of modern education in Odisha.**
- **Make an analysis on the growth of press in Odisha during the British rule.**
- **Describe the growth of journalism in Odisha during the British period.**

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UNIT-3
Chapter-2

Natural Calamities in Odsha, Famine of 1866- its causes and effects

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3.2.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss Natural Calamities in Odsha, Famine of 1866- its causes and effects. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the natural calamities in Odisha during the British period*
- *understand the the famine of 1866 in Odisha*
- *know about the causes of the famine of 1866*
- *evaluate the effects of the famine of 1866 in Odisha*

3.2.1. Natural calamities in Odisha

The occurrence of natural calamities like drought, flood, epidemics and cyclone a reoccurring phenomenon in the history of Odisha. Their frequent visitation in 19th century was the most important factor that broke the backbone of the people of Odisha. The people of Odisha have been suffering from many natural calamities. The most famous among them all was the Famine of 1866 which is famous in the history of Odisha as Na-anka famine. It had caused severe socio-economic problems for the people of Odisha for several generations to come.

3.2.2. The Famine of 1866

The Famine of 1866 in Odisha was one of the worst famines of the world. The carelessness of the British administrators in charge of Odisha Division coupled with natural calamity and economic disasters brought this catastrophe. About one-third of the total population of Odisha perished by the disastrous famine. This severe famine is also known as the *'Na-Anka* Famine' because it occurred in the ninth regnal year of Gajapati Divyasinghadeva. The calamity was so devastative that its tragic memory was in the mind of the people of Odisha for at least some decades.

3.2.2. 1. Factors responsible for the Famine of 1866

There were several factors which were responsible for the outbreak of the famine of 1866 in Odisha which can be discussed as bellow:

3.2.2. 2. Cease of rainfall

The drought of 1865 served as the potential factor for the famine of 1866. In 1865, the monsoon began early and during October-November, there was no rainfall. The lands became

dry and the crops were totally destroyed coming under the scorching sun. In that year, about one-third of the total annual produce was reaped by the cultivators. The peasants could not preserve food-stuff in that year.

3.2.2.3. Alarming shortage of food grains

Alarming shortage of food grains due to casual export of food grains was another reason for the outbreak of the famine of 1866. Export of rice from Odisha was in a massive scale every year. On an average, 20,000 tons of rice was exported annually from Odisha as the records of the last six years, preceding 1866, revealed. In 1865, 33,000 tons of rice were imported from Odisha by the wealthy *Telingah Koomtees* of Madras Presidency who sold the rice to a French company named Messers Robert and Chariol Co., thereby earning heavy profit. By this export, the entire surplus of the year 1864, was exhausted. The British government also did not import food grains in 1865 when the rain stopped suddenly.

3.2.2.4. Unpleasant economic condition of the people

Agriculture was the chief occupation of the people in Odisha. The thirty years revenue settlement which had been introduced in Odisha by the East India Company in 1837, was to end in 1866. Apprehending the enhancement of revenue, the people considerably reduced the area under cultivation from 1864. This principle was adopted with a view to show less possession of land at the time of settlement which will fix less revenue on a land-holder. The British government had studied the mind of these people well. So, it deliberately delayed the process of settlement which they would have started during the year 1864. The people of Odisha did not get a hint of it. With the decrease of cultivable land from 1864, the reduction in production became inevitable. This led to weak the economic condition of the people of Odisha.

3.2.2.5. No attention for the improvement of agriculture in Odisha

On the other hand, East India Company did not pay attention for the improvement of agriculture in Odisha after the occupation of the land. The British Governement had not started irrigation facility in Odisha till 1866. The farmers of the land had to depend completely on monsoon for cultivation. In 1865, the rainfall ceased in September and by the end of October, rice became limited and costly. It not only increased the plight of the peasants but also of the

zamindars who thought it difficult to pay revenue-in time. On 26 October, 1865, Muspratt, the Collector of Balasore forwarded a petition of the local *zamindars* who had prayed for the postponement of revenue due to inability of the peasants to pay rent for failure of crops. However, the British higher authorities did not pay attention to this stern reality.

3.2.2.6. Lack of communication

The lack of communication facility was another cause for the famine. There was no concrete road between Odisha and Calcutta. Further, it was intersected by a number of unbridged rivers that discouraged the traders of Odisha to have any trade link with Calcutta. At that time Odisha was inaccessible during the rainy season. Even if the government had desired to import food grains from Calcutta, it had to fail miserably due to monsoon. Had there been a good communication facility between Odisha and Calcutta, the government would have easily brought food grains from Calcutta to meet the demand of the people of Odisha during the time of famine.

3.2.2.7. No prompt action of Government machineries

No prompt action of the Government machineries was largely responsible to worsen the situation. In fact, there was no link between the ruler and the people. The English officers had not visited the remote villages. So, they were ignorant about the condition of the people. Had they visited the villages regularly, they would have known about the sufferings of the people. Even, T. E. Ravenshaw, the then Commissioner of Odisha, could not know about the wretched condition of the people.

3.2.2.8. Artificial scarcity of food grains in the market

The British government could not control the artificial scarcity of food grain in the market when the rice merchants joined hands during the famine and hoarded rice. So, price of rice rose up higher and higher. The government would have regulated trade and commerce by taking those traders into task and fixing a reasonable price of rice and other essential goods. So, the merchants by monopolizing the sell of rice at high price which made the condition of the common people more miserable.

3.2.2. 9. Absence of media

At that time there was no proper media (print and electronic) to highlight the famine. No local daily was being published which would have reflected the pitiable condition of the people for the notice of the government. Though, G.N. Barlow, the Collector of Puri, Ramakoy Chatterjee, the Deputy Collector and some police officers had drawn the attention of the government regarding the famine and the Collector of Balasore had given hints about the famine to the Commissioner; these stray reference were not listened.

Besides the above causes the lack of education of the people of Odisha and the responsibility of T.E. Ravenshaw was also largely responsible for the outbreak of the famine of 1866. Had Ravenshaw taken serious steps, Odisha would not have come under the grip of this dreadful famine.

The above factors were mainly responsible for the outbreak of the famine which was devastative in nature.

3.2.2. 10. Beginning of the famine of 1866

The famine started in October, 1865 with the acute shortage of food grains in the market of Odisha. Although, the Collector of Puri had informed T.E. Ravenshaw, the Commissioner of Odisha, regarding this alarming situation. But without taking any relief measure, T.E. Ravenshaw rather informed the Bengal' government about sufficiency of food grains in Odisha at that time.

3.2.2. 11. Preliminary reports on famine

The famine is considered to have started in October 1865. Barlow's information regarding the starvation death at Parikud and Malud did not make Ravenshaw worry. Barlow had suggested to undertake public works by paying wage in terms of food grains to labourers as grains were not available in the local markets. The Bengal government sanctioned money for the construction of road but denied of paying the labourers in terms of food grain. No food grains

were imported from outside. At the early part of December 1865, Ravenshaw suggested for the formation of relief committees and went on long tours to the Tributary Mahals.

When Ravenshaw returned from tour on 31 January, 1866 and on the same day, he sent an urgent telegram to the Calcutta government to provide food grains instead of wages for the distressed people of Odisha. However, it was not listened by the Bengal authorities.

3.2.2. 12. Sir Cecil Beadon's visit of Cuttack

From 13 to 19 February, 1866 Sir Cecil Beadon, the Lieutenant Governor of Bengal, visited Cuttack. Neither he carefully visualized the situation, nor the government servants projected the true picture of the famine before him out of fear. In his speech, he advised the Rajas and local *zamindars* to redress the grievances of the people by providing them relief. The condition worsened when, by the end of March, the jails were overcrowded with criminals who had committed crimes simply to get food inside the jail. The gravity of the situation was fully realised by the Commissioner himself when the hungry mob trampled him down at Balasore on his return journey from Mayurbhanj in March, 1866. Then, he immediately wrote to the Board of Revenue and his letter was uncared for. At last in May, when Ravenshaw insisted upon to provide ration to the troops at Cuttack to feed the prisoners and hungry people, the Board ordered for the import of rice.

3.2.2. 13. Course of the Famine

When the government was planning to import rice and virtually sanctioned Rs. 25, 00,000 for the same in the last week of June, monsoon had already been started. It was practically impossible to import food due to lack of transport and communication. Even when rice reached Cuttack after August, Odisha was in the grip of a devastating flood in September. In spite of the distribution of cooked food in 88 centers, the death toll was heavy due to epidemics like Cholera. Pyari Mohan Acharya has given a clear picture of the pitiable condition of the famine of 1866 in the following words "The towns were filled with the sorrowful shrieks of thousands of men, women, and children who had been reduced to mere skeletons. The crematory grounds near the towns and villages were full of innumerable dead bodies and upon them the vultures, and jackals feasted to their hearts' content…….".

3.2.2. 14. Initiatives of the Government machineries

Taking the graveness of the situation, the government machineries were geared up to deal with this alarming situation from July to October, 1866. The Public Works Department adopted different steps in which grains were given as wage. The East India Irrigation Company also undertook 'Food for Work' programme. The government created Famine Relief Fund. Several relief committes were created under the direct supervision of a special Commissioner to look after the relief measures and sanitary conditions of the people at Puri, Cuttack and Balasore districts.

3.2.2. 15. End of the famine

Further, public donations were collected by the government from the Hatas (market places), *zamindars* and wealthy persons and distributed among the poor and destitute. Some relief in cash was granted to thatch houses and for repairing the same. The orphan boys and girls were paid rupees three each per month. For the marriage of each orphan girl, rupees twenty were given. Free medical service and medicine were provided to the people. Christian missionaries rendered habitual service to the poor and destitutes. The *zamindars* were granted remission of revenues with the condition that, in retrospect, they would remit the revenue for the *royat.* An extra allowance was granted to the government servants to meet the high cost of living. By adopting such measures, the government became successful in meeting the famine-stricken people of Odisha. By December, 1867, the famine was declared as over. By that time, sufficient relief measures had been provided to the people of Odisha. The farmers had been supplied adequate seeds and food grains through the *zamindars*. The government also supplied the same to them in cheap price.

3.2.2. 16. Report of the Enquiry Commission for the Famine of 1866

In December 1866, by the order of the secretary of State for India, an enquiry commission was formed to enquire into the causes, circumstances and extent of the famine. It consisted of three members-George Campbell, the President, W.E. Morton and H.L.Dampier, the

two members. On 6 April, 1867, the Odisha Famine Commission submitted its report. As per the views of the members of this commission, besides inevitable circumstances, negligence of administrative authorities and errors of certain individual officers were responsible for such a catastrophe.

3.2.2. 17. Consequences of the Famine

The consequences of the *Na-Anka* famine were far reaching. (1)It exposed the failure of the administrative machineries in Odisha to look after the people.(2) The mortality was around 1,000,000, nearly one-third of the population of the province as per the calculation of the government.(3) Chaos and confusion prevailed everywhere in Odisha and epidemics followed the famine and made the life of people more miserable.

3.2.2. 18. 1866 Famine: A blessing in disguise

The famine of 1866 was a blessing in disguise as it ushered a new era in the field of administration in Odisha. The authoritative attitude and carelessness of the government were relegated to the distant background. On the other hand, government adopted sympathetic attitude and policies towards the people of Odisha. Basing on the recommendation of the Famine Commission of Odisha, the Government of India framed famine relief policies for the entire country.

3.2.2. 19. Benevolent measures of T. E. Ravenshaw after the Famine

After the famine T. E. Ravenshaw stimulated the government machineries for the promotion of education in Odisha. He established a number of vernacular schools in the rural areas and put emphasis on the Odia language, converted the Cuttack Zilla School into Ravenshaw College, became instrumental for the establishment of a medical school and a training school in 1866 and 1869 respectively, at Cuttack, construction and improvement of the embankment in Banki and Aul, promotion of trade and commerce in Odisha and facilitated transport and communication, railway lines passed from Bengal to distant South via Odisha,. However, the famine of 1866 proved to be a turning point in the history of modern Odisha.

3.2. 3. Conclusion

Thus, the famine of 1866 was a turning point in the history of modern Odisha. In this famine, the people of Odisha had suffered a lot. It had taken away one third of its population. However, the aftermath of the famine was good for the state. The British Government brought many administrative and other facilities for the benefit of the people. The Famine of 1866, forced them to adopt benevolent and sympathetic policies towards the people of Odisha.

3.2. 4. Summary

- The occurrence of natural calamities like drought, flood, epidemics and cyclone a reoccurring phenomenon in the history of Odisha.
- Their frequent visitation in 19th century was the most important factor that broke the backbone of the people of Odisha.
- The people of Odisha have been suffering from many natural calamities.
- The most famous among them all was the Famine of 1866 which is famous in the history of Odisha as Na-anka famine.
- The Famine of 1866 in Odisha was one of the worst famines of the world.
- The carelessness of the British administrators in charge of Odisha Division coupled with natural calamity and economic disasters brought this catastrophe.
- About one-third of the total population of Odisha perished by the disastrous famine.
- There were several factors which were responsible for the outbreak of the famine of 1866 in Odisha.
- The drought of 1865 served as the potential factor for the famine of 1866.
- Alarming shortage of food grains due to casual export of food grains was another reason for the outbreak of the famine of 1866.
- East India Company did not pay attention for the improvement of agriculture in Odisha after the occupation of the land.
- The lack of communication facility was another cause for the famine. No prompt action of the Government machineries was largely responsible to worsen the situation.
- The British government could not control the artificial scarcity of food grain in the market when the rice merchants joined hands during the famine and hoarded rice.
- At that time there was no proper media (print and electronic) to highlight the famine.

- The famine started in October, 1865 with the acute shortage of food grains in the market of Odisha.
- At the early part of December 1865, Ravenshaw suggested for the formation of relief committees and went on long tours to the Tributary Mahals.
- When Ravenshaw returned from tour on 31 January, 1866 and on the same day, he sent an urgent telegram to the Calcutta government to provide food grains instead of wages for the distressed people of Odisha. However, it was not listened by the Bengal authorities.
- From 13 to 19 February, 1866 Sir Cecil Beadon, the Lieutenant Governor of Bengal, visited Cuttack. Neither he carefully visualized the situation, nor the government servants projected the true picture of the famine before him out of fear.
- Taking the graveness of the situation, the government machineries were geared up to deal with this alarming situation from July to October, 1866. The Public Works Department adopted different steps in which grains were given as wage.
- . By December, 1867, the famine was declared as over. By that time, sufficient relief measures had been provided to the people of Odisha.
- In December 1866, by the order of the secretary of State for India, an enquiry commission was formed to enquire into the causes, circumstances and extent of the famine.
- It consisted of three members-George Campbell, the President, W.E. Morton and H.L.Dampier, the two members.
- As per the views of the members of this commission, besides inevitable circumstances, negligence of administrative authorities and errors of certain individual officers were responsible for such a catastrophe.
- The consequences of the *Na-Anka* famine were far reaching.
- It exposed the failure of the administrative machineries in Odisha to look after the people.
- The mortality was around 1,000,000, nearly one-third of the population of the province as per the calculation of the government.

- Chaos and confusion prevailed everywhere in Odisha and epidemics followed the famine and made the life of people more miserable.

- However, the famine of 1866 was a turning point as it ushered a new era in the field of administration in Odisha.

3.2. 5. Exercise

- **Write a note on the natural calamities in Odisha with reference to the Famine of 1866.**
- **Highlight the causes of the famine of 1866.**
- **Discuss the course and result of the famine of 1866.**
- **Make an analysis on the causes and effects of the famine of 1866 in Odisha.**

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UNIT-3
Chapter-III

Socio-Cultural changes in 19th Century Odisha

Structure

3.3.0. Objectives

3.3.1. Introduction

3.3.2. Social and cultural changes in 19th century Odisha

3.3.2.1. Impact of the Christian Missionaries

3.3.2.2. Introduction of English education

3.3.2.3. Influence of the Brahmo Movement

3.3.2.4. Appearance of Mahima dharrna

3.3.2.5. Influence of literary awakening

3.3.3. Conclusion

3.3.4. Summary

3.3.5. Exercise

3.3.6. Further Reading

3.3.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Socio-Cultural changes in 19th Century Odisha. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the social changes in Odisha in 19th century*
- *understand the cultural changes in 19th changes in 19th century Odisha*
- *know about the factors responsible for the social and cultural changes in Odisha in 19th century*

3.3.1. Introduction

The nineteenth century witnessed socio-cultural changes in Odisha. This socio-cultural awakening was basically the outcome of the impact of western civilization upon the Indian society. The English educated elite class spearheaded this movement.

3.3.2. Social and cultural changes in 19th century Odisha

The factors that brought about the socio-cultural changes Social and cultural changes in 19th century Odisha were the impact of Christian missionaries, introduction of English education and growth of Press, journalism and modern literature. Besides these factors, the socio-religious reform movements, going on in other parts of the country, particularly Bengal, contributed to the socio-cultural changes in Odisha.

3.3.2.1. Impact of the Christian Missionaries

The activities of the Christian Missionaries brought socio-cultural changes in Odisha. Soon after the British conquest of Odisha, the Christian missionaries started their activities in this province. In 1809, William Carey, the Baptist Missionary of Serampore brought out the Odia version of the New Testament which was the work of a Odia scholar, named puhishottam Pandit. In 1820's a number of missionaries such as William Bampton, James Pegg, Charles Lacey and Amos Sutton came to Odisha and carried on their activities. Although, the missionaries' primary aim was proselytisation, yet in some ways they proved to be the pioneers of westernization and modernization. They established schools for imparting knowledge of Christianity through the vemacular language. By the end of 1823, they were running fifteen vernacular schools at Cuttack. The same year they established the first English School of Odisha an Anglo-Vernacular school at Cuttack.

By translating the Christian tracts and Gospels into Odia language the missionaries in a way initiated the development of modern vernacular prose literature, although their translations were defective. Some of the missionaries wrote non-Christian books in Odia language. For example, Sutton wrote Odia Grammar, History and Geography and Odia primer for the schools and compiled a dictionary in Odia language. The missionaries established the first printing press of Odisha at Cuttack in 1837. They were also pioneers in the field of vernacular journalism. They brought out the earliest journals of Odisha such as *Jnanaruna* (1849), *Prabodh Chandrika* (1856) and *Arunodaya (1861).*

In several ways, the missionaries contributed to the socio-religious reformation. They established orphanages in which they gave shelter to the destitute children and rescued Meriahs. The missionaries also took some steps for the education and uplift of the women. Some female missionaries engaged themselves in this work. The missionaries appear to have significantly interacted with the indigenous religious life even in the early stage. Sadhu Sundar Das, a reformist Hindu religious guru, who had his monastery at Kujibar near Cuttack and used to preach theism and denounce idolatry, was impressed by the preaching of missionaries. The missionaries anti-idolatrous views were similar to those of this guru. Being impressed by Christianity, some of the disciples of Sadhu Sundar Das embraced Christianity, though he himself adhered to his ancestral religion. It is presumed by some scholars that Mahima Swami, was in some ways influenced by Christianity.

3.3.2.2. Introduction of English education

Due to the introduction of English education, there were socio-cultural changes in Odisha. Progress of education among women was much slower, compared to men, due to social prejudice and the compulsion of early marriage. Throughout the nineteenth century the Odia girls could not go beyond the middle vernacular standard. It is worthy to mention that towards the progress of education, some rajas and zamindars made notable contributions. Because of the donation of Rs. 20,000 by the Maharaja Krushna Chandra Bhanja of- Mayurbhanja to the Ravenshaw College, the college could be made a permanent educational institution in 1881. The Raja of Khallikote extended 'his patronage to the college, opened in the Berhampur Zilla School building in 1878. The construction of rallways across the coastal Odisha in 1896 enabled the Odia students to go to Calcutta to receive higher education.

3.3.2.3. Influence of the Brahmo Movement

The new elite class which was a product of English education was influenced by Brahmo movement of Bengal and sought to bring about social reforms like abolition of child marriage and introduction of widow marriage. The Brahmo Samaj had been formed in Bengal in 1828 by Raja Rammohan Roy for propagating monotheism and abolition of idolatry and bringing about social reforms. By the middle of nineteenth century the Brahmo preachers from Bengal came to Balasore. In 1869 Haranath Bhattacharya, a professor of philosophy in the Cuttack college, a follower of Keshab Chandra Sen formed Utkal Brahmo Samaj at Cuttack. In 1875 Pratap Chandra Mazumdar, a prominent follower of Keshab came to Cuttack and addressed a meeting in the Cuttack High School premise on 6 July 1875.

The Brahmos built a Brahmo Mandir at Cuttack and brought out a number of periodicals. Balasore and Cuttack were the two important centres of Brahmo movement in Odisha. The Brahmo movement not only failed to make any successful inroad into the stronghold of Brahmanical orthodoxy but also failed to have significant impact on the general public. Its influence was confined to certain persons of intelligentsia class many of whom happened to be Bengalis. The leading Odia lights who were influenced by Brahmo faith included Fakir Mohan Senapati, Madhusudan Rao, Pyari Mohan Acharya, Chaturbhuj Pattanayak (who wrote a number of books, on Brahmoism), Bishwanath Kar and Nandakishor Bal. Among the rulers of princely states, Maharaja Bhagirathi Mahendra Bahadur of Dhenkanal extended patronage to Brahmoism by giving donation for the construction of Mandir at Cuttack, Maharaja Shrirama Chandra Bhanjadeo of Mayurbhanj accepted Brahmo faith and Sudhaldev Basudev, the ruler of Bamanda was a staunch critic of Brahmo faith. The Brahmos were able to draw students to their meetings and *sankirtans,* which was not liked by their guardians. Thus the Brahmo movement played a great role in the socio-cultural changes in Odisha.

3.3.2.4. Appearance of Mahima dharrna

During the last quarter of the nineteenth century an indigenous religious cult, prevalent among the lower castes and tribal of the hilly regions of central and western Odisha, called Mahima Dharrna gave an unqualified challenge to Brahrnanical orthodoxy. Mahima Dharma is a religion of Hindu reform movement that turned against Jagannath worship in particular. Unlike the so-called Neo-Hindu reform movement, as for instance the Brahmo Samaj which came into

being as a sequel to the encounter with Christianity and the philosophies of the west and obtained from there, i.e. from outside, the criteria of their criticism of its own tradition, non intrinsic direct western influence in the emergence of Mahima Dharma can be traced. On the contrary, this movement derives its criticism of the Hindu tradition directly. From the tradition itself; thus standing in an almost paradoxical two-fold relation to the tradition which it accepts on the one hand and rejects on the other.

3.3.2.5. Influence of literary awakening

The literary awareness also brought social and cultural changes in Odisha in 19th century. The growth of education brought about a literary awakening in Odia language. Fakir Mohan Senapati and Radhanath Roy may be regarded as the pioneers of this literary awakening. Fakir Mohan Senapati (1847-1918) was born in a village, called Mallikashpur, near the Balasore town. A man of little formal education and a self-made man. Fakir Mohan by self-study could make himself an erudite scholar not only in his own language but also in other Indian languages including Sanskrit and acquired working knowledge in English language. He poured his profound erudition and experience into his writings by which he lavishly enriched the Odia language which was about to be extinguished in the mid-nineteenth century because of lack of printing press and advocacy of some Bengalis for the introduction of the Bengali medium of instruction in the schools of Odisha.

Fakir Mohan achieved spectacular success in various fields like administration, business, literature and journalism. He could rise to become the Dewan of some princely slates of Odisha and win the recognition of the British officers of high rank. He was a poet, novelist, administrator, scholar, social reformer, printer, journalist, businessman and patriot. Fakir Mohan felt very much pained at the want of printed books in Odia language. He felt, as he observed in his autobiography, for this reason the Odias were being humiliated by the Bengalis who had a fairly developed press and literature in their language. He became determined to establish a press at Balasore for promoting the development of Odia language. For this purpose he formed an association. He and his associates carried on propaganda among the people so that they would be the shareholders of press. By his writings, brilliant and prolific writings, Fakir Mohan brought about a literary awakening in Odisha, which afterwards facilitated the movement for a separate political identity of the Odias.

3.3.3. Conclusion

Thus, the educated elite class of Odisha like the elite elsewhere in India sought to change the social and cultural life of the people of Odisha in 19th century through such measures as promotion of education and uplift and emancipation of women, etc. They were also influenced and inspired by social reform movements in other parts of India. But the slow progress of education and lack of strong intellectual elite slackened the process of social regeneration in Odisha.

3.3.4. Summary

- The nineteenth century witnessed socio-cultural changes in Odisha.
- This socio-cultural awakening was basically the outcome of the impact of western civilization upon the Indian society.
- The English educated elite class spearheaded this movement.
- The factors that brought about the socio-cultural changes Social and cultural changes in 19th century Odisha were the impact of Christian missionaries, introduction of English education and growth of Press, journalism and modern literature.
- The activities of the Christian Missionaries brought socio-cultural changes in Odisha.
- Soon after the British conquest of Odisha, the Christian missionaries started their activities in this province.
- In several ways, the missionaries contributed to the socio-religious reformation.
- They established orphanages in which they gave shelter to the destitute children and rescued Meriahs.
- The missionaries also took some steps for the education and uplift of the women.
- Some female missionaries engaged themselves in this work.
- The missionaries appear to have significantly interacted with the indigenous religious life even in the early stage.
- Due to the introduction of English education, there were socio-cultural changes in Odisha.
- Progress of education among women was much slower, compared to men, due to social prejudice and the compulsion of early marriage.
- Throughout the nineteenth century the Odia girls could not go beyond the middle vernacular standard.

- It is worthy to mention that towards the progress of education, some rajas and zamindars made notable contributions.
- The new elite class which was a product of English education was influenced by Brahmo movement of Bengal and sought to bring about social reforms like abolition of child marriage and introduction of widow marriage.
- During the last quarter of the nineteenth century an indigenous religious cult, prevalent among the lower castes and tribal of the hilly regions of central and western Odisha, called Mahima Dharrna gave an unqualified challenge to Brahrnanical orthodoxy.
- Mahima Dharma is a religion of Hindu reform movement that turned against Jagannath worship in particular.
- The literary awareness also brought social and cultural changes in Odisha in 19th century.
- The growth of education brought about a literary awakening in Odia language.
- Fakir Mohan Senapati and Radhanath Roy may be regarded as the pioneers of this literary awakening.
- Fakir Mohan brought about a literary awakening in Odisha, which afterwards facilitated the movement for a separate political identity of the Odias.
- Thus, the educated elite class of Odisha like the elite elsewhere in India sought to change the social and cultural life of the people of Odisha in 19th century through such measures as promotion of education and uplift and emancipation of women, etc.

3.3.5. Exercise

- **Write a note on the social and cultural changes of 19th century Odisha.**
- **Highlight the factors responsible for the social and cultural changes in Odisha in 19th century.**
- **Discuss the role of Brahmo Samaj in the socio-cultural changes in Odisha.**
- **Highlight the impact of the activities of the Christian Missionaries in the social and cultural changes in Odisha in 19th century.**

3.3.6. Further Reading

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UNIT-3
Chapter-III

Mahima Dharma

Structure

3.4.0. Objectives

3.4.1. Introduction

3.4.2. Mahima Dharma

3.4.2.1. Founder of Mahima Dharma

3.4.2.2. Bhima Bhoi and Mahima Dharma

3.4.2.3. Doctrines of Mahima Dharma

3.4.2.4. Doctrine of Monotheism

3.4.2.5. Principle of Non-Dualism

3.4.2.6. Theory of Creation of the universe

3.4.2.7. Rejection of image worship

3.4.2.8. Opposition to caste system

3.4.2.9. Vasudhaivakutumbakam

3.4.2.10. Principle of *satsanga* or common meal for all

3..4.2.11. Rule of Bisuddhaadvaita Brahumavada

3..4.2.12. Importance on ethical codes for the householders

3..4.3. Conclusion

3.4.4. Summary

3.4.5. Exercise

3.4.6. Further Reading

3.4.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Mahima Dharma. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the Mahima Dharma*
- *understand the history of the founder of Mahima Dharma*
- *know about the teachings of Mahima Dharma*

3.4.1. Introduction

The 19th century Renaissance in India had greatly influenced Odisha. On the other hand, Odisha's Renaissance was different because it bloomed from a very rural set up being uninfluenced by any western education. In thought and expression, it emerged in its own unique way in the form of Mahima Dharma. Through simple doctrines it projected many complicated theories. It raised voice against Saivism, Shaktism, Vaishnavism and other Brahmanical religious faiths.

3.4.2. Mahima Dharma

Mahima Dharma appeared in the early part of 19th century A.D. as a religion in the Hindu reform movement. The founder of this *dharma* was Mahima Gosain. By the efforts of Bhima Bhoi, the blind poet, it was spread in the nook and corner of Odisha. Gradually, by the efforts of the monks of this *dharma* it found its way to Bengal, Assam, Andhra Pradesh, Bihar and Madhya Pradesh.

3.4.2.1. Founder of Mahima Dharma

Mahima Dharma was founded by Mahima Swami or Mahima Gosain. He reached Puri around 1826 from where he started *Mahimabada.* He slept on sand and so people called him *'Dhulia Gosain'.* He carried discussion on Non-Dualism with the Pandits of Mukti Mandapa inside the Jagannath temple and opposed the idol-worship. He lived at Udaygiri, Khandagiri, Dhauli and at last reached Kapilas in the Dhenkanal district. He wore the bark of Kumbhi tree. Bhagirathi Mahindra Bahadur, the king of Dhenkanal sent milk for him early in the morning.

Mahima Gosain made Govinda Das as his first disciple and gradually many disciples including the great Biswanath Baba were created. Bhima Bhoi of Rairakhol become his disciple.

Through his great literary creation like *Stuti Chintamani, Brahmanirupana Gita, Nirveda Sadhana, Chautisa Madhuchakra, Adyanta Gita, Astakabihari Gita* etc., he popularised the Mahima Cult. From 1862 to 1867 Mahima Dharma spread like wild fire in the nook and corner of Odisha. Mahima Gosain breathed his last in 1867. The disciples of Mahima Gosain became famous as Mahima monks *Alekha sanyasi*.

3.4.2.2. Bhima Bhoi and Mahima Dharma

The great saint Bhima Bhoi played a key role for the spread of Mahima Dharma. He was born in 1855 at Rairakhol in Kondh family. His father was Dhaneswar Bhoi and mother was Gauri. Bhima Bhoi was born-blind. However, historians differ from each other on this question. By coming in contact with Mahima Gosain, Bhima got insight or direct knowledge and was indoctrinated by him. After being an Abadhut it is not known whether Bhima Bhoi stayed in Rairakhol or came to Joranda. Still then, it is sure that he spent a long time in Joranda and tried to popularize Mahima Cult. He composed many songs which were liked by the people and they were automatically attracted towards the Mahima Cult. Of course, the rival sects spoke ill of Bhima and tried to prevent the spread of Mahima Cult. Bhima was determined to spread the Mahima cult. His immortal creations included *'Stuti Chintamani', 'Shrutinisedha Gita', 'Brahmaniruoana Gita', Adyantagita', 'Chautisa Madhuchakra', 'Nirveda Sadhana'* etc. He died in 1895 at Khariapali village in Sonepur. Actually his efforts popularised the Manima Cult in the nook and comer of Odisha.

3.4.2.3. Doctrines of Mahima Dharma

The doctrines of Mahima Dharma are given bellow.

3.4.2.4. Doctrine of Monotheism

Believing in one god was the principle of Mahima Gosain. He preached his doctrine in Odia language. His idea found expression through the writings of Bhima Bhoi, who expressed it very lucidly and placidly. The teachings of Mahima Gosain bore no influence of other religion. In its own way the Mahima cult spread its fragrance everywhere and allured the attention of the people of Odisha and outside.

3.4.2.5. Principle of Non-Dualism

The Mahima cult urges for pure Non-Dualism. According to it, God is one and next to none. He is omniscient, omnipotent and omnipresent. He is the supreme soul and the cause of the creation of the world. He is also without form *(Nirakara),* unexpressable *(Avyakta),* without body

(Adeha), without name *(Anama),* without any feeling *(Nirvikara)* and supreme God *(Paramesvara).* He is present starting from the insect to the man. Equality is his motto and casts equal eye on everybody. Teacher or *Guru* occupies a pivotal position in the teachings of Mahima Gosain. A teacher or *Guru* can show the path of Salvation. Without him practice of dharma is meaningless. He can show path to a disciple and guide him for attaining Salvation. Bhima Bhoi has mentioned that without the grace of Mahima Gosain, he would not have realised the God. Thus, Guru occupies high place among the Avadhuta monks.

3.4.2.6. Theory of Creation of the universe

About the 'Theory of Creation' Mahima Gosain has given his own view. By the mixing of atom, *Purusa* and *Prakriti,* this world is not created. It has been created by the *Alekha Prabhu.* He is pure and without any vice. He is the root of all creations and causes. Hence, he should be worshipped as the creator of the universe.

3.4.2.7. Rejection of image worship

Mahima Dharma was against idol worship. Like Buddhism and Jainism, Mahima dharma raised voice against the superstitions of Brahmanism. He prescribed only one course of worship to the Alekha. He denied the worship different idols and rejected it. So, only formless Brahma is to be worshipped. Without him, if one worships any idol, he resorts to falsehood.

3.4.2.8. Opposition to caste system

This Dharma was against the caste system in the society and raised voice against the caste system in Odisha. It never distinguished between men and women, higher caste and lower caste, rich and poor and so on. The wise men never differentiate among caste, creed and sex. On the other hand, they try to maintain harmony and peace among the people. So, Mahima Dharma never put any constraint for the worship of God. Only through devotion God can be attained by everybody. Everyone is competent to worship God and attain him.

3.4.2.9. Vasudhaivakutumbakam

Mahima Dharma believed in the principle of Vasudhaivakutumbakam. The Mahima doctrine conceived the whole universe as a single family and desires the welfare of all. Happiness for all and peace to all is the motto of Mahima dharma. Even, the life of one may be tinged with sorrows and sufferings but he should pray for the happiness of others. There lies the true humanity. This gospel found its fullest expression in the words of Bhima Bhoi as "Let my life go to hell but the world may be rescued."

3.4.2.10. Principle of *satsanga* or common meal for all

Another notable feature of Mahima Dharma was 'Common meal for all' or *Satsanga Gosthi*. This was started by Mahima Swami himself who started it at Kashipur in Dhenkanal to show that "all souls are equal, because they worship the one Brahman." The food for all was prepared by the household devotees under the open sky and it was taken together by all.

3..4.2.11. Rule of Bisuddhaadvaita Brahumavada

It was essentially a Bhakti Cult whose philosophy is *Visuddha-advaita Brahmaveda.* It was close affinity with *Advaita Vada* of Samkaracharya which advocates exclusively *Jnana* as the only means to salvation. Thus, it is clear that there is no antagonism between Jnana and Bhakti in Mamma Dharma. *Bhakti* in Mahima Dharma means the attraction of the pure mind towards the ultimate truth- the *Parama Brahma. Bhakti* is to be guided by *Jnana.* Otherwise it is likely to miss true its true object. Mahima Dharma says that lover God is pure and the lover wants to unite with God.

3..4.2.12. Importance on ethical codes for the householders

The Mahima Dharma has always given importance on the values of life. In order to get rid of these entire falsehood one should keep divine qualities in himself. It emphasized that one should cultivate qualities like love, compassion, tranquility etc. in one's mind which will bring fullness of heart. The Mahima Cult prescribed certain ethical codes for the householders. It preached about the entertainment of guests as per the best Doctrines for householder’s capacity of a householder. One should leave meat and harmful goods. A householder should be simple and should leave anger, arrogance, pride and good moral character. Mahima dharma laid emphasis on *Brahma darshana, Trividha Sarana* and other religious performances for householders.

3..4.3. Conclusion

Thus, the Mahima Dharma had stimulated the social and religious life of the people of Odisha in 19th century. This Mahima Dharmawas quite simple. The common men were attracted towards it because it was free from the ritualistic practices of the Brahmins. Though it arose in Odisha in 19th Century Renaissance but it was never influenced by the latter. In its doctrine it was quite different from other religious sects, uninfluenced and unbiased by the prevailing currents of time. The Mahima Dharma spontaneously in the nook and corner of Odisha and outside .

3.4.4. Summary

- The 19th century Renaissance in India had greatly influenced Odisha.
- On the other hand, Odisha's Renaissance was different because it bloomed from a very rural set up being uninfluenced by any western education.
- In thought and expression, it emerged in its own unique way in the form of Mahima Dharma.
- Mahima Dharma appeared in the early part of 19th century A.D. as a religion in the Hindu reform movement.
- The founder of this *dharma* was Mahima Gosain.
- By the efforts of Bhima Bhoi, the blind poet, it was spread in the nook and corner of Odisha
- Mahima Dharma was founded by Mahima Swami or Mahima Gosain. He reached Puri around 1826 from where he started *Mahimabada.*
- Through his great literary creation like *Stuti Chintamani, Brahmanirupana Gita, Nirveda Sadhana, Chautisa Madhuchakra, Adyanta Gita, Astakabihari Gita* etc., he popularised the Mahima Cult.
- From 1862 to 1867 Mahima Dharma spread like wild fire in the nook and corner of Odisha.
- Mahima Gosain breathed his last in 1867. The disciples of Mahima Gosain became famous as Mahima monks *Alekha sanyasi*.
- The great saint Bhima Bhoi played a key role for the spread of Mahima Dharma.
- He was born in 1855 at Rairakhol in Kondh family. His father was Dhaneswar Bhoi and mother was Gauri. Bhima Bhoi was born-blind.
- Believing in one god was the principle of Mahima Gosain. He preached his doctrine in Odia language.
- The Mahima cult urges for pure Non-Dualism. According to it, God is one and next to none.
- He is omniscient, omnipotent and omnipresent. He is the supreme soul and the cause of the creation of the world.
- Mahima Dharma was against idol worship. Like Buddhism and Jainism, Mahima dharma raised voice against the superstitions of Brahmanism.

- This Dharma was against the caste system in the society and raised voice against the caste system in Odisha.
- Mahima Dharma believed in the principle of Vasudhaivakutumbakam.
- The Mahima doctrine conceived the whole universe as a single family and desires the welfare of all.
- Happiness for all and peace to all is the motto of Mahima dharma.
- It was essentially a Bhakti Cult whose philosophy is *Visuddha-advaita Brahmaveda.*
- The Mahima Dharma has always given importance on the values of life.
- It emphasized that one should cultivate qualities like love, compassion, tranquility etc. in one's mind which will bring fullness of heart.
- The Mahima Cult prescribed certain ethical codes for the householders.
- Thus, the Mahima Dharma had stimulated the social and religious life of the people of Odisha in 19th century.

3.4.5. Exercise

- **Write a note on Mahima Dharma.**
- **Discuss the doctrines of Mahima Dharma.**
- **Highlight the role of Mahima Swami and Bhima Bhoi in spreading Mahima Dharma in Odisha and outside.**
- **Discuss how Mahima Dharma brought social and religious changes in Odisha in 19th century.**

3.4.6. Further Reading

- K. C. Jena, Socio-Economic History of Odisha during British Period. Delhi. 1978.
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UNIT-4
Chapter-I

Odia Movement: Growth of Socio-Political Associations, Growth of Public Associations in the 19th Century, Role of Utkal Sammilini (1903-1920)

Structure

4.1.0. Objectives

4.1.1. Odia Movement

4.1.2. Growth of socio-political Associations and Growth of Public Associations in 19th Century

4.1.3. Role of Utkala Sammilani (1903-1920)

4.1.4. Loyalist nature of Utkal Sammilani

4.1.5. Conclusion

4.1.6. Summary

4.1.7. Exercise

3.1.8. Further Reading

4.1.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Odia Movement: Growth of Socio-Political Associations, Growth of Public Associations in the 19th Century, Role of Utkal Sammilini (1903-1920). After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the Odia Movement*
- *understand the Growth of Socio-Political Associations*
- *know about the Growth of Public Associations in the 19th Century*
- *evaluate the role of Utkal Sammilini (1903-1920)*

4.1.1. Odia Movement

The country (Odisha) whose territory extended from Ganga to Godavari was disintegrated in course of time. The disintegration was started from the death of Mukundadeva up to the period of 1936. Due to dismemberment, the Odia-speaking territories virtually became attached to four provinces - Bengal, Madras, Central Provinces and Bihar, and being reduced to the status of linguistic minorities in all these provinces. The Odias felt neglected and dominated by the linguistic majorities, and particularly felt distressed at the deliberate efforts to abolish Odia language. The new elite that emerged in Odisha in the latter half of the nineteenth century raised its voice for the unification of Odia-speaking areas so as to safeguard the legitimate interests of Odias and preserve and develop the Odia language and culture. It may be noted here that some British officials realized the injustice of keeping the Odias divided in different provinces. As early as 1855, Henry Ricketts, the Commissioner of Odisha Division proposed the merger of Sambalpur with the Odisha Division. In 1868, Sir Stafford Northcote, the Secretary of State for India, held the view that for the purpose of better administration, the Odia speaking areas should be grouped into a single administrative unit.

4.1.2. Growth of socio-political Associations and Growth of Public Associations in 19th Century

The 19th century witnessed the growth of socio-political associations and public associations in Odisha. The educated middle class that emerged in Odisha in the post-famine period, like its counterpart elsewhere, expressed its ideas, views and aspirations through the press, meetings, and associations. A number of socio-political associations and public associations, having different objectives such as the development of Odia language and literature, protection of the interests of Odias, social reform, promotion of education and intellectual and literary discussions

were formed in the post-famine period. The lead in this field was taken by some Englishmen who formed at Cuttack an association, called Mutual Improvement Society in 1859.

These Englishmen used to discuss social issues. Subsequently following associations were formed - Utkal Bhasa Unnati Bidhayini Sabha (Association for the development of Odia language), Balasore, 1867; Utkal Bhasa Uddipani Samaj (Association for Odia Linguistic Awakening), Cuttack, 1867; Utkalollasini Sabha (Association for awakening the Odias), Cuttack, 1868; Cuttack Debating Club, 1868; Cuttack Young men's Association, 1869; Utkal Brahmo Samaj; 1869; Puri , Society, 1870; Ganjam, Utkal Hitabadini Sabha (Ganjam Association for the promotion of welfare of Odisha), Berhampur, 1872; Bhadrak Desha Hiaishini Sabha (Bhadrak Association for the welfare of the country), 1874; Ganjam Nisha Nishedhini Sabha (Ganjam Association for prohibition), 1875; Utkal Sabha, Cuttack, 1877; Balasore National Society, 1878; Madak Seban Nibarini Sabha (Association for the prohibition of wine drinking), 1879; Shiksha Bidhayini Sabha (Association for the Promotion of Education),1881; Utkal Sabha or Odisha People's Association, 1882; Anti-Corruption and Prohibition Sabha, Cuttack, 1884; Odisha Graduate and Undergraduate Association, 1888; Utkal Sahitya Sammilani (Odia Literary Association), Cuttack, 1886; Balasore Zilla School Reading Club; 1896; and Alochana ,Sabha ,of Cuttack Secondary Training School, 1893.

There were some communal and caste-based associations, such as Karan Sabha, Odisha Islam Association, 1875 and Odisha Christian, Association, Cuttack, 1896. The educated elite of Odisha like the elite elsewhere in India, sought to reform the social life through such measures as promotion of education and uplift and emancipation of women. They were also influenced and inspired by social reform movements in other parts of India. But the slow progress of education and lack of strong intellectual elite slackened the process of social regeneration.

4.1.3. Role of Utkala Sammilani (1903-1920)

The Utkala Sammilanni played the key role for the Odia movement as well as the formation of separate province of Odisha. In 1902 the Odias of Ganjam sent a memorial, signed by a large number of people, to the Viceroy Lord Curzon, suggesting the unification of Ganjam, Sambalpur and the Odisha Division of the Bengal presidency under one government and one university. Towards the end of the year, Raja Baikuntha Nath De, the zamindar of Balasore submitted a memorial to Viceroy Lord Curzon, suggesting the unification of all Odia-speaking territories under the provincial governments of Bengal, Madras or the Central provinces. Early in 1903, at

Rambha, on the shore of Chilka, some people met under the chairmanship of the raja of Khalikote, and formed the Ganjam Jatiya Samiti (Ganjam National Association).

Under the auspices of this association in April 1903, a conference was held at Berhampur under the chairmanship of Shyam Sundar Rajguru. This conference which was attended by delegates from all parts of Odisha - Cuttack, Puri, Balasore and Sambalpur resolved that the proceedings of the Odia national conferences should be recorded and that the national conferences should be held annually. In the meantime, Lord Curzon's Government drew up a plan for the addition of Sambalpur and its adjoining feudatory states, Ganjam district and the Ganjam and Vizagpatnam Agencies to the Odisha Division. Early in December, 1903, the plan was circulated among the governments of Central Provinces, Madras and Bengal for eliciting their opinions. This plan is known as Risley Circular, being circulated by Henry Risley, the Secretary to the Government of India.

In pursuance of the Berhampur resolution, the first Odia national conference was held at Cuttack on 30-31 December, 1903 through the efforts of Madhusudan Das, Rajendranarayan Bhanja Deo (the zamindar of Kanika) and Shriram Chandra Bhanjadeo (the Maharaja of Mayurbhanja). The conference met under the chairmanship of the Maharaja of Mayurbhanja and was attended by delegates from all parts of Odisha, some Europeans lawyers, zamindars, government officials and students. The conference accepted the scheme of the unification of Odia tracts as suggested in the Risley Circular. The conference laid down the foundation of a truly Odia national organisation, called Utkal Sammilani (Utkal Union Conference). Hereafter, under the leadership of Madhusudan Das, the Utkal Sammilani continued to meet year after year in different places in Odisha. The primary objective of Utkal Sammiiani was the merger of Odia-speaking tracts. But the Sammilani also concerned itself with the all round development of Odias and took up such issues as industrial development, spread of education, revival of cottage industries, social reforms, establishment of separate university for Odisha, development of agriculture and development of Odia language and literature.

4.1.4. Loyalist nature of Utkal Sammilani

The Utkal Sammilani was loyalist in nature. It always began its session by paying tributes to the British Crown and Viceroy. It aimed at achieving its goal by appeal to colonial government's justice and fairness and not through active popular agitation. It was dominated by feudal elements like rajas and zamindars who, generally speaking, had denied their subjects basic

rights and benefits of an enlightened administration. Though the Utkal Sammilani was pre-dominantly an elitist organisation, comprising the rajas, zamindars and gentry, yet its claim to represent Odias as a nation can not be denied. It is because it aimed at unifying Odia tracts and promoting the all round development of Odisha. The princes and zamindars who dominated the Sammilani were bound up with the common masses by the ties of language, religion and social custom. Some efforts were also made to give a mass base to the Utkal Sarnmllan]. Initially 381 branches were organised by 15 paid missionaries not only in Orlssa Division but also in Midnapore, Calcutta, Ganjam, Sambalpur and princely states. In certain areas of Ganjam and Koraput districts (undivided) public involvement and participation could be roused for the Sammilani. But such public enthusiasm was temporary. On the whole the Utkal Sammilanl failed to be a mass organisation; it remained confined to the elite and Madhusudan Das remained its guiding spirit from 1903 to 1920 A.D..

4.1.5. Conclusion

Thus, the Odia movement led to the growth of socio-political associations and growth of public associations in 19th century Odisha. The political consciousness of the new Odia elite manifested itself in two ways. First, it took up the cause of safeguarding the interests of Odias who were scattered in different provinces, and finally agitated for the merger of Odia-speaking areas. Secondly, it partook of national political consciousness over such matters as controversy regarding Vernacular Press Act, introduction of local self-government by Lord Ripon Government and the formation of the Indian National Congress, etc.

4.1.6. Summary

- The country (Odisha) whose territory extended from Ganga to Godavari was disintegrated in course of time.
- The disintegration was started from the death of Mukundadeva up to the period of 1936.
- Due to dismemberment, the Odia-speaking territories virtually became attached to four provinces - Bengal, Madras, Central Provinces and Bihar, and being reduced to the status of linguistic minorities in all these provinces.
- The Odias felt neglected and dominated by the linguistic majorities, and particularly felt distressed at the deliberate efforts to abolish Odia language.

- The new elite that emerged in Odisha in the latter half of the nineteenth century raised its voice for the unification of Odia-speaking areas so as to safeguard the legitimate interests of Odias and preserve and develop the Odia language and culture.
- The 19th century witnessed the growth of socio-political associations and public associations in Odisha.
- The educated middle class that emerged in Odisha in the post-famine period, like its counterpart elsewhere, expressed its ideas, views and aspirations through the press, meetings, and associations.
- A number of socio-political associations and public associations, having different objectives such as the development of Odia language and literature, protection of the interests of Odias, social reform, promotion of education and intellectual and literary discussions were formed in the post-famine period.
- The lead in this field was taken by some Englishmen who formed at Cuttack an association, called Mutual Improvement Society in 1859.
- These Englishmen used to discuss social issues.
- Subsequently following associations were formed - Utkal Bhasa Unnati Bidhayini Sabha (Association for the development of Odia language), Balasore, 1867; Utkal Bhasa Uddipani Samaj (Association for Odia Linguistic Awakening), Cuttack, 1867; Utkalollasini Sabha (Association for awakening the Odias), Cuttack, 1868; Cuttack Debating Club, 1868, etc.
- There were some communal and caste-based associations, such as Karan Sabha, Odisha Islam Association, 1875 and Odisha Christian, Association, Cuttack, 1896.
- The educated elite of Odisha like the elite elsewhere in India, sought to reform the social life through such measures as promotion of education and uplift and emancipation of women.
- The Utkala Sammilanni played the key role for the Odia movement as well as the formation of separate province of Odisha.
- In 1902 the Odias of Ganjam sent a memorial, signed by a large number of people, to the Viceroy Lord Curzon, suggesting the unification of Ganjam, Sambalpur and the Odisha Division of the Bengal presidency under one government and one university.
- In pursuance of the Berhampur resolution, the first Odia national conference was held at Cuttack on 30-31 December, 1903 through the efforts of Madhusudan Das,

Rajendranarayan Bhanja Deo (the zamindar of Kanika) and Shriram Chandra Bhanjadeo (the Maharaja of Mayurbhanja).

- The Utkal Sammilani was loyalist in nature. It always began its session by paying tributes to the British Crown and Viceroy.
- Thus, the Odia movement led to the growth of socio-political associations and growth of public associations in 19th century Odisha.

4.17. Exercise

- **Give an account on Odia movement in 19th century.**
- **Write a note on the growth of socio-political associations in Odisha in 19th century.**
- **Make an analysis on the growth of public associations in 19th century Odisha.**
- **Highlight the role of Utkal Sammilani (1903-1920) for the Odia movement.**

3.1.8. Further Reading

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UNIT-4
Chapter-II

Nationalist movement in Odisha:
Non-cooperation and Civil Disobedience Movements in Odisha

Structure

4.2.0. Objectives

4.2.1. Introduction

4.2.2. Nationalist movement in Odisha

4.2.2.1. Nationalist movement in Odisha before Gandhiji

4.2.2.2. Other early members of Odisha Congress

4.2.2.3. Impact of Swadeshi Movement on Odisha

4.2.2.4. Nationalist movement in Odisha during Gandhian Period

4.2.2.5. Impact of Khilafat Movement

4.2.3. Non-cooperation Movement in Odisha

4.2.3.1. Response towards the Non-cooperation Movement in Odisha

4.2.3.2. Programmes of Non-co-operation in Odisha

4.2.3.4. Mahatma Gandhi's first visit to Odisha

4.2.3.5. Kanika movement

4.2.4. The Civil Disobedience Movement in Odisha

4.2.4.1. Beginning of Civil Disobedience Movement in Odisha

4.2.4.2. S alt *Satyagraha* in different places of Odisha

4.2.4.3. End of Civil Disobedience movement in Odisha

4.2.4.4. Individual Civil Disobedience Movement in Odisha

4.2.5. Conclusion

4.2.6. Summary

4.2.7 Exercise

4.2.8. Further Reading

4.2.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Nationalist movement in Odisha: Non-cooperation and Civil Disobedience Movements in Odisha.After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the Nationalist movement in Odisha*
- *understand the Non-cooperation Movements in Odisha*
- *know about the Civil Disobedience Movements in Odisha*

4.2.1. Introduction

The second half of the 19th century witnessed the growth of organized nationalist movement in India. It arose to meet the challenge of foreign domination. The direct and indirect consequences of British rule provided the material, moral and intellectual conditions for the development of nationalist movement in India. In this connection, Odisha as a part of the nation also witnessed the reflections of it. In Odisha, nationalism developed in two different ways. First, the merger of all Odia-speaking regions, and secondly, in the later phase with the growth of national awakening, the people of Odisha involved themselves with the mainstream of the national movement along with the rest of the country. However, the focus of the paper will be on the nationalist movement in Odisha. In fact, the history of nationalist movement in Odisha, despite the local differences and issues, was an expression of forces that represent an integral part of the all-India freedom struggle against British Raj.

4.2.2. Nationalist movement in Odisha

In true sense, the term of nationalism developed in India with the establishment of INC at Bombay, although it was limited to the elite class only. However, the political awakening of the elite class did not percolate down to the common man. The nationalist movement in Odisha can be divided into two periods (1) from the establishment of Indian National Congress i.e. 1885 to 1920 A.D., and (2) the Gandhian period from 1920A.D. to 1947 A.D.

4.2.2.1. Nationalist movement in Odisha before Gandhiji

Being influenced by the nationalist movement in India, the elite class of Odisha created political awareness in Odisha. Different organizations like the National Society at Balasore, Odsha Association also known as Utkal Sabha at Cuttack and the Utkal Hitaisini Samaj at

Paralakhimedi were some of the early socio-political organizations formed by the intellectuals of Odisha who disseminate political ideas among the Odias. Leaders like Madhusudan Das, Baikuntanath De and Shyamsunder Raiguru etc provided guidance to these elite organizations. With the establishment of INC in 1885, these leaders served as a link between the national forum and Odisha. These organizations sent delegates to the annual sessions of INC. On 3rd March, 1886 an open meeting was held in the building of the Cuttack Printing Company which unanimously approved the resolutions, passed in the first session of the Indian National Congress, held at Bombay in 1885.

In the Calcutta session of the Congress in 1886, Raja Baikunthanath attended on behalf of National Society of Balasore. In 1988, Madhusudan Das and Gouri Shankar Roy attended the Madras Session of INC as delegates from Utkal Sabha. A meeting was held at Cuttack on 16 February, 1888 which deputed Madhusudan Das to Kendrapara where he exhorted the people to join the Congress. He was the pioneer in spreading the Congress ideas in Odisha. In 1895, Shyam Sunder Raiguru, the founder of the Utkal Haitesini Samaj of Paralakhemndi had attended the Poona Session of the Congress. These delegates on their return from the Congress session apprised the other members about the programmes of the Congress.

4.2.2.2. Other early members of Odisha Congress

Besides the above members, other Odia intellectuals whom the Indian National Congress fascinated in the 19th century were Fakir Mohan Senapati, Bhagabat Prasad Mohapatra, Nanda Kishor Bal, Gopal Chandra Praharaj, Biswanath Kar, Madhusudan Rao, Gokulananda Choudhury, Prince Padmanav Narayan Deb, Jagmohan Lal, Ram Shankar Roy, Lokanath Samantaray, Md. Abdul Satar, Dharanidhar Mishra and Baikuntha Nath Pujari etc. The early Odia delegates who attended the Congress belonged to the English-educated elite class and were moderate in their political outlook. These leaders from Odisha could not raise their voice in the annual proceedings of the Congress because of the high status maintained by the great nationalist leaders from Bengal. So, the problems of Odisha could not be placed in the Congress agenda for discussion. Because of this reason, there were only a sum total of fourteen delegates from Odisha from 1885 to 1900 who had attended the annual sessions of the Congress on six occasions only.

On the other hand, Madhusudan Das, realized the uselessness of the Congress as a political forum in Odisha. He thought that the Odias needed a regional association in order to express their identity and to give political education to the people of Odisha. Apart from this a sense of unity and awareness to the problems of the people of Odisha had to be achieved. With the above convictions, he formed the Utkal Union Conference in December 1903 with the support from the intellectuals of Odisha. The moderate period of the nationalist movement in Odisha was led by Madhusudan and his associates like R.N. Bhanj Deo, Baikuntha Nath De, Harihar Panda, Brajasunder Das and Biswanath Kar, etc. having faith in the British Raj. On the other hand, the Utkal Union Conference appealed to the British sense of justice and fair play.

4.2.2.3. Impact of Swadeshi Movement on Odisha

In 1905, the Swadeshi Movement started in Bengal in protest against the partition of Bengal which had a substantial influence on the intellectuals of Odisha. In this connection, protest meetings were held at Cuttack, Puri, Balasore, Sambalpur and other places to express empathy with the movement in Bengal. The Swadeshi agitators of Bengal laid stress on boycott of foreign goods and the manufacturing of indigenous goods which made a good impact on the Odia intellectuals. At Cuttack Janaki Nath Bose, Biswanath Kar and Dhirendera Nath Choudhury spread the massage of Swadeshi. A meeting was held in the Cuttack Municipal Hall under the presidentship of Babu Janakinath Bose on 20 August, 1905. Here Madhusudan Das gave a clarion call to the people of Odisha to boycott the foreign goods, particularly Manchester cloth and Liverpool salt, and to use the indigenous goods. The message of Swadeshi also reached Balasore and Puri. In September Abdus Sobhan Khan and Fakir Mohan Senapati organized large public meetings for the purpose at Balasore. At Puri, Haris Chandra Ghose and Dhanpati Banerjee led the students in a procession through the town and persuaded the business community to sell only Swadeshi goods and to boycott the foreign goods in their shops. Pandit Godabarish Mishra has mentioned that a bonfire of foreign clothes was made at Puri town. Many people in Balasore and Cuttack gave up the use of foreign clothes, salt and sugar.

The *Utkal Dipika* mentions that being inspired by the Swadeshi ideas, the weavers of Sambalpur, Banpur, Sukinda and Basudebpur started manufacturing fine hand loom textiles, and men and women of rich classes began to wear Berhampuri *pata* and Maniabandha *sari* on festive and other occasions. During the Dasserah festival the people purchased large quantity of local

made clothes. The swadeshi idea provoked Madhusudan Das to set up Utkal Tannery and an Art Ware at Cuttack. In this context, an exhibition of indigenous goods was held in the Cuttack Town hall on 7 August, 1907, on the occasion of the anniversary of the Swadeshi Sabha at Calcutta.

The Surat Split of the Congress in 1907 weakened the Moderates and brought a group of nationalists appeared under the leadership of Gopabbandhu in Odisha. The advent of Gopabandhu Das in Odisha politics brought a radical change in the political scenario of the state. Gopabandhu was an ultra-nationalist. In the beginning, he was a great follower of Madhusudan Das. An ideological conflict started between Madhusudan and Gopabandhu which ultimately ended with the victory of the latter.

In the Swadeshi movement, the Bengali agitators laid stress on National Education which appealed to Gopabandhu. On 12 August, 1909, he established an ideal school on the model of the Decan Education Society, called as Satyabadi Vana Vidyalaya at Sakhigopal, Puri. The establishment of Satyabadi School was a landmark in the evolution of national consciousness in Odisha. This institution became famous as a band of devoted and talented teachers like Pandit Nilakantha Das, Pandit Lingaraj Mishra, Acharya Harihar Das, Pandit Godabarish Mishra and Pandit Krupasindhu Mishra along with Gopabandhu introduced a new pattern of education most suitable to Indian society.

In this school, the teachers concerned themselves in building up their students into ideal citizens and also devoted their time to social reforms in the surrounding villages. For about 40 years the school provided leadership in the sphere of political social and literary activities in Odisha. The teachers and alumni of this school proved themselves worthy citizens and made the people of Odisha politically aware about the national movement in India. However, the extremist phase of the national movement raised its head after the Swadeshi movment. A group of radical youths of Bengal started terrorist activities under the leadership of Jatindranath Mukherjee, popularly known as Bagha Jatin. They used Balasore and Kaptipada jungle areas as the bases to raid on British institutions. However, Bagha Jatin died in an encounter with the police while his friends Manoranjan and Hiren were hanged. In this context, 3 young men of Odisha Atal Bihari Acharya, Sasanka Mukherjee and Bairagi Tripathy were taken into police custody for having their connection with the Bengal terrorists.

4.2.2.4. Nationalist movement in Odisha during Gandhian Period

The post World War-I had brought a radical change in the political scenario of India. In the First World War, the Indians had fought at the call of Gandhiji for the British victory with the expectation that in recognition of their services during the war, the British would give the Indians substantial measure of self-government. A number of students of the Ravenshaw College, led by Jadumani Mangaraj joined the British army for rendering help to the British in the war. However, the expectations of the Indians could not fulfill.

4.2.2.5. Impact of Khilafat Movement

Soon after the First World War, the Muslims of India started the Khilafat agitation against the British Government, because in the war Britain won against the Ottoman Empire, the head of which was the Calipha, the religious head of the Islamic world. Britain now placed humiliating term against the Calipha. So, the Muslims all over the world including the Muslims of India started agitation against the British. The Muslims in Odisha also started the Khilafat agitation. They formed a Khilafat Committee at Cuttack under the presidency of Akram Rusool.

4.2.3. Non-cooperation Movement in Odisha

Three important events like passing of Rowlatt Acts, Khilafat movement and Jalianawallabagh massacre occurred just after the end of the World War I which prompted the Indian nationalists to act against the British. The Rowlatt Acts were passed to suppress the freedom of Indians, and the Government of India Act, 1919, failed to satisfy the aspirations of the Indians. Protesting against the Jalianawallabagh massacre and Khilafat Movement, the Congress under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi decided in its special session, held at Calcutta in September, 1920, to start the Non-cooperation movement against the British Government.

In September1920, Gopabandhu attended this special session and returned from it, being imbued with staunch nationalist ideas. Although Madhusudan Das had associated himself with the Congress in the early phase, subsequently he kept himself aloof from it being unable to get support from the Congress leaders for the merger of Odia tracts. He kept himself preoccupied with the Odia movement. Subsequently in 1920, when Gandhi started the Non-cooperation movement, there was practically no Congress organization working in Odisha.

At the clarion call of Gandhi in 1920-21, Gopabandhu Das virtually started once again the Congress movement in Odisha. The Nagpur Session of the Indian National Congress, held in December, 1920, which finally passed the Non-Cooperation resolution, was attended by a number of delegates from Odisha such as Pandit Gopabandhu Das, Bhagirathi Mahapatra, Jagabandhu Singh, Jadumani Mangaraj, Mukunda Prasad Das, Niranjan Patanaik, and Harekrushna Mahatab. This session of the Congress decided to form the Provincial Congress Committees on linguistic basis. As a result a separate Provincial Congress Committee was formed for Odisha even though Odisha was not a separate province at that time. Soon after the Nagpur Congress session, the Utkal Union Conference was held at Chakradharpur under the presidentship of Jagabandhu Singh. In this conference Gopabandhu Das suggested a modification in the outlook of the Utkal Union Conference. He held that though the merger of all Odia speaking areas was a vital issue for Odias, yet Odisha should not remain aloof from the mainstream of national consciousness, represented by the Congress. He proposed that the aims and objects of the Indian National Congress be accepted as those of the Utkal Union conference in addition to the accepted objectives of the conference. "This was passed by the Conference, even though quite a number of people including the president of the conference abstained from voting on it as a mark of dissent.

On his return from Chakradharpur, Gopabandhu held a public meeting at Cuttack on 24 January, 1921 and exhorted the students to join the Non-Cooperation Movement. Mahatma Gandhi came to Odisha in March, 1921 and in his addresses to the people at Cuttack, Puri, Bhadrak and Berhampur he appealed to them to join the Non-cooperation movement. The Utkal Provincial Congress Committee consisted of Gopabhandhu as President, Ekram Rasool as Vice-President, Bhagirathi Mahapatra as Secretary and Brajabandhu Das as Joint Secretary. The Utkal Provincial Congress Committee deputed the following twelve members to represent Odisha in the A.I.C.C. like (1) Gopabandhu Das, (2) Jagabandhu Singh, (3) Nilakantha Das, (4) Gopabandhu Choudhury, (6) Niranjan Pattanaik, (6) Harekrushna Mahatab, (7) Bhagirathi Mahapatra, (8) Dharanidhar Mishra Banaprastha, (9) Nilakantha Das Chaudhuri, (10) Atal Bihari Acharya, (11) Brajamohan Panda, (12) Jamini Kanta Biswas. On the other hand, District and Sub-divisional Committees were also formed in Puri, Cuttack, Balasore, Sambalpur and Ganjam under the charge of the following persons.

I. Harekrushna Mahatab - Balasore district.
II. Jadumani Mangaraj -Kendrapara Subdivision of Cuttack district.
III. Rajakrushna Bose- Jajpur Subdivision of Cuttack district.
IV. Bhagirathi Mahapatra - Cuttack Sadar Subdivision with head-quarters at Alakashram, Jagatsinghpur.
V. Jagabandhu Singh and Krupasindhu Mishra - Puri District.
VI. Nilakantha Das - Sambalpur district.
VII. Niranjan Pattnaik - Ganjam district

4.2.3.1. Response towards the Non-cooperation Movement in Odisha

Mahatma Gandhi's call brought nationwide response including Odisha. A number of young persons left their schools, colleges and Government service in Odisha. H.K. Mahatab, N. Kanungo, Nabakrushna Choudhury and R.K. Bose left their studies at the call of Gandhiji and joined the Non-cooperation movement. Gopabandhu Choudhury resigned from his lucrative post of deputy collector. Bhagirathi Mahapatra, a prominent lawyer at that time gave up his legal job and joined the movement. Surendra Nath De, a sub-inspector of police and Muhammed Hanif, an excise sub-inspector resigned from their service and joined the Non-cooperation movemnt. Mahendranath Verma and Achutananda Purohit, the two promising lawyers of Sambalpur gave up their legal practice. On the other hand, Raja Krushna Bose discontinued his Medical studies and joined the movement.

The Congress workers of Odisha involved themselves whole heartedly to work out the Gandhian programmes of Non-co-operation movement in Odisha under the leadership of Gopabandhu Das. The weekly news paper Samaj started by Gopabandhu played an important role in spreading the nationalist ideas during the Non-cooperation movement in Odisha. For training the Congress volunteers and workers, two institutions like Swaraj Ashram of Cuttack and Alaka Ashram of Jagatsinghpur were established by Odisha Congress leaders. The students also established Swaraj Sevak Sangha at Cuttack for working out the programmes of Non-co-operation. Gopabandhu’s efforts to include Odisha with the main stream of nationalist movement did not go in vain. Throughout Odisha, a wave of unprecedented enthusiasm for the INC was noticed.

4.2.3.2. Programmes of Non-co-operation in Odisha

Non-cooperation meant the withdrawal of cooperation from the British Government in all aspects. The programme of Non-co-operation movement had two phases of actions. The first phase of the programme consisted of (a) boycott of schools and colleges by students and teachers, (b) boycott of British goods, (c) boycott of courts by lawyers and judges, and (d) boycott of services by the Government services, etc. The second phase of actions included (a) promotion of *Khadar* , (b) Hindu-Muslim unity, (c) removal of untouchability, and (d) promotion of national education through the establishment of National schools and colleges. As a mark of protest, picketing and burning of foreign cloths was undertaken in each and every district of the state. The picketing of foreign cloth was entirely successful at Jaleswar in Balasore district. A dealer of foreign cloths was fined by the Congress workers for dealing in foreign cloth at Jaleswar. The Congress workers of Swaraj Mandir also energetically carried on picketing against the foreign cloth shops at Balasore.

4.2.3.4. Mahatma Gandhi's first visit to Odisha

Mahatma Gandhi visited Odisha for the first time in March 1921. His visit gave a tremendous fillip to the Non-Cooperation movement in Odisha. The people of Odisha extended warm welcome to him. In every railway station large crowds of people gathered to have a glimpse of their leader i.e. Mahatma Gandhi. He reached Cuttack on 23 March 1921, and in the evening he addressed a large gathering on the Kathjuri river bed at Cuttack. In his speech, he appealed to the people of Odisha to make their contribution Tilak Swaraj Fund for getting Swaraj. Besides the promotion of Hindu-Muslim unity in the state, he set the targets for the people of Odisha like (a)enrolment of one lakh Congress members, (b) distribution of one lakh *Charkhas* (spinning wheels) and (c) collection of three lakhs of rupees for the Tilak Swaraj fund. Some news papers like 'The Samaj' and 'Utkal Sevak' played an important role in inspiring the common mass to participate in the national movement.

His visit intensified the common man's zeal and enthusiasm for the cause of nationalist movement in Odisha. Harekrushna Mahtab emphasized Gandhi's importance on *Swaraj* as the birth right of the people. In 1921, Gopabandhu went to Calcutta for enlisting the Congress members from among the Odia labour population at Calcutta. His stimulating speech to the Odias in Calcutta made a deep impact. At the call of Gopabandhu, many Odia labourers left the shops having foreign articles. Their refusal to carry foreign cloth was so successful in the

Burrabazar area of Calcutta that business in that area came to standstill. Some national schools were established in Odisha. On the other hand, the Satyabadi School of Gopabandhu was converted into a national school. Another national school was established at Nayabazar of Cuttack town by Madhusudan-Biswal, Damodar Mohanty and Atal Bihari Acharya. The curriculum of this school included such subjects as Hindi, Ayurveda, spinning, weaving and carpentry. Another national school of education was also established at Jagatsinghpur.

4.2.3.5. Kanika movement

In 1922 a peasant's revolt in the zamindari of Kanika occurred which was closely associated with the Non-co-operation movement. The zamindari of Kanika was situated in Cuttack as well as Balasore districts of Odisha. The peasants of Kanika revolted against the Raja of Kanika who was collecting various kinds of taxes and exploiting the people in many ways. The peasant's revolt initially had no connection with Non-cooperation movement. But the raja of Kanika, convinced the Government that agitation against him was engineered by the Congress and was a part of the Non-co-operation movement. The Government in order to suppress the revolt, started harsh oppression against the peasants of Kanika. To speak against the raja of Kanika was tantamount to treason. Many people tortured and women were molested. Rich persons like Khandeita Roy and Ashwini Kumar Palei were not only lost their landed property but also expelled from the estate.

The Congress leaders protested against this unfair oppression upon the innocent peasants of Kanika. In order to protest against the repression of the raja of Kanika, Gopabandhu and Bhagirathi Mahapatra came to Bhadrak to hold a meeting. The two leaders were not allowed to hold any public meeting in the region. However, with much difficulty they held a meeting at Bhadrak. For holding this meeting both the leaders were arrested and sentenced to six months imprisonment. During this time arsons were taking place in Cuttack and Balasore. On one occasion, seized with anxiety, some people of the Cuttack town assaulted a police constable. The constable was severely wounded and rescued by Gopabandhu Das. He was brought to the Swaraj Ashram where he was given medical aid, food to eat and a *Khadar* cloth to wear. Later the constable complained in the court that Gopabandhu had assaulted him and compelled him to wear the *Khadar* cloth. On this charge Gopabandhu Das and Bhagirathi Mahapatra were

sentenced to two years imprisonment. However, most of the Congress leaders of Odisha were arrested by the end of 1922.

Despite its limitations, the Non-cooperation movement roused an unparalleled political stir in Odisha. The widespread lecture tours of Gopabandhu and his associates made the people familiar with the Congress programme and roused the political knowledge of the people of Odisha. Unlike the movement of Utkal Union Conference, the Non-cooperation movement reached the common mass. By the end of 1921, about fifty two thousand Congressmen were enrolled in Odisha. After the suspension of the Non-co-operation movement, following the Chaurichaura incident in U.P. early in 1922, the Congress party was divided into two groups; while some wanted to enter the legislatures under the Government of India Act, 1919, and some wanted to work out the constructive programme of Gandhiji while boycotting the legislatures.

The Swaraj party was formed in Odisha in 1923. It looked for the Dominion Status and adopted such method as 'obstructionism' in the legislatures and Local Boards. The Congressmen like Godavarish Mishra, Jagabandhu Singh and Radharanajan Das were elected from Odisha to the Bihar and Odisha Provincial Legislative Council and Nilakantha Das was elected for Central Legislative Assembly.

After the release from jail Gopabandhu devoted himself to the Congress movement in Odisha. On the other hand, H.K. Mahtab, after his release from jail, started to work out the Gandhian constructive programme in his home district. He also started a weekly newspaper, called *Prajatantra* at Balasore on 2 September 1923. Madhusudan Das who had distanced himself from the Congress and the Non-cooperation movement became a member of the Congress in the Utkal Pradesh Congress Conference, held at Cuttack in 1924 under the presidentship of Acharya Prafulla Chandra Roy, the eminent chemist of Bengal. A women's branch was formed by Ramadevi, Saraladevi and others to strengthen the Congress organization in Odisha. Gandhiji visited Odisha in August 1925 and again in 1927 which provided boost to the Congress workers apart from popularizing his programme. A number of Congress Ashrams were established through the initiative Mahatab in different parts of the Balasore district. Gopabandhu met Lala Lajpat Roy at Calcutta in 1926. At his request Gopabandhu became a member of the servants of the People Society. Gopabandhu founded a branch of the Servants of the People Society at Cuttack and associated his news paper *Samaj* to it. At the Lahore meeting

of the Society, Gopabandhu was elected as the vice-president of the Society in 1928. However, he met a premature death at the age of 52 on 17 June 1928 which was an irreparable loss to Odisha and Congress organization in Odisha.

4.2.4. The Civil Disobedience Movement in Odisha

The Civil Disobedience Movement formed another landmark in the nationalist movement in Odisha. The Lahore session of the INC, held in December 1929, declared complete independence as its goal to be achieved by Civil Disobedience. The 26th January 1930, was celebrated as the day of independence by the Congress men of Odisha and at Cuttack, Gopabandhu Choudhury read out the declaration of independence. During this time some Congressmen of Odisha resigned from the 'Bihar and Odisha Legislative Council and Central Legislative Assembly in order to take part in the Civil Disobedience Movement.

4.2.4.1. Beginning of Civil Disobedience Movement in Odisha

Gandhiji started his march with 78 followers from the Sabarmati Ashram towards Dandi on 12 March 1930, for manufacturing salt in violation of salt laws made by the British. The Odisha Congress leaders like Gopabandhu Choudhury and Harekrushna Mahatab planned to launch a similar agitation in Odisha for violation of salt law of the British Government . In March 1930, the Utkal Provincial Congress Committee decided to launch the Civil Disobedience Movement in Odisha by manufacturing contraband salt at Inchudi near Balasore and Gopabandhu Choudhury was given the responsibility for organizing the movement. On the other hand Harekrushna Mahtab, and Surendranath Das of Balasore mobilized the villagers in the surrounding villages of Inchudi to take part in the salt agitation. On 6 April 1930 Gopabandhu Chaudhury, Acharya Harihar Das, and twenty one Satyagrahis began their foot march from the Swarajya Ashram of Cuttack towards Inchudi in Balsore. In order to suppress the movement on 8th April 1930 Gopabandhu Choudhury was arrested at Chandol for having addressed a meeting at Cuttack on 23 March1930. Now, Acharya Harihar became the next commander of Satyagrahis.

On 12 April, 1930, the *Satyagrahis* led by Acharya Harihar, reached at lnchudi in Balasore. Large number of *Satyagrahis* from various parts of Odisha like Puri, Ganjam, Sarnbalpur and Baripada joined them. Despite the oppression by the police, the *Satyagrahis* manufactured the contraband salt at Inchudi on 14 April 1930. After that Acharya Harihar and his associates and Surendra Nath Das were arrested. The manufacturing of salt continued there for a number of days in spite of the police oppression. On 20th April, led by Ramadevi, and Malati Devi, a number of women took part in the Salt *Satyagraha* at Inchudi, The Salt *Satyagraha* at Inchudi was highly successful. It was considered next only to Gandhi's *Satyagraha* at Dandi.

4.2.4.2. Salt *Satyagraha* in different places of Odisha

The credit for arranging this Salt *Satyagraha* goes to the local Congress leader of Balasore, surendra Nath Das. This contraband salt was manufactured in other places of Odisha like Sartha (Balasore district), Kujang (Cuttack dlstrlct), Kuhudi, Singheswari and Latra (Puri district) and Huma (Ganjam district). The *Satyagraha* at Sartha was organised by Mathura Mohan Behera, Karunakar Panigrahi and Nilamber Das. In the Puri district Nilakantha Das and Jagannath Rath organised the salt *Satyagraha.* In the Ganjarn district the *Satyagraha* was led by Biswanath Das, Niranjan Patnaik and Sarala Devi. At Kujang, led by Rani Bhagyabati Devi of the Kujang royal family, 500 women took part in the manufacturing of contraband salt.

The Civil Disobedience was also carried on in other forms such as boycott of the foreign cloth, picketing before the excise shops, refusal to pay *Chowkidari* tax, and spread *of Khadi.* The school as well as college students also took active part in the Civil Disobedience Movement. The volunteers were physically harassed by the police. Yet, the manufacturing of contraband salt continued. The common people supported the *Satyagrahis.* The Government arrested and imprisoned the leaders. On 26th April 1930 H, K Mahtab and Gopabandhy Chaudhury, the president and secretary of the U.P.C.C. were arrested at Balasore and sentenced to eighteen months rigorous imprisonment. The Congress offices and ashrams were seized in connection with Civil Disobedience Movement.

4.2.4.3. End of Civil Disobedience movement in Odisha

As an effect of the Gandhi-Irwin Pact on 5 March 1931, the Civil Disobedience movement was discontinued and Congress decided to participate in the second session of Round Table Conference at London. As a result of this agreement, many Congress leaders and volunteers of Odisha were released from the jail. They were given heroic reception in Balasore and Cuttack. Towards the end of December 1931, Gandhi returned broken hearted from the London Round Table Conference to India. After that the Civil Disobedience was resumed in Odisha as in the rest of India. The Government adopted repressive measures, such as arresting Congress leaders; seizing Congress offices in Puri, Cuttack, Sambalpur and Balasore districts. Due to repressive measures of the British Government, Congressmen like Surendra Nath Das, Nilambar Das, Binod Kanungo and Surendra Nath Patnaik, etc carried on underground movement in Odisha. However, the Civil Disobedience movement was suspended by Mahatma Gandhi on 7 April 1934 and it was cooled down in Odisha also. Thus, the Civil Disobedience movement had become active and the women leaders made this movement more popular.

From 1934 to 1940, the Utkal Pradesh Congress Committee and the Congress workers of Odisha devoted themselves to various constructive programmes of Gandhiji like *Charakha* programme, abolition of untouchability, Kisan movements, Harijan movement, etc. In May 1934 Gandhi made a Harijan tour to Odisha. He came from Jharsuguda to Puri. But he did not enter the temple of Lord Jagannath as the Harijans of Odisha had no access to it.

4.2.4.4. Individual Civil Disobedience Movement in Odisha

However, the Ramgarh session of the *Indian* National Congress, held *in* March 1940, decided to launch Individual Civil Disobedience Movement. It was also decided to work out with full vigour the Gandhian constructive programme and not to co-operate with the British Government in any form. The Congress volunteers were given training in Bari training camp about the civil disobedience and the *Gandhian* constructive programme. At the same time four departments were formed by the Utkal Pradesh Congress Committee for carrying out the party work in the state. The departments were (a) Programme Department, under H.K. Mahtab, (b) Harijan Department under the charge of Radhakrishna Biswas Roy, (c) Minority Department under Maulana Muhammad Atahar and (d) *Charkha* Department under a sub-committee UPCC. On 27 September 1940, the Utkal Pradesh Congress Committee appointed H.K. Mahtab as the general director of the Individual Civil Disobedience movement in Odisha and gave other

Congress leaders almost dictatorial powers to reorganize the Congress in their locality. According to the direction of the Congress high command the Congress Party of Odisha started the Individual Civil Disobedience Movement on 1st December 1940. H.K. Mahtab courted arrest after delivering an anti-war speech at Remuna on the same day. In this connection, nine others such as Bodhram Dubey, Sadasiva Tripathy, Sarala Devi, Lokanath Misra, Nityanand Kanungo, Mohan Das, Nabakrushna Chaudhury, Radhakwshria Biswas Roy and Biswanath Das were also arrested. Those who could not offer *Satyagraha* engaged themselves in the Gandhian constructive work. Towards the beginning of March 1941, the Individual Civil Disobedience had faded away.

4.2.5. Conclusion

Thus, the nationalist movement in Odisha which was started with the establishment of Indian National Congress in 1885, ended with the attainment of independence of India on 15th August 1947. The leaders and the common people of Odisha had whole heartedly supported and actively participated in all the national movements and decisions of the All India Congress Committee. All the three great movements like Non-cooperation Movement, Civil Disobedience Movement, and Quit India Movement were quite successful in Odisha.

4.2.6. Summary

- In Odisha, nationalism developed in two different ways.
- First, the merger of all Odia-speaking regions, and secondly, in the later phase with the growth of national awakening, the people of Odisha involved themselves with the mainstream of the national movement along with the rest of the country.
- The nationalist movement in Odisha can be divided into two periods (1) from the establishment of Indian National Congress i.e. 1885 to 1920 A.D., and (2) the Gandhian period from 1920A.D. to 1947 A.D.
- Being influenced by the nationalist movement in India, the elite class of Odisha created political awareness in Odisha.
- Different organizations like the National Society at Balasore, Odsha Association also known as Utkal Sabha at Cuttack and the Utkal Hitaisini Samaj at Paralakhimedi were some of the early socio-political organizations formed by the intellectuals of Odisha who disseminate political ideas among the Odias.

- Besides the above members, other Odia intellectuals whom the Indian National Congress fascinated in the 19th century were Fakir Mohan Senapati, Bhagabat Prasad Mohapatra, Nanda Kishor Bal, Gopal Chandra Praharaj, Biswanath Kar,etc.
- In 1905, the Swadeshi Movement started in Bengal in protest against the partition of Bengal which had a substantial influence on the intellectuals of Odisha.
- The post World War-I had brought a radical change in the political scenario of India.
- In the First World War, the Indians had fought at the call of Gandhiji for the British victory with the expectation that in recognition of their services during the war, the British would give the Indians substantial measure of self-government.
- Protesting against the Jalianawallabagh massacre and Khilafat Movement, the Congress under the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi decided in its special session, held at Calcutta in September, 1920, to start the Non-cooperation movement against the British Government.
- At the clarion call of Gandhi in 1920-21, Gopabandhu Das virtually started once again the Congress movement in Odisha.
- Mahatma Gandhi's call brought nationwide response including Odisha.
- A number of young persons left their schools, colleges and Government service in Odisha. H.K. Mahatab, N. Kanungo, Nabakrushna Choudhury and R.K. Bose left their studies at the call of Gandhiji and joined the Non-cooperation movement.
- Non-cooperation meant the withdrawal of cooperation from the British Government in all aspects.
- The programme of Non-co-operation movement had two phases of actions.
- Mahatma Gandhi visited Odisha for the first time in March 1921.
- His visit gave a tremendous fillip to the Non-Cooperation movement in Odisha.
- The people of Odisha extended warm welcome to him.
- In 1922 a peasant’s revolt in the zamindari of Kanika occurred which was closely associated with the Non-co-operation movement.
- After the suspension of the Non-co-operation movement, following the Chaurichaura incident in U.P. early in 1922, the Congress party was divided into two groups; while some wanted to enter the legislatures under the Government of India Act, 1919, and some

wanted to work out the constructive programme of Gandhiji while boycotting the legislatures.

- The Civil Disobedience Movement formed another landmark in the nationalist movement in Odisha.
- The 26th January 1930, was celebrated as the day of independence by the Congress men of Odisha and at Cuttack, Gopabandhu Choudhury read out the declaration of independence.
- On 12 April, 1930, the *Satyagrahis* led by Acharya Harihar, reached at lnchudi in Balasore.
- Large number of *Satyagrahis* from various parts of Odisha like Puri, Ganjam, Sarnbalpur and Baripada joined them. Despite the oppression by the police, the *Satyagrahis* manufactured the contraband salt at Inchudi on 14 April 1930.
- The Civil Disobedience was also carried on in other forms such as boycott of the foreign cloth, picketing before the excise shops, refusal to pay *Chowkidari* tax, and spread *of Khadi*.
- As an effect of the Gandhi-Irwin Pact on 5 March 1931, the Civil Disobedience movement was discontinued and Congress decided to participate in the second session of Round Table Conference at London.
- Thus, the nationalist movement in Odisha which was started with the establishment of Indian National Congress in 1885, ended with the attainment of independence of India on 15th August 1947.

4.2.7 Exercise

- **Write a note on nationalist movement in Odisha**
- **Give an account on the Non-cooperation movement in Odisha.**
- **Highlight the different programmes of Non-cooperation movement in Odisha.**
- **Make an analysis on the Civil Disobedience movement in Odisha.**

4.2.8. Further Reading

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UNIT-4
Chapter-III

Creation of separate province, Non-congress and Congress Ministries (1937-1947)

Structure

4.3.0. Objectives
4.3.1. Creation of Separate Province
4.3.1.1. The problems of the division of Odisha
4.3.1.2. Negligence Odia language
4.3.1.3. Failure of the Government to tackle natural calamities
4.3.1.4. Miserable economic life due to division
4.3.1.5. Beginning of Odia National Movement
4.3.1.6. Amalgamation of Sambalpur with Odisha division
4.3.1.7. Formation of Bihar-Odsha Province
4.3.1.8. Role of Utkal Sammilani
4.3.1.9. The Reforms of 1917
4.3.1.10. Sachchidanand Sinha Resolution of 1920
4.3.1.11. Philip-Duff Committee of 1924
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4.3.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Creation of separate province, Non-congress and Congress Ministries (1937-1947). After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the creation of separate province of Odisha*
- *understand the achievement of Congress ministries*
- *know about the rule of Non-Congress ministries of Odisha from 1937-47.*

4.3.1. Creation of Separate Province

The creation of separate province is a significant chapter in the history of modern Odisha. Odsha got disintegrated after 1568 into several regional kingdoms. The Bhois of Khurdha, the Bhanjas of Ghumsur and Myurbhanj and the Chauhans of Sambalpur gradually assumed political prominence. The sway of either the Mughals or the Marathas failed to restore the political unity of Odsha. Odsha was conquered by the East India Company in a gradual manner; first the southern part, then the coastal region and lastly Sambalpur and the adjoining tracts. It is on account of this piecemeal conquest that the British rule could not be imposed upon a united Odsha. For administration, its southern part was tagged with Madras Presidency, the coastal region with Bengal and the Western part with the Central Provinces. The Odia-speaking people were placed under three different administration as neglected, insignificant and minority groups. However, Odisha became a separate state on 1st April, 1936

4.3.1.1. The problems of the division of Odisha

The problems of such arbitrary division were many folds.

4.3.1.2. Negligence Odia language

Due to arbitrary division of Odisha, Odia language suffered from negligence. It was treated as the language of a minority people in all those three provinces. The chauvinism of the three dominant groups, viz., Bengali, Telugu and Hindi threatened the existence of Odias. Eminent Bengali scholars like Rajendralal Mitra and Kantilal Bandopadhyaya refused to recognise Odia as a distinct language. They pressed the Government to, 'make Bengali the medium of teaching and introduce Bengali textbooks in schools of Odsha. In Ganjam region Telugu was imposed on

Odia schools and in Central Province Hindi was made compulsory for the schools of Sambalpur tract.

4.3.1.3. Failure of the Government to tackle natural calamities

The disunion was responsible for the failure to tackle natural calamities like drought, famine and flood etc. because the three Governments could not take concerted measures simultaneously to deal with them. It was evident during the Great Famine of 1866 which took a heavy toll of lives and caused untold hardship to the surviving population. It led the Secretary of State for India, Strafford Northcote to admit in 1868 that reuniting the, Odia-speaking people would help to reduce the danger of neglect by the administrative divisions. In 1885, Henry Rickets, Commissioner of Oris sa division suggested uniting Sambalpur with Odsha Division on the ground of racial and cultural affinity with other parts of Odsha. H.G. Cooke, the Commissioner of Odsha, in the Annual Report of 1894-95 strongly advocated for inclusion of the Sambalpur tract in Odsha division.

4.3.1.4. Miserable economic life due to division

The economic life of the Odia-speaking people was in danger due to division. Their economic resources were divided among three divisions. The trade and commerce suffered a lot when the mouths of the Suvarnarekha and the Budhabalanga and the ports of Pipli and Chandbali were silted. There was no political will of the Government to solve the crises. All those became evident after the Famine of 1866.

4.3.1.5. Beginning of Odia National Movement

The Odia Movement started after the Famine of 1866 with the tacit or open support of some British officials. The spread of education, the language crisis, the vernacular press, the associations and last but not the least, leading personages like Madhusudan Das, Gauri Shankar Ray, Fakir Mohan Senapati and Radhanath Ray etc. substantially contributed to the awakening of political consciousness of the Odia-speaking people. In 1875, Raja Shyamanand De of Balasore and in 1885, Madhusadan Das at Cuttack presented memoranda to Government for reunion of the scattered Odia-speaking territories.

The latter further drew the attention of the Lt. Governor of Bengal to the many fold problems of the people remaining under different Governments. In 1902, Raja Baikuntha Nath De of Balasore also submitted a memorial to Viceroy Lord Curzon demanding the reunion. The memorial was given a wide publicity in the vernacular press. Madhusudan Das called on the

Viceroy at Simla in 1900 to discuss the issue. In the meantime, the people of Ganjam sent a largely signed memorial to the Viceroy. All those impressed Curzon and he became sympathetic to the cause of the Odia speaking people.

4.3.1.6. Amalgamation of Sambalpur with Odisha division

Sambalpur and the adjacent Feudatory States, included in Central Provinces in 1862 for administrative convenience, were shown as a part of 'Natural Odsha' in Grierson's survey and as 'Odia country' in Government Records. The C.P. Government found it difficult to administer as the Hindi-speaking officers were reluctant to be transferred to Sambalpur and the Odia-speaking officers similarly refused to go on transfer to Hindi-speaking area. Language became the barrier between the officials of one language and the people of another. So the Chief Commissioner of Nagpur issued Notification No. 227 on 15, January, 1895 replacing Odia by Hindi as the Language of the offices, courts and schools. It was made effective from 1 January 1896.

There was sharp reaction from the Odias against the Notification as it would deprive them of Government employment, force their children to learn Hindi and, more importantly, threaten the Odia language and culture. The press joined the people. The 'Sambalpur Hitaisini', the 'Statesman' of Calcutta vehemently protested against the order as unjust. Dharanidhar Mishra memorialized Viceroy Elgin against it. Madhusadan Das reasoned with the Viceroy to restore Odia language. He also met the members of the British Parliament in that regard in 1897. Many illustrious sons of Sambalpur, namely, Braja Mohan Patnaik, Balabhadra supkar, Mahant Bihari Das, Madan Mohan Mishra etc. also rose against the Government order. A memorial was presented to Viceroy Curzon in 1900. It suited the Viceroy's interests when the memoirialists of Sambalpur wanted inclusion of Sambalpur tract with Odsha Division of Bengal. He was planning for a territorial reorganistion of provinces like the Partition of Bengal. Curzon directed the contemporary Chief Commissioner of Nagpur Andrew Fraser to conduct an enquiry. Fraser recommended for inclusion of Sambalpur with Odsha and restoration of Odia as the official language after the enquiry. Curzon took opportunity of Fraser's report and proceeded to fix up boundaries of provinces. He sent his scheme to H.H. Risley, the Home Secretary of Govt. of India. A circular, famous as Risley circular, was issued restoring Odia as official language in Sambalpur and the adjacent Feudatory States and transferring them to Odsha Division in 1905.

4.3.1.7. Formation of Bihar-Odsha Province

The revocation of the Partition of Bengal and the union of Sambalpur tract into Bengal province made it too big in size. Lord Hardinge, the Viceroy suggested the separation of the Hindi and the Odia areas from Bengal. The Odsha Division was added to Bihar and Bihar-Odsha Province was created in 1912, while Ganjam and Vizianagaram Agency remained under Madras. The Odias resented 'the birth of the twins', Bihar and Odsha, in which the Biharis would dominate. Curzon criticized the decision in the House of Lords but Government of India turned a deaf year to all protests.

4.3.1.8. Role of Utkal Sammilani

During 1903-20 the Utkal Sammilani passed many resolutions of which amalgamation of Odia-speaking territories was the most important. However, it became very active with the emergence of Madhusudan Das. He was the moving and the dynamic spirit of the Conference. The creation of Bihar-Odsha province was described as a 'political earthquake' for the Odias. Madhusudan Das took up the matter with the Government.

4.3.1.9. The Reforms of 1917

The Reforms Committee of 1917 recommended provincial autonomy. It aroused enthusiasm among the Odia-speaking people in different parts to demand union in a province. The Utkal Union Conference sent a delegation consisting of Madhusudan Das, Gopabandhu Das, Rajendra Narayan Bhanja Deb and Harihar Panda etc. They presented a memorial in a book-form named 'Odia Movement' to Montague to unite all the Odia-speaking tracts into a province. Montague was not happy about the creation of Bihar-Odsha province. The Committee considered it as 'an artificial unit' and recommended for a sub-province for Odia-speaking people. The sub-province idea raised great hopes among the Odia-speaking people. However, the provision of a 'process of consent' by all concerned Councils i.e. of Madras, C.P., Bengal and Bihar-Odsha made it difficult to be achieved. The Odias were frustrated and their hope was shattered. The Age of the Moderates represented by Madhusudan Das was over and a group of young nationalists took over the leadership of Utkal Union Conference. A new age came in the political life of Odsha since 1920.

4.3.1.10. Sachchidanand Sinha Resolution of 1920

A resolution was moved by Sachchidanand Sihna in the Imperial Legislative Council on 20th Feb. 1920 recommending Govt. of India "to formulate a scheme for the amalgamation of Odia-speaking tracts". It became famous as Sinha Resolution. The Provincial Governments submitted

their views against the proposal. C.P. conceded the transfer of Khariar zamindari only. Bihar-Odsha gave a favourable reply. Madras Government was too rigid to hand over Ganjam. The Odia members moved a resolution in Madras Council to discuss the issue. Sasibhusan Rath, the editor of the Asha, organized public meetings at Berhampur to mobilise public opinion. Finally, Government of India persuaded Government of Madras to appoint a committee in Dec. 1924 known as Philip-Duff committee to examine the issue.

4.3.1.11. Philip-Duff Committee of 1924

The Philip-Duff Committee after visiting several places and examining grievances of Odia - speaking people was convinced of a genuine, long-standing and deep-seated desire of Odias under Madras Government to come under one administration with other Odia-speaking people. The report, however, brought sharp reaction from Madras Government as defective and discriminatory. Further the Government threatened the claim of reimbursement for public utility works at Ganjam. The Government proposed the issue of redistribution of territories to be referred to the Royal Statutory Commission scheduled to visit India in 1928. Govt. of India shelved the issue for the time being in view of the gravity of the situation.

However, significant developments took place during 1927-29. The Bihar-Odsha Government was in favour of a separate province for Odias and deputed V.M. Sen., Registrar of Finance Department, to prepare revenue-expenditure Statement of Ganjam area. He reported that it would make an annual deficit of 11.5 lakhs rupees. The members of Legislative Assembly of India-Pandit Nilakantha Das and Bhubananand Das categorically demanded a separate province for Odias, despite the financial implications Alexander Muddiman, the Home Member, sympathized with them. Government of India's attitude was thus very favourable to the cause of the Odias.

4.3.1.12. Recommendation of Simon Commission

The Indian National Congress had boycotted Simon Commission in 1928. On the other hand, the members of Utkal Union Conference led by Raja of Kanika, gave a warm welcome to the Commission at Patna railway station. It greatly impressed Simon and he recommended for the appointment of a sub-committee under C.R. Atlee to probe into the problems of the Odia people. The sub-committee under C.R. Atlee consisted of Dr. A Suhrawardy, Raja of Kanika Rajendra Narayan Bhanja Dev and Laksmidhar Mohanty. The sub-committee was sympathetic to the cause of the Odias and accepted the justification of a separate province consisting of Odsha

Division, Angul, Khariar, Ganjam and the Agency tracts. Singhbhum, Phuljhar Padampur and Vizag Agency were excluded from amalgamation into the proposed province. The Simon Commission suggested to Government India to set up a Boundary Commission to demarcate the territorial extent of the Province. The Raja of Kanika, the finance member of Bihar-Odsha Govt. worked out a reduced deficit position. The Odia leaders agreed to bear the deficit.

4.3.1.13. O' Donnel Boundary Commission for separate province

In the Round Table Conference (1930), Krushna Chandra Gajapati, the Raja of Paralakhimedi made an impressive speech and presented a memorandum to the British Government in favour of a separate Odsha province. Accordingly the Boundary Commission was constituted with Samuel O' Donnel as chairman, H.M. Mehta-Member of the Council of States and T.R. Phukan-Member of the Central Legislative Assembly as members; and Raja of Parlakhimedi, S.N. Sinha and N. Raju as associate members representing the Odias, the Biharis and Telugus respectively. B.C. Mukherjee was the Secretary of the Commission and represented the Bengalis as well. The Commission examined several factors Like language, race, geography, administrative and financial implications, visited many places in Bengal, Bihar, Central Provinces and Odsha Division, heard evidence of 400 witnesses and went through the data and the relevant information of 1931 census. Finally they recommended for

a separate province which would include Odsha Division, Angul, Padampur, Khariar Estate, the greater part of Ganjam district and Vizagapatam Agency. The new province would have an area of 33,000 square miles and a population of 8,277,000. The Commission did not recommend for a High Court or a University; no new training centre or any cadre of All India Service would be opened as the new State would confront financial constraints. Further, the Commission urged upon the Govt. of India to overcome the deficit by allocation of new revenue or subvention.

4.3.1.14. Further hindrances

The path towards making the State of Odsha was not smooth. Government of Madras refused to hand over Parlakhimedi and Jeypur. Central province refused to hand over Khariar. The delegation of Raja of Parlakhimedi and Khallikote and others met the Secretary of State of India, Samuel Hoare to reconsider the boundary issue. When the Home Department published the White Paper on 18 March 1933, after the Third Round Table Conference, Parlakhimedi and Jaypore were beyond the territory of the new province. The matter was taken up by the Joint Select Committee under the chairmanship of Lord Linlinthgow. The Committee recommended

for the formation of Odsha Province consisting of Odsha Division, Angul, Padampur, Khariar, Odia- majority part of Ganjam including Berhampur, Jeypore, thirty percent of Parlakhimedi Estate including Parlakhimedi town and Maliahs of Parlakhimedi and Jalantra. As regards financial deficit, the Committee stated that it should be met by federal subvention. The path to the making of the new State was made clear.

4.3.1.15. Administrative Committee under Sir John Austin Hubback

The Government of India set up an administrative committee with Sir John Austin Hubback as the chairman and eight members including Madhusudan Das and V. Ramaswamy as Secretary to consider and make recommendations with regard to location of headquarters of the province, cost of accommodation of offices and officials and affiliation of Odsha in matters of High Court and University, cadre of officials and such like. The Report of the Committee was published on 20 December 1933. It recommended, that Cuttack should be the capital of the new province and Puri would be the summer headquarters, Odsha should have a High Court but no University, a joint official cadre with Bihar, a new district of Koraput, two new sub-divisions of Nawapara and Gunupur and, division of Angul into two parts-under collectors of Ganjam and Cuttack respectively.

4.3.1.16. The creation of Odisha

Thus, on the basis of Joint Select Committee's report, provision was made in the Government of India Act, 1935 for the creation of the new state of Odsha. According to His Majesty, the King Emperor's Order-in-Council, dated 3 March, 1936, the province was inaugurated on 1 April, 1936. The same day, Sir John Hubback took oath as the first Governor of Odsha. Though shortened the new province marked the end of the era of dismemberment, and beginning of the era of consolidation and achievements in future course of time.

4.3. 2. Non-Congress and Congress Ministries (1937-1947)

Election was held for the provincial assembly in January 1937, under the provision of provincial autonomy in the Government of India Act, 1935. Three parties - Congress, Odisha Nationalist Party and the United Party - fought the election. The Odisha Nationalist Party and the United Party represented the rajahs and zamindars and sought to safeguard their interests. Out of 56 elective seats (4 others being nominated seats), the Congress won 36 seats, the non-Congress parties won 10 seats, and independents won 10 seats. Even though the Congress won majority of

seats in the Assembly, there was difference of opinion as to whether the Congress would form ministry.

4.3.2.1. Ban of All-India Congress Committee

In a meeting of the Congress Legislature Party, held in March, 1937, Biswanath Das, a former member of the Madras Legislative Council was elected as the leader of the Congress Party in the Assembly. The All-India Congress Committee gave the directive to the Congress Legislature parties in all provinces including Odisha not to form the ministry unless the Government gave the assurance that the special powers of the Governor would not be exercised to override the decisions of the provincial ministries. In March 1937 the Governor invited Biswanath Das the leader of the Congress Legislature party, to form the ministry and be its head. But Biswanath Das refused to accept the invitation in pursuance of the direction of the All India Congress Committee.

4.3.2.2. Ministry under Maharaja of Parlakimedi

The Governor then invited the Maharaja of Parlakimedi to form the ministry. The Maharaja of Parlakimedi formed the ministry along with two others - Mandhata Gorachand Patnaik and Maulavi latifur Rahman on 1 April 1937. The ministry of the Maharaja of Parlakimedi was supported by a minority in the legislature; hence its formation was criticized as illegal and undemocratic in press and platform. The Governor clarified that in view of the refusal of the Congress to form ministry he had no other alternative than invite the leader of a minority party to form the ministry. The Governor further clarified that his offer to the Congress still stood valid. But the Congress members in the Assembly demanded the resignation of the Parlakimedi ministry and sent a petition to the Governor, expressing their lack of confidence in it. Even though the Congress had decided to seek election to the legislatures under the Provincial Autonomy, its political agitation was going on unabated. On 26 January 1937, in spite of the Government's ban order, in all important towns of Odisha the Independence day was celebrated.

4.3.2.3. Ministry under Biswanath Das

On that day at Puri and Satyabadi, the police seized the copies of independence pledges from the Congress offices. The deputy commissioner of police, Sambalpur banned a public

meeting on that day. On 1st April 1937, the Congressmen of Odisha denounced the Government of India Act, 1935 as anti-national and reactionary. They demanded a Constituent Assembly on the basis of adult suffrage to frame a democratic constitution. 13th April 1937 was observed as the 'Inchudi Day' to commemorate the Salt Satyagraha of Inchudi. In his speech of 21 June 1937 the Viceroy assured the Congress party that the Governors would exercise their powers according to the advice of the ministries. Thereafter, with the permission of the Congress Working Committee, the Odisha Congress legislature party decided to form ministry. The Maharaja of Parlakimedi resigned and the first Congress ministry in Odisha was formed with Biswanath Das as the Prime Minister on 19 July 1937. Besides the Prime Minister, the Ministry had two ministers- Nityananda Kanungo and Bodhram Dube, and four parliamentary secretaries - Jadumani Mangaraj, Jagannath Misra, Pyarisankar Roy and Radha Krushna Biswas Roy. Mukund Prasad Das and. Nanda Kishor Das were elected as the Speaker and Deputy Speaker respectively.

4.3.2.4. Peasant Unrest

In the meantime the Congress Socialist Party carried on its activities. It formulated a programme for promoting and safeguarding the interests of peasants. The programme included such demands as fifty per cent reduction of revenue, abolition ofzamindari system, amendment of the existing tenancy law to enable the peasants to become the proprietors of the soil, abolition of salt duty, and resumption of religious endowments. In April and May, 1937 a number of peasants' meetings were held in the Cuttack and Puri districts in which the demands of the peasants were voiced. The Cuttack District Peasants' Conference expressed its want of confidence in the Parlakimedi ministry.

The new ministry, after its formation, found itself faced with the problem of peasant unrest. The peasant movement had already been going on before the formation of the ministry. On 1 September 1937 All-India Peasants' Day was observed at Cuttack. About ten thousand peasants met the Prime Minister on this day and presented their demands. The Prime Minister promised that the demands of the peasants would be sympathetically considered. The peasants' unrest in the zamindary estates assumed such a militant character that the peasants refused to offer their new year's presents to the zamindars and created paddy fields in the jungles without taking the permission of the zamindars. The peasant agitation assumed a vigorous character in

the Kanika estate under the leadership of Chakradhar Behera, M.L.A. To safeguard the interest of the peasants, the Government contemplated certain changes in the Odisha Tenancy Act, Madras Estates Land Act, and Money Lenders Act. The peasants demanded the speedy execution of the proposed changes.

On the other hand the zamindars and land holders organised themselves to oppose the proposed changes. The raja of Purl, the raja of Khalikote and the raja of Kanika started an Odia weekly, entitled *Utkal Barta* to champion the cause of landlords. On 22 September, 1937, 300 Zamindars and landholders from various parts of Odisha assembled at Cuttack and voiced their resentment to the proposed amendments. But the peasants under the leadership of socialists carried on their movement with greater vigour. In January 1938 Surendra Nath Dwivedy, the Congress socialist leader brought out a journal, called *Krushak* to champion the cause of the peasants. In February 1938, no-tax campaign was started in some estates by the Congress workers and Kisan leaders.

Towards March 1938, the peasant unrest assumed serious proportions in Tirtol and Kujang. By April 1938, the peasant un rest had spread all over the province, and the Government had to think of serious measures for dealing with the peasant unrest The peasants refused to pay unauthorized taxes *to.* the zarnindars, and demand abolition of forced labour. Different political parties gave leadership to the peasants' agitation. The state of the' peasant unrest can be visualised from the following extract from the official weekly report of 8 May, 1938. There is no doubt that several prominent leaders of outwardly divergent political persuasions are pooling their energies with a view to create disaffection among the peasantry. During the week under report in Puri district alone there have been no less than eighteen political meetings. Harekrushna Mahatab, now a member of the All-India Congress Working Committee, has been on a prolonged tour of propaganda in the interiors of the district (he himself addressing 9 meetings), accompanied by prominent adherent's to the socialist creed. Undisguised reference to a future mass no-tax campaign in conjunction with a possible general strike on railways and in key industries with a view to crippling the administration and ultimately to drive the British out of India, clearly show the persistent preaching of Communist leaders elsewhere is now resulting in similar rhetoric in Odisha.

Every effort, it seems, is to be made to intensify this propaganda during the present non-agricultural season, when the peasantry are for the most part not actively occupied." The zamindars and landholders were seriously perplexed over the peasant unrest and opposed the Tenancy Amendment Bill. They once again met in January 1938 and asked the Government to curb the socialists' activities. Nevertheless, Odisha Tenancy (Amendment) Act and Odisha Money-lenders' Act were passed in 1938. The Tenancy Act sought to safeguard the peasants against the *zamindars'* oppression and illegal exactions, and the Moneylenders' Act lowered the rate of interest, charged by the moneylenders.

On 31 March 1938, the fourth annual session of the Gandhi Seva Sangh was held at Delang in the Puri district. It was attended by the prominent national leaders like Mahatma Gandhi, Sardar Vallabh Bhai Patel, Babu Rajendra Prasad, Babu Prafulla Chandra Ghose, Acharya J.B. *Kripalani,* Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, and Dr. Pattabhi *Sitaramayya.* On this *occasion Gandhi* expressed his deep love for Odisha and concern for the *miseries* of its peopte.

4.3.2.5. Constitutional Crisis

There was a constitutional crisis in Odisha in April 1938. At that time Sir John Hubback, the Governor of Odisha was granted leave and in his place the Revenue Commissioner J.R. *Dain* was nominated as the acting. Governor for the period of Hubback's leave, The Congress ministry found it derogatory to work under a subordinate official and threatened to resiqn but the crisis was averted by the cancellation of Hubback's leave.

4.3.2.6. Crisis in the U. P.C.C.

By 1939 internal differences within the Congress organization became quite serious and adversely affected the administration. There was a sharp difference between the Congress President and the Congress ministry. Nitaksntha Das, the president of the Utkal Pradesh Congress Committee publicly criticized the ministry and insisted that the ministry should remain under the control of the U.P.C.C. Protesting against this move of Nilakantha Das, H.K. Mahtab resigned from the U.P,C.C.

4.3.2.7. Resignation of Congress ministry in Odisha

The outbreak of the Second World War in Europe in September 1939 gave a new turn to the course of nationalist movement in India, The British Government in India declared war against Germany without consulting the provincial ministries. The Congress Party alleged that the British were dragging lndia into an unwanted war without consulting the Indians for the furtherance of their imperialistic interests. In October 1939, the All-*India* Congress Committee directed the Congress ministries in all provinces to resign in protest. On 4 November 1939, the Congress ministry resigned in Odisha. After the resignation of the Congress ministries, the Congress party decided to launch an anti-war movement.

The party asked the people not to co-operate with the Government in the war efforts. 1 March 1940 was celebrated as the Martyr's Day *in* Cuttack and Balasore. The Ramgarh session of the Indian National Congress, held in March 1940, gave a call to the Congressmen to launch Individual Civil Disobedience, work out with full vigour the Gandhian constructive 'programme and not to co-operate with the British Governrnent in any way in the war efforts. By April 1940, the Congress Party was actively engaged in preparation for the civil disobedience. The Congress volunteers were being trained atthe Bari training camp about the civil disobedience and the *Gandhian* constructive programme.

4.3.2.8. Split in the U.P.C.C.

In spite of all efforts to strengthen the Congress party and movement during the war, rift within the Odisha Congress assumed serious form during the Second World War. Nilakantha Das, the president of the Utkal Pradesh Congress Committee at the time of the outbreak of war, developed a critical attitude towards the Gandhian leadership. He declared Subhas Chandra Bose as the leader of masses, and supported the latter's demand for immediate agitation against the British. Enraged at this stand of Nilakantha Das, the president of the U.P.C.C., H. K. Mahatab and some other members of the U.P.C.C. brought a motion of no-confidence against Niiakantha Das in December 1939.

In the meantime, Jadumani Mangaraj and Dibakar Patnaik left the Congress organisation and asked the people to support Sub.has Chandra Bose and his Forward Bloc. Nilakantha Das resigned from Congress presidency and Radhakrushna Biswas Roy and Nabakrushna Chaudhury were elected as the president and secretary of the Utkal Pradesh Congress Committee

respectively. Nilakantha Das criticised the individual *Satyagraha*, launched by the Congress, as a selfish electioneerinq by a set of leaders who had lost the faith of the masses. On 27 January 1941, M. N. Roy, the Communist leader, visited Cuttack, and in a meeting held at Cuttack, he justified India's partlcipatlon in the war. Nilakantha Das supported M. N. Roy's view. At this stage the Odisha branch of All India Democratic Union was formed to carry on movement in favour of India's participation in the Second World War. Nilakantha Das, Godavarish Mishra and Raja of Khalikote became members of the All-India Democratic Union.

Towards July 1941, Nilakantha Das and Godavarish Mishra carried on active propaganda in favour of War efforts. The activities of Nilakantha Oas were very much disliked by the members of the Utkal Pradesh Congress Committee. The U.P.C.C. asked him to resign from the Central Legislative Assembly to which he had been elected on the ticket of the Congress party against whose leadership and policies he was then working. But as he refused to comply with the direction of the U.P.C.C., he was expelled from the Congress Party.

4.3.2.9. Formation of Coalition Ministry

By August 1940 the dissident Congress leader Godavarish Mishra had started a move (or the formation of a coalition ministry. On 24 November 1941 a coalition ministry was formed with the Maharaja of Parlakimedi as the Prime Minister and Godavarish Mishra and Maulavia Abdus Sobhan Khan as the ministers. This coalition ministry was supported by 26 members of the Legislative Assembly, which included some -dissident Congressmen. The coalition ministry remained in office for two and a half years, i.e. till 29 June, 1944. By acting contrary to the national mainstream, this ministry evoked criticism .in the nationalist circles. An important achievement of this ministry was the establishment of the Utkal University in November 1943.

4.3.2.10. Towards Independence

By the beginning of 1943, the political situation of Odisha became quiet. The end of the Second World War and the victory of the Labour Party in the post-war election of England almost made it certain that the British would give independence to India in near future. On 6 May 1944,

Gandhi was released from jail on the ground of ill health. After release he declared the cancellation of the mass civil disobedience resolution, adopted by the. Congress on 8 August 1942. In May 1945 the Congress leaders were released from jail for the purpose of holding discussion with the Viceroy Lord Wavel at Simla. The Simla talks ended in fiasco because of the adamant attitude of the Muslim League leader M.A Jinnah.

4.3.2.11. Fresh election for provincial assemblies

Thereafter, the British authorities decided to hold election for provincial assemblies, and constitute Constituent Assembly with the provincial assemblies as the electorate for the making of the future Constitution of India. In the election, held early in 1946, the Congress party secured majority of seats in the Odisha Legislative Assembly, and formed ministry under the Prime Ministership of Harekrushna Mahatab on 23 April 1946. The first popular act of the new ministry; was the release of an political prisoners. The new ministry took initiative for the merger of the Odisha princely states with Odisha. This ministry also made definite attempts to remove communal tension between the Hindus and Muslims of Odisha, as the Hindu-Muslim relation had become very bitter because of the communal riots in Bengal and Punjab. In the meantime the persons elected from Odisha to the Constituent Assembly were H.K. Mahtab, Bodhram Dube, Rajkrushna Bose, Santanu Kumar Das, Biswanath Das, Bhubanananda Das, Nandakishore Das, Malati Chaudhury, Laxminarayan Sahu.

4.3.3. Conclusion

Thus, the country attained independence on 15 August 1947, forthe country in general and Odisha in particular the vital problem of merger of princely states remained to be solved. Through the exertions of H.K. Mahatab, the new Prime Minister of Odisha and under the leadership of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel the merger of most of the princely states with Odisha was achieved by the end of 1947.

4.3.4. Summary

- The creation of separate province is a significant chapter in the history of modern Odisha.

- Odsha got disintegrated after 1568 into several regional kingdoms. The Bhois of Khurdha, the Bhanjas of Ghumsur and Myurbhanj and the Chauhans of Sambalpur gradually assumed political prominence.
- The sway of either the Mughals or the Marathas failed to restore the political unity of Odsha.
- Odsha was conquered by the East India Company in a gradual manner; first the southern part, then the coastal region and lastly Sambalpur and the adjoining tracts.
- For administration, its southern part was tagged with Madras Presidency, the coastal region with Bengal and the Western part with the Central Provinces.
- The Odia-speaking people were placed under three different administration as neglected, insignificant and minority groups.
- However, Odisha became a separate state on 1st April, 1936.
- A circular, famous as Risley circular, was issued restoring Odia as official language in Sambalpur and the adjacent Feudatory States and transferring them to Odsha Division in 1905.
- The Odsha Division was added to Bihar and Bihar-Odsha Province was created in 1912, while Ganjam and Vizianagaram Agency remained under Madras.
- During 1903-20 the Utkal Sammilani passed many resolutions of which amalgamation of Odia-speaking territories was the most important.
- The Reforms Committee of 1917 recommended provincial autonomy.
- A resolution was moved by Sachchidanand Sihna in the Imperial Legislative Council on 20th Feb. 1920 recommending Govt. of India "to formulate a scheme for the amalgamation of Odia-speaking tracts".
- The Philip-Duff Committee after visiting several places and examining grievances of Odia -speaking people was convinced of a genuine, long-standing and deep-seated desire of Odias under Madras Government to come under one administration with other Odia-speaking people.
- The Simon Commission suggested to Government India to set up a Boundary Commission to demarcate the territorial extent of the Province.

- Finally the Donnel Committee recommended for a separate province which would include Odsha Division, Angul, Padampur, Khariar Estate, the greater part of Ganjam district and Vizagapatam Agency.
- Thus, on the basis of Joint Select Committee's report, provision was made in the Government of India Act, 1935 for the creation of the new state of Odsha.
- According to His Majesty, the King Emperor's Order-in-Council, dated 3 March, 1936, the province was inaugurated on 1 April, 1936.
- Election was held for the provincial assembly in January 1937, under the provision of provincial autonomy in the Government of India Act, 1935.
- In March 1937 the Governor invited Biswanath Das the leader of the Congress Legislature party, to form the ministry and be its head.
- But Biswanath Das refused to accept the invitation in pursuance of the direction of the All India Congress Committee.
- The Governor then invited the Maharaja of Parlakimedi to form the ministry.
- The Maharaja of Parlakimedi resigned and the first Congress ministry in Odisha was formed with Biswanath Das as the Prime Minister on 19 July 1937. Besides the Prime Minister, the Ministry had two ministers- Nityananda Kanungo and Bodhram Dube.
- In October 1939, the All-*India* Congress Committee directed the Congress ministries in all provinces to resign in protest.
- On 4 November 1939, the Congress ministry resigned in Odisha.
- By August 1940 the dissident Congress leader Godavarish Mishra had started a move (or the formation of a coalition ministry.
- On 24 November 1941 a coalition ministry was formed with the Maharaja of Parlakimedi as the Prime Minister and Godavarish Mishra and Maulavia Abdus Sobhan Khan as the ministers.
- In the election, held early in 1946, the Congress party secured majority of seats in the Odisha Legislative Assembly, and formed ministry under the Prime Ministership of Harekrushna Mahatab on 23 April 1946.
- The first popular act of the new ministry; was the release of an political prisoners.

- Thus, the country attained independence on 15 August 1947, for the country in general and Odisha in particular the vital problem of merger of princely states which was achieved by H.K. Mahatab and Sardar Patel.

4.3.5. Exercise

Give an account on the creation of separate province of Odisha.

Make an analysis on the formation of Odisha as a separate province.

Write a note on the functions of the Non-Congress ministries.

Discuss the rule of Congress ministries from 1937 to 1947.

4.3.6. Further Reading

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UNIT-4
Chapter-IV

Quit India Movement

Structure

4.4.0. Objectives

4.4.1. The Quit India Movement in Odisha

4.4.1.1. Quit India movement in Koraput district

4.4.1.2. Role of Laxman Naik

4.4.1.3. In the Cuttack district

4.4.1.4. Quit India movement in Jajpur subdivision of Cuttack

4.4.1.5. Quit India movement in Balasore district

4.4.1.6. Violence at Khairadihi

4.4.1.7. Police oppression at Eram

4.4.2. Conclusion

4.4.3. Summary

4.4.4. Exercise

4.4.5. Further Reading

4.4.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss the Quit India Movement. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the Quit India Movement in Odisha*
- *understand the impact of Quit India Movement on Odisha*
- *know about the role of common men in the Quit India movement in Odisha*
- *evaluate the Quit India movement in different districts of Odisha*

4.4.1. The Quit India Movement in Odisha

The dragging of India into the war scenario of the World War II by the British Government and expected Japan's plan to capture India, forced Gandhiji to declare Quit India movement in India. On 8 August 1942, the AICC passed the Quit India Resolution at Bombay to cast a final blow against the British imperialism. This movement also known as August Revolution was the culmination of the Gandhian struggle for freedom in India and its manifestations in Odisha. But on the very next day all the Congress leaders from various parts of the nation were arrested. Among the leaders of Odisha, H. K. Mahtab was the only leader who was arrested at Bombay and sent to the Ahmadnagar fort jail. The British Government by its gazette notification Nos. 137 and 147 dated 9 August they declared all Congress institutions in the Province as unlawful. All the Congress offices in the province were seized by the Police by 10 August 1942. All the district level prominent Congress workers were arrested by the police. The 1arge scale arrest of the nationalist leaders in Odisha boomeranged in the form of mass fury.

The British Government's strategy to suppress the uprising through firm control of the urban centres went wrong. Leadership of the movement now devolved upon the younger generation of students. The situation seemed to be normal and quiet after these arrests. But within two weeks, cases of revolutionary activities were reported from the remote villages of Odisha where the police were not prepared to tackle the law and order problem. The students of

the Revenshaw College organized meetings, processions and supporting the call of Mahatma Gandhi boycotted the classes. As a mark of protest against the arrest of their leaders they resolved to break laws and turned violent, setting fire to Government offices and assaulting the officers. They even resorted to harmful activities like damaging the railway tracks and cutting of telegraph lines etc.

4.4.1.1. Quit India movement in Koraput district

Despite the absence of leaders, there were spontaneous popular outbursts in a number of places. The anti-war propaganda which had already been conducted by the Congressmen and Socialists and the suffering of the people caused by the war had prepared the ground for the spontaneous outburst of the masses, even among the hill tribes of the Koraput district. The Civil Disobedience assumed serious character towards the later part of August 1942. Thinking that the Government machinery had collapsed, the people defied the Government authorities in the distant villages of Odisha. Without having guidance of the leaders who were in jail, they indulged themselves in violent activities. They attacked the Government institutions like post-offices, revenue offices, P.W.D. bungalows and police stations and burnt some of them. In some places, the telegraph lines were cut-off.

The Quit India movement took the character of a mass revolt in the backward district of Koraput which was mostly *Adivasis* populated area. The *Adivasis* became so enraged against the British authorities that they threatened to pull down all Government institutions in the district. Looking at this, the British Government suppressed the movement by arresting the leaders.

Despite that the movement was started at Jeypore by two boys. These two boys, carrying Congress flags, preached the message of revolution on 13 August 1942. It was followed by *hartals* and campaigns for non-payment of taxes. The Congress workers organized big gatherings in various important places of the Koraput district and some workers were arrested on 16 August1942. On the very day a mob, consisting of 1,000 persons, invaded a *taluka* office. The violent mob was dispersed by the police with *lathi* charges. In the meantime the Congress workers started picketing before the excise shops, and shops having foreign articles.

4.4.1.2. Role of Laxman Naik

The violent mob burnt down some records at the Lakshmipur police-station. During the Quit India Movement the supreme heroism was exhibited in the Koraput district by Laxman Naik who was an ordinary illiterate four-anna member of the UPCC. With having leadership quality, he could mobilize public opinion in favour of the INC and against the British Government and its exploitation. In 1936 he was arrested for organizing no-tax campaign in the Mathili area of Koraput disrtict. He was also arrested twice and sentenced for nine months rigorous imprisonment for being involved in the Individual Civll Disobedience of 1940-41. On 31 July 1942, he had attended the meeting of Congress workers at Jeypore where instructions were issued to the Congress workers about the impending Quit India Movement.

Laxman Naik organized an army of 200 men, armed with saplings, cudgel and *lathis* to fight against the British Government. The followers of Laxman wearing *Khadar*, and carrying Congress flags and Gandhi's portrait, marched through the intense jungle, damaged the liquor shops and attacked the Mathili police station on 21 August 1942. The violent mob did not care for the caution of the police and assaulted them. By this attack some policemen were injured. The policemen started firing at the mob which resulted in killing four persons and injuring four others. In this incident Laxman Naik himself got injured. He was arrestedand sent to Berhampur jail where he was executed on 29 March 1943 on the basis of the false charge of killing the forest guard Ramaya. He was not only a revolutionary but also a constructive Congress worker. He had constructed a road, a bridge and a school in his locality with the help of his followers.

In the last week of August 1942, the condition in the Peppadahandi area of the Nawarangpur Taluk became grave. A violent mob of four to five thousand persons marched towards the Peppadahandi police station on 24th August 1942. The police asked the mob to go away. But the mob attacked the police at Peppadahandi police station. A subedar and a constable were injured. The police started firing in which 12 persons killed and 14 got injured and 3 died in the hospital.

4.4.1.3. In the Cuttack district

After the arrest of the leaders, the students of the Ravenshaw College and other educational institutions carried on the movement in the Cuttack district. About 200 students from

Ravenshaw College set fire to the office building on 15th August 1942. The police arrested two student leaders- Surajmal Saha and Bibhudendra Mishra and sent them to the Berhampur Jail. The UPCC workers pasted posters in various places, asking the Government officials to resign and the people to stop payment of taxes and carry on various revolutionary activities. Some prominent persons including the lawyers of the town organized meetings at Cuttack in which resolutions were passed condemning the repressive measures of the Government, demanding .the release of national leaders, etc. In some places the common men became violent and carried on revolutionary activities like arson and looting, etc.

4.4.1.4. Quit India movement in Jajpur subdivision of Cuttack

Maximum cases of revolutionary activities were reported in Jajpur subdivision of Cuttack district. The revolutionary mob at Jajpur set fire to the police uniforms in twenty six places, six canal revenue offices, four post-offices, five excisable articles, six zamindari Kutcheries, and four P.W.D. bungalows in August 1942. The violent mob started burning various Government offices and cut down the embankments, canals and telegraphs lines in different areas of Jajpur. In Binjharpur a violent mob attacked police persons when the latter were escorting some prisoners. The mob was dispersed after police firing. In some villages, young men formed defence associations for fighting against police oppressions in their areas. A mob of 10,000 in the Jajpur town proceeded towards the police station and S.D.O.'s office on 27th August 1942. The mob was dispersed by the armed force by dropping dynamites among the people.

4.4.1.5. Quit India movement in Balasore district

The police oppression was most severe in Balasore district. The Congress workers went to the remote villages to organize revolutionary activities among the people. The students left schools and colleges and went on strike at various places in Balasore. The Balasore Zilla School was closed; *hartals* were organized in a number of markets; picketing was carried on before the courts and Government offices in Balsore. The students distributed among the public a pamphlet asking them to follow Congress programme in the district. The Congress workers requested the people through the pamphlet to plunder salt stocks, to obstruct Government servants by not furnishing them with any information, not to allow any domestic servants to work in the houses of the Government servants, not to supply any boat, motor or other conveyance to the

Government servants, to compel merchants not to supply any food stuff to the Government servants, to close schools and colleges, to induce the Government servants to resign from their jobs, to disrupt communications, to observe *hartal* in factories and mills, to cut the telegraph lines and stop the communication of the postal papers and message and to break and loot the post-boxes, to form *Swaraj panchaycits* in the villages, to stop payment of taxes or assessments, to break laws by mass civil disobedience, to break forest laws and to persuade the Government servants to demand higher pay and wage.

In several places of the Balasore district clash took place between the police and the violent mob. A mob of about 5,000 armed men invaded the police station in the Bhandaripokhari village, injured the police officials, smashed the furniture and tore the records in the police station on 17 August 1942. The crowd also set fire to the post-office, dismantled a wooden bridge and cut the telegraph lines in different places. In order to penalize the people, the British Government imposed a collective fine of Rs. *6,0001-* upon the twelve surrounding villages in the affected area. The police also arrested two leaders for this uprising-Jagannath Das and Dwarakanath Das both of whom were Congress M.L.As of Balsore In a clash between the police and the mob, six persons were kllled and five persons got injured on 21st September 1942 at Dhamnagar.

4.4.1.6. Violence at Khairadihi

On 28th September 1942, another clash between the police and the people took place in the village Khairadihi, situated under the Khaira police station. As a result of the police firing two persons were killed and one got injured.

4.4.1.7. Police oppression at Eram

The Quit India movement became very intense at Eram in Basudevpur. The most ghastly act of the police oppression took place in this village. This place had become a strong centre of Congress activities in the district. On 28 September 1942, people gathered at an open place (*Melan Padia*) and resolved not to pay tax. So, the police came to the Eram village to arrest some leaders. On the arrival of the police the people started blowing the conch and about five thousand people armed with *lathis* gathered. The police asked the mob to disperse. But instead of dispersing, they attacked the police. The place where the people had gathered had a narrow exit

from the field. The D.S.P. closed the exit point and ordered firing in the evening. This resulted in 26 persons death and 54 persons got injured. But according to the unofficial estimate 35 persons were killed and 107 persons were injured. The Eram tragedy can be compared to the Jallianwallabagh massacre of the Punjab. Since that day Eram is famous as "Rakta Tirtha Eram". After the police oppression an underground organization was formed by the Congress Socialist leaders of Odisha to carry on the civil disobedience movement.

4.4.2. Conclusion

Thus, the Quit India Movement in Odisha was a mass-oriented and widespread movement. It got tremendous support in towns, villages, *Adivasi* areas and even princely states. It had assumed the character of a militant, and in many cases violent mass upsurge in certain areas such as Papadahandi and Mathili (Koraput district), Nimapada (Puri district), Bhandaripokhari, Dhamnagar, Khaira, and.Eram (Balasore district), and Kaipara (Cuttack district) etc. As the top Congress leaders had been arrested and jailed immediately after the passing of Quit India resolution, the masses took resort to their own style of violent assertion. The people made violent attacks on such symbols of colonial government as post offices, revenue offices, police stations, dak bung lows, and telephone lines etc. and attacked constable, chowkidars and peons who resisted these attacks. The Quit India Movement was not only anti-colonial but also anti-feudal. People attacked the kutcheries of zamindars like Kalkala, Darpan, Madhupur and Kanika and stole paddy from stores of paddy owners and burnt accounts of money-lenders in different areas of Odisha.

4.4.3. Summary

- The dragging of India into the war scenario of the World War II by the British Government and expected Japan's plan to capture India, forced Gandhiji to declare Quit India movement in India.
- On 8 August 1942, the AICC passed the Quit India Resolution at Bombay to cast a final blow against the British imperialism.
- This movement also known as August Revolution was the culmination of the Gandhian struggle for freedom in India and its manifestations in Odisha.

- But on the very next day all the Congress leaders from various parts of the nation were arrested.
- Among the leaders of Odisha, H. K. Mahtab was the only leader who was arrested at Bombay and sent to the Ahmadnagar fort jail.
- The British Government's strategy to suppress the uprising through firm control of the urban centres went wrong.
- Leadership of the movement now devolved upon the younger generation of students.
- The situation seemed to be normal and quiet after these arrests. But within two weeks, cases of revolutionary activities were reported from the remote villages of Odisha where the police were not prepared to tackle the law and order problem.
- The students of the Revenshaw College organized meetings, processions and supporting the call of Mahatma Gandhi boycotted the classes.
- As a mark of protest against the arrest of their leaders they resolved to break laws and turned violent, setting fire to Government offices and assaulting the officers.
- They even resorted to harmful activities like damaging the railway tracks and cutting of telegraph lines etc.
- The anti-war propaganda which had already been conducted by the Congressmen and Socialists and the suffering of the people caused by the war had prepared the ground for the spontaneous outburst of the masses, even among the hill tribes of the Koraput district.
- The violent mob burnt down some records at the Lakshmipur police-station. During the Quit India Movement the supreme heroism was exhibited in the Koraput district by Laxman Naik who was an ordinary illiterate four-anna member of the UPCC.
- After the arrest of the leaders, the students of the Ravenshaw College and other educational institutions carried on the movement in the Cuttack district.
- About 200 students from Ravenshaw College set fire to the office building on 15th August 1942.

- Maximum cases of revolutionary activities were reported in Jajpur subdivision of Cuttack district.
- The police oppression was most severe in Balasore district.
- On 28th September 1942, another clash between the police and the people took place in the village Khairadihi, situated under the Khaira police station.
- As a result of the police firing two persons were killed and one got injured.
- The Quit India movement became very intense at Eram in Basudevpur.
- Thus, the Quit India Movement in Odisha was a mass-oriented and widespread movement. It got tremendous support in towns, villages, *Adivasi* areas and even princely states

4.4.4. Exercise

- **Write a note on the Quit India Movement in Odisha.**
- **Highlight the Quit India Movement in different districts of Odisha.**
- **Make an analysis on the Quit India Movement in Koraput district of Odisha.**
- **Give an account on the Quit India Movement in Balasore and Jajpur districts of Odisha.**

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UNIT-4
Chapter-V

British relation with Princely States of Odisha and Prajamandal Movement and Merger of states

Structure

4.5.0. Objectives

4.5.1. British relation with Princely States of Odisha

4.5.1. 1. States of central Odisha

4.5.1. 2. States under Central Provinces

4.5.1. 3. Transferred states to Odisha division

4.5.1. 4. Features of British-Feudatory States relationship

4.5.1. 5. Indirect control by the British

4.5.1. 6. Policy of 'No-interference'

4.5.1. 7. Policy of laissez-faire

4.5.1. 8. Creation of office of the Superintendent of the Tributary Mahals

4.5.1. 9. Impact of the Revolt of 1857

4.5.1. 10. Results of the relation with feudatory states

4.5.1. 11. British relation with feudatory chiefs in 20th century

4.5.1. 12. Conclusion

4.5.2. The Prajamandal Movement and the Merger of Princely State in Odisha

4.5.2. 1. The Prajamandal Movement

4.5.2. 2. Appearance of Native states

4.5.2. 3. Causes of the Prajamandal Rebellion

4.5.2. 4. Economic Exploitation of the Garajat rulers

4.5.2. 5. Oppression of the Kings

4.5.2. 6. Frequent tax increase

4.5.2. 7. First Phase of the Prajamandal Movement

4.5.2. 8. Conference of the People of Garajat states of Odisha

4.5.2. 9. Prajamandal Movement in different places of Odisha

4.5.2. 10. Prajamandal movement at Nilgiri

4.5.2. 11. Dhenkanal Prajamandal movement

4.5.2. 12. Prajamandal movement in Talcher

4.5.2. 13. Gangapur

4.5.2. 14. Movement at Ranpur

4.5.2. 15. Nayagarh

4.5.2. 16. Bonai

4.5.2. 17. Sonepur

4.5.2. 18. Prajamandal in Mayurbhanj

4.5.2. 19. Other places

4.5.2. 20. Consequences of the Prajamandal movement

4.5.3. Merger of the Princely States of Odisha

4.5.3. 1. Beginning of the merger

4.5.3. 2. Prajamandal conference at Cuttack

4.5.3. 3. Merger of Nilgiri

4.5.3. 4. Political Development

4.5.3. 5. Cuttack Conference

4.5.3. 6. Merger of the Garajat States

4.5.3. 7. Rebellion in Sareikela Kharasuan

4.5.3. 8. Results of Garajat merger

4.5.4. Conclusion

4.5.5. Summary

4.5.6. Exercise

4.5.7. Further Reading

4.5.0. Objectives

This chapter will discuss the British relation with Princely States of Odisha and Prajamandal Movement and Merger of the states. After studying this lesson the students will be able to:

- *know the British relation with Princely States of Odisha*
- *understand the Prajamandal Moveme*
- *know about the Merger of the states* with Odisha

4.5.1. British relation with Princely States of Odisha

The Feudatory States also known as Native States or Princely States or Garhjat States or Tributary Mahals were twenty six in number by the time of the merger with the Province of Odisha in 1948-49. Those feudatory states divided into three groups were:

4.5.1. 1. States of central Odisha

There were nineteen States of central Odisha-Angul, Athgarh, Athmallik, Banki, Baudh, Baramba, Daspalla, Dhenkanal, Hindol, Khandapara Keonjhar, Mayurbhanj, Narasirnhapur, Nayagarh, Nilgiri, Pal Lahara, Talcher, Tigria and Ranapur. Two of them-Banki and Angul were annexed to British Odisha in 1840 and 1847 respectively.

4.5.1. 2. States under Central Provinces

There were five States under Central Provinces-Patna, Sonepur, Kalahandi, Bamanda and Rairakhoi were transferred to Odisha division in 1905.

4.5.1. 3. Transferred states to Odisha division

Two like States-Gangpur and Bonai were transferred to Odisha division from Chhotanagpur in 1905.

4.5.1. 4. Features of British-Feudatory States relationship

The British followed the following features towards the feudatory states.

4.5.1. 5. Indirect control by the British

Feudatory States were controlled indirectly in contrast to British Odisha which was under the direct administration of the British government. The British was the Paramount or Sovereign Authority and Feudatory States were subordinate allies to it.

4.5.1. 6. Policy of 'No-interference'

The British followed a policy of 'No-interference' in the internal affairs of the States. Regulation XII of 1805 exempted the nineteen States from implementing the administrative laws of British-

ruled territory of Odisha. The British tried to secure the good-will and co-operation of the States in the early phase of their rule.

4.5.1. 7. Policy of laissez-faire

The policy of laissez-faire changed towards 1813. The British insisted on loyalty of the Chiefs of States and maintenance of public peace and started interfering in internal matters as in the cases of Dhenkanal and Mayurbhanj.

4.5.1. 8. Creation of office of the Superintendent of the Tributary Mahals

A significant feature was the creation of the office of the Superintendent of the Tributary Mahals in 1814. His powers were defined in Regulation XI of 1816. The Chiefs were to administer civil and criminal justice in their respective states. Serious offences and those demanding capital punishment were to be referred to the Superintendent. He was empowered to dispose of cases of inheritance, succession and such other claims.The Judge-cum-Magistrate of Cuttack, Edward Impey, became the first Superintendent in 1814.

The creation of the office of Superintendent brought Garhjat States under closer British supervision, without any hostility with the Chiefs or the people of the hilly tract since non-interference in the state affairs continued as the British policy. The Commissioner of Odisha was appointed Superintendent of the Tributary Mahals in 1817 in place of the Judge-cum- Magistrate of Cuttack. Government interference were allowed to be made in 1821 only in cases of political nature like feuds among Chiefs, defiance or violation of loyalty to Govt. and oppression by the Chiefs. The Chiefs of Banki and Angul were imprisoned and the States were annexed to British Odisha on political grounds.

4.5.1. 9. Impact of the Revolt of 1857

The Great Indian Revolt of 1857 brought about a noticeable change in British Policy. The British Crown conferred Sanads on the Chiefs in 1862 granting them hereditary title of Raja and guaranteed them the right of adoption, The loyalty and co-operation of the Odishan Chiefs in the days of Great Revolt of 1857 made the Govt. adopt a conciliatory and friendly policy towards them. The Chiefs of "Mayurbhanj and Keonjhar were conferred the title of 'Maharaja' for their services during the period. Sir Richard Jemple, the Lt. Governor felicitated the Chiefs in a grand Durbar held at Cuttack in Nov. 1874. Relationship was re-defined and renewed moral

responsibility of the British Government for good governance in the States, interference in cases of oppression, violation of law and order, disputed succession and the like.

4.5.1. 10. Results of the relation with feudatory states

The relationship between the feudatory states and the British had brought the following results:

(a) The British power gained from such policies. The rulers of the States became loyal supporters of the British Raj. They vied with each other to gain favour of the Government officials. By virtue of the right of supervision of state administration, the Government could interfere in their administration as and when necessary.

(b) The Feudatory Chiefs in many cases were negligent and in some cases oppressive. They could continue, despite their maladministration, if they could manage to get the favour of the Paramount sovereign authority.

(c) Maladministration was almost chronic. As a result, discontent grew among the peasants who constituted the bulk of population. Disturbances and agrarian revolts broke out in many of the States such as in Baud, Athamallik, Keonghar and Nayagarh in the later half of 19th century.

4.5.1. 11. British relation with feudatory chiefs in 20th century

The growth of national consciousness became alarming for the British authority. They tried to maintain more cordial relationship with the Feudatory Chiefs. At the same time, they wanted that the princes should pay more attention to the welfare of the people. Two important steps were taken in that regard. The first was the appointment of Political Agent and the second was preparation of Feudatory States Manual. Sir Andrew Fraser, the Lt. Governor of Bengal strongly recommended for the appointment of the Political Agent for the Feudatory States of Odisha under the control of the Commissioner of Odisha. He should act as the friend, philosopher and guide of the rulers for effective administration. In 1906, L.C.B Cobden-Ramsay was appointed Political Agent for the Feudatory States of Odisha. The Sanads granted to the Feudatory States formed the basis of the Feudatory States Manual. It provided guidelines to the Chiefs. Their dignity as Valuable asset' was recognised. At the same time attempts were made to help the Chiefs to discharge their responsibilities. Its effects were far-reaching. While securing the good will and loyalty of the Chiefs and maintaining sound administration, it would curb the nationalist risings in the States. So far as States under direct administration of the British were concerned, the Political Agent acted as the Chief authority subject to the control of the Commissioner.

Many States faced a lot of troubles from the Praja Mandalas or State's People's Conference after 1920. The All-India Congress Party championed their cause to establish representative or democratic governments. The British Government also came to realise the changing conditions. Maladministration, popular discontentment and growth of consciousness were reflected in the Montague-Chelmsford Report as the present stir cannot be a matter of indifference to the princes. The British Government realised that the Feudatory Chiefs who were a pillar of strength to them could not survive if they failed to provide good administration. It was revealed from the statements of Lord Linlithgow, the Viceroy in 1939 and L.S. Amery, the Secretary of State for India in 1943.

4.5.1. 12. Conclusion

Thus, during the two decades preceding the Merger of the States in 1948 witnessed implementation of some reform measures and developments in administration, education and public works. Whereas in some States, oppression and suppression of the popular revolts continued unabated. The British Government could read the writing on the wall, in the fag-end of their rule, that the days of the Chiefs were numbered and they were rather lukewarm in their support to the Chiefs.

4.5.2. The Prajamandal Movement and the Merger of Princely State in Odisha

The princely states remained under the protection of British Government since its occupation in 1803. During the British rule, princes of the native states committed barbaric atrocities on their subjects. The British unhesitatingly supported the authority in these princely or native states. When torture and exploitation of the princes became intolerable, the subjects of these provinces revolted against the authorities. However, the princes, crushed these rebellions with traditional ferocity. When India became independent on 15 August 1947, the hitherto sovereign princely states of Odisha merged into the national mainstream largely through the efforts of Sardar Patel and Dr. Harekrushna Mahatab.

4.5.2. 1. The Prajamandal Movement

During the British rule, the princely or the native states of Odisha enjoyed sovereign power. Gradually, the kings of these areas became repressive. Exploitation and repression became a characteristic feature of all native states. The people were exploited through several means of taxation like 'Rasad', 'Magan', 'Bethi' and 'Begari'. Finally, when exploitation of the people became unbearable, they were captivated by a burning desire to revolt. Their accumulated hatred and anger against the ruling princes were manifested in the Prajamandal movement.

4.5.2. 2. Appearance of Native states

During the Gajapati rule in Odisha, the hereditary feudatory kings ruling in the hilly tracts of Odisha had been enjoying internal sovereignty of power since the days of the Mughals. But in the areas occupied by the Mughals known as the *Mughalbandi* kingdom, the Mughal administrative system was in operation. The kings of these mountainous states or the *'Garajat'* states paid taxes and homage to the Mughals. When the Maratthas occupied Odisha, the kings of these Garajat areas paid tribute to the Maratthas in exchange for retaining their internal sovereignty. The system was perpetuated when the British captured Odisha, that is the Garajat princes paid taxes to the British while retaining their sovereign internal power. In 1936 the new Odisha province was created and in the same year the Eastern States Agency was divided into three sections. In the Odisha State Agency, of the 26 Garajat regions under the Odisha division, 23 were retained in Odisha of the remaining 3, Mayurbhanj stayed in the Bengal Agency whereas Kalahandi and Patna were retained under the Chattisgarh Agency. In 1937, in accordance with the importance of these native states, they were divided into A, Band C sections. In the 'A' category were states like Dhenkanal, Keonjhar, Mayurbhanj, Bamanda, Boudh, Gangapur, Patna, Kalahandi, Sonepur, Sareikala and Nayagarh- a total of 11 states. To the 'B' category were included states like Athagarh, Baramba, Narsinghpur, Athamallik, Hmdol, Daspalla, Khandapara, Kharasuan, Rairakhol, Talcher, Bolangir, and Nilgiri a total of 12 states. The 'C' category comprised of Pallahara, Ranpur and Tigiria a total of 3 states. Prior to the Prajamandal movement the whole lot of these Garajat states paid taxes to the British and were loyal to them. In return the British allowed them to enjoy internal sovereignty.

4.5.2. 3. Causes of the Prajamandal Rebellion

The following causes were responsible for the rebellion in the Garjat states of Odisha:

4.5.2. 4. Economic Exploitation of the Garajat rulers

The kings of these Garajat states led a life of extreme luxury and pomp. Hence huge amount of money was essential to cater to their needs. All the amount was extracted by the king's officers from the people. The people's condition gradually became more and more miserable When their economic backbone was broken and they could endure no more, the people took to revolt against such atrocities.

4.5.2. 5. Oppression of the Kings

Apart from the regular taxes, the kings extracted money and services from the people through various dubious means. Among such taxes were *Bethi, Begari, Magana, Rasad, Bheti* and *Karasamagri.* 'Bethi' was applied for palace construction or garden beautification without paying any wages to the workers. To carry goods and domestic articles of royal officers from one place to another, free of cost, was known as 'Begari'. When there was either a wedding or a death in the royal family or even when the king purchased a new car, the people had to pay either in cash or in kind and this was known as 'Magana', When the king's officers toured village areas and put up camps at different places, their food and comforts were to be provided by the 'Praja' or the people and this was known as 'Rasad'. 'Bheti' was the gift which was bound to be offered by the people to the king when the king gave them audience. The king was to be provided with rice, pulses, cereals and ghee at half the market price and this was known as Karasamagri. The people had to endure such tyrannical whims of the king. In future, however, they became the means to incite the people to revolt and thus paved the way for the Prajamandal movement .

4.5.2. 6. Frequent tax increase

The other factor leading to the movement was frequent tax increase. Even after exploiting the people in various ways, the kings did not rescind from resorting to frequent tax increase. The people’s life became a burden to them and they were forced to raise revolt against the feudatory chiefs.

4.5.2. 7. First Phase of the Prajamandal Movement

Between 1908 and 1928, five peasant rebellions were witnessed in Bamanda. They resented the unjust tax increase. When a few leaders were imprisoned the rebellion subsided. In Dhenkanal a peoples rebellion broke out in 1922 under the leadership of Maheswar Subahu Singh, Purna Chandra Mohapatra and Benudhar Panda. Peoples movements were witnessed in Nilgiri in 1928, in Boudh in 1930 and in Talcher in 1932. All the rebellions were suppressed ruthlessly.

4.5.2. 8. Conference of the People of Garajat states of Odisha

To give a proper direction to the Prajamandal movement, for the first time on 20 June 1931, the 'Orissa Garajat state people's Association' was convened at Cuttack. Its first session was presided over by Bhubanananda Das. The conference gave a call to the subject people to establish their rights through rebellion. After this, on 23-24 June 1937, the second session of the conference was presided over by a senior leader of the Congress, Pattabhi Sitararnmayya. The conference adopted a resolution for the abolition of *Begari, Magana, Rasad, Bheti*. Hereafter, an enquiry committee was set up under Satish Chandra Bose, Balwantrai Mehta, Braja Sunder Das and Sarangadhar Das. The committee was sympathetic to the cause of the 'Prajas' and it supported their demands. This gave a new momentum to the Prajamandal movement.

4.5.2. 9. Prajamandal Movement in different places of Odisha

Odisha witnessed a number of Prajamandal movements in different parts of the state which are given bellow.

4.5.2. 10. Prajamandal movement at Nilgiri

The 1938 Prajamandal movement at Nilgiri is a very special event in the history of Odisha. Under the initiative of Harakrushna Mahtab and Sarangdhar Das a 'Prajamandal' as formed at Gariamal. Its president was Kailash Chandra Mohanty and the secretary was Banamali Das. On 11 July 1938, that is on the day of the Rath Yatra (car festival) they addressed a huge gathering and made pointed references to the misrule of the king. Their demands included the formulation of a new agricultural policy, to stop paying unjustified taxes and for evolving welfare administrative system. However, the people were advised to achieve their aims through non-violent means. By the king's order 120 people were arrested of whom 50 were fined Rs. 50 each and the rest were put in jail. When Banarnali Das was marching towards Machhuapatna leading 5000 people, to start peaceful satyagraha, the king sought help from the Odisha police. Finally, through the intervention of the Political Agent Major Bezelgate, Harekrushna Mahatab and the Balasore magistrate Sulaiman, the rebellion came to an end. The people's demands were conceded by the king to a very large degree.

4.5.2. 11. Dhenkanal Prajamandal movement

The 'Praja of Dhenkanal started a rebellion against the payment of Bethi, Magana, Rasad and Sunia Bheti. The objectives of the Prajamandal were printed in pamphlets were circulated among the people. On 13 September 1938 despite police warning while Harekrushna Mahatab, Naba Krushna Chowdhury and Sarangdhar Das addressed a mammoth rally of more than 50,000 men,

the state police and the British police resorted to lathi charge on the people. The Congress leadership nevertheless advised people not to get cowed down by such atrocities but to continue with the movement in a peaceful manner. Harmohan Patnaik was arrested and sent to Cuttack jail and houses of many of the Prajamandal leaders were burnt. A 12 year old boy Baji Rout was killed in police firing, but the people continued with the movement hoping to get justice. 29th October 1938 was celebrated as the *'Garajat Day'*. Finally in 1939, as per the report of the Central Police Bureau, the British government withdrew all powers of the king of Dhenkanal. The king's powers were now vested in the hands of Khan Bahadur A. K. Khan. *'Bethi'* was revoked, land tax was reduced from four *annas* to two *annas* and all arrested leaders were released.

4.5.2. 12. Prajamandal movement in Talcher

The Prajamandal movement in Talcher assumed dangerous proportions. Extremely hateful and inhuman treatment like severe caning, spitting and urinating in peoples' mouth, were meted out by the Talcher royal authorities. In 1939, under the leadership of the Talcher Prajamandal President Pabitra Mohan Pradhan, the people presented the king a petition of demands for stopping of such barbaric punishments and for the withdrawal of Magana, Rasad etc. The movement at Talcher was conducted by Krutibas Rath, Maguni Pradhan, Dasarathi Pani and others. The 'Prajas' or the people left Talcher and took refuge in the British ruled Anugul region. Many leaders of the Congress reached Anugul and the political agent Mr. Hessene and Harekrushna Mahatab signed a pact in 1939. This is famous as the Hessene-Mahatab Agreement. Gandhiji expressed his satisfaction over the agreement. The King had to accept most of the clauses of the agreement. Peace was restored at last and the people who fled Talcher returned home.

4.5.2. 13. Gangapur

The *Gangapur* Prajamandal movement too assumed a terrified character. Upon the death of the king, the queen took charge of the administration into her hands. The 'Praja' of Gangapur mostly belonged to the Munda tribe and their leader was Nirmal Munda. He protested against tax increase, but his efforts were futile. Hence he incited the people not to pay taxes. The queen requested the assistant political agent Lt. Megar to arrest him. While having discussions with the people, the police misinterpreted the peoples' language and their signs. It resulted in an

unprovoked firing by the British on innocent people and many were killed and injured. Many denounced the British for having resorted to such barbaric acts. But even then the Queen of Gangapur showed no sympathy to the people.

4.5.2. 14. Movement at Ranpur

The Ranpur Praarnandai movement was reflection of the all-Odisha peoples' or 'Praja' dissatisfaction against their rules. The people demanded an end to misrule and tyranny and inaugurate an era of benevolent administration on 27 December 1939. The king imprisoned the rebels but there was a tremendous uproar for freeing the people. The king became panicky a-id took shelter under the political agent Major Bezelgate. On 5 January 1939, a huge congregation moved towards the palace. Bezelgate too, moved with the police towards the palace. He was surounded by the people but he asked them to disperse and clear away from the path leading towards the palace. But the people paid no heed to his warning. Bezelgate opened fire and one 'praja' was killed in the firing. Suddenly the people became violent and Bezelgate was beaten mercilessly. Helpless, Bezelgate ran towards the house of a 'praja' to hide under a bullock cart. But under the direction of Raghunath Monanty and Dibakar Parida, he was dragged out and beaten severely. Bezelgate succumbed to his injuries. After this the British police started a ruthless repression and brought an end to the Ranpur Prajamandal movement. 26 people were tried. Raghunath Mohanty was hanged and Dibakar Parida was deported to the Andamans. Hereafter, the efforts of Harakrushna Mahatab and Professor N. G. Ranga were successful in finding a way to end the Prajamandal movements. The memories of the martyrs Raghu-Dibakar are still alive in the minds of Oriyas.

4.5.2. 15. Nayagarh

Prajamandala was constituted in Nayagarh in June 1938 under the leadership of Narayan Nanda. A' charter of demands was submitted to the ruling chief. It contained demands of civil liberties, abolition of feudal dues and people's participation in a responsible government. The Prajamandal resolved to launch an agitation and carry it on till their demands were fulfilled. The Raja arrested the leaders. The people gathered in front of the palace demanding release of their leaders on December 30, 1938. The Raja had to release them. He further promised to fulfil their demands. In the meantime, he had sought the assistance of the Political Agent Major Bazelgette. The Agent came to his help but before he could deal with the situation he had to leave Nayagarh for Ranapur where the situation was more serious.

4.5.2. 16. Bonai

At Bonaigarh, the Prajamandal was formed in 1938. The praja raised voice against Bethi etc. and demanded withdrawal of such obnoxious taxes. They submitted a representation to the king. The king considered these demands and withdrew Bethi. But for the purpose of construction of roads and government buildings, he levied small taxes on the people. The people however, held a meeting and decided to disobey the orders of the king.

4.5.2. 17. Sonepur

The Sonepur State Prajamandal was formed in December 1938 under the presidentship of Bhimsen Bhoi. Its demands were almost the same as in the case of other States abolition of feudal dues, responsible government and agrarian legislation. The State Government arrested two leaders, namely Loknath Satpathy and Mohan Mishra while they presented the charter of demands. Bhimsen Bhoi and a few others were arrested when they made Satyagraha for release of the two leaders. Prajamandal was banned Dolamani Das was expelled from the State, his property was confiscated. In March 1939, Sri Mohan Mishra, Laxman Satpathy and Pitambar Bhoi wanted to meet the Resident who was coming to Sonepur. They were arrested on the way. There were strong protests against the arrest. People were detained in large number, trials were made, imprisonment and fines were imposed. The activities of the Prajamandal slowed down during the World War- 11. However, during the Quit India Movement, Rama Chandra Satpathy, Laxman Satpathy, Mohan Mishra, Chaturbhuja Mishra, Satyananda Hota, Dhanabanta Mallik, Nandalal Sethi, Damodar Rath and Dasrathi Rath etc. were detained for more than two years. A salient feature of the time was the participation of students in the activities of Prajamandala. Narasingha Prasad Nanda, a student of Ravenshaw College and Duryodhan Satpathy, Suresh Mishra, Satyanarayan Mishra etc. of Sonepur High School formed a Students' Congress and organised a meeting under the Presidentship of Sri Laxman Satpathy. A mammoth meeting of Prajamandal was organised for three days in May 1946 at Bagchhera village under Sarangadhar Das. About forty thousand people participated in the meetings.

4.5.2. 18. Prajamandal in Mayurbhanj

In 1940, the Prajamandal was formed in Mayurbhanj. Sarat Chandra Das was its president. To denigrate the Prajamandal in the eyes of the people, the king formed a parallel government organisation known as the *Prajamangal* and started delivering assistance to the people. But the Prajamandal slowly and steadily pursued the movement in a non-violent manner. On 16

September 1947, it presented a charter of demands to the king Maharaja Pratap Chandra Bhanjadeo. The charter specifically demanded reforms in the administration. As a result, the king was forced to form a three-man cabinet which included Sarat Chandra Das. He became a constitutional monarch looking after the well being of the people. Though very late, the Mayurbhanj Prajamandal had achieved success beyond expectation.

4.5.2. 19. Other places

The Prajamandal movement was witnessed in other parts of Odisha also. Notable among them were Khandapara, Patna, and Kalahandi. The people had become quite conscious about their rights. Through the Prajamandal by non-violent means they were successful in presenting their view point to their respective kings. Many leaders of congress addressed the 'prajas' and greatly helped them in activating their movement. It resulted in making the Prajamandal movement in Odisha successful to a very large degree.

4.5.2. 20. Consequences of the Prajamandal movement

The results of the Prajamandal movement in Odisha were far-reaching.

- It was successful in putting forth the demands of the people in a very forceful way. Killing of Bezelgate made the fact brutally clear. Hence the kings became tolerant towards the people to a certain degree.
- In 1939 the Government of Odisha set up a State Enquiry Committee and came to know the reasons for the movement. It was evident that excessive oppression by the kings was the root cause of the movement.
- The people realised that non-violence was the most effective weapon they possessed and they had a firm conviction that it was through this their demands could be fulfilled. Finally, the Prajamandal movement was a catalyst in accelerating the process of merger of the 'garajat' or The native, princely states.
- The Prajamandal movement opened a new chapter in the history of Odisha. Tyrannised by the kings for generations, the people finally raised their voice against the institution of monarchy as a whole and were successful to a very large extent in achieving their deriands.
- The Congress too rendered assistance to the people in this democratic campaign. The Prajamandal movement sounded the death-knell of monarchy in Odisha.

4.5.3. Merger of the Princely States of Odisha

In the Post-war scenario elections were held for the Odisha Provincial Legislative Assembly in which the congress got a majority. Harekrushna Mahatab was appointed Prime Minister on 3rd April 1946. It was during that year the Cabinet Mission visited India and Mahatab gave assurance that he would place before it the issue of the merger of the 'garajat' states with the new Odisha province. After India's independence Nilgiri was the first Garajat state in Odisha from where sounds of revolt were heard. The authorities were forced to merge Nilgiri with the Odisha administration. Hereafter Iron man Sardar Patel and Harekrushna Mahatab made persistent effort to end the separate existence of the native princely states. These states were subsequently merged with Odisha.

4.5.3. 1. Beginning of the merger

In this connection, Harekrushna Mahatab took the initiative of merging all the native states with the Odisha administration by putting forth this demand before the Cabinet Mission. On 16 October 1947 he convened a meeting of all the kings of the princely states at Sambalpur. He tried to convince them that for maintenance of peace, discipline, law and order, it was extremely essential that all these native states should merge with Odisha. But this meeting did not yield very positive results. The kings of the native provinces put forth a counter arguement that yielding to Mahatab's demand implied their losing all privileges they had been enjoying for generations. They conveniently tried to overlook the implications of the Prajamandal movements in the recent past and tended to ignore the possibility of what shape it could take in future. For the time being, however, Mahatab felt thoroughly discouraged.

4.5.3. 2. Prajamandal conference at Cuttack

A conference of the Prajamandal was convened on the eve of independence on 10 August 1947. The people of Chhatisgarh and the other native states of Odisha participated in this meeting. In the context of India's attainment of independence, the role of this conference was significant. The people unequivocally expressed their desire to merge with Odisha and the proposal was formally accepted in this conference. But the decision of the people in this conference fell on deaf ears of the concerned kings of the native states. In future, however, the kings had to bear the consequences. The king of Patna Rajendra Narayan Singh Deo tried to foil Mahatab's efforts for the merger of the native states with Odisha. R. N. Singh Deo took the leadership in forming the *Eastern Zone Native States Association* comprising of the Garajat regions of Chhatisgarh and Odisha. It was inaugurated on 1 August 1947. This new body had its own police force and in

case there was any sign of disturbance in any native state its police force was prepared to crush it. Hence at this juncture any possibility of the merger of the Garajat states with Odisha seemed remote. This was a rude shock to Mahatab.

4.5.3. 3. Merger of Nilgiri

Immediately after the independence of India the situation in Nilgiri became very tense. The king of Nilgiri in order to strengthen his position tried to befriend the tribal people. He even directed the *adivasis* to fight against the non-adivasis with bows, arrows and spears and to burn and destroy their houses. By such actions the king believed he could terrorise the 'prajas' or people and compel them to seek his protection. He could then impose his will on them as he had been doing. But matters turned out contrary to his expectations. The people could see through the king's game and regrouped again to revolt against him. This was a rare opportunity for the then Prime Minister of Odisha Harekrushna Mahatab. He promptly dashed to Delhi and sought permission of the Home Minister Sardar Patel for the merger of Nilgiri with Odisha. The permission was granted immediately. On his return from Delhi on 14 November he despatched the Magistrate of Balasore and the Revenue Minister of Odisha, Naba Krushna Chowdhury with an armed police force to take over the administration of the Nilgiri state. The king of Nilgiri was undone and having no alternative surrendered the administration of his state to the Province of Odisha. Thus, taking advantage of the rapidly spreading discontent and the consequent misrule, Harekrushna Mahatab acted swiftly and with great alacrity to bring about the merger of Nilgiri with Odisha.

4.5.3. 4. Political Development

Hereafter on 20 November 1947, a meeting was arranged in the chamber of Mahatab, C. C. Desai, B.D.S. Bedi. They unanimously supported the merger of the Garajat states with Odisha. It was decided that in the near future, the kings of all the Gadajat states would be summoned together and advised for the merger of their respective states with Odisha. At Delhi, almost simultaneously, Sardar Patel proposed to break up the Eastern Region Native States Association (Purbanchal Desiya Rajya Sangha). This indeed was a shot in the arm for Harekrushna Mahatab. On his return he became active to give shape to the discussions held at Delhi.

4.5.3. 5. Cuttack Conference

On 24 December 1947, Mahatab convened a meeting at Cuttack for the purpose of the merger of the Garajat States. He personally had discussions with the kings of the A. B, and C categories Gadajat States. Initiating the discussions with the B & C category states, he later on invited the kings of the 'A' category states. While he advised the kings there was also a subtle note of warning that in independent India there was no scope left for the native princely states. Hence their merger with Odisha was not only essential, it was inevitable. Sardar Patel's proposals were opposed by the kings of the A category states. Before leaving Cuttack for Bhubaneswar, Sardar Patel again advised the kings that signing the agreement on merger of their respective states would demonstrate their sign of maturity. Sardar Patel was wise and he knew the art of diplomacy. He patiently waited at the Cuttack railway station for an hour. In the meanwhile V. P. Menon had returned after collecting the signatures of all the kings. The king of Mayurbhanj, however, put forth the argument that he had installed a constitutional government but later on it merged with Odisha. Hereafter the process of merger of the Garajat states with Odisha took a final shape.

4.5.3. 6. Merger of the Garajat States

The efforts of Sardar Patel, Harekrushna Mahatab and V. P. Menon had made possible the merger of the Garajat states with Odisha. On 23 December 1947, as per the 'Extra Provincial Jurisdiction Act,' the administration of the Garajat states was transferred to the hands of Government of Odisha. It became operational on 1 January 1948. However, it is to be borne in mind that when the Garajat states merger conference was summoned in Cuttack, the leaders of the Prajamandal movement were not invited. Apprehending trouble and confusion, Mahatab deliberately did not call them. After the merger of the Garajat states Mahatab appointed Kapileswar Nanda of Bolangir, Kailash Chandra Mohanty of Nilgiri and Pabitra Mohan Pradhan of Talcher as 'advisors' with the rank of Ministers. Indeed, largely through the efforts of Harekrushna Mahatab 24, A B, and C category Garajat states merged with Odisha. Mayurbhanj was the only Garajat state that merged with India on 16 October 1948 but in 1949 the central Government handed the state to the Government of Odisha. Tragically though, Sareikela and Kharasuna remained detached from Odisha forever.

4.5.3. 7. Rebellion in Sareikela Kharasuan

Though Mayurbhanj merged with Odisha, the twin Garajat states of Sareikela and Kharasuan were merged with Bihar. This resulted in the outbreak of rebellion in these two states. Brutal

force was used to crush the rebellion. For ever, these two states had to stay away from Odisha. The people's desire of merging with Odisha remained a distant dream due to Sardar Patel's policy of 'blood and iron'. He wanted these two states to remain in Bihar.

4.5.3. 8. Results of Garajat merger

The consequences of the merger of the Garajat states were many.

Primarily, by merging with Odisha, the kings and people the Garajat states could feel the sweet taste of independence.

Second, by becoming a part of democracy, the people and the kings of native states gradually got acquainted with a new form of government and its working' process.

Third, the fire of the accumulated anger of the people of these areas was finally extinguished after the total merger of the Garajat states with Odisha.

Finally, with the intervention of the Government of Odisha, the huge deposit of mineral resources in these Garajat area, were now beneficially utilised by the state.

4.5.4. Conclusion

Thus, a new chapter was opened in the history of Modern Odisha after the merger of the native princely states with Odisha. After being oppressed by monarchical tyranny for generations, the 'Prajas' or people could get happiness and independence. The barrier between the ruler and the ruled was broken forever into pieces. The merger of the Princely staes with Odisha became possible due to the earnest effort of Harekrushna Mahatab and the help provided by Sardar Patel and V.P. Menon from the Central Government of India.

4.5.5. Summary

- The Feudatory States also known as Native States or Princely States or Garhjat States or Tributary Mahals were twenty six in number by the time of the merger with the Province of Odisha in 1948-49.
- Feudatory States were controlled indirectly in contrast to British Odisha which was under the direct administration of the British government.
- The British followed a policy of 'No-interference' in the internal affairs of the States.
- The policy of laissez-faire changed towards 1813.
- A significant feature was the creation of the office of the Superintendent of the Tributary Mahals in 1814.
- The Great Indian Revolt of 1857 brought about a noticeable change in British Policy.

- The growth of national consciousness became alarming for the British authority. They tried to maintain more cordial relationship with the Feudatory Chiefs.
- Many States faced a lot of troubles from the Praja Mandalas or State's People's Conference after 1920.
- Thus, during the two decades preceding the Merger of the States in 1948 witnessed implementation of some reform measures and developments in administration, education and public works.
- When India became independent on 15 August 1947, the hitherto sovereign princely states of Odisha merged into the national mainstream largely through the efforts of Sardar Patel and Dr. Harekrushna Mahatab.
- The people were exploited through several means of taxation like 'Rasad', 'Magan', 'Bethi' and 'Begari'.
- Finally, when exploitation of the people became unbearable, they were captivated by a burning desire to revolt.
- Their accumulated hatred and anger against the ruling princes were manifested in the Prajamandal movement.
- To give a proper direction to the Prajamandal movement, for the first time on 20 June 1931, the 'Orissa Garajat state people's Association' was convened at Cuttack.
- Odisha witnessed a number of Prajamandal movements in different parts of the state.
- The 1938 Prajamandal movement at Nilgiri is a very special event in the history of Odisha.
- Under the initiative of Harakrushna Mahtab and Sarangdhar Das a 'Prajamandal' as formed at Gariamal.
- The 'Praja of Dhenkanal started a rebellion against the payment of Bethi, Magana, Rasad and Sunia Bheti.
- The objectives of the Prajamandal were printed in pamphlets were circulated among the people.
- The Prajamandal movement in Talcher assumed dangerous proportions.
- The *Gangapur* Prajamandal movement too assumed a terrified character.
- The Ranpur Praarnandai movement was reflection of the all-Odisha peoples' or 'Praja' dissatisfaction against their rules.

- Prajamandala was constituted in Nayagarh in June 1938 under the leadership of Narayan Nanda.
- At Bonaigarh, the Prajamandal was formed in 1938.
- The Sonepur State Prajamandal was formed in December 1938 under the presidentship of Bhimsen Bhoi.
- In 1940, the Prajamandal was formed in Mayurbhanj. Sarat Chandra Das was its president.
- To denigrate the Prajamandal in the eyes of the people, the king formed a parallel government organisation known as the *Prajamangal* and started delivering assistance to the people.
- The Prajamandal movement was witnessed in other parts of Odisha also. Notable among them were Khandapara, Patna, and Kalahandi.
- It was during that year the Cabinet Mission visited India and Mahatab gave assurance that he would place before it the issue of the merger of the 'garajat' states with the new Odisha province.
- . Hereafter Iron man Sardar Patel and Harekrushna Mahatab made persistent effort to end the separate existence of the native princely states. These states were subsequently merged with Odisha.
- A conference of the Prajamandal was convened on the eve of independence on 10 August 1947.
- Taking advantage of the rapidly spreading discontent and the consequent misrule, Harekrushna Mahatab acted swiftly and with great alacrity to bring about the merger of Nilgiri with Odisha.
- On 24 December 1947, Mahatab convened a meeting at Cuttack for the purpose of the merger of the Garajat States.
- The efforts of Sardar Patel, Harekrushna Mahatab and V. P. Menon had made possible the merger of the Garajat states with Odisha.
- On 23 December 1947, as per the 'Extra Provincial Jurisdiction Act,' the administration of the Garajat states was transferred to the hands of Government of Odisha. It became operational on 1 January 1948.
- Though Mayurbhanj merged with Odisha, the twin Garajat states of Sareikela and Kharasuan were merged with Bihar.

- Thus, a new era dawned in the history of Odisha after the merger of the native princely states with Odisha,

4.5.6. Exercise

- **Give an account on the British relation with the Princely States of Odisha.**
- **Write a note on the Prajamandal Movement in Odisha.**
- **Highlight the Prajamandal Movement in different parts of the state.**
- **Make an analysis on the Merger of Princely states with Odisha.**
- **Discuss the role of H.K. Mahatab in the merger of Princely states with Odisha.**

4.5.7. Further Reading

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N.B.: It is important to mention that the nomenclature of Orissa (now Odisha) has been sed several times. Actually, the name of Orissa was officially changed to Odisha and its

nguage from Oriya to Odia by the 113th Amendment Bill of the Constitution passed by both ouses of Parliament following Presidential assent to the Orissa (the Alteration of Name) Bill n 4 November 2011 (Friday) to the bill passed by Parliament and issuance of a gazette otification. The change of spelling was effected retrospectively from 1 November 2011.